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CLASS 10

CBSE

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPERS

CBSE · CLASS 10 · 2026-27
15
SAMPLE PAPERS

WITH CRISP NOTES, MIND MAPS & TOPPER'S ANSWER SHEETS

ENGLISH

LANGUAGE & LITERATURE

WITH CBSE SQP 2026-27 & BOARD PAPERS 2026, 2025 SOLVED

- 3 Official CBSE Papers Fully Solved
- 7 Solved + 5 Practice Papers
- 50% Competency Based Questions
- CBSE Topper's Answer Sheets
- Step-wise Marking Scheme
- Chapter-wise Crisp Notes & Mind Maps

AS PER LATEST
CBSE PATTERN 2026-27

BOARD EXAM 2027

15 Sample Papers + Chapter Notes

Most asked: Notes and a mind map for every chapter · 3 official CBSE papers · 7 solved · 5 unsolved · topper answer sheets · CBQ bank · latest pattern

1. Pattern, Mind Maps and Crisp Notes

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4. Unsolved Practice Papers

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Answer keys, Papers 11-15	409

Nitesh Bhaiya ki baat

Pehle notes se chapter revise karo, phir har paper 3 ghante ka clock laga ke solve karo. Marking scheme ke value points aur ½-mark splits dhyan se dekho. Last ke 5 papers full mock test ki tarah do.

EXAM PATTERN Board Exam 2026-27

Latest CBSE Pattern: English Language + Literature (184)

Most asked: Theory 80 marks (3 hours) + Internal Assessment 20 marks · 11 questions · 3 sections

1. Paper at a Glance

Section	What it tests	Marks
A. Reading Skills	Two unseen passages: comprehension, inference, vocabulary	20
B. Grammar & Writing	Grammar tasks + formal letter + analytical paragraph	20
C. Literature	First Flight + Footprints without Feet	40
Total (theory)	**Time: 3 hours**	**80**
Internal Assessment	Listening & Speaking (5) + other school-based components	20

2. Question-wise Blueprint

Q	Type	Choice	Marks
1	Discursive passage (400–450 words), 8 sub-parts (MCQ, T/F, analogy, fact/opinion, 2-mark inference)	None	10
2	Case-based factual passage with data/chart (200–250 words), 9 sub-parts; both passages together 600–700 words	None	10
3	Grammar: 12 tasks (gap filling, editing, transformation, reported speech)	Any 10 of 12	10

Q	Type	Choice	Marks
4	Formal letter (about 120 words)	1 of 2	5
5	Analytical paragraph on chart / table / cues (about 120 words)	1 of 2	5
6	Extract from prose / drama (First Flight)	1 of 2	5

Q	Type	Choice	Marks
7	Extract from poetry (First Flight)	1 of 2	5
8	Short answers, 40–50 words (First Flight)	4 of 5	4×3=12
9	Short answers, 40–50 words (Footprints)	2 of 3	2×3=6

Q	Type	Choice	Marks
10	Long answer, 100–120 words (First Flight)	1 of 2	6
11	Long answer, 100–120 words (Footprints)	1 of 2	6

3. Grammar Syllabus (Q3)

Topic	Typical board task
Tenses	Fill in the verb form in brackets (present perfect, past perfect, passive)
Modals	Choose must / might / should / could for the context
Subject-verb concord	Error-correction: *Neither… nor*, *Each of*, collective nouns

Topic	Typical board task
Determiners	*few / little / any / those / which* in notices and emails
Reported speech	Commands & requests, statements, questions: complete the sentence

4. Writing: How Marks are Given

Criterion (letter / paragraph)	Marks
Format (letter) / Organisation of ideas (paragraph)	1
Content: relevant points, data interpreted correctly	2
Organisation and coherence	1
Accuracy: grammar, spelling, punctuation	1

Exam Alert

- → Word limits matter: stay close to 40–50 words (3-markers) and 100–120 words (6-markers, letters, paragraphs).
- → In Q3 only 10 of the 12 tasks are required: pick the ten you are surest of and write the item numbers clearly.
- → Write question numbers exactly as printed (e.g. 1 (IV), 3 (VII)).

5. Literature Syllabus 2026-27

First Flight: Prose	First Flight: Poems
A Letter to God	Dust of Snow
Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom	Fire and Ice
Two Stories about Flying	A Tiger in the Zoo

First Flight: Prose	First Flight: Poems
From the Diary of Anne Frank	How to Tell Wild Animals
Glimpses of India	The Ball Poem
Mijbil the Otter	Amanda!

First Flight: Prose	First Flight: Poems
Madam Rides the Bus	The Trees
The Sermon at Benares	Fog
The Proposal (Play)	The Tale of Custard the Dragon

First Flight: Prose	First Flight: Poems
	For Anne Gregory

Footprints without Feet (Supplementary Reader)
A Triumph of Surgery · The Thief's Story · The Midnight Visitor
A Question of Trust · Footprints without Feet · The Making of a Scientist
The Necklace · Bholi · The Book That Saved the Earth

Not in syllabus (deleted)

The Hundred Dresses I & II, The Hack Driver and the poem Animals are **not** part of the current syllabus. Skip them while revising.

Board ka favourite tip

→ Literature answers mein character ka naam aur ek textual detail zaroor likho: examiner value points dhundhta hai.

→ Letter mein sender address, date, receiver address, subject, salutation, closing: format ke poore 1 mark yahin se aate hain.

→ Analytical paragraph mein highest, lowest aur ek clear comparison likhna mat bhoolo; apni opinion mat daalo.

6. Reading Section: Question Types and Strategy

Question type	How to crack it
Phrase / word meaning	Re-read the full sentence; replace the word with each option and check the sense.
Complete with one of two options	Locate the paragraph named in brackets; the answer is usually a paraphrase, not a copied line.
True / False	Watch for words like *only, always, primarily, rather than*: they often make a statement false.
Analogy (a : b :: c : d)	Find the relationship in the first pair (cause-effect, object-result) and match it exactly.
Fact / Opinion	Facts can be checked (numbers, events); opinions carry judgement words (*better, deeper, meaningful*).
Assertion-Reason	Judge each statement separately against the passage, then check whether the reason explains the assertion.

Question type	How to crack it
EXCEPT questions	Tick each option against the paragraph; the odd one out is either not mentioned or contradicts it.
2-mark inference	Give a claim + a reason from the passage (two clear value points of 1 mark each).
Suitable title	Name the central idea and link it to one key detail of the passage.

7. Literature Answer Framework

Answer	Structure that scores
Extract (1–2 marks)	Answer only what is asked; quote a word or phrase from the extract where it helps.
Short answer (3 marks, 40–50 words)	Direct answer (1) + textual evidence (1) + inference / significance (1).
Long answer (6 marks, 100–120 words)	Introduction linking to the text · 3–4 developed points with incidents · a concluding line that answers the question.

Answer	Structure that scores
Character sketch	Trait + incident as proof for each trait; end with what the character teaches.
Value-based / extrapolation	Connect the text to real life without leaving the story behind; mention the character by name.

Common mistakes that cost marks

→ Copying long lines from the passage instead of answering in your own words.

→ Wrong names or details from the chapter (e.g. confusing Lencho's letter amount: he asked God for 100 pesos and received 70).

→ Ignoring the internal choice and attempting both options: only the first attempted is evaluated, so decide before you write.

→ No paragraphing in long answers and letters; no subject line in a formal letter.

A Letter to God

Most asked: irony of the ending, the hailstorm as more than weather, why the postmaster signed "God"

Chapter at a glance

Author: G.L. Fuentes (Mexico) · **Genre:** short story with an ironic twist · **Setting:** a lone house on a low hill in a valley; the town post office · **Theme:** unshakeable faith, selfless kindness, irony, man vs nature

1. Summary in Points

1. Lencho's ripe corn field needs only rain. Rain comes; he calls the drops "new coins": big ones ten-cent pieces, little ones fives.
2. A strong wind brings huge hailstones ("frozen pearls"). In an hour the field is white "as if covered with salt"; the corn is destroyed. "A plague of locusts would have left more than this."
3. With a single hope, help from God, Lencho ("an ox of a man" who can write) asks God for **100 pesos** and posts the letter addressed "To God".
4. The fat, amiable postmaster laughs, then says "What faith!" To keep that faith alive he collects money from staff, friends and his own salary: only a little more than half. He signs it "God".
5. Lencho is not surprised, but angry on counting **70 pesos**. He asks God for the rest, not by mail, as "the post office employees are a bunch of crooks".

2. Themes and Characters

→ **Irony:** the helpers are called crooks; gratitude was expected, suspicion came.

→ **Two conflicts:** human vs nature (hail) and human vs human (Lencho vs post office).

→ **Message:** true kindness seeks no credit; faith without reason turns naive.

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Lencho	hard-working ("knew his fields intimately"), hopeful, firm faith, naive, ungrateful in effect
Postmaster	kind, generous, respects faith; gives part of his salary, feels "contentment"
Wife	hopeful, consoling: "no one dies of hunger"

3. Key Lines

→ "They are new coins." Rain = money from harvest; his hope.

→ "What faith! I wish I had the faith..." Turning point; admiration.

→ "...a bunch of crooks." Peak irony of the story.

Devices: metaphor ("new coins", "frozen pearls", "an ox of a man") · simile ("as if covered with salt") · hyperbole (locusts line) · situational irony (ending).

Word meanings: crest: hilltop · draped: covered · amiable: friendly · conscience: inner sense of right and wrong · contentment: satisfaction

Board ka favourite

→ Ending ki **irony** sabse zyada poocha gaya.

→ **Hailstorm** sirf weather nahi, faith ka test (SQP 2026-27).

→ Postmaster ne **"God"** sign kyon kiya: Lencho ka faith na toote.

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav How does the hailstorm work as more than a weather event?

Ans: destroys the crop (man vs nature) · turns "new coins" hope into despair · tests Lencho's faith · triggers the letter and the postmaster's kindness: it drives the plot.

Q2. 3M Board fav Why did the postmaster sign the letter "God"?

Ans: To keep Lencho's faith unshaken; he wanted no credit. Shows he was kind, humane and respected another's belief.

Q3. 6M Board fav "Blind faith can mislead." Discuss with reference to Lencho. (100-120 words)

Ans: faith gave hope after total loss · it moved the postmaster to charity · but Lencho never asked who sent the money · he blamed honest helpers as "crooks" · faith needs reason and gratitude.

Q4. 3M What is ironic about Lencho's second letter?

Ans: The postmaster and staff gave their own money; Lencho trusts God completely but calls the very people who helped him "a bunch of crooks". The helpers are suspected: the opposite of what we expect.

Q5. 1M The postmaster's act shows that true charity is ____ (done for recognition / done without expecting credit).

Ans: done without expecting credit

Exam Alert

Asked **100**, got **70 pesos** (not 50). Do not call Lencho greedy: he is naive, unquestioning.

Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom

Most asked: twin obligations, meaning of courage, freedom from boyhood to manhood, "the oppressor must be liberated"

Chapter at a glance

Author: Nelson Rolihlahla Mandela · **Genre:** extract from his autobiography · **Setting:** Union Buildings amphitheatre, Pretoria, South Africa; 10 May 1994 · **Theme:** freedom, courage, end of apartheid, forgiveness

1. Summary in Points

1. 10 May 1994: inauguration of South Africa's **first democratic, non-racial government**; the largest gathering of world leaders on South African soil. His daughter Zenani is with him.
2. Mr de Klerk is sworn in as second deputy president, Thabo Mbeki as first deputy president, then Mandela as the first Black President.
3. A fly-past of jets and helicopters shows the military's loyalty to democracy; generals who once would have arrested him salute him.
4. Two anthems are sung: whites sing "Nkosi Sikelel-iAfrika", blacks sing "Die Stem", the old anthem: a sign of unity.
5. Decades of oppression (racial domination since the early 1900s) produced heroes like Oliver Tambo, Walter Sisulu and Chief Luthuli; from them he learnt courage.
6. Every man has **twin obligations**: to family and to people/country. In South Africa a man who served his people was torn from his family.
7. Freedom: as a boy he felt free; as a young man he wanted to earn, marry, live lawfully; then saw his people were not free. He joined the ANC. "The oppressor must be liberated just as surely as the oppressed."

2. Themes and Mandela's Traits

- → **Freedom** is indivisible: no one is free while others are chained.
- → **Courage** is not the absence of fear but the triumph over it.
- → **Love** comes more naturally to the human heart than hate; hate is learnt.

Mandela: forgiving (wants the oppressor freed too), self-sacrificing (family given up for the nation), optimistic ("a glimmer of humanity" even in guards).

3. Key Lines

- → "Never, never and never again shall it be that this beautiful land will again experience the oppression of one by another." Pledge of the new nation.
- → "A man who takes away another man's freedom is a prisoner of hatred."

Word meanings: apartheid: racial segregation · emancipation: freedom from restrictions · confer: give · bedecked: decorated · transitory: temporary · resilience: ability to recover

Board ka favourite

- → **Twin obligations** aur unka conflict: har saal ka sawaal.
- → **Courage** ka matlab: fear pe jeet, fear ka na hona nahi.
- → **Freedom** ka concept: boyhood se manhood tak kaise badla.

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M · Board fav · What "twin obligations" does Mandela mention? Why could he not fulfil both?

Ans: obligations to family (parents, wife, children) and to people, community, country · under apartheid a man who served his people was punished, isolated and torn from his family · so serving the nation meant sacrificing family life.

Q2. 3M · Board fav · What does Mandela mean by "the oppressor must be liberated just as surely as the oppressed"?

Ans: the oppressor is a prisoner of hatred, prejudice and narrow-mindedness · both lose their humanity · true freedom means freeing both.

Q3. 6M · Board fav · How did Mandela's idea of freedom change from boyhood to manhood? (100–120 words)

Ans: boyhood: free to run, swim, roast mealies, ride bulls · student/young man: freedom to earn, marry, lead a lawful life · realisation that his people were not free; "freedom was an illusion" · hunger for his own freedom became hunger for the freedom of his people, then of all people, black and white · joined the ANC · conclusion: freedom is indivisible.

Exam Alert

Second deputy president = de Klerk; first deputy = Thabo Mbeki. Do not mix up the two anthems.

Two Stories about Flying

Most asked: fear overcome by hunger, role of the mother, the mystery of the black aeroplane, risk-taking

Chapter at a glance

Author: His First Flight: Liam O'Flaherty; The Black Aeroplane: Frederick Forsyth · **Genre:** short stories (realistic; mystery) · **Setting:** a cliff ledge by the sea; a night flight over France to England · **Theme:** fear, courage, faith, help in need

1. His First Flight: Summary

1. Alone on his ledge, the young seagull fears the vast sea below; his two brothers and sister have flown. Parents scold him, threaten to let him starve; the family taunts him. He has not eaten since the previous nightfall.
2. His mother flies to him with a piece of fish but halts just out of reach. Maddened by hunger he dives at it and falls into space.
3. Terror lasts a minute; his wings spread and he soars. His family flies around him, praising him.
4. Tired, he lands on the "green sea", sinks, then floats; his family offers him scraps of dog-fish. He has made his first flight.

2. The Black Aeroplane: Summary

1. At 1:30 a.m. the narrator flies his old Dakota (DS 088) from France to England, dreaming of holiday and a "good big English breakfast". Paris Control tells him to turn twelve degrees west.
2. Huge storm clouds, "like black mountains", appear. Low on fuel (on his last tank), he says "I'll take the risk" and flies in.
3. Inside, compass, radio and instruments go dead. A black aeroplane with no lights appears; its pilot waves "Follow me". With fuel for 5–10 minutes left, he follows it down to a runway; it vanishes.
4. The woman in the control centre says no other aeroplane was flying: his was the only one on the radar. The helper remains a mystery.

3. Themes and Characters

→ **Seagull story:** fear lives in the mind; hunger and the mother's tough love push the timid bird into confidence.

→ **Aeroplane story:** a daring, impulsive pilot is saved by unexplained help (angel, divine help or instinct): left open to the reader.

Key lines: "He felt certain that his wings would never support him": fear is in the mind · "I'll take the risk": impulsive daring

Word meanings: ledge: narrow shelf of a cliff · upbraiding: scolding · derisively: mockingly · preening: cleaning feathers · curveting: leaping · banking: flying with one wing higher

Board ka favourite

→ **Valli aur seagull** ka comparison (SQP 2026-27, 6 marks): dono ka transformation.
→ Mother ne fish paas laake **kyun roki**?
→ "**I'll take the risk**": risk kya tha, kyun liya?
→ Black aeroplane ka pilot **kaun tha**: apna reasoned view likho.

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav Why did the mother seagull halt with the fish just out of reach?

Ans: to make him lean out and dive; hunger would overcome fear · it was deliberate tough love to teach him to fly.

Q2. 3M Board fav What was the risk the pilot took? Why did he take it?

Ans: flying straight into the storm with little fuel instead of going back to Paris · he wanted to get home to his family and his breakfast.

Q3. 6M Board fav Compare the young seagull with Valli: how does each catalyst drive change? (100–120 words)

Ans: seagull: external push (hunger, mother's trick); fear overcome in a moment · Valli: inner curiosity and careful planning; saved fares for months · both gain confidence and a new view of the world · seagull is forced, Valli chooses · lesson: change comes from need or from will, but needs courage.

Q4. 1M No one in the control centre saw the black aeroplane because ____.

Ans: no other aeroplane was flying; his was the only one on the radar

Exam Alert

The seagull had **two brothers and a sister**. The Dakota's compass and radio failed **inside** the storm, not before it.

From the Diary of Anne Frank

Most asked: why Anne keeps a diary, Kitty, Mr Keesing's three essays, Anne's character

Chapter at a glance

Author: Anne Frank · **Genre:** diary (extract from The Diary of a Young Girl) · **Setting:** Amsterdam, Holland; 20 June 1942 (written in Dutch) · **Theme:** loneliness, need for a true friend, wit, teacher-student bond

1. Summary in Points

1. Writing a diary feels strange to 13-year-old Anne: she has never written before and thinks no one will care for a schoolgirl's musings. Yet "paper has more patience than people".
2. She has loving parents, a 16-year-old sister, about thirty friends, but no true friend to confide in. So the diary will be that friend: **Kitty**.
3. Sketch: born 12 June 1929 in Frankfurt; sister Margot (1926); family moved to Holland in 1933; Montessori school; Mrs Kuperus, headmistress, her sixth-form teacher; Grandma died January 1942.
4. **Mr Keesing**, the maths teacher, punishes her talking with essays: "A Chatterbox", then "An Incorrigible Chatterbox", then "Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox".
5. Essay 1: talking is a student's trait; her mother talks as much, and inherited traits cannot be cured. Essay 3: a poem (with friend Sanne) about a mother duck and a father swan who bit his three talkative ducklings to death.
6. Mr Keesing takes the joke well, reads the poem to classes and lets her talk.

2. Themes and Characters

→ **Loneliness:** a crowd of friends is not a true friend.
→ **Wit wins:** Anne turns punishment into humour.
→ **Good teaching:** a teacher who can laugh earns respect.

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Anne	talkative, witty, frank, introspective, sensitive ("Maybe it's my fault that we don't confide in each other")
Mr Keesing	strict but sporting; "old fogey"; laughs at her poem and stops the punishment
Father / Grandma	"most adorable father"; Grandma's candle lit at her 1942 birthday: love and memory

3. Key Lines

→ "Paper has more patience than people." A diary listens without judging.
→ "Teachers are the most unpredictable creatures on earth." Her frankness and humour.
→ "Mr Keesing was trying to play a joke on me... I'd make sure the joke was on him."

Word meanings: listless: without energy · confide: tell secrets privately · quaking in its boots: very nervous · old fogey: old-fashioned person · incorrigible: that cannot be corrected · ingenuity: inventiveness

Board ka favourite

→ Anne ne diary kyun likhi aur **Kitty** naam kyun diya.
→ **Teen essays** ka order yaad rakho.
→ Mr Keesing **unpredictable** kaise tha.

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav Why did Anne call her diary Kitty?
Ans: she had no true friend to confide in · wanted the diary to be that friend, not a record of bare facts · naming it made the friend feel real.

Q2. 3M Board fav How did Anne justify being a chatterbox?
Ans: talking is a student's trait · she would try to control it · her mother talked as much, if not more · inherited traits cannot be cured.

Q3. 6M Board fav How does Anne turn punishment into victory? What does this show about her? (100–120 words)
Ans: Mr Keesing assigned three essays for talking · first she argued convincingly (inherited trait) · third title was meant as a joke on her · with Sanne's help she wrote a witty poem on a father swan and ducklings · joke turned on the teacher; he read it to classes and let her talk · shows Anne as witty, confident, creative and good-humoured.

Exam Alert

Mr Keesing taught **maths**. Third essay title is exact: "Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox". The poem was written **with Sanne**.

GLIMPSES OF INDIA

Most asked: Goa's baker tradition, Coorg's people and adventures, legends of tea, purpose of each piece

Chapter at a glance

Author: A Baker from Goa: Lucio Rodrigues; Coorg: Lokesh Abrol; Tea from Assam: Arup Kumar Datta · **Genre:** travelogues / descriptive prose · **Setting:** Goa, Coorg (Karnataka), Assam · **Theme:** India's cultural and natural diversity

1. A Baker from Goa

1. Elders recall the Portuguese days and their loaves. The bakers (**pader**) still exist; the thud and jingle of the baker's bamboo still heralds his arrival.
2. He came twice a day; children ran to him for bread-bangles; elders bought loaves.
3. Bread is essential: bol for marriages, cakes and bolinhas for Christmas, sandwiches for a daughter's engagement.
4. Dress: **kabai**, a single-piece long frock to the knees; later shirt and trousers shorter than full length.
5. Monthly bills were recorded in pencil on a wall. Baking was profitable: the baker's family never starved; a "jackfruit-like" plump body was proof.

2. Coorg

1. Coorg (Kodagu), the smallest district of Karnataka, lies midway between Mysore and Mangalore: rainforests, spices, coffee.
2. Best season: September to March. People possibly of Greek (Alexander's army) or Arab descent; the **kuppia** resembles the kuffia of Arabs and Kurds.
3. Coorgis are brave and hospitable; the Coorg Regiment is highly decorated; General Cariappa, the first Indian Army Chief, was a Coorgi; Kodavus may carry firearms without a licence.
4. River Kaveri rises here; mahaseer fish; river rafting, canoeing, rock climbing, the Brahmagiri hills, Nisargadhama island, Tibetan monks of Bylakuppe.

Word meanings: pader: Goan baker · heralding: announcing · kabai: baker's long frock · martial: warlike · ascetic: one who lives a strict, simple life · flush: fresh growth of tea leaves

3. Tea from Assam

1. Pranjol (from Assam) and Rajvir travel by train to Assam; "over eighty crore cups of tea are drunk every day throughout the world".
2. Legends: a Chinese emperor's boiled water got tea leaves from burning twigs; **Bodhidharma** cut off his eyelids and ten tea plants grew from them.
3. Tea was drunk in China as far back as 2700 B.C.; it reached Europe in the 16th century as medicine. Assam has the largest concentration of plantations.
4. At Dhekiabari, managed by Pranjol's father, Rajvir knows the second-flush (sprouting) period, May to July, yields the best tea.

Board ka favourite

→ **Tea ke legends** kyun dale (SQP 2026-27): curiosity, cultural value, tea ka global history.
→ Baker ki **dress** aur **bread ka importance** occasions mein.
→ Coorg ke log: **martial, brave, hospitable.**

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav Why has the writer included the legends of tea's origin?

Ans: make the narrative lively and engaging · show tea's ancient, cross-cultural roots (China and India) · reveal Rajvir's curiosity and homework.

Q2. 3M Board fav How is bread an integral part of Goan life?

Ans: bol at marriages · cakes and bolinhas at Christmas · sandwiches at a daughter's engagement · the baker's daily visit is a tradition.

Q3. 6M Board fav "Glimpses of India" shows unity in diversity. Discuss. (100-120 words)

Ans: three regions: west coast, south, north-east · different food, dress, occupations: baking, coffee, tea · history: Portuguese, Greek/Arab, Chinese links · common thread: pride in tradition, hospitality, link with nature · conclusion: varied cultures form one India.

Exam Alert

Kodagu is the **smallest** district of Karnataka. Best tea: **second flush, May-July.** Kabai = frock, kuppia = Coorgi coat.

MIJBIL THE OTTER

Most asked: Mij in the box and on the plane, the air hostess, Mij's games, the Londoners' guesses

Chapter at a glance

Author: Gavin Maxwell (Scottish naturalist) · **Genre:** autobiographical animal narrative, light humour · **Setting:** Basra, Southern Iraq (1956) → flight via Paris → London · **Theme:** man-animal bond, an otter's intelligence, responsibility of a pet

1. Summary in Points

1. After his dog Jonnie died, Maxwell wanted an **otter**. In 1956 a friend told him otters were common in Iraq's **Tigris marshes**; at Basra **two Arabs** brought one in a sack: "Here is your otter..."
2. He named it **Mijbil**, a race new to science: *Lutrogale perspicillata maxwelli*, **Maxwell's otter**. Aloof at first, he soon went wild with joy in the bath, learnt to **turn on the tap**, dribbled a ball "like a four-footed soccer player" and rolled marbles on his belly.
3. The British airline would not fly animals, so they flew via **Paris**, Mij in a box **18 inches square**. Mij **tore its lining to shreds**, blood-spattered; Maxwell rushed to the airport holding the lid down.
4. The air hostess let Mij sit on his knee; he escaped, a woman screamed "A rat!", Maxwell's face landed in curry; the hostess calmly found Mij.
5. In London Mij invented a **ball game on a sloping suitcase lid** and ran along a school's low wall on every walk. Londoners guessed: baby seal, squirrel, walrus, hippo, beaver, bear cub, leopard, brontosaur.

2. Themes and Characters

- → **Animals are intelligent** and emotional: Mij plays, invents games, fears and loves.
- → **Responsibility:** a pet needs time, patience and special care (travel, water, toys).
- → **Humour:** the plane chaos and the Londoners' wild guesses.
- → **Title:** the otter is the hero; the whole account centres on Mij's nature, moods and antics, told with warmth.

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Mij	playful, intelligent, affectionate: turns on taps, invents games, nuzzles Maxwell
Maxwell	caring, patient, humorous: body-belt, bath, cleans the torn box
Air hostess	kind, calm: "the very queen of her kind"; lets Mij on his knee, finds him

3. Key Lines

- → "...a phase of my thraldom that has not yet ended." Maxwell became a willing slave of Mij's love.
- → "...like a ricochetting bullet." The car sped through Basra to the airport.
- → "Here, Mister — what is that supposed to be?" A labourer's question: the "highest score".

Word meanings: aloof: distant · apathy: lack of interest · appalling spectacle: shocking scene · conjectural: guessed · Mustellines: otter group (badger, mongoose, weasel, stoat, mink)

Board ka favourite

- → **Air hostess "queen of her kind"** kyun: kind, calm, helpful.
- → **Box + plane episode**: 6-marker ka favourite.
- → Species **"Maxwell's otter"** kyun: race science ke liye nayi thi.

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav Why does Maxwell call the air hostess "the very queen of her kind"?

Ans: She understood his problem, kept Mij's fish cool, let him keep Mij on his knee and calmly found the escaped otter with a charming smile: kind, patient and helpful.

Q2. 6M Board fav "Owning a pet is a big responsibility." Explain with reference to Mij. (100-120 words)

Ans: needs understanding, not only love · water, body-belt, toys, time · travel rules: airline refusal, box size · Mij suffered in the box: careless handling hurts · keep a pet only if ready for lifelong care.

Exam Alert

Flight went to **Paris** first, not direct to London. Mij tore the box **lining**, not the lid.
Spell: Mijbil, Camusfearna.

Madam Rides the Bus

Most asked: Valli's planning, why "madam", the dead cow, Valli's character, first brush with death

Chapter at a glance

Author: Vallikkannan (tr. from Tamil by K.S. Sundaram) · **Genre:** short story, coming of age · **Setting:** a South Indian village and the town six miles away · **Theme:** curiosity, self-respect, first encounter with death

1. Summary in Points

1. **Valliammai (Valli)**, 8, longed to ride the bus that passed her door every hour. By listening quietly she learnt: town **six miles** away, fare **30 paise one way**, trip **45 minutes**.
2. She saved **sixty paise**, resisting peppermints, toys and balloons, even at the village fair. Plan: slip out while her mother napped (1 to 4 pm) and take the **one o'clock bus** both ways.
3. The conductor teased her as "**madam**"; she replied "I'm not a child... I'm eight years old." She stood on the seat to look over the canvas blind: canal, palm trees, mountains, green fields.
4. She laughed at a **young cow** running ahead of the bus, and snubbed a nosy **elderly woman** with big ear-lobe holes and betel juice on her lips.
5. In town she stayed on the bus and refused the conductor's offer of a **cold drink**: "I don't have enough money."
6. Returning, she saw the **same cow lying dead**, hit by a fast vehicle; her joy died. Back at **3:40**, she slipped home; her mother and aunt never knew. Valli smiled to herself, keeping her secret.

2. Themes and Characters

→ **Curiosity and planning:** a child's careful saving and timetable.
→ **Self-respect:** pays her own fare, refuses favours from strangers.
→ **Growing up:** the dead cow is her first lesson that life is fragile.

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Valli	curious, determined, self-reliant, sensitive: saves 60 paise, "I'm not a child", grieves for the cow
Conductor	friendly, humorous, kind: calls her "madam", offers a drink
Elderly woman	nosy, talkative: questions a child travelling alone

3. Key Lines

→ "Proud! proud!" Slang Valli shouted at friends who boasted of the town.
→ "Better save some for tomorrow." Conductor teasing her laughter at the cow.
→ "...there wasn't much chance of that, was there?" Adults cannot read her secret.

Word meanings: stifled: suppressed · thriftily: spending carefully · haughtily: proudly · repulsive: causing dislike · spreadeagled: spread out · haunted: kept returning to mind

Board ka favourite

→ **Valli ki planning:** 6 miles, 30 paise one way, 60 paise saved.
→ **"Madam" kyun:** conductor ka mazaak uske grown-up airs pe.
→ **Dead cow** = maut se pehli mulaqat (6M).

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav Why does the conductor call Valli "madam"?

Ans: She behaved like a grown-up: paid her own fare, travelled alone, insisted she was not a child and refused help. He addressed her with playful, mock respect.

Q2. 3M Why did Valli not get off in town or accept the cold drink?

Ans: Money only for the return fare; had to be home before her mother woke; would not take favours from a stranger: self-respect.

Q3. 6M Board fav How did the dead cow change Valli's journey? (100–120 words)

Ans: the running cow first made her laugh · on return it lay dead, eyes fixed, blood all over · excitement died; no wish to look out · first encounter with death: life is uncertain · she returns quieter and wiser.

Q4. 2M Extract: "Better save some for tomorrow." Who says this, and why?

Ans: The conductor, teasing Valli for laughing till she cried at the running cow.

Exam Alert

Saved **60 paise** (30 + 30), not 30. The dead cow was the **same** one she laughed at.

The Sermon at Benares

Most asked: Kisa Gotami's two rounds of asking, the mustard seed, what she learnt, the Buddha's method

Chapter at a glance

Author: from Betty Renshaw's *Values and Voices* · **Genre:** sermon / religious prose in an old-fashioned style · **Setting:** Benares (Varanasi), on the Ganges · **Theme:** death is universal; grief brings no peace

1. Summary in Points

1. Prince **Siddhartha Gautama** (563–483 BC) married at 16. At about **25** he saw a sick man, an aged man, a funeral and a monk begging alms, and left to seek enlightenment.
2. After **seven years** of wandering he sat under a peepal tree; enlightened after **seven days**, he named it the **Bodhi Tree** and became the Buddha. He preached his first sermon at **Benares**.
3. **Kisa Gotami**'s only son died. She carried him to her neighbours asking for **medicine**; they said she had lost her senses. A man sent her to Sakyamuni, the Buddha.
4. The Buddha asked for a handful of **mustard seed** from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend.
5. Everyone offered seed, but every house had lost someone: "the living are few, but the dead are many". Watching the city lights flicker and go out, she realised: "How selfish am I in my grief! Death is common to all."
6. The Buddha's sermon: life is brief and painful; all mortals die, like ripe fruit falling or earthen pots breaking. Weeping brings no peace; the wise draw out "the arrow of lamentation".

2. Themes and Characters

→ **Death is universal** and inevitable; no one is spared.

→ **Grief is selfish** when it ignores the shared fate of all; acceptance gives peace.

→ **Teaching by experience:** the Buddha lets Kisa discover the truth herself.

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Kisa Gotami	grief-stricken, hopeful, then wise: seeks medicine, then accepts death
The Buddha	compassionate, wise teacher: mustard-seed task instead of a lecture

3. Key Lines

→ "...the living are few, but the dead are many." Every family knows loss.

→ "As ripe fruits are early in danger of falling..." Death can come any time.

→ "...draw out the arrow of lamentation." Let go of grief to find peace.

Word meanings: afflicted: suffering · desolation: deep sorrow · lamentation: expression of grief · mortals: those bound to die · procure: obtain · repaired: went

Board ka favourite

→ **Do baar ghar-ghar**: pehli baar medicine, doosri baar mustard seed.

→ Kisa ne kya samjha: **death common to all.**

→ Buddha ka tareeka: **khud anubhav** se seekhna.

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M · Board fav · What did Kisa Gotami ask for the first and the second time? Did she get it?

Ans: First: medicine to revive her dead son; no, as no medicine can cure death. Second: mustard seed from a house untouched by death; no, as every house had lost someone.

Q2. 3M · Why did Kisa understand only the second time?

Ans: Grief blinded her at first. The Buddha's task made her meet many grieving families, so she saw for herself that death is common to all.

Q3. 6M · Board fav · How did the Buddha make Kisa accept her loss? What does it teach us? (100–120 words)

Ans: did not preach; gave a practical task · every house had lost someone · lights flickering = lives ending · realised her grief was selfish · sermon: death is certain; weeping only adds pain · lesson: accept loss, find peace.

Q4. 1M · "Kisa Gotami *repaired* to the Buddha." "Repaired" means: (a) mended (b) went (c) prayed (d) returned

Ans: (b) went: an old-fashioned use.

Exam Alert

Seed was easy to get; a house **where no one had died** was not. Do not write "no one gave her seed".

THE PROPOSAL

Most asked: the quarrels over Oxen Meadows and the dogs, the characters, farce and the theme of marriage for property

Chapter at a glance

Author: Anton Chekhov (Russia) · **Genre:** one-act play, a farce (1888-89) · **Setting:** Chubukov's country house, 19th-century Russia · **Theme:** marriage for property, petty quarrels, satire

1. Summary in Points

1. **Ivan Vassilevitch Lomov** (35), a nervous, suspicious landowner with palpitations, comes in evening dress (dress-jacket, white gloves) to propose to **Natalya** (25). Her father **Chubukov** gladly agrees and calls her.
2. Lomov starts a long preamble and mentions "**my Oxen Meadows**". Natalya flares up: they are **ours**. The land is about five dessiatins, worth perhaps 300 roubles, but neither will give in.
3. Chubukov joins in; insults fly: Lomov calls him a "grabber"; Chubukov calls Lomov a "pettifogger" and his family drunkards. Lomov leaves, nearly fainting.
4. Chubukov reveals Lomov came to propose; Natalya wails "Bring him back!" Lomov returns.
5. A new quarrel: Lomov's dog **Guess** (bought from Mironov for **125 roubles**) versus Chubukov's **Squeezer** (85 roubles), "overshot" says Lomov. Lomov collapses.
6. Chubukov puts Natalya's hand in the dazed Lomov's; they are engaged, kiss, and at once argue again: "Better!" "Worse!" while Chubukov shouts "Champagne!"

2. Themes and Characters

- → **Marriage of convenience:** both families want to unite land and wealth, not love.
- → **Satire on the rich:** trivial quarrels over a meadow and dogs.
- → **Farce:** exaggeration, quick reversals, comic insults.

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Lomov	nervous, hypochondriac, quarrelsome: palpitations, "my foot's gone to sleep"
Natalya	sharp, stubborn, practical: fights for meadows, then begs "Bring him back!"
Chubukov	greedy, hypocritical: hugs Lomov, then insults him, then rushes the match

3. Key Lines

- → "I've always loved you, my angel, as if you were my own son." Chubukov's insincere sweetness.
- → "Oxen Meadows are ours, not yours!" The first quarrel begins.
- → "Well, that's a way to start your family bliss!" Irony: the quarrels will never end.

Word meanings: implore: request earnestly · malicious: spiteful · impudence: rudeness · intriguer: schemer · pettifogger: one who quarrels over trifles

Board ka favourite

- → **Do jhagde:** Oxen Meadows + Guess vs Squeezer.
- → Theme: **shaadi property ke liye**, pyaar ke liye nahi.
- → Character sketch: Lomov / Natalya / Chubukov (6M).

4. Likely Questions

Q1. 3M *Board fav* Why does Natalya change her attitude towards Lomov suddenly?

Ans: On learning that Lomov had come to propose, she realises at 25 that this is a good match; she wants him back at once, showing she is practical and keen to marry.

Q2. 3M What does the title "The Proposal" suggest? Is it apt?

Ans: It is about Lomov's marriage proposal, which is delayed by petty quarrels; the proposal finally happens but quarrels continue: apt and ironic.

Q3. 6M *Board fav* "The Proposal" is a satire on marriage among the rich. Discuss. (100-120 words)

Ans: marriage for land and wealth, not love · Chubukov happy to unite estates · trivial fights: meadows, dogs · characters selfish and quarrelsome · engagement followed by fresh fight · Chekhov mocks greed and pettiness through farce.

Q4. 2M What does "overshot" mean, and why does Lomov use it about Squeezer?

Ans: Upper jaw longer than the lower; Lomov says an overshot dog is a bad hunter, so Guess is better.

Exam Alert

Guess is **Lomov's** dog (125 roubles); Squeezer is **Chubukov's** (85 roubles). Lomov is 35, Natalya 25.

Dust of Snow

Most asked: How does a small incident change the poet's mood? Why a crow and a hemlock tree?

Poem at a glance

Poet: Robert Frost, American poet of rural New England · **Form:** 8-line lyric, 2 quatrains, one single sentence · **Rhyme scheme:** abab cdcd · **Tone:** reflective; gloom turns to cheer · **Theme:** small moments in nature heal a sad heart

1. Stanza-wise Explanation

1. **Stanza 1:** A crow on a hemlock tree shakes the branch and fine snow ("dust of snow") falls on the poet. The event is tiny and unplanned.
2. **Stanza 2:** The cold touch changes his mood. He had "rued" (regretted) the day; now the rest of it is "saved" and he feels fresh.

2. Central Idea

Nature heals. Even things linked with sorrow (a crow, a poisonous hemlock) can bring joy, and one positive moment can rescue a whole day. As Frost said, "a little thing touches a larger thing".

3. Symbols and Devices

Device	Example and effect
Symbolism	crow (ill omen), hemlock (poison, gloom) = sorrow; snow = joy, renewal
Metaphor	"dust of snow" = fine snowflakes
Alliteration	"saved some", "has ... heart"
Enjambment	one sentence across 8 lines, like one quick moment
Contrast	dark images produce a bright change of mood

Why not a nightingale or an oak? Frost avoids "beautiful" images to show that joy can come from unexpected, unpleasant sources.

Words: hemlock: poisonous tree with small white flowers · rued: held in regret · shook down: made to fall

Exam Alert

- → "Rued" = regretted, not "ruined".
- → The crow does not throw snow deliberately; it shakes the branch.
- → Hemlock is poisonous, not beautiful.

Board ka favourite

Mood change and its cause; why crow and hemlock; "momentary events, lasting impact" (paired with *The Ball Poem*, SQP 2026-27). **Tip:** "small incident, big change" wala contrast zaroor likho.

Extract Practice (CBSE pattern)

Has given my heart / A change of mood / And saved some part / Of a day I had rued.

Q1. 1M The poet's mood before the incident was one of
(a) excitement (b) anger (c) regret (d) boredom
Ans: (c)

Q2. 1M Complete: "saved some part" suggests that _____.
Ans: the rest of a day wasted in sorrow was redeemed

Q3. 1M Fill in ONE word: The rhyme scheme of the extract is _____.
Ans: cdcd

Q4. 2M How does the extract show the healing power of nature?
Ans: A tiny touch of snow lifts the poet's depression at once; nature refreshes the mind without any design.

Q5. 3M Board fav Why does Frost use a crow and a hemlock tree? (40-50 words)
Ans: Value points: both usually stand for gloom and death · yet they bring joy · contrast shows positivity can come from anywhere · our response decides our mood.

Q6. 6M Board fav (100-120 words) How do brief moments in "Dust of Snow" and "The Ball Poem" create a lasting impact?
Ans: Outline: snow lifts depression, lesson: small joys heal · lost ball teaches the "epistemology of loss" and responsibility · trivial events, deep inner change · conclusion: big lessons come through small experiences.

Fire and Ice

Most asked: What do "fire" and "ice" stand for? How will the world end, according to the poet?

Poem at a glance

Poet: Robert Frost · **Form:** one stanza of 9 lines, short lyric · **Rhyme scheme:** abaabcbcb (fire, ice, desire, fire; twice, hate, ice, great, suffice) · **Tone:** casual, ironic, understated · **Theme:** human desire and hatred can destroy the world

1. Explanation

1. **Lines 1–2:** People hold two views on how the world will end: in fire (the sun bursting, a burning earth) or in ice (the earth freezing).
2. **Lines 3–4:** From his experience of desire, the poet agrees with those who favour fire.
3. **Lines 5–9:** If the world had to perish twice, his knowledge of hate tells him that ice is "also great" for destruction and "would suffice".

2. Symbolism

Symbol	Stands for
Fire	desire, greed, lust, avarice, fury, conflict
Ice	hatred, coldness, indifference, rigidity, intolerance, insensitivity, cruelty

Frost turns a scientific debate into a moral one: the real danger is not nature but uncontrolled human emotions. Desire spreads fast like fire; hatred hardens slowly like ice.

3. Literary Devices

Device	Example and effect
Antithesis, anaphora	fire vs ice; "Some say" repeated in lines 1–2
Metaphor	"tasted of desire": desire as something tasted
Understatement	"Is also great / And would suffice": calm words for total destruction, creating irony
Enjambment	lines 6–9 run on as one cold thought

Rhyme and meaning: rhyme links fire with desire and ice with suffice; the short last lines land like a cold verdict.

Words: perish: die · suffice: be sufficient · favour: support

Exam Alert

- → Do not write that the poem is about science; fire and ice are symbols of emotions.
- → The poet does not choose only one; he says both are capable of destroying the world.

Board ka favourite

What fire and ice symbolise; how the rhyme scheme brings out the contrast; poet's message. **Tip:** symbols ko emotions se jodo: fire = desire, ice = hatred.

Extract Practice (CBSE pattern)

But if it had to perish twice, / I think I know enough of hate / To say that for destruction ice / Is also great / And would suffice.

Q1. 1M "Ice" in the extract symbolises
(a) winter (b) hatred and coldness (c) peace (d) greed
Ans: (b)

Q2. 1M Complete: The poet says "perish twice" to suggest that _____.
Ans: even if the world were destroyed once by desire, hatred alone could destroy it again

Q3. 1M Fill in ONE word: The tone of "would suffice" is _____.
Ans: ironic (or understated)

Q4. 2M How does the poet's experience shape his view?
Ans: He speaks from what he has "tasted of desire" and knows "of hate"; personal knowledge of these emotions makes him sure that both are destructive.

Q5. 3M Board fav What is the message of "Fire and Ice"? (40–50 words)
Ans: Value points: fire = desire, ice = hatred · both can end the world · desire is quick and consuming, hate is slow and cold · we must control these emotions to save humanity.

Q6. 6M Board fav (100–120 words) "The world is threatened more by human emotions than by natural disasters." Discuss with reference to the poem.
Ans: Outline: two theories of the end · Frost links them to desire and hate · today: greed causes wars and exploitation, hatred causes violence · solution: tolerance, contentment, empathy.

A Tiger in the Zoo

Most asked: Contrast the tiger in the zoo with the tiger in the wild. What is the poet's attitude to zoos?

Poem at a glance

Poet: Leslie Norris, Welsh poet · **Form:** 5 quatrains · **Rhyme scheme:** abcb, loosely (cage/rage, grass/pass, cars/stars) · **Tone:** sympathetic; quietly critical of captivity · **Theme:** freedom vs captivity; animals belong in the wild

1. Stanza-wise Explanation

1. **St. 1 (zoo):** He stalks the few steps of his cage in vivid stripes, on velvet pads, in "quiet rage".
2. **St. 2-3 (wild):** He "should be" lurking in shadow and long grass near the water hole where plump deer pass, or snarling at the jungle's edge, baring fangs and claws, terrorising the village.
3. **St. 4-5 (zoo):** Locked in a concrete cell, he ignores visitors; at night he hears patrolling cars and stares with brilliant eyes at the brilliant stars, longing for freedom.

Structure: zoo ⟶ jungle ⟶ zoo: there is no escape.

2. Zoo vs Wild

	In the zoo	In the wild
Place	cage, concrete cell, bars	shadow, long grass, water hole, jungle's edge
Actions	stalks, ignores visitors, stares at stars	lurks, slides, snarls, bares fangs, terrorises
Mood	quiet rage, helplessness	power, freedom, fearlessness

3. Literary Devices

Device	Example and effect
Oxymoron	"quiet rage": anger he cannot express
Metaphor	"pads of velvet": soft paws; "concrete cell" = prison
Alliteration	"sliding ... shadow", "baring ... bars"
Repetition	"brilliant eyes / brilliant stars": both bright, but out of reach
Anaphora, imagery	"He should be" opens stanzas 2 and 3; vivid visual images

Words: stalks: walks with slow, angry steps · lurking: waiting hidden · snarling: angry warning sound

Exam Alert

→ "Ignoring visitors" shows hopelessness and contempt, not friendliness.

→ Write the poet's view clearly: wild animals should live in their natural habitat.

Board ka favourite

Contrast of cage and jungle; meaning of "quiet rage"; are zoos justified? **Tip:** do column wali table (zoo vs wild) se answer likho, marks pakke.

Extract Practice (CBSE pattern)

He stalks in his vivid stripes / The few steps of his cage, / On pads of velvet quiet, / In his quiet rage.

Q1. 1M "The few steps of his cage" suggests that the cage is
(a) spacious (b) very small (c) comfortable
(d) temporary

Ans: (b)

Q2. 1M Complete: The phrase "quiet rage" is an example of _____.

Ans: oxymoron

Q3. 1M Fill in ONE word: "Pads of velvet" refers to the tiger's soft _____.

Ans: paws

Q4. 2M What does the word "stalks" reveal about the tiger's state of mind?

Ans: He walks slowly and angrily up and down, showing restlessness, frustration and suppressed anger at captivity.

Q5. 3M Board fav How does the poet contrast the tiger in the zoo with the tiger in the wild? (40-50 words)

Ans: Value points: zoo: small cage, concrete cell, quiet rage, ignoring visitors · wild: lurking, sliding, snarling, free and powerful · captivity crushes his natural strength.

Q6. 6M Board fav (100-120 words) Are zoos necessary? Answer with reference to the poem.

Ans: Outline: poem shows a caged tiger's helpless anger and longing (stars) · zoos deny freedom and natural behaviour · some role in conservation and education · better alternatives: national parks, sanctuaries, reserves · conclusion: animals belong in the wild.

How to Tell Wild Animals

Most asked: How does the poet use humour and poetic licence? How does one identify the Lion, Tiger, Bear and Crocodile?

Poem at a glance

Poet: Carolyn Wells, American humorist · **Form:** 6 stanzas of 6 lines · **Rhyme scheme:** ababcc · **Tone:** humorous, ironic, light-hearted · **Theme:** a comic "guide" to identifying wild animals that are deadly up close

1. The Six Animals

Animal	How to "tell" it (identification)
Asian Lion	a large tawny beast that roars at you "as you're dyin'"
Bengal Tiger	a noble beast with black stripes on a yellow ground; notice "if he eats you"
Leopard	hide peppered with spots; he "lept" on you and will "lep and lep again"
Bear	hugs you very, very hard; if in doubt "one more caress"
Hyena / Crocodile	hyenas come with merry smiles; if they weep, they are crocodiles
Chameleon	small, lizard-like, no ears, no wing; if you see nothing on the tree, it is the chameleon

The joke: each "rule" works only when it is too late, at the moment the animal attacks. The real advice is ironic: admire wild animals from a safe distance.

2. Literary Devices

Device	Example and effect
Poetic licence	"dyin'" rhymes with "lion"; "lept", "lep" fit rhythm; "A novice might nonplus" (correct: a novice might be nonplussed)
Irony / humour	"Just notice if he eats you"; "one more caress" for a deadly bear hug
Alliteration	"simple rule ... spots", "true tree"
Idiom	crocodile tears; laughing hyena; bear hug
Personification	hyenas "come with merry smiles"

Words: tawny: brownish-yellow · ground: background · discern: identify · hide: skin · caress: gentle touch · novice: beginner · nonplus: puzzle

Exam Alert

→ "Lept" and "lep" are deliberate misspellings (poetic licence), not errors; mention rhythm and humour.

→ The poem is a humorous poem, not a real guide.

Board ka favourite

Poetic licence examples; how to identify the lion and tiger; why is the poem humorous? **Tip:** "when it is too late" wala irony har answer me likho.

Extract Practice (CBSE pattern)

If strolling forth, a beast you view, / Whose hide with spots is peppered, / As soon as he has lept on you, / You'll know it is the Leopard. / 'Twill do no good to roar with pain, / He'll only lep and lep again.

Q1. 1M The words "lept" and "lep" are used (a) by mistake (b) for American spelling (c) as poetic licence for rhythm and humour (d) to show anger

Ans: (c)

Q2. 1M Complete: "Peppered" here means _____.

Ans: covered with spots

Q3. 1M Fill in ONE word: The rhyme scheme of the stanza is _____.

Ans: ababcc

Q4. 2M How does the last couplet create humour?

Ans: It says roaring in pain is useless because the leopard will only leap again; treating a fatal attack lightly creates dark humour.

Q5. 3M Board fav How does the poet suggest you identify the lion and the tiger? (40–50 words)

Ans: Value points: lion: large tawny beast roaring as you are dying · tiger: black stripes on yellow, notice if he eats you · identification comes only at the moment of death, hence ironic humour.

Q6. 6M Board fav (100–120 words) Poets take liberties with language to create humour. Discuss with reference to the poem.

Ans: Outline: poetic licence defined · dyin'/lion, lept/lep, "a novice might nonplus" · irony: caress, merry smiles, crocodile tears · ababcc rhyme and rhythm · conclusion: liberties make it funny and memorable.

The Ball Poem

Most asked: What is the "epistemology of loss"? Why does the poet not offer the boy money for a new ball?

Poem at a glance

Poet: John Berryman, American poet · **Form:** free verse, 18 lines, one stanza · **Rhyme scheme:** none (free verse) · **Tone:** sympathetic, reflective, philosophical · **Theme:** loss, responsibility and growing up

1. Explanation

1. **The loss:** A boy's ball goes merrily bouncing down the street and into the harbour water. The poet asks, "What is he to do?"
2. **The grief:** "An ultimate shaking grief" fixes the boy; he stands rigid, trembling, staring into the water where "all his young days" went: the ball held his childhood memories.
3. **No intrusion:** The poet will not intrude or offer a dime for a new ball; another ball is "worthless" because the boy must learn the lesson himself.
4. **The lesson:** He senses his "first responsibility in a world of possessions": things are lost, "no one buys a ball back", and "money is external".
5. **Epistemology of loss:** He learns what it means to lose something and "how to stand up", a lesson every man must learn one day.

2. Symbols and Devices

Device	Example and effect
Symbolism	ball = childhood, innocence, possessions; harbour/water = loss that cannot be reversed
Rhetorical question	"What is the boy now, who has lost his ball, / What, what is he to do?"
Repetition	"Merrily", "balls", "how to stand up": stresses joy lost and courage gained
Alliteration	"boy ... ball", "stands rigid ... staring"
Transferred epithet	"desperate eyes": the boy, not his eyes, is desperate
Enjambment	lines run on, like the ball rolling away

Words: intrude: enter where not welcome · a dime: ten cents (U.S.) · rigid: stiff · desperate: hopeless · epistemology: study of the nature of knowledge

Exam Alert

→ The poet is not unkind; he stays away so that the boy learns to cope himself.

→ "Money is external": money cannot replace memories or emotions.

Board ka favourite

Why the poet does not intrude; meaning of "epistemology of loss"; what the boy learns; pairing with *Dust of Snow* (SQP 2026-27). **Tip:** "responsibility + stand up" dono words answer me daalo.

Extract Practice (CBSE pattern)

I would not intrude on him; / A dime, another ball, is worthless. Now / He senses first responsibility / In a world of possessions.

Q1. 1M The poet does not offer the boy a new ball because
(a) he is miserly (b) the boy must learn to cope with loss (c) balls are costly (d) the boy is rude
Ans: (b)

Q2. 1M Complete: "A world of possessions" refers to _____.
Ans: a material world where things are bought, owned and lost

Q3. 1M Fill in ONE word: "Intrude" means to _____ where one is not welcome.
Ans: enter

Q4. 2M What is the "first responsibility" the boy senses?
Ans: To accept that possessions are lost and to bear the loss bravely; he must learn to stand up again on his own.

Q5. 3M Board fav What does the boy learn from the loss of his ball? (40-50 words)
Ans: Value points: losses are part of life · money cannot buy back what is lost or the memories attached · he must take responsibility and stand up · this is the "epistemology of loss", a step into maturity.

Q6. 6M Board fav (100-120 words) "Loss is a great teacher." Discuss with reference to "The Ball Poem".
Ans: Outline: the ball and the boy's grief · poet's refusal to intrude · lesson: money is external, nothing replaces memories · responsibility and resilience · link to life: failures and losses build maturity · conclusion: every man must learn "how to stand up".

AMANDA!

Most asked: Why stanzas are in brackets · Amanda's age and wishes · is she moody? · irony

Poem at a glance

Poet: Robin Klein (Australian children's writer)

Form: 7 three-line stanzas; 1, 3, 5, 7 = an elder's (mother's) orders; 2, 4, 6 (in brackets) = Amanda's daydreams

Rhyme: orders: none, each line ends in "Amanda!"; dreams: **aaa**

Tone: scolding (orders) vs dreamy, calm (dreams); ironic ending

1. Stanza-wise Explanation

1, 3, 5: Orders on posture, nails, homework, tidy room, shoes, chocolate, acne; "look at me when I'm speaking to you" shows Amanda is not listening.

2: She is a mermaid alone in a "languid, emerald sea": peace and solitude.

4: She is an orphan roaming the street, patterning dust with bare feet: "The silence is golden, the freedom is sweet."

6: She is Rapunzel in a "tranquil and rare" tower and will never let down her hair: no one may reach her.

7: "Stop that sulking... always so moody... Anyone would think that I nagged at you": the elder cannot see her own nagging (irony).

2. Central Idea

Constant nagging drives a child into a private dream world. Amanda is not moody; she longs for freedom. **Message:** guide children with patience and give them space.

3. Poetic Devices

Device	Example
Repetition, anaphora	"Amanda!" ending each order; "Don't bite... / Don't hunch..."
Metaphor	"emerald sea"; "The silence is golden"
Alliteration	"Stop that slouching and sit up straight"
Allusion	Rapunzel (fairy tale)
Irony	"Anyone would think that I nagged at you"

Word meanings

languid: slow, relaxed · **sole inhabitant**: only one living there · **hushed**: quiet · **tranquil**: calm · **sulking**: silent and bad-tempered

Board ka favourite

→ Why brackets? Stanzas 2, 4, 6 are Amanda's unspoken thoughts. Age: about 9 to 12 (homework, acne, fairy tales).

→ Tip: likho ki Amanda "moody" nahi hai, bas freedom chahti hai. Yahi key point hai.

4. Extract-based Practice

"(I am an orphan, roaming the street. / I pattern soft dust with my hushed, bare feet. / The silence is golden, the freedom is sweet.)"

Q1. 1M Complete: Amanda wishes to be an orphan because _____.

Ans: no one would then order her about; she wants freedom.

Q2. 1M "hushed, bare feet" appeals to the senses of (a) taste and smell (b) touch and sound (c) sight only (d) smell and sight

Ans: (b) touch and sound

5. Likely Questions

Q3. 3M Board fav Contrast the elder's world with Amanda's world. (40–50 words)

Ans: Orders: harsh, repetitive, no rhyme. Dreams: calm, rhyming, peaceful, solitary (sea, street, tower). She is mentally absent; control pushes her into fantasy.

Q4. 6M Board fav "Children need guidance, not constant correction." Discuss with reference to the poem. (100–120 words)

Ans: Parents mean well (health, discipline) · orders without reason or warmth · Amanda escapes as mermaid, orphan, Rapunzel = freedom, solitude · elder calls her moody (irony) · communication breaks · better: explain, listen, give space.

Exam Alert

→ Amanda is not really an orphan or a mermaid: these are imaginary roles.

→ Rhyme scheme aaa belongs only to the bracketed stanzas.

The Trees

Most asked: Where are the trees · treeless forest · moon described twice · silence in letters · symbolism

Poem at a glance

Poet: Adrienne Rich (USA, b. 1929), called a feminist and radical poet

Form: Free verse, 3 stanzas; no rhyme scheme.

Speaker: a woman inside the house, writing letters

Tone: Calm and observant, then urgent and dramatic ("Listen. The glass is breaking.")

1. Stanza-wise Explanation

1: The trees kept inside the house are moving out to the empty forest, where no bird could sit, no insect hide, no sun bury its feet in shadow. By morning the forest will be full.

2: All night the roots work to free themselves from the cracks in the veranda floor; leaves strain toward the glass, twigs stiff with effort, long-cramped boughs shuffle "like newly discharged patients" moving to the clinic doors.

3: The poet writes long letters but scarcely mentions the departure of the forest. The moon first shines whole in an open sky; at the end the glass breaks, the trees stumble into the night, and the moon is "broken like a mirror", its pieces flashing in the crown of the tallest oak.

2. Central Idea and Symbolism

Literally, man has emptied forests and confined trees indoors; the trees break free and return. At a deeper level the trees stand for **women** confined to the home by a male-dominated society, struggling and finally escaping. **Message:** freedom is natural; confinement cannot last.

3. Poetic Devices

Device	Example
Personification	trees move, roots work, boughs shuffle; "sun bury its feet"
Simile	"like newly discharged patients"; "like a voice"; "like a mirror"
Imagery	"small twigs stiff with exertion"; "smell of leaves and lichen"
Symbolism	trees = women; house = confinement; forest = freedom

Word meanings

disengage: separate · **bough**: branch · **lichen**: fungus-alga growth on trunks

Board ka favourite

→ Moon: whole and shining, then "broken like a mirror", as the trees break the glass and their branches split the moonlight.

→ Tip: 6-marker mein dono level likho: nature (deforestation) aur women's freedom.

4. Extract-based Practice

"All night the roots work / to disengage themselves from the cracks / in the veranda floor. / The leaves strain toward the glass / small twigs stiff with exertion"

Q1. 1M Complete: The roots "work all night" because they _____.

Ans: are struggling to free themselves from the cracks of the floor and reach the forest.

Q2. 1M "stiff with exertion" suggests that the twigs are (a) dead (b) straining hard (c) relaxed (d) broken

Ans: (b) straining hard

Q3. 1M Name the device in "The leaves strain toward the glass".

Ans: Personification

5. Likely Questions

Q4. 3M Board fav Why does the poet scarcely mention the departure of the forest in her letters? (40–50 words)

Ans: The event is strange and unexpected, and people often stay silent about such happenings; it may also hint that she too is confined and cannot yet voice her wish to escape.

Q5. 6M Board fav "The Trees" is a poem about nature and about human freedom. Explain. (100–120 words)

Ans: Nature: forests emptied by man; trees kept as indoor plants; they reclaim the forest · struggle shown through roots, leaves, boughs (patients) · freedom: trees = women confined at home; breaking glass = breaking barriers · speaker's silence = suppressed voice · ending: broken moon, new order · message: freedom is natural.

Exam Alert

→ It is free verse, not rhyming. The trees are inside the house, not in a garden.

→ The boughs are compared to "newly discharged patients", not to prisoners.

FOG

Most asked: What is the fog like · three cat-like features · metaphor · free verse

Poem at a glance

Poet: Carl Sandburg (American poet)
Form: Free verse, 6 short lines in 2 stanzas; no rhyme scheme
Core device: Extended (implied) metaphor: fog = cat
Tone: Quiet, calm, observant

The poem (NCERT)

The fog comes / on little cat feet. // It sits looking / over harbour and city / on silent haunches / and then moves on.

1. Line-wise Explanation

Lines 1-2: The fog arrives silently and softly, the way a cat walks on "little cat feet": no one hears it come.

Lines 3-5: It sits over the harbour and the city like a cat sitting "on silent haunches", looking, watching quietly, covering everything.

Line 6: "and then moves on": like a cat that leaves whenever it likes, the fog drifts away without warning.

2. Central Idea

Sandburg captures fog through a cat: it comes silently, sits still and watches, and leaves suddenly. Nature is quiet, mysterious and temporary; like fog, difficult times also pass. **Theme:** silent beauty and changing moods of nature.

3. Poetic Devices

Device	Example
Metaphor (implied)	fog compared to a cat without "like"/"as"
Personification	"It sits looking"; "moves on"
Imagery	"little cat feet"; "silent haunches"
Alliteration	"sits... silent"
Enjambment	"It sits looking / over harbour and city"
Free verse	no rhyme, no fixed rhythm

Board ka favourite

→ Three ways the fog is like a cat: it comes silently on little feet, sits on its haunches looking, then moves on at will.
→ Poet does not say "like a cat": the comparison is implied (metaphor), not a simile.
→ Tip: "haunches" ka matlab: knees bent karke baithna. Spelling dhyan se.

Word meanings

haunches: sitting with knees bent · **harbour**: place where ships are kept · **moves on**: goes away

4. Extract-based Practice

"It sits looking / over harbour and city / on silent haunches / and then moves on."

Q1. 1M Complete: "It" in the first line refers to _____.
Ans: the fog

Q2. 1M "on silent haunches" creates an image of (a) a lion pouncing (b) a cat sitting still, watching (c) a ship anchoring (d) a crowd waiting
Ans: (b) a cat sitting still, watching

Q3. 2M Is "Fog" a rhyming poem? Give a reason.
Ans: No. It is free verse: no rhyme scheme and no regular rhythm.

5. Likely Questions

Q4. 3M Board fav How does Sandburg make an ordinary sight memorable? (40-50 words)
Ans: By one sustained cat image: silent arrival, watchful sitting, sudden leaving. Short free-verse lines and soft sounds ("sits... silent") match the quiet fog.

Q5. 6M "Like the fog, troubles come and go." Write how the poem carries this lesson. (100-120 words)
Ans: Fog comes unannounced like trouble · it sits and covers harbour and city (blocks our vision) · "then moves on": nothing lasts · patience and calm help · nature teaches acceptance · conclusion: short poem, timeless lesson.

Exam Alert

→ Write "metaphor", not "simile" (no "like"); fog sits over "harbour and city".

The Tale of Custard the Dragon

Most asked: Characters and pet names · why cowardly · ballad and parody · irony · devices

Poem at a glance

Poet: Ogden Nash (wrote 400+ pieces of comic verse)

Form: Humorous ballad close to a parody (mock-heroic); 4-line stanzas

Rhyme: aabb (house/mouse); "winda" spelt to rhyme with Belinda. Tone: humorous, ironic

Character	Pet name / trait
Belinda	owner; "brave as a barrel full of bears"; cries "Help! Help!"
Ink	black kitten; "trickled down to the bottom of the household"
Blink	grey mouse; "strategically mouseholed"
Mustard	yellow dog; "fled with a terrified yelp"
Custard	"cowardly" dragon; the only one who fights

1. Story in Brief

1. Belinda lives in a little white house with Ink, Blink, Mustard, a little red wagon and Custard. Custard has sharp teeth, spikes, scales, "mouth like a fireplace, chimney for a nose".

2. All claim bravery; Custard cries for a safe cage, so they tickle him and call him "Percival". A pirate climbs in, a pistol in each hand, a cutlass in his teeth, black beard, wooden leg. Everyone flees or hides.

3. Custard jumps up "snorting like an engine", dodges two bullets and gobbles the pirate. All hug him, but soon boast again; Custard modestly says everybody is braver than him, and still cries for a safe cage.

2. Theme

True courage is shown in action, not boasting. The "cowardly" dragon is the real hero; the boasters run away. Humour and irony mock false bravery and the habit of judging by appearance.

Exam Alert

→ Ink = kitten, Blink = mouse, Mustard = dog; teased name of Custard = "Percival".

3. Poetic Devices

Device	Example
Simile	"brave as a barrel full of bears"; "like a robin at a worm"
Alliteration	"barrel full of bears"; "clatter and a clank"
Onomatopoeia	"Meowch!", "Weeck!", "clatter", "clank"
Coinage / spelling	"realio, trulio"; "mouseholed"; "winda"
Irony	the "coward" saves everyone

Board ka favourite

→ Why "cowardly dragon"? He cried for a nice safe cage. Why tickled? To tease the timid dragon.

→ Tip: final answer mein irony zaroor likho: jo darpok kehlata tha, wahi hero nikla.

4. Extract-based Practice

"But up jumped Custard, snorting like an engine, / Clashed his tail like irons in a dungeon, / With a clatter and a clank and a jangling squirm, / He went at the pirate like a robin at a worm."

Q1. 1M Complete: The simile "like a robin at a worm" shows that Custard attacked _____.

Ans: quickly and easily, as if the pirate were weak prey.

Q2. 1M "clatter" and "clank" are examples of (a) metaphor (b) onomatopoeia (c) personification (d) hyperbole

Ans: (b) onomatopoeia

5. Likely Questions

Q3. 3M Board fav Why is the poem called a ballad close to a parody? (40-50 words)

Ans: It tells a story in rhyming stanzas like a ballad, but mocks the heroic ballad: a cowardly dragon is the hero, boasters flee, with comic words and spellings.

Q4. 6M Board fav "Actions speak louder than words." Discuss with reference to the poem. (100-120 words)

Ans: Belinda and pets boast, mock Custard · pirate arrives: Belinda cries "Help!", Mustard flees, Ink and Blink hide · Custard fights and saves all · yet he stays humble; others boast again · lesson: courage = action, humility; do not judge by appearance.

For Anne Gregory

Most asked: Honey-coloured ramparts · why dye her hair · only God · outer vs inner beauty

Poem at a glance

Poet: W.B. Yeats (1865–1939), Irish; Nobel Prize for Literature 1923

Form: 3 stanzas of 6 lines; a conversation (NCERT: between a young man and a young woman)

Rhyme: **abcbdb** (despair/ear/hair); refrain "for yourself alone / And not your yellow hair"

Tone: Light, teasing, reflective

1. Stanza-wise Explanation

1 (young man): No young man, "thrown into despair" by her "great honey-coloured ramparts at your ear", will love her for herself alone and not for her yellow hair.

2 (Anne): She can dye her hair brown, black or carrot, so that young men may love her for herself alone.

3 (young man): An old religious man found a text to prove that **only God** could love her for herself alone and not her yellow hair.

2. Central Idea

People are drawn first to outward beauty. Anne wants to be loved for her inner self, but the speaker says unconditional love for the inner self is possible only for God. **Theme:** outer beauty vs inner beauty; true love.

3. Poetic Devices

Device	Example
Metaphor	"honey-coloured ramparts" (hair as castle walls)
Hyperbole	"thrown into despair"
Alliteration	"yourself... yellow"
Refrain	"for yourself alone / And not your yellow hair"

Word meanings

ramparts: high, wide walls around a castle or fort · **despair**: loss of hope · **yesternight**: last night · **text**: a passage from a religious book

Board ka favourite

→ Ramparts: her thick golden hair is like a protective wall; men are attracted but cannot see beyond it to the real her.

→ Why dye? So that she is loved for herself. Hair colour: yellow (golden).

→ Tip: "only God" wala point har answer mein: insaan pehle looks dekhta hai.

4. Extract-based Practice

"But I can get a hair-dye / And set such colour there, / Brown, or black, or carrot, / That young men in despair / May love me for myself alone / And not my yellow hair."

Q1. 1M Complete: The speaker wants to dye her hair because _____.

Ans: she wants to be loved for her inner self, not her beauty.

Q2. 1M The tone of the speaker here is (a) defiant and confident (b) sad (c) fearful (d) sarcastic

Ans: (a) defiant and confident

Q3. 2M Who is the speaker of the first and third stanzas?

Ans: The young man (often read as the poet), speaking to Anne.

5. Likely Questions

Q4. 3M Board fav What is the significance of the old religious man's text? (40–50 words)

Ans: It ends the debate: humans love outward beauty; only God loves a person for the soul alone, so changing hair colour will not change human nature.

Q5. 6M Board fav "Beauty attracts, but character keeps." Discuss with reference to the poem. (100–120 words)

Ans: Golden hair attracts young men · Anne wants love for her real self · dye would change only appearance · speaker: human love starts with looks; only God loves the inner self · message: value character; looks fade · conclusion with refrain.

Exam Alert

→ Hair colour is yellow (golden), not brown: brown is what she may dye it to.

→ Rhyme scheme is abcbdb, not aabb.

A Triumph of Surgery

Most asked: Mrs Pumphrey's indulgence vs Herriot's good sense; irony of the title; character sketches

1. Chapter at a Glance

At a glance	
Author / genre	James Herriot (Yorkshire vet) · humorous first-person story
Setting	Mrs Pumphrey's house and Herriot's surgery (vet clinic), England
Narrator	Mr Herriot, the veterinary surgeon ("I")

2. Summary in Points

1. Tricki, Mrs Pumphrey's Pekinese, is hugely fat, *"like a bloated sausage with a leg at each corner"*; eyes bloodshot, tongue lolling.
2. She feeds him extras (malt, cod-liver oil, Horlicks at night, cream cakes, chocolates); no exercise as Hodgkin the gardener has lumbago.
3. Herriot warns her; she cannot be firm. Soon Tricki refuses food, vomits and lies panting on a rug.
4. Herriot takes him to his surgery for a fortnight; she sends beds, toys, bowls and throws in his coats.
5. Two days of **no food, only water**; then Tricki joins Joe the greyhound and the pack, fights for food, plays, hunts rats. No medicine.
6. Mrs Pumphrey sends eggs (two dozen at a time), then wine, then brandy "to build him up"; Herriot and his partners enjoy them.
7. Tricki returns lithe and hard-muscled; she weeps: *"This is a triumph of surgery!"*

3. Theme and Message

→ **Pampering is not love:** overindulgence harms pets and children alike.

→ **Common sense over medicine:** diet, exercise and company cure Tricki.

→ **Irony:** there was no surgery at all; loneliness of the rich adds pathos.

Style and devices: first-person narration by the vet · situational irony (title) · simile ("bloated sausage") · hyperbole ("thirty feet of gleaming black metal" for her car) · light satire on the idle rich · humour from the vet's own temptation to keep Tricki.

4. Characters

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Mr Herriot	Wise, tactful, firm, humorous: "harden your heart"; cures without blaming her; honestly admits enjoying the eggs and wine
Mrs Pumphrey	Rich, lonely, over-indulgent, emotional, generous: "I can't bear to refuse him"; rings a dozen times a day
Tricki	Greedy, pampered Pekinese who turns lively and fit with the pack

5. Key Line

"This is a triumph of surgery!": situational irony; she mistakes plain diet and exercise for a medical miracle.

Word meanings: rheumy: watery · **listless**: without energy · **distraught**: extremely worried · **convalescing**: recovering · **lithe**: flexible

Board ka favourite

→ Foolish love (Mrs Pumphrey) vs sensible care (Herriot): ye contrast har saal aata hai.

→ Title ironic kyun: koi operation nahi, sirf diet + exercise + doston ka saath.

Likely Board Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav Was Herriot tactful as well as full of common sense?

Ans: Yes. He saw overfeeding, not illness, was the cause and cured Tricki by fasting, diet and exercise; he removed him without blaming Mrs Pumphrey and returned him without exposing her folly.

Q2. 6M Board fav "Overindulgence is as harmful as neglect." Discuss with reference to the story. (100–120 words)

Ans: **Value points:** love shown only as food (cakes, chocolates, Horlicks) · no exercise · obesity, vomiting, collapse · Herriot's firm regime cures him in a fortnight · lesson for parents and pet owners: real care needs discipline · love must be wise.

Exam Alert

→ **No operation** was done. Tricki is the Pekinese; Joe is the greyhound.

→ Order of gifts: eggs, then wine, then brandy.

The Thief's Story

Most asked: Hari Singh's change of heart, Anil's trust, why Anil did not report him

1. Chapter at a Glance

At a glance	
Author / genre	Ruskin Bond · first-person short story
Setting	A North Indian town: room over the Jumna Sweet Shop, the station, the maidan, the clock tower
Narrator	The thief, 15, calling himself "Hari Singh"

2. Summary in Points

1. Hari Singh, an experienced 15-year-old thief, flatters Anil (about 25) at a wrestling match to win his trust.
2. Anil cannot pay him but agrees to feed him; teaches him to cook, write his name and promises to teach sentences and numbers.
3. Hari cheats about a rupee a day on shopping; Anil knows but does not mind.
4. Anil sells a book and tucks a bundle of notes under his mattress. Hari steals the **600 rupees** (in fifties) to catch the 10.30 Express to Lucknow.
5. At the station he hesitates and misses the train; he sits in the rain at the maidan and the clock tower.
6. He realises education can make him "a clever and respected man"; he returns and slips the money back.
7. Next morning Anil hands him a still-wet fifty-rupee note: "Today we'll start writing sentences." He knows, but forgives silently.

3. Theme and Message

→ **Trust and kindness transform:** Anil's faith reforms Hari more than punishment could.

→ **Value of education:** learning offers a respected life beyond petty theft.

→ **Conscience:** the battle between greed and goodness in the narrator.

Style and devices: first-person confession by the thief · irony (the most trusting man is the hardest to rob) · personification ("a beam of moonlight stepped over the balcony") · rain and the deserted platform mirror his inner turmoil · an open, silent ending.

4. Characters

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Hari Singh	Clever, manipulative, observant ("a study of men's faces"), lonely, finally repentant: returns the money; his last smile is natural
Anil	Trusting, generous, easy-going, forgiving, a struggling writer: gives a key; pays the wet note; says nothing

5. Key Lines

Line	Meaning
"Not for the loss of money, but for the loss of trust."	Anil would grieve over broken faith, not cash
"the smile came by itself"	The fake smile turns genuine: reform complete

Word meanings: flattery: insincere praise · **appealing**: attractive · **unlined**: free of worry

Board ka favourite

→ Hari wapas kyun aaya: education ka lalach + Anil ka trust + conscience.

→ Anil ne police ko kyun nahi bulaya: wo jaanta tha pyaar aur trust se insaan sudharta hai.

Likely Board Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav Why did Anil not hand Hari over to the police?

Ans: Anil was kind and forgiving. He understood that Hari had returned the money by choice; punishment would harden him, while trust and education could reform him. The wet note shows he knew but chose silence.

Q2. 6M Board fav How does the story show that trust and education can change a person? (100–120 words)

Ans: Value points: Hari a habitual thief, false names monthly · Anil's trust (key, room, lessons) · theft, then hesitation at the station · reflection in the rain: "a clever and respected man" · returns the money · Anil's silent forgiveness · smile becomes genuine · message: compassion reforms.

Exam Alert

→ The amount is **600 rupees in fifties**; the train is the 10.30 Express to Lucknow.

→ "Hari Singh" is a false name; Anil is the writer, not the narrator.

THE MIDNIGHT VISITOR

Most asked: Ausable's presence of mind; the invented balcony; Ausable vs a typical secret agent

1. Chapter at a Glance

At a glance	
Author / genre	Robert Arthur · spy story with a twist ending
Setting	Ausable's small room, sixth and top floor of a gloomy French hotel, Paris; about midnight
Characters	Ausable (agent), Fowler (young writer), Max (rival spy), Henry (waiter)

2. Summary in Points

1. Fowler, a young romantic writer, is disappointed: Ausable is fat, wheezy, with an American accent (from Boston, in Paris 20 years).
2. Ausable promises an important paper on **new missiles** will reach him at 12.30.
3. They find Max in the room with a small automatic pistol; he got in with a **passkey** and wants the report.
4. Ausable grumbles that someone got in "through that nuisance of a balcony" last month; Max believes it.
5. A knock comes. Ausable says it is the police, who "will not hesitate to shoot".
6. Max climbs out of the window to hide on the balcony, drops, and screams.
7. It was Henry the waiter with drinks. *"There is no balcony."*

3. Theme and Message

→ **Presence of mind and wit** defeat brute force (a gun).

→ **Appearances deceive:** the dull fat man is the cleverest agent.

→ **Reality vs romance:** spying is quiet brainwork, not film-style glamour.

Style and devices: third-person narration through Fowler's eyes · suspense built by the gun, the countdown ("thirty-one minutes") and the knocking · foreshadowing (the balcony complaint) · contrast between Ausable's looks and his mind · surprise twist in the last line.

4. Characters

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Ausable	Calm, quick-witted, imaginative, confident: invents a detailed balcony story and the police at the door
Max	Crafty, fox-like, armed but gullible and nervous: believes the balcony, bites his lip
Fowler	Young, romantic, easily thrilled, naive: expects pistols and dark-eyed beauties

5. Key Line and Device

"You see, my young friend, there is no balcony.": twist ending; dramatic irony as the reader, like Max, believes the lie.

Word meanings: prosaic: ordinary · **espionage**: spying · **wheezed**: breathed noisily · **shrilly**: in a high pitch

Board ka favourite

→ Balcony story convincing kyun: detail (old suite, next room, empty room two doors down, management complaint) + irritation in voice.

→ Plan kab bana: Max ka passkey sunte hi, unhone mauke ka faayda uthaya.

Likely Board Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav How did Ausable make Max believe there was a balcony?

Ans: He sounded genuinely irritated, gave precise details (it belonged to the next apartment, reached from an empty room two doors down, someone used it last month, the management promised to block it), and then used the knock as "police" to push Max towards it.

Q2. 6M Board fav "Presence of mind can save us in a crisis." Explain with reference to Ausable. (100–120 words)

Ans: Value points: armed rival in his room · no panic; sits calmly · plants the balcony idea · uses the waiter's knock as "police" · Max jumps and is eliminated without a fight · report safe · lesson: calm, quick thinking beats force.

Exam Alert

→ Max entered with a **passkey**, not via a balcony; Henry is the waiter, not the police.

→ Ausable is American (Boston), working in Paris.

A Question of Trust

Most asked: Horace Danby tricked by the lady in red; irony of "honour among thieves"

1. Chapter at a Glance

At a glance	
Author / genre	Victor Canning · crime story with irony
Setting	Shotover Grange, a country house, on a July afternoon
Characters	Horace Danby (locksmith-thief), the young lady in red, Sherry (dog)

2. Summary in Points

1. Horace Danby, about 50, unmarried, a respected locksmith, robs one safe a year to buy rare books.
2. After two weeks' study, he enters Shotover Grange while the servants are at the movies: kitchen key from a hook, gloves on, calls the dog "Sherry".
3. The flowers trigger his **hay fever**; he sneezes loudly.
4. A young lady in red appears, behaves like the owner, and threatens to call the police.
5. She says she forgot the safe's numbers and needs her jewels for a party. Eager to please, he **takes off his gloves** (to give her his lighter) and opens the safe.
6. His fingerprints are everywhere; he is arrested. The real owner's wife is sixty and grey-haired.
7. Horace becomes assistant librarian in prison and hates the phrase "honour among thieves".

3. Theme and Message

→ **Crime does not pay:** even a careful planner is caught.

→ **Irony:** a thief is outwitted by a cleverer thief.

→ **Ends do not justify means:** a good motive (books) does not excuse theft.

Style and devices: third-person narration · situational irony (a locksmith-thief outwitted by a thief; he ends up back in prison, as assistant librarian) · title pun: Horace trusts the wrong person · hay fever as a comic flaw · a surprise reveal of the real owner's wife.

4. Characters

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Horace Danby	Meticulous planner, lover of books, vain, gullible: studies the house for two weeks yet trusts a stranger and removes gloves
The lady	Cool, confident, clever, a skilled actress: knows the dog's name, straightens ornaments, talks of her husband

5. How She Deceived Him

Calm, amused manner · Sherry rubs against her · scolds the dog "as if away a month" · threatens the police · story of jewels, party and husband.

Word meanings: hay fever: allergy to pollen or dust · **respectable**: socially honoured

Board ka favourite

→ Horace "not completely honest" kyun: respectable locksmith, par saal mein ek safe lootta hai.

→ Kahan galti hui: gloves utaare, aurat pe bharosa kiya, flowers se sneeze.

Likely Board Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav Why does Horace hate the phrase "honour among thieves"?

Ans: He believed thieves respect each other, yet the young lady, herself a thief, tricked him into opening the safe without gloves and let him take the blame. He was jailed for a robbery she committed.

Q2. 6M Board fav "Horace Danby was a meticulous planner but still he faltered." Explain. (100-120 words)

Ans: Value points: two weeks' study of rooms, wiring, paths · knew servants' timing, dog's name · gloves, cut alarm · faltered: hay fever, trusted the lady, removed gloves, left fingerprints · arrested; no one believed him · lesson: crime catches up; overconfidence ruins.

Exam Alert

→ He removed gloves to hand her his **lighter**, then opened the safe bare-handed.

→ The real owner's wife is sixty and sharp-tongued, not the lady in red.

Footprints without Feet

Most asked: "Griffin was rather a lawless person"; misuse of science; the Iping episodes

1. Chapter at a Glance

At a glance	
Author / genre	H.G. Wells · science fiction (from *The Invisible Man*)
Setting	London (a big store, Drury Lane) and the village of Iping, in winter
Characters	Griffin (scientist), Mrs and Mr Hall (inn), clergyman and wife, Jaffers (constable)

2. Summary in Points

1. Griffin swallows rare drugs and becomes transparent as glass. Two boys in London follow his muddy bare footprints.
2. Earlier, he set fire to his landlord's house in revenge and stripped to escape unseen.
3. Freezing in mid-winter, he spends a night in a big London store, dresses and eats; oversleeps and flees naked when assistants chase him.
4. At a Drury Lane theatrical shop he takes bandages, dark glasses, false nose and whiskers, attacks and robs the shopkeeper.
5. At Iping inn he tells Mrs Hall he wants solitude and has a damaged face; his money runs out.
6. He steals the clergyman's housekeeping money; in his room the hat and chair attack Mrs Hall, who thinks it is witchcraft.
7. Confronted, he throws off his disguise: a headless man. Constable Jaffers tries to arrest him, is knocked unconscious, and Griffin escapes.

3. Theme and Message

→ **Misuse of science:** a great discovery serves crime without ethics.

→ **Isolation and arrogance** turn genius into lawlessness.

→ **Crime breeds crime:** each offence leads to the next.

Style and devices: third-person narration · science fiction with humour · suspense and mystery (footprints from nowhere, empty study) · imagery ("a headless man") · comic exaggeration in the chair attack · an open ending as Griffin escapes.

4. Characters

Character	Traits (with evidence)
Griffin	Brilliant but lawless, short-tempered, selfish, callous: arson, theft, attacks the shopkeeper and Jaffers
Mrs Hall	Curious, practical, superstitious: excuses him as he paid in advance; blames spirits for the chair
Jaffers	Dutiful, brave: tries to arrest "a man without a head"

5. Key Line

"Brilliant scientist though he was, Griffin was rather a lawless person.": the thesis line for most 6-mark answers.

Word meanings: eccentric: odd · **callously**: cruelly · **solitude**: being alone

Board ka favourite

→ Griffin lawless: landlord ka ghar jalaya, store mein chori, shopkeeper ko maara, clergyman ke paise, Jaffers pe hamla.

→ Invisibility ke fayde aur nuksaan: thand, bhook, kapde chahiye, mud se pakda gaya.

Likely Board Questions

Q1. 3M Board fav How did the invisible man first become visible?

Ans: He stepped in mud and left footprints on the steps of a London house. Later he became "visible" by wearing clothes, a hat, bandages, dark glasses and a false nose.

Q2. 6M Board fav "Griffin was rather a lawless person." Comment. (100–120 words)

Ans: **Value points:** genius discovers invisibility · burns landlord's house · loots the London store · attacks and robs the Drury Lane shopkeeper · steals the clergyman's money · terrifies the Halls · assaults Jaffers · science without values is dangerous.

Exam Alert

→ The story is set in **winter** (January); Iping is a village, not part of London.

→ The chair pushes the Halls out; it was Griffin, not ghosts.

The Making of a Scientist

Most asked: role of Ebright's mother · the turning-point book · lesson from failure · qualities of a scientist

Chapter at a glance

Author: Robert W. Peterson · **Genre:** biographical account (true story)
Setting: Reading, Pennsylvania (USA); science fairs; Harvard
Central idea: curiosity, hard work and the right guidance make a scientist

1. Summary in Points

1. At **22**, Richard H. Ebright, a former "scout of the year", and his college room-mate published a new theory of how cells work in the *Proceedings of the National Academy of Science*.

2. An only child near **Reading, Pennsylvania**, he collected butterflies from kindergarten; by **Class 2** he had all **25 species** found around his town.

3. His **mother** (his father died when he was in Class 3) bought him telescopes, microscopes and cameras and gave him the book ***The Travels of Monarch X***: the turning point. He began tagging monarchs for **Dr Frederick A. Urquhart** (University of Toronto).

4. **Class 7:** he lost at the county science fair with slides of frog tissues and learnt that winners do **real experiments**. Next: the **viceroy copies monarch** project won.

5. **High school:** proved the **12 gold spots** on a monarch pupa make a hormone needed for full development; won international fair prizes and summer work at the **Walter Reed Army Institute of Research**.

6. At **Harvard** he identified the hormone's structure; X-ray photos gave him the idea of **how a cell "reads" the blueprint of its DNA**, worked out with room-mate **James R. Wong**.

2. Themes

- → **Formula of a scientist:** a first-rate mind + curiosity + the will to win for the right reasons.
- → **Failure teaches:** one loss turned him from displays to real experiments.
- → **Parents and mentors matter:** mother, Dr Urquhart, teacher Richard A. Weiherer.
- → **Healthy competition** and curiosity drive excellence.

3. Characters

Who	Traits and evidence
Richard Ebright	curious, determined, competitive (for the right reasons), versatile
His mother	devoted and encouraging: "Richie was my whole life"; found learning work for him every evening
Dr Urquhart	guide: sent "a stack of suggestions" for experiments

Word meanings: tedious boring · **pupa** stage between caterpillar and adult · **entomology** study of insects

Board ka favourite

- → Mother ka role + book *Monarch X* = turning point.
- → Haar se seekh: display nahi, real experiment.
- → 3 qualities of a scientist zaroor likho.

Most Important Questions

3-mark (40–50 words) and 6-mark (100–120 words) answers

Q1. 3M Board fav How did a book become a turning point in Ebright's life?

Ans: *The Travels of Monarch X*, a gift from his mother, told how monarchs migrate to Central America and invited readers to tag them for Dr Urquhart. It opened the world of science to him: tagging, raising monarchs and later research.

Q2. 3M What lesson did Ebright learn from losing at the science fair?

Ans: His frog-tissue slides won nothing. Winners did real experiments, not neat displays, so he began genuine experiments.

Q3. 6M Board fav Describe the role of Ebright's mother in making him a scientist.

Ans: Value points: his only companion after his father's death · learning work every evening · telescope, microscopes, cameras, trips · gave *Monarch X* · wrote to Dr Urquhart · built discipline and confidence. Conclusion: a parent who nurtures curiosity shapes a child's future.

Exam Alert

- → Room-mate: **James R. Wong**; teacher: **Richard A. Weiherer**; age at the theory: **22**.
- → He lost in **Class 7**; there are **12** gold spots.

THE NECKLACE

Most asked: Matilda's character · cause of her ruin · ironic ending · M. Loisel as a husband

Chapter at a glance

Author: Guy de Maupassant (French) · **Genre:** short story with a twist (irony)
Setting: Paris, France (19th century)
Central idea: vanity and false pride can ruin a life; honesty saves

1. Summary in Points

1. **Matilda**, pretty but born into a family of clerks, married a petty clerk in the **Board of Education**, **M. Loisel**. She was unhappy, dreaming of luxury.

2. An invitation to the **Minister of Public Instruction's** ball (Monday, January 18) upset her: she had no dress. Loisel gave her **400 francs** he had saved to buy a **gun**.

3. She borrowed a **diamond necklace** from her rich friend **Mme Forestier**. At the ball she was the prettiest woman and a great success.

4. Leaving at about 4 a.m., she ran off in her shabby wraps to avoid notice. At home the necklace was **lost**. They wrote that its **clasp was broken** to gain time.

5. They bought a look-alike in a **Palais-Royal** shop for **36,000 francs** (valued at 40,000): 18,000 left by Loisel's father, the rest borrowed from usurers.

6. For **ten years** they lived in an attic, sent away the maid and worked hard to repay. Matilda grew old and rough. Then Mme Forestier told her: the necklace was **false**, worth at most **500 francs**.

2. Themes and Irony

- → **Vanity and greed for show** ruin Matilda; ten years for one evening of glory.
- → **Honesty:** one confession would have saved them; pride stopped her.
- → **Irony of fate:** they paid 36,000 francs for a fake worth 500; "How small a thing will ruin or save one!"

3. Characters

Who	Traits and evidence
Matilda Loisel	vain, discontented, proud; later hard-working and honest (repays every franc)
M. Loisel	loving, sacrificing, content: gives up his gun money, searches all night, works extra
Mme Forestier	generous, rich friend; frank at the end

Word meanings: incessantly continuously · **usurer** one who lends money at very high interest · **chaplet** string of jewels · **vexation** annoyance

Board ka favourite

- → Matilda ki ruin ka cause: vanity + false pride + no honesty.
- → Ending = irony; quote "How small a thing will ruin or save one!"

MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

3-mark (40–50 words) and 6-mark (100–120 words) answers

Q1. 3M Board fav Why was Matilda unhappy even after her marriage?
Ans: She was pretty and charming but felt born for luxury. Married to a petty clerk, she suffered from her poor house, worn chairs and ugly curtains, and envied rich women like Mme Forestier.

Q2. 3M How did the Loisels replace the necklace?
Ans: They found a similar one at the Palais-Royal for 36,000 francs, paid 18,000 left by Loisel's father and borrowed the rest from usurers.

Q3. 6M Board fav "Matilda's vanity and lack of honesty led to her ruin." Discuss.
Ans: Value points: dreamt of a rich life · wanted to shine at the ball · borrowed a necklace to look rich · did not confess the loss · ten years of poverty to repay · learnt it was fake. Message: be content and honest; truth would have saved her.

Exam Alert

- → Loisel was a clerk in the **Board of Education**; the ball was given by the **Minister of Public Instruction**.
- → Replacement cost **36,000** francs; the fake was worth **500**; the dress cost **400**.

BHOLI

Most asked: Bholi's transformation · role of the teacher · dowry and girls' education

Chapter at a glance

Author: K.A. Abbas · **Genre:** short story (social theme)
Setting: a village in India; Ramlal's home, the girls' primary school
Central idea: education gives a girl confidence, voice and self-respect

1. Summary in Points

1. Sulekha, called **Bholi** (the simpleton), was the fourth daughter of **Numberdar Ramlal**. She fell off a cot at **ten months**; **smallpox at two** left deep pockmarks; she could not speak till five and then **stammered**.

2. Neglected at home, she wore her sisters' old clothes. When she was seven, a **girls' primary school** opened; the **Tehsildar** asked Ramlal to send his daughters. Her parents sent only Bholi, thinking no one would marry her anyway.

3. Bholi feared school like the old cow **Lakshmi** being sold. But the **teacher** spoke kindly, helped her say her name and promised: learn, and people will listen to you with respect.

4. Years later a proposal came from **Bishamber Nath**, a well-to-do grocer: lame, about 45-50, with grown children from his first wife.

5. At the wedding, seeing her pockmarked face, he demanded **5,000 rupees** as dowry. Ramlal put his turban at his feet and paid.

6. Bholi **threw the garland into the fire** and refused to marry "such a mean, greedy and contemptible coward". She promised to serve her parents in old age and **teach in the same school**.

2. Themes

- **Education empowers:** the stammering girl speaks "in a clear loud voice".
- **Evils exposed:** dowry, neglect of girls, preference for looks.
- **A good teacher** can change a life.

3. Characters

Who	Traits and evidence
Bholi	neglected, timid at first; later confident, bold, self-respecting
The teacher	kind, encouraging; watches proudly at the end, "the completion of her masterpiece"
Ramlal	traditional, worried father; obeys the Tehsildar, pays the dowry
Bishamber	old, lame, greedy grocer; demands dowry

Word meanings: simpleton a foolish person · **pockmarks** scars left by smallpox · **izzat** honour · **contemptible** deserving hatred

Board ka favourite

- Teacher ka role + Bholi ka transformation (6M).
- Garland fire mein: dowry ke against stand.

MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

3-mark (40-50 words) and 6-mark (100-120 words) answers

Q1. 3M Board fav Why was Bholi sent to school?
Ans: The Tehsildar asked Ramlal to send his daughters to the new school. His wife said no one would marry the ugly, simple Bholi anyway, so she should go and let the teachers worry about her.

Q2. 3M Why did Bholi refuse to marry Bishamber?
Ans: He was old and lame, and at the wedding he demanded 5,000 rupees. Bholi would not marry such a mean, greedy coward who insulted her father.

Q3. 6M Board fav How did the teacher change Bholi's life?
Ans: Value points: first person to speak kindly to her · encouraged her to say her name · promised respect through learning · gave books and confidence · Bholi lost her stammer and fear · stood up against dowry · chose to teach. Conclusion: education turned a "simpleton" into a confident woman.

Exam Alert

- Real name **Sulekha**; father **Ramlal** (numberdar); groom **Bishamber Nath**.
- Dowry demanded was **5,000** rupees; she was seven when school opened.

The Book That Saved the Earth

Most asked: Think-Tank vs Noodle · how a book saved Earth · role of humour

Chapter at a glance

Author: Claire Boiko · **Genre:** one-act play (science-fiction comedy)
Setting: Mars Space Control and Centerville Public Library; told from the 25th century
Central idea: misunderstanding of books saves Earth; arrogance is foolish

1. Summary in Points

1. A **Historian** of the **25th century** recalls the **twentieth century**, the "Era of the Book", and the **Martian invasion of 2040**.

2. Probe One crew (**Captain Omega, Lieutenant Iota, Sergeant Oop**) lands in the **Centerville Public Library**; Oop thinks it is a storage barn or a haberdashery.

3. **Think-Tank**, Mars' egg-headed, vain commander, calls books **sandwiches**; Oop tastes one. His tactful apprentice **Noodle** says Earthlings use them to communicate, then to "watch" (read).

4. Taking vitamins to increase intelligence, the crew reads **Mother Goose**. "Mistress Mary" makes Think-Tank think Earthlings grow silver and explosives; "Hey Diddle Diddle" that cows can launch an attack.

5. **"Humpty Dumpty"**, who looks like him, convinces him Earth plans to capture him. He orders the crew home and Mars evacuated to **Alpha Centauri**.

6. Later, Noodle replaced Think-Tank, Earth and Mars became friends and a model library opened in **Marsopolis**; but Martians never read Mother Goose.

2. Themes and Devices

- → **Arrogance vs wisdom:** "Think-Tank is never wrong" leads to defeat.
- → **Value of books** and of reading.
- → **Humour and irony:** a book of nursery rhymes defeats an invasion.

3. Characters

Who	Traits and evidence
Think-Tank	vain, foolish, self-proclaimed genius; demands full salutation
Noodle	wise, tactful, humble; corrects him politely ("an insignificant bit of data")
Omega, Iota, Oop	obedient crew; Oop is comic, Iota sly

Word meanings: **haberdashery** shop selling small items of dress · **decipher** find the meaning · **levity** lack of seriousness · **peevishly** irritably

Board ka favourite

- → Noodle Think-Tank ko kaise correct karta hai: tact + flattery.
- → Think-Tank ki galat interpretations (3 rhymes) yaad karo.

Most Important Questions

3-mark (40–50 words) and 6-mark (100–120 words) answers

Q1. 3M Board fav How does Noodle correct Think-Tank without offending him?
Ans: He praises him ("your Brilliance") and offers his correction as "an insignificant bit of data" or a "cloudy piece of information", letting Think-Tank claim the idea as his own.

Q2. 3M Why was the twentieth century called the "Era of the Book"?
Ans: There were books on every subject, and people read them and learnt from them; books were everywhere.

Q3. 6M Board fav How did a book of nursery rhymes save the Earth?
Ans: Value points: crew finds Mother Goose · Think-Tank misreads it as code · silver and explosives grown, cows in space · Humpty Dumpty looks like him; "great fall" means capture · panics, cancels invasion, flees to Alpha Centauri · arrogance and ignorance defeat Mars.

Exam Alert

- → Invasion year **2040**; narrator in the **25th** century; library in **Centerville**.
- → Mars fled to **Alpha Centauri**; Noodle later replaced Think-Tank.

TENSES

Most asked: verb-form blanks, present perfect vs simple past, tense + passive in notices and emails

1. Tense Chart (active forms)

	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perf. cont.
Present	V1 / V1+s	is/am/are + V-ing	has/have + V3	has/have been + V-ing
Past	V2	was/were + V-ing	had + V3	had been + V-ing
Future	will + V1	will be + V-ing	will have + V3	will have been + V-ing

2. Uses the Board Tests

Tense	Use and example
Simple present	habits, facts, timetables: Water **boils** at 100 °C.
Present continuous	now / fixed plan: We **are leaving** tomorrow.
Present perfect	past action, present result: The town **has changed** a lot.
Pres. perf. cont.	began in past, still going: She **has been practising** since 7.
Simple past	definite past time: They **met** last week.
Past continuous	in progress at a past moment: I **was reading** when he called.
Past perfect	earlier of two past actions: The bus **had left** before we came.
Future perfect	done before a future time: By May we **will have finished**.

3. Time Markers Decide the Tense

Signal words	Tense
always, usually, every day; universal truths	Simple present
since, for, already, just, yet, ever, so far, recently	Present perfect
yesterday, last week, ago, in 2020	Simple past
by the time + past; before/after with two past actions	Past perfect

Passive inside tenses: is/are + V3 · is being + V3 · has been + V3 · was/were + V3 · had been + V3 · will be / must be + V3. **Conditionals:** If + present, will + V1 · If + past, would + V1 · If + had + V3, would have + V3.

Exam Alert

- → ✗ I have seen him yesterday. ✓ **I saw him yesterday.**
- → ✗ She is knowing the answer. ✓ **She knows** *(no -ing with know, own, want)*
- → ✗ I am living here since 2019. ✓ **I have been living**
- → ✗ If it will rain, we will stay. ✓ **If it rains**

Board ka favourite

- → SQP 2026-27: "your application ____ by our committee *last week*" ⟶ **was reviewed** ("last week" = simple past).
- → SQP: "This hill station ____ (lose) its beauty *since* the last time I saw it" ⟶ **has lost**. Pehle time marker dekho, phir active/passive.

MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Board-style items, answers in maroon

Q1. By the time the ambulance arrived, the crowd ____ (disperse). **Ans:** had dispersed

Q2. Look! The children ____ (fly) kites on the terrace. **Ans:** are flying

Q3. Our school ____ (win) the trophy three times so far. **Ans:** has won

Q4. Formal email: "We regret that the workshop scheduled for Monday ____ due to heavy rain." (a) has been postponed (b) had postponed (c) is postponing (d) postpones **Ans:** (a) has been postponed

Q5. She ____ (prepare) for the debate since 7 a.m. **Ans:** has been preparing

Q6. I ____ (read) a novel when the doorbell rang. **Ans:** was reading

Q7. Error / Correction: "He has completed the project two days ago." **Ans:** has completed ⟶ completed

Q8. By the end of this year, the metro ____ (connect) the airport. **Ans:** will have connected

Q9. The new library ____ (inaugurate) by the Principal last Monday. **Ans:** was inaugurated

Q10. Error / Correction: "My grandfather is living here since 1970." **Ans:** is living ⟶ has been living

MODALS

Most asked: choose the modal from context: rule (must), advice (should), possibility (may/might), request (could/would)

1. Modals and What They Express

Modal	Expresses	Example
can / could	ability; could = past ability, polite request	**Could** you help me?
may / might	permission; possibility (might = less sure)	It **might** rain.
must	rule, compulsion; sure deduction	Badges **must** be worn.
must not	prohibition	You **must not** litter.
should / ought to	advice, duty	You **should** rest.
need not	no necessity	You **need not** come.
will / would	promise; polite request, past habit	**Would** you mind?
used to / have to	past habit / outside obligation	I **have to** leave.

2. Fine Differences

Pair	Difference
must / have to	must = rule or speaker's authority; have to = outside need; past of both: had to
must not / need not	forbidden / not necessary
should / must	advice (choice left) / compulsion (no choice)
should have + V3	regret: I **should have** left earlier.
must have + V3	deduction: It **must have** rained.

Rules for every modal

- Modal + V1: He can **swim** (not swims / to swim); no added s: She **may** come.
- Never two modals: will can ⟶ **will be able to.**
- Passive: modal + be + V3: Forms **must be submitted.**

Read the context

Notice / policy ⟶ **must** · advice ⟶ **should** · chance ⟶ **may / might** · request ⟶ **could / would** · permission ⟶ **may** · no need ⟶ **need not.**

Exam Alert

- ✗ She can sings. ✓ **She can sing.**
- ✗ You must not bring a pen; we have plenty. ✓ **You need not bring**
- ✗ He ought study. ✓ **He ought to study.**

Board ka favourite

- SQP 2026-27: school safety *policy*: "All students ____ wear their badges" ⟶ **must** (rule).
- SQP: "If you practise regularly, you ____ win the quiz" (might/must) ⟶ **might** (jeet pakki nahi, sirf chance).

MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Board-style items, answers in maroon

Q1. Visitors ____ not feed the animals; it is prohibited. (must / need) **Ans:** must

Q2. You ____ not carry an umbrella; it will be sunny. (need / must) **Ans:** need

Q3. "____ I borrow your notes for a day, Ma'am?" (a) Must (b) May (c) Should (d) Would **Ans:** (b) May

Q4. You look exhausted. You ____ take some rest. **Ans:** should

Q5. He topped the exam; he ____ have worked hard. (must / need) **Ans:** must

Q6. When I was six, I ____ swim across the pool. (can / could) **Ans:** could

Q7. Error / Correction: "You will can finish it tonight." **Ans:** will can ⟶ will be able to

Q8. "Candidates ____ submit the form by 5 p.m.; late entries are not accepted." (a) might (b) could (c) must (d) would **Ans:** (c) must

Q9. It is cloudy; it ____ rain later, but I am not sure. (might / must) **Ans:** might

Q10. I missed the bus. I ____ have left earlier. (should / can) **Ans:** should

Q11. Error / Correction: "Students must to wear the school uniform on Mondays." **Ans:** must to wear ⟶ must wear

Subject–Verb Agreement

Most asked: Error / Correction items on each, neither…nor, as well as, one of

1. The Core Rule

The verb agrees with its **real subject**. Words between the subject and the verb do not change it: The quality of the mangoes **is** poor. With **there is / there are** the verb follows the noun after it (There **are** many books). Titles and names of countries are singular (The United States **is** large).

2. Rules with Examples

Subject	Verb	Example
each, every, either, neither, everyone, nobody	Singular	Each of the boys **has** a kit.
neither…nor, either…or, not only…but also	Nearer subject	Neither the staff nor the **manager was** aware.
as well as, along with, with, besides	First subject	The **teacher**, with her students, **is** here.
A and B	Plural	Ravi and Mohan **are** friends.
A and B = one idea / person	Singular	Bread and butter **is** my breakfast.
one of + plural noun	Singular	One of my friends **lives** in Pune.
a number of / the number of	Plural / Singular	A number of boys **are** absent.
collective noun as a unit	Singular	The jury **has** decided.
amount, distance, time as one unit	Singular	Ten kilometres **is** a long walk.
news, mathematics, physics	Singular	The news **is** good.
police, cattle, people, scissors	Plural	The police **have** come.
many a + singular noun	Singular	Many a student **has** tried.
most / some / all + of	Noun after of	Most of the boys **are** here.

Quick test

Strike out the phrase after **of**, **along with**, **as well as** and read again: "Each ~~of the players~~ **has**…", "The captain~~, with his team,~~ **was** welcomed."

Exam Alert

→ ✗ The box of chocolates were… ✓ **The box … was**

→ ✗ Neither Rita nor her sisters was… ✓ **sisters were**

→ ✗ Every boy and girl were present. ✓ **was present**

Board ka favourite

→ SQP 2026-27: "Neither the developers nor the project manager **were** aware" ⟶ were / **was**.

→ SQP: "Each of the participants … **have** been given" ⟶ have / **has**. Table mein sirf galat aur sahi word likho.

Most Important Questions

Board-style items, answers in maroon

Q1. Each of the players have been given a new kit. **Ans:** have ⟶ has

Q2. Neither the principal nor the teachers was present. **Ans:** was ⟶ were

Q3. The news of his victory were a relief. **Ans:** were ⟶ was

Q4. The captain, along with his team, were welcomed. **Ans:** were ⟶ was

Q5. A number of students was absent. **Ans:** was ⟶ were

Q6. Not only the students but also the teacher were excited. **Ans:** were ⟶ was

Q7. "Many a soldier ____ lost his life." (a) have (b) has (c) were (d) are **Ans:** (b) has

Q8. The cattle ____ grazing in the field. (is / are) **Ans:** are

Q9. One of the windows ____ broken. (is / are) **Ans:** is

Q10. Twenty kilometres ____ too far to walk. (is / are) **Ans:** is

Q11. Mathematics are my favourite subject. **Ans:** are ⟶ is

Q12. Most of the students in the hall ____ from Delhi. (is / are) **Ans:** are

Reported Speech

Most asked: report a statement, a question or advice by completing the given sentence

1. Tense Changes (reporting verb in past)

Direct	Reported
simple present / present continuous	simple past / past continuous
present perfect / simple past	past perfect
will, shall, can, may	would, should, could, might
must (duty)	had to
would, could, should, might, ought to	no change

No change: reporting verb in present (He **says** he **is** busy) and universal truths (the earth **revolves** round the sun).

2. Time and Place Words

Direct	Reported	Direct	Reported
now	then	today	that day
tomorrow	the next day	yesterday	the previous day
next week	the following week	last week	the previous week
here	there	this / these	that / those

3. Sentence Types

Type	Pattern and example
Statement	said / told + object + **that**: Rohan said that he had won.
Yes/No question	asked + **if / whether** + statement order: She asked me if I was ready.
Wh- question	asked + **wh-word** + statement order: He asked me where I lived.
Command, request, advice	ordered / requested / advised + object + **to / not to** + V1: She requested me to sit down.
Suggestion	suggested that they **should** + V1

Exam Alert

→ ✗ He asked me where did I live. ✓ **where I lived**
→ ✗ She told that she was late. ✓ **She told me that / She said that**
→ ✗ He told us to not run. ✓ **not to run**

Board ka favourite

→ SQP 2026-27: Doctor: "You should reduce your sugar intake..." ⟶ The doctor **advised** the patient **to reduce** his/her sugar intake and exercise regularly.
→ SQP: Juhi asked her friend **if she was prepared for the mathematics test the following week.**
→ Advised / recommended dono chalte hain; tense ya pronoun galat to mark nahi.

Most Important Questions

Board-style items, answers in maroon

Q1. Rohan said, "I have finished my project." **Ans:** Rohan said that he had finished his project.

Q2. Teacher: "Do not run in the corridors." **Ans:** The teacher told the students not to run in the corridors.

Q3. Meera asked me, "Where are you going tomorrow?" **Ans:** Meera asked me where I was going the next day.

Q4. "Can you help me?" Arjun asked his sister. **Ans:** Arjun asked his sister if she could help him.

Q5. "Please lend me your bicycle," said Ravi to Amit. **Ans:** Ravi requested Amit to lend him his bicycle.

Q6. Isha: "I was absent yesterday." Complete: Isha explained that ____. **Ans:** she had been absent the previous day.

Q7. Error / Correction: "She asked me where did I live." **Ans:** did I live ⟶ I lived

Q8. "Let us plant trees," said the principal. **Ans:** The principal suggested that they should plant trees.

Q9. Coach: "You must reach by 6 a.m." Complete: The coach told the players that ____. **Ans:** they had to reach by 6 a.m.

Q10. Father said, "The sun rises in the east." **Ans:** Father said that the sun rises in the east.

Q11. The receptionist said to the guest, "Your room will be ready in ten minutes." **Ans:** The receptionist told the guest that his/her room would be ready in ten minutes.

Q12. "Why are you late today?" the teacher asked Rahul. **Ans:** The teacher asked Rahul why he was late that day.

DETERMINERS

Most asked: few/a few, little/a little, this/that/these/those, some/any, each/every, articles

1. Types of Determiners

Type	Words
Articles	a, an, the
Demonstratives	this, that, these, those
Possessives	my, your, his, her, its, our, their
Quantifiers	some, any, much, many, few, little, enough, all, no
Distributives	each, every, either, neither
Numbers / Interrogatives	one, first / which, what, whose

2. Articles

→ **a / an** go by sound: **an** hour, **an** MLA, **a** university, **a** one-way street.

→ **the** for specific or already-mentioned things, unique things (the sun), superlatives (the best), rivers and mountain ranges (the Ganga, the Himalayas).

→ **the** + adjective for a class (the poor), with instruments (plays the flute) and ordinals (the first).

→ No article before meals, languages, games: He plays cricket. She went to school (to study).

3. Quantifiers

Word	Use and example
many, few, a few, fewer	countable: **many** books, **fewer** cars
much, little, a little, less	uncountable: **much** water, **less** sugar
few / little	hardly any (negative): **Little** food was left.
a few / a little	some (positive): I have **a little** time.
some / any	some: positive, offers; any: negatives, questions
each / every	each: one by one, takes "of"; every: no "of"
either / neither	one of two / none of two + singular noun
fewer / less	fewer + countable; less + uncountable
this, that / these, those	near, far; singular / plural: **those** who came late

Exam Alert

→ ✗ Less people came. ✓ **Fewer people**

→ ✗ Every students must come. ✓ **Every student**

→ ✗ He is a honest boy. ✓ **an honest boy**

Board ka favourite

→ SQP 2026-27: "Please note that ____ applicants who have submitted incomplete forms..." ⟶ **those** (plural, specific group).

→ SQP: "Saira was disappointed ... there was ____ food left" ⟶ **little** (negative sense).

→ SQP: "What among these books have you read?" ⟶ What / **Which** (limited choice).

MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Board-style items, answers in maroon

Q1. He is ____ honest man. (a / an) **Ans:** an

Q2. Hurry! We have ____ time left. (little / a little) **Ans:** little

Q3. ____ students who finished the project will get a certificate. (Those / That) **Ans:** Those

Q4. Can I have ____ water, please? (some / any) **Ans:** some

Q5. "She has visited ____ countries, so she can guide us." (a) a few (b) few (c) little (d) much **Ans:** (a) a few

Q6. There were ____ cars on Sunday. (fewer / less) **Ans:** fewer

Q7. Error / Correction: "Every students must carry an ID card." **Ans:** students ⟶ student

Q8. Error / Correction: "How much books did you buy?" **Ans:** much ⟶ many

Q9. ____ of the girls was given a medal. (Each / Every) **Ans:** Each

Q10. You can take ____ road; both lead to the market. (either / neither) **Ans:** either

Q11. I bought ____ umbrella and ____ uniform. (a / an) **Ans:** an, a

Q12. The Ganga is ____ holiest river of India. **Ans:** the

Q13. He lent me ____ books he had, all three of them. (the few / few) **Ans:** the few

Q14. I do not have ____ money left for the trip. (some / any) **Ans:** any

Editing, Omission and Gap Filling

Most asked: Q3: 12 one-mark tasks, attempt any 10, in the exact SQP 2026-27 formats

Method for Q3 (10 marks: any 10 of 12)

1. Find the real subject and the time marker.
2. Name the topic: tense, modal, concord, determiner or reporting.
3. In Error / Correction, write only the wrong word and the right word.
4. In reporting, change tense, pronoun and time words together.

1. Practice Set A: Exact SQP Formats

Q1. Complete the formal email: "Your request for a refund ____ yesterday." (a) has approved (b) was approved (c) is approving (d) will be approved **Ans:** (b) was approved

Q2. Report the coach's statement. Coach: "You should warm up before every match." **Ans:** The coach advised the players to warm up before every match.

Q3. Notice: "____ students who wish to join the trek must register by Monday." (a) This (b) Those (c) That (d) Each **Ans:** (b) Those

Q4. Aman: "I could not finish my homework." Complete: Aman told his mother that ____. **Ans:** he had not been able to finish his homework.

Q5. Error / Correction: "The president, along with the members, were present." **Ans:** were ⟶ was

Q6. Hospital rule: "Visitors ____ maintain silence in the ICU corridor." (a) might (b) could (c) must (d) would **Ans:** (c) must

Q7. Select the error and correction: "Neither of the two answers are correct." (a) Neither ⟶ None (b) two ⟶ both (c) are ⟶ is (d) answers ⟶ answer **Ans:** (c) are ⟶ is

Q8. Riya asked the librarian, "Have the new magazines arrived?" Complete: Riya asked the librarian ____. **Ans:** whether the new magazines had arrived.

Q9. "There is ____ milk left; please buy some." (a) few (b) many (c) a few (d) little **Ans:** (d) little

Q10. Error / Correction: "One of my cousins live in Canada." **Ans:** live ⟶ lives

Q11. (may / must): "If you leave now, you ____ catch the last bus." **Ans:** may

Q12. Travel blog: "The old fort ____ (stand) on this hill for five hundred years." **Ans:** has stood

2. Set B: Editing (one error per line)

Line	Error	Correction
Exercise keep the body fit.	keep	keeps
Many a doctor advise a morning walk.	advise	advises
It improve blood circulation.	improve	improves
Walking is a best form of exercise.	a	the
Every students should exercise daily.	students	student
They should started the habit early.	started	start

3. Set C: Omission

Line	Before	Missing	After
Diwali is festival of lights.	is	a	festival
People clean decorate their homes.	clean	and	decorate
Sweets distributed among friends.	Sweets	are	distributed
We should avoid crackers protect the air.	crackers	to	protect

4. Set D: Gap Filling

Last Sunday our class (a) ____ a visit to an old-age home. We (b) ____ been planning it for a month. One of the residents (c) ____ us stories of his childhood. We promised that we (d) ____ visit again. **Ans:** (a) paid (b) had (c) told (d) would

Exam Alert

- Do not copy the whole sentence in the answer table; write the error and the correction only.
- Write the correction in the same word class: a verb for a verb, a determiner for a determiner.
- In reporting items, the right reporting verb with a wrong tense earns no mark.

Board ka favourite

- Concord (each, neither...nor, one of) aur tense + passive har saal aate hain.
- Saare 12 attempt karo; best 10 count hote hain.

Formal Letter Writing

Most asked: Letter to the Editor, letter to the RWA, complaint, order and enquiry (5 marks, 120 words)

1. Format of a Formal Letter (Block Format)

CBSE accepts the **block format**: every line starts at the left margin, no indentation, a blank line between parts. The labelled model shows each part in order; the 1 mark for format is lost if any part is missing or misplaced.

Model 1: Letter to the Editor (parts labelled)

You are Arjun Mehta, 22 Shiv Vihar, Rohini, Delhi. Write to the Editor of a daily about potholed roads after the monsoon. (120 words)

1 Sender's address 22, Shiv Vihar
Sector 9, Rohini, Delhi
2 Date 30 October 2026

3 Receiver The Editor
The City Chronicle, New Delhi

4 Subject **Subject: Dangerous potholes on roads in Rohini**

5 Salutation Sir

6 Body: purpose Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the civic authorities to the dangerous condition of roads in Sector 9, Rohini, after the recent monsoon.

7 Body: details Deep potholes and broken edges have appeared along the main road near the Government Senior Secondary School. Rainwater collects in them, so riders cannot judge their depth. Last week alone, three two-wheeler accidents were reported, and schoolchildren are forced to walk on the road because the footpath has caved in. Stagnant water has also become a breeding ground for mosquitoes, raising the risk of dengue.

8 Body: request I earnestly request the Municipal Corporation to repair the stretch on priority, install proper drainage and conduct regular inspections. Residents, too, must report damaged roads promptly.

9 Close Yours faithfully

10 Name *Arjun*
Arjun Mehta

Plan in 1 minute before writing

- → Underline the receiver, the sender's name and **every point** the question asks you to cover.
- → Jot 2-3 points per paragraph: purpose, details with one fact or figure, request.
- → Write the subject first: it keeps the whole letter on track.

Exam Alert

- → **Yours faithfully** for an editor or manager, not "Yours sincerely".
- → No subject line, contractions (*don't, can't*) or informal words (*plz, thanks a lot*).
- → A point asked in the question left out (e.g. "public awareness") costs content marks; 200 words earn nothing extra.

Part	Rule to remember
Address	Use only the name and address given in the question; never your own
Date	*30 October 2026*, not 30/10/26
Receiver	Designation first: The Editor / The Manager / The Secretary, RWA
Subject	One line, 6-10 words, states the issue exactly
Salutation	Sir / Madam (never "Dear Friend")
Body	3 paragraphs: purpose, details (facts, effects), request / suggestions; 100-120 words
Close	*Yours faithfully* (never "Your's"), signature, full name, designation

2. CBSE Marking Scheme (5 marks)

Criterion	Marks	What the examiner looks for
Format	1	All parts present, in the right order
Content	2	Every point of the question covered with relevant detail
Organisation	1	Logical 3-paragraph flow with linkers
Accuracy	1	Grammar, spelling, punctuation, formal tone

3. Letter Types and Phrase Bank

Type and receiver	Ready opening / key phrases
Editor (social issue)	Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to ...
Complaint (Manager / civic officer)	I wish to lodge a complaint regarding ... Kindly replace / refund / take strict action.

Type and receiver	Ready opening / key phrases
Order (Sales Manager)	I wish to place an order for the following items ... (give a table: item, quantity)
Enquiry (Director / Admissions)	I would be grateful if you could provide information about the duration, fees and ...

Type and receiver	Ready opening / key phrases
RWA / authority (Secretary)	As a concerned resident of ..., I wish to bring to your notice the need for ...
Linkers and closing	Firstly, moreover, however, consequently ... I hope you will take prompt action.

Model 2: Letter of Complaint

You are Kavya Iyer, Pune. Complain to the Manager, Smart Home Appliances, about a defective water purifier.

14, Lake View Apartments, Baner Road, Pune
30 October 2026

The Manager
Smart Home Appliances, FC Road, Pune

Subject: Complaint regarding a defective water purifier

Sir / Madam

I wish to lodge a complaint about a defective water purifier (Model AquaPure RO-7, Invoice No. 4582) which I purchased from your store on 5 October 2026.

Within a week of installation, the purifier began leaking from the base, and the filter indicator now remains red at all times. The water also has an unpleasant taste. I contacted your service centre twice, on 14 and 18 October, but no technician has visited so far, despite your promise of a 48-hour response.

Since the product is under a one-year warranty, I request you to replace it at the earliest or refund the full amount of Rs 14,500. Copies of the invoice and warranty card are enclosed. I hope you will resolve the matter within a week.

Yours faithfully
Kavya
Kavya Iyer

SQP 2026-27 pattern: RWA letter value points

Q: Maya Nair writes to the RWA Secretary on the need for a community centre. Value points expected: lack of recreational and community space; centre as a safe place for all age groups; indoor games and workshops for children; meetings, yoga and cultural events for adults; less isolation for senior citizens; appeal for early action.

Model 3: Letter Placing an Order

You are Rohan Das, Librarian, Sunrise Public School, Bhopal. Order books from Book World Distributors.

Sunrise Public School, Arera Colony, Bhopal
30 October 2026

The Sales Manager
Book World Distributors, MP Nagar, Bhopal

Subject: Order for library books

Sir

I wish to place an order for the following books for our school library, as per your latest catalogue:

S.No.	Title	Author	Copies
1	Wings of Fire	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	10
2	The Story of My Experiments with Truth	M.K. Gandhi	8
3	Malgudi Days	R.K. Narayan	12
4	The Diary of a Young Girl	Anne Frank	8

Kindly ensure that the books are new, in good condition and delivered by 15 November 2026. Please extend the usual 15 per cent discount for educational institutions. Payment will be made by cheque on delivery, along with your bill.

Damaged copies will be returned at your cost.

Yours faithfully
Rohan
Rohan Das, Librarian

Board ka favourite

→ Recent papers: **Editor** (waste burning, noise, water shortage), **RWA Secretary** (community centre, park), **complaint**, **order / enquiry**.

→ Content points ka formula: problem + effects + suggestions + appeal. Body 3 paras me, yahi organisation ka mark hai.

4. Practice Prompts

1. Meera Joshi, Jaipur: letter to the Editor on stray cattle on city roads, with remedies.
2. Aman Verma, Sports Captain: order sports equipment from Sports Gear India for your school.
3. Riya Sen, Kolkata: enquire about a summer course in graphic design: duration, fees, hostel.
4. Karan Gill, Ludhiana: request your RWA Secretary for a well-lit park and an open-air gym.
5. Neha Kapoor: complain to the Municipal Commissioner about irregular garbage collection.

ANALYTICAL PARAGRAPH

Most asked: Bar or line chart, table, product features or SWOT notes (5 marks, 100–120 words)

1. What CBSE Wants

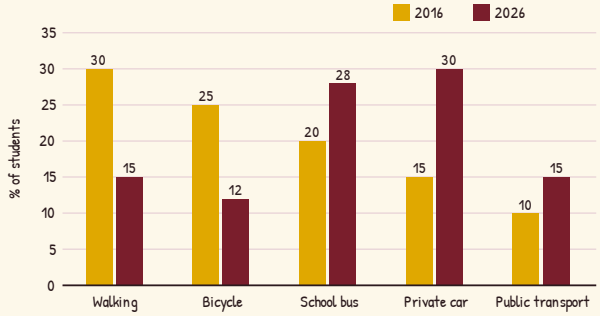
An analytical paragraph (Q5, **5 marks, 100–120 words**) **examines** data or cues and draws conclusions: a bar, line or pie chart, a table, a map, cues, product details or SWOT notes (SQP 2026-27 used product features and SWOT notes). It is **not** a description or summary and carries **no title**. Marks: **Content 2** (key figures, comparisons, inference), **Organisation 2** (intro, body, conclusion; linkers), **Accuracy 1**.

Part	What to write
Introduction (1–2 lines)	What the data shows, where, when + overall trend: *The bar chart compares … Overall, …*
Body (5–6 lines)	2–3 biggest changes with figures; compare and group: *Walking halved … In contrast, …*
Conclusion (1–2 lines)	Inference, reason or suggestion, no new data: *This trend suggests … / On balance, …*

Idea	Useful words
Rise / fall	increase, climb, surge, soar, double / decline, drop, dip, plummet, halve
Degree	sharply, steadily, significantly, marginally; reached a peak of, hit a low of
Stable / varied	remain stable, level off, plateau / fluctuate, vary
Compare / evaluate	whereas, in contrast, twice as many as, the highest share; on balance, outweigh, advisable

2. Model 1: Bar Chart

Q: The bar chart shows how students of a city travelled to school in 2016 and 2026. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words.



Mode of travel to school, students of a city (%), 2016 vs 2026

Model answer

The bar chart compares how students of a city travelled to school in 2016 and 2026. Overall, it reveals a clear shift from active modes to motorised transport. Walking, the most common mode in 2016 at 30 per cent, halved to 15 per cent by 2026. Cycling dropped from 25 to 12 per cent. In sharp contrast, the share travelling by private car doubled from 15 to 30 per cent, making it the most popular mode. School buses also gained ground, rising from 20 to 28 per cent, while public transport grew modestly from 10 to 15 per cent. This trend points to longer distances and safety concerns, but it also means heavier traffic and less exercise, which schools and planners must address.

3. Model 2: Cue / SWOT Table

Q: Your school is considering a complete ban on mobile phones on campus. Study the notes and evaluate the proposal in about 120 words.

Advantages	Disadvantages
Fewer distractions in class	Parents cannot reach children in emergencies
Less cyberbullying and photo misuse	No quick access to learning apps
More face-to-face talk and outdoor play	Safe storage of phones is difficult

Model answer

A complete ban on mobile phones in school has clear merits as well as some drawbacks. On the positive side, it would remove a major source of distraction and help students concentrate in class. It would also reduce cyberbullying and the misuse of photographs, making the campus safer. Moreover, students would spend breaks talking and playing rather than staring at screens. On the other hand, parents fear they could not reach their children in an emergency, and students would lose quick access to learning apps. Safe storage of phones is another problem. On balance, the ban seems advisable if the school provides an emergency helpdesk phone and supervised digital learning in its computer lab.

Board ka favourite and Exam Alert

- → Chart: overall trend, phir 2–3 biggest changes figures ke saath, end me reason. Cue/SWOT: dono sides balance karo, last line me verdict.
- → No title, bullets or headings; never list every figure, select and compare.

A Letter to God

1 Story in Steps

- Ripe corn on a hill; needs only rain
- Raindrops = "new coins" (10c, 5c)
- Hail ("frozen pearls") for an hour
- Field white "as if covered with salt"
- Only hope: God; asks for **100 pesos**
- Letter "To God" posted in town
- Postmaster collects money, signs "God"

2 Characters

- **Lencho:** hard-working farmer
- **Lencho:** firm faith, but naive
- **Lencho:** suspects his own helpers
- **Postmaster:** fat, amiable, moved
- **Postmaster:** gives part of salary
- **Wife:** hopeful, consoling
- **Staff:** give "an act of charity"

3 Themes and Message

- **Faith:** unshaken after total loss
- **Kindness** that seeks no credit
- **Man vs nature:** hail vs harvest
- **Man vs man:** Lencho vs post office
- Faith without reason turns naive
- Gratitude expected, suspicion came
- Hailstorm = a test of faith (SQP)

A LETTER TO GOD

G.L. Fuentes

4 Key Lines

- "They are new coins." (hope)
- "...frozen pearls." (the hail)
- "A plague of locusts would have left more than this."
- "What faith! I wish I had..."
- "Remember, no one dies of hunger."
- "...a bunch of crooks." (irony)
- Gets **70 pesos**; wants the rest

5 Literary Devices

- **Metaphor:** "new coins"
- **Metaphor:** "frozen pearls"
- **Metaphor:** "an ox of a man"
- **Simile:** "as if covered with salt"
- **Hyperbole:** the locusts line
- **Irony:** helpers called crooks
- **Contrast:** faith vs suspicion

6 Exam Focus

- Irony of the ending (3M)
- Hailstorm: more than weather
- Why postmaster signed "God"
- "Blind faith can mislead" (6M)
- Compare Lencho and postmaster
- Asked 100, got 70 (not 50)
- Lencho is naive, not greedy

Quick Tip: Ending ki irony aur postmaster ki kindness: dono ka example ready rakho.

Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom

1 10 May 1994

- Union Buildings, Pretoria
- First democratic, non-racial govt.
- Largest gathering of world leaders
- **de Klerk:** second deputy president
- **Thabo Mbeki:** first deputy president
- Mandela: first Black President
- Fly-past: army loyal to democracy
- Whites: "Nkosi"; blacks: "Die Stem"

2 Twin Obligations

- Every man has **twin obligations**
- **1. Family:** parents, wife, children
- **2. People:** community, country
- Free country: both can be met
- Apartheid: serving people cost family
- Ripped from family and home
- Mandela chose his people first

3 Idea of Freedom

- **Boyhood:** free to run and swim
- **Youth:** earn, marry, live lawfully
- Then saw his people were not free
- Own hunger became hunger for all
- Joined the **ANC**; branded a criminal
- "The oppressor must be liberated just as surely as the oppressed."
- Freedom is indivisible

LONG WALK TO FREEDOM

Nelson Mandela

4 Courage and Heroes

- Courage = triumph over fear
- Not the absence of fear
- Oppression bred great heroes
- **Oliver Tambo**, **Walter Sisulu**
- **Chief Luthuli** and many more
- Love comes more naturally than hate
- Hate is learnt; love can be taught

5 Mandela's Traits

- **Forgiving:** frees oppressor too
- **Self-sacrificing:** family for nation
- **Optimistic:** humanity in guards
- **Humble:** credits earlier heroes
- **Courageous:** conquered his fear
- **Visionary:** a non-racial nation
- Oppressor: "a prisoner of hatred"

6 Exam Focus

- Twin obligations and conflict
- Meaning of courage
- Freedom: boyhood to manhood (6M)
- Why two anthems were sung
- Meaning of the military fly-past
- "Never, never and never again..."
- Mbeki first deputy, de Klerk second

Quick Tip: Twin obligations aur courage ka matlab: har saal aata hai, apne words mein ready rakho.

Two Stories about Flying

1 His First Flight

- Young seagull alone on the ledge
- Brothers and sister have all flown
- Parents threaten to starve him
- No food since the previous nightfall
- Mother holds fish just out of reach
- Maddened by hunger, he dives at it
- Wings spread; he soars at last
- Lands on the "green sea", floats

2 The Black Aeroplane

- 1:30 a.m.: Dakota, France to England
- Dreams of a "big English breakfast"
- Paris Control: turn 12 degrees west
- Storm clouds "like black mountains"
- Fuel low: "I'll take the risk"
- Compass and radio die in the storm
- Black plane, no lights, guides him in
- Control: no other plane on radar

3 Themes

- Fear lives in the mind, not the wings
- Hunger pushes the gull past fear
- Mother's tough love builds courage
- Family praise completes the change
- Pilot's daring nearly costs his life
- Help in need: angel, God or instinct?
- Mystery left open to the reader

4 Characters

- **Seagull:** timid, then confident
- **Mother:** wise, uses tough love
- **Father:** scolds, threatens
- **Family:** taunt, then cheer him
- **Pilot:** daring, impulsive
- **Black pilot:** silent helper
- **Control woman:** sees no plane

5 Key Lines and Images

- "...wings would never support him"
- "I'll take the risk."
- **Simile:** "like black mountains"
- "Good big English breakfast"
- Fish held just out of reach
- "Green sea": the gull's view
- Plane vanishes after landing

6 Exam Focus

- Compare Valli and seagull (6M)
- Why mother held back the fish
- What risk did the pilot take?
- Who was the black pilot? (view)
- Fear vs courage in both stories
- Gull: 2 brothers and 1 sister
- Instruments fail **inside** storm

TWO STORIES ABOUT FLYING

O'Flaherty · Forsyth

Quick Tip: Valli aur seagull ka comparison 6 marks mein aata hai: dono ka transformation likho.

From the Diary of Anne Frank

1 Why a Diary

- Writing a diary feels strange at 13
- Thinks no one cares for her musings
- "Paper has more patience than people"
- Loving parents, 16-year-old sister
- About thirty friends, no true friend
- Diary becomes her friend: **Kitty**
- Starts with a sketch of her life
- Begun 20 June 1942, in Dutch

2 Life Sketch

- Born 12 June 1929, Frankfurt
- Sister Margot born in 1926
- Family moved to Holland in 1933
- Studied at a Montessori school
- Mrs Kuperus: headmistress, sixth form
- Grandma died in January 1942
- Candle lit for Grandma on birthday

3 Mr Keesing's Essays

- Maths teacher; punishes her talking
- **Essay 1:** "A Chatterbox"
- Talking is inherited from her mother
- Inherited traits cannot be cured
- **Essay 2:** "An Incorrigible Chatterbox"
- **Essay 3:** "Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox"
- Keesing laughs; lets her talk

DIARY OF ANNE FRANK

Anne Frank

4 Anne's Traits

- **Talkative:** a born chatterbox
- **Witty:** turns punishment to fun
- **Frank:** honest about teachers
- **Introspective:** judges herself
- **Lonely:** no one to confide in
- **Sensitive:** misses Grandma
- **Loving:** "most adorable father"

5 Key Lines and Themes

- "Teachers are the most unpredictable creatures on earth."
- "...the joke was on him."
- "Old fogey": her name for Keesing
- **Loneliness** amid many friends
- **Wit wins** over punishment
- **Good teacher** can take a joke
- Poem with Sanne: duck and swan

6 Exam Focus

- Why a diary; why named Kitty
- Order of the three essays
- How Keesing was unpredictable
- Character sketch of Anne (6M)
- Paper vs people: explain
- Keesing taught **maths**
- Poem written **with Sanne**

Quick Tip: Teen essays ka order aur Kitty naam kyun: dono pakka yaad rakho.

Glimpses of India

1 A Baker from Goa

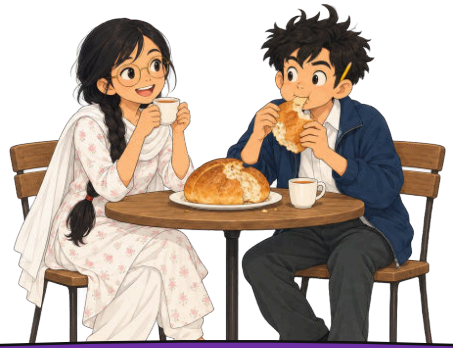
- By Lucio Rodrigues
- Elders miss Portuguese-era loaves
- Bakers (**pader**) still exist in Goa
- Jingle of his bamboo heralds him
- Came twice a day; bread-bangles
- **Bol:** weddings; cakes: Christmas
- Dress: **kabai**, frock to the knees
- Bills in pencil on a wall

2 Coorg (Kodagu)

- By Lokesh Abrol
- Smallest district of Karnataka
- Between Mysore and Mangalore
- Coffee estates, spices, rainforests
- Best season: September to March
- Greek or Arab descent; **kuppia** coat
- Coorg Regiment; General Cariappa
- River Kaveri rises here; mahaseer

3 Tea from Assam

- By Arup Kumar Datta
- Pranjol and Rajvir go by train
- 80 crore cups of tea drunk daily
- Legend: a Chinese emperor's brew
- Legend: Bodhidharma's eyelids
- China drank tea from 2700 B.C.
- Europe, 16th century: as medicine
- Dhekiabari: best tea May to July



GLIMPSES OF INDIA

Three travelogues

4 Themes

- India's cultural and natural diversity
- Old traditions survive change
- Food tied to Goan festivals
- Coorgis: brave and hospitable
- Legends add charm to history
- Nature and adventure in Coorg
- Assam: largest tea plantations

5 Key Words

- **Pader:** Goan baker
- **Kabai:** baker's long frock
- **Bolinhas:** Christmas sweets
- **Kuppia:** like the Arab kuffia
- **Kodavus:** guns without licence
- **Second flush:** sprouting period
- **Jackfruit-like** plump baker

6 Exam Focus

- Why the tea legends (SQP)
- Bread at Goan occasions
- Baker's dress then and now
- Coorg adventures: rafting, climbing
- Bylakuppe Tibetan monks
- Kodagu is the **smallest** district
- Best tea: second flush

Quick Tip: Teeno pieces ka purpose yaad rakho: tradition, diversity, aur tea ke legends.

Mijbil the Otter

1 Story in Steps

- Dog Jonnie dies; Maxwell wants an otter
- 1956, Basra: otters of Tigris marshes
- Two Arabs bring an otter in a sack
- Named Mijbil; aloof at first
- Wild with joy in the bath
- No animals on British airline: via Paris
- In London: walks and new games

2 The Flight Episode

- Box 18 inches square for the trip
- Mij tears the box lining to shreds
- Blood-spattered; lid held down
- Air hostess lets Mij on his knee
- Mij escapes; a woman screams "A rat!"
- Maxwell's face lands in curry
- Hostess calmly finds Mij

3 Mij's Nature

- New race: *Maxwell's otter*
- Learns to turn on the tap
- Dribbles a ball like a footballer
- Rolls marbles on his belly
- Ball game on a sloping suitcase lid
- Runs along a school's low wall
- Plays, fears and loves like a child

MIJBIL THE OTTER

Gavin Maxwell

4 Characters

- **Mij:** playful, intelligent
- **Mij:** affectionate, inventive
- **Maxwell:** caring, patient
- **Maxwell:** humorous narrator
- **Air hostess:** kind and calm
- "The very queen of her kind"
- **Londoners:** curious, puzzled

5 Guesses and Key Lines

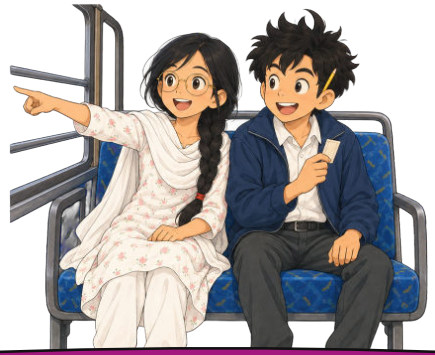
- Baby seal, squirrel, walrus
- Hippo, beaver, bear cub
- Leopard, even brontosaur
- "...what is that supposed to be?"
- "...a phase of my thraldom..."
- "...like a ricochetting bullet"
- Themes: animal intelligence, care

6 Exam Focus

- Air hostess: "queen of her kind"
- Box and plane episode (6M)
- Why called "Maxwell's otter"
- Mij's games and intelligence
- A pet needs time and patience
- Flew via **Paris**, not direct
- Tore the **lining**, not the lid

Quick Tip: Box aur plane wala episode 6 marks ka favourite hai: sequence yaad rakho.

Madam Rides the Bus



MADAM RIDES THE BUS

Vallikkannan

1 Story in Steps

- Valli, 8, longs to ride the bus
- Learns: town is six miles away
- Fare 30 paise one way; 45 minutes
- Saves **60 paise**; skips sweets, toys
- Slips out during mother's nap
- Takes the one o'clock bus
- Home at 3:40; no one finds out

2 On the Bus

- "I'm not a child... I'm eight years old."
- Stands on seat to see over blind
- Canal, palm trees, mountains, fields
- Laughs at a young cow running ahead
- Snubs a nosy elderly woman
- Stays on the bus in town
- Refuses a drink: "not enough money"

3 The Return

- Same cow lies dead by the road
- Hit by a fast-moving vehicle
- Her joy dies; she sits quietly
- Image of the cow haunts her
- Slips home before mother wakes
- Aunt and mother never learn
- Smiles to herself: secret kept

4 Characters

- **Valli:** curious, determined
- **Valli:** self-reliant, sensitive
- **Conductor:** friendly, humorous
- **Conductor:** kind to a child
- **Elderly woman:** nosy, talkative
- **Mother:** naps, never suspects
- **Friends:** boast of the town

5 Themes and Symbols

- Curiosity with careful planning
- Self-respect: pays her own fare
- Growing up; first brush with death
- **Bus:** the wider world
- **Dead cow:** fragile life
- **"Madam":** mock respect
- "Proud! proud!" (to her friends)

6 Exam Focus

- Valli's planning in numbers
- Why the conductor says "madam"
- Dead cow and its effect (6M)
- Valli's character sketch
- Compare Valli and seagull
- Saved 60 paise, not 30
- Same cow she had laughed at

Quick Tip: Valli ki planning ke numbers aur dead cow ka asar: dono 6M mein aate hain.

The Sermon at Benares

The Buddha

1 The Buddha's Life

- Prince Siddhartha Gautama
- Lived 563-483 BC; married at 16
- At 25 saw sick, old, dead, a monk
- Left home to seek enlightenment
- Wandered for seven years
- Peepal tree: enlightened in 7 days
- Named it the **Bodhi Tree**
- First sermon preached at Benares

2 Kisa Gotami's Story

- Her only son dies
- Asks neighbours for medicine
- They think she has lost her senses
- A man sends her to Sakyamuni
- Task: mustard seed from a house...
- ...where no one has lost anyone
- Every house has lost a loved one
- City lights flicker out: she sees

3 The Sermon

- Life is brief and full of pain
- All who are born must die
- Like ripe fruits early to fall
- Like the potter's pots, all break
- Weeping brings no peace
- Grief makes one sick and pale
- Wise draw out the "arrow of lamentation"

4 Themes

- Death is universal, inevitable
- Grief is selfish if it ignores all
- Acceptance brings peace
- Learning by own experience
- Compassion of the Buddha
- The wise do not grieve
- Sorrow shared by every family

5 Characters and Lines

- **Kisa:** grief-stricken, then wise
- **Buddha:** compassionate teacher
- "The living are few, but the dead are many."
- "How selfish am I in my grief!"
- "Death is common to all."
- Method: a task, not a lecture
- Old-fashioned, sermon-like style

6 Exam Focus

- Two rounds door to door: why
- What Kisa Gotami learnt
- The Buddha's method of teaching
- Lamps image: lives flicker out
- Meaning of the sermon (6M)
- Seed was easy; deathless house not
- Mistake: "no one gave her seed"

Quick Tip: Kisa do baar ghar-ghar gayi: pehli baar medicine, doosri baar mustard seed. Fark likho.

The Proposal

1 Plot in Steps

- Lomov, 35, comes in evening dress
- Chubukov agrees, calls Natalya
- Preamble: "my Oxen Meadows"
- Natalya: the meadows are ours
- Insults fly; Lomov leaves, faint
- Told of proposal: "Bring him back!"
- Second quarrel: the two dogs
- Engaged, yet they argue at once

2 The Two Quarrels

- **1. Oxen Meadows:** both claim land
- 5 dessiatins, about 300 roubles
- Lomov calls Chubukov a "grabber"
- Chubukov calls him "pettifogger"
- **2. Dogs:** Guess vs Squeezer
- Lomov's Guess: 125 roubles
- Squeezer: 85; Lomov: "overshot"

3 Themes and Genre

- **Farce:** exaggeration, quick reversals
- Marriage for property, not love
- Satire on rich landowners
- Trivial quarrels over land and dogs
- Comic insults and hypocrisy
- One-act play, Russia (1888-89)
- Engaged, yet fighting at the end

THE PROPOSAL

Anton Chekhov

4 Characters

- **Lomov:** nervous, hypochondriac
- **Lomov:** quarrelsome, palpitations
- **Natalya:** sharp, stubborn
- **Natalya:** practical, wants to marry
- **Chubukov:** greedy, hypocritical
- **Chubukov:** rushes the match
- All three: proud and petty

5 Key Lines

- "...as if you were my own son."
- "Oxen Meadows are ours, not yours!"
- "Bring him back!"
- "...my foot's gone to sleep"
- "...a way to start your family bliss!"
- "Better!" "Worse!"
- "Champagne!"

6 Exam Focus

- The two quarrels (6M)
- Marriage for property: theme
- Character sketch of any one
- Why the play is a farce
- Guess: Lomov's; Squeezer: Chubukov's
- Lomov 35, Natalya 25
- Irony of the happy ending

Quick Tip: Do jhagde yaad rakho: Oxen Meadows aur Guess vs Squeezer. Theme: shaadi property ke liye.

Dust of Snow

DUST OF SNOW

Robert Frost

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** Robert Frost, American poet
- **Form:** 8-line lyric, two quatrains, one single sentence
- **Rhyme scheme:** abab cdcd
- **Tone:** reflective; gloom turns to cheer
- **Speaker:** the poet, on a sad day
- **Setting:** winter; a crow on a hemlock tree

2 Stanza Flow

- **St. 1:** a crow sits on a hemlock tree
- It shakes the branch; fine snow falls on the poet
- **St. 2:** the cold touch changes his mood at once
- He had "rued" (regretted) the whole day
- Now the rest of the day is "saved"
- He feels fresh and hopeful again

3 Symbols & Devices

- **Crow:** ill omen, bad luck, sorrow
- **Hemlock:** poisonous tree, gloom, death
- **Snow:** joy, freshness, renewal
- **Metaphor:** "dust of snow" = fine snowflakes
- **Alliteration:** "saved some", "has ... heart"
- **Enjambment:** one sentence across eight lines
- **Contrast:** dark images bring a bright mood

4 Central Idea & Themes

- Nature heals a sad, depressed heart
- One small moment can rescue a whole day
- Joy can come from unexpected, dark sources
- Our response decides our mood
- Frost: "a little thing touches a larger thing"
- **Message:** stay open to small joys

5 Key Lines & Words

- "The way a crow / Shook down on me"
- "The dust of snow / From a hemlock tree"
- "Has given my heart / A change of mood"
- "And saved some part / Of a day I had rued."
- **Rued:** held in regret
- **Hemlock:** poisonous tree with small white flowers
- **Shook down:** made to fall

6 Exam Focus

- Mood change and its cause (3M)
- Why a crow and hemlock, not nightingale or oak?
- "Rued" = regretted, not "ruined"
- Crow does not throw snow; it shakes the branch
- Pair with *The Ball Poem*
- 6M: small experiences, big lessons

Quick Tip: "Small incident, big change" ka contrast har answer me zaroor likho.

Fire and Ice

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** Robert Frost
- **Form:** one stanza of 9 lines, short lyric
- **Rhyme scheme:** abaabcbcb
- Rhymes: fire/desire/fire; ice/twice/ice/suffice
- **Tone:** casual, ironic, understated
- **Theme:** desire and hatred can destroy the world

FIRE AND ICE

Robert Frost

2 Line Flow

- **Lines 1-2:** two views on the end of the world
- Some say fire: sun bursts, earth burns
- Some say ice: the earth freezes
- **Lines 3-4:** having "tasted of desire", he favours fire
- **Lines 5-9:** if the world "had to perish twice"
- His knowledge of hate says ice "would suffice"
- Both are equally capable of destruction

3 Symbolism

- **Fire:** desire, greed, lust, avarice
- Fire also: fury, conflict, passion
- **Ice:** hatred, coldness, indifference
- Ice also: rigidity, intolerance, cruelty
- Desire spreads fast and consumes, like fire
- Hatred hardens slowly and numbs, like ice

4 Poetic Devices

- **Antithesis:** fire vs ice, desire vs hate
- **Anaphora:** "Some say" in lines 1-2
- **Metaphor:** "tasted of desire"
- **Understatement:** "Is also great / And would suffice"
- **Irony:** calm words for total destruction
- **Enjambment:** lines 6-9 run on as one cold thought

5 Message & Words

- Real danger: uncontrolled human emotions
- Not nature, but greed and hate end the world
- Today: greed causes wars and exploitation
- Hatred causes violence and division
- **Solution:** tolerance, contentment, empathy
- **Perish:** die; **suffice:** be enough; **favour:** support

6 Exam Focus

- What fire and ice symbolise (most asked)
- How rhyme links fire-desire and ice-suffice
- Not a science poem: symbols of emotions
- Poet does not choose one; both can destroy
- Meaning of "perish twice"
- 6M: emotions vs natural disasters

Quick Tip: Symbols ko emotions se jodo: fire = desire, ice = hatred. Yahi core hai.

A Tiger in the Zoo

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** Leslie Norris, Welsh poet
- **Form:** 5 quatrains
- **Rhyme:** abcb, loosely (cage/rage, cars/stars)
- **Tone:** sympathetic, quietly critical of zoos
- **Structure:** zoo, then jungle, then zoo: no escape
- **Theme:** freedom vs captivity

2 Stanza Flow

- **St. 1:** stalks the few steps of his cage
- Vivid stripes, velvet pads, "quiet rage"
- **St. 2:** "should be" lurking near the water hole
- **St. 3:** snarling at the jungle's edge, terrorising the village
- **St. 4:** locked in a concrete cell, ignores visitors
- **St. 5:** hears patrolling cars, stares at the stars

A TIGER IN THE ZOO

Leslie Norris

3 Zoo vs Wild

- **Zoo place:** cage, bars, concrete cell
- **Wild place:** shadow, long grass, water hole
- **Zoo actions:** stalks, ignores, stares
- **Wild actions:** lurks, slides, snarls, bares fangs
- **Zoo mood:** quiet rage, helplessness
- **Wild mood:** power, freedom, fearlessness
- Captivity crushes his natural strength

4 Poetic Devices

- **Oxymoron:** "quiet rage": anger he cannot express
- **Metaphor:** "pads of velvet" = soft paws
- **Metaphor:** "concrete cell" = prison
- **Alliteration:** "sliding ... shadow"
- **Repetition:** "brilliant eyes / brilliant stars"
- **Anaphora:** "He should be" in stanzas 2 and 3

5 Key Lines & Words

- "He stalks in his vivid stripes / The few steps of his cage"
- "On pads of velvet quiet, / In his quiet rage."
- "Locked in a concrete cell"
- "And stares with his brilliant eyes / At the brilliant stars."
- **Stalks:** walks with slow, angry steps
- **Lurking:** waiting hidden; **snarling:** angry growl

6 Exam Focus

- Contrast cage vs jungle (3M, most asked)
- Meaning of "quiet rage"
- Ignoring visitors = hopelessness, contempt
- Stars = freedom he cannot reach
- 6M: Are zoos justified? Sanctuaries better
- Poet's view: animals belong in the wild

Quick Tip: Zoo vs wild wali do column table se answer likho, marks pakke.

How to Tell Wild Animals

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** Carolyn Wells, American humorist
- **Form:** 6 stanzas of 6 lines
- **Rhyme scheme:** ababcc
- **Tone:** humorous, ironic, light-hearted
- A comic "guide" to identifying wild animals
- **Real advice:** admire them from a safe distance

2 The Animals (1)

- **Asian Lion:** large tawny beast
- Lion roars at you "as you're dyin'"
- **Bengal Tiger:** noble, black stripes on yellow ground
- Tiger: "just notice if he eats you"
- **Leopard:** hide peppered with spots
- Leopard "lept" on you, will "lep and lep again"

3 The Animals (2)

- **Bear:** hugs you very, very hard
- If in doubt, "one more caress"
- **Hyena:** comes with merry smiles
- **Crocodile:** if they weep, they are crocodiles
- **Chameleon:** small, lizard-like, no ears, no wing
- See nothing on the tree? It is the chameleon
- Every "rule" works only when it is too late

4 Poetic Licence

- "dyin'" rhymes with "lion"
- "lept", "lep" for rhythm and humour
- "A novice might nonplus" (correct: be nonplussed)
- Deliberate misspellings, not errors
- Licence keeps rhyme and rhythm smooth
- Makes the poem funny and memorable

5 Humour & Devices

- **Irony:** "Just notice if he eats you"
- **Irony:** "one more caress" for a deadly bear hug
- **Alliteration:** "simple rule ... spots", "true tree"
- **Idioms:** crocodile tears, bear hug, laughing hyena
- **Personification:** hyenas "come with merry smiles"
- **Words:** tawny = brownish-yellow; discern = identify
- **Words:** hide = skin; novice = beginner

6 Exam Focus

- Examples of poetic licence (most asked)
- How to identify the lion and the tiger (3M)
- Why is the poem humorous?
- Couplet "lep and lep again": dark humour
- It is a funny poem, not a real guide
- 6M: poets take liberties with language

Quick Tip: "When it is too late" wali irony har answer me likho.

The Ball Poem

THE BALL POEM

John Berryman

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** John Berryman, American poet
- **Form:** free verse, 18 lines, one stanza
- **Rhyme scheme:** none (free verse)
- **Tone:** sympathetic, reflective, philosophical
- **Theme:** loss, responsibility, growing up
- **Speaker:** the poet, watching a boy
- **Setting:** a street near a harbour

2 Poem Flow

- Ball bounces merrily down the street
- It falls into the harbour water
- "What, what is he to do?"
- "An ultimate shaking grief" fixes the boy
- He stands rigid, trembling, staring into the water
- "All his young days" went with the ball
- He learns "how to stand up"

3 No Intrusion

- Poet "would not intrude on him"
- Will not offer a dime for a new ball
- "A dime, another ball, is worthless"
- Boy must learn the lesson himself
- Poet is not unkind, but wise
- **Money is external:** cannot buy back memories

4 The Lesson

- "First responsibility in a world of possessions"
- Things are lost; "no one buys a ball back"
- **Epistemology of loss:** knowing what loss means
- Learning to bear loss and stand up again
- A lesson every man must learn one day
- A step from innocence into maturity

5 Symbols & Devices

- **Ball:** childhood, innocence, memories
- **Harbour water:** loss that cannot be reversed
- **Rhetorical question:** "What is he to do?"
- **Repetition:** "merrily", "how to stand up"
- **Alliteration:** "boy ... ball", "stands ... staring"
- **Transferred epithet:** "desperate eyes"
- **Enjambment:** lines roll on like the ball

6 Exam Focus

- Why the poet does not offer money (3M)
- Meaning of "epistemology of loss"
- What the boy learns from the loss
- **Words:** intrude, dime, rigid, desperate
- Pair with *Dust of Snow* (SQP 2026-27)
- 6M: "Loss is a great teacher"

Quick Tip: "Responsibility + stand up" dono words answer me zaroor daalo.

Amanda!

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** Robin Klein, Australian children's writer
- **Form:** 7 three-line stanzas
- St. 1, 3, 5, 7: an elder's (mother's) orders
- St. 2, 4, 6 (in brackets): Amanda's daydreams
- **Rhyme:** dreams aaa; orders end in "Amanda!"
- **Tone:** scolding vs dreamy; ironic ending

2 The Orders

- "Don't bite your nails, Amanda!"
- Homework, tidy room, clean shoes
- "Don't eat that chocolate... remember your acne"
- "Look at me when I'm speaking to you"
- Shows Amanda is not listening at all
- "Stop that sulking... always so moody"

3 The Daydreams

- **Mermaid:** alone in a "languid, emerald sea"
- Sole inhabitant: wants peace and solitude
- **Orphan:** roaming the street, bare feet
- "The silence is golden, the freedom is sweet"
- **Rapunzel:** in a "tranquil and rare" tower
- Will never let down her hair: no one reaches her

AMANDA!

Robin Klein

4 Poetic Devices

- **Repetition:** "Amanda!" ends each order
- **Anaphora:** "Don't bite... / Don't hunch..."
- **Metaphor:** "emerald sea", "silence is golden"
- **Alliteration:** "Stop that slouching and sit up straight"
- **Allusion:** Rapunzel (fairy tale)
- **Irony:** "Anyone would think that I nagged at you"

5 Message & Words

- Constant nagging drives a child into dreams
- Amanda is not moody; she longs for freedom
- Parents mean well, but give no reasons or warmth
- Guide with patience; listen and give space
- **Languid:** slow, relaxed; **hushed:** quiet
- **Tranquil:** calm; **sulking:** silent, bad-tempered

6 Exam Focus

- Why are stanzas 2, 4, 6 in brackets?
- Amanda's age: about 9-12 (homework, acne)
- Is Amanda moody? (most asked)
- Irony in the last stanza
- Not a real orphan or mermaid: imaginary roles
- 6M: guidance, not constant correction

Quick Tip: Likho ki Amanda "moody" nahi hai, bas freedom chahti hai. Yahi key point hai.

The Trees

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** Adrienne Rich (USA), feminist poet
- **Form:** free verse, 3 stanzas, no rhyme
- **Speaker:** a woman inside the house, writing letters
- **Tone:** calm and observant, then urgent
- "Listen. The glass is breaking."
- **Theme:** nature's freedom; women's freedom

2 Stanza Flow

- **St. 1:** trees inside move out to the empty forest
- Forest: no bird sits, no insect hides
- No sun buries its feet in shadow
- **St. 2:** all night the roots work free of floor cracks
- Leaves strain toward the glass
- Boughs shuffle "like newly discharged patients"
- **St. 3:** glass breaks; trees stumble into the night

3 The Struggle

- **Roots:** disengage from cracks in the veranda floor
- **Leaves:** strain toward the glass
- **Twigs:** "stiff with exertion"
- **Boughs:** long-cramped under the roof
- Every part of the tree fights to escape
- By morning the forest will be full

4 Symbolism

- **Trees:** women confined to the home
- **House:** confinement, male-dominated society
- **Forest:** freedom, natural place
- **Breaking glass:** breaking barriers
- **Moon:** whole, then "broken like a mirror"
- Moon pieces flash in the crown of the tallest oak
- **Speaker's letters:** silence, suppressed voice

THE TREES

Adrienne Rich

5 Poetic Devices

- **Personification:** roots work, boughs shuffle
- **Personification:** "sun bury its feet"
- **Simile:** "like newly discharged patients"
- **Simile:** "like a voice", "like a mirror"
- **Imagery:** "smell of leaves and lichen"
- **Words:** bough = branch; disengage = separate

6 Exam Focus

- Where are the trees? Inside the house
- Why is the forest empty?
- Moon described twice: whole, then broken
- Why she scarcely mentions it in her letters (3M)
- Boughs = "discharged patients", not prisoners
- 6M: nature (deforestation) + women's freedom

Quick Tip: 6-marker me dono level likho: nature (deforestation) aur women's freedom.

Fog

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** Carl Sandburg, American poet
- **Form:** free verse, 6 short lines, 2 stanzas
- **Rhyme scheme:** none
- **Core device:** extended (implied) metaphor
- Fog is compared to a cat throughout
- **Tone:** quiet, calm, observant
- **Setting:** a harbour and a city

2 Line Flow

- **Lines 1-2:** "The fog comes / on little cat feet"
- Arrives silently, softly, unheard
- **Lines 3-5:** "It sits looking / over harbour and city"
- Sits "on silent haunches", watching
- Covers everything below it
- **Line 6:** "and then moves on"
- Leaves suddenly, at its own will

3 Fog as a Cat

- **1.** Comes silently on little cat feet
- **2.** Sits still on its haunches, looking
- **3.** Moves on whenever it likes
- Cat-like: quiet, watchful, independent
- No "like" or "as": comparison is implied
- So it is a metaphor, not a simile

4 Poetic Devices

- **Metaphor (implied):** fog = cat
- **Personification:** "It sits looking", "moves on"
- **Imagery:** "little cat feet", "silent haunches"
- **Alliteration:** "sits ... silent"
- **Enjambment:** "It sits looking / over harbour"
- **Free verse:** no rhyme, no fixed rhythm
- Short lines match the soft, quiet fog

5 Central Idea & Message

- Silent beauty and changing moods of nature
- Nature is quiet, mysterious, temporary
- Like fog, difficult times also pass
- Patience and calm help us through troubles
- An ordinary sight made memorable
- **Words:** haunches = sitting with knees bent
- **Harbour:** place where ships are kept

6 Exam Focus

- What is the fog compared to? (1M)
- Three cat-like features of fog (3M)
- Write "metaphor", not "simile"
- Is it a rhyming poem? No, free verse
- Fog sits over "harbour and city"
- 6M: "Like the fog, troubles come and go"

Quick Tip: "Haunches" ka matlab: knees bend karke baithna. Spelling dhyan se likho.

The Tale of Custard the Dragon

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** Ogden Nash, 400+ pieces of comic verse
- **Form:** ballad close to a parody (mock-heroic)
- 4-line stanzas; **rhyme:** aabb (house/mouse)
- "Winda" spelt to rhyme with Belinda
- **Tone:** humorous, ironic
- **Theme:** true courage vs boasting

CUSTARD THE DRAGON

Ogden Nash

2 Characters

- **Belinda:** owner, "brave as a barrel full of bears"
- **Ink:** black kitten; **Blink:** grey mouse
- **Mustard:** yellow dog, "brave as a tiger in a rage"
- **Custard:** "cowardly" dragon, the real hero
- "Mouth like a fireplace, chimney for a nose"
- Teased name for Custard: "Percival"

3 Story Flow

- All boast of bravery; Custard cries for a safe cage
- They tickle him and laugh at him
- A pirate climbs in the window: pistols, cutlass
- Black beard, wooden leg; everyone flees or hides
- Custard dodges bullets, gobbles the pirate
- Others boast again; Custard stays modest

4 Reactions to the Pirate

- **Belinda:** paled and cried "Help! Help!"
- **Mustard:** fled with a terrified yelp
- **Ink:** trickled to the bottom of the household
- **Blink:** strategically mouseholed
- **Custard:** "snorting like an engine"
- Went at the pirate "like a robin at a worm"

5 Poetic Devices

- **Simile:** "brave as a barrel full of bears"
- **Simile:** "like a robin at a worm"
- **Alliteration:** "clatter and a clank"
- **Onomatopoeia:** "Meowch!", "Weeck!", "clank"
- **Coinage:** "realio, trulio", "mouseholed"
- **Irony:** the "coward" saves everyone
- **Simile:** "Clashed his tail like irons in a dungeon"

6 Exam Focus

- Pet names and traits (Ink, Blink, Mustard)
- Why is Custard called cowardly?
- Why is it a ballad close to a parody? (3M)
- Why do the others boast again at the end?
- Do not judge by appearance
- 6M: "Actions speak louder than words"

Quick Tip: Final answer me irony zaroor likho: jo darpok kehlata tha, wahi hero nikla.

For Anne Gregory

1 Poem at a Glance

- **Poet:** W.B. Yeats, Irish, Nobel Prize 1923
- **Form:** 3 stanzas of 6 lines each
- A conversation: young man and young woman
- **Rhyme scheme:** abcbdb (despair/ear/hair)
- **Tone:** light, teasing, reflective
- **Theme:** outer beauty vs inner beauty

2 Stanza Flow

- **St. 1 (young man):** men are "thrown into despair"
- By her "great honey-coloured ramparts"
- No one will love her for herself alone
- **St. 2 (Anne):** she can dye her hair
- Brown, or black, or carrot
- **St. 3 (young man):** an old religious man's text
- Only God can love her for herself alone

FOR ANNE GREGORY

W.B. Yeats

3 Key Ideas

- People are drawn first to outward beauty
- Anne wants love for her inner self
- Dye would change only her appearance
- Human love starts with looks
- Unconditional love: possible only for God
- **Message:** value character; looks fade

4 Poetic Devices

- **Metaphor:** "honey-coloured ramparts"
- Hair as castle walls guarding her real self
- **Hyperbole:** "thrown into despair"
- **Alliteration:** "yourself ... yellow"
- **Refrain:** "for yourself alone / And not your yellow hair"
- **Imagery:** golden, honey-coloured hair

5 Words & Key Lines

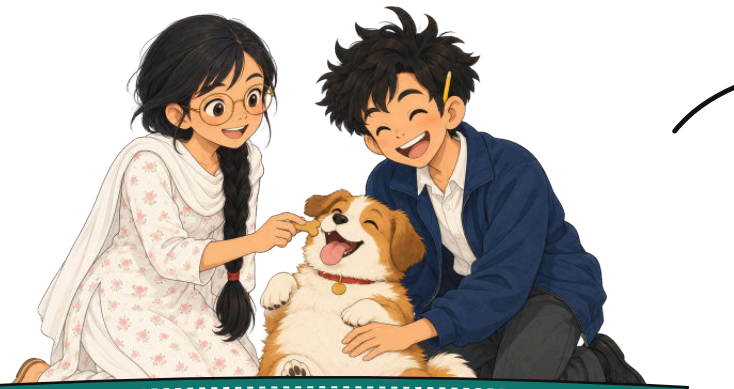
- **Ramparts:** high, wide walls around a fort
- **Despair:** loss of hope
- **Yesternight:** last night
- **Text:** a passage from a religious book
- "Never shall a young man, / Thrown into despair"
- "But I can get a hair-dye / And set such colour there"
- "That only God, my dear, / Could love you for yourself alone"

6 Exam Focus

- Why does Anne want to dye her hair? (3M)
- Meaning of "honey-coloured ramparts"
- Significance of the old religious man's text
- Hair is yellow (golden), not brown
- Rhyme scheme abcbdb, not aabb
- 6M: "Beauty attracts, but character keeps"

Quick Tip: "Only God" wala point har answer me: insaan pehle looks dekhta hai.

A Triumph of Surgery



A TRIUMPH OF SURGERY

James Herriot

1 Story in Steps

- Tricki, a Pekinese, grossly overfed
- Extras: malt, cod-liver oil, Horlicks
- Cream cakes and chocolates too
- No walks: Hodgkin has lumbago
- Tricki vomits, lies panting on a rug
- Herriot takes him to the surgery
- After a fortnight: lithe, hard-muscled

2 The Cure

- **Two days:** no food, only water
- Joins Joe and the dog pack
- Fights for food, plays, chases rats
- **No medicine**: diet + exercise only
- Her luggage: beds, toys, coats, bowls
- Gifts: eggs, then wine, then brandy
- Returns fit; she weeps with joy

3 Characters

- **Herriot:** wise, tactful, firm, funny
- Tells her to cut out sweets and extras
- **Mrs Pumphrey:** rich, lonely, doting
- "I can't bear to refuse him"
- Rings a dozen times a day for news
- **Tricki:** greedy, pampered, then fit
- **Joe:** greyhound, leads the pack

4 Themes and Message

- **Pampering is not love**
- Overindulgence harms pets and children
- **Common sense** beats medicine
- **Loneliness** of the rich
- Real care needs discipline
- Light satire on the idle rich
- Honesty: Herriot admits enjoying gifts

5 Devices and Key Lines

- **Irony:** no surgery was ever done
- **Simile:** "like a bloated sausage"
- "with a leg at each corner"
- **Hyperbole:** "thirty feet of gleaming metal"
- "This is a triumph of surgery!"
- Humour: vet enjoys the eggs and wine

6 Exam Focus

- Foolish love vs sensible care (6M)
- Why is the title ironic? (3M)
- Was Herriot tactful? Give evidence
- Overindulgence is as bad as neglect
- Character sketch of Mrs Pumphrey
- **Alert:** Tricki Pekinese; Joe greyhound
- **Alert:** gifts: eggs, wine, brandy

Quick Tip: Title ki irony pakki karo: koi surgery nahi, sirf diet aur exercise.

The Thief's Story

THE THIEF'S STORY

Ruskin Bond

1 Story in Steps

- Hari Singh, 15, an experienced thief
- Flatters Anil at a wrestling match
- Anil feeds him; Hari cooks for him
- Cheats a rupee a day on shopping
- Steals **600 rupees** in fifties at night
- Misses the **10.30 Express** to Lucknow
- Slips the money back before dawn

2 Turning Point

- Hesitates as the train pulls out
- Sits in the rain at the maidan
- Values writing: "whole sentences"
- Wants to be "a clever and respected man"
- Conscience wins over greed
- Anil gives him a still-wet fifty
- Learning sentences worth more than theft

3 Characters

- **Hari:** clever, cunning, lonely
- "a fairly good study of men's faces"
- Takes a new name every month
- **Anil:** trusting, generous writer
- Teaches Hari to write his name
- Knows of the theft, says nothing
- Anil earns money by fits and starts

4 Themes and Message

- **Trust transforms** a person
- Kindness reforms more than punishment
- **Education**: path to respect
- **Conscience:** greed vs goodness
- **Silent forgiveness**: second chance
- Hard to rob a trusting man

5 Devices and Key Lines

- First-person confession by the thief
- **Irony:** trust protects Anil
- "a beam of moonlight stepped over"
- **Rain** mirrors his inner turmoil
- "Not for the loss of money, but for the loss of trust"
- "the smile came by itself"

6 Exam Focus

- Why did Anil not call the police?
- Three reasons Hari came back (3M)
- Trust and education change lives (6M)
- Character sketch of Anil
- **Alert:** 600 rupees; train to Lucknow
- **Alert:** Hari narrates, Anil writes
- **Alert:** money hidden under mattress

Quick Tip: Hari wapas kyun aaya: education + Anil ka trust + conscience. Teeno likho.

THE MIDNIGHT VISITOR

Robert Arthur

1 Story in Steps

- Fowler, young writer, meets Ausable
- Ausable: fat, wheezy, from Boston
- Report on **new missiles** due at 12.30
- Max waits inside with a small pistol
- Max got in with a **passkey**
- Ausable grumbles about "the balcony"
- Knock: Max jumps out and screams

2 The Twist

- Max hides "on the balcony"
- **No balcony**: falls from sixth floor
- Knock was Henry, the waiter
- Brings the drinks Ausable ordered
- "there is no balcony"
- Report saved without a shot
- Max is outwitted by words

3 Characters

- **Ausable:** calm, witty, imaginative
- Looks dull; mind is razor-sharp
- **Max:** crafty, armed, but gullible
- Anxious; believes the balcony story
- **Fowler:** romantic, naive, thrilled
- Expected spies and beauties

4 Why Max Believed

- Ausable sounded truly irritated
- Said it belongs to next apartment
- Reached from an empty room nearby
- Used once last month, he claimed
- Police "will not hesitate to shoot"
- Little time to think it over
- Clock pressure: report due any minute

5 Themes and Devices

- **Presence of mind** beats force
- **Appearances deceive**
- Real spying is quiet brainwork
- **Foreshadowing:** the balcony
- **Suspense:** pistol, knock, clock
- **Twist** in the very last line
- **Reality vs romance** of spy life
- Fowler's disappointment: humour

6 Exam Focus

- How did Ausable fool Max? (3M)
- Ausable vs a film secret agent
- Presence of mind in a crisis (6M)
- Character sketch of Max
- **Alert:** Max used a passkey
- **Alert:** Henry is the waiter
- **Alert:** sixth floor, Paris
- Contrast Ausable and Fowler

Quick Tip: Balcony story ke 3 details yaad karo: next apartment, empty room, last month.

A Question of Trust

1 Story in Steps

- Horace Danby, 50, a locksmith
- Robs one safe a year for rare books
- Studies Shotover Grange for weeks
- Servants away at the movies
- Kitchen key; dog called "Sherry"
- Flowers in the room: hay fever starts
- Lady in red appears, threatens police

2 How She Tricked Him

- Calm, amused, like the mistress
- Knew the dog's name, Sherry
- Story: forgot the safe code
- Needs her jewels for a party
- He opens the safe **without gloves**
- Gloves off to light her cigarette
- Tidied ornaments like an owner

3 Characters

- **Horace:** meticulous planner
- Loves rare and expensive books
- Vain, eager to impress a lady
- **Lady in red:** cool, clever actress
- A thief who outwits a thief
- **Real wife:** sixty, grey-haired
- Respectable by day, thief once a year

A QUESTION OF TRUST

Victor Canning

4 Ending and Irony

- His fingerprints are everywhere
- Nobody believes his story
- Assistant librarian in prison
- Hates "honour among thieves"
- **Irony:** thief robbed by a thief
- **Title:** trusted the wrong person
- She vanishes with the jewels

5 Themes and Message

- **Crime does not pay**
- Ends do not justify the means
- **Overconfidence** brings a fall
- **Appearances deceive**
- Small flaw (hay fever) ruins a plan
- Surprise ending, third person
- Greed for books makes him a criminal

6 Exam Focus

- Why hate "honour among thieves"?
- Meticulous, yet he faltered (6M)
- How did the lady deceive him? (3M)
- Was Horace a respectable man?
- **Alert:** gloves off for the lighter
- **Alert:** real wife is sixty
- **Alert:** safe behind a poor painting
- **Alert:** the lady was a thief too

Quick Tip: Horace ki 3 galtiyan: hay fever, lady pe trust, gloves utaare.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET

H.G. Wells

1 London Episodes

- Griffin swallows rare drugs
- Body becomes transparent as glass
- Boys follow muddy footprints
- Sets fire to landlord's house
- Spends night in a big London store
- Oversleeps, flees naked in the cold
- Robs a Drury Lane theatre shop

2 Iping Episodes

- Room at the Iping inn in winter
- Bandages, dark glasses, false nose
- Pays in advance: rudeness excused
- Steals clergyman's money
- Hat and chair attack Mrs Hall
- Mrs Hall blames witchcraft
- Wants solitude, says face is damaged

3 Climax and Escape

- Villagers confront the stranger
- Throws off disguise: headless man
- Constable Jaffers tries to arrest
- Strips off clothes, fully invisible
- Jaffers knocked unconscious
- Griffin escapes: open ending
- Constable sent for in secret

4 Characters

- **Griffin:** brilliant but lawless
- Selfish: arson, theft, assault
- **Mrs Hall:** curious, superstitious
- **Mr Hall:** the landlord of the inn
- **Jaffers:** brave, dutiful constable
- **Clergyman:** robbed at night
- **Shopkeeper:** attacked and robbed
- Griffin cannot control his temper

5 Themes and Devices

- **Misuse of science** breeds crime
- Genius without ethics is dangerous
- **Crime breeds crime**
- Invisibility costs: cold, hunger
- **Suspense:** footprints from nowhere
- **Imagery:** "a headless man"
- Comic scene: chair attacks Mrs Hall
- Science-fiction by H.G. Wells

6 Exam Focus

- "Brilliant but lawless": prove (6M)
- List his crimes in order
- How was he first noticed? (3M)
- Pros and cons of invisibility
- **Alert:** winter; Iping a village
- **Alert:** no ghost: it was Griffin
- **Alert:** Jaffers was the constable

Quick Tip: Griffin ke crimes order me likho: ghar jalaya, store, shopkeeper, clergyman, Jaffers.

THE MAKING OF A SCIENTIST

Robert W. Peterson

1 Life in Steps

- Richard H. Ebright, only child
- Near Reading, Pennsylvania
- Collected butterflies from age 5
- By Class 2: all **25 species** nearby
- Father died when he was in Class 3
- Book *Travels of Monarch X*
- Tagged monarchs for Dr Urquhart
- Also collected rocks, fossils, coins

2 Science Fairs

- **Class 7:** lost at county fair
- Had shown slides of frog tissues
- Winners did **real experiments**
- Viceroy project: 1st in zoology
- Studied **12 gold spots** on pupa
- Spots make a growth hormone
- Prizes; worked at Walter Reed
- Entered International Science Fair

3 Discovery

- At Harvard: hormone's structure
- X-ray photos sparked a new idea
- How a cell "reads" its DNA
- Theory at **22**, with James R. Wong
- Published in a top science journal
- Also a debater, canoeist, scout
- Harvard graduate: 2nd of 1,510

4 People Who Shaped Him

- **Mother:** his only companion
- "Richie was my whole life"
- Bought telescopes, microscopes
- Found learning work every evening
- **Dr Urquhart:** "stack of suggestions"
- **Weiherer:** social studies teacher
- He had no one else to play with

5 Making of a Scientist

- **First-rate mind**
- **Curiosity** about everything
- **Will to win**, for right reasons
- **Failure teaches**: one loss
- Mentors and parents nurture talent
- A true, biographical account
- Healthy competition drives excellence

6 Exam Focus

- How was a book a turning point?
- Lesson from losing a fair (3M)
- Mother's role in his success (6M)
- Three qualities of a scientist
- **Alert:** lost in Class 7
- **Alert:** 12 gold spots; theory at 22
- **Alert:** room-mate James R. Wong

Quick Tip: Mother ka role + Monarch X book + haar se seekh: ye teen points pakke.

THE NECKLACE

Guy de Maupassant

1 Story in Steps

- Matilda, pretty, born to clerks
- Married M. Loisel, a petty clerk
- Invited to the Minister's ball
- Loisel gives **400 francs** for a dress
- Borrows diamonds from Mme Forestier
- Prettiest at the ball; great success
- Home at 4 a.m.: necklace lost

2 Replacing It

- Letter: clasp broken, to gain time
- Look-alike at Palais-Royal shop
- Bought for **36,000 francs**
- 18,000 from father; rest borrowed
- **Ten years** of hardship and debt
- Matilda grows old and rough
- Loisel copies documents at night

3 The Twist

- Meets Mme Forestier years later
- Confesses the truth at last
- Necklace was false: **500 francs**
- "How small a thing will ruin or save one!"
- **Irony of fate**: ten wasted years
- One honest word would have saved them
- Matilda proud she repaid every franc

4 Characters

- **Matilda:** vain, discontented
- Dreams of luxury and admiration
- Later honest, hard-working
- **Loisel:** loving, content, sacrificing
- Gives up his gun money for her
- **Mme Forestier:** rich, generous
- **Matilda** later: brave, humble

5 Themes and Message

- **Vanity** and false pride ruin
- **Honesty** could have saved them
- **Contentment** brings peace
- **Appearances deceive**: fake gems
- Hard work redeems Matilda
- French story with a twist ending
- **Fate**: a small thing changes a life
- Pride stops a simple confession

6 Exam Focus

- Why was Matilda unhappy? (3M)
- How was the necklace replaced?
- Vanity led to her ruin (6M)
- Character sketch of M. Loisel
- **Alert:** dress 400; paid 36,000
- **Alert:** real worth only 500
- **Alert:** Minister of Public Instruction
- Was Matilda responsible for her fate?

Quick Tip: Numbers yaad rakho: 400 dress, 36,000 replacement, 500 asli keemat, 10 saal.

BHOLI

K.A. Abbas

1 Story in Steps

- Sulekha (Bholi), Ramlal's 4th daughter
- Fell off a cot at ten months
- Smallpox at two: pockmarked face
- Spoke late; then stammered
- Neglected; wore sisters' old clothes
- Sent to the new girls' school
- Teacher's kindness gives her words

2 The Wedding

- Groom: Bishamber Nath, grocer
- Lame, old, has grown children
- Sees pockmarks: wants **5,000 rupees**
- Ramlal puts his turban at his feet
- Bholi **throws the garland** away
- Refuses "a mean, greedy coward"
- Will teach at the same school

3 Role of the Teacher

- First to speak kindly to Bholi
- Helps her say "Bholi" clearly
- Learn, and people will respect you
- Gives her a picture book
- Wedding: "completion of her masterpiece"
- Turns a "simpleton" into a woman
- Her voice "so soft and soothing"

4 Characters

- **Bholi:** timid, then bold
- Feared school like Lakshmi the cow
- **Ramlal:** worried, traditional
- **Bishamber:** greedy, lame, old
- **Tehsildar:** urges girls' schooling
- **Mother:** agrees: no one would wed her
- **Teacher:** kind, motherly, inspiring

5 Themes and Message

- **Education empowers** girls
- **Dowry** is a social evil
- Neglect of the girl child
- Girls judged by looks, not worth
- **A good teacher** changes a life
- Self-respect over social pressure
- Speaks up against injustice
- Girls deserve equal chances

6 Exam Focus

- Why was Bholi sent to school?
- Why did she refuse the groom? (3M)
- Teacher changed her life (6M)
- Bholi: timid to bold, with evidence
- **Alert:** real name Sulekha
- **Alert:** dowry 5,000 rupees
- **Alert:** "a clear loud voice"

Quick Tip: Bholi ka transformation: stammer se "clear loud voice" tak. Teacher ka role zaroor likho.

The Book That Saved the Earth

THE BOOK THAT SAVED THE EARTH

Claire Boiko

1 Story in Steps

- 25th-century Historian narrates
- 20th century: "Era of the Book"
- Martians plan to invade in 2040
- Probe One lands in Centerville library
- Think-Tank calls books "sandwiches"
- Crew reads *Mother Goose* rhymes
- Think-Tank panics, invasion called off

2 Misread Rhymes

- **Mistress Mary:** silver bells
- Thinks Earth grows silver, explosives
- **Hey Diddle Diddle:** cow, moon
- Fears cows will attack in space
- **Humpty Dumpty:** egg-shaped like him
- "Great fall" read as his capture
- Rhymes read as secret codes

3 Characters

- **Think-Tank:** vain, arrogant, foolish
- "Never wrong"; consults his mirror
- **Noodle:** wise, tactful apprentice
- **Captain Omega:** leads Probe One
- **Lt Iota:** obedient crew member
- **Sgt Oop:** made to taste a book
- **Historian:** 25th-century narrator

4 How Noodle Corrects

- "your Brilliance", "your Intelligence"
- "an insignificant bit of data"
- "a cloudy piece of information"
- Lets Think-Tank take the credit
- Later replaces Think-Tank
- Library opens in Marsopolis
- Earth and Mars become friends

5 Themes and Devices

- **Arrogance** leads to defeat
- **Value of books** and reading
- **Irony:** rhymes stop an invasion
- Literal reading causes panic
- One-act sci-fi comedy, flashback
- Martians never read Mother Goose
- Satire on vanity and blind obedience

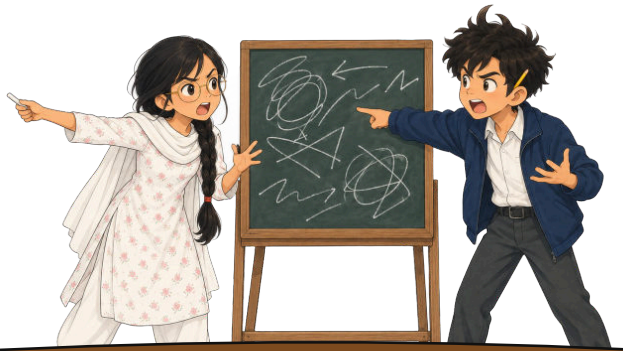
6 Exam Focus

- How does Noodle correct him? (3M)
- Why "Era of the Book"?
- How did rhymes save Earth? (6M)
- Contrast Think-Tank and Noodle
- **Alert:** invasion year 2040
- **Alert:** Centerville library
- **Alert:** fled to Alpha Centauri

Quick Tip: Teen rhymes aur Think-Tank ki galat samajh: ye table bana ke likho.

GRAMMAR AT A GLANCE

Class 10 · Section B



1 Tenses

- **Present perfect:** has/have + V3
- **Past perfect:** had + V3 (earlier act)
- **Future perfect:** will have + V3
- **since, for, yet, so far:** pres. perfect
- **ago, last week:** simple past
- **Passive:** was/were + V3, has been + V3
- **If** + present, will + V1
- **Error:** have seen yesterday → saw

2 Modals

- **must:** rule; **must not:** prohibition
- **need not:** no necessity
- **should:** advice; **might:** less sure
- **could/would:** polite request
- **may:** permission; possibility
- Always modal + V1: can **sing**
- Never two modals: will be able to
- **must have + V3:** deduction

3 Subject-Verb Agreement

- Verb agrees with the real subject
- **each, every, one of:** singular
- **neither...nor:** nearer subject
- **as well as, along with:** 1st subject
- **a number of** plural; **the number** sing.
- **news, mathematics:** singular
- **police, cattle, people:** plural

4 Determiners

- **an** hour, **a** university (sound)
- **the:** unique, superlative, rivers
- **few / little:** hardly any
- **a few / a little:** some
- **fewer** cars; **less** sugar
- **some** positive; **any** in questions
- **which:** limited choice

5 Reported Speech

- Tense one step back: is → was
- **will, can, may** → would, could, might
- now → then; tomorrow → next day
- Questions: asked **if** / wh-word
- Statement order: where **I lived**
- Commands: advised + **to / not to**
- No change: universal truths

6 Q3 Method (10 marks)

- 12 items; attempt any 10
- Find real subject and time marker
- Name it: tense, modal, concord...
- Write only error + correction
- One word per blank
- Same word class in correction
- Omission: word before, missing, after

Quick Tip: Pehle time marker aur real subject dekho, phir answer mein sirf sahi word likho.

Writing Skills at a Glance

1 Formal Letter Format

- Block format: no indentation
- Sender's address, then date
- Date in words: 30 October 2026
- Receiver: designation first
- Subject: one line, 6-10 words
- Salutation: Sir / Madam
- **Yours faithfully**, name, title
- Never "Your's faithfully"

2 Letter Types

- **Editor:** "your esteemed newspaper"
- **Complaint:** replace / refund
- **Order:** items, quantity, delivery
- **Enquiry:** fees, duration, details
- **RWA:** park, community centre
- Topics: noise, waste, water shortage
- **Order:** state payment mode too

3 Letter Body and Marks

- **Para 1:** purpose of writing
- **Para 2:** details, facts, effects
- **Para 3:** request or suggestion
- **Format 1** + **Content 2**
- **Organisation 1** + **Accuracy 1**
- 120 words; formal, no slang
- Plan in 1 minute before writing
- Blank line between all parts

WRITING SKILLS

Letter + Analytical Paragraph

4 Analytical Paragraph

- 5 marks, 100-120 words
- Bar, line, pie, table, cues, SWOT
- **Intro:** what, where, when
- State the **overall trend** early
- **Body:** 2-3 key changes, figures
- Compare; never list every figure
- **Conclusion:** inference only
- No title, bullets or headings

5 AP Language Bank

- **Rise:** increase, surge, double
- **Fall:** decline, drop, halve
- **Degree:** sharply, steadily
- **Peak:** reached a peak of
- **Stable:** level off, plateau
- **Compare:** whereas, in contrast
- **Evaluate:** on balance, outweigh
- **Fluctuate:** rise and fall

6 AP Marks and Tips

- **Content 2:** figures, inference
- **Organisation 2:** clear sequence
- **Accuracy 1:** grammar, spelling
- Open: "The bar chart compares..."
- SWOT: balance both sides
- Quote exact figures with %
- Underline every point asked
- Model: walking halved, 30% to 15%

Quick Tip: Letter me "Yours faithfully" aur AP me no title: ye do marks bachate hain.

SECTION

COMPETENCY BASED QUESTIONS

Chapter-wise

Extract-based sets, short and long answer questions on every chapter and poem of First Flight and Footprints without Feet, with integrated grammar and writing tasks. Model answers and value points follow each chapter.

As per the latest CBSE pattern: 50% competency-based questions

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 1

A Letter to God

G.L. Fuentes

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

The house — the only one in the entire valley — sat on the crest of a low hill. From this height one could see the river and the field of ripe corn dotted with the flowers that always promised a good harvest. The only thing the earth needed was a downpour or at least a shower.

i. The flowers in the field were a sign of (1)
   (a) the end of the rainy season
   (b) a good harvest to come
   (c) a poor crop that year
   (d) the family's love of gardening

ii. Why could the family see the river and the field clearly? (1)

iii. Which phrase in the extract tells us that the house was isolated? (1)

iv. What does the last line reveal about a farmer's dependence on nature? Explain with reference to the extract. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Lencho wrote a letter to God asking for a hundred pesos.
Reason (R): The hailstorm had destroyed his entire crop, and he had complete faith that God would help him. (1)
   (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
   (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
   (c) A is true, but R is false.
   (d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A village shopkeeper loses his stock in a flood and a neighbour quietly sends him money without revealing his name. This is closest to what the postmaster did in the story, because the postmaster (1)
   (a) wanted Lencho to repay the money later
   (b) hoped to be praised by the villagers
   (c) did not want to shake a simple man's faith in God
   (d) was ordered by his seniors to send the money

iii. What does the phrase "an ox of a man" suggest about Lencho? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Lencho called the post office employees "a bunch of crooks" although they had helped him. What does this irony show about blind faith, and what lesson can a reader draw from it for real life?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are the postmaster. Write a diary entry (about 120 words) on the day Lencho's second letter reached the post office, describing your feelings about his faith and the reaction of your staff.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) a good harvest to come

ii. Because the house stood on the crest of a low hill, giving a wide view.

iii. "the only one in the entire valley"

iv. Even with ripe corn and promising flowers, the crop still needed rain; the farmer's whole year depended on weather he could not control, which makes him hopeful yet vulnerable.

Answer Q2

i. (a) His ruined crop and his firm faith together explain why he wrote to God.

ii. (c) did not want to shake a simple man's faith in God; he kept his help anonymous.

iii. It suggests that he was strong, hard-working and simple, used to labouring like an ox in the fields.

Answer Q3 The irony shows that blind faith can make a person ungrateful and suspicious of the very people who help. Lencho trusted God completely but could not imagine human kindness. The lesson is that faith should be balanced with reason, and we should recognise and value the quiet goodness of people around us.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Format: day, date and a personal, reflective tone in the first person.
- Recalls laughing at first on reading a letter addressed to God, then being moved by the writer's faith.
- Mentions deciding not to shake that faith and collecting money from staff and friends, plus part of own salary.
- Notes that only seventy pesos could be raised, a little over half the hundred asked for, and it was sent signed "God".
- Describes reading the second letter calling the employees crooks and feeling hurt yet amused.

- Reflects that kindness is its own reward and does not depend on thanks.
- Closes with a resolve to keep helping people without expecting gratitude.

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 2

Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom

Nelson Mandela

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

> *I was not born with a hunger to be free. I was born free — free in every way that I could know. Free to run in the fields near my mother's hut, free to swim in the clear stream that ran through my village, free to roast mealies under the stars and ride the broad backs of slow-moving bulls.*

i. The freedom the speaker describes in the extract is the freedom of **(1)**
(a) a political leader
(b) a carefree child
(c) a prisoner after release
(d) a wealthy landowner

ii. What literary device is used in the repetition of the word "free"? **(1)**

iii. What are "mealies"? **(1)**

iv. "I was not born with a hunger to be free." What does this suggest about how the speaker's idea of freedom changed as he grew up? **(2)**

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Mandela says that the brave man is not he who does not feel afraid, but he who conquers that fear.
Reason (R): Mandela believed that courage meant never experiencing fear at all. **(1)**
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A student volunteer stops helping at home on weekends to run a community literacy drive. In Mandela's terms, this student is choosing between **(1)**
(a) personal freedom and political ambition
(b) obligation to family and obligation to the community
(c) education and employment
(d) wealth and fame

iii. What does Mandela mean when he calls the country's greatest wealth its "people"? **(1)**

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Mandela says that the oppressor must be liberated just as surely as the oppressed. How can this idea help resolve a conflict in a school or neighbourhood today?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

"Courage is not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it." Evaluate how Nelson Mandela's life and words in the chapter illustrate this idea, and link it to a situation a young person might face today (about 120 words).

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) a carefree child

ii. Repetition (anaphora), which stresses how complete his childhood freedom felt.

iii. Ears or cobs of maize (corn).

iv. As a child he felt free and had no need to seek freedom; only as he grew older did he realise that his freedom, and that of his people, was an illusion under the apartheid laws, and this created his hunger for it.

Answer Q2

i. (c) A is true, but R is false; Mandela said courage is triumph over fear, not its absence.

ii. (b) obligation to family and obligation to the community, which Mandela called the twin obligations.

iii. He means that the courage, goodness and strength of its people are worth more than its gold and diamonds.

Answer Q3 Mandela means that a person who takes away another's freedom is himself a prisoner of hatred and prejudice. In a school or neighbourhood quarrel, if both sides see that bullying or bias harms the doer too, they can talk, forgive and rebuild trust instead of seeking revenge, so everyone ends up freer.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Mandela admits he felt fear many times but learned that the brave man conquers fear rather than never feeling it.
- He chose a life of struggle that cost him family time and nearly thirty years in prison.
- He drew courage from the men and women who risked their lives for the cause.
- He believed in the goodness of human beings and that love can be taught as easily as hatred.

- His inauguration as the first black President shows that courage over fear can transform a nation.
- Real-life link: a student who speaks up against unfairness despite fear shows the same courage on a small scale.
- Conclusion: courage is a choice made repeatedly, and it makes lasting change possible.

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 3

Two Stories about Flying

Liam O'Flaherty and Frederick Forsyth

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

The young seagull was alone on his ledge. His two brothers and his sister had already flown away the day before. He had been afraid to fly with them. Somehow when he had taken a little run forward to the brink of the ledge and attempted to flap his wings he became afraid.

i. Why was the young seagull alone on the ledge? (1)
(a) His family had abandoned him for good
(b) He was sick and could not move
(c) His siblings had already flown and he was too afraid to follow
(d) He was guarding the nest

ii. What does the word "brink" mean in the extract? (1)

iii. What did the seagull do each time he tried to fly? (1)

iv. How is the seagull's fear similar to the fear a student feels before a first big challenge? Explain briefly. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The young seagull flew for the first time together with his brothers and sister.
Reason (R): Hunger finally made him forget his fear and dive at the fish his mother held out. (1)
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A trainee pilot, alone in bad weather, follows a stranger's directions and lands safely, but nobody can later confirm who helped. Like the pilot in "The Black Aeroplane", the trainee is left with (1)
(a) a sense of mystery about the unknown helper
(b) pride in his own navigation skill
(c) anger at the control tower
(d) a decision to give up flying

iii. In "The Black Aeroplane", what does the pilot's decision to fly into the storm reveal about him? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

In "The Black Aeroplane", the pilot follows a mysterious aeroplane through the storm, but the woman in the control tower says no other aeroplane was flying. What inference can you draw about the event, and what does the pilot's choice tell us about decision-making in a crisis?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Both stories show a moment when fear is overcome, though in different ways. Compare how the young seagull and the pilot handle fear, and explain what each story teaches readers about facing difficulties (about 120 words).

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (c) His siblings had already flown and he was too afraid to follow

ii. The extreme edge of the ledge.

iii. He ran to the edge and flapped his wings but became afraid and stopped.

iv. Like the seagull at the ledge, a student facing a first stage performance or exam often doubts his ability and holds back; in both cases the fear is in the mind, and the ability is already there waiting to be tried.

Answer Q2

i. (d) A is false, as he flew alone a day after his siblings; R is true.

ii. (a) a sense of mystery about the unknown helper; the other plane remained unexplained.

iii. It reveals that he took a reckless risk, choosing to reach home for breakfast over his own safety.

Answer Q3 The black aeroplane may have been a supernatural helper or the pilot's own inner guidance, since it had no lights and no one else saw it. The pilot chose to trust and follow it despite risk, showing that in a crisis calm judgement and willingness to act can save lives when normal help fails.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- The young seagull is held back by self-doubt and believes his wings will never support him.
- His family uses hunger as motivation; the mother tempts him with fish, and he dives and finally flies.

- The pilot is experienced but faces a sudden storm, failed instruments and almost no fuel.
- He disobeys the rule of going round the storm, then trusts the black aeroplane to guide him to safety.
- The seagull's fear is overcome by a push from need; the pilot's by trust and calm action.
- Lesson: courage often comes from taking the first step, and help may come from unexpected places.
- Real-life link: a first-time job, a move to a new city or a tough exam can be faced the same way.

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 4

From the Diary of Anne Frank

Anne Frank

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

Writing in a diary is a really strange experience for someone like me. Not only because I've never written anything before, but also because it seems to me that later on neither I nor anyone else will be interested in the musings of a thirteen-year-old schoolgirl. Oh well, it doesn't matter. I feel like writing, and I have an even greater need to get all kinds of things off my chest.

i. Why does the writer find keeping a diary a 'strange experience'? (1)

(a) She has been forbidden to write by her teachers

(b) She has never written before and doubts anyone will care about her thoughts

(c) She finds writing physically tiring

(d) She is writing in a language she does not know well

ii. What does the phrase 'get all kinds of things off my chest' mean in this context? (1)

iii. Which word in the extract tells us that the writer considers her thoughts unimportant to others? (1)

iv. The writer says, 'Oh well, it doesn't matter.' What does this reveal about her attitude towards writing? (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Anne called her diary "Kitty" and wrote to it as if writing to a friend.
Reason (R): Anne felt she had no true friend in whom she could confide her deepest thoughts. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A student is asked to write an essay on "talking in class" as a punishment, and turns it into a witty piece that makes the teacher laugh. This is most like Anne because she (1)

(a) refused to do the punishment work

(b) used humour and logic to win the teacher over

(c) complained to her parents about the teacher

(d) copied the essay from a classmate

iii. What does Anne's remark that paper has more patience than people suggest about her? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Anne says that 'paper has more patience than people'. In today's world, many teenagers turn to private journals or notes on their phones. How far do you agree that writing can help a young person cope with loneliness? Support your view with reference to Anne.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are Mr Keesing, the maths teacher. Write a diary entry (about 120 words) describing how Anne's poem about the duckling changed your view of her and of punishing talkative students.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) She has never written before and doubts anyone will care about her thoughts

ii. It means to express and release feelings and worries that she has been holding inside.

iii. 'Musings', which suggests casual, private reflections she feels others would not value.

iv. It shows her self-confidence and inner need: she sets aside her doubts about readers because writing is mainly for herself, a way to share feelings she cannot share with anyone around her.

Answer Q2

i. (a) Lacking a real confidante, she made the diary her friend Kitty.

ii. (b) used humour and logic to win the teacher over; her verse made Mr Keesing laugh.

iii. It suggests that she felt people did not listen to her, so she turned to the diary to share her feelings.

Answer Q3 Writing gives a safe, judgement-free space to sort out feelings. Anne had family and friends but no true confidant, so she created 'Kitty' as a friend in her diary. Similarly, a journal lets teenagers reflect calmly and understand themselves, though it works best alongside talking to trusted people.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Date and opening: began the day annoyed by Anne's non-stop talking in class once again.
- Recalls the earlier punishments: the essays 'A Chatterbox' and 'An Incorrigible Chatterbox' meant to teach her a lesson.
- Reaction to her clever arguments: she defended talking as a trait inherited from her mother, which made him laugh.
- The turning point: the third essay, 'Quack, Quack, Quack, said Mistress Chatterback', written as a witty poem.
- Realises she turned a punishment into a creative piece and that her humour deserves respect.
- Decides to let her talk and stops giving extra homework, enjoying the joke himself.
- Reflection: learns that understanding a child's nature works better than rigid punishment.

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 5

Glimpses of India

Lucio Rodrigues, Lokesh Abrol, Arup Kumar Datta

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

Midway between Mysore and the coastal town of Mangalore sits a piece of heaven that must have drifted from the kingdom of God. This land of rolling hills is inhabited by a proud race of martial men, beautiful women and wild creatures.

i. Which literary device is used in the phrase 'a piece of heaven that must have drifted from the kingdom of God'? (1)

(a) Simile (b) Personification

(c) Hyperbole (d) Alliteration

ii. Name the place being described in the extract. (1)

iii. Which phrase in the extract tells us that the people of the region have a strong military tradition? (1)

iv. Based on the extract, why would a travel brochure find this opening effective for attracting tourists? Give two reasons. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): In the old days, the baker and his family in Goa never had to go hungry.
Reason (R): Baking was a profitable profession in Goa at that time. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A group of tourism students is preparing a talk on 'Tea from Assam'. Why does Pranjol show little excitement as the train passes the tea gardens? (1)

(a) He dislikes the taste of tea.

(b) He is afraid of travelling by train.

(c) He has grown up on a tea garden, so the sight is ordinary to him.

(d) He wants the journey to end quickly.

iii. In 'A Baker from Goa', what does the statement that 'the thud and jingle of the traditional baker's bamboo can still be heard' suggest? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

In 'A Baker from Goa', the baker's arrival with his jingling bamboo was an event the whole village waited for. In an age of supermarkets and online delivery, what do communities lose when such traditional trades disappear? Answer with reference to the text.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

You are a student who recently visited a tea estate in Assam, as described in 'Tea from Assam'. Write a letter (about 120 words) to your cousin describing the journey and what you learnt about tea.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (c) Hyperbole

ii. Coorg (Kodagu), the smallest district of Karnataka.

iii. 'A proud race of martial men'.

iv. It creates an image of a heavenly, unspoilt landscape of rolling hills, and it promises interesting people and wildlife, appealing both to nature lovers and to visitors curious about local culture.

Answer Q2

i. (a) Because baking paid well, the baker's family always looked happy and prosperous.

ii. (c) Familiar sights from his own childhood no longer surprise him.

iii. It suggests that the old Portuguese bread-making tradition still survives in Goan villages.

Answer Q3 Traditional trades link people personally. The Goan pader was part of daily life, weddings and festivals; children waited eagerly for bread-bangles. When such trades vanish, communities lose familiar faces, a sense of continuity with their heritage and the warmth of shared rituals, even if convenience increases.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Format: sender's address, date, salutation and a warm opening about the recent trip to Assam.
- The journey: miles of tea bushes on both sides of the track, seen from the train window, set against forested hills.
- Facts learnt: Assam has the largest concentration of tea plantations in the world; tea is drunk by millions every day.
- Legends shared: the Chinese emperor whose boiling water caught a few tea leaves, and the Indian legend of Bodhidharma's eyelids growing into tea plants.
- Visit to the estate: tea pluckers with bamboo baskets during the second flush (May to July), the best season for tea.
- History: tea was first drunk in China in 2700 BC, and words like 'chai' and 'chini' come from Chinese.
- Closing: invites the cousin to visit together next time; complimentary close and name.

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 6

Mijbil the Otter

Gavin Maxwell

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

For the first twenty-four hours Mijbil was neither hostile nor friendly; he was simply aloof and indifferent, choosing to sleep on the floor as far from my bed as possible. The second night Mijbil came on to my bed in the small hours and remained asleep in the crook of my knees until the servant brought tea in the morning.

i. Which word best describes Mijbil's behaviour during his first day with the narrator? (1)

(a) Aggressive (b) Playful

(c) Detached (d) Frightened

ii. What does the word 'aloof' mean in the extract? (1)

iii. What change in Mijbil's behaviour is seen on the second night? (1)

iv. What does this gradual change suggest about building a relationship with a wild animal? Explain briefly. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The narrator carried Mijbil from Basra to London in a box on a flight.
Reason (R): Airlines at that time freely allowed pets to roam in the passenger cabin. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. Mijbil spent hours playing with rubber balls and a tortoise shell. What would an animal-care volunteer most likely conclude from this? (1)

(a) Otters prefer to be left completely alone.

(b) Otters need play and stimulation to stay content.

(c) Otters should be kept in small boxes.

(d) Otters lose interest in toys within a day.

iii. Mijbil went wild with joy in the bathtub, plunging and rolling in the water. What does this show about otters? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

On the flight to London, the narrator's careful plans for Mijbil fell apart, leading to chaos in the cabin. What does this episode teach us about the responsibilities and practical difficulties of keeping an exotic pet?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Wildlife experts often argue that wild animals belong in their natural habitat, not in homes. Evaluate this view in about 120 words, using the narrator's experience with Mijbil as evidence.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (c) Detached

ii. Distant and uninterested; keeping away from others.

iii. He came onto the narrator's bed and slept in the crook of his knees, showing growing trust.

iv. It suggests that trust cannot be forced; with patience, space and gentle care, a wild animal slowly feels safe and begins to bond with its keeper.

Answer Q2

i. (c) A is true, but R is false; the British airline refused animals and Mijbil had to travel boxed.

ii. (b) Constant play showed his need for activity and engagement.

iii. Otters are water-loving creatures; water is their natural element.

Answer Q3 Mij tore apart the box, bled and escaped, terrifying passengers. It shows that a wild animal's needs and instincts are hard to control in human settings. Owners must plan carefully, accept inconvenience and think about the animal's comfort and safety before choosing to keep such pets.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Introduction: Mijbil, an otter from the marshes of Iraq, was kept as a pet by the narrator, who loved him deeply.
- Natural instincts persisted: Mij loved water, splashed in the bath and played with water endlessly, showing his need for his habitat.
- Stress of captivity: in the box on the flight he panicked, tore the lining and hurt himself.
- Unfamiliar settings: in London people mistook him for a seal, a beaver or even a hippo, showing how out of place he was.
- Positive side: with patience and care the narrator earned his trust, and Mij invented games such as playing with marbles.
- Evaluation: while bonding is possible, the animal's well-being and freedom matter more than human wishes.
- Conclusion: wild animals are best protected in their habitats; keeping them needs expert knowledge and should be the rare exception.

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 7

Madam Rides the Bus

Vallikkannan

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

There was a girl named Valli. She was eight years old. She was very curious about the world, and her favourite pastime was standing in the front doorway of her house, watching what was happening in the street outside. There were no playmates of her own age on her street, and this was about all she had to do.

i. Which quality of Valli does the extract bring out most clearly? (1)

(a) Shyness (b) Curiosity
(c) Laziness (d) Obedience

ii. Why did watching the street become Valli's main pastime? (1)

iii. Pick the word from the extract that means 'an activity done for enjoyment in free time'. (1)

iv. How does this habit of observing the street prepare Valli for the adventure that follows? Explain. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Valli felt sad and quiet on her return journey.
Reason (R): Valli had saved sixty paise for her bus trip. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A school counsellor uses 'Madam Rides the Bus' to discuss first encounters with death. Why did Valli stop looking out of the window on the way back? (1)

(a) She felt tired and sleepy after the trip.
(b) The conductor had scolded her for leaning out.
(c) The bus had become very crowded.
(d) The memory of the cow killed on the road troubled her.

iii. What does the conductor's habit of calling Valli 'madam' suggest about the way he treats her? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Valli saved every coin and refused even a ride on the merry-go-round to pay for her bus trip. What does this tell you about her, and what can students learn from it about reaching a goal?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are Valli. On the night after your bus ride, write a diary entry describing the journey, what you saw, and how the sight of the dead cow on the way back changed your mood.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) Curiosity

ii. She had no playmates of her own age on her street.

iii. Pastime

iv. Watching the bus pass every day made her long to ride it; her habit of observing led her to gather details about fares and timings quietly, so her curiosity turned into a carefully planned trip.

Answer Q2

i. (b) Both are true, but her sadness came from seeing the dead cow, not from her savings.

ii. (d) The dead cow made her aware of how suddenly life ends.

iii. He playfully treats her as a grown-up passenger, humouring her pride and independence.

Answer Q3 It shows self-control, patience and determination; she gave up small pleasures for a bigger dream. Students can learn that a goal needs planning, saving time or effort, and resisting distractions. Like Valli, steady small sacrifices make an ambitious aim possible without depending on others.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Opens with date and the thrill of finally riding the bus alone with money saved over months.
- Mentions standing on the seat to look out, refusing to be treated as a child and insisting she is a grown-up.
- Describes the sights: the canal, palm trees, green fields, distant mountains and the busy town.
- Records her decision not to get off at the town and to stay in the bus, and her refusal of the conductor's offer of a cool drink.
- Notes the young cow that ran ahead of the bus, which made her laugh on the way out.
- On the return, seeing the same cow lying dead by the road saddens her; the joy of the trip fades and she realises how fragile life is.
- Ends with keeping the trip a secret from her mother and a thoughtful reflection on growing up.

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 8

The Sermon at Benares

From the teachings of the Buddha

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

> *Kisa Gotami had an only son, and he died. In her grief she carried the dead child to all her neighbours, asking them for medicine, and the people said, 'She has lost her senses. The boy is dead.' At length, Kisa Gotami met a man who replied to her request, 'I cannot give thee medicine for thy child, but I know a physician who can.'*

i. Why did the neighbours say that Kisa Gotami had 'lost her senses'? (1)

(a) She refused to eat

(b) She asked for medicine for a child who was already dead

(c) She left her home

(d) She quarrelled with them

ii. Who was the 'physician' the man referred to? (1)

iii. What state of mind does Kisa Gotami's going from house to house reveal? (1)

iv. The man calls the Buddha a 'physician'. Evaluate why this word is fitting. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The Buddha gave Kisa Gotami a medicine that brought her son back to life.
Reason (R): The Buddha wanted Kisa Gotami to realise that death is common to all. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A grief counsellor compares the mustard-seed task to modern counselling. What was the Buddha's real purpose in sending Kisa Gotami from house to house? (1)

(a) To let her discover for herself that death touches every family.

(b) To collect mustard seed for a healing medicine.

(c) To keep her busy until she forgot her son.

(d) To test whether the neighbours would help her.

iii. Kisa Gotami watched the city lights flicker up and go out again. What does this image suggest? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

The Buddha asked Kisa Gotami for a handful of mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a family member. Why was this a wiser method than simply telling her that everyone dies?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

'Grief and selfishness make us suffer; acceptance brings peace.' Evaluate this idea from the lesson and connect it with a situation of loss or failure that young people face today.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) She asked for medicine for a child who was already dead

ii. The Buddha (Sakyamuni).

iii. Deep grief and denial; she could not accept her son's death.

iv. The Buddha could not cure the body, but he healed the mind; by leading Kisa Gotami to understand that death is universal, he cured her grief, which is the deeper ailment.

Answer Q2

i. (d) A is false, as no medicine revived the boy; R is true.

ii. (a) Self-discovery helped her accept her loss far better than advice.

iii. Human lives, like those lights, begin and end; death is inevitable for all.

Answer Q3 Advice alone would not have reached a grieving mind. By sending her house to house, the Buddha let her discover the truth herself. Learning through experience, she saw that death touches every family, realised her grief was not unique, and accepted it calmly. Self-discovered truth lasts longer than a lecture.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Kisa Gotami's suffering grew because she thought her loss was hers alone.
- The mustard seed search showed her that death is common to all; her selfish grief gave way to understanding.
- The Buddha teaches that the wise do not grieve, knowing the terms of the world; lamentation only increases pain and harms the body.
- Acceptance does not mean not caring; it means facing reality so that one can move forward.
- Real-life link: a student who fails an exam or loses a loved one may withdraw; seeing that others too face setbacks helps them cope.
- Talking to others, sharing feelings and accepting the event lets one rebuild with peace of mind.
- Conclusion: the lesson remains relevant; peace comes from acceptance and compassion, not from denial.

FIRST FLIGHT · PROSE · CHAPTER 9

The Proposal

Anton Chekhov

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

> *I'm cold... My whole body is trembling, as though I'd got an examination before me. The great thing is, I must have my mind made up. If I give myself time to think, to hesitate, to talk a lot, to look for an ideal, or for real love, then I'll never get married.*

i. The speaker compares his nervousness to that of a person (1)

(a) going to war

(b) facing an examination

(c) meeting a doctor

(d) losing a lawsuit

ii. Who is the speaker and why has he come to Chubukov's house? (1)

iii. What does the extract suggest about the speaker's reason for marrying? (1)

iv. How does this nervousness add to the comedy of the play later on? (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Chubukov is delighted when Lomov reveals that he has come to ask for Natalya's hand. Reason (R): Chubukov has always admired Lomov's calm temper and robust health. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. Natalya angrily quarrels with Lomov over the Oxen Meadows, yet she cries for him to be brought back once she learns he came to propose. A counsellor would say this mainly shows that she (1)

(a) has completely lost interest in owning land

(b) is afraid of her father's anger

(c) does not understand what a proposal is

(d) wants to be married but cannot let go of her pride in small disputes

iii. Even after Lomov proposes, the pair begin quarrelling about Guess and Squeezer. What does this ending suggest about their future married life? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Lomov and Natalya quarrel over the Oxen Meadows and over whose dog is better, even though marriage is at stake. What does this reveal about human nature, and how can such petty quarrels be avoided in real life?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are Chubukov. Write a letter to a close friend describing the strange afternoon when Lomov came to propose to your daughter, and give your view of the young couple.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) facing an examination

ii. Lomov; he has come to propose marriage to Natalya, Chubukov's daughter.

iii. He wants to marry for practical reasons, not out of love or an ideal.

iv. Because he is so anxious and hypochondriac, Lomov never reaches the proposal; small claims like Oxen Meadows and the dogs set off quarrels, palpitations and fainting, which makes the scene farcical.

Answer Q2

i. (c) Chubukov is genuinely pleased, but Lomov is nervous and ailing, so R is false.

ii. (d) She longs for marriage, yet ego drags her back into petty arguments.

iii. It suggests their marriage will be full of constant, comic quarrels over trivial matters.

Answer Q3 It shows how pride, greed and the urge to win small arguments can overpower good sense. Both value property and ego over the relationship. In real life, listening patiently, letting go of trivial issues and keeping the bigger goal in view prevent petty disputes from spoiling relationships.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Format: address, date, greeting and close; tone of an amused but practical landowner.
- Describes Lomov arriving in evening dress, nervous and hesitant, and his own delight because he had long wanted the match.
- Narrates how Lomov began talking to Natalya and a quarrel broke out over the ownership of the Oxen Meadows.
- Admits he too joined in, calling Lomov names, and that Lomov left in a rage.
- Describes Natalya's hysterics on learning Lomov had come to propose, and his calling Lomov back.
- Mentions the second quarrel over the dogs, Guess and Squeezer, and Lomov fainting.
- Concludes that he hurried them into an engagement and expects a married life full of quarrels, said with humour.

GRAMMAR · SECTION B

Integrated Grammar

Q1 GAP FILLING — 1 mark

Read the school notice and choose the correct option to fill the blank.
All students of Class 10 _____ requested to submit their science project files to the lab assistant by Friday.

(a) is (b) are
(c) was (d) has been

Q2 GAP FILLING — 1 mark

Complete the line from a travel blog with the correct form of the verb in brackets.
By the time we reached the hill station, the last cable car _____ (leave) for the day.

Q3 GAP FILLING — 1 mark

Choose the correct modal to complete the hospital signboard.
Visitors _____ switch off their mobile phones inside the intensive care unit.

(a) might (b) could
(c) must (d) would

Q4 EDITING — 1 mark

Identify the error in the given line from a newspaper report and write the correction.
The number of electric scooters on city roads have doubled in the last two years.

Q5 EDITING — 1 mark

Identify the error in the given line from a student's diary and supply the correction in the format: error / correction.
Yesterday I have finished reading an interesting novel about space travel.

(a) have finished / finished
(b) reading / read
(c) an / a
(d) about / on

Q6 REPORTED SPEECH — 1 mark

Read the conversation between a coach and a player and complete the report.
Coach: "Why did you miss the practice session this morning?"
Report: The coach asked the player _____

Q7 REPORTED SPEECH — 1 mark

A customer said to the shopkeeper, "Please show me a cheaper pair of sports shoes."
Choose the correct reported form.
The customer _____ a cheaper pair of sports shoes.

(a) told the shopkeeper please show him

(b) requested the shopkeeper to show him

(c) ordered the shopkeeper that he show him

(d) asked the shopkeeper did he show him

Q8 REPORTED SPEECH — 1 mark

Complete the report of this exchange from a class meeting.
Monitor: "Has anyone seen the attendance register?"
Teacher: "I kept it in the cupboard."
Report: The monitor asked if anyone had seen the attendance register. The teacher replied that _____

Q9 OMISSION — 1 mark

In the line below from a housing society notice, one word is missing. Write the word before the omission, the missing word and the word after it.
The residents' association will organise a free health check-up camp the community hall on Sunday morning.

Q10 GAP FILLING — 1 mark

Choose the correct option to complete the line from a sports report.
Neither the coach nor the players _____ happy with the referee's final decision.

(a) is (b) was

(c) are (d) has been

Q11 GAP FILLING — 1 mark

Choose the correct modal to complete the advice given in a weather update.
Clouds are gathering over the city and it _____ rain by evening, so keep an umbrella handy.

(a) must (b) shall

(c) need (d) might

Q12 REPORTED SPEECH — 1 mark

Read the exchange at a bus stop and complete the report.
Passenger: "Will this bus stop near the railway station?"
Report: The passenger asked the conductor _____

ANSWERS

Answer Q1 (b) are: plural subject 'All students' takes a plural verb.

Answer Q2 had left: past perfect shows an action completed before another past action.

Answer Q3 (c) must: a firm rule or obligation is expressed with 'must'.

Answer Q4 have → has: subject is 'The number', which is singular.

Answer Q5 (a) have finished / finished: 'yesterday' needs the simple past, not present perfect.

Answer Q6 why he had missed the practice session that morning: question becomes statement order, past shifts to past perfect, 'this' to 'that'.

Answer Q7 (b) requested the shopkeeper to show him: a polite request uses 'requested' plus 'to'-infinitive.

Answer Q8 she had kept it in the cupboard: simple past shifts to past perfect in reported speech.

Answer Q9 camp / in / the: a preposition is needed before 'the community hall' ('at' is also acceptable).

Answer Q10 (c) are: with 'neither ... nor', the verb agrees with the nearer subject, 'the players', which is plural.

Answer Q11 (d) might: 'might' expresses a possibility, not a certainty or obligation.

Answer Q12 whether that bus would stop near the railway station: a yes/no question is reported with 'whether' or 'if', 'will' changes to 'would' and 'this' to 'that'.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 1

Dust of Snow

Robert Frost

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

The way a crow
Shook down on me
The dust of snow
From a hemlock tree

Has given my heart
A change of mood
And saved some part
Of a day I had rued.

i. Which of the following best describes the speaker's state of mind before the incident? (1)

(a) cheerful and carefree

(b) gloomy and regretful

(c) angry and restless

(d) curious and excited

ii. What does the word 'rued' mean as used in the extract? (1)

iii. Name the poetic device used in the phrase 'dust of snow'. (1)

iv. The crow and the hemlock tree are usually linked with gloom. Why do you think the poet chose them to bring about a happy change? (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The poet's mood changes after the crow shakes snow down on him.
Reason (R): The crow and the hemlock tree are traditionally seen as symbols of joy and hope. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A student who reads 'Dust of Snow' after a stressful week of exams would most likely take away the idea that (1)

(a) winter is the best season for reflection

(b) a small, unexpected moment in nature can lift a heavy mood

(c) birds should be kept away from people walking outdoors

(d) regret about a bad day can never be overcome

iii. What does the phrase 'saved some part of a day' suggest about the poet's day as a whole? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

The poem shows how a tiny, unplanned moment saved the speaker's day. Describe a situation from student life where a small gesture can change someone's mood, and explain what the poem teaches us about such moments.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are the speaker of the poem. Write a diary entry (about 120 words) describing the day you had been regretting and how a crow shaking snow from a hemlock tree changed your mood.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) gloomy and regretful

ii. It means regretted or felt sorry about.

iii. Metaphor: fine, light snowflakes are compared to dust.

iv. The poet shows that joy can come from the most ordinary or even unpleasant sources. By using symbols of sorrow to lift his mood, he suggests that a positive outlook can find something hopeful in anything.

Answer Q2

i. (c) The mood does change, but crows and hemlock usually suggest gloom, not joy.

ii. (b) A tiny natural incident saved part of the poet's regretted day.

iii. The day had largely gone badly, but the incident rescued at least part of it from total regret.

Answer Q3 A student upset after a poor test score may cheer up when a friend shares a joke or a word of encouragement. Like the shower of snow in the poem, such small, unplanned moments can lift a heavy mood. The poem teaches us to stay open to little joys and to offer them to others.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Diary format: date, salutation-free opening, signature at the end.
- The day began badly; the speaker felt low, tired and full of regret.
- While walking, a crow perched on a hemlock tree shook fine snow down on him.
- The sudden, cool touch of the snow startled him out of his gloomy thoughts.
- He realised that nature can heal a troubled mind in the simplest way.
- The rest of the day felt lighter and worth living; part of it was saved.
- Resolve: to notice small joys and not let one bad moment spoil a whole day.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 2

Fire and Ice

Robert Frost

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

Some say the world will end in fire,
Some say in ice.
From what I've tasted of desire
I hold with those who favour fire.
But if it had to perish twice,
I think I know enough of hate
To say that for destruction ice
Is also great
And would suffice.

i. In the poem, 'fire' symbolises **(1)**

(a) hatred and coldness (b) desire and greed
(c) warmth and love (d) anger of nature

ii. What does the word 'suffice' mean here? **(1)**

iii. Why does the poet side with those who believe the world will end in fire? **(1)**

iv. How is hatred, represented by ice, as destructive as desire? Explain with a real-life example. **(2)**

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The poet believes that ice would also be great enough to destroy the world.
Reason (R): Hatred, like ice, makes people cold and insensitive and can slowly destroy humanity. **(1)**

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A news report describes two neighbouring countries spending heavily on weapons because of a long-standing hostility. Which idea from 'Fire and Ice' does this situation best illustrate? **(1)**

(a) Desire is never satisfied by material wealth.
(b) The world will end because of natural disasters.
(c) Hatred is powerful enough to bring about destruction.
(d) Cold climates are dangerous for human survival.

iii. What does the phrase 'From what I've tasted of desire' tell us about the source of the poet's opinion? **(1)**

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Frost suggests that the world will be destroyed not by nature but by human emotions. In the light of today's events, such as conflicts and over-consumption of resources, do you agree with him? Justify your view.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Your school is holding a debate on the topic 'Greed and hatred are the greatest threats to humanity'. Using ideas from 'Fire and Ice', write a speech (about 120 words) in favour of the motion.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) desire and greed

ii. It means to be enough or adequate.

iii. From his own experience of desire, he knows how quickly it spreads and consumes everything.

iv. Hatred makes people cold, rigid and insensitive, slowly freezing relationships and humanity. For example, long-held hatred between communities or nations can lead to violence and wars that destroy lives just as surely as greed does.

Answer Q2

i. (a) Ice stands for hatred, whose coldness the poet says is enough for destruction.

ii. (c) Long-held hostility mirrors the poem's 'ice', which can destroy the world.

iii. His view comes from personal experience of how consuming desire can be, not from mere theory.

Answer Q3 Yes. Unchecked desire drives people and nations to exploit resources, pollute the planet and compete endlessly, while hatred fuels wars and divisions. Both emotions cause real destruction today. The poem warns that controlling greed and hatred is essential if humanity is to survive and live in peace.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Opening: greet the audience and state the motion clearly.
- Introduce the poem's idea that the world may end in fire (desire) or ice (hatred).
- Desire, like fire, spreads fast and is never satisfied; it leads to greed, exploitation and environmental damage.
- Hatred, like ice, is cold and slow but makes people insensitive and leads to conflict and war.
- Real-life links: wars over land and power, and over-use of natural resources.
- Solution: self-control, tolerance, empathy and contentment can protect humanity.

- Conclusion: restate that controlling these emotions is the key to a safe world; thank the audience.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 3

A Tiger in the Zoo

Leslie Norris

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

He stalks in his vivid stripes
The few steps of his cage,
On pads of velvet quiet,
In his quiet rage.

He should be lurking in shadow,
Sliding through long grass
Near the water hole
Where plump deer pass.

i. The phrase "pads of velvet quiet" suggests that the tiger's movement is (1)
(a) clumsy and heavy
(b) soft and silent
(c) nervous and hurried
(d) slow because of illness

ii. Why does the poet describe the tiger's rage as "quiet"? (1)

iii. Identify the contrast the poet sets up between the two stanzas. (1)

iv. A wildlife officer reads this extract and says it is a strong argument for protecting natural habitats. Do you agree? Justify with reference to the extract. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): At night the tiger stares with his brilliant eyes at the brilliant stars.
Reason (R): He enjoys the company of the visitors and waits eagerly for them to return. (1)
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A city plans to replace small cages in its zoo with large, forest-like enclosures. Which line of thought from the poem would most strongly support this plan? (1)
(a) Caged animals are dangerous and must be kept far from visitors.
(b) Tigers are happiest when people watch them closely.
(c) A zoo should mainly entertain children on holidays.
(d) A tiger belongs in long grass and shadow, not in a few steps of a cage.

iii. What does the word 'locked' in 'locked in a concrete cell' emphasise about the tiger's condition? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

The tiger in the poem ignores the visitors but stares at the stars at night. What does this behaviour reveal about his state of mind, and what message does it give to people who visit zoos for entertainment?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are the tiger in the zoo. Write a diary entry at night, after the visitors have left, expressing your feelings about life in the cage and your memories or dreams of the jungle (about 120 words).

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) soft and silent

ii. His anger at captivity is real but helpless, so it stays suppressed and silent.

iii. The first shows the tiger confined to a few steps of a cage; the second shows where he truly belongs, free in the forest.

iv. Yes. The tiger's natural instincts of lurking, sliding through grass and hunting near the water hole cannot be expressed in a cage; only a protected natural habitat lets such an animal live as it is meant to.

Answer Q2

i. (c) He does gaze at the stars, but he ignores the visitors, so R is false.

ii. (d) The poem contrasts the cramped cage with the tiger's natural forest home.

iii. It stresses his complete, forced confinement and total loss of freedom.

Answer Q3 Ignoring the visitors shows his indifference and silent protest against the humans who confine him. Staring at the brilliant stars reveals his longing for freedom and the open world he has

lost. Visitors should realise that a caged animal is not a source of fun but a living being deprived of its natural life.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Format: date and time, a personal tone in the first person throughout.
- Describes the day: pacing the few steps of the concrete cell while crowds stared and pointed.
- Expresses suppressed anger and helplessness; strength and power wasted behind bars.
- Recalls or imagines the jungle: lurking in shadows, long grass, the water hole and passing deer.
- Notes the night sounds of patrolling cars and the last voices, deepening loneliness.
- Ends by gazing at the brilliant stars, a symbol of the freedom he longs for.
- Conveys the theme that wild animals belong in their natural habitat, not in captivity.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 4

How to Tell Wild Animals

Carolyn Wells

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

If strolling forth, a beast you view,
Whose hide with spots is peppered,
As soon as he has lept on you,
You'll know it is the Leopard.
'Twill do no good to roar with pain,
He'll only lep and lep again.

i. The spellings "lept" and "lep" in the extract are an example of (1)

(a) a printing error (b) poetic licence
(c) alliteration (d) personification

ii. What does the phrase "hide with spots is peppered" mean? (1)

iii. How, according to the poet, will the reader identify the leopard? (1)

iv. Explain how the poet creates humour in this stanza. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The poem cannot be used as a practical guide for identifying wild animals.
Reason (R): Almost every test it suggests can be completed only when the animal is close enough to attack the reader. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A wildlife photographer quotes the lines "If there is nothing on the tree, 'Tis the chameleon you see." What quality of the chameleon is the poet humorously pointing to? (1)

(a) It is too large to fit on a branch
(b) It hides under the ground during the day
(c) It blends so well with its surroundings that it seems invisible
(d) It runs away the moment it sees a human

iii. What does the poet suggest by calling the bear's crushing hug a "caress"? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

The poem advises readers to identify animals in ways that would put their lives at risk. If you were preparing a real safety guide for visitors to a forest reserve, which two pieces of the poem's 'advice' would you turn into sensible tips, and how?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

"Carolyn Wells uses humour to teach and entertain at the same time." Evaluate this statement with reference to the poem, and explain why humour is an effective way of sharing information in real life (about 120 words).

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) poetic licence

ii. The animal's skin is thickly dotted with spots, as if sprinkled with pepper.

iii. Only when it leaps on the reader, which is a humorous and dangerous way of identifying it.

iv. She offers an absurd identification test that can only be passed by being attacked, and adds that crying in pain is useless since the leopard will keep leaping; the irony and the playful spelling make a deadly situation funny.

Answer Q2

i. (a) The identification comes at the moment of danger, so the advice is ironic, not practical.

ii. (c) It blends so well with its surroundings that it seems invisible; its camouflage means you see 'nothing' where it sits.

iii. It is irony: a deadly, bone-crushing grip is described as a gentle, loving touch.

Answer Q3 Instead of waiting for the Bengal tiger to eat you, the guide would say: recognise black stripes on a yellow coat from a distance and stay inside the vehicle. Instead of letting a bear hug you, it would say: never approach a bear; back away slowly. Real safety means identification from a safe distance.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- The poem is a mock guide that gives identification rules for wild animals in a light-hearted way.
- Each animal is linked to a real feature: the tawny Asian lion, the striped Bengal tiger, the spotted leopard, the hugging bear.
- Humour comes from irony: the reader learns the animal's name only at the moment of being attacked or eaten.
- Wordplay and poetic licence (dyin'/Lion, lept, lep) and the bear's deadly 'caress' add fun.
- The crocodile's tears versus the hyena's smiles, and the invisible chameleon, end on witty observation.
- Real-life link: safety campaigns and advertisements use humour because a laugh makes a message memorable.
- Conclusion: the poem entertains while leaving readers with accurate features of each animal.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 5

The Ball Poem

John Berryman

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

No use to say 'O there are other balls':
An ultimate shaking grief fixes the boy
As he stands rigid, trembling, staring down
All his young days into the harbour where
His ball went. I would not intrude on him;
A dime, another ball, is worthless.

i. The word "rigid" in the extract suggests that the boy is **(1)**
(a) angry and stubborn
(b) frozen with shock and grief
(c) ready to jump into the water
(d) calm and indifferent

ii. Why does the speaker say it is "no use" to tell the boy that there are other balls? **(1)**

iii. What does "staring down all his young days into the harbour" imply? **(1)**

iv. The speaker decides not to intrude and not to offer money for a new ball. Do you think this is a caring choice? Give reasons. **(2)**

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The speaker decides not to give the boy money for another ball.
Reason (R): The ball bounced merrily down the street and fell into the water. **(1)**
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A child is heartbroken when the old bicycle he rode for years is stolen, even though his parents promise a brand-new one. Which idea from the poem best explains his grief? **(1)**
(a) What is lost carries memories that money cannot buy back
(b) Children always prefer old things to new ones
(c) Parents should never replace lost belongings
(d) Losses are unimportant if they are quickly replaced

iii. What does the phrase "the epistemology of loss" mean in the poem? **(1)**

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

The poet says, "Money is external." Explain this idea and relate it to a situation in real life where something lost could not be replaced with money.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are the boy in the poem. Many years later, as a young adult, you write a letter to a younger cousin who is upset over losing a favourite possession. Share what losing your ball taught you about loss and responsibility (about 120 words).

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) frozen with shock and grief

ii. The boy grieves not for an object that can be replaced but for something he valued that is gone forever.

iii. The ball carried memories of his childhood, so he feels those happy days have sunk with it.

iv. Yes. Replacing the ball would only hide the lesson; by letting the boy face the loss himself, the speaker allows him to learn responsibility and how to cope with loss, which will help him all his life.

Answer Q2

i. (b) Both are true, but the speaker holds back so the boy can learn about loss, not because of how the ball was lost.

ii. (a) What is lost carries memories that money cannot buy back; as the poem says, money is external.

iii. Coming to understand the nature of loss: that possessions will be lost and one must learn to bear it.

Answer Q3 Money can buy a new object but cannot restore the feelings, memories and attachment linked to what was lost. For example, a student who loses a pen gifted by a late grandparent may buy an identical pen, yet the emotional value and the memory attached to the original cannot be bought back.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Format: informal letter with address, date, salutation and closing; warm, comforting tone.
- Recalls the day the ball bounced merrily down the street and fell into the harbour.
- Describes the shock and grief: standing rigid and trembling, feeling that childhood had sunk with it.
- Explains that a new ball or money could not have replaced what was lost; money is external.
- Shares the lesson of the 'epistemology of loss': things will be lost in a world of possessions.
- Advises the cousin to accept the loss, take responsibility for belongings and learn to stand up again.
- Ends with encouragement that coping with small losses prepares one for bigger ones in life.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 6

Amanda!

Robin Klein

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

Did you finish your homework, Amanda?
Did you tidy your room, Amanda?
I thought I told you to clean your shoes, Amanda!
(I am an orphan, roaming the street.
I pattern soft dust with my hushed, bare feet.
The silence is golden, the freedom is sweet.)

i. Which feeling best describes the speaker of the first three lines? (1)

(a) Gentle curiosity (b) Impatient insistence
(c) Quiet admiration (d) Deep sorrow

ii. Why are the last three lines placed within brackets? (1)

iii. What does the phrase 'the silence is golden' suggest about Amanda's present life? (1)

iv. Amanda imagines being an orphan even though she has a family. What does this reveal about her and what lesson can parents draw from it? (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Amanda imagines herself as Rapunzel living in a tower.
Reason (R): Amanda wants long golden hair that she can let down for visitors. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. The adult ends with "Stop that sulking at once, Amanda! You're always so moody, Amanda!" Which conclusion is the most reasonable for a reader to draw? (1)

(a) Amanda is naturally rude and ungrateful
(b) Amanda is unwell and needs rest
(c) The adult is pleased with Amanda's behaviour
(d) The constant nagging is causing the moodiness the adult complains about

iii. Amanda pictures herself as a mermaid "drifting blissfully" in a calm sea. What does this daydream show she longs for? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER 3 marks

The last stanza ends with the line 'Anyone would think that I nagged at you'. Evaluate how this line changes the reader's view of the speaker. Do you think the speaker is aware of her own behaviour?

Q4 LONG ANSWER 6 marks

Imagine you are Amanda. Write a diary entry (about 120 words) describing a day full of instructions and how your daydreams helped you cope. Also note what you wish the adults around you understood.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) Impatient insistence; the questions are really orders she expects obeyed.

ii. They show Amanda's private daydream, which runs silently alongside the spoken instructions.

iii. It suggests her real life is full of constant nagging, so silence feels precious to her.

iv. It shows she feels so restricted that even loneliness seems better than constant control. Parents can learn that guidance must leave a child some space and freedom, or it pushes the child away.

Answer Q2

i. (c) She likes the tower for its calm solitude and says she will never let her hair down, so R is false.

ii. (d) The constant nagging is causing the moodiness the adult complains about; endless orders have pushed her into silence.

iii. Peace and freedom, floating calmly with no one directing her every move.

Answer Q3 The line is ironic, because the whole poem is a list of nagging remarks. It shows the speaker sees herself as a caring guide, not a nag, and blames Amanda's moodiness instead of her own tone. She is unaware of the effect of her words, which makes the reader sympathise more with Amanda.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Date and an opening line about another day of being told what to do at every step.
- Lists the repeated instructions: biting nails, posture, homework, tidying the room, cleaning shoes, avoiding chocolate.
- Describes escaping into daydreams: a mermaid in a calm emerald sea, a free orphan walking barefoot, Rapunzel safe in her tower.
- Explains that these dreams stand for peace, freedom and being left alone.
- Admits feeling sulky and hurt when called 'moody' for reacting to the nagging.
- Wishes adults would correct her kindly, listen to her and trust her to manage small things.
- Ends with a hope that tomorrow will bring a little more understanding and space.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 7

The Trees

Adrienne Rich

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED 5 marks

The trees inside are moving out into the forest,
the forest that was empty all these days
where no bird could sit
no insect hide
no sun bury its feet in shadow
the forest that was empty all these nights
will be full of trees by morning.

i. Why was the forest 'empty' in the poet's view? (1)

(a) A storm had blown the trees down

(b) The trees had been confined indoors by people

(c) Birds had abandoned it in winter

(d) It was a desert without water

ii. Identify the poetic device in 'no sun bury its feet in shadow'. (1)

iii. What will change 'by morning'? (1)

iv. How does the extract show the loss to other living beings when trees are taken away from nature? Link it to a present-day concern. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The poet tries hard to stop the trees from leaving the house.
Reason (R): The poet sits inside writing long letters while the trees move out. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. After a housing project, a town council replants a cleared hillside so that birds and insects return. Which message of the poem does this action reflect? (1)

(a) Trees grow best when kept indoors

(b) Nature belongs in the open and must be returned to its place

(c) Forests are useful only for timber

(d) Houses should be built inside forests

iii. What does the line "The moon is broken like a mirror" suggest at the end of the poem? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER **3 marks**

The branches are compared to 'newly discharged patients / half-dazed, moving / to the clinic doors'. What does this comparison suggest about the condition of the trees, and how does it support the poem's message?

Q4 LONG ANSWER **6 marks**

'The Trees' can be read both as a poem about nature and as a poem about women seeking freedom. Write an analytical answer (about 120 words) evaluating both readings, with a link to real life.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) The trees had been confined indoors by people, so the forest had none.

ii. Personification: the sun is given feet that it buries in shadow.

iii. The empty forest will be full again, as the trees from the house return to it.

iv. Without trees, birds lose perches, insects lose shelter and the sun has no shade to rest in, so the whole ecosystem suffers. This mirrors today's deforestation and urban expansion, which destroy habitats and reduce biodiversity.

Answer Q2

i. (d) She makes no attempt to stop them and barely mentions the departure, so A is false while R is true.

ii. (b) Nature belongs in the open and must be returned to its place, just as the trees restore the empty forest.

iii. The old, confining order has shattered and nature is free again, moonlight now glinting through the restored forest.

Answer Q3 The simile shows the trees as weak, cramped and confused after long confinement indoors, just as patients feel after a long hospital stay. Their slow, eager movement towards the door shows a longing for freedom and health, supporting the message that nature belongs outside and suffers when humans control it.

Answer Q4 Value points

- On the surface, the poem shows potted trees breaking free from a house to restore the empty forest.
- It criticises human control over nature, from indoor plants to large-scale deforestation.
- The roots, leaves and boughs straining outward show nature's own determination to survive and reclaim its space.
- Read symbolically, the house stands for a confining domestic world and the trees for women held within it.
- The poet writing letters while scarcely mentioning the departure suggests that such quiet struggles often go unnoticed.
- The breaking glass and the moon in the tallest oak suggest a bold, beautiful release from restriction.
- In real life, both readings call for respecting freedom: protecting forests and giving every person equal space to grow.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 8

Fog

Carl Sandburg

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED **5 marks**

The fog comes
on little cat feet.
It sits looking
over harbour and city
on silent haunches
and then moves on.

i. Which quality of fog is highlighted by 'little cat feet'? (1)

(a) Its loud and sudden arrival

(b) Its quiet, soft and unnoticed arrival

(c) Its harmful effect on health

(d) Its bright white colour

ii. Name the main poetic device used throughout the poem. (1)

iii. What does 'sits looking over harbour and city' suggest about the fog? (1)

iv. The fog 'moves on' just as it came. What does this tell us about the nature of fog, and how is it like a cat's behaviour? (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The poet presents the fog as a cat throughout the poem.
Reason (R): Like a cat, fog arrives silently, stays a while and then leaves of its own accord. (1)
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A commuter notices that the thick morning fog has vanished by noon without any warning. Which line from the poem best captures this experience? (1)
(a) "The fog comes"
(b) "on little cat feet"
(c) "and then moves on."
(d) "over harbour and city"

iii. What does the phrase "silent haunches" suggest about the fog? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

The poem is very short and does not rhyme. Do you think this form suits its subject? Give reasons.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Dense winter fog often disrupts life in Indian cities. Write an article (about 120 words) for your school magazine titled 'When the Fog Comes Calling', using the poet's image of fog as a cat and adding practical safety advice.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) Its quiet, soft and unnoticed arrival, like a cat's padded steps.

ii. Metaphor (extended): the fog is presented as a cat without using 'like' or 'as'.

iii. It suggests the fog spreads over and covers the whole area for a while, as if watching it.

iv. Fog is temporary and changeable; it settles for a while and then drifts away without warning. A cat too arrives silently, sits watching calmly and then leaves at its own will, unpredictably.

Answer Q2

i. (a) The fog's silent, unpredictable movement is exactly why it is compared to a cat.

ii. (c) "and then moves on." It shows the fog leaving suddenly, on its own.

iii. The fog rests quietly and motionless over the place, like a cat sitting on its hind legs.

Answer Q3 Yes. Fog arrives quietly and stays only briefly, and the short, free-verse lines create the same light, silent and fleeting effect. Without rhyme or regular rhythm the poem feels natural and unforced, like the fog's soft drifting. Its brevity also makes the single cat image vivid and easy to picture.

Answer Q4 Value points

- Title and writer's name; opening that uses the poet's image of fog arriving silently on 'little cat feet'.
- Describes how fog quietly covers roads, rail tracks, harbours and airports in winter mornings.
- Notes its effects: delayed trains and flights, poor visibility and a higher risk of road accidents.
- Mentions that smoke and pollution mixed with fog form smog, which harms health.
- Safety advice: drive slowly with fog lights and low beams, keep distance, wear reflective clothing.
- Health advice: avoid early morning outdoor exercise on smoggy days, wear masks if air quality is poor.
- Conclusion: like the cat in the poem, fog moves on; patience and care keep us safe until it does.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 9

The Tale of Custard the Dragon

Ogden Nash

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

Belinda paled, and she cried, Help! Help!
But Mustard fled with a terrified yelp,
Ink trickled down to the bottom of the household,
And little mouse Blink strategically mouseholed.

But up jumped Custard, snorting like an engine,
Clashed his tail like irons in a dungeon,
With a clatter and a clank and a jangling squirm
He went at the pirate like a robin at a worm.

i. The comparison "like a robin at a worm" suggests that Custard attacked the pirate (1)
(a) timidly and slowly
(b) eagerly and without fear
(c) clumsily and by accident
(d) quietly and secretly

ii. What does the word "mouseholed" tell us about Blink's reaction to the danger? (1)

iii. Identify the poetic device in "snorting like an engine". (1)

iv. How does this extract overturn the reader's earlier impression of the household's 'brave' pets and the 'cowardly' dragon? Explain with reference to the lines. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Ink, Blink and Mustard rudely called Custard 'Percival'.
Reason (R): Custard was the only one who fought the pirate. (1)
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. In a class, a quiet student who never boasts calmly handles an emergency while the loud 'brave' ones panic. Which idea from the poem does this reflect? (1)
(a) Pets should be kept in cages for safety.
(b) Strength depends on a person's size.
(c) Humour is the best way to hide fear.
(d) Real courage is shown in action, not in boasting.

iii. What does Custard's repeated wish for "a nice safe cage" reveal about him? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

After saving the household, Custard is still called a coward and is not given credit. Why do you think the others behave this way, and what does this tell us about how people sometimes treat those who are different?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are Custard. On the night after the pirate's defeat, write a diary entry describing the attack, how you felt while fighting, and your feelings when the others still laughed at you. (about 120 words)

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) eagerly and without fear

ii. Blink hid in a mousehole to save herself; Nash turns the noun into a verb for humour.

iii. Simile: Custard's loud snorting is compared to the noise of an engine.

iv. Mustard, Ink and Blink, who boasted of bravery, flee and hide when real danger comes, while Custard, mocked as a coward, leaps forward and attacks the pirate. True courage is shown in action, not in boasting.

Answer Q2

i. (b) Both statements are true, but they teased him for crying for a safe cage, not for fighting.

ii. (d) Real courage is shown in action; Custard acted while the boasters fled.

iii. It shows he is cautious and seeks safety, which makes the others wrongly think him a coward.

Answer Q3 Ink, Blink and Mustard cannot admit that the one they teased proved braver than them, so they claim they would have done better. This shows how people protect their pride and keep labels on those who are different instead of judging them fairly by their actions.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Format: date and a personal, reflective tone written in the first person as Custard.
- Describes the pirate climbing in through the window with pistols and a cutlass while the others fled or hid.
- Admits that he usually cries for a nice safe cage, yet when Belinda was in danger he jumped up without thinking.
- Recalls swallowing the pirate in one gulp and the joy of seeing Belinda safe and happy.
- Expresses hurt that Ink, Blink and Mustard still boast that they would have been twice as brave.
- Reflects that courage means acting when it matters, and resolves to stay true to himself in spite of the teasing.

FIRST FLIGHT · POETRY · POEM 10

For Anne Gregory

W.B. Yeats

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

"Never shall a young man,
Thrown into despair
By those great honey-coloured
Ramparts at your ear,
Love you for yourself alone
And not your yellow hair."

i. The phrase "honey-coloured ramparts" refers to (1)
(a) the walls of a castle
(b) Anne's golden hair framing her face
(c) the young man's thick curls
(d) the earrings Anne is wearing

ii. Why does the speaker say the young man is "thrown into despair"? (1)

iii. Identify the poetic device used in "ramparts at your ear". (1)

iv. What concern about love and outward beauty does the speaker raise in these lines? Do you agree with him? Give a reason. **(2)**

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The speaker claims that only God could love Anne for herself alone.
Reason (R): The speaker himself discovered this idea in a holy text. **(1)**
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A teenager edits her photos to win more likes online but feels that nobody knows the real her. Whose feelings in the poem are closest to hers? **(1)**
(a) Anne Gregory
(b) the old religious man
(c) the young man in despair
(d) the speaker

iii. Which value does Anne show when she wishes to be loved "for myself alone"? **(1)**

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Anne says she will dye her hair brown, black or carrot so that she is loved for herself alone. Why does her plan not really solve the problem? Relate your answer to the way people today judge others on social media.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

"Only God could love you for yourself alone." Evaluate this idea from the poem and discuss whether unconditional love, free of any attraction to looks, is possible among human beings. Support your answer with an example from real life. (about 120 words)

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) Anne's golden hair framing her face

ii. He is so overwhelmed by her beauty that he feels hopeless about winning her love.

iii. Metaphor: her hair is compared to the protective walls of a fort.

iv. He fears that young men will be attracted only by her looks and will not love her true inner self. A reasoned view: yes, physical appearance often draws first attention, though lasting love depends on character.

Answer Q2

i. (c) A is true, but the text was found by an old religious man, not the speaker.

ii. (a) Anne Gregory, who wants to be valued for herself, not her looks.

iii. Self-respect: she wants to be valued for her inner qualities rather than her appearance.

Answer Q3 Changing the colour of her hair only replaces one outward feature with another; admirers would still judge her by appearance. Similarly, online profiles are judged by filtered pictures and looks. Real acceptance comes only when people value character, values and personality over surface appeal.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- The old man suggests that human love is always influenced by physical appearance, and only divine love is truly unconditional.
- Anne, young and idealistic, wants to be valued for her inner self, not for her golden hair.
- The poem shows the gap between youthful hope and the experience of age.
- Yeats implies that beauty attracts, but it should not be the only basis of love.
- Real-life link: a parent's love for a child or a friend who stands by us in illness or failure comes close to loving 'for yourself alone'.
- Conclusion: though attraction often begins with looks, deep human relationships can grow beyond them through respect and understanding.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 1

A Triumph of Surgery

James Herriot

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

I was really worried about Tricki this time. I had pulled up my car when I saw him in the street with his mistress and I was shocked at his appearance. He had become hugely fat, like a bloated sausage with a leg at each corner. His eyes, bloodshot and rheumy, stared straight ahead and his tongue lolled from his jaws.

i. Tricki's condition, as described in the extract, was mainly the result of **(1)**
(a) a serious infection
(b) old age
(c) overfeeding and lack of exercise
(d) an injury in the street

ii. Who is the 'mistress' referred to in the extract? **(1)**

iii. Which word in the extract means 'watery and inflamed'? (1)

iv. Why does the narrator compare Tricki to "a bloated sausage with a leg at each corner"? What does this image suggest about the narrator's attitude? (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Mr Herriot performed a major operation to cure Tricki.
Reason (R): Tricki recovered through a strict diet, exercise and the company of other dogs. (1)
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A doting grandparent keeps feeding a child sweets and rich snacks despite the doctor's warning. Whose behaviour in the story does this mirror? (1)
(a) Hodgekin, the gardener
(b) Mrs Pumphrey
(c) Mr Herriot's partner
(d) the other dogs at the surgery

iii. Mrs Pumphrey calls Tricki's recovery "a triumph of surgery". Why is this phrase ironic? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Mrs Pumphrey loved Tricki deeply, yet her love nearly harmed him. What lesson can parents and pet owners today learn from her behaviour?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are Mrs Pumphrey. Write a letter to Mr Herriot after Tricki returns home healthy, thanking him and describing what you have learnt from the experience. (about 120 words)

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (c) overfeeding and lack of exercise

ii. Mrs Pumphrey, Tricki's wealthy and doting owner.

iii. Rheumy.

iv. The comic image stresses how shapeless and swollen the dog had become. It shows the narrator's gentle humour along with his real concern, as a vet, for the animal's deteriorating health.

Answer Q2

i. (d) No operation was done; Tricki was cured by diet, exercise and play.

ii. (b) Mrs Pumphrey, whose excessive pampering and overfeeding made Tricki ill.

iii. No surgery was performed; Tricki recovered only through fasting, exercise and the company of other dogs.

Answer Q3 Mrs Pumphrey showed love through excess food, sweets and comfort but ignored discipline and exercise. Parents and pet owners should understand that real care means doing what is healthy, even if it is less pleasant, such as balanced food, activity and firm limits, rather than giving in to every demand.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Format: address, date, salutation, a warm and grateful tone, and a suitable close.
- Expresses heartfelt thanks for the 'triumph of surgery' that restored Tricki to health.
- Describes Tricki bounding towards her, lively and lean, when she came to collect him.
- Admits that her overfeeding with malt, cod-liver oil, cream cakes and chocolates caused his illness.
- Recognises that his treatment was simply a strict diet, exercise and the company of other dogs.
- Promises to give Tricki controlled meals and regular walks in future.
- Ends by offering to keep sending gifts, such as eggs and wine, as a token of her gratitude.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 2

The Thief's Story

Ruskin Bond

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

> *I was still a thief when I met Anil. And though only 15 years old, I was an experienced and fairly successful hand. Anil was watching the wrestlers when I approached him. He was about 25 — a tall, lean fellow — and he looked easy-going, kind and simple enough for my purpose. I hadn't had much luck of late and thought I might be able to get into the young man's confidence.*

i. Which quality of Anil made the narrator choose him as a target? (1)
(a) His wealth and fine clothes
(b) His easy-going and simple appearance
(c) His interest in wrestling
(d) His strict and watchful nature

ii. What does the phrase 'a fairly successful hand' suggest about the narrator? (1)

iii. Why did the narrator want to 'get into the young man's confidence'? **(1)**

iv. The narrator judges Anil in a single glance. Evaluate how reliable this first impression turns out to be by the end of the story. **(2)**

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The narrator went back and slipped the money under Anil's mattress before Anil woke up.
Reason (R): He realised that learning to read and write, and Anil's trust, could give him a better future than the stolen money. **(1)**
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A shopkeeper lets a new helper handle the cash box even though he has heard rumours about the boy's past. Which idea from the story does this situation reflect? **(1)**
(a) Wealth matters more than learning.
(b) Strict punishment is the only way to reform someone.
(c) Quiet trust can bring out the best in a person.
(d) People never change their habits.

iii. The next morning Anil hands the narrator a fifty-rupee note but says nothing about the theft. What value does his silence show? **(1)**

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Anil gives the boy fifty rupees the next morning without a word about the theft. What does this silent act reveal, and how can such quiet forgiveness change a person in real life?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

You are the narrator. On the night you returned the money to Anil's mattress, write a diary entry describing what you had planned, what made you turn back, and what you have decided about your future.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) His easy-going and simple appearance

ii. It suggests he was already a skilled and practised thief despite his young age.

iii. He had not had much luck lately and hoped to win Anil's trust so that he could rob him.

iv. Only partly reliable: Anil is indeed kind and trusting, but he is not simple; he quietly knows about the theft and chooses to forgive, showing a wisdom the narrator had failed to see.

Answer Q2

i. (a) The hope of becoming an educated, trusted person made him return the money.

ii. (c) Quiet trust can bring out the best in a person; Anil's trust reformed the narrator.

iii. Forgiveness and generosity: he knew of the theft (the notes were damp) yet chose to trust the boy.

Answer Q3 Anil's silence shows that he knew of the theft yet chose trust over punishment. By offering money and the promise of education, he gave the boy dignity instead of shame. In real life, quiet forgiveness often awakens a person's conscience more deeply than a scolding, because it leaves room for self-correction.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Opens with the date and the narrator's restless, confused state of mind on the rain-soaked night.
- Recalls stealing Anil's six hundred rupees and planning to catch the Lucknow Express.
- Describes hesitating on the platform as the train pulled out, unable to board it.
- Reflects that Anil's trust and the chance to read and write were worth more than the money.
- Admits that the face of a trusting man who has been robbed troubled him deeply.
- Records slipping back into the room and placing the damp notes under the mattress.
- Ends with a resolve to give up stealing and become an educated, honest person.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 3

The Midnight Visitor

Robert Arthur

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

Ausable did not fit any description of a secret agent Fowler had ever read. Fowler had been looking forward to mysterious figures in the night, the crack of pistols, drugs in the wine. Instead, he had climbed five flights of stairs in a musty French hotel to a small room. Ausable was fat. Very fat.

i. What had Fowler expected from his meeting with a secret agent? (1)

(a) A quiet dinner and polite conversation

(b) Thrilling scenes of danger and intrigue

(c) A lecture on French history

(d) A long journey across Europe

ii. What was Fowler's profession, which explains his romantic idea of spies? (1)

iii. Which word in the extract means 'smelling stale and damp'? (1)

iv. How does the author use the contrast between Fowler's expectation and Ausable's appearance to prepare the reader for the story's twist? (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Ausable stayed calm when he found Max waiting in his room with a pistol.
Reason (R): Ausable had arranged for the police to arrive at his room at that exact hour. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. During a tense situation at work, a manager solves a problem with a clever idea instead of panicking. Which quality of Ausable does this mirror? (1)

(a) Physical strength (b) Wealth and influence

(c) A sense of humour (d) Presence of mind

iii. Who actually knocked at the door, and what does this reveal about Ausable? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Ausable defeats an armed rival without a single shot. What does this tell us about the value of presence of mind, and where might this quality help a student in everyday life?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

"Brains, not brawn, win the day." Evaluate this statement with reference to Ausable's handling of Max, and connect it to a real-life situation.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) Thrilling scenes of danger and intrigue

ii. He was a writer, so his ideas of spies came from stories he had read.

iii. Musty

iv. By showing that Ausable looks unheroic, the author lowers our expectations; the real excitement then comes from his sharp mind, not action, as he outwits Max with a quick, invented story.

Answer Q2

i. (c) A is true, but R is false; the knock was only the waiter with drinks, and the police story was invented.

ii. (d) Presence of mind; Ausable defeated an armed rival using only quick thinking.

iii. Henry the waiter, bringing the drinks Ausable had ordered; Ausable turned an ordinary event into part of his invented story.

Answer Q3 Ausable stays calm, invents the story of a balcony and police on the spot, and lets Max trap himself. Presence of mind turns a weak position into victory. A student can use the same calm thinking in an exam that suddenly feels difficult, in an emergency at home, or when handling a bully without violence.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Introduction: Ausable looks fat and slow, nothing like the heroic spy of fiction.
- Max enters with a pistol and demands the report on new missiles, so Ausable is physically at a disadvantage.
- Ausable calmly invents a balcony below the window and blames it for Max's entry.
- When the knock comes, he claims the police are arriving, which panics Max.
- Max tries to escape onto the non-existent balcony and falls, while the visitor is only Henry with drinks.
- Real-life link: negotiators and leaders often solve crises through calm reasoning rather than force.
- Conclusion: intelligence and composure are stronger weapons than strength or weapons.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 4

A Question of Trust

Victor Canning

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

> *Horace Danby was a good, solid citizen — but not entirely honest. He was about fifty, unmarried and lived with a housekeeper who worried more about his health than he did. He was happy and successful, except for hay fever which attacked him every summer. He made locks; and every year he planned carefully and robbed a safe.*

i. Which phrase best captures the contradiction in Horace Danby's character? **(1)**

(a) a good, solid citizen — but not entirely honest

(b) about fifty, unmarried

(c) worried more about his health

(d) happy and successful

ii. What health problem troubled Horace every summer? **(1)**

iii. How did his profession help him in his secret activity? **(1)**

iv. Horace stole only to buy rare books. Do you think a 'good' purpose can justify a dishonest act? Give a reason. **(2)**

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The young woman was the real owner of Shotover Grange.
Reason (R): She cleverly pretended to be the lady of the house to make Horace open the safe. **(1)**

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A person shares a bank OTP with a polite caller who sounds very official. Which lesson from the story applies most closely? **(1)**

(a) Smooth talk and appearances can deceive us.

(b) Good locks keep every valuable safe.

(c) Honesty is always rewarded at once.

(d) Hard work alone brings success.

iii. What makes the title 'A Question of Trust' ironic? **(1)**

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Horace, a clever thief, is himself tricked by a young woman. What is ironic about this, and what lesson does it offer about trusting strangers?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

You are Horace Danby, now in prison. Write a letter to your housekeeper explaining what happened at Shotover Grange and what you have learnt from it.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (a) a good, solid citizen — but not entirely honest

ii. He suffered from hay fever, an allergy to pollen.

iii. As a locksmith he understood locks and safes, so he could open them skilfully.

iv. No. A noble aim does not make theft right, because the owner still suffers a loss; Horace's own arrest shows that wrong means bring their own punishment.

Answer Q2

i. (d) A is false, but R is true; she was a thief posing as the owner.

ii. (a) Smooth talk and appearances can deceive us, just as the woman's charm fooled Horace.

iii. Horace, himself a dishonest man, was cheated because he trusted a stranger; the deceiver was deceived.

Answer Q3 The irony is that a man who deceives others for a living is fooled by a charming woman posing as the lady of the house; he even opens the safe for her and is blamed for the theft. The lesson is that confident appearances can mislead, so trust should rest on proof, not on manners.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Opening: apologises to the housekeeper for the worry his arrest has caused her.
- Explains that he entered Shotover Grange to rob the safe and buy rare books with the money.
- Describes being caught by a charming young woman who claimed to be the lady of the house.
- Admits that he opened the safe for her with his bare hands, trusting her story about the police.
- Reveals that she was a thief herself and that his fingerprints led to his arrest.
- Reflects bitterly on the irony that a thief was outwitted by a thief.
- Closes with a resolve to lead an honest life after his release and to trust more carefully.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 5

Footprints without Feet

H.G. Wells

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

The two boys started in surprise at the fresh muddy imprints of a pair of bare feet. What was a barefooted man doing on the steps of a house in the middle of London? And where was the man? As they gazed, a remarkable sight met their eyes. A fresh footprint appeared from nowhere! Further footprints followed, one after another, descending the steps and progressing down the street.

i. Why were the two boys surprised when they first noticed the footprints? (1)

(a) The footprints were unusually large.

(b) Fresh muddy prints of bare feet appeared on a London house's steps with no person in sight.

(c) The footprints were made of blood.

(d) The footprints led into a museum.

ii. Whose footprints were these, and why could he not be seen? (1)

iii. Which word in the extract shows that the boys looked at the sight steadily and with wonder? (1)

iv. The writer uses short questions and an exclamation in the extract. What effect does this create on the reader? Explain. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Griffin was a brilliant scientist.
Reason (R): He set fire to his landlord's house in London. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A gifted student uses a talent for computers to steal classmates' passwords. Which message from Griffin's story does this situation echo? (1)

(a) Scientific skill always earns respect.

(b) Talent misused without values brings trouble and isolation.

(c) Staying hidden is always the wisest choice.

(d) Villagers are quick to welcome strangers.

iii. What does Griffin's theft from the London store and of the clergyman's money show about his character? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Griffin was a brilliant scientist, yet the story calls him "lawless". Using his conduct in the story, explain how scientific talent without moral responsibility can become dangerous. Connect your answer to a present-day example.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are Mrs Hall, the landlady of the inn at Iping. Write a diary entry (about 120 words) describing your strange guest, the events that troubled you, and how you felt after he escaped.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) Fresh muddy prints of bare feet appeared on a London house's steps with no person in sight.

ii. They were Griffin's; he had made himself invisible by swallowing certain rare drugs.

iii. "Gazed".

iv. The rapid questions mirror the boys' bewilderment and invite the reader to share their curiosity, while the exclamation "A fresh footprint appeared from nowhere!" sharpens the sense of mystery and suspense, pulling the reader into the strange event.

Answer Q2

i. (b) Both are true, but burning the house shows his lawlessness, not his scientific brilliance.

ii. (b) Talent misused without values brings trouble and isolation, as Griffin ended up hunted and alone.

iii. He was selfish and lawless, using his power only for his own gain.

Answer Q3 Griffin used his discovery only for selfish ends: he set fire to his landlord's house, robbed a shop and attacked people. Talent without ethics turned a breakthrough into a threat. Similarly today, skills in hacking or deepfake technology can harm society when misused, so knowledge must be guided by conscience and law.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Date and opening: record the arrival of an odd guest in winter, wrapped in bandages, with blue goggles and a hat hiding his face.
- Note her early attempts at friendliness and how he rudely rejected them, keeping strictly to himself.
- Describe the suspicious happenings: the clergyman's house burgled, and the guest's room found empty with his clothes lying about.

- Recall the shock of seeing the furniture move and being pushed out of the room by an unseen force.
- Narrate the confrontation over unpaid bills when he removed his bandages and nose, revealing a headless figure.
- Mention the constable's failed attempt to arrest him and his escape after throwing off his clothes.
- Close with her fear, relief that he is gone, and a resolve to be more careful about strangers.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 6

The Making of a Scientist

Robert W. Peterson

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

Ebright's mother encouraged his interest in learning. She took him on trips, bought him telescopes, microscopes, cameras, mounting materials, and other equipment and helped him in many other ways. "He was my whole life after his father died," she said. "I used to bring home all kinds of things for him to learn from."

i. What role did Ebright's mother play in his development as a scientist? (1)

(a) She forced him to study science against his will.

(b) She discouraged his hobby of collecting butterflies.

(c) She nurtured his curiosity by providing equipment, trips and constant support.

(d) She sent him to a foreign university.

ii. Why does the mother say that her son was her "whole life"? (1)

iii. Name any one item mentioned in the extract that would help a young naturalist observe tiny specimens closely. (1)

iv. How does the extract show that parental involvement can shape a child's future? Support your answer with one inference. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Ebright's first science fair entry did not win a prize.
Reason (R): He had only displayed slides of frog tissues, while the winners had carried out real experiments. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A student's model wins nothing at an inter-school fair, but she spends the next year designing a proper experiment and wins the following time. Which trait of Ebright does she reflect? (1)

(a) Depending on luck to succeed

(b) Learning from failure and working harder

(c) Copying the ideas of the previous winners

(d) Giving up a hobby after one setback

iii. Name any two qualities that, according to the chapter, combine to make a scientist like Ebright. (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Ebright's first science fair project on butterflies did not win a prize. How did this failure help him grow? What lesson can students draw from it in their own studies?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

"A scientist is made, not born." Evaluate this statement in the light of Richard Ebright's life, discussing the qualities and circumstances that made him a successful scientist (about 120 words).

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (c) She nurtured his curiosity by providing equipment, trips and constant support.

ii. Because her husband had died when Ebright was in the third grade, and he was all she had.

iii. A microscope.

iv. By filling his world with learning tools and time, the mother turned Ebright's natural curiosity into disciplined inquiry; she even gave him the book that started his butterfly-tagging work. Her steady encouragement made learning a joy, laying the foundation for his later scientific achievements.

Answer Q2

i. (a) Losing taught him that a winning project needs a genuine experiment, not just a display.

ii. (b) Learning from failure and working harder: Ebright turned his first loss into better experiments.

iii. A first-rate mind, curiosity, and the will to win for the right reasons (any two).

Answer Q3 Losing made Ebright realise that a winning project needs real experiments, not just neat displays. He began testing ideas, which led to the viceroy-monarch study and the discovery of a new insect hormone. Students learn that failure is feedback: analysing mistakes and improving the method leads to deeper learning and success.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Ebright had natural curiosity: as a child he collected butterflies, rocks, coins and fossils in Reading, Pennsylvania.
- His mother's encouragement and the book The Travels of Monarch X opened the world of science to him.
- He showed perseverance by raising and tagging thousands of butterflies and continuing after an early science fair loss.
- He learnt to do real experiments, studying the viceroy's mimicry and the gold spots on the monarch pupa, which won him prizes.
- His work led to a theory of how cells read their DNA, published while he was still a young researcher.
- He was also a debater, public speaker and canoeist, showing that a well-rounded mind supports scientific thinking.
- Conclusion: talent was a seed, but guidance, hard work and the will to win made him a scientist, so the statement largely holds true.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 7

The Necklace

Guy de Maupassant

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

She was one of those pretty young ladies, born as if through an error of destiny, into a family of clerks. She had no dowry, no hopes, not the slightest chance of being appreciated, understood, loved and married by a rich and distinguished man; and she slipped into marriage with a minor clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction.

i. What does the phrase "an error of destiny" suggest about Matilda's view of her life? (1)

(a) She was grateful for her humble family.

(b) She believed she deserved a richer, grander life than the one fate gave her.

(c) She thought her husband had made an error.

(d) She regretted not studying harder.

ii. Why did Matilda feel she had no chance of marrying a rich man? (1)

iii. Whom did Matilda finally marry? (1)

iv. How does this opening paragraph prepare the reader for the tragedy that follows? Give one reason. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Matilda was unhappy even though her life was reasonably comfortable.
Reason (R): She had been born into a wealthy family of high social rank. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A teenager buys a costly phone on a loan just to impress classmates and then struggles for months to repay it. Which message of the story does this situation echo most closely? (1)

(a) Hard work always brings quick rewards

(b) Friends should share their possessions freely

(c) Borrowing is the safest way to meet one's needs

(d) Vanity and the wish to show off can lead to great hardship

iii. What does the final revelation that the borrowed necklace was only an imitation suggest about Matilda's decision to hide its loss? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Had Matilda told Madame Forestier the truth about the lost necklace at once, how might her life have changed? What does this teach us about honesty?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

Imagine you are Monsieur Loisel. Ten years after the ball, write a letter to a close friend (about 120 words) reflecting on how one evening changed your family's life and what you have learnt.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) She believed she deserved a richer, grander life than the one fate gave her.

ii. She came from a family of clerks and had no dowry.

iii. Monsieur Loisel, a minor clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction.

iv. It establishes Matilda's dissatisfaction and longing for luxury. This vanity later drives her to borrow the necklace to appear wealthy at the ball, and its loss costs her ten years of hardship, so the seed of the tragedy lies in this discontent.

Answer Q2

i. (c) A is true, but R is false: she was born into a family of clerks, which fed her discontent.

ii. (d) Vanity and the wish to show off can lead to great hardship, as Matilda's ten years of toil show.

iii. Had she honestly admitted the loss, she could have avoided ten years of needless suffering.

Answer Q3 Madame Forestier would have revealed that the necklace was imitation, worth at most five hundred francs. The Loisels would have avoided the thirty-six-thousand-franc debt and ten years of drudgery. The lesson is that honesty, even when embarrassing, is far less costly than hiding a mistake out of pride.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- Recall obtaining the ball invitation hoping to please Matilda, and giving up his savings for a gun to buy her a dress.
- Describe the joy of the ball and the shock of discovering at home that the borrowed diamond necklace was lost.
- Explain the frantic search and the decision to replace it with one costing thirty-six thousand francs.
- Narrate how he used his inheritance and borrowed heavily, signing ruinous promises and dealing with usurers.
- Describe the hard years: dismissing the maid, moving to a garret, his night work copying manuscripts, and Matilda's ageing through labour.
- Mention the final bitter discovery that the original necklace was false.
- Reflect on the lesson: pride and false appearances cost dearly, and truthfulness and contentment matter more than show.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 8

Bholi

K.A. Abbas

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

Bholi's real name was Sulekha. She was the fourth daughter of Numberdar Ramlal. She was ten months old when she fell off the cot on her head and perhaps it had damaged some part of her brain. That was why she remained a backward child and came to be known as Bholi, the simpleton.

i. Which word best describes the attitude reflected in the name "Bholi" given to the girl? (1)

(a) affectionate (b) respectful
(c) dismissive (d) protective

ii. State the accident that first set Bholi apart from her sisters. (1)

iii. Complete the sentence: The narrator uses the word "perhaps" because _____. (1)

iv. How does a label like "simpleton" affect the confidence of a child? Answer with reference to Bholi. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): Bholi refused to marry Bishamber at the wedding ceremony.
Reason (R): Bholi's father sent her to school mainly because the Tehsildar had urged the villagers to do so. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A volunteer teacher patiently encourages a shy child who stammers, and within months the child begins to speak up in class. This most closely mirrors which idea in the story? (1)

(a) Kindness and education can build a neglected child's confidence
(b) Children learn best when they are scolded
(c) Shy children should be kept away from school
(d) Only wealthy families can help children improve

iii. Why did Bholi's parents accept Bishamber's proposal without much hesitation? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Bholi's teacher changed her life with a few kind words. What does this tell us about the role of a teacher in shaping a child who has been neglected at home?

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

You are Bholi. On the night your wedding was called off, write a diary entry (about 120 words) describing what happened and how you feel about your decision.

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (c) dismissive

ii. She fell off a cot on her head when she was ten months old.

iii. the damage to her brain is only a guess, never confirmed by anyone.

iv. A label repeated daily makes a child believe it; Bholi grew silent, stammered and withdrew, because everyone treated her as foolish instead of helping her.

Answer Q2

i. (b) Both are true, but she refused because Bishamber was greedy and had insulted her, not because of the Tehsildar.

ii. (a) Kindness and education can build a neglected child's confidence, as the teacher did for Bholi.

iii. He was well-off and asked for no dowry at first, and they feared no one else would marry Bholi.

Answer Q3 A sensitive teacher can see potential that a family overlooks. By speaking gently, ignoring her stammer and promising she would become the most learned in the village, the teacher gave Bholi hope and confidence. Patient encouragement, not pity, turns a silent, frightened child into a confident, self-respecting individual.

Answer Q4 Value points

- Format: date and a personal opening; first-person, reflective tone.
- Describes the greedy groom, Bishamber, demanding five thousand rupees as dowry after seeing her pock-marks.
- Recalls her father's humiliation as he laid his turban at Bishamber's feet and paid the money.
- Explains why she refused to marry a mean, greedy and contemptible man.
- Notes that she spoke without stammering, showing the confidence education gave her.
- Resolves to serve her parents in their old age and teach in the same school.
- Ends with gratitude to her teacher and pride in her own self-respect.

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET · CHAPTER 9

The Book That Saved the Earth

Claire Boiko

Q1 EXTRACT-BASED — 5 marks

> *Noodle: Humpty Dumpty sat on a wall,*
> *Humpty Dumpty had a great fall.*
> *All the King's horses, and all the King's men,*
> *Couldn't put Humpty together again.*

i. Why does this rhyme terrify Think-Tank? (1)

(a) He fears the King's soldiers

(b) He believes it describes a plan to destroy an egg-shaped leader like him

(c) He cannot understand the language

(d) He thinks walls are dangerous on Mars

ii. What kind of book is Noodle reading from? (1)

iii. Which trait of Think-Tank is shown by his reaction to a simple rhyme? (1)

iv. How does this misunderstanding end the Martian invasion? Explain briefly. (2)

Q2 QUICK COMPETENCY CHECK — 3 marks

i. Assertion (A): The Martians succeeded in invading Earth in the twenty-first century.
Reason (R): The story is narrated by a historian living in the twenty-fifth century. (1)

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

ii. A team leader refuses to admit that he cannot read a map, ignores his teammates' advice and leads the group in the wrong direction. Whose behaviour in the play does this resemble? (1)

(a) Noodle, who carefully reads the book aloud

(b) Omega, who obeys orders faithfully

(c) Think-Tank, whose pride makes him misjudge everything

(d) The Historian, who records events accurately

iii. What is ironic about the name 'Think-Tank'? (1)

Q3 SHORT ANSWER — 3 marks

Think-Tank never admits he does not know something and calls the others "stupid". How can such a leadership style harm a team? Relate it to a real-life group project.

Q4 LONG ANSWER — 6 marks

"Books are not only for information; they can also change history." Evaluate this statement with reference to the play and your own experience (about 120 words).

ANSWERS

Answer Q1

i. (b) He believes it describes a plan to destroy an egg-shaped leader like him

ii. A book of nursery rhymes, Mother Goose.

iii. His arrogance makes him misread everything, revealing his foolishness and insecurity.

iv. Convinced that the Earthlings have discovered his weakness, Think-Tank panics and orders an immediate retreat, so a harmless book saves the Earth.

Answer Q2

i. (d) A is false, as the invasion was abandoned, but R is true: the Historian narrates from the future.

ii. (c) Think-Tank, whose pride makes him misjudge everything, including a harmless book of rhymes.

iii. It suggests great intelligence, yet the character is conceited and makes foolish judgements.

Answer Q3 A leader who thinks he knows everything ignores others' ideas and makes decisions on wrong assumptions. Think-Tank misread a nursery book and retreated in fear. In a group project, a bossy leader who silences members may miss errors; a humble leader who listens gets better results.

Answer Q4 **Value points**

- The twentieth century is called the Age of the Book in the play, showing the value of books.
- The Martians, unable to read Earth's books correctly, draw absurd conclusions about Earthlings.
- A simple Mother Goose book, misread by Think-Tank, makes the invaders flee and saves the planet.
- This humour shows that understanding a book needs context, not just reading the words.
- Real-life link: books shape beliefs, inspire movements and preserve knowledge across generations.
- Readers must read with curiosity and an open mind, unlike the proud Think-Tank.
- Conclusion: the play humorously proves that the right book, rightly read, can change history.

WRITING SKILLS · SECTION B

Writing Skills

Q1 FORMAL LETTER — 5 marks

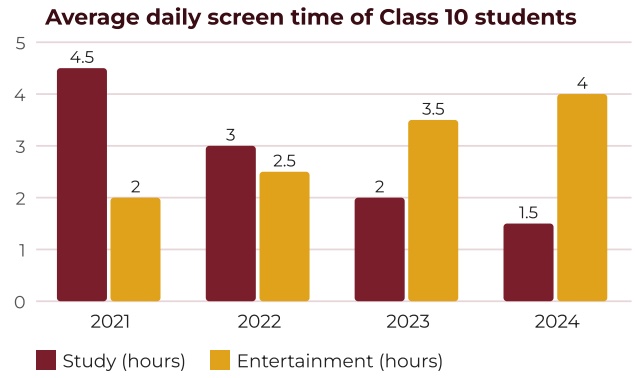
You are Kavya/Karan, a resident of 14, Lake View Colony, Bhopal. Streetlights in your colony have not worked for the past three weeks, leading to a rise in chain-snatching incidents and accidents at night. Write a letter to the Municipal Commissioner, Bhopal Municipal Corporation, complaining about the problem and requesting urgent repair. (100-120 words)

Q2 FORMAL LETTER — 5 marks

You are Riya/Rohan, Head Girl/Head Boy of Sunrise Public School, Sector 9, Dwarka, New Delhi. Your school plans to set up a reading corner for junior students. Write a letter to The Sales Manager, Bookwell Distributors, Daryaganj, New Delhi, placing an order for storybooks, encyclopaedias and magazines, and asking about discounts and delivery. (100-120 words)

Q3 ANALYTICAL PARAGRAPH — 5 marks

The bar chart below shows the average daily screen time (in hours) of students of Class 10 in a city, for study and for entertainment, from 2021 to 2024. Write an analytical paragraph (100-120 words) describing the data.



ANSWERS

Answer Q1 **Value points**

- Format: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, complimentary close and name (1).
- Subject: Complaint regarding non-functional streetlights in Lake View Colony.
- States the problem: streetlights not working for three weeks despite oral complaints.
- Consequences: rise in chain-snatching, unsafe streets for women, children and the elderly, minor road accidents.
- Request: immediate repair and regular maintenance checks by the electricity wing.

- Polite, firm close expecting prompt action; formal tone and concise language throughout.

Answer Q2 Value points

- Format: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, complimentary close and name (1).
- Subject: Placing an order for books for the school reading corner.
- Purpose: school setting up a reading corner for Classes 3 to 5.
- Order details in a clear list: titles or categories, number of copies (e.g. 20 storybooks, 2 sets of encyclopaedias, annual magazine subscriptions).
- Terms: asks for the usual school discount, mode of payment and delivery date; requests undamaged copies and a bill.
- Courteous close requesting confirmation of the order.

Answer Q3 Value points

- Introduction: the chart compares daily screen time spent on study and entertainment by Class 10 students over four years, 2021 to 2024.
- Study screen time fell steadily from 4.5 hours in 2021 to 3.0 hours in 2022, 2.0 hours in 2023 and 1.5 hours in 2024, a drop of 3 hours.
- Entertainment screen time rose from 2.0 hours in 2021 to 2.5, then 3.5, and reached 4.0 hours in 2024, doubling over the period.
- In 2021 study use was more than twice entertainment use; by 2023 the trend had reversed, with entertainment (3.5) ahead of study (2.0).
- Total screen time stayed around 5.5 to 6.5 hours a day (6.5 in 2021, 5.5 in 2022 and 2023, 5.5 in 2024), so the change is in purpose, not in total use.
- Conclusion: the shift after online classes ended suggests a growing habit of recreational screen use that schools and parents need to address.

How to attack competency-based questions

1. **Read the stem first.** Before the extract, read what each sub-question asks; then read the extract with those points in mind.
2. **Quote, then explain.** For reference-to-context answers, pick the exact phrase from the extract and explain it in your own words.
3. **Match length to marks.** 1 mark: one precise line. 3 marks: 40 to 50 words with one example. 6 marks: 100 to 120 words, planned in three parts.
4. **Name the character and the trait.** Support every trait with an incident from the chapter, not a general statement.
5. **Use the format marks.** Letters and analytical paragraphs carry marks for format: heading, date, subject, salutation, introduction and conclusion.
6. **Read data carefully.** In chart-based paragraphs, compare the highest, the lowest and the overall trend; quote the numbers.
7. **Check grammar answers in context.** Read the full sentence again with your option in place before you mark it.
8. **Revise with the value points.** Tick the value points you covered after each set; the missed ones are your revision list.

Exam Tip: pehle sawaal padho, phir extract. Answer me extract ka shabd zaroor quote karo, isse marks pakke hote hain.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184
SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER
CLASS-X- (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

Read the instructions carefully and follow them:
1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A
READING SKILLS (20 marks)

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Have you ever really looked at a toy store shelf and wondered what you're actually looking at? Rows upon rows of plastic products—bright, shiny, and visually appealing. We barely question them anymore. But here's a question worth asking: does the type of toy we choose really matter? The answer might surprise you. It turns out that choosing between a conventional plastic toy and an eco-friendly alternative is about far more than just grabbing something off the shelf.

(2) Let's be honest—plastic toys are everywhere. They've been the default choice for generations, and there's a reason: they're affordable, they're designed to grab attention, and they work. However, what exactly are we getting when we buy a mass-produced plastic toy? Often, we're getting something made with chemicals like BPA* and lead, substances that make manufacturing cheaper. These aren't just abstract risks floating in the background. They're real concerns that affect real people, especially children who interact with these toys daily.

(3) This is precisely why eco-friendly toys matter so much. Crafted from organic cotton, sustainable wood, and recycled materials, they ask a fundamental question: what if toys could be safe, engaging, and environmentally responsible all at once? When we choose these alternatives, we're not just buying a toy—we're making a statement about what we value.

(4) Ever noticed how a wooden block can keep a child entertained for hours, while some plastic gadget loses its appeal in minutes? There's a reason for that. Eco-friendly toys often engage children's minds differently. Natural materials offer something special—rich textures, varied tactile experiences, and a kind of sensory richness that engages the brain in deeper ways. A wooden building set doesn't just entertain; it challenges children to think, problem-solve, and create. It demands imagination in a way that pre-programmed, plastic alternatives never can.

There is no change in the Question Paper Design and Assessment Pattern for Academic Session 2026-27

(5) Think about the typical lifespan of a plastic toy. It breaks, it ends up in landfills, and it's replaced. Eco-friendly toys, however, are designed to survive. They're built to last years, to be passed along, to become keepsakes rather than waste. This durability speaks volumes about the difference between toys made purely for profit and toys made with purpose.

(6) Ultimately, the choice between conventional and eco-friendly toys reflects something deeper: how we think about consumption itself. Do we want a world where toys are disposable trinkets, or do we want objects that matter—that are safe, engaging, and kind to the planet? It's not just about toys. It's about the choices we make every single day and what those choices say about who we are and what kind of future we're building.

*BPA: Bisphenol A, a chemical used primarily in the production of plastic items

Created for academic usage / 435 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In Paragraph 1, what does the phrase ‘rows upon rows of plastic products' emphasise? 1

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. 1

When the writer says, 'These aren’t just abstract risks floating in the background', he refers to _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) the potential health hazards present in mass-produced plastic toys that consumers often ignore or are unaware of.
(b) the general concerns about toy safety that exist in society but don't directly affect individual purchasing decisions.

III The writer mentions, ‘organic cotton, sustainable wood, and recycled materials’ in paragraph 3. 1
Which of the following is an example of ‘recycled material’?

A. Hand spun clothes certified by environmental organisations
B. Cotton grown without pesticides or synthetic fertilisers
C. Plastic bottles processed and converted into shoes
D. Wood treated with chemical preservatives to extend lifespan

IV In paragraphs 2 and 3, the writer contrasts the characteristics of plastic toys with eco-friendly toys. 2
What does this comparison reveal about the writer's perspective on consumer responsibility?

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 4) 1
The sensory richness of eco-friendly toys primarily enhances children's entertainment value rather than their cognitive development.

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VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). 1

disposable trinkets: landfills:: _____ :_____

(a) eco-friendly toys: environmental responsibility
(b) meaningful keepsakes: future generations

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). 1

(i) BPA and lead are used in the production of mass-produced plastic toys.
(ii) Plastic toys are affordable and attractive, which makes them popular.
(iii) Eco-friendly toys are designed to survive longer and are not discarded as waste.
(iv) Wooden toys engage children's minds in deeper and more meaningful ways than plastic toys.
(v) The choice between plastic and eco-friendly toys is about mindful consumption.

A. (i) O (ii) O (iii) F (iv) F (v) O
B. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F
C. (i) O (ii) F (iii) F (iv) O (v) O
D. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

VIII What might be the author's purpose of asking rhetorical questions** throughout the passage? 2

** *a figure of speech in which questions are asked for a reason other than to get an answer*

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) A 2023 report found that 'audio routines' have become a mainstay in people's daily lives. Unlike traditional content, audio-based experiences offer a hands-free and eyes-free experience, allowing individuals to stay entertained or absorb information outside the confines of a screen or paper book. The audiobooks market in India is also witnessing intense growth, fuelled by the rapid adoption of smartphones and a rising preference for convenient, on-the-go content consumption.

(2) A survey found that half of audiobook listeners spend between 1-4 hours per week listening to audiobooks and 33% spend 5-10 hours a week. When asked in which scenarios they're most likely to hit play on an audiobook, commute was the most popular choice. 63% said they listen to audiobooks while on the go, 54% while completing household chores and 44% while relaxing or falling asleep. 56% of the listeners generally prefer to listen to fiction over non-fiction books.

(3) 67% of audiobook listeners say they read more with audiobooks compared to books in traditional text format. When integrated into daily routines, audiobooks serve as a channel for more people to enjoy literature, accommodating those with the busiest of schedules.

(4) The audiobook format also offers a user-friendly format that enables a diverse population, including individuals with physical or neurological limitations to have access to literature. Additionally, it serves as a valuable resource for individuals with attention span difficulties, allowing them to engage with books despite the challenges of sitting down and maintaining a focus on reading.

Created for academic usage / 253 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. 1
The word 'mainstay' as used in Paragraph 1 suggests that audiobooks have _____.
(overpowered people's lives/ become a support in people's lives)

II What does relationship between smartphone adoption and audiobook suggest about consumer preferences? (Paragraph 1) 1

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. 1
Assertion: The most preferred scenario for listening to audiobooks is when travelling.
Reason: During travel, listeners struggle with short attention span problems.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.
B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.
C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
All of the following are mentioned in paragraph 2 EXCEPT—

A. 50% of audiobook listeners spend between one and four hours weekly listening to audiobooks.
B. A little more than half of the audiobook listeners prefer fiction over non-fiction content.
C. Approximately 30% percent of listeners spend less than one hour weekly listening to audiobooks.
D. Audiobooks have made it possible for people to appreciate literature.

V Compare the preference for fiction (56%) versus non-fiction in audiobooks. What might this suggest about listener expectations? (Paragraph 2) 2

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 3) 1
Audiobook adoption has worked well for people with busy lifestyles because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 4 that indicates that everyone would find audiobooks easy and comfortable. 1

VIII A student with reading difficulties wants to complete his reading assignments in school. Why would an audio book option be an advantage? (Paragraph 4) 1

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Rise of Audiobooks: Transforming Reading' is a suitable title for the passage. 1

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SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20

GRAMMAR

3. Complete **any ten** of the twelve following tasks, as directed.

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of a formal email: 1

Dear Ms. Sharma,
We are writing to confirm that your application for the scholarship programme _____ by our selection committee last week.

A. has been reviewed
B. was reviewed
C. has been reviewing
D. will be reviewed

II Report the doctor's statement. 1

Doctor: "You should reduce your sugar intake and exercise regularly."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the official notice: 1

Notification to All Students,

Please note that _____ applicants who have submitted incomplete forms are required to resubmit their documents by Friday.

A. these
B. those
C. this
D. that

IV Read Isha's statement to her class teacher about missing school: 1

"I was absent yesterday because I had to visit the dentist for my regular check-up."

Report Isha's statement by completing the following sentence:
Isha explained that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a technical report: 1

Neither the software developers nor the project manager were aware of the compatibility issues.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from the school's safety policy: 1

All students _____ wear their identification badges at all times while on campus premises.

A. might
B. could
C. must
D. may

There is no change in the Question Paper Design and Assessment Pattern for Academic Session 2026-27

VII The given question has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. 1

What among these books have you read before?

No.	Error	Correction
A.	What	Which
B.	among	between
C.	these	this
D.	have	has

VIII Juhi asked her friend the following question: 1

"Are you prepared for the mathematics test next week?"

Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.

Juhi asked her friend _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank. 1

Saira was disappointed when she saw there was _____ food left to serve the guests.

A. few B. least

C. any D. little

X Identify the error and suggest the correction. 1

Each of the participants in the Science Fair have been given a set of guidelines to follow during the competition.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the teacher's advice by choosing the correct options from those given in brackets. 1

If you practice regularly, you _____ win the quiz competition next month. (might / must)

XII Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets from a travel blog. 1

This hill station _____ (lose) its natural beauty since the last time I saw it.

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Maya Nair, a concerned resident of Green View Colony, Guwahati. You feel that your colony lacks adequate recreational and community spaces for residents of all age groups. The existing facilities are insufficient. Write a letter to the Secretary of your Resident Welfare Association (RWA) in 120 words, highlighting the need for establishing a community centre in the colony explaining how it will benefit the residents. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Nandan Banerjee, a concerned citizen. Write a letter to the Editor of a local daily raising concern over the open burning of hospital and domestic waste in your city. Draw attention to its serious health implications, the need for scientific waste disposal practices and public awareness. **5**

5 A. Read the product details mentioned on an e-commerce website for a student study desk organiser. **5**

- ⇒ Multi-compartment storage with dedicated slots for books, stationery, and digital devices
- ⇒ Eco-friendly bamboo wood construction with non-toxic finish
- ⇒ Adjustable shelves to accommodate different item sizes
- ⇒ Compact yet spacious design suitable for a small room space
- ⇒ Anti-slip base prevents sliding on smooth surfaces
- ⇒ Available in natural wood and light oak finishes
- ⇒ Backed by a 5-year durability guarantee

Now, analyse why this desk organiser would be a good purchase for students. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as its sustainability, organisational efficiency, optimal use of space, functionality, and student appeal.

OR

5 B. Vikram, a student of Grade X, has been offered the position of President of his school's Debate Club, which requires 5-7 hours weekly commitment. Study the SWOT notes and write an analytical paragraph in 100-120 to evaluate whether accepting this responsibility is advisable. **5**

Strengths	**W**eaknesses	**O**pportunities	**T**hreats
Develops public speaking and leadership skills	Significant time commitment away from studies	Recognition and awards when representing school in state or national level competitions	Risk of burnout balancing multiple responsibilities
Creates strong network of like-minded peers	Managing team conflicts and disagreements	Opportunity to collaborate with other school clubs for joint events	Conflicts with board examination preparation schedule & potential decline in academic performance
Access to debate mentors and senior members who can provide guidance and support	Limited time available for other activities	Useful for university admissions in future due to leadership experience	Criticism or negative feedback from members

SECTION C **40**

LITERATURE TEXTBOOK

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A Natalya: But what's this? Why, you're in evening dress! Well, I never! Are you going to a ball or what? Though I must say you look better…Tell me, why are you got up like that?
Lomov: [excited] You see, honoured Natalya Stepanova…the fact is, I've made up my mind to ask you to hear me out…Of course you'll be surprised and perhaps even angry, but a…[aside] It's awfully cold!
Natalya: What's the matter? [pause] Well?
Lomov: I shall try to be brief: You must know, honoured Natalya Stepanova, that I have long, since my childhood, in fact, had the privilege of knowing your family. My late aunt and her husband, from whom, as you know, I inherited my land, always had the greatest respect for your father and your late mother. (The Proposal)

I Which of the following statements best explains Natalya's attitude in the opening lines of the extract? 1

(a) She is genuinely surprised by his formal attire and expresses sincere admiration while seeking an explanation.
(b) She mocks his formal dress with sarcasm to conceal her anxiety about his unexpected and unusual appearance.

II What do the ellipses (…) in Lomov's speech highlight? 1

A. reveals his struggle to articulate his prepared thoughts
B. shows his overconfidence and casual attitude
C. demonstrates his anxiety and emotional turmoil
D. indicates a lack of intelligence and education

III Complete the following suitably. 1
Lomov is quite formal in his conversation with Natalya and prepares lengthy justifications because he _____.

IV How does the author's use of stage directions such as [excited] and [aside] enhance the dramatic tension in this extract? 2

OR

B Sweat broke out over her whole body. Would her stammering tongue again disgrace her? For the sake of this kind woman, however she decided to make an effort. She had such a soothing voice; she would not laugh at her.
"Bh-Bh-Bho-Bho," she began to stammer.
"Well done, well done," the teacher encouraged her. "Come on, now— the full name?

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"Bh-Bh-Bho-Bholi." At last she was able to see it and felt relieved as if it was a great achievement.
"Well done." The teacher patted her affectionately and said, "Put the fear out of your heart and you will be able to speak like everyone else."
Bholi looked up as if to ask, "Really?" (Bholi)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1

Bholi shows some physical symptoms like sweat breaking out over her body and stammering. This shows she is _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
"Would her stammering tongue again disgrace her?" The author has used this question as a narrative technique, with the aim of _____.

A. convincing readers to judge Bholi
B. showcasing Bholi's inabilities
C. giving readers a peek into Bholi's thoughts
D. showing sympathy for Bholi

III The teacher's statement, "Put the fear out of your heart and you will be able to speak like everyone else." suggests that Bholi's primary obstacle is psychological rather than physical. Elaborate. 2

IV Fill in the blank with the correct word from the bracket. 1
Bholi's gesture of looking up 'as if to ask, Really?' reveals a mix of _____.
(hope and hesitation/ disobedience and doubt)

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A. Don't eat that chocolate, Amanda!
Remember your acne, Amanda!
Will you please look at me when I'm speaking to you,
Amanda! (Amanda)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1
The speaker connects chocolate consumption to acne, which reveals her concerns regarding _____.

II How does the speaker's demand 'look at me when I'm speaking to you' suggest the dynamic between them? 1

A. The speaker asserts authority which has a great influence on Amanda.
B. Amanda is defiant and the speaker feels disrespected and ignored.
C. Amanda is interested in listening to the speaker but is distracted.
D. The speaker feels insecure and anxious about losing Amanda.

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1

The speaker's use of 'Will you please' in the beginning of the third line suggests a _____ rather than a demand.

IV Analyse how the repetition of Amanda's name and the use of exclamation marks contribute to the tone and mood of the extract. 2

OR

B. Listen. The glass is breaking.
The trees are stumbling forward
into the night. Winds rush to meet them.
The moon is broken like a mirror,
its pieces flash now in the crown of the tallest oak. (The Trees)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1

The word 'listen' at the opening of the extract creates a sense of _____, pulling the reader directly into the dramatic manner of nature's revolt.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1

The phrase 'stumbling forward' suggests that the trees' movement is _____.

A. graceful and purposeful
B. deliberate and controlled
C. unsteady and uncertain
D. rapid and aggressive

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
The repeated imagery of 'breaking' in the extract suggests that it is not destruction but a/an _____part of any meaningful change or liberation.

IV How does the sequence of sensory experiences in the extract enhance meaning and impact readers? 2

8. Answer ***any four*** of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words**.** **4x 3=12**

I How does the poem use the 'cat metaphor' to characterise the fog's nature? 3
(Fog)

II The writer uses humour to simultaneously entertain readers and critique societal attitudes toward animals. Elaborate. (Mijbil the Otter) 3

III How does the hailstorm function as more than just a weather event in the story? 3
(A Letter to God)

IV Assess how the poem's message about not judging by appearances still relevant today. (The Tale of Custard the Dragon) 3

V Why has the writer included the legends about tea's origin-the Chinese emperor's story and Bodhidharma's tale in the narrative? 3

(Glimpses of India- Tea from Assam)

9. Answer ***any two*** of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2 x 3 = 6**

I Compare Hari's initial approach to Anil with his honest smile at the story's end. What does this change reveal? (The Thief's Story) 3

II Analyse how the writer uses irony throughout the story to convey the message that vanity and materialism lead to one's downfall. (The Necklace) 3

III Why does Horace take off his gloves to give the young lady his lighter? What does this action tell us about his state of mind at that crucial moment? 3

(A Question of Trust)

10 Answer ***any one*** of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Valli in 'Madam Rides the Bus' and the young seagull in 'His First Flight' are protagonists of the story who undergo personal transformation. Compare and contrast how the catalysts in these stories drive the change.

OR

B. The poems, 'The Ball Poem' and 'Dust of Snow' capture brief moments that teach lasting lessons. How do these poems propose that momentary events generate a lasting impact?

11. Answ**er *any one*** of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. In the story, 'The Midnight Visitor' the 'balcony' functions as the story's central plot device, yet it never physically exists. Discuss what the balcony symbolises in the story.

OR

B. In 'The Book that Saved the Earth', Think-Tank rules Mars with absolute authority and arrogance, yet he makes ridiculous mistakes throughout the play. Evaluate how this impacts his leadership.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184
MARKING SCHEME
CLASS-X- (2026-27)

General Instructions: -

1. The Marking Scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers / sample answers. The value points are in the nature of Guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. The students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, then due marks should be awarded accordingly.
2. If a student has attempted an extra question, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note "Extra Question".
3. If more than one option is mentioned in the answer of multiple choice questions, then no marks to be awarded.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

SECTION A: READING		
Discursive Passage		
1.	**Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.**	**10**
I	It emphasises the overwhelming abundance and endless rows of plastic toys in stores, highlighting how pervasive plastic products have become in consumer culture.	1
II	(a) the potential health hazards present in mass-produced plastic toys that consumers often ignore or are unaware of.	1
III	C Plastic bottles processed and converted into shoes	1
IV	The writer's comparison reveals that consumer responsibility extends beyond mere convenience and affordability. By highlighting the presence of harmful chemicals (BPA and lead) in plastic toys alongside the safer, more sustainable materials used in eco-friendly toys, the writer suggests that consumers should prioritise children's health and environmental impact over cost. The writer emphasises that making informed choices is both a personal and collective responsibility.	2
V	False	1
VI	(b) is correct. [maintains the logical relationship of the original analogy. Just as 'disposable trinkets (throwaway items) end up in 'landfills' (waste and environmental destruction); 'meaningful keepsakes' end up being with 'future generations' (as a legacy).]	1
VII	D. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O	1

VIII	The author uses rhetorical questions to engage readers directly and provoke thought. It is to make readers reflect on their choices. The questions encourage critical thinking and build a persuasive argument that guides readers toward accepting the need for eco-friendly alternatives.	2
	Case-Based Passage	
2.	**Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.**	**10**
I	become a support in people's lives	1
II	It suggests that consumers increasingly prefer digital, on-the-go content fitting mobile lifestyles, rather than physical books or stationary screen-based media.	1
III	C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.	1
IV	C. Approximately 30% of listeners spend less than one hour weekly listening to audiobooks.	1
V	The strong fiction preference (56%) indicates audiobooks are used for narrative-driven content. Storytelling formats likely work better in audio where the narrator's voice and the intricacies of the plot enhance engagement.	2
VI	audiobooks allow individuals to consume literature while engaging in other activities, eliminating the need to carve out dedicated time for conventional reading practices.	1
VII	user-friendly format	1
VIII	Any one • Audio format removes text processing barriers especially for students who struggle with reading such as decoding words & reading sentences. • Engagement occurs despite reading challenges when one is listening to audiobooks.	1
IX	Any one • This title comprehensively captures all major themes of the passage as it acknowledges the paradigm shift shown by the 67% of listeners who read more with audiobooks. • This title balances key ideas covered in all four paragraphs, growing popularity of audiobooks, while identifying key benefits.	1
	SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR (20 marks)	
	GRAMMAR (10 marks)	
3.	Complete **any ten** of twelve of the following tasks, as directed.	
I	B. was reviewed	1
II	The doctor advised/ recommended the patient to reduce his/ her/ their sugar intake and exercise regularly.	1
III	B. those	1

IV	she had been absent the previous day because she had had to visit the dentist for her regular check-up.	1
V	Error: were Correction: was	1
VI	C. must	1
VII	A. what - which	1
VIII	if she was prepared for the mathematics test the following week.	1
IX	D. little	1
X	Error: have Correction: has	1
XI	might	1
XII	has lost	1
	WRITING SKILLS (10 MARKS)	
4.	**Format-1 Content-2 Organisation of ideas-1 Accuracy-1**	**1 x 5 =5**
A.	(The response may be created from the following content points) ⇒ Issue and context • Insufficient recreational facilities in the colony • Lack of dedicated space for community activities and social gatherings • No indoor play areas for children and youth • Absence of venue for cultural programs and events ⇒ Need for Community Centre • Essential for promoting social bonding among residents-creates sense of belonging and colony pride • Provides safe, organised space for multiple age groups • Bridges gap between different families and communities ⇒ Benefits for Children and Youth • Indoor games, activities, and educational programs • Safe environment for recreation away from traffic • Develops skills and talents through workshops ⇒ Benefits for Adults and Elderly • Venue for community meetings and discussions • Space for cultural programs and celebrations • Fitness and yoga classes • Social events to reduce isolation among senior citizens ⇒ Appeal to RWA Secretary • Request for action and timely implementation • Call for cooperation from all residents and authorities • Urgency of meeting this fundamental community need	

	OR	
B.	The response may be created from the following value points: ⇒ Issue and context • Open burning of hospital/biomedical waste — used syringes, bandages and other disposed items— in public spaces • Domestic garbage burnt on roadsides, open plots, and near residential areas • Practice widespread, frequent, and largely unchecked in the city ⇒ Health Implications • Release of toxic gases in the air, soil and groundwater contamination from chemical residue and ash • Causes respiratory diseases — asthma, bronchitis, chronic lung damage • Spread of infectious diseases from unprocessed biomedical waste • Particularly harmful to children, elderly, and pregnant women ⇒ Scientific Waste Disposal Practices • Strict enforcement of biomedical waste disposal protocols in all hospitals and clinics • Colour-coded bin system for segregation — biomedical, recyclable, and organic waste • Regular and timely municipal collection of domestic waste to discourage open burning ⇒ Public Awareness • Awareness campaigns in hospitals, schools, and residential colonies about responsible waste disposal • Involvement of Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs) in local monitoring • Media campaigns highlighting health and environmental dangers of open burning ⇒ Appeal to Editor and Authorities • Request the newspaper to amplify the issue and reach a wider audience • Urge civic authorities — Municipal Corporation and Pollution Control Board — to act swiftly • Appeal to citizens to act responsibly and report violations	
5.	**Content - 2 Organisation of ideas - 2 Accuracy - 1**	**1 x 5 =5**
Analytical paragraph writing should **NOT** be confused with writing a description of given elements or writing a summary. It requires examining the given elements closely and sharing inputs based on given stimulant. It carries no title or heading.		
A.	**Suggested Response:** The student study desk organiser is an excellent purchase for students who are academically focused and like to keep things organised. Firstly, its multi-compartment storage with dedicated slots for books, stationery, and devices keeps the study space organised and clutter-free, helping one focus better on studies. Secondly, the eco-friendly bamboo wood construction shows environmental responsibility, making it a sustainable choice. Moreover, adjustable shelves allow storage space customisation for different-sized items. The compact design is perfect for small rooms. Additionally, the anti-slip base	

	prevents the organiser from sliding on smooth surfaces, ensuring safety and stability. Furthermore, the natural wood and light oak finishes look attractive and suit any room décor. Finally, the five-year durability guarantee, guarantees quality and excellent value for money, making this organiser an excellent choice and a smart investment for students.	
	OR	
B.	**Suggested Response:** Accepting the Debate Club presidency offers Vikram significant opportunities to develop leadership and public speaking skills while building a strong network of peers. The recognition gained at competitions and mentorship from experienced debaters could strengthen his university applications in future. However, these benefits are offset by some challenges. The 5–7-hour weekly commitment directly conflicts with board examination preparation, risking academic decline and burnout. Additionally, managing team conflicts and handling criticism demands substantial emotional effort. While collaborating with other clubs presents growth opportunities, it results in limited time available for personal interests and recreational activities. Consequently, Vikram should accept this position only if he can establish robust time management strategies and prioritise academic commitments. With proper planning, the benefits of leadership development and personal growth likely outweigh the challenges.	
SECTION D: LITERATURE TEXTBOOK (40 marks)		
6.	**Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two.**	**5**
A.	**Prose (The Proposal)**	
I	(a) is correct [Natalya's words demonstrate genuine surprise and curiosity, not mockery. Her sincere compliment "Though I must say you look better…" and straightforward questions show she is simply trying to understand why he's dressed formally.]	1
II	C. demonstrates his anxiety and emotional turmoil.	1
III	Any one • is nervous/ anxious about proposing to her and wants to establish his worthiness and family credentials to gain her approval • hopes to impress her by demonstrating his respect and his right intentions through formal address and family connections.	1
IV	The stage directions significantly enhance the dramatic tension in several ways: • [excited] reveals Lomov's emotional state despite his formal speech, showing the gap between his outward composure and inner agitation, creating dramatic irony. • [aside] allows readers/audience to understand Lomov's private thoughts, making his anxiety visible and relatable, while emphasising his nervousness through this interjection about it being cold.	2
	OR	
B.	**Prose (Bholi)**	

I	extremely scared and anxious/ nervous and apprehensive	1
II	C. giving readers a peek into Bholi's thoughts [The author uses the narrative technique of internal monologue. This technique allows readers to directly access Bholi's thoughts, emotions, and fears—providing a glimpse into her psychological state.]	1
III	Despite her stammer, Bholi is able to say her full name after receiving encouragement from the teacher. It shows that anxiety and the fear of being judged are the primary obstacles-which are psychological. By addressing Bholi's emotional state through compassion and reassurance, the teacher enables Bholi to overcome the problem of stammering.	2
IV	hope and hesitation	1
7.	**Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two.**	**5**
A.	**Poetry (Amanda)**	
I	Amanda's physical appearance and health OR immediate consequences of Amanda's choices	1
II	B. Amanda is defiant and the speaker feels disrespected and ignored.	1
III	request	1
IV	The repetition of 'Amanda' emphasises the speaker's frustration and creates an insistent, nagging quality. The exclamation marks convey urgency, exasperation, and emotional intensity. Together, they establish a tone of frustrated concern and create a mood of tension and conflict between the speaker and Amanda.	2
	OR	
B.	**Poetry (The Trees)**	
I	sense of immediacy/ urgency	1
II	C. unsteady and uncertain, breaking through all obstacles	1
III	fundamental or inevitable	1
IV	This sensory progression reflects the transformation process—chaos begins with sound of the glass breaking, intensifies through struggle shown by movement of trees stumbling forward, concludes in supreme beauty of flashing moonlight. Engaging multiple senses immerses readers emotionally in the experience rather than merely informing them.	2
8.	**Answer *any four* of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words.**	**4x 3=12**
Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall		
I	Fog arrives silently like a cat's quiet footfall, settles, observes, then departs without disruption. The comparison gives fog feline qualities — mysterious, aloof,	3

	and intensely observant — transforming an ordinary natural phenomenon into something unknowable. It also suggests a deeper connection between living and non-living elements of nature, leaving a lasting impression on the imagination.	
II	The comic descriptions serve dual purposes — Mijbil's tap-screwing frustration and playful mischief is humorous and entertains readers, while the absurd guesses of Londoners and the labourer's indignant reaction critique human arrogance. People's insistence on fitting Mijbil into predetermined categories like 'rat' critiques human arrogance and disconnection from the natural world.	3
III	The hailstorm is a turning point that tests Lencho's faith. It destroys his crops and creates his crisis, but it also becomes the catalyst for demonstrating both his unwavering belief and the postmaster's compassion. The natural disaster reveals character and creates opportunities for human connection and kindness.	3
IV	Today's culture often judges people by superficial traits—appearance, social media presence, or initial impressions. Custard's story remains relevant in showing that true character emerges through actions under pressure, not outward appearance or shallow traits. The poem challenges modern tendencies to form instant judgments about people's worth based on limited information.	3
V	These legends humanise tea's history beyond mere facts and dates. They add cultural richness and show how different civilizations—Chinese and Indian—value tea spiritually and medically. Including legends demonstrates that tea's significance isn't purely commercial; it holds deep cultural meaning. The legends also make the narrative more engaging and memorable for readers.	3
9.	**Answer *any two* of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words.**	**2 x 3=6**
Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall		
I	Initially, Hari manipulates Anil through calculated charm and deception. His final smile is genuine and spontaneous, requiring no effort. This contrast demonstrates authentic change—Hari moves from viewing relationships as opportunities for exploitation to valuing genuine human connection. The effortless smile suggests his change has been internalised, and is not merely a behavioural compliance.	3
II	The story weaves multiple ironies—Matilda sacrifices everything to replace a worthless necklace; ten years of poverty transform her into the very 'common woman' she despised; her pride becomes her downfall. The ultimate irony reveals that her suffering was entirely needless. The writer uses irony to critique materialism and expose how vanity leads to self-inflicted tragedy.	3
III	Removing his gloves tells us that Horace has abandoned his careful criminal protocol due to emotional manipulation. He's so eager to please the lady and be released that he forgets basic safety procedures. This action reveals his desperation, vulnerability, and how the young lady exploited his fear of prison. His loss of caution suggests he's emotionally compromised—no longer thinking like a criminal but like a desperate man seeking escape.	3

10.	**Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words.**	**6**
	Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1	
A.	• Both Valli in ‘Madam Rides the Bus’ and the young seagull in ‘His First Flight’ are protagonists who undergo significant personal transformation. • However, they undergo transformation through contrasting catalysts. The seagull's change is driven by acute biological necessity—prolonged hunger and family isolation force instinctive action, overriding fear. His catalyst is external and involuntary: starvation compels the desperate dive, revealing dormant flying ability. • Unlike the seagull's straightforward hunger, Valli's motivation includes curiosity and yearning for experience. She has observed the bus with fascination, longing for the independence and an opportunity to discover it represents. This internal yearning—for dignity, independence, and experience beyond prescribed domestic limits—acts as a catalyst in her transformation. • However, both catalysts function identically: forcing protagonists towards liberating suppressed potential, and demonstrating that transformation requires catalysts powerful enough to overcome fear and unwillingness, whether biological desperation or independence.	6
	OR	
B.	• Both poems show that important learning can happen instantly, not slowly over time. When the ball falls into the water, the boy understands loss's permanence quickly. When snow falls on the speaker, the mood shift happens immediately. In both poems, one powerful moment seems to teach everything at once. • Berryman suggests the boy will remember this moment's lesson forever. One lost ball teaches him about loss, and responsibility—lessons that shape the rest of his life. Frost's speaker also shows lasting change: the dust of snow doesn't just make them feel better for a few minutes; it transforms how they see their day. The moment is quick, but its effect lasts. • The boy in ‘The Ball Poem’ doesn't think through loss step-by-step; he feels it deeply in one moment. The speaker in ‘Dust of Snow’ doesn't reason about beauty; they experience it directly.	6
11.	**Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words.**	**6**
	Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1	
A.	• The balcony symbolises the power of narrative to create reality. It exists only in language—in Ausable's detailed description and Max's belief—yet it becomes more ‘real’ than the room itself because characters act upon it. Ausable constructs the balcony's existence through plausible details: explaining the building's history, describing access routes, mentioning previous intrusions. • The non-existent balcony reveals the story's focus on truth versus perception. Max accepts the balcony's existence because Ausable's account aligns with what Max expects to find in a hotel in Paris. • Ultimately, the balcony represents the triumph of storytelling over material facts. Ausable understands that controlling the narrative gives absolute power: the fictional balcony becomes more consequential than any physical barrier.	6
	OR	

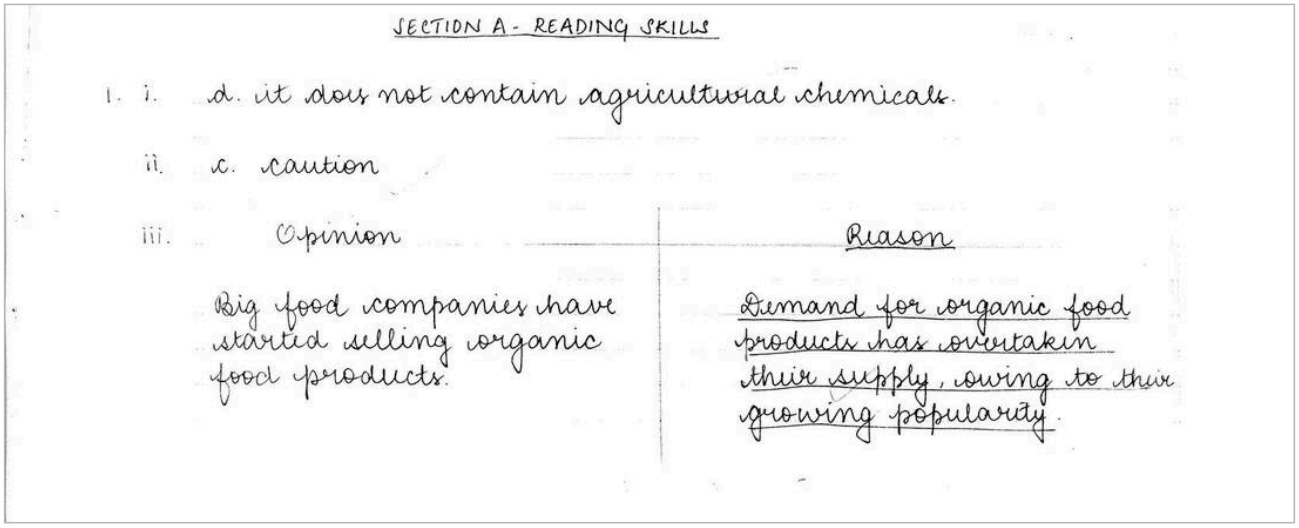
B.	• Think-Tank represents the danger of absolute power combined with absolute ignorance. Think-Tank's refusal to admit errors transforms his foolishness into catastrophe. Throughout the play, he mistakes books for sandwiches, then hats, then weapons—yet insists each misinterpretation proves his genius. When corrected, he claims he knew it and is never wrong. This pattern reveals that his intelligence becomes useless without humility. • His absolute authority amplifies this flaw dangerously. As no one challenges him, Think-Tank never receives honest feedback. His space crew's fearful obedience prevents reality-check. Consequently, his errors escalate: nursery rhymes become military threats, and paranoia replaces reasoning. • By the climax, these combined flaws—arrogance plus refusal to acknowledge mistakes—drive catastrophic decisions. Seeing Humpty Dumpty's image, he panics completely, ordering Mars's evacuation. Think-Tank's character demonstrates that unchecked power combined with arrogance and foolishness creates destructive leadership. His massive brain becomes a liability rather than an asset.	6

Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book, Board Exam 2023 (same pattern)
Model answers for this paper's pattern, arranged in question order (Q1 to Q11).

Q1 (i)-(viii) Reading
(2023 board paper)

Answer book page 12 · Q1 (i)-(iii) (lower part of page; Section A begins)



SECTION A - READING SKILLS

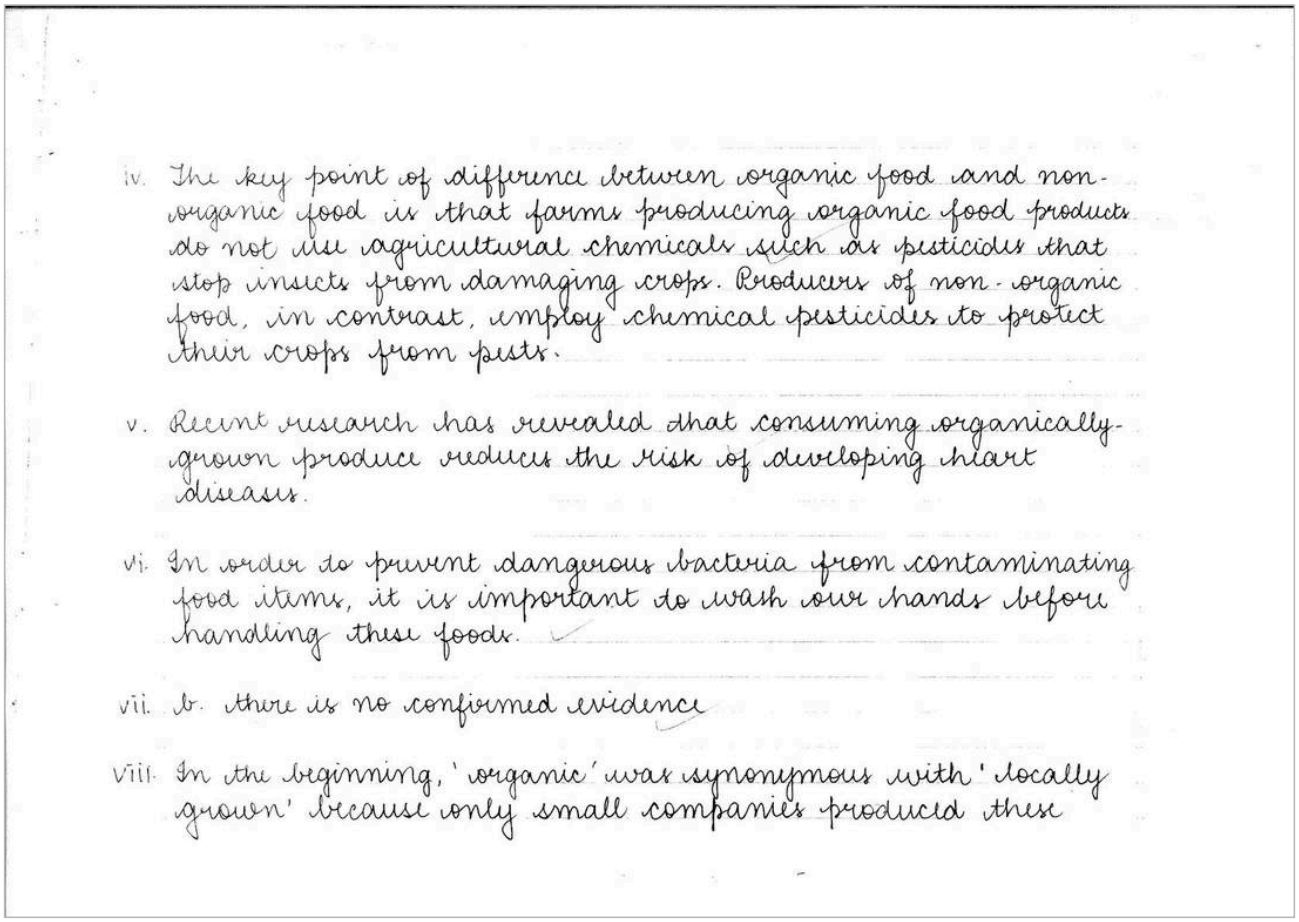
1. i. d. it does not contain agricultural chemicals.

ii. c. caution

iii.

Opinion	Reason
Big food companies have started selling organic food products.	Demand for organic food products has overtaken their supply, owing to their growing popularity.

Answer book page 13 · Q1 (iv)-(viii)



iv. The key point of difference between organic food and non-organic food is that farms producing organic food products do not use agricultural chemicals such as pesticides that stop insects from damaging crops. Producers of non-organic food, in contrast, employ chemical pesticides to protect their crops from pests.

v. Recent research has revealed that consuming organically-grown produce reduces the risk of developing heart diseases.

vi. In order to prevent dangerous bacteria from contaminating food items, it is important to wash our hands before handling these foods.

vii. b. there is no confirmed evidence

viii. In the beginning, 'organic' was synonymous with 'locally grown' because only small companies produced these

Answer book page 14 · Q1 (viii) contd-(x), Q2 (i)-(ii)

products at first.

ix. As harmful bacteria can contaminate both organic and non-organic fruits and vegetables, doctors recommend washing produce carefully before eating it. Meat, fish and chicken too can become contaminated and it is therefore essential to wash our hands thoroughly before handling these foods.

x. In several countries, foods that claim to be organic (free from chemical pesticides) must have special labels that guarantee they are grown organically.

2. i. A vast blanket of pollution stretching across south Asia is cutting down sunlight by ten percent over India, leading to altered rainfall patterns.

ii. a. I, II and III (damaging agriculture, putting people at risk, modifying rainfall pattern).

Answer book page 15 · Q2 (iii)-(x)

iii. possibility : potential :: suspecting : doubting

iv. c. There has not been enough time to determine that

v. Depletion of forest cover contributes to weather disruption while organic farming does not.

vi. a. worsen

vii. The haze has cut down sunlight over India ... As ~~was~~ a consequence / an impact, the ~~N~~orth-West of India is drying up.

viii. Two countries which are affected due to depleting forest cover are India and China.

ix. c. continue

x. a. 1. Impact of Pollution in South Asia

Answer book page 16 · Q2 (x) contd, Q3 (ii), (iv), (v)

2. Effects of Acid Rain

3. Understanding the Consequences of Haze

4. Debate over Droughts

SECTION B - GRAMMAR AND CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS

3. ii. The clerk at the ticket counter enquired where the passenger wanted to go. The passenger requested the clerk to give him a ticket to Bhopal.

iv. b.

Error	Correction
at	on

v. When I was a very young girl, b. going grocery shopping was considered a major outing for me.

Answer book page 17 · Q3 (vi)-(xii)

vi. The package a. will arrive at nine in the morning, the day after tomorrow.

vii. Tony asked Sarita why she had called him. Sarita wanted to know whether Tony would go to the museum with her.

viii.

Error	Correction
should	can

ix. Gopal asked Roma which way the metro station was.

x. Drivers a. must wear helmets for their safety.

xi. Economics a. is difficult for the students of grade nine.

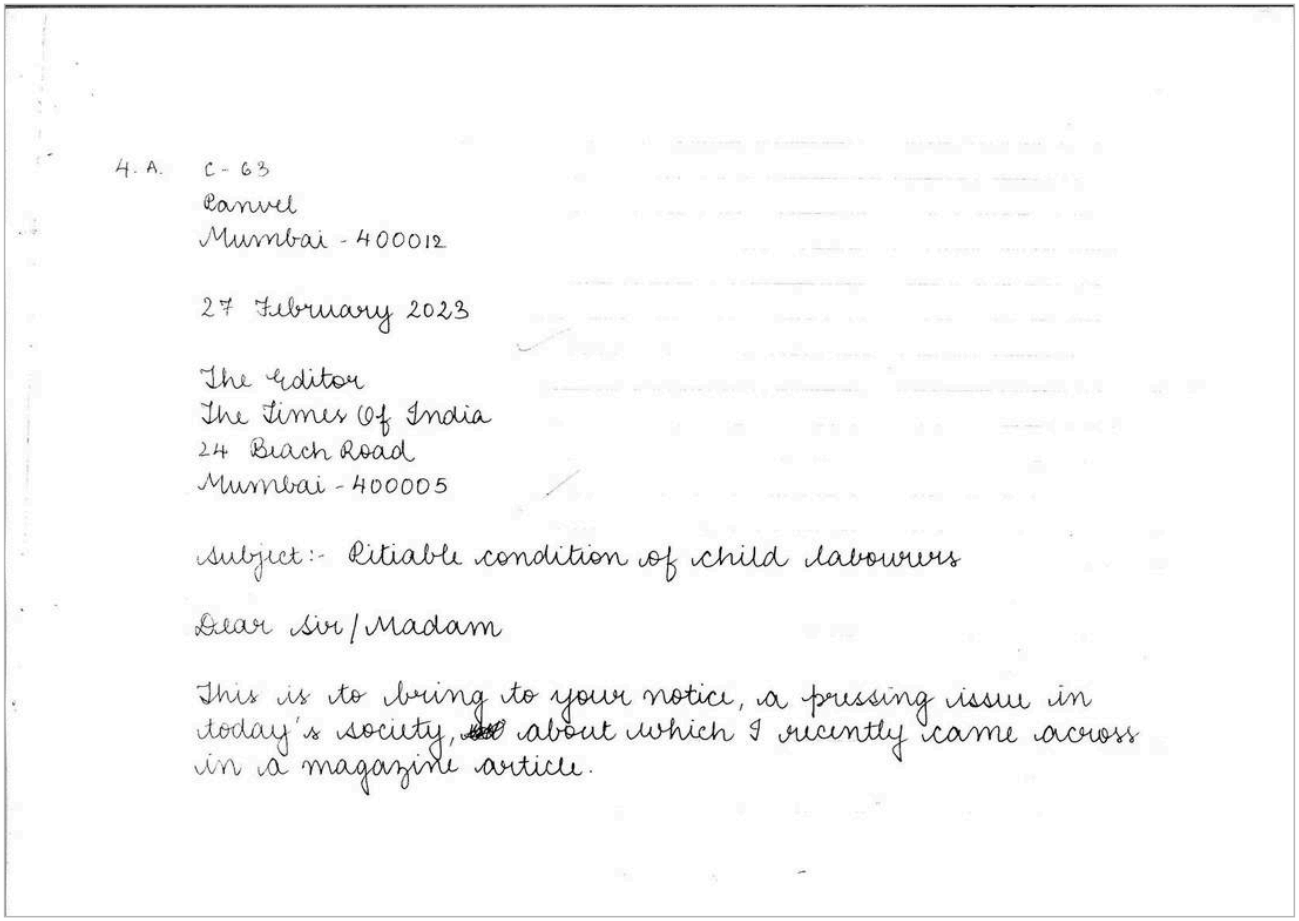
xii. c. The father said that he had bought a watch.

Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book, Board Exam 2023 (same pattern)
Model answers for this paper's pattern, arranged in question order (Q1 to Q11).

Q4 (a) Letter
(2023 board paper)

Answer book page 18 · Q4 (a) formal letter



A. A. C-63
Panvel
Mumbai - 400012

27 February 2023

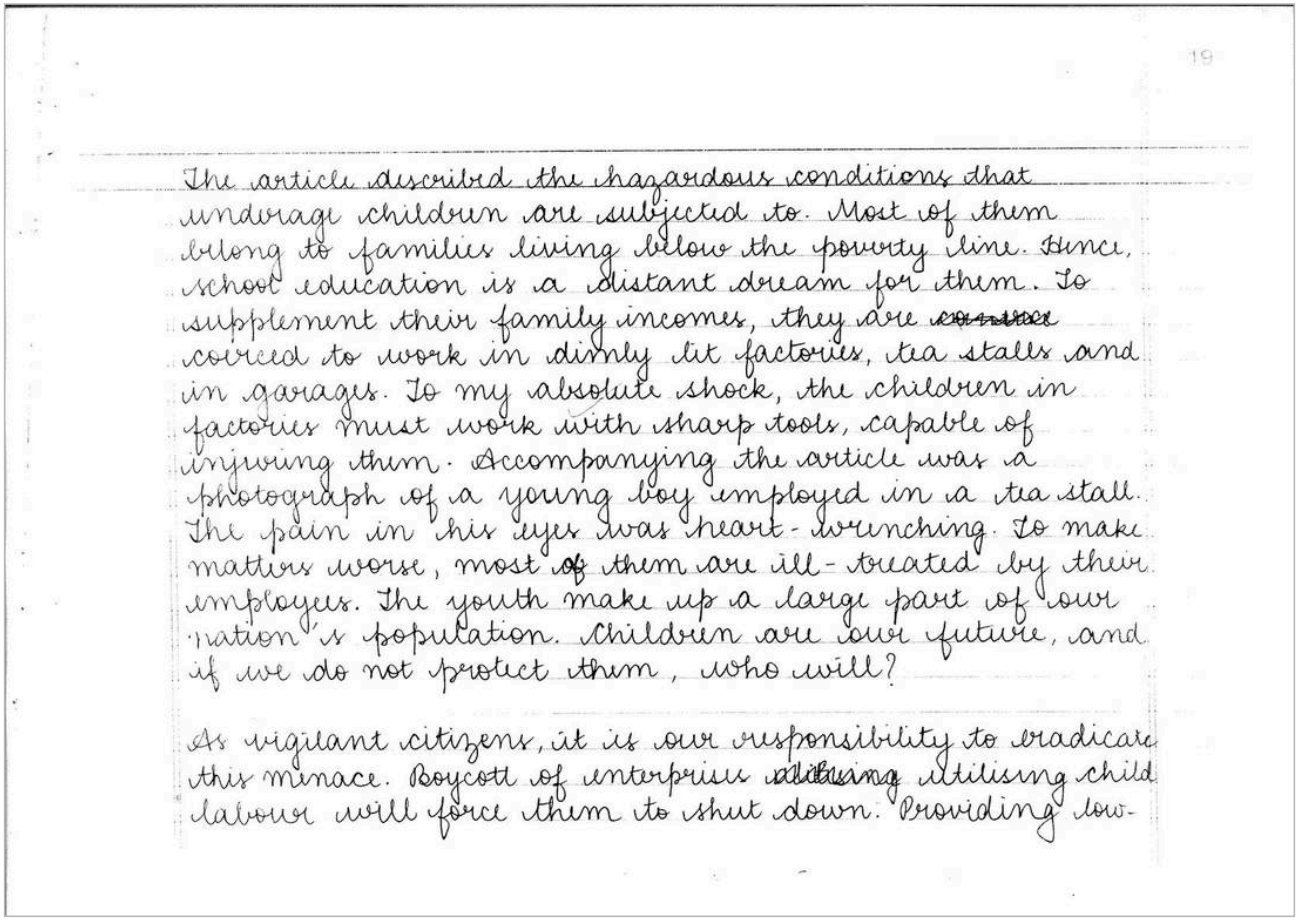
The Editor
The Times Of India
24 Beach Road
Mumbai - 400005

Subject :- Pitiable condition of child labourers

Dear Sir / Madam

This is to bring to your notice, a pressing issue in today's society, about which I recently came across in a magazine article.

Answer book page 19 · Q4 (a) contd



19

The article described the hazardous conditions that underage children are subjected to. Most of them belong to families living below the poverty line. Since, school education is a distant dream for them. To supplement their family incomes, they are ~~coerced~~ coerced to work in dimly lit factories, tea stalls and in garages. To my absolute shock, the children in factories must work with sharp tools, capable of injuring them. Accompanying the article was a photograph of a young boy employed in a tea stall. The pain in his eyes was heart-wrenching. To make matters worse, most of them are ill-treated by their employers. The youth make up a large part of our nation's population. Children are our future, and if we do not protect them, who will?

As vigilant citizens, it is our responsibility to eradicate this menace. Boycott of enterprises ~~utilising~~ utilising child labour will force them to shut down. Providing low-

Answer book page 20 · Q4 (a) concluded, Q5 analytical paragraph

cost education to these children will go a long way. Government agencies must take a more pro-active approach through surprise checks and hefty penalties. I hope that this national problem is brought to the notice of the authorities concerned through the columns of your esteemed newspaper and the necessary measures are taken.

Yours truly
~~Jyoti~~
(Anjali)

5 A

The Issue Of Air Pollution

The given table provides the pollution figures of some major Indian towns and cities. The data includes three major air pollutants namely, suspended particulate matter, sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides, their

Answer book page 21 · Q5 contd

permissible levels and their levels in Ludhiana, Delhi, Mumbai and Chennai. The levels of suspended particulate matter in all four cities (453 in Ludhiana, 680 in Delhi, 485 in Mumbai and 262 in Chennai) far exceed the permissible level of 200. The abnormal levels of particulate matter may be attributed to the smoke and dust released by vehicles in these well-developed cities, apart from burning of agricultural produce in Delhi and Ludhiana. The permissible levels of both sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide are 80. The high proportions of sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide in Delhi (124 and 134 respectively) are alarming. However, in the other cities, these are fortunately well within the limit. The sulphur dioxide levels are lowest in Ludhiana at 20, followed by Mumbai at 27 and then Chennai at 45. The levels of nitrogen oxide follow the opposite trend with Chennai at 34 and then Mumbai at 53 and Ludhiana at 64. It is evident that air pollution is a major issue affecting big towns and cities in

Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book, Board Exam 2023 (same pattern)
Model answers for this paper's pattern, arranged in question order (Q1 to Q11).

Q5 · Q6 (b) · Q7 (a) Extracts
(2023 board paper)

Answer book page 22 · Q5 concluded

India. Unless we take steps to mitigate it, the quality of human life will only deteriorate in future. Let us work towards a cleaner and greener environment

Answer book page 3 · Q6 (b) extract, Q7 (a) (i)-(ii)

SECTION C - LITERATURE

6. B. i. c. he didn't like him.

ii. Griffin deliberately removed his clothes because he wanted to become invisible.

iii. d. The Amar Place was completely destroyed by the fire.

iv. c. he left muddy footprints.

v. b. Griffin promised to behave himself.

7. A. i. d. Bengal Tiger

ii. It is clear that 'Alliteration' is the poetic device used for 'roaming round' because the same consonant sound - 'r' sound has been used at the start of two consecutive or closely-placed words.

Answer book page 4 · Q7 (a) (iii)-(v), Q8 (a), (b)

iii. The given statement is true.

iv. a. irony

v. b. discern

8. a. Coorgi homes have a tradition of hospitality. While sipping a cup of steaming hot, aromatic coffee, one will be regaled by the tales of valour narrated by the Kodavus about their sons, brothers and fathers. Unsurprisingly, the first Chief of the Indian Army, General Cariappa was a Coorgi. To this day, the courageous Kodavus are the only people in India, permitted to carry fire-arms without a licence.

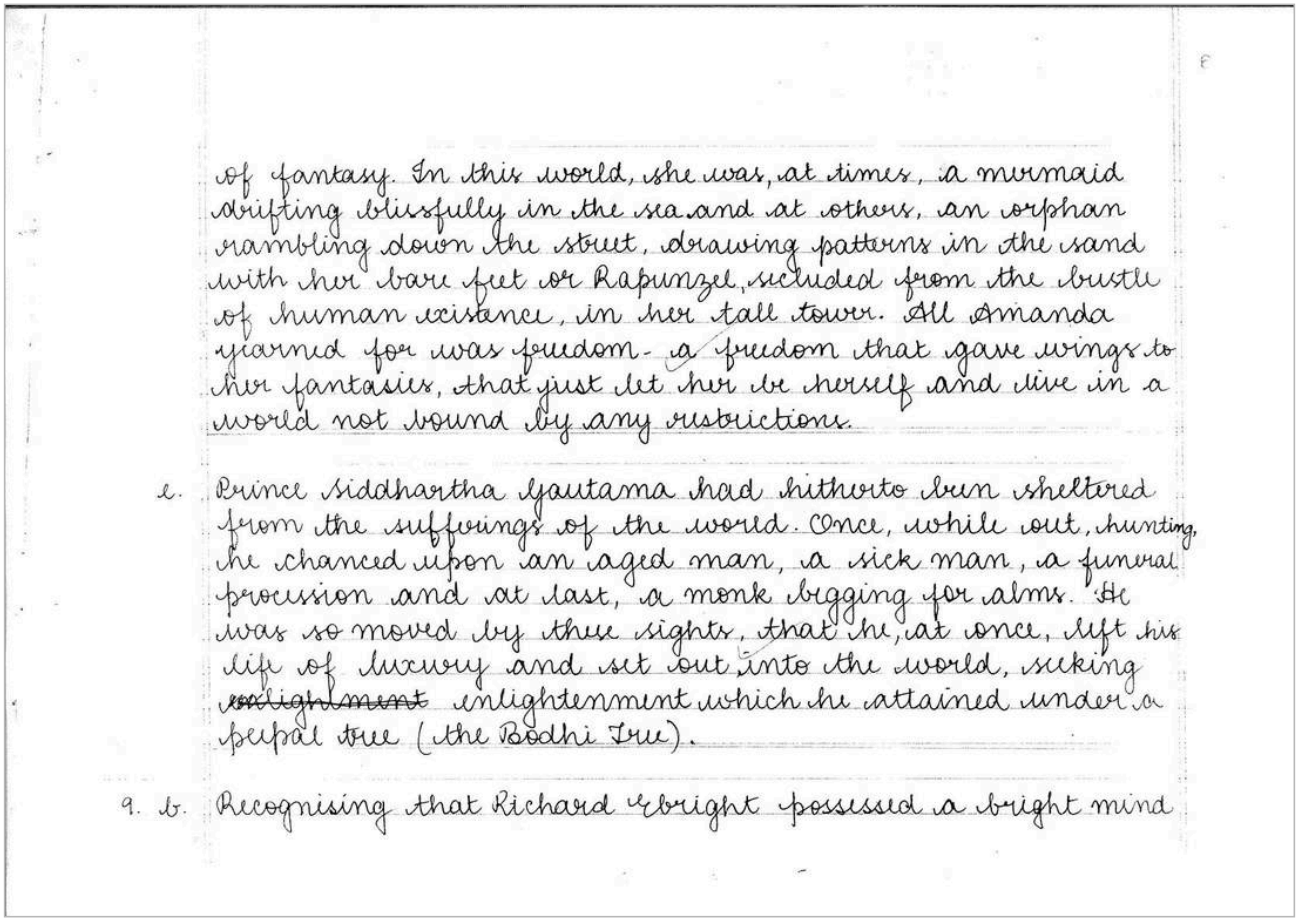
b. Lincho was an ox of a man who worked like an animal on his field and was thus dependent on a good harvest for his living. Hence, when the hailstorm destroyed Lincho's crop, he was devastated. But, Lincho's faith was

Answer book page 5 · Q8 (b) contd, (d)

bigger than his fears as he had always been taught to believe that there was a single ray of hope - help from God. So unshakeable was Lincho's faith in the Almighty that it drove him to write a letter beseeching the Lord for a hundred pesos to sow his field again and live until the crop came. He was driven only by the faith that his devotion would not go unrewarded. In the end, it was Lincho's unalloyed devotion that impressed the postmaster who then decided to help the poor man, by urging his friends and employees to contribute their mite and also giving a part of his own salary, thus managing to collect seventy pesos to assist Lincho.

d. Amanda was a young girl who was constantly nagged by her mother, in a bid to fit Amanda into the mold dictated by society. In the process, Amanda felt that her individuality was curtailed. That Amanda felt restricted by the numerous instructions clamped down on her by her mother is evident from how Amanda escaped into a world

Answer book page 6 · Q8 (d) contd, (e), Q9 (b)

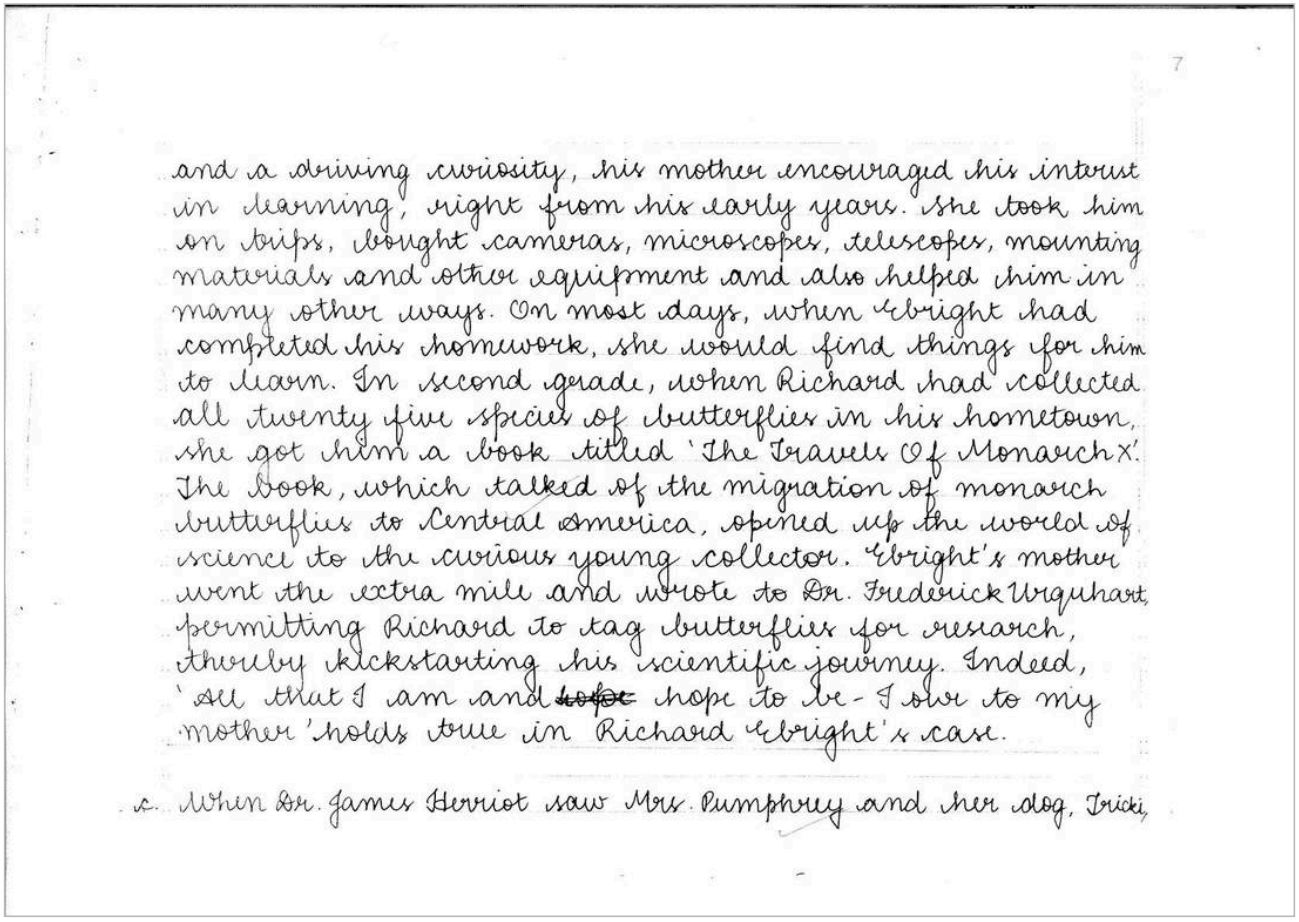


of fantasy. In this world, she was, at times, a mermaid drifting blissfully in the sea and at others, an orphan rambling down the street, drawing patterns in the sand with her bare feet or Rapunzel, secluded from the bustle of human existance, in her tall tower. All Amanda yearned for was freedom - a freedom that gave wings to her fantasies, that just let her be herself and live in a world not bound by any restrictions.

e. Prince Siddhartha Gautama had hitherto been sheltered from the sufferings of the world. Once, while out, hunting, he chanced upon an aged man, a sick man, a funeral procession and at last, a monk begging for alms. He was so moved by these sights, that he, at once, left his life of luxury and set out into the world, seeking ~~enlightenment~~ enlightenment which he attained under a peepal tree (the Bodhi Tree).

9. b. Recognising that Richard Ebright possessed a bright mind

Answer book page 7 · Q9 (b) contd, (c)



and a driving curiosity, his mother encouraged his interest in learning, right from his early years. She took him on trips, bought cameras, microscopes, telescopes, mounting materials and other equipment and also helped him in many other ways. On most days, when Ebright had completed his homework, she would find things for him to learn. In second grade, when Richard had collected all twenty five species of butterflies in his hometown, she got him a book titled 'The Travels Of Monarch X'. The book, which talked of the migration of monarch butterflies to Central America, opened up the world of science to the curious young collector. Ebright's mother went the extra mile and wrote to Dr. Frederick Urquhart, permitting Richard to tag butterflies for research, thereby kickstarting his scientific journey. Indeed, 'All that I am and ~~hope~~ hope to be - I owe to my mother' holds true in Richard Ebright's case.

c. When Dr. James Herriot saw Mrs. Pumphrey and her dog, Tricki,

Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book, Board Exam 2023 (same pattern)
Model answers for this paper's pattern, arranged in question order (Q1 to Q11).

Q9 (c) · Q10 (a) Long answer
(2023 board paper)

Answer book page 8 · Q9 (c) contd, Q10 (a)

in the street, he pulled up his car as he was astonished at Tricki's appearance. Tricki had become fat, like a bloated sausage, with a leg at each corner. His eyes, bloodshot and rheumy stared straight ahead, while his tongue lolled from his jaws, highlighting the dog's listlessness, owing to his being fed with extras between meals (malt, cod liver oil and a bowl of Horlicks), apart from cream cakes and chocolates by his overindulgent mistress (who attributed his lack of energy to malnutrition rather than to Tricki being overweight).

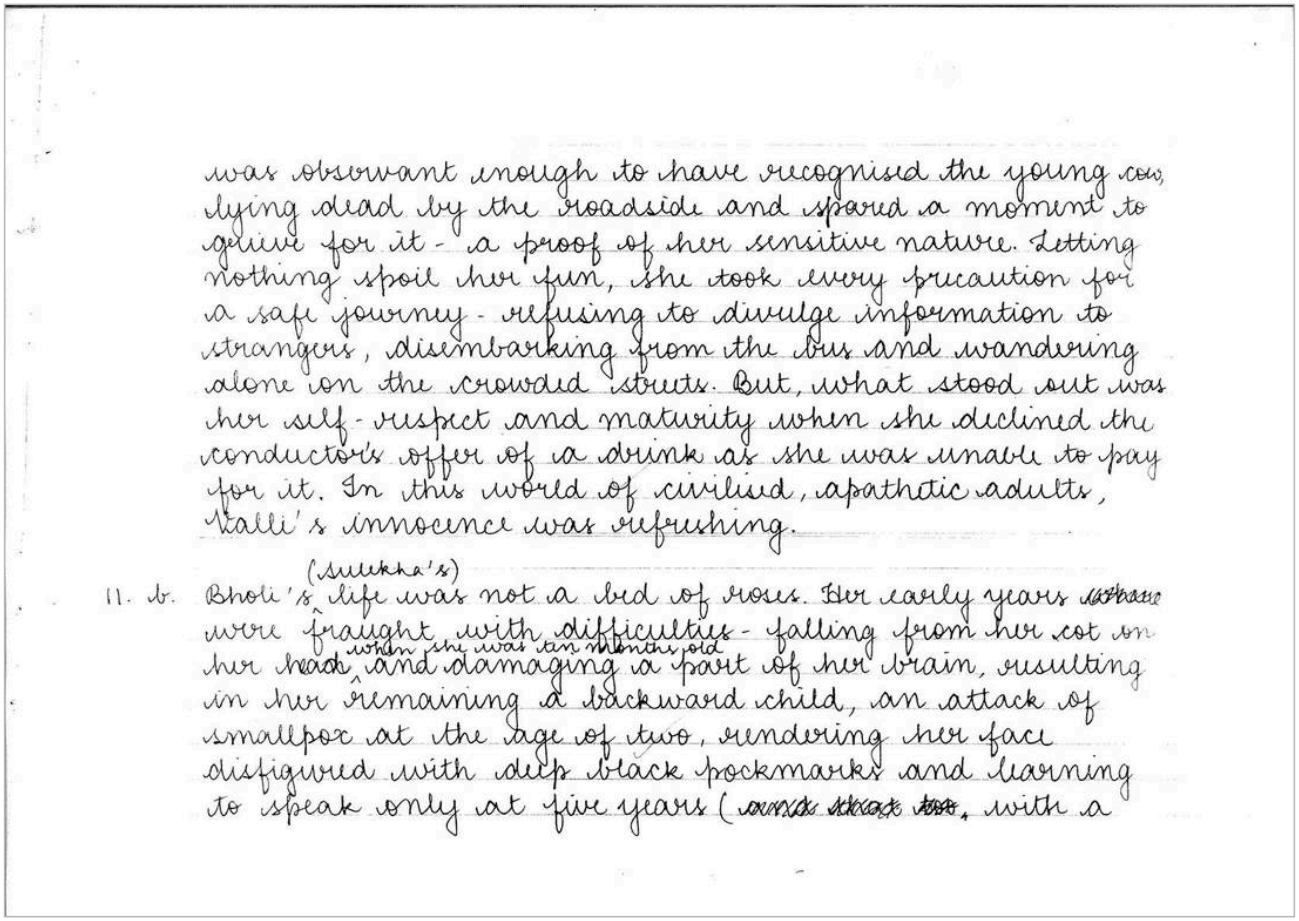
10. a. Valli, an eight-year old girl, drew pleasure from the simplest of things. The most fascinating thing of all, to her, was the bus that plied between her village and the nearby town. So enthralled was she by it that she decided to ride on the bus. But, this was not bravado of the foolhardy kind for her decision was accompanied by meticulous planning.

Answer book page 9 · Q10 (a) contd

Over a period of several days and months, Valli listened carefully to the conversations between her neighbours and those who travelled by the bus and herself asked discreet questions here and there. In this manner, she picked up numerous small details about the journey - the distance (six miles), the duration (forty five minutes), the fare (thirty paise one way) and the bus schedule. That she saw her plans executed to perfection was apparent from the way she thriftily saved whatever stray coins came her way, resisting every temptation to purchase toys, peppermints, balloons and a ride on the merry-go-round at the village fair and finally slipping out of the house without her mother's knowledge (while her mother took her afternoon nap).

Her pride at being able to afford the fare was evident from how she repeatedly stressed on her having bought a ticket on her own. Her childlike fascination for the scenery, the shops and the crowds was contagious. She

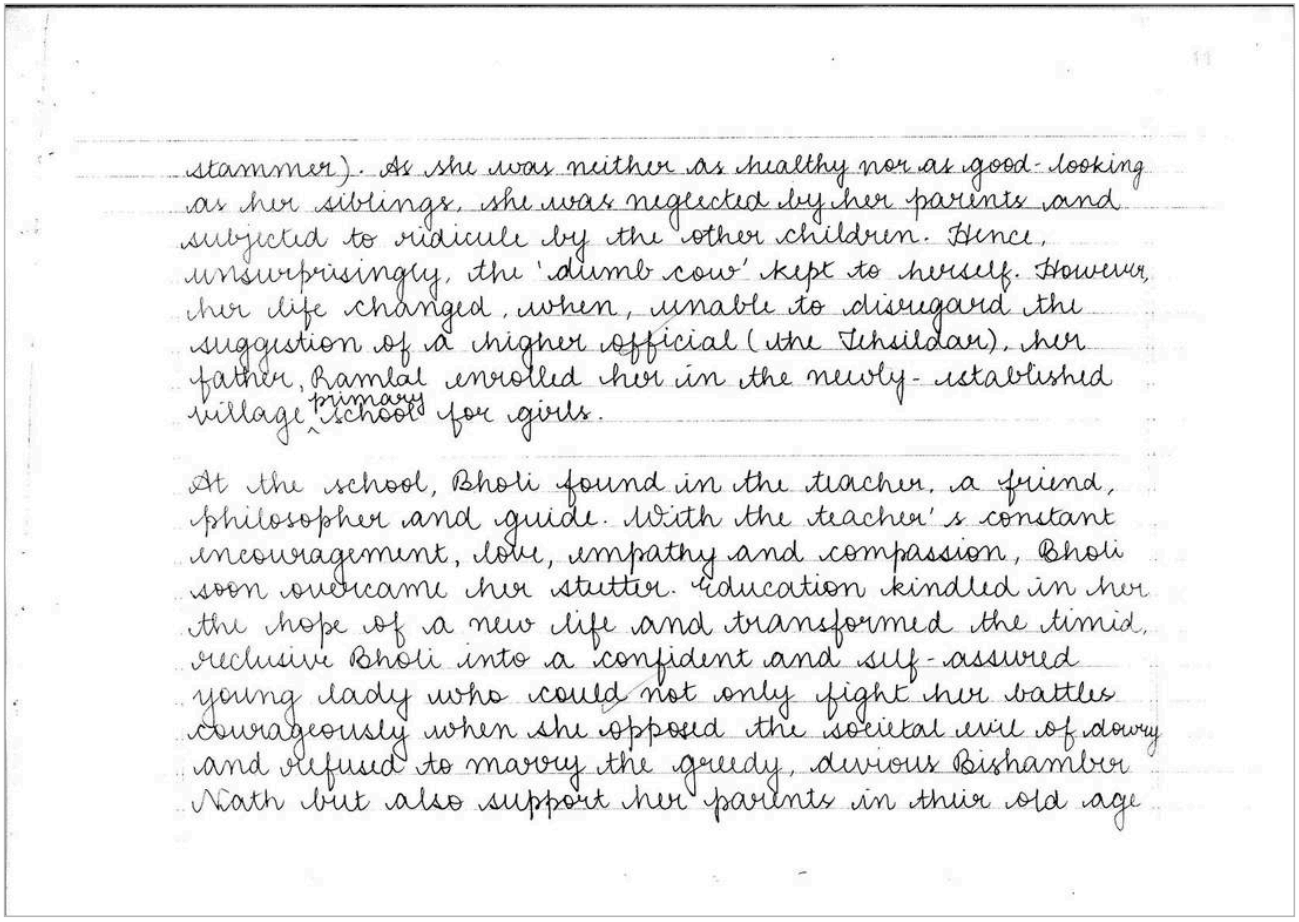
Answer book page 10 · Q10 (a) concluded, Q11 (b)



was observant enough to have recognised the young cow lying dead by the roadside and spared a moment to grieve for it - a proof of her sensitive nature. Letting nothing spoil her fun, she took every precaution for a safe journey - refusing to divulge information to strangers, disembarking from the bus and wandering alone on the crowded streets. But, what stood out was her self-respect and maturity when she declined the conductor's offer of a drink as she was unable to pay for it. In this world of civilised, apathetic adults, Kalli's innocence was refreshing.

11. b. Bholi's (Sukkha's) life was not a bed of roses. Her early years were fraught with difficulties - falling from her cot on her head when she was ten months old and damaging a part of her brain, resulting in her remaining a backward child, an attack of smallpox at the age of two, rendering her face disfigured with deep black pockmarks and learning to speak only at five years (~~and stuck too~~, with a

Answer book page 11 · Q11 (b) contd



stammer). As she was neither as healthy nor as good-looking as her siblings, she was neglected by her parents and subjected to ridicule by the other children. Hence, unsurprisingly, the 'dumb cow' kept to herself. However, her life changed, when, unable to disregard the suggestion of a higher official (the Tehsildar), her father, Ramlal enrolled her in the newly-established village primary school for girls.

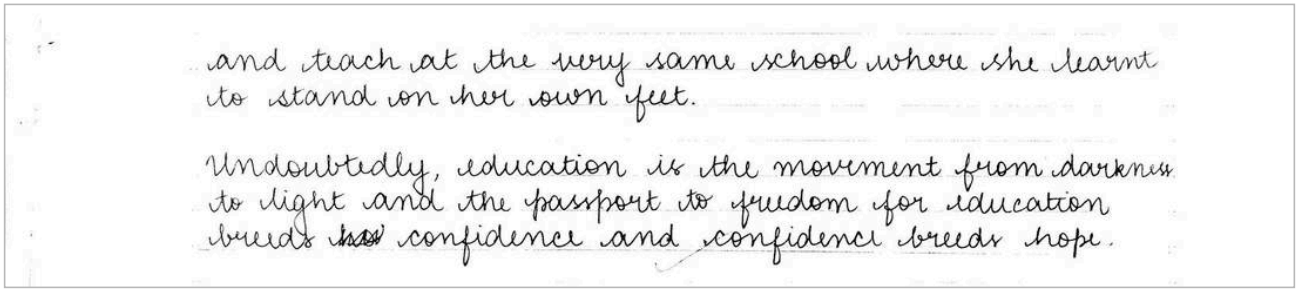
At the school, Bholi found in the teacher, a friend, philosopher and guide. With the teacher's constant encouragement, love, empathy and compassion, Bholi soon overcame her stutter. Education kindled in her the hope of a new life and transformed the timid, reclusive Bholi into a confident and self-assured young lady who could not only fight her battles courageously when she opposed the societal evil of dowry and refused to marry the greedy, devious Bishambar Nath but also support her parents in their old age

Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book, Board Exam 2023 (same pattern)
Model answers for this paper's pattern, arranged in question order (Q1 to Q11).

Q11 (b) concluded
(2023 board paper)

Answer book page 12 · Q11 (b) concluding lines (top of page)


and teach at the very same school where she learnt to stand on her own feet.

Undoubtedly, education is the movement from darkness to light and the passport to freedom for education breeds ~~has~~ confidence and confidence breeds hope.

What to learn from this topper's answer book

1. **Number every answer exactly.** Each answer starts with its question number and part (4.a, 8.b, 2.ii, viii), so the examiner finds it at once, even though this topper wrote Section C before Section A.

2. **Use the complete letter format.** In Q4 the sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject line and salutation are each on a separate line before the body begins. Format alone carries 1 mark.

3. **Answer the exact question asked.** Reading answers are short and to the point: the option letter with its full text, the exact word for a vocabulary item, and one complete sentence where a line is asked for.

4. **Underline the key words.** Key answers such as *potential*, *consequence / impact* and *India and China* are underlined, which makes the marking points stand out.

5. **Back literature answers with details from the text.** The Q8 answers name the Kodavus, General Cariappa and the postmaster, and explain how Lencho's faith shaped his actions instead of retelling the whole story.

6. **Close long answers with a strong conclusion.** The Q11 answer ends on a clear final thought (education as the passport to freedom), giving the answer a proper end and leaving the examiner with its main idea.

Checklist before you submit

- ☐ Every question and part is numbered exactly as in the paper.
- ☐ Letter: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, closing and name.
- ☐ Analytical paragraph: introduction, data described in order, a clear conclusion.
- ☐ Long answers stay within the word limit and end with a conclusion.
- ☐ Key words are underlined and the work is neat, with no overwriting.
- ☐ Five minutes kept at the end to re-read every answer.

Series : MNL2K **SET~1**

Q.P. Code 2/2/1

Roll No. | | | | | | | | |

Candidates must write the Q.P. Code on the title page of the answer-book.

ENGLISH
(Language and Literature)

*Time allowed : **3** hours* *Maximum Marks : **80***

	NOTE :
(I)	Please check that this question paper contains **19** printed pages.
(II)	Q.P. Code given on the right hand side of the question paper should be written on the title page of the answer-book by the candidate.
(III)	Please check that this question paper contains **11** questions.
(IV)	**Please write down the Serial Number of the question in the answer-book at the given place before attempting it.**
(V)	15 minute time has been allotted to read this question paper. The question paper will be distributed at 10.15 a.m. From 10.15 a.m. to 10.30 a.m., the candidates will read the question paper only and will not write any answer on the answer-book during this period.

General Instructions :

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them :

(i) *This question paper comprises **11** questions. All questions are compulsory.*

(ii) *The question paper contains **three** sections :*
***Section A** – Reading Skills*
***Section B** – Grammar and Creative Writing Skills*
***Section C** – Literature*

(iii) *Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.*

SECTION A
Reading Skills

20 marks

1. Read the following passage carefully : *10*

(1) In the fast-evolving landscape of the present age, digital saturation and algorithmically curated lives, the phenomenon of FOMO — the Fear of Missing Out — has progressed from a fleeting psychological discomfort into a pervasive cultural condition. Initially, the term was coined to describe the anxiety provoked by the perception that others are participating in rewarding experiences from which one is absent. FOMO now pervades virtually in every dimension of contemporary existence, fuelled largely by the continuous updates of edited content on social media platforms. Significantly, it is the anxiety that others are experiencing something more fulfilling, exciting, or meaningful.

(2) The roots of FOMO lie in the interplay between the evolutionary instincts of an individual and modern technology. It may be traced as a fundamental human trait — the innate desire to belong. Man — being a social creature naturally, always tries to seek inclusion and belonging as a means of survival. Albeit, nowadays social media has escalated this instinct by bothering individuals with real-time updates of others' lives — carefully edited vacations, career milestones or even temporal joys framed as extraordinary. Each notification becomes a reminder of what we are not doing, a mirror reflecting our perceived inadequacies.

(3) FOMO is not solely a personal affliction; it is a cultural artifact also, shaped by the values of a society that equates busyness with worth and novelty with happiness. Moreover, consumerism fuels this fire with brands exploiting FOMO through limited time offers, exclusive events, and influencer-driven trends that promise belonging or status. The rise of the 'experience economy', where memories and moments are commodified, intensifies the pressure to participate in everything from music festivals to viral food craze.

(4) Furthermore, FOMO has created profound shifts in behaviour also. Due to this, the decision-making process has become increasingly worrisome, with people hesitating to commit to plans for fear of a better alternative emerging later. It often leads to impulsive choices, such as overspending on unnecessary products, overcommitting to events or making hasty life decisions to avoid feeling excluded. People, due to FOMO, struggle to focus on their priorities because they are distracted by what others are doing. Even highlighted reels of professional journeys shared online by others breed discontent and cause anxiety and dissatisfaction, where no experience feels complete.

(5) The gloomy side of FOMO manifests in lowered self-esteem, impaired concentration and in severe cases, depression. Ironically, the more one tries to engage with multiple activities to 'keep up', the greater it leads to emotional exhaustion. The illusion of missing out on something 'better' elsewhere robs individuals of their ability to engage themselves fully in their present experiences.

(6) To overcome the Fear of Missing Out we require intentional strategies. To avoid constant comparison, specific timings for checking the apps and social media should be set. One can also engage oneself in mindful breathing or meditation to stay grounded to the present. By prioritizing self-awareness and authentic experiences, one can take the edge off FOMO's grip and cultivate a richer, more satisfying life without chasing external validation. Finally, we need to recognize that carefully selected online portrayals, which are essentially selective, generate emotional resilience.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

(i) What is the primary psychological trigger behind FOMO in the context of social media usage ? *1*

Paragraph (1)

(A) physical fatigue

(B) fear of rejection from loved ones

(C) need of privacy to keep oneself safe

(D) fear of being left out of rewarding experiences

(ii) Complete the following with the correct option from the two given below : *1*

FOMO has entered every dimension of a person's existence because _____.

(A) more exciting events are taking place nowadays

(B) of constant edits and updates on the social media platforms

Paragraph (1)

(iii) What is the impact of the 'experience economy' on individuals ? *1*

Paragraph (3)

(iv) How does FOMO affect an individual's decision-making ability ? *2*

Paragraph (4)

(v) Support the writer's viewpoint that FOMO leads to emotional consequences. Paragraph (4) *1*

(vi) List two effective ways to deal with Fear of Missing Out (FOMO). *2*

Paragraph (6)

(vii) State whether the following statement is True or False : *1*

People need to make an effort to come out of their FOMO state of mind. Paragraph (6)

(viii) Complete the following with the correct option from the ones given below. *1*

In the phrase 'generate emotional resilience', the word 'resilience' refers to the ability to Paragraph (6)

(A) support and create more social content.

(B) withstand emotional anxiety of FOMO.

(C) accelerate the notifications on social media.

(D) give in to digital social pressure.

2. Read the following passage carefully : *10*

(1) The craze for cosmetics has escalated globally, driven by evolving beauty standards and social media influence. The cosmetics industry thrives on innovation, offering various products catering to various skin types and preferences. In India, the cosmetics industry has witnessed a remarkable growth over the past decade, driven by rising 'disposable incomes', increased urbanization, and changing lifestyles. In contemporary times, people are more aware about their personal grooming.

(2) In the year 2024, the Indian cosmetics market generated revenue of approximately ₹ 1,34,000 crore and is projected to reach around ₹ 2,40,000 crore by 2028. This robust performance is driven as a result of strong e-commerce and growing demand for organic and premium product offerings due to increasing awareness of personal grooming, skin care routines among consumers, especially teenagers and young adults, who are the dominant demographic in cosmetics purchase, as they seek trendy and innovative solutions.

(3) The cosmetics industry is broadly divided into various segments such as skin care, hair care, colour cosmetics, fragrances, and personal hygiene products. Skincare leads the segments, accounting for nearly 35% of the market, followed by hair care at 25%. Colour cosmetics — including make-up products have seen significant growth, especially post-pandemic, due to the rise of e-commerce and social media. E-commerce platforms have played a crucial role in expanding access to cosmetics especially in Tier II and Tier III cities. In fact, online sales contribute to around 25% of total cosmetics sales in India.

(4) Over and above that, men's grooming has emerged as a significant segment, valued at around ₹ 25,000 crore in the year 2024 with increasing demand for beard care, skin care and fragrances customized to men. This growth is fuelled by social media influencers, coupled with the increase of gender-neutral cosmetic formulations. This shows an aspirational pursuit of personal refinement, where appearance augments confidence, dismantling archaic stereotypes associated with male cosmetics consumption.

(5) Though the cosmetics industry plays a vital role in the Indian economy, it faces several challenges including managing intense competition, complying with regulations, ensuring product quality, and addressing ethical sourcing concerns. In addition, the industry struggles with copied products, adapting to changing consumer preferences and navigating the complexities of the supply chain.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

(i) Complete the sentence with a reason :

The global demand for beauty products has intensified because of _____. *1*

Paragraph (1)

(ii) What does the phrase 'thrives on innovation' tell us about the cosmetic industry ? *1*

(A) The industry is slow-growing.

(B) The industry is growing and evolving by the day.

(C) The industry is becoming popular in rural areas.

(D) The industry is gradually becoming more expensive.

Paragraph (1)

(iii) Identify the word that indicates that the cosmetics industry is anticipated to grow. *1*

Paragraph (2)

(iv) Given that teenagers and young adults form the primary group for cosmetics purchases, what are the key factors that shape their buying decisions ? *1*

Paragraph (2)

(v) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. Paragraph (2) *1*

Assertion : The Indian cosmetics market generated a profit of approximately ₹ 1,34,000 crore in 2024.

Reason : It became possible due to strong e-commerce and growing demand for organic and premium product offerings.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.

(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is ***not*** the correct explanation of the Assertion.

(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.

(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(vi) How has the rise of e-commerce platforms impacted the revenue of the Indian cosmetics industry ? Explain in 30 – 40 words. Paragraph (3) *1*

(vii) Based on your understanding of Paragraph (3), fill in the blank with suitable options : *1*

The skincare segment currently dominates the Indian cosmetics industry. Currently its share is _____ (20%, 25%, 35%) approximately.

(viii) Complete the sentence suitably. *1*

That men's grooming has increased the demand for gender-neutral cosmetic formulations symbolizes _____. Paragraph (4)

(ix) Mention any two major challenges faced by the cosmetics industry at present. Paragraph (5) *2*

SECTION B

Grammar and Creative Writing Skills *20 marks*

Grammar

3. Complete any ***ten*** of the following twelve tasks, as directed. *10×1=10*

(i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the brackets, for the given portion of a report. *1*

The group _____ (walk) for hours through forests and hills in Mexico before it reached the barbed wire fence, marking the boundary of the forest.

(ii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option given in the brackets : *1*

_____ (Several/Both/All) people attended the convention because the entry was open to all at a very nominal fee.

(iii) Read the given sentence from a story, identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence. *1*

The farmer told his sons that he had hidden a treasure in the fields but he had forget the actual place.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	*Correction*

(iv) Report the dialogue between two friends by completing the sentence : *1*

Harry : Good morning Bobby, how do you do ?

Bobby : Quite well, thank you; but these are hard times.

Harry wished Bobby good morning and enquired about his well-being. Bobby thanked him and said that he was quite well, but remarked _____.

(v) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the line given below : *1*

I don't know what it is. It feel like an incredibly lucky day for me.

Option No.	*Error*	*Correction*
(A)	don't	doesn't
(B)	is	have
(C)	feel	feels
(D)	lucky	luckily

(vi) Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the dialogue given below : *1*

Sahil said to Shekhar, "Which are your books ?"

(A) Sahil asked Shekhar which his books were.

(B) Sahil asked Shekhar which books are yours.

(C) Sahil asked Shekhar which has been his books.

(D) Sahil asked Shekhar which are his books.

(vii) Complete the given sentence with the correct form of the verb by selecting the correct option : *1*

A case _____ against the unidentified truck driver for causing damage to the street poles due to negligence and rash driving.

(A) was registered

(B) is register

(C) have been registered

(D) may registered

(viii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option from the brackets : *1*

Anita _____ (ought to/would/have to) likely complete the project on time as her team is collaborating effectively.

(ix) Identify the error and supply the correction for the following note in a hair salon's instruction manual : *1*

All tools and frequently touched surfaces must be disinfect after each client's treatment.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	*Correction*

(x) Suhani and Sneha decided to purchase books to focus on 'Reading Skills' in their summer vacations. *1*

Report the question asked by Suhani to Sneha.

Which books are we going to purchase today from the Book Fest ?

Suhani asked Sneha _____.

(xi) Replace the underlined word used in the sentence with the best option given below : *1*

Since Sheenam study diligently for months, she will clear the competitive exam.

(A) studying

(B) was studied

(C) has been studying

(D) have been studied

(xii) Identify the error and supply the correction for the following sentence. *1*

True tradition is not in celebrations, but in the culture we carries forward.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	*Correction*

Creative Writing Skills

Note : *All details presented in the questions in the writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.*

4. Attempt any ***one*** from (a) and (b) given below in about 120 words : *5*

(a) You are Sanjana/Sanjit of Avenue Apartments, XYZ Colony, Sakshamgarh. Recently, you read in the newspaper about adulteration in food and dairy products consumed by us daily. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily expressing your views on food adulteration. Highlight the health risks of eating such foods and suggest measures to tackle the issue.

OR

(b) Going for a walk in your residential colony offers a convenient way to integrate physical activity into your daily routine. Write a letter to the Director, Municipal Board, requesting maintenance of the colony parks, installation of lighting poles, and repair of walking tracks to facilitate walkers and create a safe community space. You are Rita/Raghav Mishra, President RWA, Senatown.

5. Attempt any ***one*** from (a) and (b) given below in about 120 words : *5*

(a) Read the given details of the school activities that help children in their personality development.

- student councils, clubs
- activities in the Morning Assembly
- celebration of important days
- organization of various competitions
- sports and academic activities

Analyse the details and write an analytical paragraph about the impact of school activities on students. Focus on factors like fosters leadership, responsibility, communication skills, discipline, daily motivation, and team building.

OR

(b) Read the following details about fashion trends.

In today's world, fashion is not just about clothes, it is driven by images and impressions. Fashion trends provide a powerful reflection of society's evolution, and creativity. Write an analytical paragraph about how the factors mentioned below have shaped the fashion trends in recent years with key causes, effects and future implications.

- creative expression
- social media influence
- celebrity endorsements
- blend of traditional and modern styles
- commercialization of festivals
- customized fashion choices
- rising e-commerce

SECTION C

Literature *40 marks*

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any ***one*** of the given two, (a) or (b) : *5*

(a) Out of the experience of an extraordinary human disaster that lasted too long, must be born a society of which all humanity will be proud. We, who were outlaws not so long ago, have today been given the rare privilege to be host to the nations of the world on our own soil. We thank all of our distinguished international guests for having come to take possession with the people of our country of what is, after all, a common victory for justice, for peace, for human dignity.

(Nelson Mandela : Long Walk to Freedom)

(i) Which of the following options justifies the statement made by Mandela, "We, who were outlaws …" ? *1*

(A) The international leaders who came to attend the ceremony

(B) Due to Apartheid, many countries broke diplomatic relations with South Africa

(C) The Commonwealth countries and their people

(D) The people who fought in the Anglo-Boer War

(ii) Complete the sentence appropriately :

Mandela thanked all the distinguished international guests because _____. *1*

(iii) In the above lines, Mandela mentions 'extraordinary human disaster'. What is the significance of this phrase in his speech ? *2*

(iv) The tone of Mandela in the above excerpt is : *1*

1. unifying
2. determined
3. aggressive
4. pessimistic
5. hopeless

Select the correct option :

(A) 1, 2 and 4
(B) 2 and 4
(C) 1 and 2
(D) 4 and 5

OR

(b) "Richard was competitive," Mr. Weiherer continued, "but not in a bad sense." He explained, "Richard wasn't interested in winning for winning's sake or winning to get a prize. Rather, he was winning because he wanted to do the best job he could. For the right reasons, he wants to be the best." And that is one of the ingredients in the making of a scientist. Start with a first-rate mind, add curiosity, and mix in the will to win for the right reasons. Ebright has these qualities.

(The Making of a Scientist)

(i) In light of the excerpt, what can we infer about Richard from Mr. Weiherer's statement, "Richard was competitive, but not in a bad sense" ? *1*

(ii) Mention the 'ingredients' which are necessarily required in the making of a scientist. *2*

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets : *1*

Mr. Weiherer suggests that Richard was _____. (lethargic/persistent)

(iv) As per the above excerpt, what is ***not true*** about Ebright ? Select the correct option. *1*

(A) strongly curious
(B) bright minded
(C) competitive spirit
(D) irrational

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any ***one*** of the given two, (a) or (b) : *5*

(a) Though to distinguish beasts of prey

A novice might nonplus,

The Crocodile you always may

Tell from the Hyena thus:

Hyenas come with merry smiles;

But if they weep they're Crocodiles.

The true Chameleon is small,

A lizard sort of thing;

He hasn't any ears at all,

And not a single wing.

If there is nothing on the tree,

'Tis the chameleon you see.

(How to Tell Wild Animals)

(i) How does the poet describe the crocodile's tears ? Choose the correct option : *1*

(A) genuine and heartfelt

(B) joyful and sincere

(C) false and deceptive

(D) cold and indifferent

(ii) What confusion will a newcomer face while distinguishing between a hyena and a crocodile, as described humorously by the poet in the above extract ? *1*

(iii) Mention any two characteristics of a chameleon on the basis of the given extract. *2*

(iv) Fill in the blank with the correct option from those given in the brackets : *1*

The tone of the poet in the above lines is _____ (playful and humorous/serious and confused).

OR

(b) Did you finish your homework, Amanda?

Did you tidy your room, Amanda?

I thought I told you to clean your shoes, Amanda!

(I am an orphan, roaming the street.

I pattern soft dust with my hushed, bare feet.

The silence is golden, the freedom is sweet.)

(Amanda!)

(i) Complete the sentence appropriately : *1*

Amanda wants to be an orphan because _____.

(ii) What does the image of Amanda "roaming barefoot in the dusty street" signify ? *2*

(iii) Amanda's tone while imagining herself as an orphan is : *1*

(A) excited

(B) fearful

(C) angry

(D) peaceful

(iv) What does the speaker do on the dust ? *1*

8. Answer any ***four*** of the following five questions in 40 – 50 words each : *4×3=12*

(i) In the poem 'Fire and Ice', how does the intense human emotion symbolised by fire, lead to the destruction of the world ?

(ii) Mention the details that Anne provides about her family in her diary.

(From the Diary of Anne Frank)

(iii) Bread plays a pivotal role in Goan culture and tradition. Support the statement with evidences from the text.

(Glimpses of India : A Baker from Goa)

(iv) What happened when Maxwell took Mijbil to the bathroom ?

(Mijbil the Otter)

(v) Despite her young age, how does Valli manage to gather the subtle details about the bus journey ?

(Madam Rides the Bus)

9. Answer any ***two*** of the following three questions in 40 – 50 words each : *2×3=6*

(i) Why does Hari Singh find it pleasant to work for Anil, though he was a thief ?

(The Thief's Story)

(ii) How does Matilda face 'the horrible life of necessity' ?

(The Necklace)

(iii) The teacher built up Bholi's confidence on her first day at school. Discuss.

(Bholi)

10. Answer any ***one*** of the following two questions in 100 – 120 words : *6*

(a) How do Lencho in 'A Letter to God' and Kisa Gotami in 'The Sermon at Benares' respond to their experiences of suffering and loss ? How did they overcome their respective losses ?

OR

(b) How does the contrast between the pilot's fear in 'The Black Aeroplane' and Custard's initial cowardice in 'The Tale of Custard the Dragon' highlight that courage can be found in the most unexpected characters when circumstances demand it ? Discuss with reference to the two.

11. Answer any ***one*** of the following two questions in 100 – 120 words : *6*

(a) Compare and contrast Tricki's condition before and after his stay at the surgery. How does this contrast help in understanding the role of proper care, discipline and environment in ensuring Tricki's well-being ?

(A Triumph of Surgery)

OR

(b) How does Think-Tank's arrogance and ignorance contribute to the theme of wit over power in 'The Book that Saved the Earth' ?

(Q.P. CODE /Set No 184/2-2-1)

Marking Scheme
Strictly Confidential
(For Internal and Restricted use only)
Secondary School Examination, 2026 (Xth)
SUBJECT NAME English Language and Literature
(Q.P. CODE /Set No 184/2-2-1)

General Instructions: -

1	You are aware that evaluation is the most important process in the actual and correct assessment of the candidates. A small mistake in evaluation may lead to serious problems which may affect the future of the candidates, education system and teaching profession. To avoid mistakes, it is requested that before starting evaluation, you must read and understand the spot evaluation guidelines carefully.
2	**"Evaluation policy is a confidential policy as it is related to the confidentiality of the examinations conducted, evaluation done and several other aspects. Its leakage to public in any manner could lead to derailment of the examination system and affect the life and future of millions of candidates. Sharing this policy/document to anyone, publishing in any magazine and printing in Newspaper/Website, etc. may invite action under various rules of the Board and IPC."**
3	Evaluation is to be done as per instructions provided in the Marking Scheme. It should not be done according to one's own interpretation or any other consideration. Marking Scheme should be strictly adhered to and religiously followed. **However, while evaluating, answers which are based on latest information or knowledge and/or are innovative, they may be assessed for their correctness otherwise and due marks be awarded to them. In Class-X, while evaluating two competency-based questions, please try to understand given answer and even if reply is not from marking scheme but correct competency is enumerated by the candidate, due marks should be awarded.**
4	The Marking scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers. These are in the nature of Guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. The students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, the due marks should be awarded accordingly.
5	The Head-Examiner must go through the first five answer books evaluated by each evaluator on the first day, to ensure that evaluation has been carried out as per the instructions given in the Marking Scheme. If there is any variation, the same should be zero after deliberation and discussion. The remaining answer books meant for evaluation shall be given only after ensuring that there is no significant variation in the marking of individual evaluators.
6	Evaluators will mark (√) wherever answer is correct. For wrong answer CROSS 'X' be marked. Evaluators will not put right (✓) while evaluating which gives an impression that answer is correct and no marks are awarded. **This is most common mistake which evaluators are committing.**
7	If a question has parts, please award marks on the right-hand side for each part. Marks awarded for different parts of the question should then be totaled up and written in the left-hand margin and encircled. This may be followed strictly.
8	If a question does not have any parts, marks must be awarded in the left-hand margin and encircled. This may also be followed strictly.

9	If a student has attempted an extra question, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note **"Extra Question"**.
10	No marks to be deducted for the cumulative effect of an error. It should be penalized only once.
11	A full scale of marks _____ (example 0 to 80/70/60/50/40/30 marks as given in Question Paper) has to be used. Please do not hesitate to award full marks if the answer deserves it.
12	Every examiner has to necessarily do evaluation work for full working hours i.e., 8 hours every day and evaluate 20 answer books per day in main subjects and 25 answer books per day in other subjects (Details are given in Spot Guidelines).This is in view of the reduced syllabus and number of questions in question paper.
13	Ensure that you do not make the following common types of errors committed by the Examiner in the past :- ● Leaving answer or part thereof unassessed in an answer book. ● Giving more marks for an answer than assigned to it. ● Wrong totaling of marks awarded on an answer. ● Wrong transfer of marks from the inside pages of the answer book to the title page. ● Wrong question wise totaling on the title page. ● Wrong totaling of marks of the two columns on the title page. ● Wrong grand total. ● Marks in words and figures not tallying/not same. ● Wrong transfer of marks from the answer book to online award list. ● Answers marked as correct, but marks not awarded. (Ensure that the right tick mark is correctly and clearly indicated. It should merely be a line. Same is with the X for incorrect answer.) ● Half or a part of answer marked correct and the rest as wrong, but no marks awarded.
14	While evaluating the answer books if the answer is found to be totally incorrect, it should be marked as cross (X) and awarded zero (0) Marks.
15	Any unassessed portion, non-carrying over of marks to the title page, or totaling error detected by the candidate shall damage the prestige of all the personnel engaged in the evaluation work as also of the Board. Hence, in order to uphold the prestige of all concerned, it is again reiterated that the instructions be followed meticulously and judiciously.
16	The Examiners should acquaint themselves with the guidelines given in the "**Guidelines for Spot Evaluation**" before starting the actual evaluation.
17	Every Examiner shall also ensure that all the answers are evaluated, marks carried over to the title page, correctly totaled and written in figures and words.
18	The candidates are entitled to obtain photocopy of the Answer Book on request on payment of the prescribed processing fee. All Examiners/Additional Head Examiners/Head Examiners are once again reminded that they must ensure that evaluation is carried out strictly as per value points for each answer as given in the Marking Scheme.

MARKING SCHEME
ENGLISH (Language and Literature) (Subject Code-184)
(PAPER CODE: 2/2/1)

Q.No.	EXPECTED OUTCOMES/VALUE POINTS	Marks
	SECTION – A (Reading Skills)	**20 Marks**
	1. PASSAGE I	**10 marks**
(i)	(D) Fear of being left out of rewarding experiences.	1
(ii)	(B) Of constant edits and updates on social media platforms.	1
(iii)	**(Any one)** • Intensifies pressure to participate in everything from music festivals to viral food craze. • Memories and moments are commodified	1
(iv)	**(Any Two)** • Hesitate to commit to plans due to fear of better alternative emerging later. • Impulsive choice such as overspreading, overcommitting to events. • Hasty decisions to avoid feeling excluded • Struggle to focus on their priorities • Causes anxiety and dissatisfaction.	2
(v)	**(Any One)** • Dissatisfaction • Anxiety • Breeds discontent • Fear of commitment • Impulsive behavior • Distraction • Overcommitting	1
(vi)	**(Any Two)** • By setting specific timings for checking apps and social media. • Mindful breathing or meditation. • Prioritizing self-awareness and authentic experiences. • Avoids constant comparison	

- Not chasing external validation
- Generate emotional resilience 2

(vii) True 1

(viii) (B) Withstand emotional anxiety of FOMO 1

2. PASSAGE 2 **10 marks**

(i) **(Any One)**
- Evolving beauty standards
- Social media influence
- Awareness about personal grooming 1

(ii) (B) The industry is growing and evolving by the day 1

(iii) Projected 1

(iv) **(Any one)** 1
- Increasing awareness of personal grooming
- Skin care routines among consumers
- Trendy and innovation solutions/demand for organic and premium products.

(v) (A) Both the Assertion and Reason are true and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion

OR

(D) The Assertion is False but the Reason is True 1

(vi) **(Any One)**
- Played crucial role in expanding access to cosmetics especially in Tier II and Tier III cities.
- Online sale contribute around 25% of total cosmetic sale in India. 1

(vii) 35 % 1

(viii) **(Any One)**
- An aspirational pursuit of refinement enhancing self-confidence.
- Dismantling archaic stereotypes 1

(ix) **(Any Two)**
- Intense competition

- Complying with regulations
- Ensuring product quality
- Changing consumer preferences
- Addressing ethical sourcing concern
- Complexity of supply chain
- Copied products 2

SECTION – B 20

(Grammar and Creative Writing Skills)

3. Complete ANY Ten of the following twelve tasks as directed: (10x1=10)

Full credit – 1 mark for correct answer. No Partial credit

(i) Walked/had been walking/had walked 1

(ii) Several 1

(iii) 1

Error	Correction
Forget	Forgotten

(iv) that those were hard times 1

(v) (C) ERROR- Feel CORRECTION- feels 1

(vi) (A) Sahil asked Shekhar which his books were. 1

(vii) (A) was registered 1

(viii) would 1

(ix) 1

Error	Correction
Disinfect	Disinfected

(x) which books they were going to purchase that day from the book fest/
which books they were going to purchase from the book fest that day. 1

(xi) (C) has been studying 1

(xii) 1

Error	Correction
Carries	Carry

CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS **10 marks**

4. Letter writing – Attempt ANY ONE from (a) and (b) given below: **5**

- ❖ **Content – 2 marks (Any four value points from the headers)**
- ❖ **Format – 1 mark**

- **No mark for format alone if content is irrelevant or missing**
- **Full credit of 1 mark if all aspects are mentioned**
- **Partial credit of ½ mark if one or two aspects are missing**
- **No credit if more than two aspects are missing**

- ❖ **Organisation of ideas – 1 mark(effective style, orderly sequence, paragraph structure, formal tone and vocabulary**
- ❖ **Accuracy – 1 mark (Spelling, Punctuation and Grammar)**
  - **½ mark to be deducted if there are three or more spelling errors.**

a. Value points : **2+1+1+1**

(At least four points, two from each aspect)

- Digestive disorders like diarrhea, Stomach cramps etc.
- Food poisoning
- Allergic reactions like skin rashes, irritation
- Respiratory issues
- May impact brain development
- Food adulteration is rampant
- Negligence by Government Agencies

Suggestions:

- Public awareness campaign
- Encouraging home testing
- Hard punishments
- Regular raids
- Proactive measures by Government Agencies

(Any other relevant points)

OR

b. Value points : **2+1+1+1**

(At least four points two from each aspect)

- Colony parks are ill maintained/require maintenance

- Poorly lit street lights
- Walking path broken/uneven
- Unsafe community space
- Menace of stray animals (dogs, cows, monkeys)

Suggestions:

- Maintenance of colony parks
- Installation of street lights
- Repair of walking tracks to facilitate walkers
- Creation of safe community space
- Rehabilitation of stray animals

(Any other relevant point)

5. Analytical Paragraph- Attempt ANY ONE from (a) and (b) given below: 5

❖ **Content – 2 marks**

- **Full credit of 2 marks will be awarded if a minimum of four trends/points which are included in the question, are duly analyzed and synthesized.**
- **Partial credit of 1 mark will be awarded if only two value points are included.**

❖ **Organisation of Ideas – 2 marks**

- **Effective style, orderly sequence, single paragraph structure, formal tone and functional vocabulary**
- **Linking words and phrases/cohesive devices such as however, in addition to, therefore, in contrast to should be included.**

❖ **Accuracy – 1 mark (Spelling, Punctuation and Grammar)**

- **½ mark to be deducted if there are three or more spelling errors.**

a. Value Points : 2+2+1

- Student councils
- Activities in morning assembly
- Celebration of important days
- Organization of various competitions
- Sports and academic activities
- School Activities foster leadership qualities, responsibility, communication skills
- Also fosters discipline, daily motivation and team building

OR

7

b. Value Points: **2+2+1**

- Creative expression
- Social media influence
- Celebrity endorsements
- Blend of traditional and modern style
- Customized fashion choices
- Rising e – commerce

SECTION - C
LITERATURE TEXT BOOK 40 MARKS

6. Read the following extracts and answers the questions for any one of the two (a) or (b): 5 marks

a.

(i) (B) Due to Apartheid, many countries broke diplomatic relations with South Africa 1

(ii) They supported them to fight against racial discrimination or apartheid/ They joined the ceremony

(Any other relevant point) 1

(iii) **(Any two)**

- Refers to racial discrimination/apartheid that lasted too long
- Suffered oppressions
- They were denied of basic rights and freedom
- Makes an emphatic statement.
- To draw attention towards 'disaster' (apartheid)

(Any other relevant point) 2

(iv) (C) 1 and 2 1

OR

b. (i) **(Any one)**

- Richard had a strong desire to win not for the sake of fame, money or to undermine others.

- His competitiveness was genuine which shows his passion in science and desire to do best work. 1

(ii) **(Any two)**

- A first rate mind
- Strong curiosity
- Strong will to excel
- Determination

(Any other relevant point) 2

(iii) Persistent 1

(iv) (D.) irrational 1

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two (a) or (b): 5 marks

a. (i) (C) False and deceptive 1

(ii) Both are described humorously- the hyena appears to laugh or smile whereas the crocodile may appear crying. 1

(iii) **(Any two)**

- Small like a lizard
- Doesn't have ears or wings
- Changes colour and blends itself according to the background.

(Any other relevant point) 2

(iv) Playful and humorous 1

OR

b. (i) She is continuously nagged by her mother/she wants to be free/ tired of nagging (Any other relevant point) 1

(ii) **(Any two)**

- Desire or longing for freedom
- Freedom from rules and discipline
- No one to nag and correct her
- Wants to enjoy her childhood

(Any other relevant point) 2

(iii) (A) Excited 1

(iv) She is making patterns with her feet on the soft dust. 1

8. Answer any four of the following five questions in 40 – 50 words each: (4x3=12)

- **Content – 2 marks (at least 2 value points)**
- **Expression – 1 mark (effective style, coherence and cohesion)**

(i) (Any two points) 2+1

- Fire symbolizes – desire
- Fire / desire may lead to greed, avarice, lust, conflict and fury
- These instincts may lead to destruction of the world
- As fire symbolizes desire, if not controlled may be the cause of the end of the world.

(Any other relevant point)

(ii) (Any two points) 2+1

Intricate details about family

- Father- Otto Frank, most adorable, loving patient and understanding did not marry her mother until he was thirty six
- Mother- Edith Frank, good looking, talkative
- Elder Sister -Margot, she was born in Germany
- Grandmother and aunts - loving
- Family- Jewish, lived in Frankfurt before moving to Amsterdam

(Any other relevant point)

(iii) (Any two points) 2+1

- Marriage gifts meaningless without ‘bol’
- Sandwiches on the occasion of daughter’s engagement
- Cake and bolinhas must for Christmas and other festivals
- Symbol of community, life and tradition

(Any other relevant point)

(iv) (Any two points) 2+1

- Seemed to be startled and surprised initially
- Jumped up and down in bathtub underwater.
- Enough slosh and splash- slid and rolled/tried to climb out/ scrambled around
- Scattered the soap, toothbrushes and other toiletries
- Wanted to extend every drop of water

(Any other relevant point)

(v) (Any two points) 2+1

- World beyond her village
- Keen observer
- Gathered information by asking questions to passengers
- Used to hear conversation of neighbours
- Gathered minute details like fare, timings etc. through her discreet questions

(Any other relevant point)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions in 40 – 50 words each: (2x3=6)

- **Content – 2 marks (at least 2 value points)**
- **Expression – 1 mark (effective style, coherence and cohesion)**

(i) (Any two points) 2+1

- Because Anil was a kind, gentle and trusting person
- Showed affection, made him comfortable (even though Hari Singh didn't know how to cook)
- Never suspected, never rebuked (even when he stole/pilfered from him daily)
- Did not burden him with too much work
- Taught him how to read and write

(Any other relevant point)

(ii) (Any two points) 2+1

- Dreamed of luxury and riches
- Faced extreme poverty due to loss of necklace
- For repaying heavy debt had to do all the household chores (cleaned utensils, washed clothes and floors, fetched water from the streets, shopped at cheap markets, bargained for every coin)
- She became the woman of the street

- Continuous hard work ruined her beauty

(Any other relevant point)

(iii) (Any two points) 2+1

- Suffered neglect and rejection from parents and siblings
- Encouragement of teacher made her confident/ enabled her to speak
- Praised her small efforts
- Gave her assurances- promised her no one will mock her again
- The teacher gave her books and talked very soothingly/gently

(Any other relevant point)

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions in 100 – 120 words: 6 marks

- **Content – 3 marks (Any Three Points duly supported by relevant textual evidence)**
- **Expression – 2 marks (effective style, coherence and cohesion, using a balanced comparison and synthesis of the two aspects/texts)**
- **Accuracy – 1 mark (Spelling, Punctuation and Grammar)**

(a) (Any three points– at least one point must be included from each lesson/aspect like their suffering, grief and loss) 3+2+1

A Letter to God (Lencho)

- Poor farmer, dependent on crops for survival
- Corn fields destroyed by hailstorm, ruined him and left his family on the verge of starvation
- Responds with unshakable faith in God
- Asks for 100 pesos to survive, when receives less money than requested, still believed God helped him
- Suspects the post office employees-shows his blind faith in God

Sermon at Benares (Kisa Gotami):

- Kisa Gotami's only son died
- Refuses to accept death
- Went to Buddha to seek cure
- But then realized that death is inevitable to all

Synthesis:

- Both suffered great loss
- Lencho's loss is material

- Kisa Gotami's loss is emotional
- But ultimately both try to come out of their loss / grief in their own way.
- Lencho overcomes his loss through strong faith and hope in God
- Kisa Gotami overcomes her loss by gaining wisdom and acceptance through understanding the reality of human life/ Lets go of her attachment.

(Any other relevant point)

OR

(b) ANY ONE point from each lesson and at least one contrast point : 3+2+1

The Black Aeroplane (Pilot)

- Pilot was confident but when saw black clouds panicked at first
- Then kept on flying
- Showed his determination
- Reveals his inner strength
- Mystery of black aeroplane provides him hope and guidance

The Tale of Custard the Dragon (Custard)

- Used to think of himself as a coward
- Real danger comes when the pirate attacked
- Fought bravely
- Saved and surprised everyone
- Perceived a true hero than a coward
- Unexpected courage and strength of custard was revealed, when everyone panicked

Contrast:

- Both faced unexpected danger
- But dealt courageously in their respective situations
- Both show their inner and true strength when faced danger
- Ultimately saved themselves from their predicaments

(Any other relevant point)

11. Answer any one of the following two questions in 100 – 120 words: 6 marks

- **Content – 3 marks (Any Three Points duly supported by relevant textual evidence)**

- **Expression – 2 marks (effective style, coherence and cohesion)**
- **Accuracy – 1 mark (Spelling, Punctuation and Grammar)**

(a) (At least three points – one from each part of the question) **3+2+1**

Before surgery:
- Hugely fat like bloated sausage
- Eyes blood shot and rheumy
- Moves lethargically
- Overfed, suffers from vomiting
- Problem in breathing

After surgery:
- A lithe and hard muscled animal
- Active
- Glossy and shiny
- Alert and excited

Role of proper care, discipline and environment:
- Controlled diet
- No overfeeding
- Regular exercise
- Environment - as played with other dogs
  - Used to fight to have his meal
  - involved in friendly scrimmages
- Lost weight, became healthy, regained his health

(Any other relevant points)

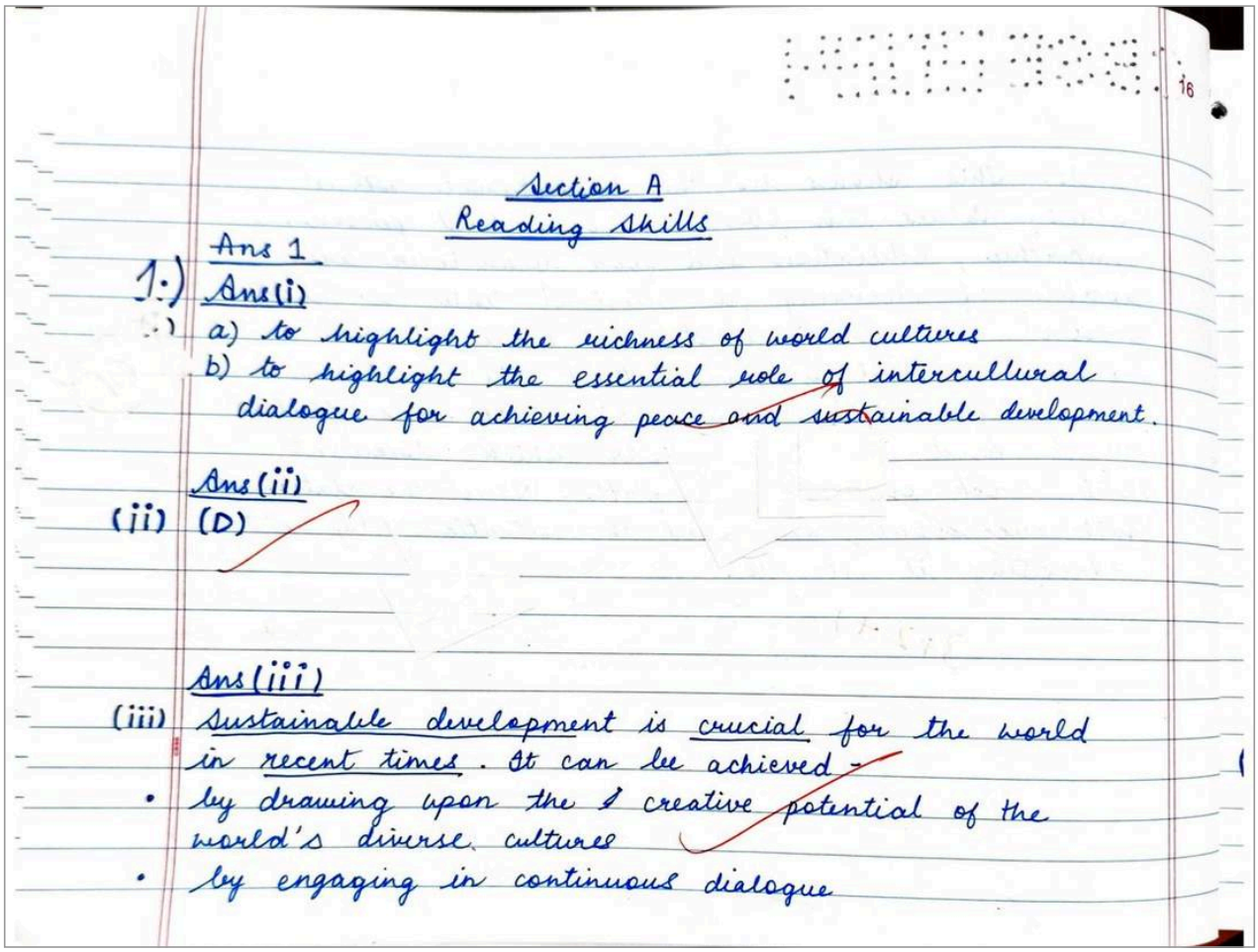
OR

(b) (At least three points) **3+2+1**

- Think tank considered himself genius, most brilliant in universe
- Expected others to flatter him
- Looks down the people on the earth
- Constantly boats his technological superiority
- When misunderstood books as weapons panicked but refused to accept his fault.
- His arrogance collapses when misunderstands the rhymes, shows wisdom and wit are stronger than power
- Took credit away from Noodle for his intelligent outputs
- Shows arrogance and superiority but cannot win the power of mind or wit

(Any other relevant point)

Q1 (i)-(iii) Reading answer book p.16



16

Section A
Reading Skills

1.) Ans 1

Ans (i)

a) to highlight the richness of world cultures
b) to highlight the essential role of intercultural dialogue for achieving peace and sustainable development.

Ans (ii)

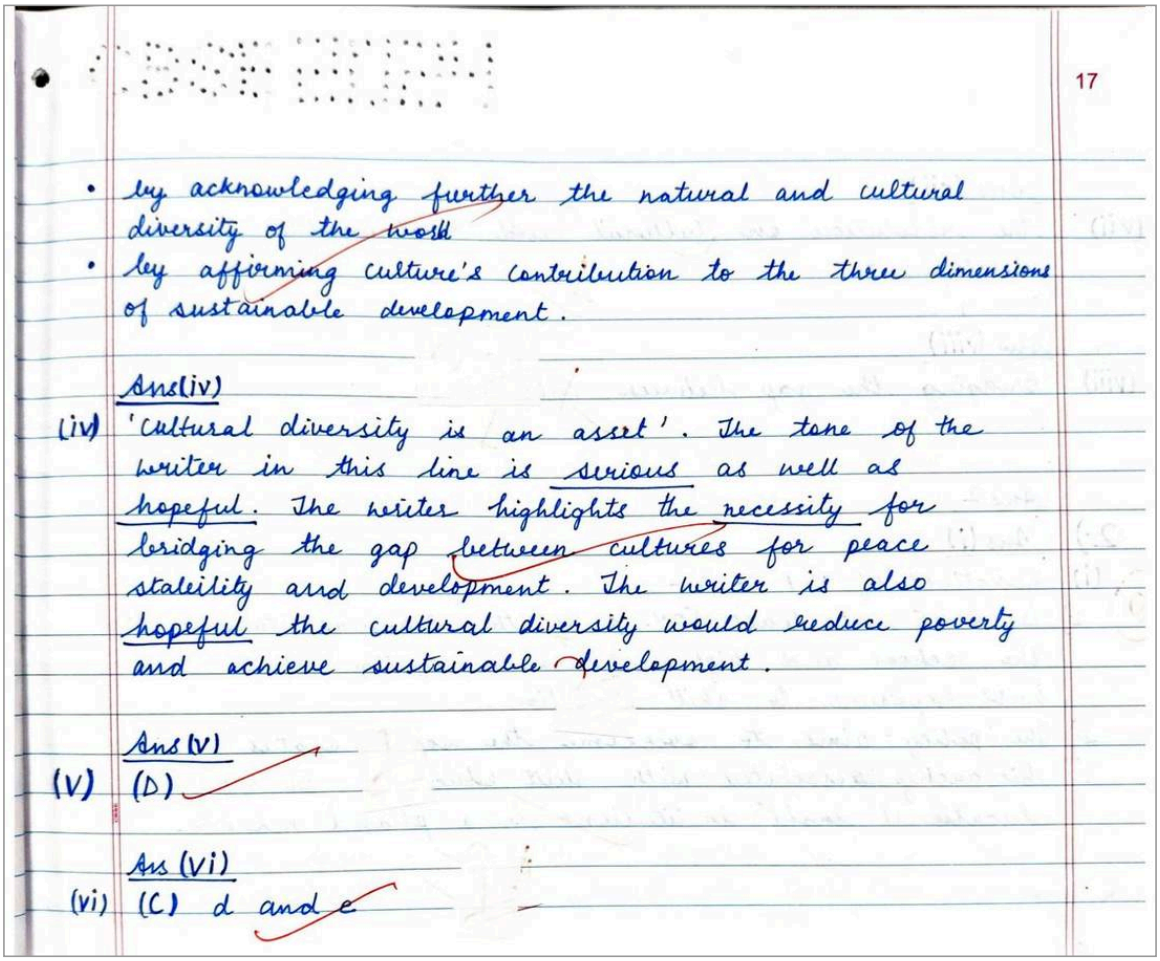
(ii) (D)

Ans (iii)

(iii) Sustainable development is crucial for the world in recent times. It can be achieved -

- by drawing upon the creative potential of the world's diverse cultures
- by engaging in continuous dialogue

Q1 (iii)-(vi) Reading answer book p.17



17

- by acknowledging further the natural and cultural diversity of the world
- by affirming culture's contribution to the three dimensions of sustainable development.

Ans (iv)

(iv) 'Cultural diversity is an asset'. The tone of the writer in this line is serious as well as hopeful. The writer highlights the necessity for bridging the gap between cultures for peace stability and development. The writer is also hopeful the cultural diversity would reduce poverty and achieve sustainable development.

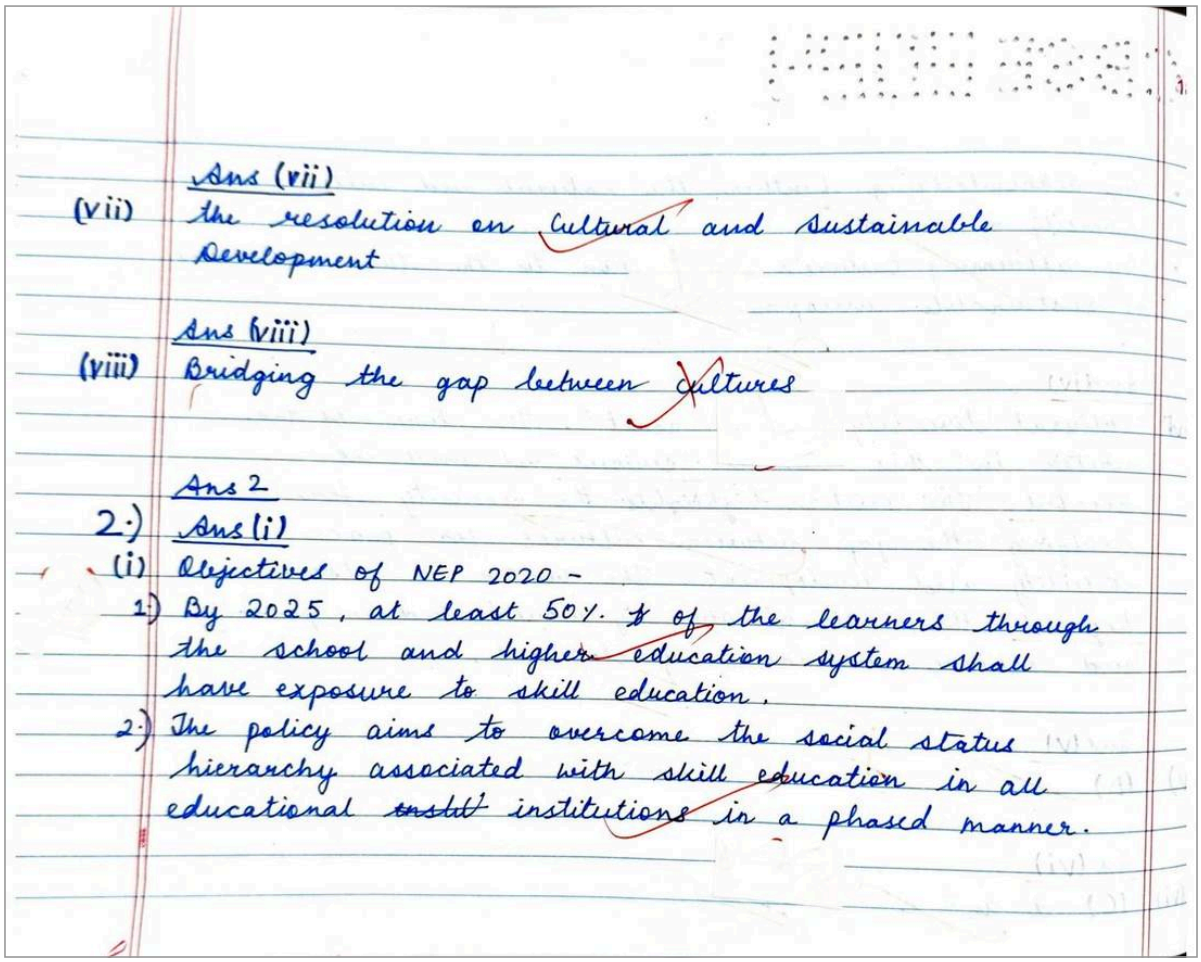
Ans (v)

(v) (D)

Ans (vi)

(vi) (C) d and e

Q1 (vii), (viii) · Q2 (i) Reading answer book p.18

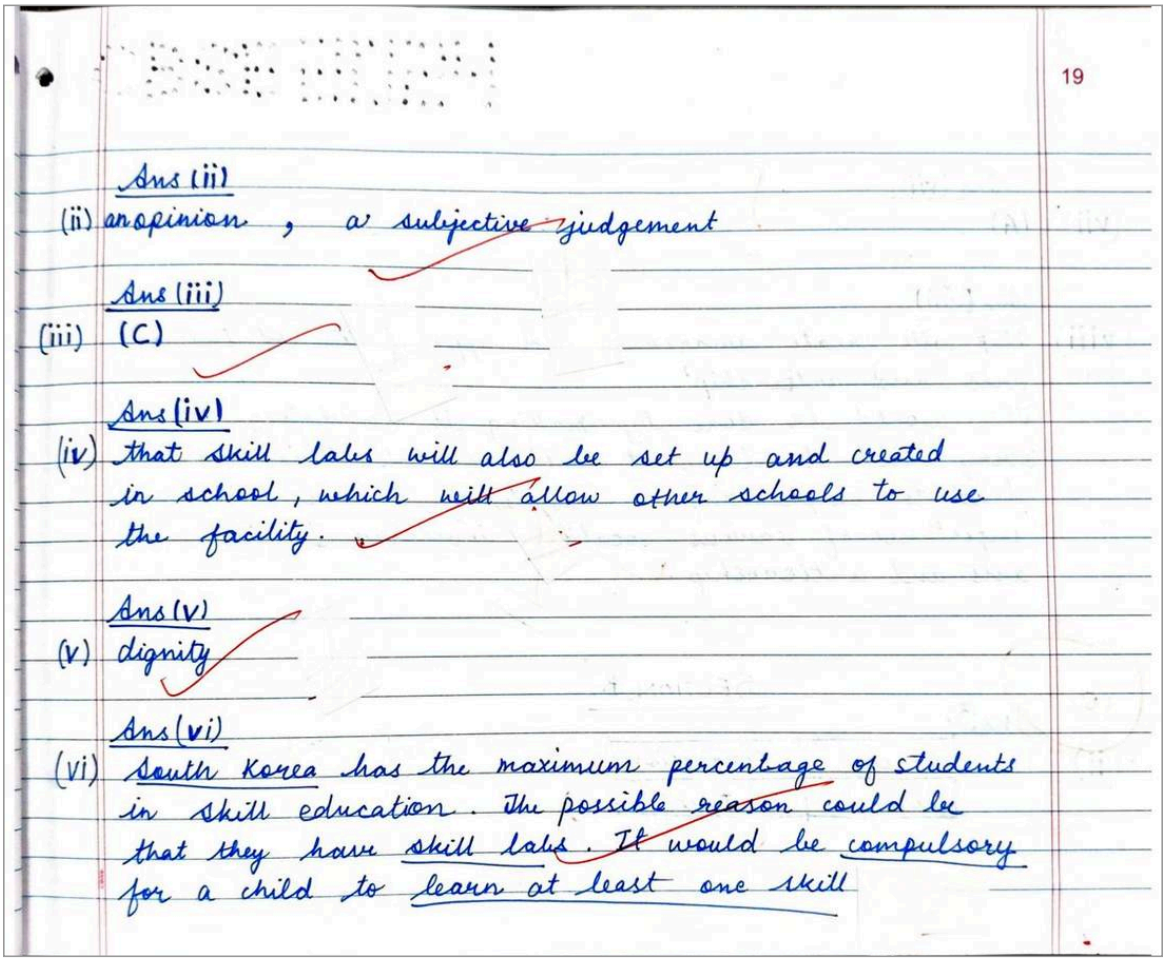


Ans (vii)
(vii) the resolution on Cultural and Sustainable Development

Ans (viii)
(viii) Bridging the gap between cultures

Ans 2
2.) Ans (i)
(i) Objectives of NEP 2020 -
1.) By 2025, at least 50%. of the learners through the school and higher education system shall have exposure to skill education.
2.) The policy aims to overcome the social status hierarchy associated with skill education in all educational institutions in a phased manner.

Q2 (ii)-(vi) Reading answer book p.19



19

Ans (ii)
(ii) an opinion, a subjective judgement

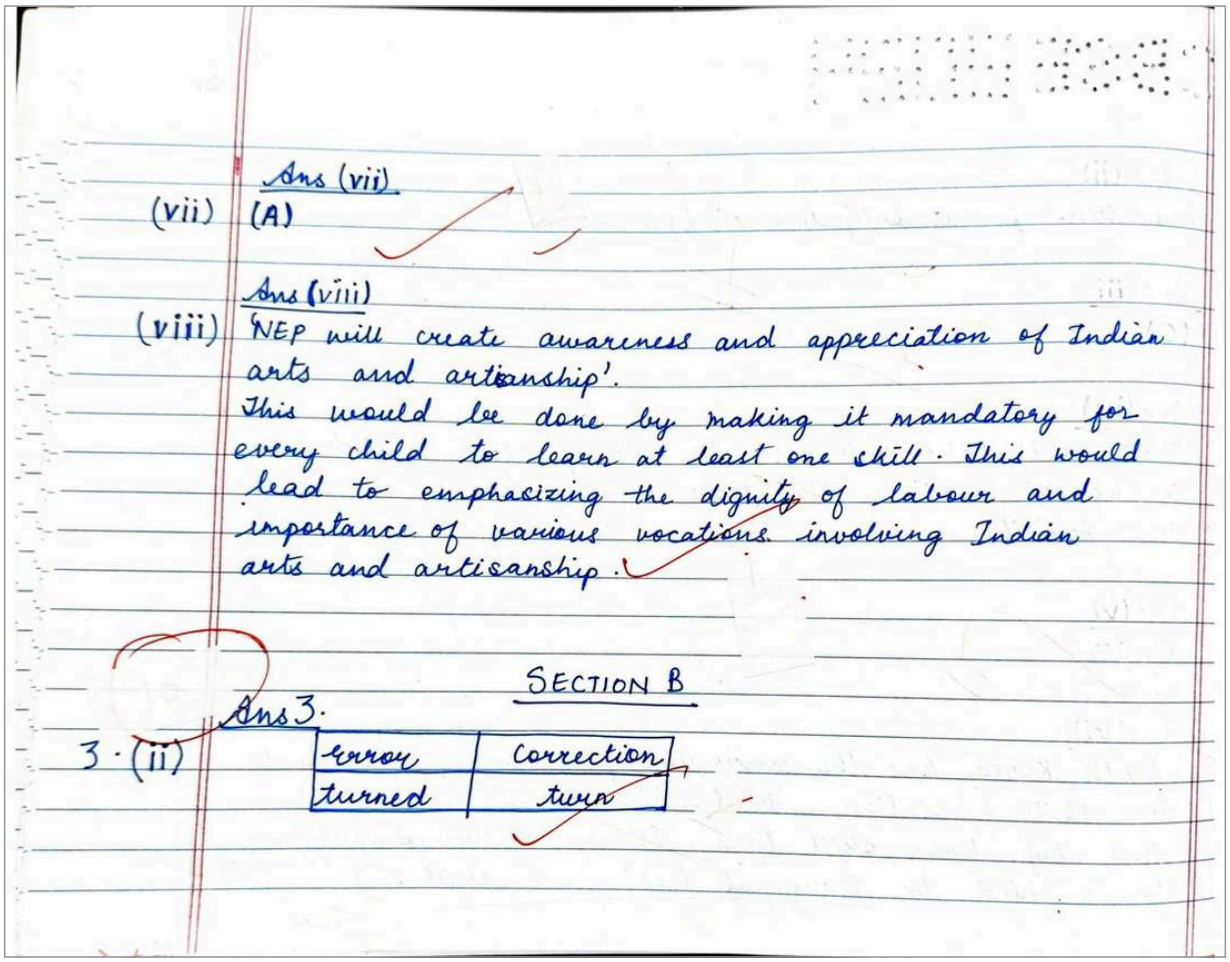
Ans (iii)
(iii) (C)

Ans (iv)
(iv) that skill labs will also be set up and created in school, which will allow other schools to use the facility.

Ans (v)
(v) dignity

Ans (vi)
(vi) South Korea has the maximum percentage of students in skill education. The possible reason could be that they have skill labs. It would be compulsory for a child to learn at least one skill

Q2 (vii), (viii) · Q3 (ii) Grammar answer book p.20



Ans (vii)

(vii) (A)

Ans (viii)

(viii) 'NEP will create awareness and appreciation of Indian arts and artisanship'.
This would be done by making it mandatory for every child to learn at least one skill. This would lead to emphasizing the dignity of labour and importance of various vocations involving Indian arts and artisanship.

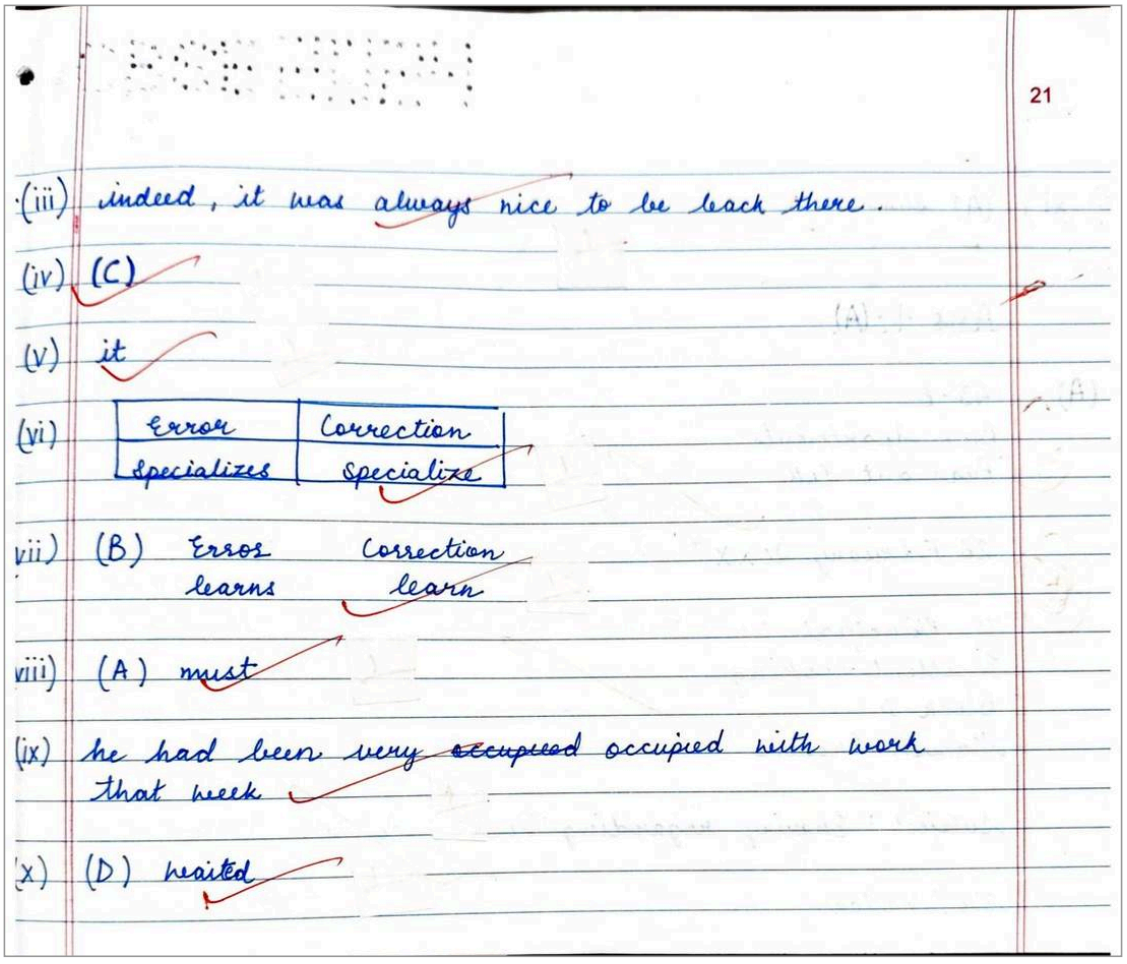
SECTION B

Ans 3.

3. (ii)

Error	Correction
turned	turn

Q3 (iii)-(x) Grammar answer book p.21



21

(iii) indeed, it was always nice to be back there.

(iv) (C)

(v) it

(vi)

Error	Correction
Specializes	Specialize

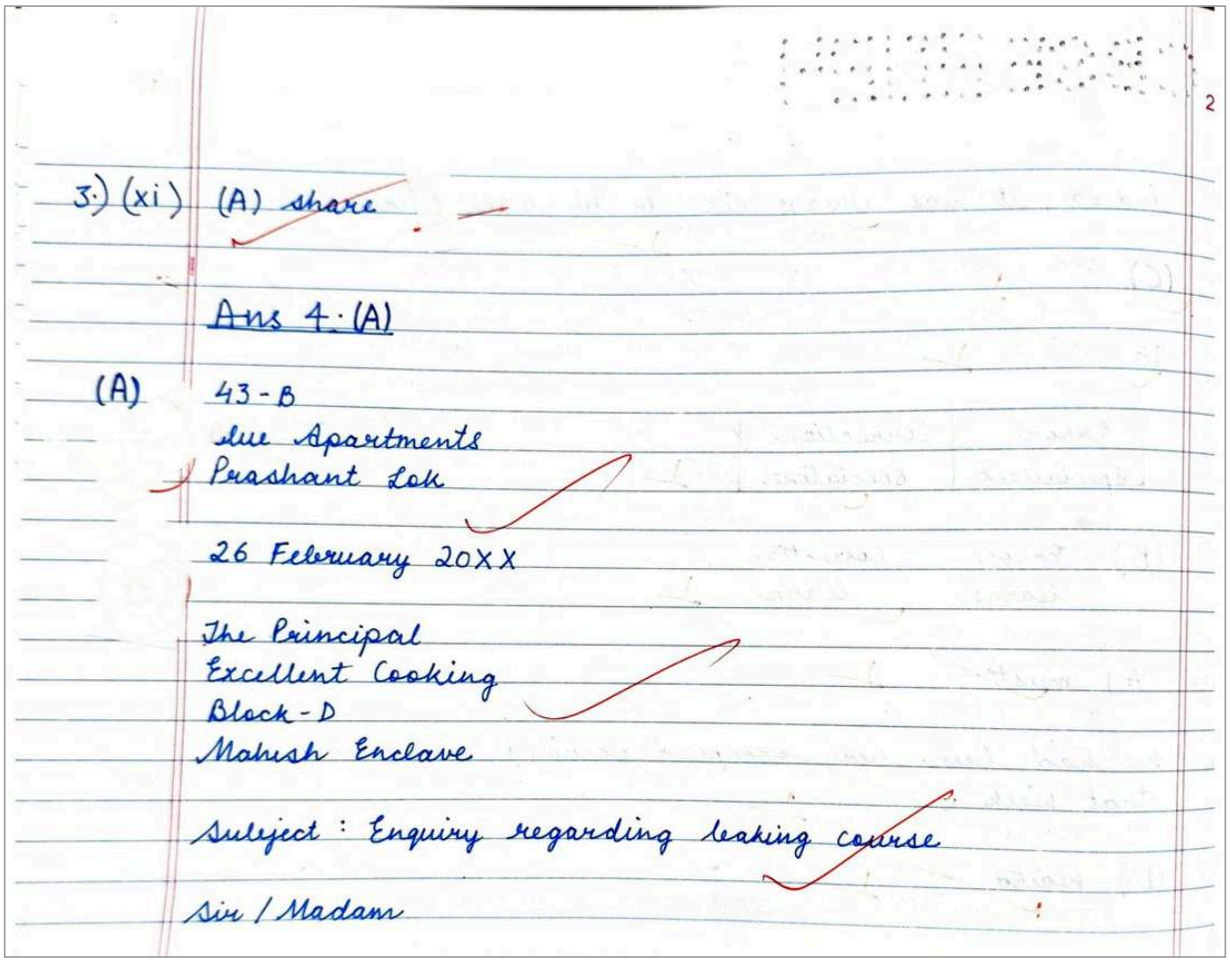
(vii) (B) Erros learns — Correction learn

(viii) (A) must

(ix) he had been very ~~occupied~~ occupied with work that week

(x) (D) waited

Q3 (xi) · Q4 (A) Formal Letter answer book p.22



2

3.) (xi) (A) share

Ans 4. (A)

(A) 43-B
Sue Apartments
Prashant Lok

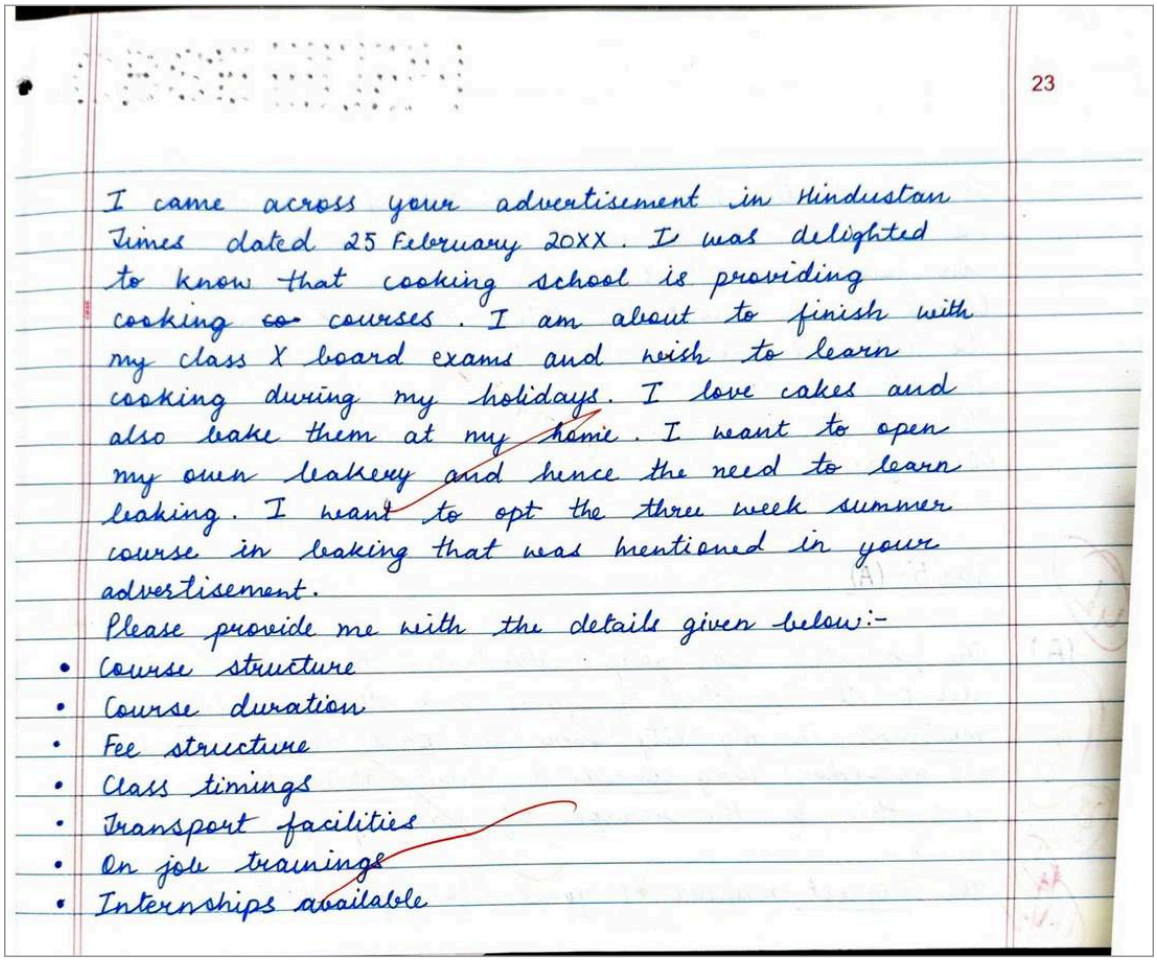
26 February 20XX

The Principal
Excellent Cooking
Block-D
Mahish Enclave

Subject : Enquiry regarding baking course

Sir / Madam

Q4 (A) Formal Letter (contd.) answer book p.23



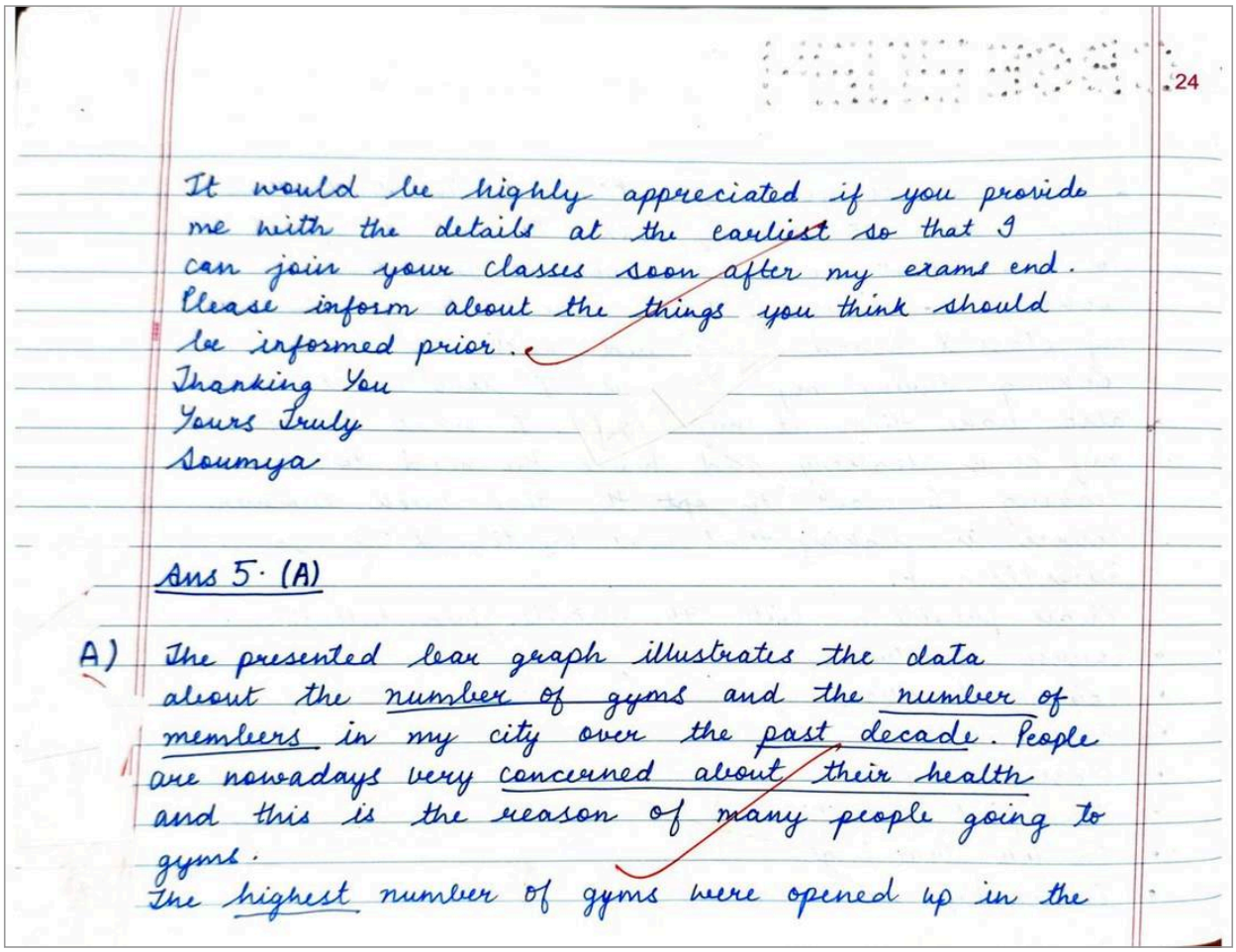
23

I came across your advertisement in Hindustan Times dated 25 February 20XX. I was delighted to know that cooking school is providing cooking ~~co~~ courses. I am about to finish with my class X board exams and wish to learn cooking during my holidays. I love cakes and also bake them at my home. I want to open my own bakery and hence the need to learn baking. I want to opt the three week summer course in baking that was mentioned in your advertisement.
Please provide me with the details given below:-

- Course structure
- Course duration
- Fee structure
- Class timings
- Transport facilities
- On job trainings
- Internships available

Q4 (A) end · Q5 (A) Analytical Para

answer book p.24



24

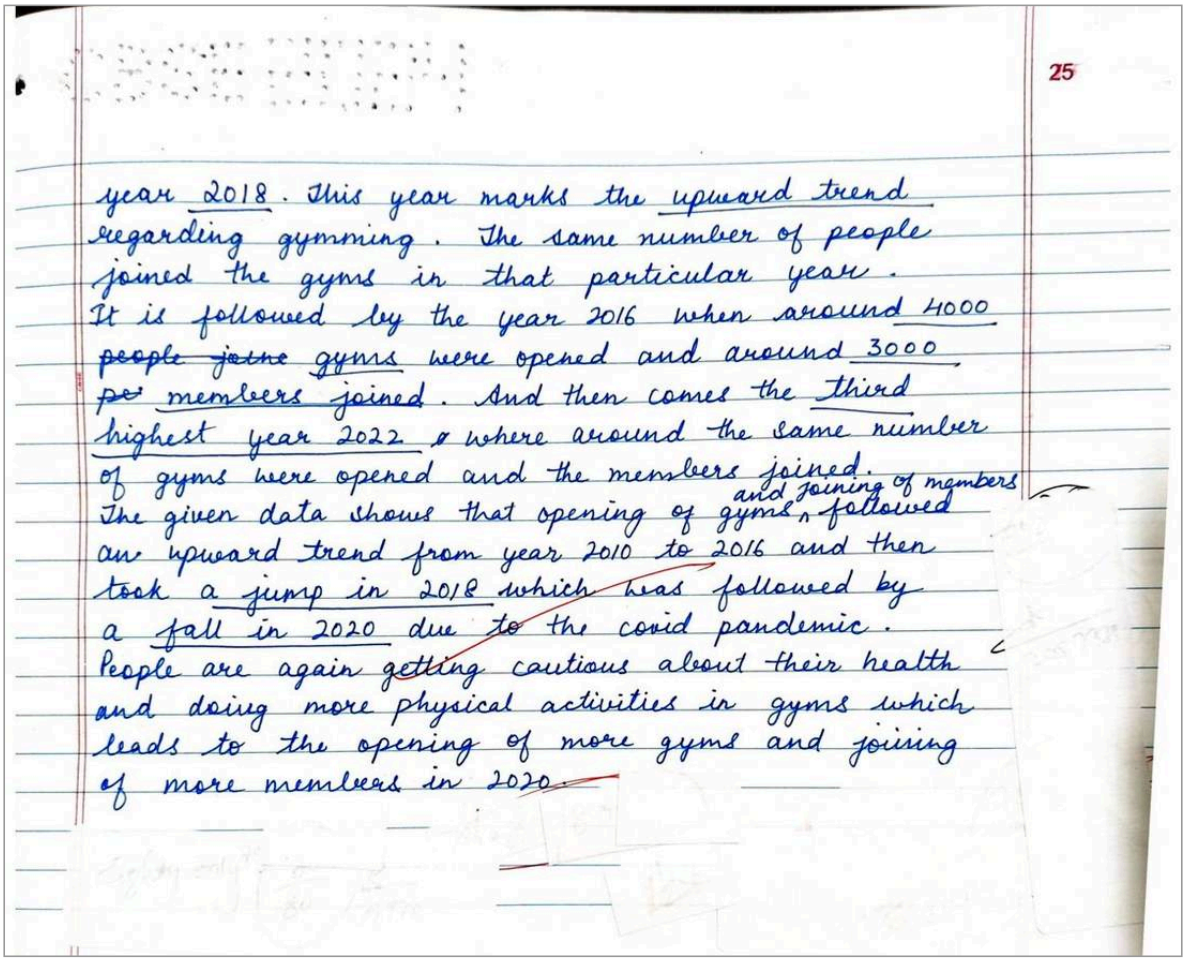
It would be highly appreciated if you provide me with the details at the earliest so that I can join your classes soon after my exams end. Please inform about the things you think should be informed prior.
Thanking You
Yours Truly
Soumya

Ans 5. (A)

A) The presented bar graph illustrates the data about the number of gyms and the number of members in my city over the past decade. People are nowadays very concerned about their health and this is the reason of many people going to gyms.
The highest number of gyms were opened up in the

Q5 (A) Analytical Paragraph (contd.)

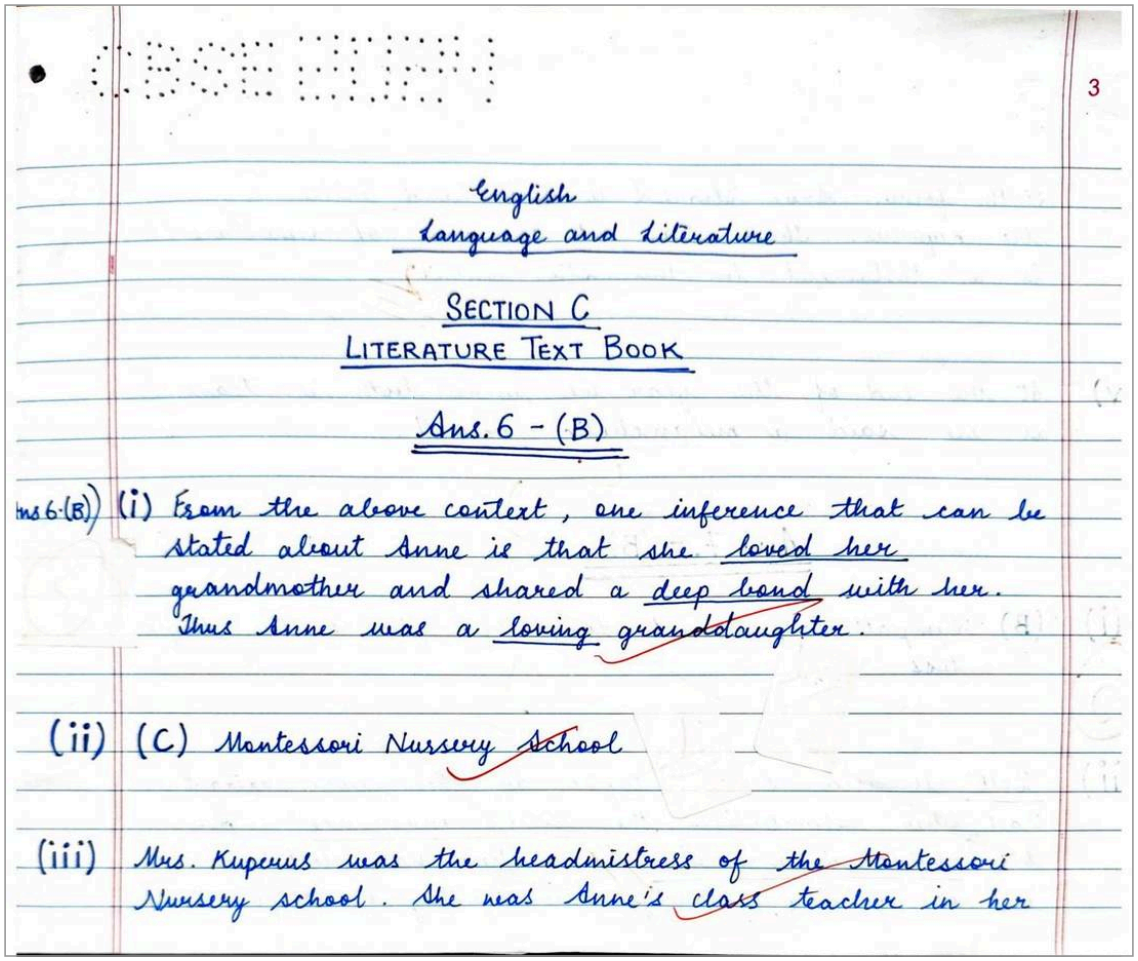
answer book p.25



25

year 2018. This year marks the upward trend regarding gymming. The same number of people joined the gyms in that particular year.
It is followed by the year 2016 when around 4000 ~~people joine~~ gyms were opened and around 3000 ~~pe~~ members joined. And then comes the third highest year 2022 where around the same number of gyms were opened and the members joined.
The given data shows that opening of gyms and joining of members followed an upward trend from year 2010 to 2016 and then took a jump in 2018 which was followed by a fall in 2020 due to the covid pandemic.
People are again getting cautious about their health and doing more physical activities in gyms which leads to the opening of more gyms and joining of more members in 2020.

Q6 (B) (i)-(iii) Extract answer book p.3



3

English
Language and Literature

SECTION C
LITERATURE TEXT BOOK

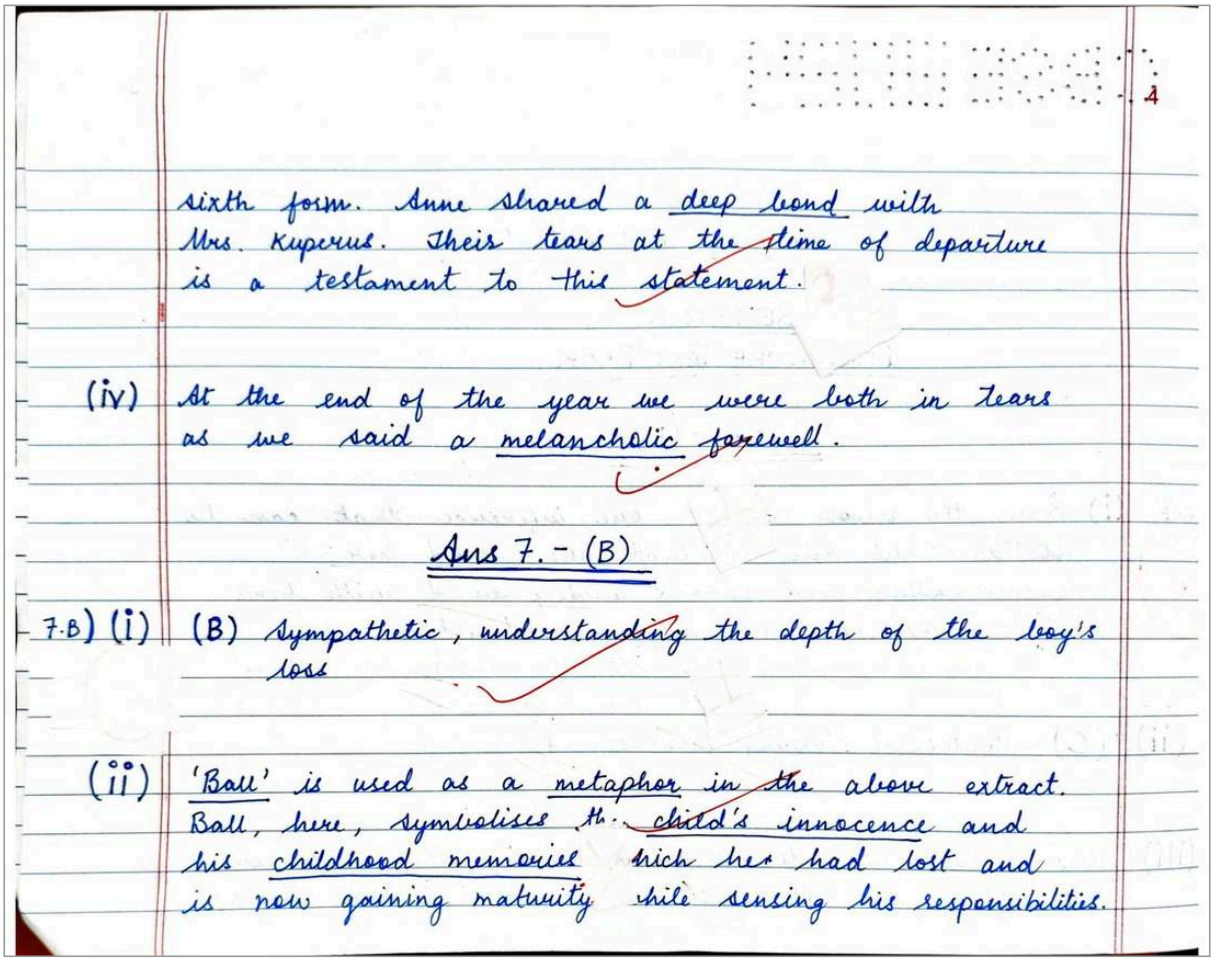
Ans. 6 - (B)

Ans 6.(B)) (i) From the above content, one inference that can be stated about Anne is that she loved her grandmother and shared a deep bond with her. Thus Anne was a loving granddaughter.

(ii) (C) Montessori Nursery School

(iii) Mrs. Kuperus was the headmistress of the Montessori Nursery school. She was Anne's class teacher in her

Q6 (B) (iii), (iv) · Q7 (B) (i), (ii) answer book p.4



4

sixth form. Anne shared a deep bond with Mrs. Kuperus. Their tears at the time of departure is a testament to this statement.

(iv) At the end of the year we were both in tears as we said a melancholic farewell.

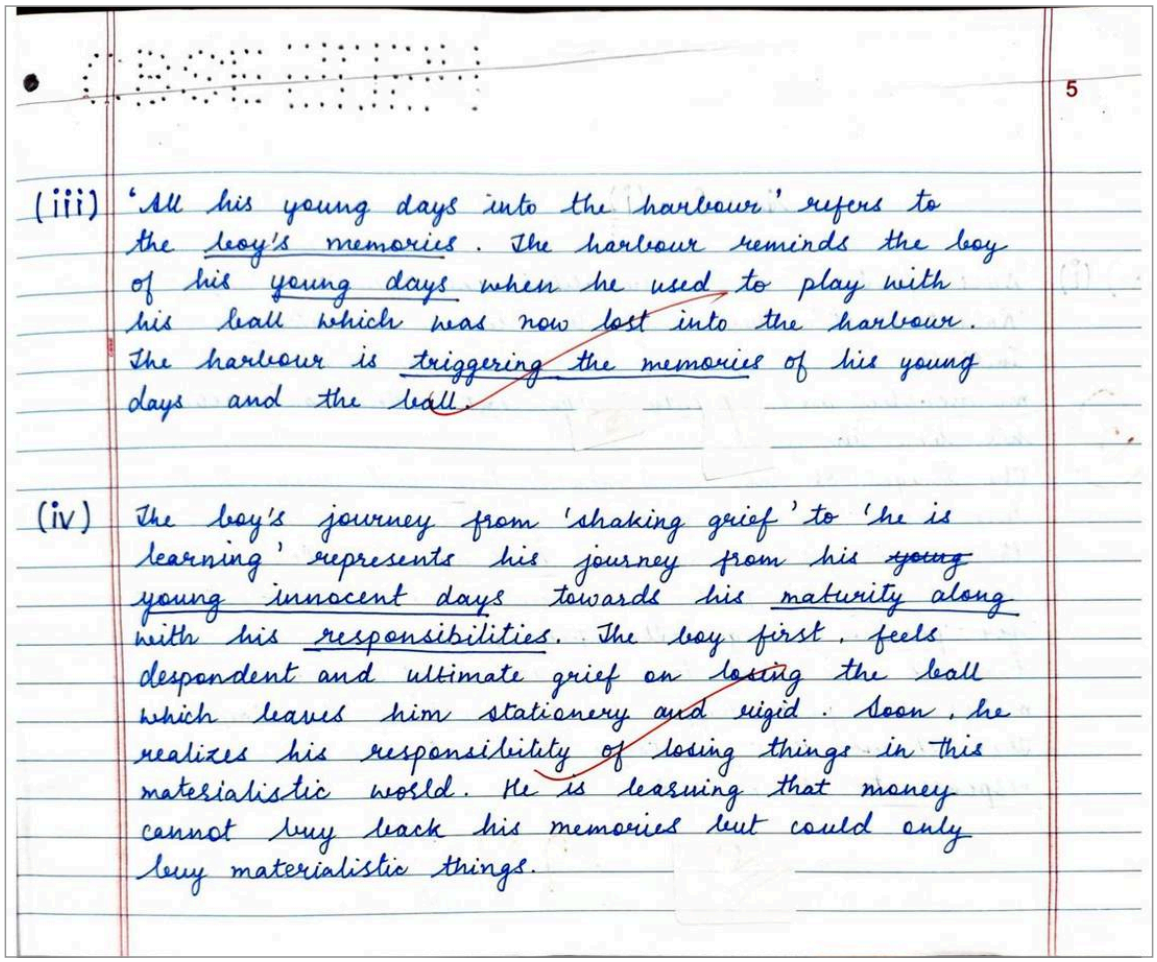
Ans 7. - (B)

7.B) (i) (B) Sympathetic, understanding the depth of the boy's loss

(ii) 'Ball' is used as a metaphor in the above extract. Ball, here, symbolises the child's innocence and his childhood memories which he had lost and is now gaining maturity while sensing his responsibilities.

Q7 (B) (iii), (iv) Extract

answer book p.5



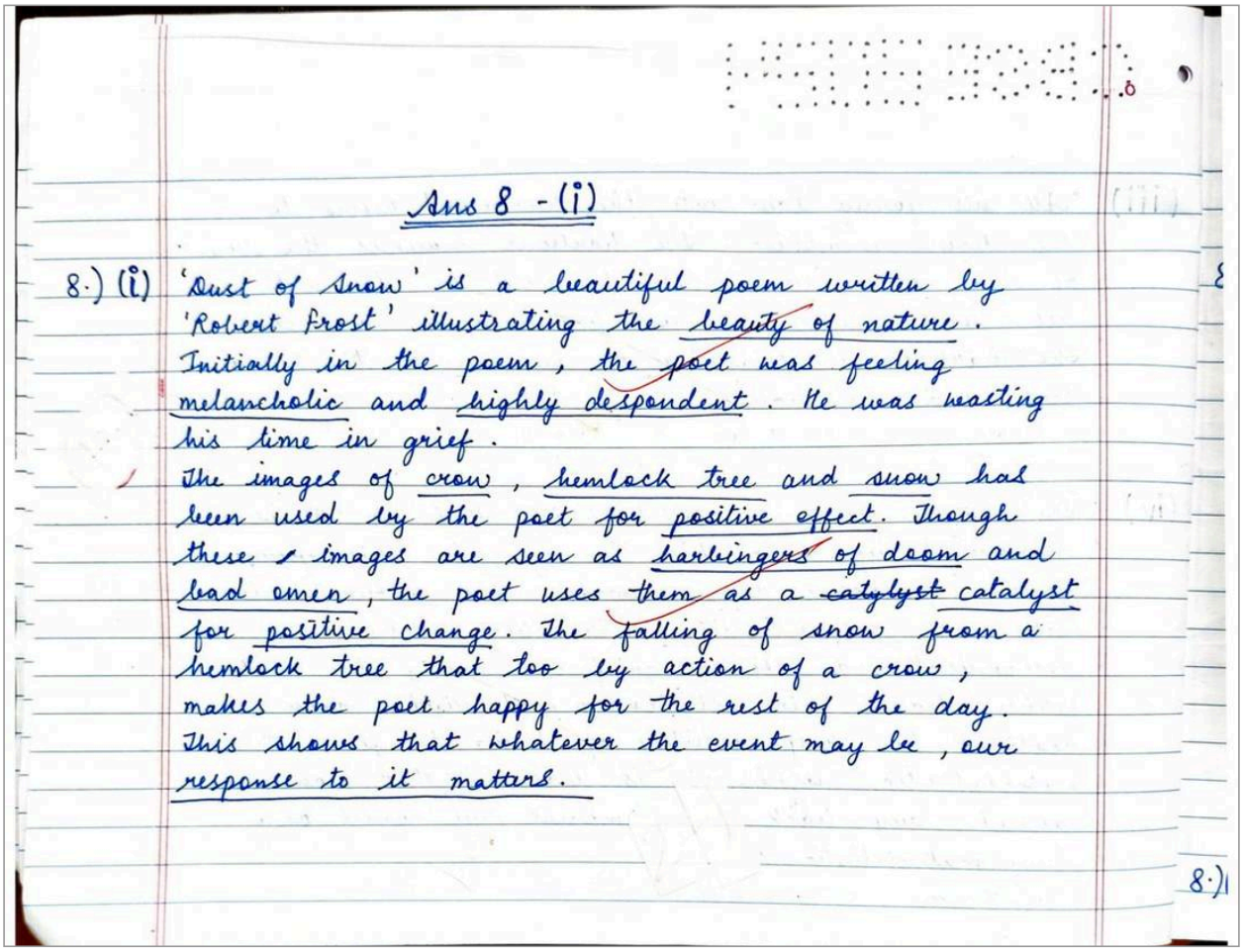
5

(iii) 'All his young days into the harbour' refers to the boy's memories. The harbour reminds the boy of his young days when he used to play with his ball which was now lost into the harbour. The harbour is triggering the memories of his young days and the ball.

(iv) The boy's journey from 'shaking grief' to 'he is learning' represents his journey from his ~~young~~ young innocent days towards his maturity along with his responsibilities. The boy first, feels despondent and ultimate grief on losing the ball which leaves him stationery and rigid. Soon, he realizes his responsibility of losing things in this materialistic world. He is learning that money cannot buy back his memories but could only buy materialistic things.

Q8 (i) Short Answer

answer book p.6



6

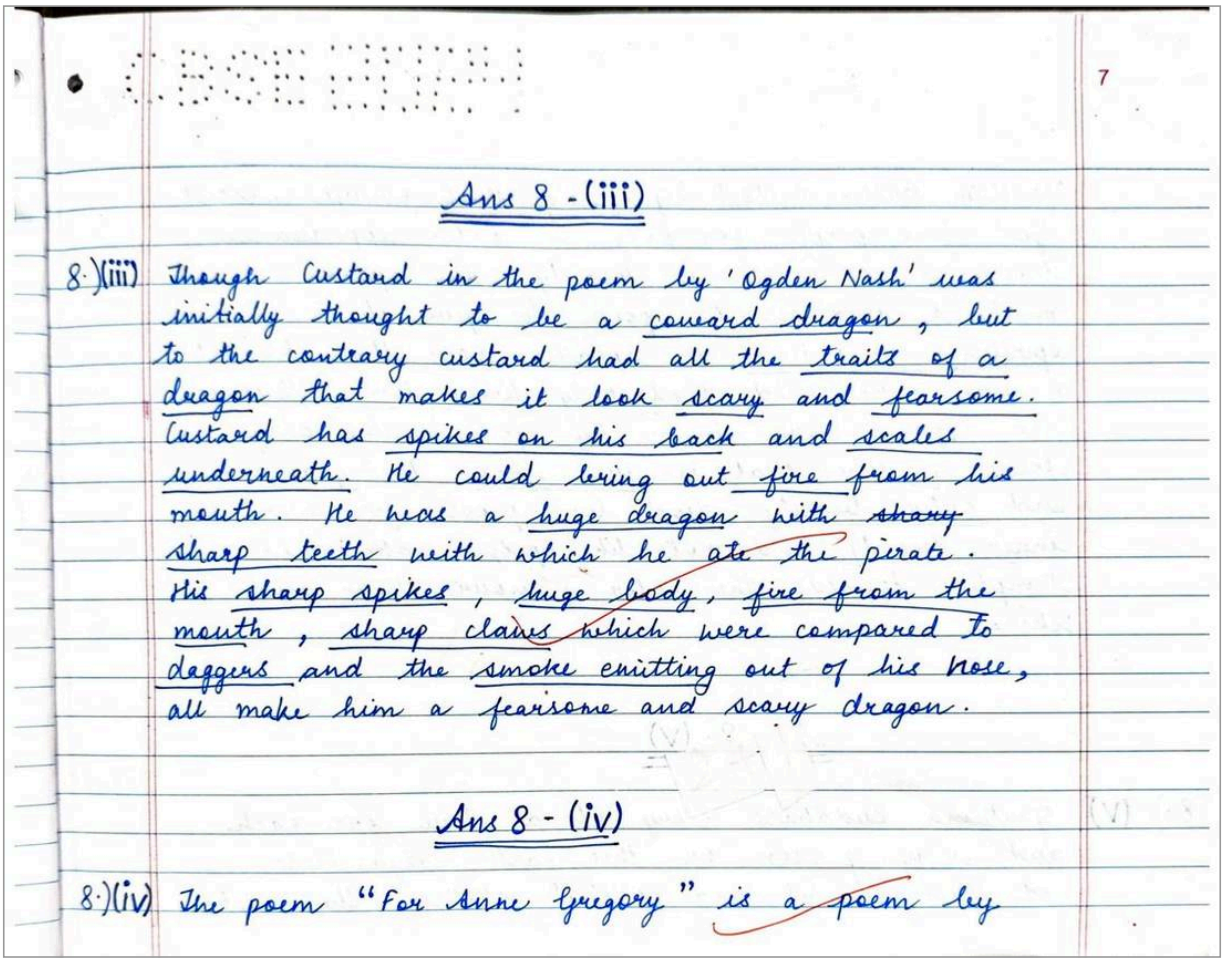
Ans 8 - (i)

8.) (i) 'Dust of Snow' is a beautiful poem written by 'Robert Frost' illustrating the beauty of nature. Initially in the poem, the poet was feeling melancholic and highly despondent. He was wasting his time in grief.

The images of crow, hemlock tree and snow has been used by the poet for positive effect. Though these images are seen as harbingers of doom and bad omen, the poet uses them as a ~~catalyst~~ catalyst for positive change. The falling of snow from a hemlock tree that too by action of a crow, makes the poet happy for the rest of the day. This shows that whatever the event may be, our response to it matters.

8.)

Q8 (iii), (iv) Short Answer answer book p.7



7

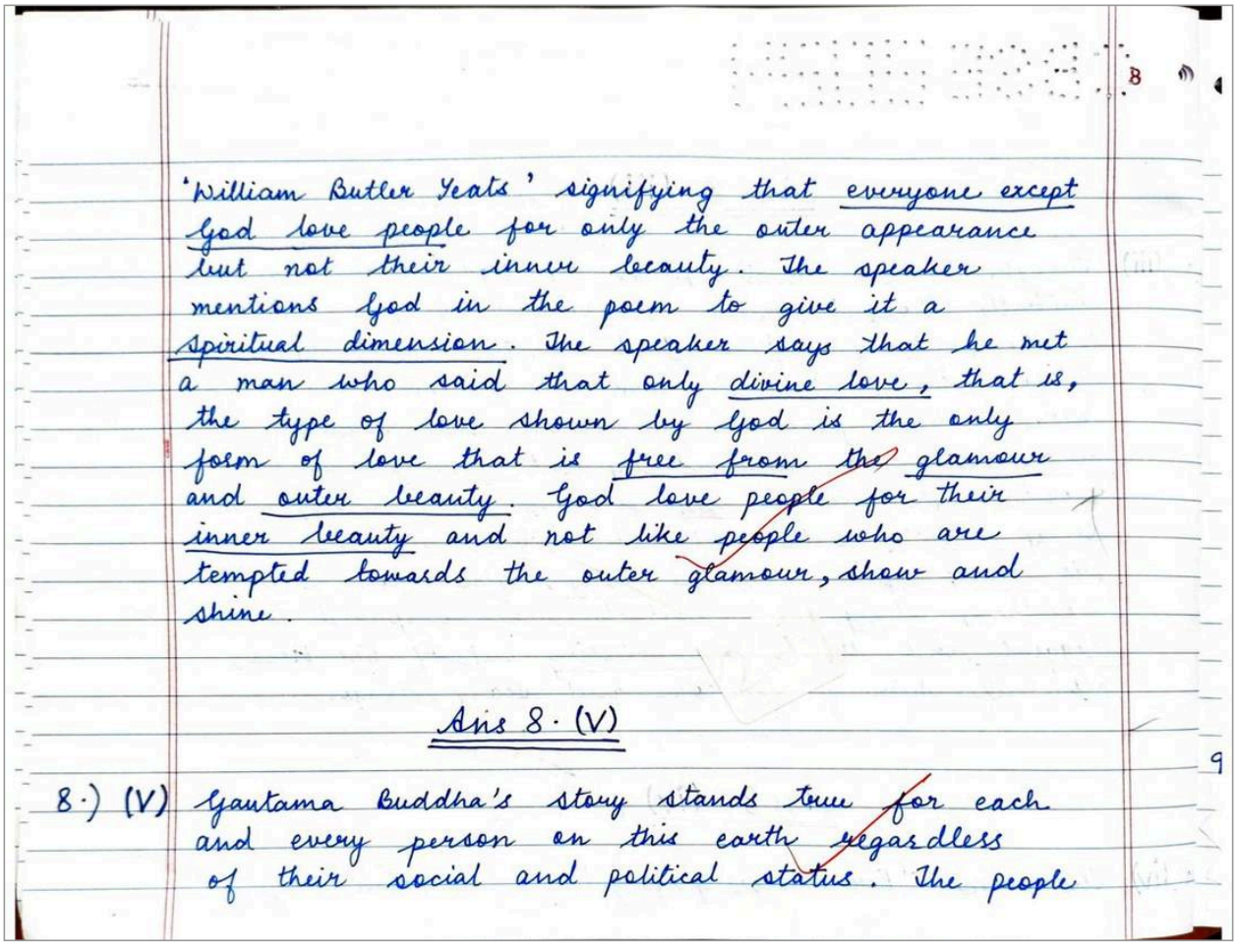
Ans 8 - (iii)

8.)(iii) Though Custard in the poem by 'Ogden Nash' was initially thought to be a coward dragon, but to the contrary custard had all the traits of a dragon that makes it look scary and fearsome. Custard has spikes on his back and scales underneath. He could bring out fire from his mouth. He was a huge dragon with ~~sharp~~ sharp teeth with which he ate the pirate. His sharp spikes, huge body, fire from the mouth, sharp claws which were compared to daggers and the smoke emitting out of his nose, all make him a fearsome and scary dragon.

Ans 8 - (iv)

8.)(iv) The poem "For Anne Gregory" is a poem by

Q8 (iv), (v) Short Answer answer book p.8



8

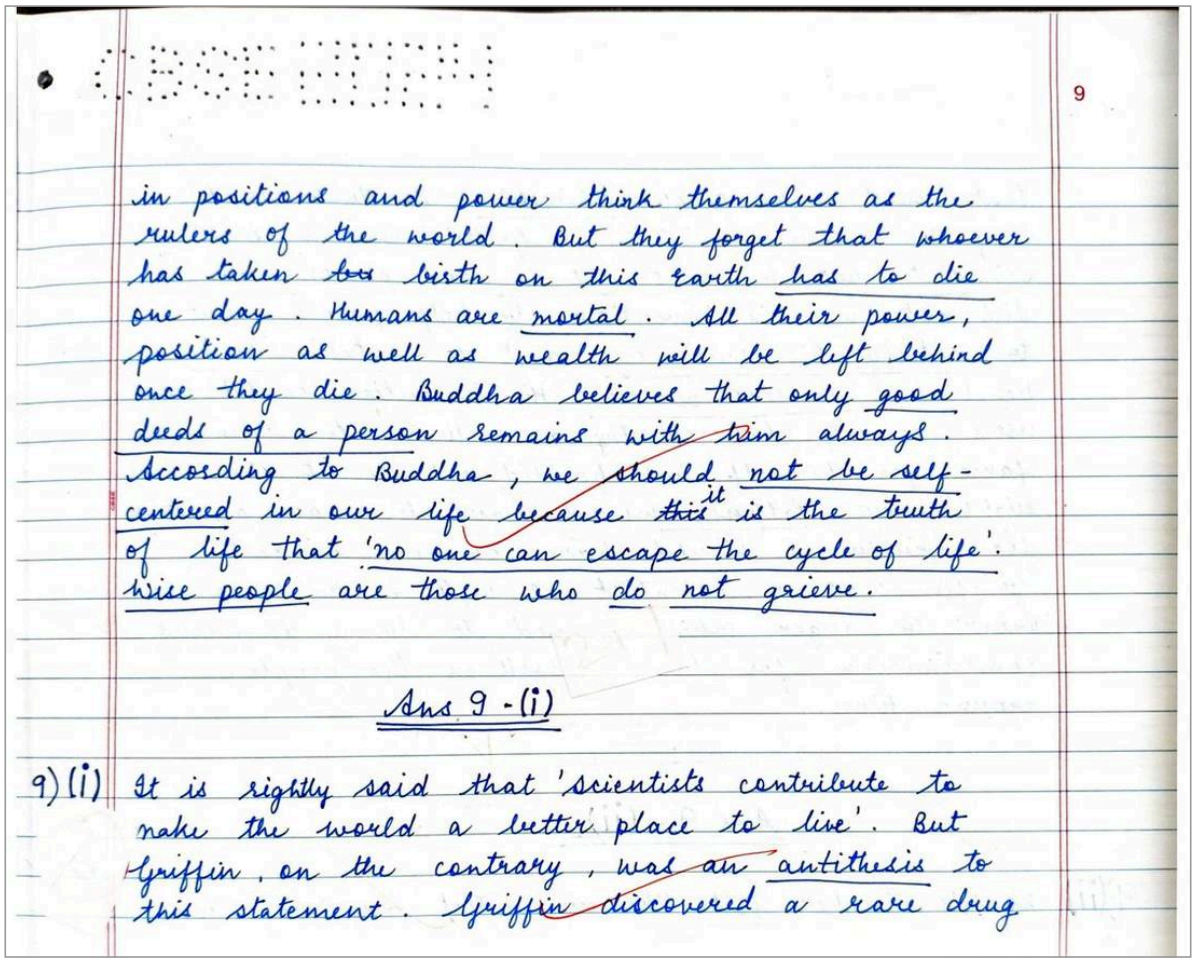
'William Butler Yeats' signifying that everyone except God love people for only the outer appearance but not their inner beauty. The speaker mentions God in the poem to give it a spiritual dimension. The speaker says that he met a man who said that only divine love, that is, the type of love shown by God is the only form of love that is free from the glamour and outer beauty. God love people for their inner beauty and not like people who are tempted towards the outer glamour, show and shine.

Ans 8. (v)

9

8.) (v) Gautama Buddha's story stands true for each and every person on this earth regardless of their social and political status. The people

Q8 (v) · Q9 (i) Short Answer answer book p.9

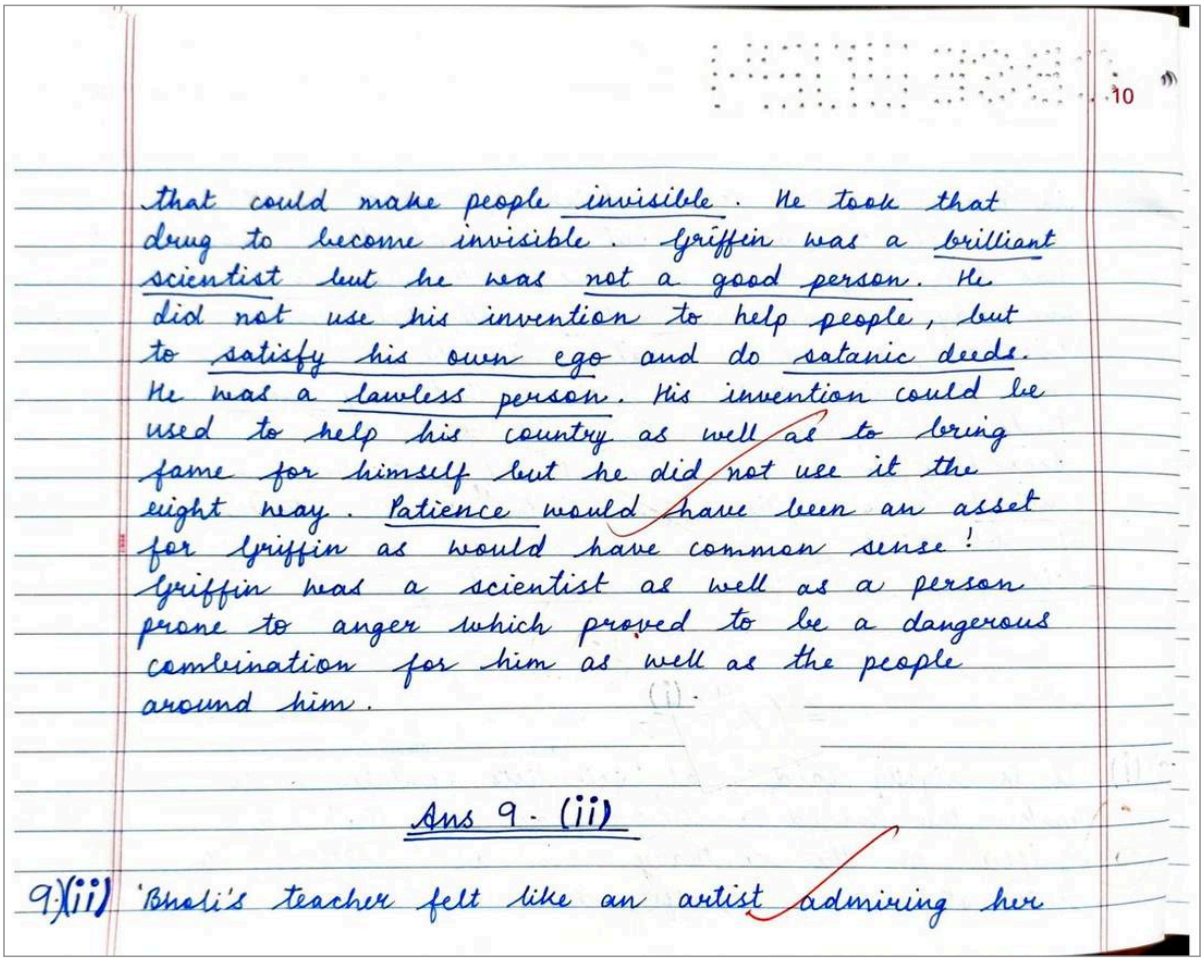


in positions and power think themselves as the rulers of the world. But they forget that whoever has taken ~~bo~~ birth on this earth has to die one day. Humans are mortal. All their power, position as well as wealth will be left behind once they die. Buddha believes that only good deeds of a person remains with him always. Accosding to Buddha, we should not be self-centered in our life because ~~this~~ it is the truth of life that 'no one can escape the cycle of life'. Wise people are those who do not grieve.

Ans 9 - (i)

9) (i) It is rightly said that 'scientists contribute to make the world a better place to live'. But Griffin, on the contrary, was an antithesis to this statement. Griffin discovered a rare drug

Q9 (i), (ii) Short Answer answer book p.10



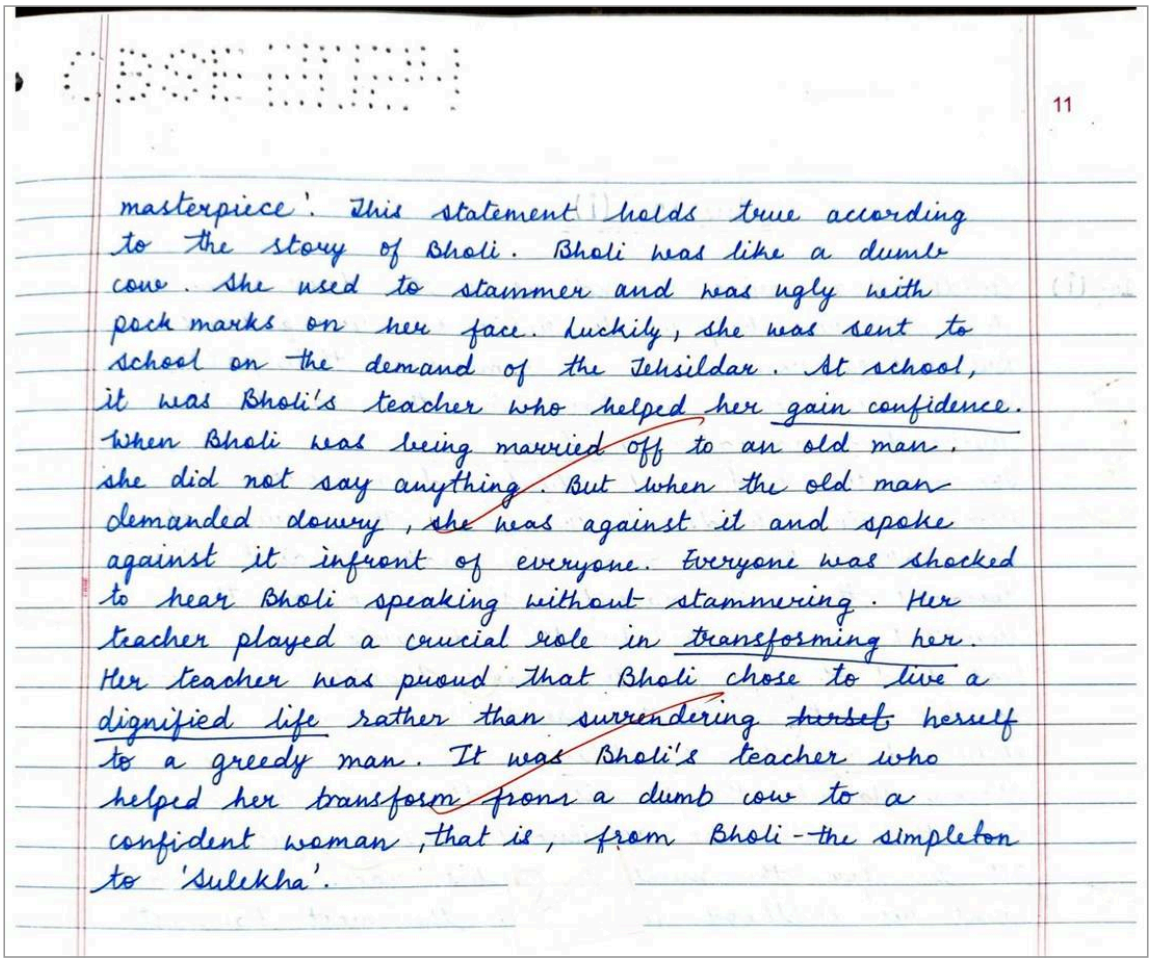
that could make people invisible. He took that drug to become invisible. Griffin was a brilliant scientist but he was not a good person. He did not use his invention to help people, but to satisfy his own ego and do satanic deeds. He was a lawless person. His invention could be used to help his country as well as to bring fame for himself but he did not use it the right way. Patience would have been an asset for Griffin as would have common sense! Griffin was a scientist as well as a person prone to anger which proved to be a dangerous combination for him as well as the people around him.

Ans 9 - (ii)

9) (ii) 'Bholi's teacher felt like an artist admiring her

Q9 (ii) Short Answer (contd.)

answer book p.11

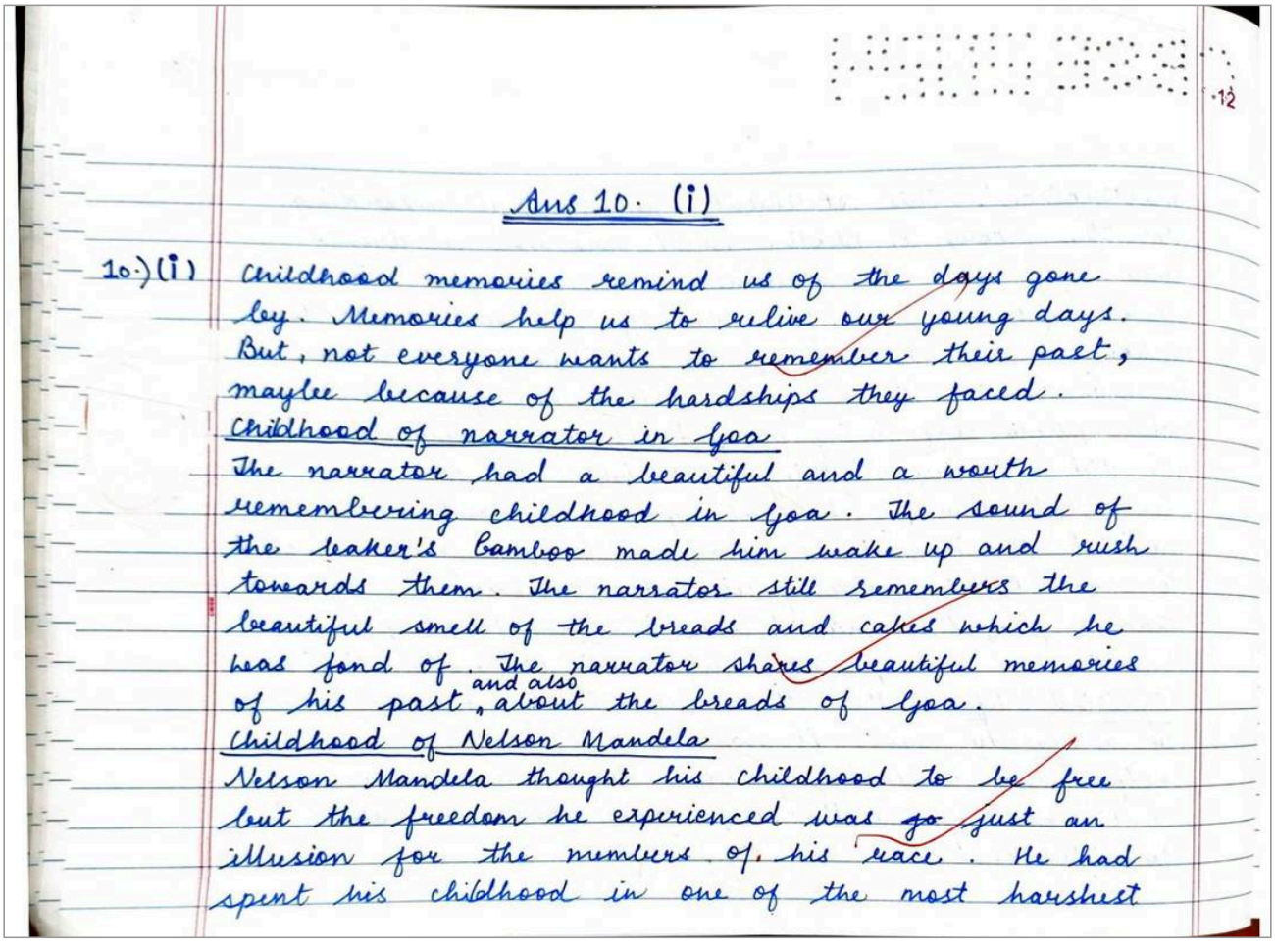


11

masterpiece'. This statement holds true according to the story of Bholi. Bholi was like a dumb cow. She used to stammer and was ugly with pock marks on her face. Luckily, she was sent to school on the demand of the Tehsildar. At school, it was Bholi's teacher who helped her gain confidence. When Bholi was being married off to an old man, she did not say anything. But when the old man demanded dowry, she was against it and spoke against it infront of everyone. Everyone was shocked to hear Bholi speaking without stammering. Her teacher played a crucial role in transforming her. Her teacher was proud that Bholi chose to live a dignified life rather than surrendering ~~herself~~ herself to a greedy man. It was Bholi's teacher who helped her transform from a dumb cow to a confident woman, that is, from Bholi - the simpleton to 'Sulekha'.

Q10 (i) Long Answer

answer book p.12



12

Ans 10. (i)

10.)(i) Childhood memories remind us of the days gone by. Memories help us to relive our young days. But, not everyone wants to remember their past, maybe because of the hardships they faced.

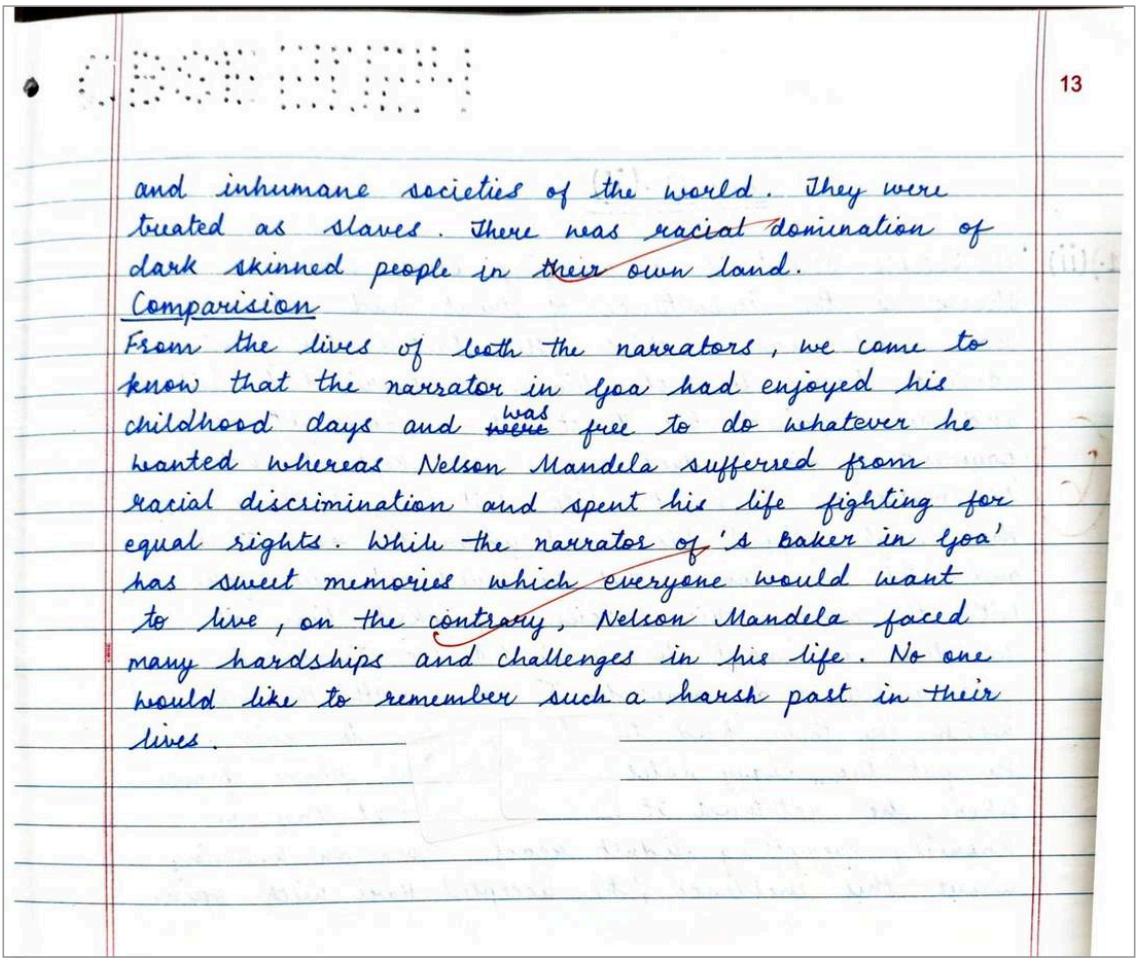
Childhood of narrator in Goa

The narrator had a beautiful and a worth remembering childhood in Goa. The sound of the baker's bamboo made him wake up and rush towards them. The narrator still remembers the beautiful smell of the breads and cakes which he was fond of. The narrator shares beautiful memories of his past, and also about the breads of Goa.

Childhood of Nelson Mandela

Nelson Mandela thought his childhood to be free but the freedom he experienced was ~~so~~ just an illusion for the members of his race. He had spent his childhood in one of the most harshest

Q10 (i) Long Answer (contd.) answer book p.13



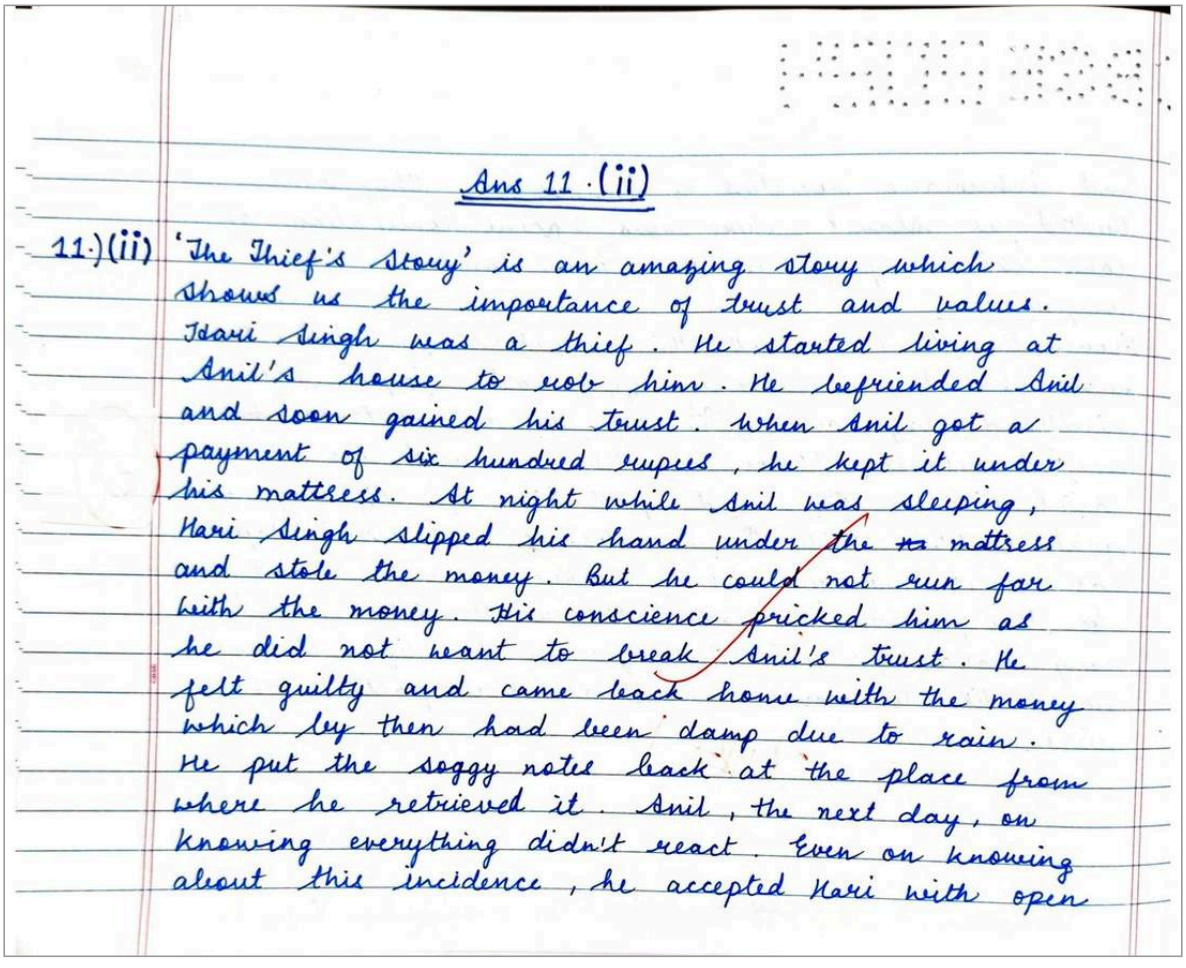
13

and inhumane societies of the world. They were treated as slaves. There was racial domination of dark skinned people in their own land.

Comparision

From the lives of both the narrators, we come to know that the narrator in Goa had enjoyed his childhood days and ~~were~~ was free to do whatever he wanted whereas Nelson Mandela sufferred from racial discrimination and spent his life fighting for equal rights. While the narrator of 'A Baker in Goa' has sweet memories which everyone would want to live, on the contrary, Nelson Mandela faced many hardships and challenges in his life. No one would like to remember such a harsh past in their lives.

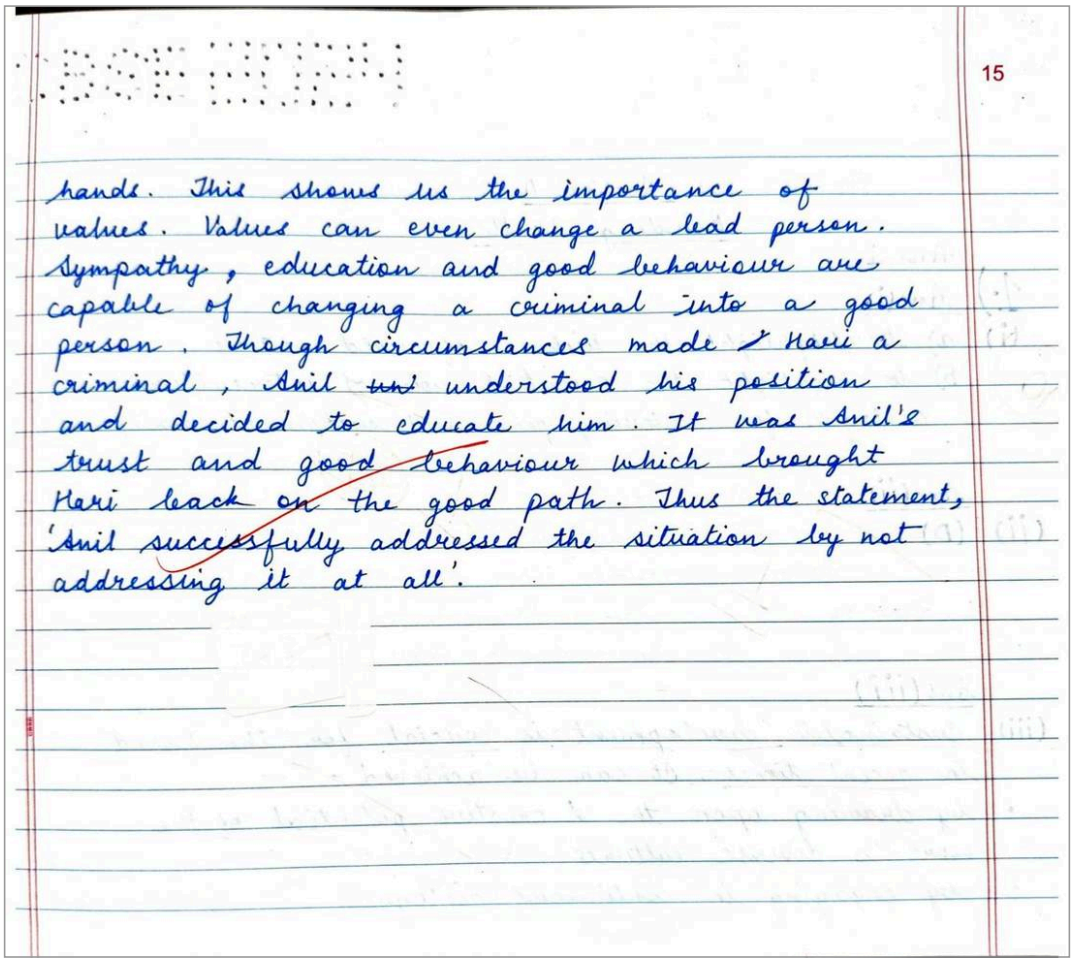
Q11 (ii) Long Answer answer book p.14



Ans 11.(ii)

11.)(ii) 'The Thief's Story' is an amazing story which shows us the importance of trust and values. Hari Singh was a thief. He started living at Anil's house to rob him. He befriended Anil and soon gained his trust. When Anil got a payment of six hundred rupees, he kept it under his mattress. At night while Anil was sleeping, Hari Singh slipped his hand under the ~~a~~ mattress and stole the money. But he could not run far with the money. His conscience pricked him as he did not want to break Anil's trust. He felt guilty and came back home with the money which by then had been damp due to rain. He put the soggy notes back at the place from where he retrieved it. Anil, the next day, on knowing everything didn't react. Even on knowing about this incidence, he accepted Hari with open

Q11 (ii) Long Answer (contd.) answer book p.15



15

hands. This shows us the importance of values. Values can even change a bad person. Sympathy, education and good behaviour are capable of changing a criminal into a good person. Though circumstances made Hari a criminal, Anil ~~and~~ understood his position and decided to educate him. It was Anil's trust and good behaviour which brought Hari back on the good path. Thus the statement, 'Anil successfully addressed the situation by not addressing it at all'.

What to learn from this topper's answer book

- Every answer starts with its question number and part, e.g. Q8 (iii), so the examiner finds it at once.
- Reading and grammar answers are short and exact: only the word, phrase or option that is asked.
- The letter keeps the full format (address, date, receiver, subject, salutation) and lists the details it asks for as clear points.
- The analytical paragraph is built on the figures given in the question, quoted in the answer.
- Literature answers name the characters, stay close to the text and end by tying back to the question.
- The topper wrote Section C first; any order is allowed if each answer is clearly numbered.

Series : HF1EG

Set – 2

Q.P. Code	2/1/2

Roll No.

Candidates must write the Q.P. Code on the title page of the answer-book.

ENGLISH
(Language and Literature)

*Time allowed : **3** hours* *Maximum Marks : **80***

- Please check that this question paper contains **19** printed pages.
- Q.P. Code given on the right hand side of the question paper should be written on the title page of the answer-book by the candidate.
- Please check that this question paper contains **11** questions.
- **Please write down the Serial Number of the question in the answer-book at the given place before attempting it.**
- 15 minute time has been allotted to read this question paper. The question paper will be distributed at 10.15 a.m. From 10.15 a.m. to 10.30 a.m., the candidates will read the question paper only and will not write any answer on the answer-book during this period. #

General Instructions :

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them :

(i) *This question paper comprises **11** questions. All questions are compulsory.*

(ii) *The question paper contains **three** sections :*
***Section A** – Reading Skills*
***Section B** – Grammar and Creative Writing Skills*
***Section C** – Literature*

(iii) *Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.*

SECTION A
Reading Skills

20 marks

1. Read the following passage carefully : *10*

(1) Saffron is a spice that's long been revered across the globe, captivating hearts and palates with its deep-red hue and complex flavour. It is one of the most prized spices that you can find on this planet. Just like gold is among the most valuable metals in the world, saffron means the same in the world of spices. Also known as 'kesar' in Hindi, it has a rich history and is often called an ancient spice. Saffron is being used since ages in various foods made for the royals and the elite as it contains medicinal properties.

(2) Originating from the delicate stigma of the saffron crocus flower, it transforms the ordinary into the extraordinary, infusing dishes with a subtle, earthy sweetness that adds a special taste to the palate. Saffron has a strong exotic aroma and a unique flavour and is used to colour and flavour many Mediterranean and Asian dishes, particularly rice, fish and English, Scandinavian, and Balkan breads.

(3) Saffron forms the backbone of several iconic dishes from around the world, such as the Spanish rice, seafood dish Paella, the French stew Bouillabaisse, Italian rice dish Risotto Milanese, the Indian ice cream Kesar Kulfi, Pakistani rice dish Biryani, and baked Iranian rice Tachin. Saffron's rich red colour is attributed to crocin; its bitter taste, to picrocrocin; and its distinctive aroma, to safranal.

(4) Saffron is cultivated chiefly in Iran but is also grown in Spain, France, Italy, and parts of India. A labour-intensive crop, the three stigmas are handpicked from each flower, spread on trays, and dried over charcoal fires for use as a food flavouring and colouring agent.

(5) Most historians speculate it was first domesticated in Iran, but south-western Greek islands remain strong contenders. Traders, conquerors, and world explorers introduced it to China, India and the Middle East. From there, it travelled to Mediterranean Europe.

(6) The high retail value of saffron is maintained in world markets because of labour-intensive harvesting methods, which require some 444,000 hand-picked saffron stigmas per kilogram — equivalently, 150,000 crocus flowers per kilogram. Forty hours of labour are needed to pick 150,000 flowers. Almost all saffron grows in a belt from Spain in the west to India in the east. Iran is responsible for around 88% of global production. Afghanistan comes second, and Spain is the third largest producer, while the United Arab Emirates, Greece, the Indian subcontinent and Morocco are among minor producers.

(7) Given its high price, adulteration is quite common, unfortunately. Adulterants like beetroot or pomegranate are used to enhance red colour; silk fibres, oil, or wax are used to add bulk, and powdered saffron can be adulterated with turmeric and paprika.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

(i) What is the tone of the writer in the given lines ? *1*

Rationalise your response in about 40 words.

"Saffron is being used since ages in various foods made for the royals and the elite as it contains medicinal properties."

Paragraph (1)

(ii) Which of the following statements best describes the comparison made in the sentence ? *1*

"Just like gold is among the most valuable metals in the world, saffron means the same in the world of spices."

(A) Gold and saffron have similar physical properties.

(B) Gold and saffron have equal monetary value.

(C) Saffron is considered the most valuable spice, similar to how gold is valued among metals.

(D) Gold and saffron are both rare commodities in the global market.

Paragraph (1)

(iii) List any two points why saffron is revered across the globe.
Paragraphs (2) and (3) *2*

(iv) Fill in the blank from the given options : *1*

In the phrase 'backbone of several iconic dishes', the word 'iconic' refers to _____.

(A) delicately cooked

(B) widely recognized

(C) peculiar and rare

(D) strange and infamous Paragraph (3)

(v) Complete the sentence appropriately : *2*

Saffron has a labour-intensive cultivation process which involves _____. Paragraph (4)

(vi) State whether the following statement is True or False : *1*

According to historians, saffron was first used in the kitchens in Iran. Paragraph (5)

(vii) Which of the following statements best describes the reason for saffron's high retail value ? *1*

(A) Due to its magical or mystical properties.

(B) Because it can only be grown in specific regions.

(C) Due to its labour-intensive cultivation process and its relatively low yield per plant.

(D) Because traders, conquerors, and world explorers hoard it.
Paragraph (6)

(viii) Support the writer's view with evidence from the text that saffron is often adulterated. Paragraph (7) *1*

2. Read the following passage carefully : *10*

(1) Silk is a natural protein fibre, some forms of which can be woven into textiles. Silk has a long history in India. It is known as *Resham* in eastern and northern India, and *Pattu* in the southern parts of India. India is the second largest producer of silk in the world after China.

(2) Silk is renowned for its luxurious qualities with a natural soft and smooth texture that feels comfortable on the skin. One of its unique qualities is to absorb and release moisture, regulating the body temperature, and keeping the wearer cool and dry.

(3) Silk is one of the strongest natural fibres, but it loses up to 20% of its strength when wet. Its elasticity is moderate to poor: if elongated even a small amount, it remains stretched. It can be weakened if exposed to too much sunlight. It may also be attacked by insects, especially if left dirty.

(4) The process of silk production is known as sericulture. Silk is produced by several insects; but, generally, only the silk of moth caterpillars has been used for textile manufacturing. To produce 1 kg of silk, 104 kg of mulberry leaves must be eaten by 3000 silkworms.

(5) So what makes silk so costly ? Firstly, cultivation of silk is a labour-intensive work. Secondly, the silk fabric is carefully derived from the larva of the silkworms which spin silk threads around themselves to make from cocoons natural sources. This makes the production limited due to factors like — climate, availability of

quality mulberry leaves and time required by silkworms to complete their lifecycle. Thirdly, the intensive work can only be carried out with specialized knowledge and expertise by skilled artisans and craftsmanship. Lastly, superior quality silk fabrics are made from long and uniform silk fibres giving them a smooth and lustrous appearance. Thus, production requires careful selection, adding to the cost.

In 2021, Karnataka was the highest producer of raw silk at 8483 metric tonnes followed by Andhra Pradesh at 5520 metric tonnes with Assam close behind at 5038 metric tonnes. At the other end of the spectrum there was Chhattisgarh (248 metric tonnes), Nagaland (230 metric tonnes) and UP trailed behind at 179 metric tonnes.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

(i) What does the phrase 'luxurious qualities' in paragraph (2) tell you about the silk fabric ? Write in 40 words with evidence from the text. *2*

(ii) Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. *1*

Assertion : Silk production requires careful selection.

Reason : Long and uniform silk fibres give silk a glossy appearance.

(A) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.

(B) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is ***not*** the correct explanation of the assertion.

(C) The assertion is true, but the reason is false.

(D) The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

(iii) Justify the following statement :

Silk whispers luxury! Its price reflects not just its rarity but the value of the meticulous process behind its creation. *1*

(iv) According to the passage, mention the top two countries that produce silk. *1*

(v) "Factors like climate, availability of quality mulberry leaves and time required by silkworms to complete their lifecycle are important factors for the production of silk."

State any one inference that can be drawn from this. *1*

(vi) Complete the following with a suitable reason from the text :

Though silk is considered one of the strongest fibres, it is _____. *1*

(vii) Based on the given text, mention the states which produced the most and the least amount of raw silk in India in the year 2021. *1*

(viii) Complete the sentence suitably.

104 kgs of mulberry leaves eaten by 3000 silkworms results in _____. *1*

(ix) With reference to the given passage, give one reason why silk production is considered labour-intensive. *1*

SECTION B

Grammar and Creative Writing Skills *20 marks*

Grammar

3. Complete any ***ten*** of the following twelve tasks, as directed. *10×1=10*

(i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the brackets, for the given portion of a letter. *1*

'Thank you for _____ (consider) my application. I look forward to working in your organization.

(ii) Read the given sentence. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

Ninety-seven percent of the Earth's water is salty ocean water and another two percent is trapping in the Earth's ice caps and glaciers. *1*

Error	*Correction*

(iii) Yukti and Sanjay had a conversation about going to a restaurant. Report Yukti's question. *1*

"Does this restaurant serve good South Indian food ?"

(iv) Read the dialogue between Amit and his sister Ananya, regarding her travel to the railway station. *1*

Amit : Are you sure you can manage to go to the railway station on your own ?

Ananya : Oh yes! I have already booked a cab.

Select the correct option to report the above dialogue.

Amit asked Ananya _____ to go to the railway station on her own. Ananya replied in the affirmative and said that she had already booked a cab.

(A) if she is sure she can manage

(B) if she was sure she could manage

(C) if she surely can manage

(D) if she was sure to managing

(v) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete the sentence taken from a book about 'Birds'. *1*

Each year, thousands of birds _____ (migrate/immigrate/emigrate) southwards to avoid the harsh winter, embarking on an incredible journey that spans thousands of miles.

(vi) Identify and correct the error in the given line taken from an agency's advertisement. *1*

Tell us much about your project and we'll select suitable candidates for you to hire.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	*Correction*

(vii) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line taken from an article about growing obesity.

Obesity in teenage children is a major concern between parents today. *1*

Option No.	*Error*	*Correction*
(A)	teenage	teenagers
(B)	concern	concerns
(C)	between	among
(D)	today	now

(viii) Complete the given narrative with the correct option to fill in the blank. *1*

Yesterday, Tanu walked to the park and _____ a breezy evening.

(A) to enjoying
(B) will enjoy
(C) enjoyed
(D) did enjoyed

(ix) Report the dialogue between two friends by completing the sentence. *1*

Bhawna : I finished the project yesterday.

Sohail : That's great ! Are you going to present it tomorrow ?

Bhawna told Sohail that _____. Sohail responded that it was great and asked if she were going to present it the next day.

(x) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the notice on a school notice board. *1*

We are pleased to announce that our Annual Sports Day _____ on 30th April, 2025 at the school playground from 9 a.m. to 3 p.m.

(A) is held

(B) will be held

(C) had been held

(D) to be held

(xi) Complete the slogan on "Save Earth", by filling in the blank with the correct option.

Lets join hands, cultivate conservation, and _____ a greener tomorrow for generations to come. *1*

(A) ensuring

(B) ensure

(C) ensures

(D) ensured

(xii) Identify the error and supply the correction for the following note in an air purifier's instruction manual. *1*

The plug should fit upto the outlet. If it doesn't fit, do not force it in.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	*Correction*

Writing

Note : *All details presented in the questions in the writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.*

4. Attempt any ***one*** from (a) and (b) given below : *5*

(a) You are Rashmi / Roshan, a concerned citizen, residing at G-16, Himmat Path, Nayanagar. Compose a letter in about 120 words to the Director, Municipal Corporation, drawing his attention to the open drains in your colony. The drains are not only the breeding ground for disease-causing organisms but are also polluting the surrounding areas, especially the water bodies which could lead to water-borne diseases. Suggest measures for addressing this issue.

OR

(b) You are Mamta / Manish, a student of Grade 11 of Hitech Public School Roopbagh. You have recently volunteered as a student-teacher in a three-week literacy camp held for the children of construction site workers in your neighbourhood. It was a fulfilling and a meaningful experience for you. It sensitized you to the needs of the community, boosted your confidence, and improved your social skills. Write a letter in about 120 words to the editor of a national daily expressing your views on the benefits of volunteering and how students can contribute to the betterment of society.

5. Attempt any ***one*** from (a) and (b) given below : *5*

(a) In the past few years, the teaching-learning process has taken a leap and gone beyond the four walls of the classroom. Today, it has become possible to learn not just by sitting in a physical classroom, but from anywhere. Given below is a chart depicting the differences between E-learning and Classroom learning. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, assessing the benefits and drawbacks of both, by selecting features that support your analysis.

E-learning	**vs. Classroom learning**
• accessible anytime anywhere • at your own pace • no travel costs, saves time	• same place, same time • caters to the needs of the class • transportation cost and time consuming

OR

(b) Read the given details of a computer.

* electronic device that can store and process information
* makes life easy and simple
* physical description — monitor, keyboard, CPU and mouse
* computer technology used in all fields — education, medicine, commerce, entertainment

Analyse the details and write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words about the description and role of computers in today's world.

SECTION C

Literature *40 marks*

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any ***one*** of the given two, (a) or (b) : *5*

(a) Not a leaf remained on the trees. The corn was totally destroyed. The flowers were gone from the plants. Lencho's soul was filled with sadness. When the storm had passed, he stood in the middle of the field and said to his sons, "A plague of locusts would have left more than this. The hail has left nothing. This year we will have no corn."

That night was a sorrowful one.

"All our work, for nothing."

"There's no one who can help us."

"We'll all go hungry this year."

(A Letter to God)

(i) Why were there no leaves left on the trees ? *1*

(A) The locusts ate them up.

(B) An earthquake had occurred.

(C) There was a hailstorm.

(D) The animals grazed on them.

(ii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets.

Lencho felt _____ (jubilant/devastated) when he saw his destroyed corn fields. *1*

(iii) When Lencho says, "All our work, for nothing," what does he refer to ? Explain in about 40 words. *2*

(iv) Why would Lencho have preferred a plague of locusts to a hailstorm ? *1*

OR

(b) Later, he patted me on the head and said never mind, he'd teach me to cook. He also taught me to write my name and said he would soon teach me to write whole sentences and to add numbers. I was grateful. I knew that once I could write like an educated man there would be no limit to what I could achieve.

It was quite pleasant working for Anil. I made the tea in the morning and then would take my time buying the day's supplies, usually making a profit of about a rupee a day. I think he knew I made a little money this way but he did not seem to mind.

(The Thief's Story)

(i) What does the following line tell us about the character of Anil ?

"I think he knew I made a little money this way but he did not seem to mind." *1*

(ii) Which of the following best describes the realization Hari Singh had while working for Anil ? *1*

(A) that he would become a rich person one day

(B) that Anil was a very intelligent master but a miser

(C) that he would be able to accomplish a lot if he gets educated

(D) that Anil made a lot of money from his job

(iii) What did Anil promise to teach Hari Singh, and how did Hari Singh feel about the opportunity to learn ? Answer in about 40 words. *2*

(iv) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. *1*

The narrator earned extra money by making a/an _____ (profit/investment) of about a rupee a day.

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any ***one*** of the given two, (a) or (b) : *5*

(a) "I heard an old religious man
But yesternight declare
That he had found a text to prove
That only God, my dear,
Could love you for yourself alone
And not your yellow hair." (For Anne Gregory)

(i) Complete the sentence appropriately : *1*

The speaker addresses the person he is speaking to as "my dear" because _____.

(ii) The poet mentions "yellow hair". What is its significance in the context of the statement ? Answer in about 40 words. *2*

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. *1*

The poet suggests that God's love in comparison to that of a human being is _____ (selfish/selfless).

(iv) As per the above extract, what attributes does God not love a person for ? Select the correct option. *1*

1. Wealth
2. Physical appearance
3. Intelligence
4. Inner qualities
5. Youth

(A) 1 and 4
(B) 3, 4, and 5
(C) 2 and 4
(D) Only 4

OR

(b) He stalks in his vivid stripes
The few steps of his cage,
On pads of velvet quiet,
In his quiet rage.
He should be lurking in shadow,
Sliding through long grass

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

(i) Identify and name any one figure of speech in the above extract. *2*

(ii) Fill in the blank with one word. *1*

The tiger's stalking on 'pads of velvet' suggests a movement that is _____.

(iii) Based on the given lines from the poem, which words would best describe the feelings of the tiger ? *1*

(A) Calm and content

(B) Both subdued and angry

(C) Both frustrated and happy

(D) Both angry and famished

(iv) Select the option that applies the same rhyme scheme as the first four lines of the given extract. *1*

(A) The people along the sand
All turn and look one way
They turn their back on the land
They look at the sea all day

(B) Along the sand, the people
All turn and look one way
They turn back on the sand
They look at the sea all day

(C) The people along the sand
Look one way and all turn
Their backs on the land
They look at the sea all day

(D) The people along the sand
They turn their back on the land
They look one way
At the sea all day.

8. Answer any ***four*** of the following five questions in 40 – 50 words each : *4×3=12*

(i) Why does the author use the phrase "that drove a law-abiding citizen to become a criminal" to describe Mandela ?

(Nelson Mandela – Long Walk to Freedom)

(ii) What happened to the poet when a dust of snow fell on him ?

(Dust of Snow)

(iii) How does the author support the view that the people of Coorg are possibly of Arabic descent ?

(Glimpses of India – Coorg)

(iv) Mention two points of difference between a Bengal tiger and an Asiatic lion.

(How to Tell Wild Animals)

(v) What efforts did the narrator make to get his mail from Europe ?

(Mijbil the Otter)

9. Answer any ***two*** of the following three questions in 40 – 50 words each : *2×3=6*

(i) Analyze how Herriot uses Tricki and Mrs. Pumphrey's relationship to comment on societal attitudes towards pets and the responsibilities associated with their care.

(A Triumph of Surgery)

(ii) Today reading books is on the decline because of the prevalence of electronic media. Contrarily, earth is saved by a 'Book' in the chapter "The Book That Saved the Earth". Elaborate.

(iii) Discuss the character development of Griffin, as he grapples with the repercussions of his actions and attempts to navigate a world, where his once extraordinary abilities have become a burden.

(Footprints without Feet)

10. Answer any ***one*** of the following two questions in 100 – 120 words : *6*

(a) Amanda and Valli both represent a longing for freedom. Examine the above observation with reference to the two texts.

(Amanda and Madam Rides the Bus)

OR

(b) In 'The Ball Poem", Berryman explores the themes of loss, growing up, and transformation. Mandela also experienced loss of freedom and suffering along with his countrymen during his growing years on the basis of his race and colour.

Compare and contrast the commonality of themes in both the texts.

(The Ball Poem and Nelson Mandela – Long Walk to Freedom)

11. Answer any ***one*** of the following two questions in 100 – 120 words : *6*

(a) How did the lady in red manage to outsmart and outmaneuver the other thief, Horace Danby, by robbing the safe without leaving a single fingerprint ?

(A Question of Trust)

OR

(b) How did Mr. & Mrs. Loisel replace the lost necklace ? What kind of life did the Loisels lead thereafter ?

(The Necklace)

Q.P. Code: 2/1/2	
Marking Scheme Strictly Confidential (For Internal and Restricted use only) Secondary School Examination, 2025 ENGLISH LANGUAE & LITERATURE - 184(SET- 2/1/2)	
General Instructions: -	
1	You are aware that evaluation is the most important process in the actual and correct assessment of the candidates. A small mistake in evaluation may lead to serious problems which may affect the future of the candidates, education system and teaching profession. To avoid mistakes, it is requested that before starting evaluation, you must read and understand the spot evaluation guidelines carefully.
2	**"Evaluation policy is a confidential policy as it is related to the confidentiality of the examinations conducted, Evaluation done and several other aspects. Its' leakage to public in any manner could lead to derailment of the examination system and affect the life and future of millions of candidates. Sharing this policy/document to anyone, publishing in any magazine and printing in News Paper/Website etc. may invite action under various rules of the Board and IPC."**
3	Evaluation is to be done as per instructions provided in the Marking Scheme. It should not be done according to one's own interpretation or any other consideration. Marking Scheme should be strictly adhered to and religiously followed. **If any change in the marking scheme is to be considered, this has to be raised with the Controller of Examinations and only after his approval and after all evaluation centres are informed, can this be taken forward.**
4	The Marking Scheme carries all value points for the answers. Students may/can express these value points in their own words and if the expression is correct, due marks should be awarded accordingly.
5	The Head-Examiner must go through the first five answer books evaluated by each evaluator on the first day, to ensure that evaluation has been carried out as per the instructions given in the Marking Scheme. If there is any variation, the same should be zero after deliberation and discussion. The remaining answer books meant for evaluation shall be given only after ensuring that there is no significant variation in the marking of individual evaluators.
6	Evaluators will mark (√) wherever answer is correct. For wrong answer CROSS 'X" be marked. No answer should be left unmarked by evaluators. **This is the most common mistake which evaluators are committing.**
7	If a question has parts, please award marks on the right-hand side for each part. Marks awarded for different parts of the question should then be totalled up and written in the left-hand margin and encircled. This must be followed strictly.
8	If a question does not have any parts, marks must be awarded in the left-hand margin and encircled. This must also be followed strictly.
9	If a student has **attempted an extra question**, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note **"Extra Question/Over- Attempted"**. If a student has **not attempted** any question, **NA** should be mentioned in the Caging / marks entry column.

10	No marks to be deducted for the cumulative effect of an error. It should be penalized only once.
11	A full scale of marks _____(example 0 to 80/70/60/50/40/30 marks as given in Question Paper) has to be used. Please do not hesitate to award full marks if the answer deserves it.
12	Every examiner has to necessarily do evaluation work for full working hours i.e., 8 hours every day and evaluate 20 answer books per day in main subjects and 25 answer books per day in other subjects (Details are given in Spot Guidelines).
13	Ensure that you do not make the following common types of errors committed by the Examiner in the past:- ● Leaving answer or part thereof unassessed in an answer booklet. ● Giving more marks for an answer than assigned to it. ● Wrong totalling of marks awarded on an answer. ● Wrong transfer of marks from the inside pages of the answer booklet to the title page. ● Wrong question wise totalling on the title page. ● Wrong totalling of marks of the two columns on the title page. ● Wrong grand total. ● Marks in words and figures not tallying/not same. ● Wrong transfer of marks from the answer book to online award list. ● Answers marked as correct, but marks not awarded. (Ensure that the right tick mark is correctly and clearly indicated. It should merely be a line. Same is with the X for incorrect answer.) ● Half or a part of answer marked correct and the rest as wrong, but no marks awarded.
14	While evaluating the answer books if the answer is found to be totally incorrect, it should be marked as cross (X) and awarded zero (0)Marks.
15	Any unassessed portion, non-carrying over of marks to the title page, or totalling error detected by the candidate shall damage the prestige of all the personnel engaged in the evaluation work as also of the Board. Hence, in order to uphold the prestige of all concerned, it is again reiterated that the instructions be followed meticulously and judiciously.
16	The Examiners should acquaint themselves with the guidelines given in the "**Guidelines for Spot Evaluation**" before starting the actual evaluation.
17	Every Examiner shall also ensure that all the answers are evaluated, marks carried over to the title page, correctly totalled and written in figures and words.
18	It may be noted that the candidates are entitled to obtain photocopy of the Answer Book on request on payment of the prescribed processing fee. All Examiners/Additional Head Examiners/Head Examiners are once again reminded that they must ensure that evaluation is carried out strictly as per value points for each answer as given in the Marking Scheme.

Set-2

QP CODE-2/1/2

MARKING SCHEME
English Language and Literature (Code No. 184)
CLASS-X (2024-25)

SECTION A- 20 marks Reading		
QNO		**MARKS**
1.	**Passage 1**	**10 marks**
i.	• Tone – Informative / objective / formal / appreciative • Rationalization - Writer - presented factual information about the historical use of Saffron - its medicinal properties, without any particular emotional or subjective bias.	½ + ½
ii.	(C) Saffron is considered to be the most valuable spice, similar to how gold is valued among metals.	**1**
iii.	• (Any Two Value Points) • Being used since ages in various foods made for the royals and elites/ Forms the backbone of several iconic dishes from around the world • Contains medicinal properties. • Has strong aroma and unique flavour. • Has high retail value because of labour-intensive harvesting methods.	**1 + 1**
iv.	(B) widely recognised	**1**
v.	• (Any Two Value Points) • hand-picking / drying over charcoal fires/spread on trays/ forty hours of labour	**1 + 1**
vi.	True	**1**
vii.	(C) Due to its labour - intensive cultivation process and its relatively low yield per plant.	**1**
viii.	**(Any Two Value Points)** • Beetroot and pomegranate are used as adulterants to enhance red colour of Saffron • because of its high price, adulteration is quite common • silk fibres, oil or wax – used to add bulk • Powdered saffron can be adulterated with turmeric and paprika	½ + ½

2.	**Passage 2**	**10 Marks**
i.	• (Any Two Value Points) • Soft and smooth texture • Feels comfortable on skin • Absorbs, releases moisture	**1 + 1**
ii.	(A) Both the assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion	**1**
iii.	**(Any One Value Point)** • Labour-intensive cultivation. • Limited production due to natural factors. • Specialized knowledge, expertise required. • Careful selection for superior quality.	**1**
iv.	China and India	**½ + ½**
v.	• This makes the production limited/cost high/ (any other correct response to be accepted) •	**1**
vi.	**(Any One Value Point)** • easily damaged as it loses 20% strength when wet • moderate to poor elasticity • weakened when exposed to sunlight • if dirty – attacked by insects	**1**
vii.	• Karnataka produced the most amount • Uttar Pradesh produced the least amount.	**½ + ½**
viii.	• …production of 1 kg of silk	**1**
ix.	It requires specialised knowledge / expertise by skilled artisans and craftsmanship.	**1**
	SECTION B **Grammar and Creative Writing Skills**	**20 marks**
	GRAMMAR	**10 Marks**
3.	• Any ten out of twelve questions to be attempted/marked. • Full credit 1 mark for correct answers • No partial credit	**10 x 1 = 10**
i.	Considering	**1**
ii.	trapping – trapped	**1**
iii.	Yukti asked Sanjay if/whether that restaurant served good South Indian food	**1**

iv.	(B) If she was sure she could manage.	**1**
v.	Migrate	**1**
vi.	ERROR – Much CORRECTION – More/ Something	**1**
vii.	(C) between – among	**1**
viii.	(C) enjoyed	**1**
ix.	She had finished the project the day before/ the previous day	**1**
x.	(B) will be held	**1**
xi.	(B) ensure	**1**
xii.	ERROR – upto CORRECTION - into	**1**
	WRITING SKILLS	**10 Marks**
4.	**Formal Letter Writing - Any one from (a) and (b) to be attempted**	**5**
a.	• **Format** – 1 mark (no mark for format alone if content is irrelevant or missing, full credit of 1 mark if all aspects are mentioned. • Partial credit of ½ mark if one or two aspects are missing • No credit if more than two aspects are missing • **Organisation of ideas** – 1 mark (effective style, orderly sequence, paragraphed structure and formal tone and vocabulary) • **Accuracy** – 1 mark (spelling, punctuation and grammar) • **Content** – 2 marks (Any two value points) ➢ **Topic Introduction** : Open drains in your colony ➢ **Problem** – Breeding ground for diseases- causing organisms/ polluting the surrounding areas/polluting the water bodies – water borne diseases ➢ **Suggestive measures** – Sprinkle insecticides / cover the drains etc. • (Any other relevant point to be accepted)	1+1+1+2
	OR	
b.	• **Format** – 1 mark (no mark for format alone if content is irrelevant or missing, full credit of 1 mark if all aspects are mentioned. • Partial credit of ½ mark if one or two aspects are missing • No credit if more than two aspects are missing	1+1+1+2

	• **Organisation of ideas** – 1 mark (effective style, orderly sequence, paragraphed structure and formal tone and vocabulary) • **Accuracy** – 1 mark (spelling, punctuation and grammar) • **Content** – 2 marks (Any two value points) • **Introduction of Topic** – three week literacy camp – for construction workers' children • **Experience –** fulfilling and meaningful/ sensitized to the needs of the community/ boosted confidence/ improved social skills • **Suggestive Measures** – hold more such camps, incentives to the participants etc. • (Any other relevant point to be accepted)	
5.	• Analytical Paragraph Writing - Any one from (a) and (b) to be attempted.	**5**
a.	• **Organisation of ideas** – 2 (effective style, orderly sequence, single paragraph structure, formal tone and functional vocabulary, **Linking words and phrases like**: however, in addition to, in contrast to, therefore etc. should be included) • **Accuracy** – 1 (spelling, punctuation and grammar) • **Content** – 2 marks • Full credit of 2 marks for all value points given in the question • Partial credit of 1 mark if only two value points are given ➢ At least any two value points from those given below to be included – ➢ E-Learning – Accessible, anytime, anywhere ; At your own pace ; no travel cost, saves time • **VS** ➢ Classroom Learning – same place, same time ; caters to the needs of the class ; transportation cost and time consuming	2+1+2
	• OR	
b.	• **Organisation of ideas** – 2 (effective style, orderly sequence, single paragraph structure, formal tone and functional vocabulary, **Linking words and phrases like:** however, in addition to, in contrast to, therefore etc. should be included) • **Accuracy** – 1 (spelling, punctuation and grammar) • **Content** – 2 marks • Full credit of 2 marks for all value points given in the question • Partial credit of 1 mark if only two value points are given ➢ At least any two value points from those given below to be included –	2+1+2

	• Electronic device that can store and process information • makes life easy and simple • physical description – monitor, keyboard, CPU and mouse • computer technology used in all fields – education, medicine, commerce and entertainment	
	SECTION C **Literature Textbook and Supplementary Reading Text**	**40 Marks**
6.	**Answer the questions for any one from the given two extracts (a) and (b).**	**5**
a.		
i.	(C) There was a hailstorm	**1**
ii.	Devastated	**1**
iii.	• (Any Two Value Points) • All his effort put in the field had gone in vain. • The storm had destroyed his cornfields. • He will not be able to earn any money as the crops were destroyed.	**1+1**
iv.	A few leaves would have been left	**1**
	OR	
b.		
i.	**(Any One Value Point)** • Anil was careless/casual/generous about his money. • Anil did not seem to bother about little profit made by Hari Singh. • Anil was being helpful by not disclosing the fact that he knew about the profit being made by Hari Singh	**1**
ii.	(C) That he would be able to accomplish a lot if he gets educated.	**1**
iii.	• Anil promised to teach him how to cook, write his name, whole sentences and add numbers. • The narrator felt grateful for the opportunity to learn, believing that once he could write like an educated man, there would be no limit to what he could achieve	**1 +1**
iv.	profit	**1**
7.	**Answer the questions for any one from the given two extracts (a) and (b).**	**5**
a.		
i.	**(Any One Value Point)** • It is a term of endearment or affection. • It suggests a close relationship or familiarity between the speaker and the person they are addressing	**1**
ii.	**(Any Two Value Points)** • The "yellow hair" mentioned in the poem is likely symbolic of physical beauty or attractiveness • The religions man suggests it not to be the basis of God's love. • Youth considers it to be a reason for loving someone	**1+1**

iii.	Selfless	**1**
iv.	1 mark to be awarded to all students who attempt this question as the options given do not contain the correct answer.	**1**
	OR	
b.		
i.	• Oxymoron – In his quiet rage • Metaphor – pads of velvet quiet • Repetition – quiet • Alliteration – stress, should, stripes, shadow • Imagery – lurking, sliding • Personification **1 mark for identification and 1 mark for naming the figure of speech**	**1 + 1**
ii.	Soft, restless, restrained, smooth, stealthily **(Any One Value Point)**	**1**
iii.	(B) both subdued and angry.	**1**
iv.	(B) Along the sand, the people All turn and look one way They turn back on the sand They look at the sea all day	**1**
8.	**Answer any Four of the following five questions in 40- 50 words.** **Content – 2 Marks** **Expression – 1 Mark (Effective style, coherence/cohesion)**	**4 X 3 = 12**
i.	• (Any Two Value Points) • Mandela - driven with the purpose - gain freedom for his people, give them a life of dignity and respect. • Broke laws to gain freedom for his own people/fought against discrimination • Imprisoned / faced many challenges/ brutalities of authorities • (Any other relevant point to be accepted)	**2 +1**
ii.	**(Any Two Value Points)** • Changed the mood of the poet. • The snow shook off his sadness and depression • left him in a happy mood for the rest of the day/ saved his day **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	**2 +1**
iii.	• The long brown coat with an embroidered waistbelt worn by the Kodavas, known as Kuppia, • Resembles the Kuffia worn by the Arabs and The Kurds. • **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	**2 +1**

	•	
iv.	**(Any Two Value Points – At least one from each)** • **The Asiatic Lion** - has a huge body with a dull brown/tawny skin, roars ferociously while killing its prey. • **The Bengal Tiger** - has black stripes on a yellow body, kills its prey silently. **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	**2 +1**
v.	• He cabled England - nothing happened for three days - booked a call 24 hours in advance. • On the first day the line was out of order - On the second day - exchange closed for a religious holiday - On the third day - another breakdown - five days later the mail arrived. • **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	**2 +1**
9.	**Answer any Four of the following five questions in 40- 50 words.** **Content – 2 Marks** **Expression – 1 Mark (Effective style, coherence/cohesion)**	**2 X 3 = 6**
i.	• (Any Two Value Points) • Mrs. Pumphrey's overindulgence – over pampering, overfeeding Reluctance to impose discipline on Tricki reflects a common tendency among pet owners to spoil their animals without considering the consequences. • The absence of adequate exercise for Tricki emphasizes the importance of regular exercise for pets and the impact of external factors on their well being. • It offers a critical examination of human behaviour towards animals and the need for responsible pet ownership **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	**2 +1**
ii.	• (Any Two Value Point) • A seemingly innocuous book containing nursery rhymes plays a pivotal role in saving the earth from destruction. • Martian invasion was prevented because of the book • The book, discovered by the inhabitants of a faraway planet, contains nursery rhymes from Earth's literature, which the aliens misinterpret as factual accounts of historical events. • The misunderstanding arises when the aliens lacking knowledge of Earth's culture and language, mistake the nursery rhymes for an accurate depiction of human history. • **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	**2 +1**
iii.	• (Any Two Value Points)	**2 +1**

	• Griffin undergoes significant character development. Once a figure consumed by his desire for power and dominance through invisibility, Griffin, later, grappled with the consequences of his actions. • He navigates a world where his once extraordinary abilities became a burden, leading him to confront the moral implications of his scientific pursuits. • Examples from text how he indulges in many harmful activities. **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	
10.	**Answer any One of the following two questions in 100- 120 words.** **Content – 3 Marks** **Expression – 2 Marks (Effective style, coherence/cohesion)** **Accuracy – 1 Mark (Grammar, spellings and punctuation)**	**1 X 6 =6**
a.	• (Any Three Value Points – At least one value point for each text) • Amanda- • Amanda represents the longing for freedom – felt dominated, while her mother/parent/guardian, represents instructional control over freedom, this highlights the contrast. • The poem conveys the moral that children need to be allowed more freedom. Excessive nagging may make them annoyed and disobedient and hence they may develop a type of dislike for real life. • Madam rides the bus- • On the other hand, Valli - eight years old – has no friends – wanted to explore the world - mesmerized by the bus journey between her village and the city - started saving money for the bus fare. • Planned her journey meticulously. **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)** **OR**	**3 + 2 +1**
b.	**(At least 1 value point from each text + 1 mark for conclusion)** • The Ball Poem- Berryman - beautifully describes a boy who has lost his ball - gave a lesson full a wisdom - everyone must learn to bear the pain associated with loss - need to learn the ways for bearing those losses - both material and human. • **'A Long Walk to Freedom'** by Nelson Mandela is about the struggle of freedom of South Africa. Mandela recalls the reason for this movement - black-skinned people exploited by the whites. • While taking vow as the first black President, Mandela established democracy in the country - said there would be no discrimination henceforth.	**3 + 2 +1**

	• • Conclusion - While the Ball Poem teaches us to accept loss and that suffering is a part of life, A Long Walk to Freedom, teaches us to fight for loss of freedom and suffering as a human right. **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	
11.	**Answer any One of the following two questions in 100- 120 words.** **Content – 3 Marks** **Expression – 2 Marks (Effective style, coherence/cohesion)** **Accuracy – 1 Mark (Grammar, spellings and punctuation)**	**1 X 6 = 6**
a.	**(Any Three Value Points)** • Lady in Red is also a thief • Acted with confidence. • Convincing manner and passed off as the lady of house. • Horace left fingerprints when caught, the young lady exploited his confusion and fear of going to prison. • Made Horace open the safe - gave the jewels to the lady. • He was caught and arrested. **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)** OR	**3 + 2 +1**
b.	**(Any Three Value Points – at least one value point from each part)** • They found a necklace exactly like the one they had lost - got it for 36000 francs - Mr. Loisel had 18000 Francs – They borrowed the rest and returned the necklace to Madam Forester. • They led a miserable life/ exhausted the savings – changed lodgings, rented a room in the attic - Matilda did menial work in the kitchen, washed dishes and soiled linen - Clothed like an ordinary woman. • Mr. Loisel put the books of a merchant in order - He did copying at five sous a page – It took ten years to pay off all the debts. **(Any other relevant point to be accepted)**	**3 + 2 +1**

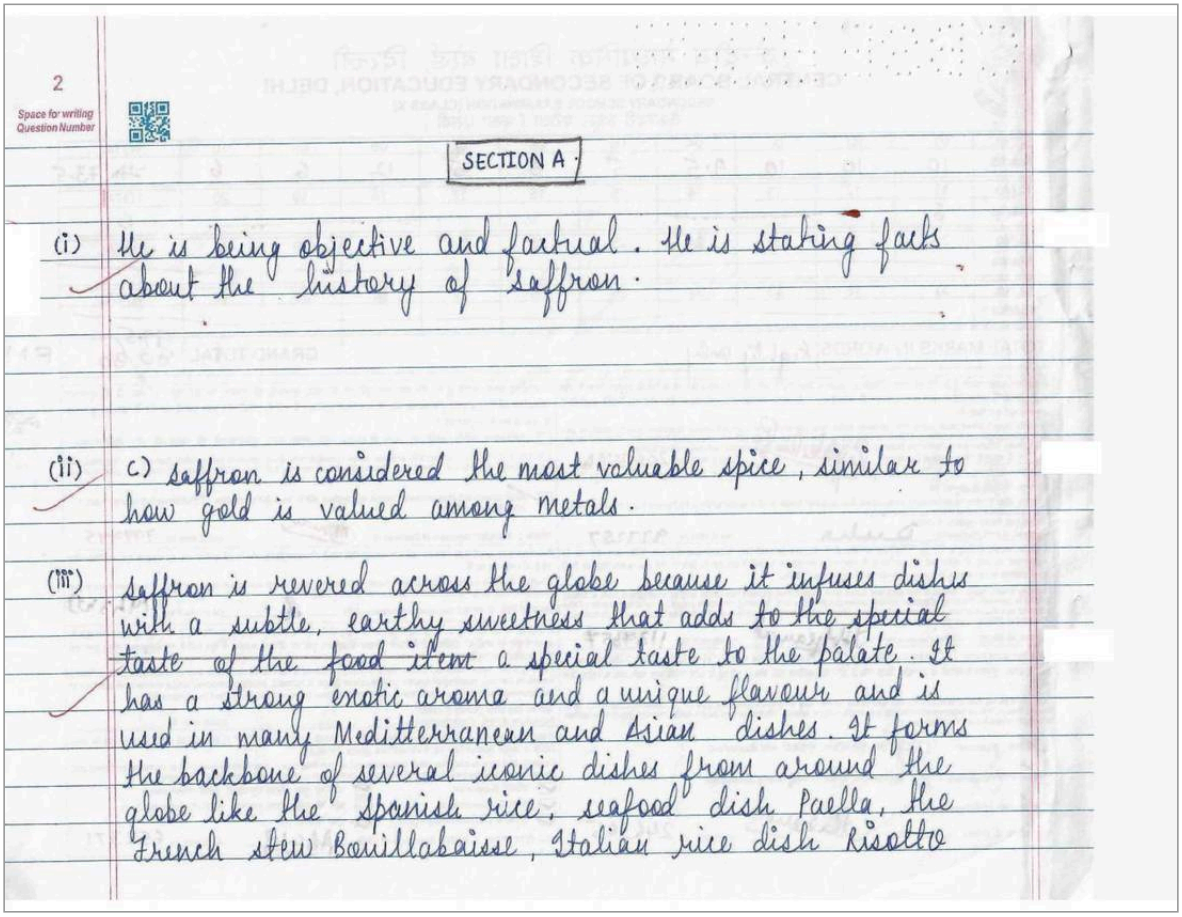
Topper's Answer Sheet

Q1 (i)–(viii) Reading

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2 · all answer pages, arranged Q1 to Q11

Q1 (i)–(iii) · Reading Passage 1

answer book p.2



2

Space for writing Question Number

SECTION A

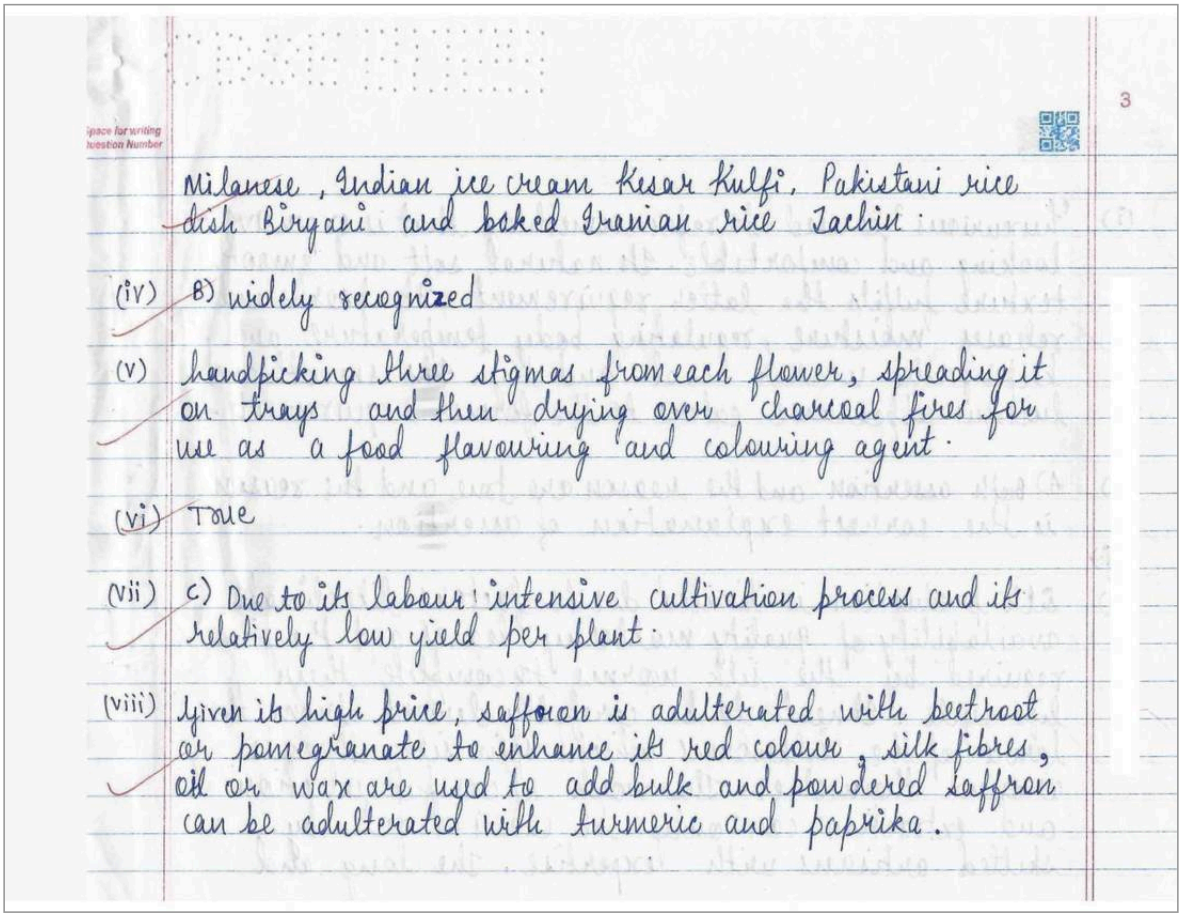
(i) He is being objective and factual. He is stating facts about the history of saffron.

(ii) c) saffron is considered the most valuable spice, similar to how gold is valued among metals.

(iii) saffron is revered across the globe because it infuses dishes with a subtle, earthy sweetness that adds to the special taste of the food item a special taste to the palate. It has a strong exotic aroma and a unique flavour and is used in many Mediterranean and Asian dishes. It forms the backbone of several iconic dishes from around the globe like the Spanish rice, seafood dish Paella, the French stew Bouillabaisse, Italian rice dish Risotto

Q1 (iii)–(viii) · Reading Passage 1

answer book p.3



3

Space for writing Question Number

Milanese, Indian ice cream Kesar Kulfi, Pakistani rice dish Biryani and baked Iranian rice Tachin.

(iv) B) widely recognized

(v) handpicking three stigmas from each flower, spreading it on trays and then drying over charcoal fires for use as a food flavouring and colouring agent.

(vi) True

(vii) c) Due to its labour intensive cultivation process and its relatively low yield per plant.

(viii) Given its high price, saffron is adulterated with beetroot or pomegranate to enhance its red colour, silk fibres, oil or wax are used to add bulk and powdered saffron can be adulterated with turmeric and paprika.

Topper's Answer Sheet

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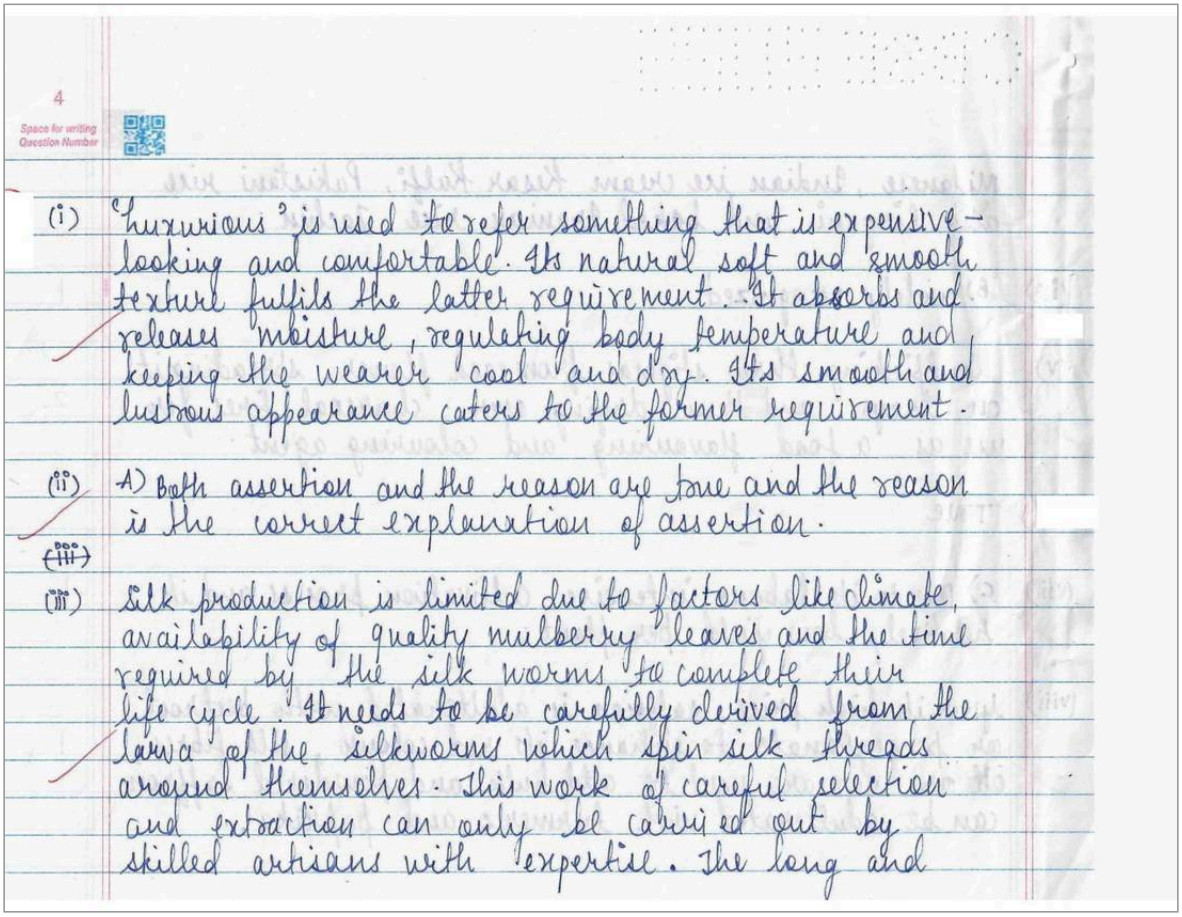
Q2 (i)–(vi) Reading

Q2 (i)–(iii) · Reading Passage 2

answer book p.4



4

(i) 'luxurious' is used to refer something that is expensive-looking and comfortable. Its natural soft and smooth texture fulfils the latter requirement. It absorbs and releases moisture, regulating body temperature and keeping the wearer cool and dry. Its smooth and lustrous appearance caters to the former requirement.

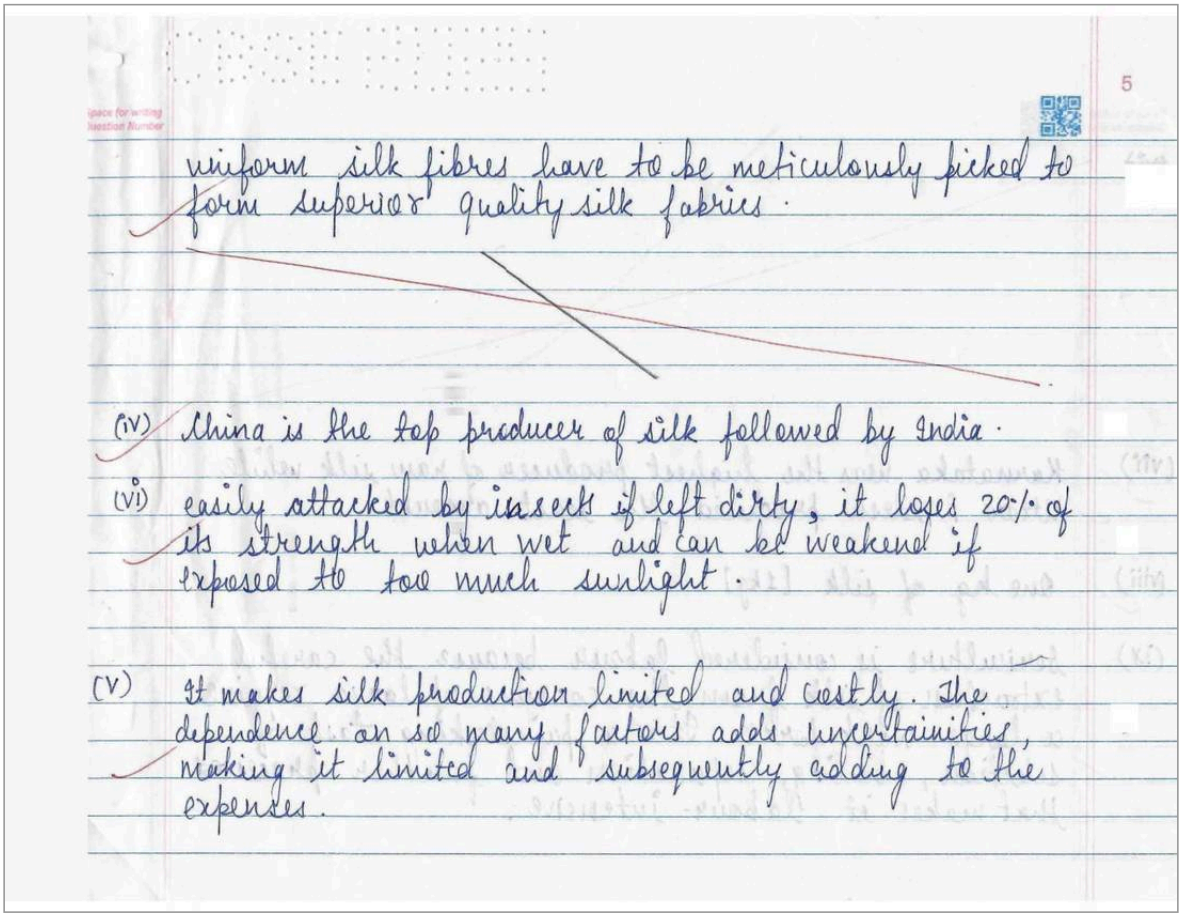
(ii) A) Both assertion and the reason are true and the reason is the correct explanation of assertion.

(iii)

(iii) Silk production is limited due to factors like climate, availability of quality mulberry leaves and the time required by the silk worms to complete their life cycle. It needs to be carefully derived from the larva of the silkworms which spin silk threads around themselves. This work of careful selection and extraction can only be carried out by skilled artisans with expertise. The long and

Q2 (iii)–(vi) · Reading Passage 2

answer book p.5



5

uniform silk fibres have to be meticulously picked to form superior quality silk fabrics.

(iv) China is the top producer of silk followed by India.

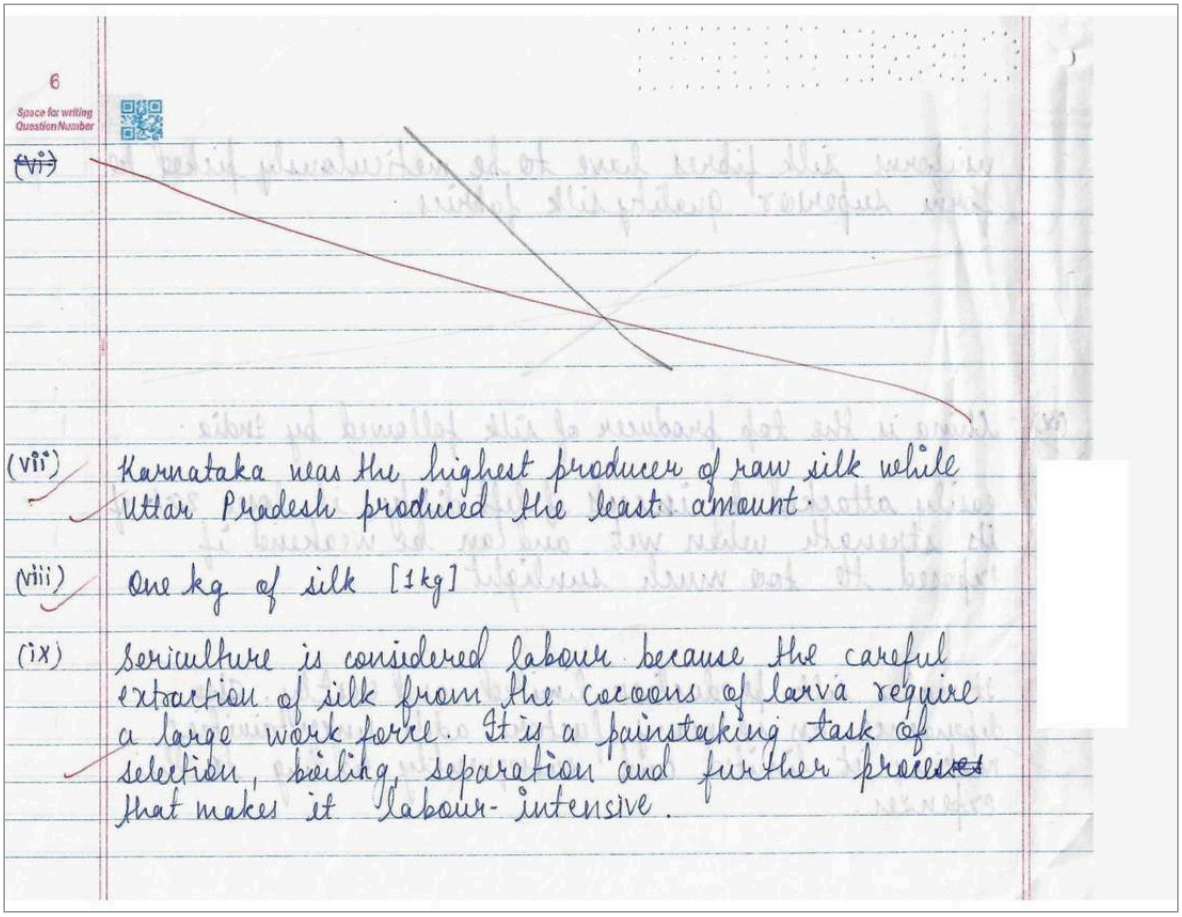
(vi) easily attacked by insects if left dirty, it loses 20% of its strength when wet and can be weakend if exposed to too much sunlight.

(v) It makes silk production limited and costly. The dependence on so many factors adds uncertainities, making it limited and subsequently adding to the expenses.

Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q2 (vii)–(ix) · Reading Passage 2 answer book p.6



6

Space for writing Question Number

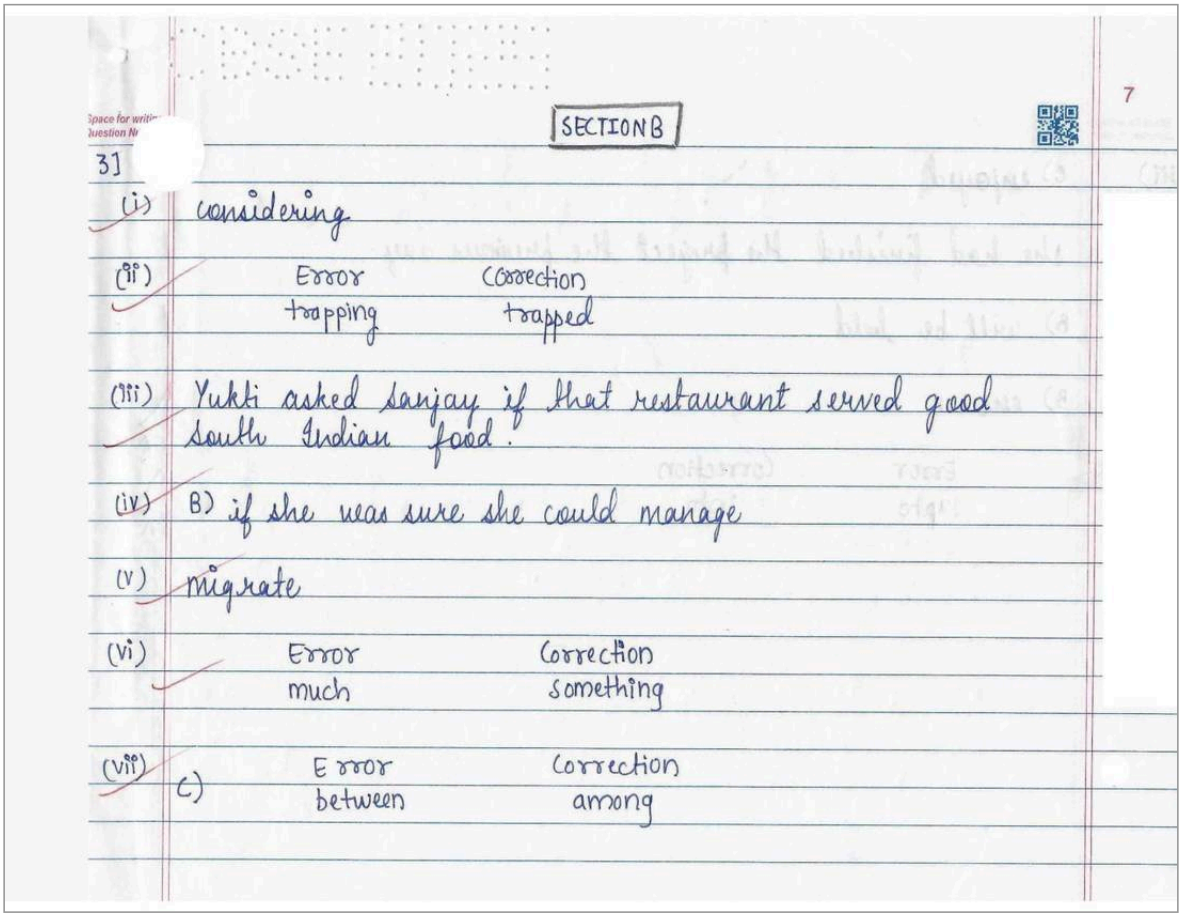
~~(vi)~~

(vii) Karnataka was the highest producer of raw silk while Uttar Pradesh produced the least amount.

(viii) One kg of silk [1kg]

(ix) Sericulture is considered labour because the careful extraction of silk from the cocoons of larva require a large work force. It is a painstaking task of selection, boiling, separation and further ~~process~~ that makes it labour-intensive.

Q3 (i)–(vii) · Grammar answer book p.7



7

SECTION B

3]

(i) considering

(ii)

Error	Correction
trapping	trapped

(iii) Yukti asked Sanjay if that restaurant served good South Indian food.

(iv) B) if she was sure she could manage

(v) migrate

(vi)

Error	Correction
much	something

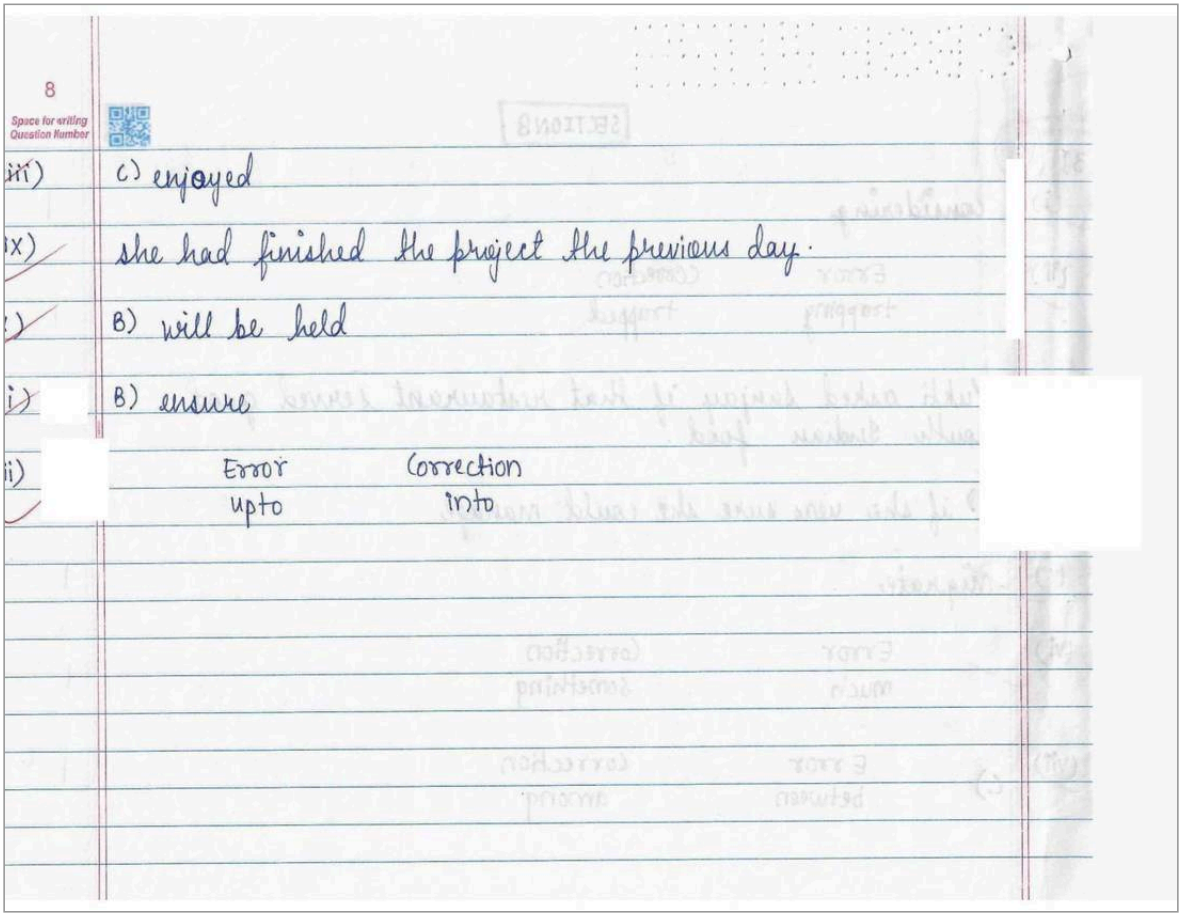
(vii) C)

Error	Correction
between	among

Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q3 (viii)–(xii) · Grammar answer book p.8


8

Space for writing Question Number

iii) c) enjoyed

ix) she had finished the project the previous day.

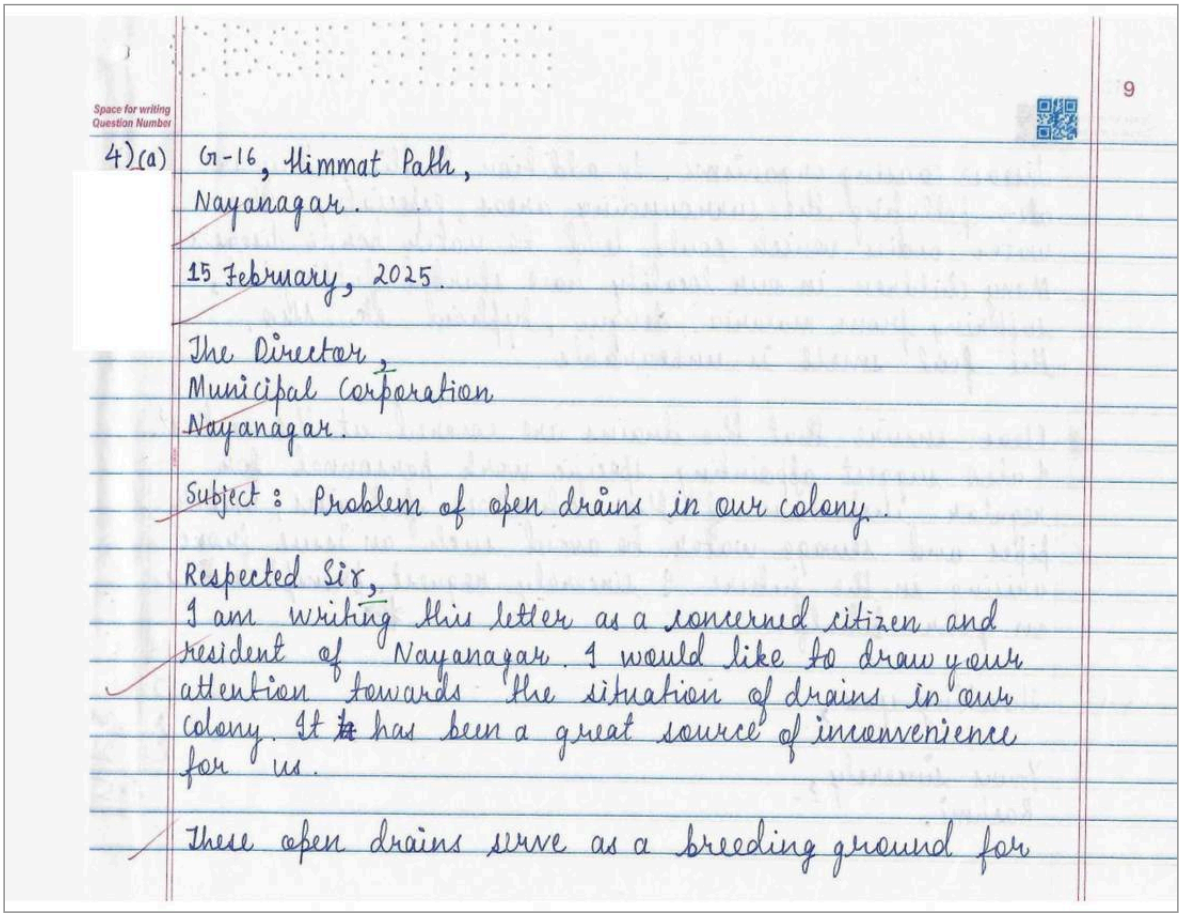
x) B) will be held

i) B) ensure

ii)

Error	Correction
upto	into

Q4 (A) · Formal Letter answer book p.9


9

Space for writing Question Number

4)(a) G-16, Himmat Path,
Nayanagar.

15 February, 2025.

The Director,
Municipal Corporation
Nayanagar.

Subject : Problem of open drains in our colony.

Respected Sir,
I am writing this letter as a concerned citizen and resident of Nayanagar. I would like to draw your attention towards the situation of drains in our colony. It has been a great source of inconvenience for us.

These open drains serve as a breeding ground for

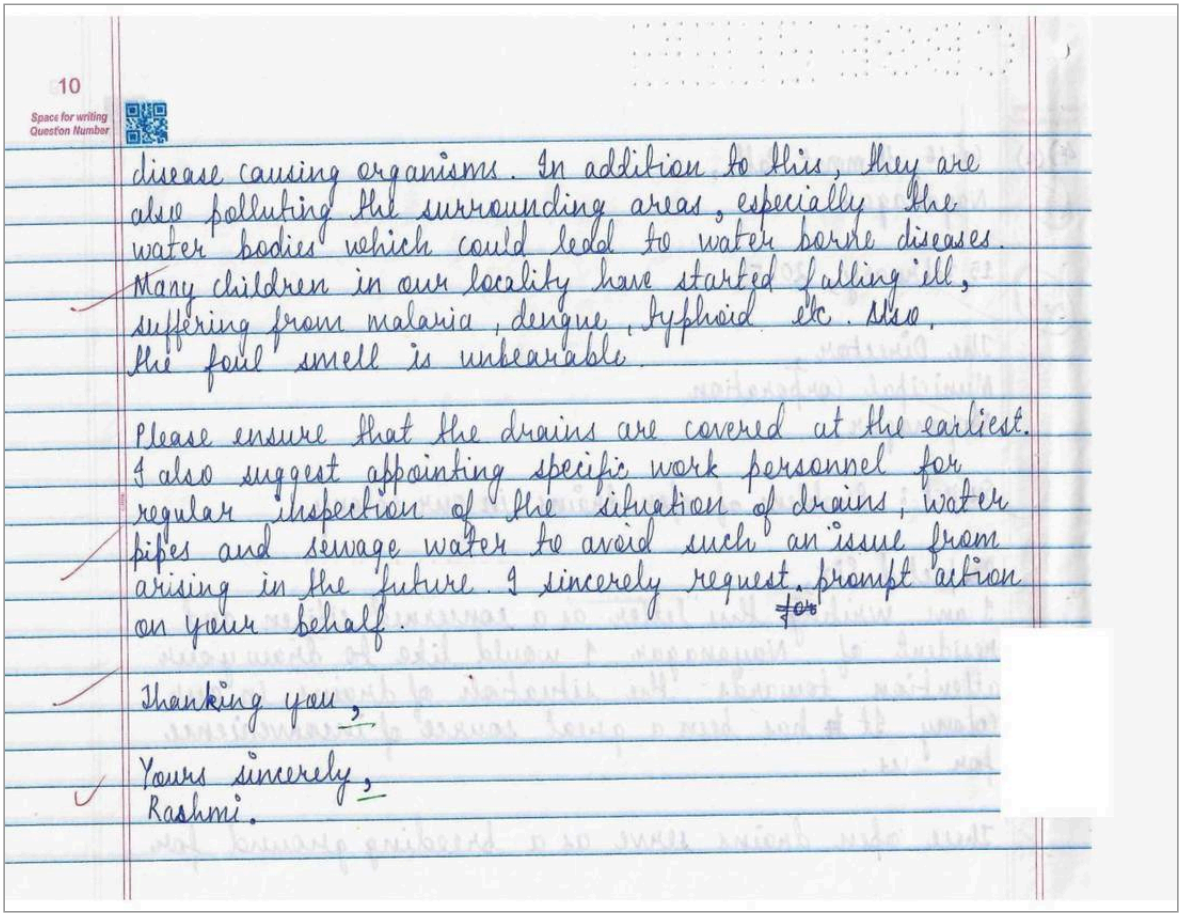
Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q4 (A) Letter · Q5 (A) Analytical Para

Q4 (A) · Formal Letter (contd.)

answer book p.10



10

Space for writing Question Number

disease causing organisms. In addition to this, they are also polluting the surrounding areas, especially the water bodies which could lead to water borne diseases. Many children in our locality have started falling ill, suffering from malaria, dengue, typhoid etc. Also, the foul smell is unbearable.

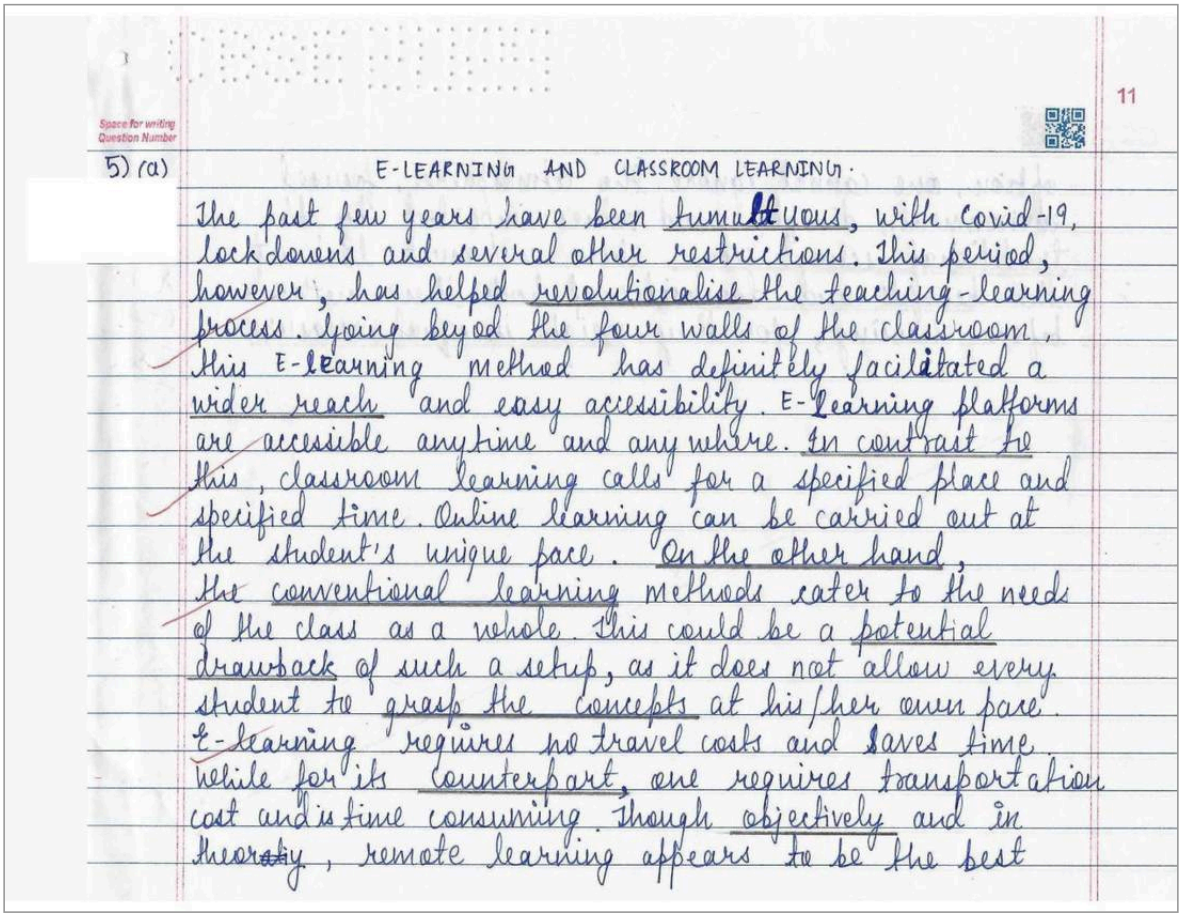
Please ensure that the drains are covered at the earliest. I also suggest appointing specific work personnel for regular inspection of the situation of drains, water pipes and sewage water to avoid such an issue from arising in the future. I sincerely request prompt action ~~for~~ on your behalf.

Thanking you,

Yours sincerely,
Rashmi.

Q5 (A) · Analytical Paragraph

answer book p.11



11

Space for writing Question Number

5) (a) E-LEARNING AND CLASSROOM LEARNING.

The past few years have been tumultuous, with Covid-19, lockdowns and several other restrictions. This period, however, has helped revolutionalise the teaching-learning process. Going beyond the four walls of the classroom, this E-learning method has definitely facilitated a wider reach and easy accessibility. E-learning platforms are accessible anytime and anywhere. In contrast to this, classroom learning calls for a specified place and specified time. Online learning can be carried out at the student's unique pace. On the other hand, the conventional learning methods cater to the needs of the class as a whole. This could be a potential drawback of such a setup, as it does not allow every student to grasp the concepts at his/her own pace. E-learning requires no travel costs and saves time, while for its counterpart, one requires transportation cost and is time consuming. Though objectively and in ~~theory~~, remote learning appears to be the best

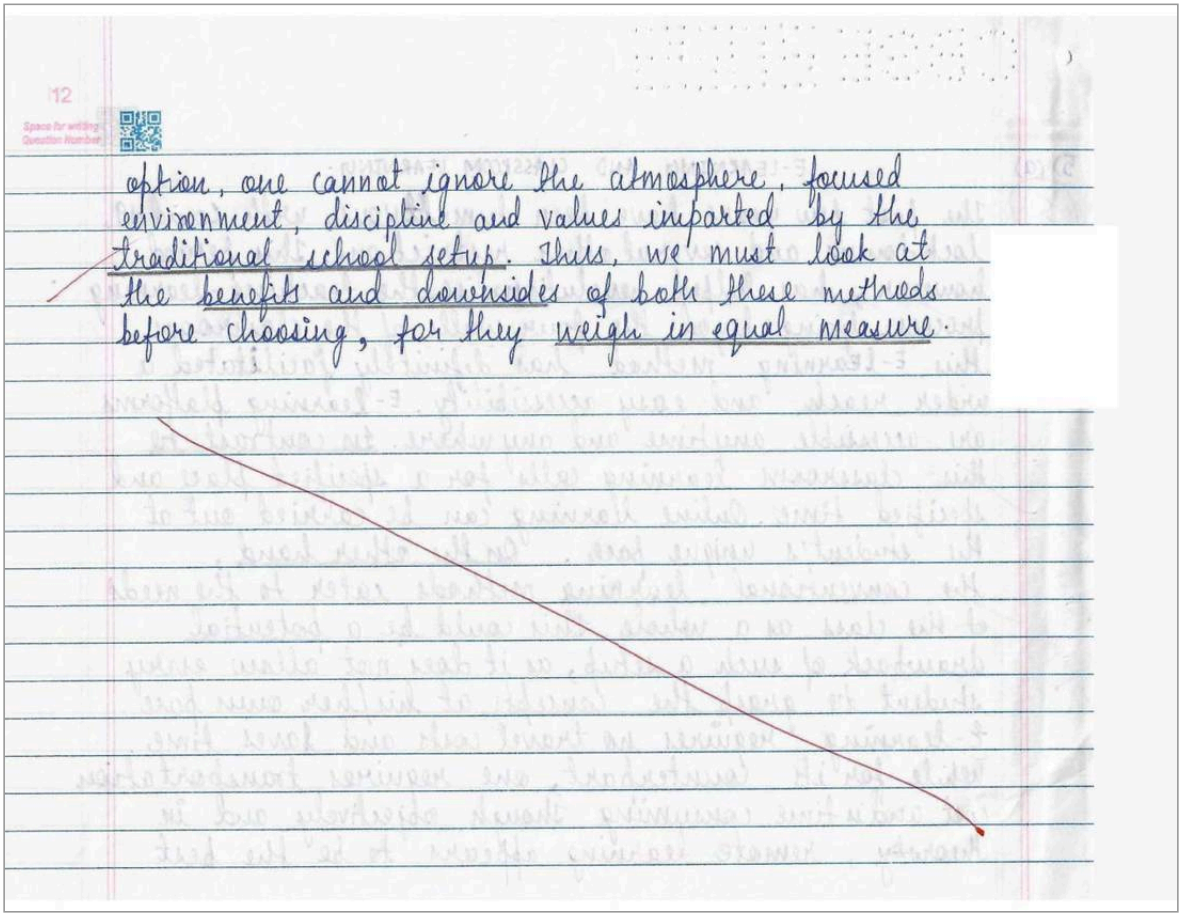
Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q5 (A) contd. · Q6 (A) Extract

Q5 (A) · Analytical Paragraph (contd.)

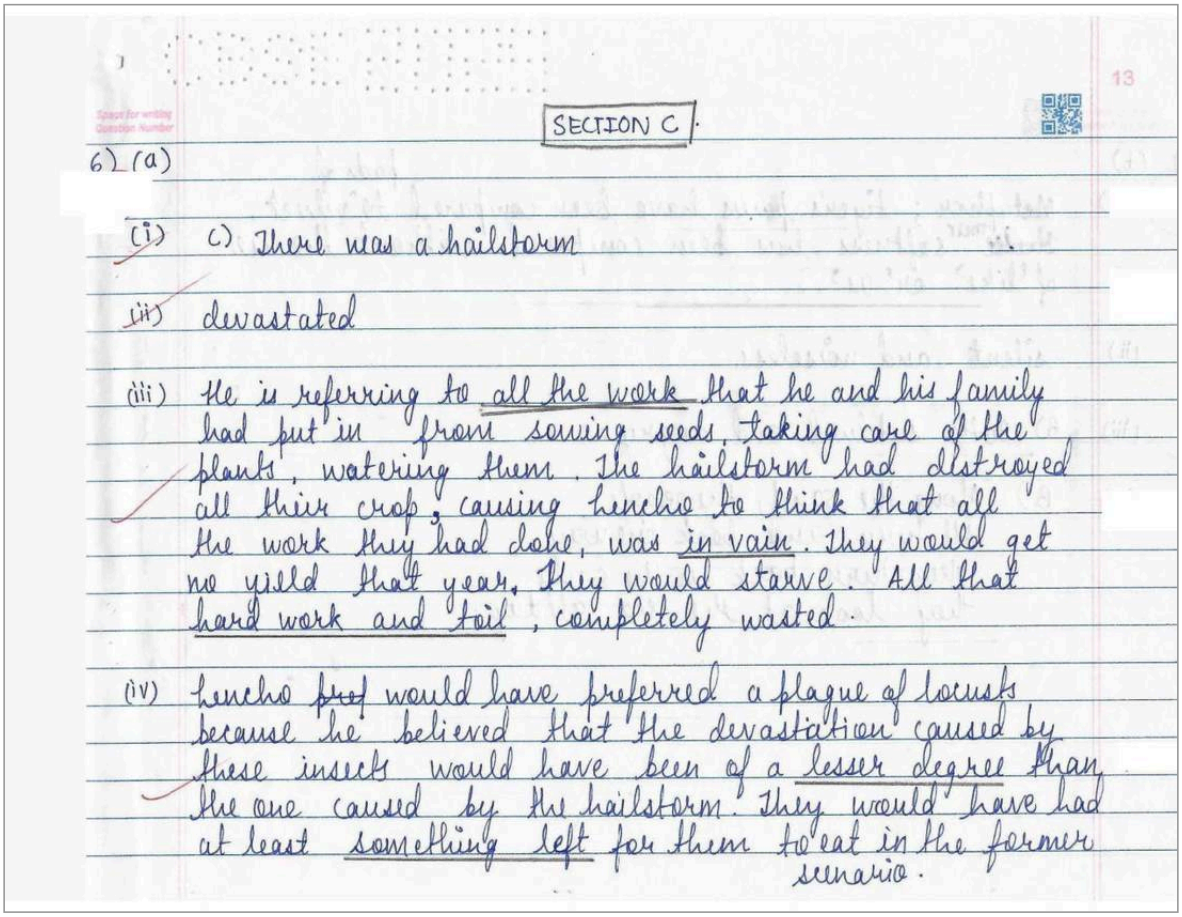
answer book p.12



option, one cannot ignore the atmosphere, focused environment, discipline and values imparted by the traditional school setup. Thus, we must look at the benefits and downsides of both these methods before choosing, for they weigh in equal measure.

Q6 (A) · Extract: A Letter to God

answer book p.13



SECTION C

6) (a)

(i) c) There was a hailstorm

(ii) devastated

(iii) He is referring to all the work that he and his family had put in from sowing seeds, taking care of the plants, watering them. The hailstorm had destroyed all their crop, causing Lencho to think that all the work they had done, was in vain. They would get no yield that year. They would starve. All that hard work and toil, completely wasted.

(iv) Lencho ~~prof~~ would have preferred a plague of locusts because he believed that the devastation caused by these insects would have been of a lesser degree than the one caused by the hailstorm. They would have had at least something left for them to eat in the former scenario.

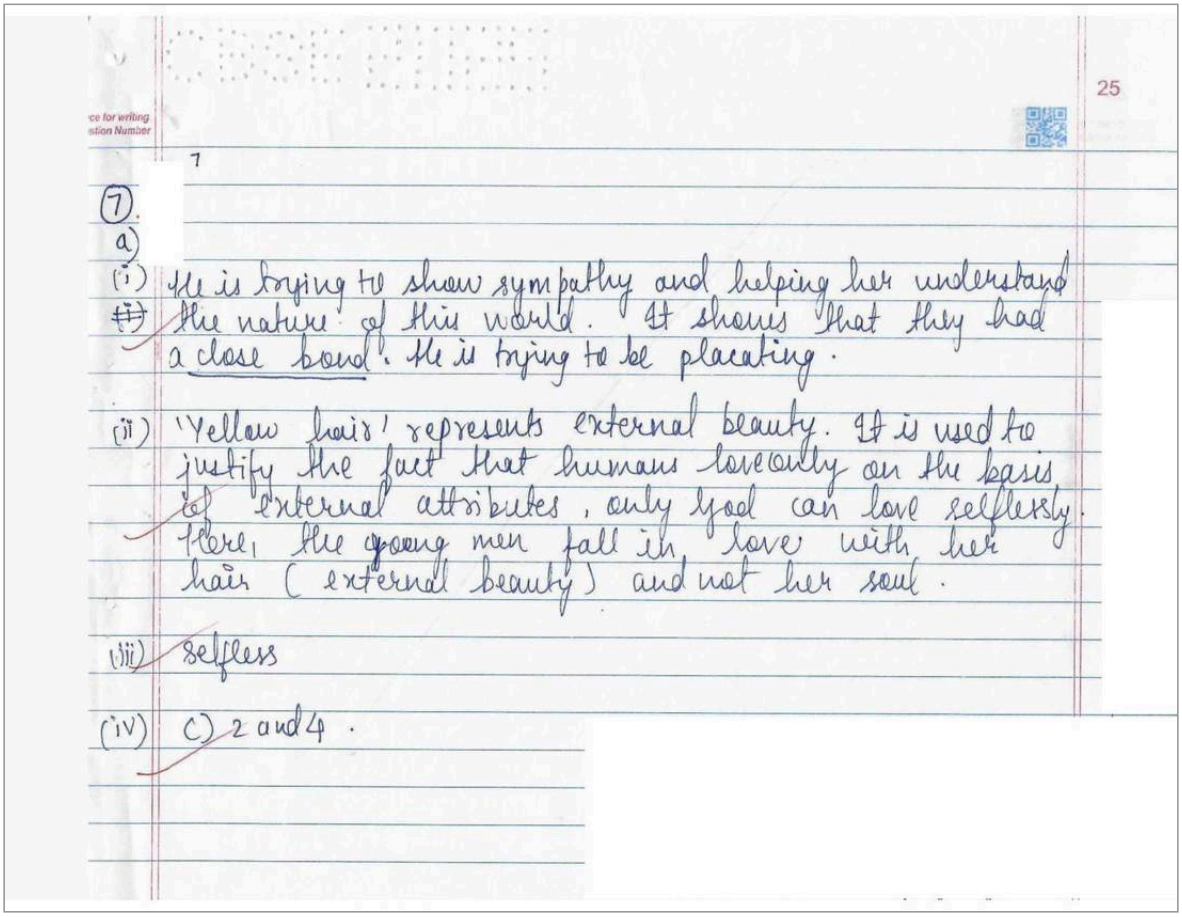
Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q7 (A) & (B) Poetry Extracts

Q7 (A) · Extract: For Anne Gregory

answer book p.25



25

Space for writing Question Number 7

(7)

a)

(i) He is trying to show sympathy and helping her understand the nature of this world. It shows that they had a close bond. He is trying to be placating.

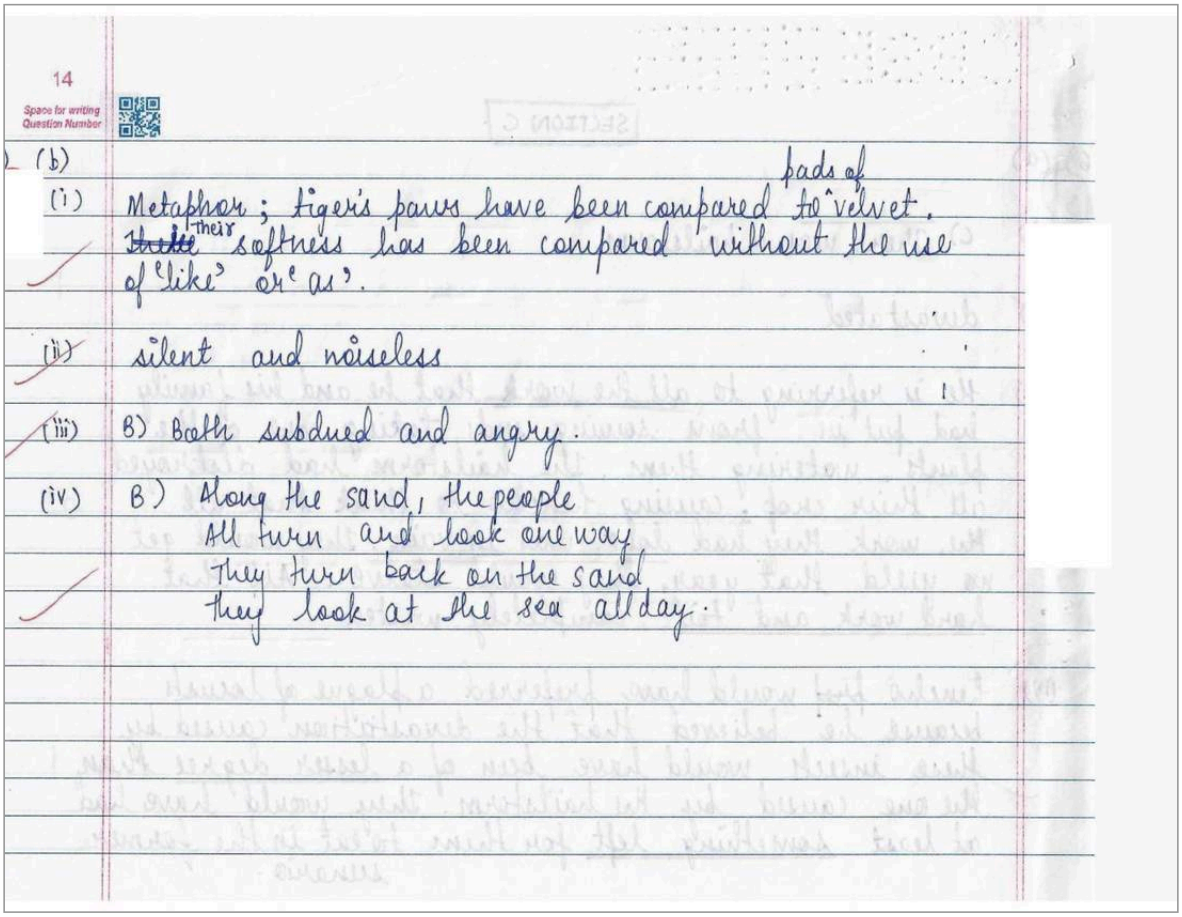
(ii) 'Yellow hair' represents external beauty. It is used to justify the fact that humans love only on the basis of external attributes, only God can love selflessly. Here, the young men fall in love with her hair (external beauty) and not her soul.

(iii) selfless

(iv) c) 2 and 4.

Q7 (B) · Extract: A Tiger in the Zoo

answer book p.14



14

Space for writing Question Number

(b)

(i) Metaphor; tiger's paws have been compared to pads of velvet. ~~Their~~ their softness has been compared without the use of 'like' or 'as'.

(ii) silent and noiseless

(iii) B) Both subdued and angry.

(iv) B) Along the sand, the people
All turn and look one way
They turn back on the sand
They look at the sea all day.

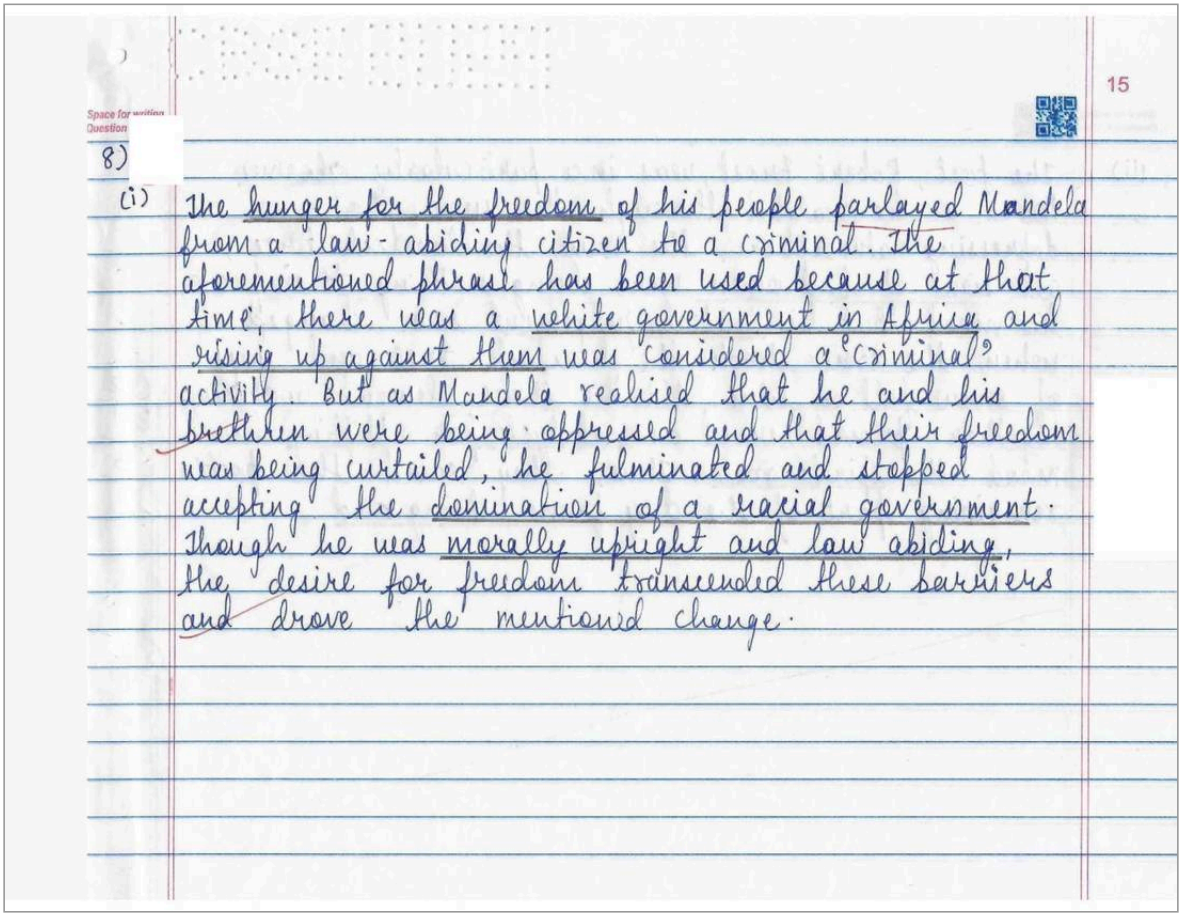
Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q8 (i), (ii) Short Answers

Q8 (i) · Long Walk to Freedom

answer book p.15



15

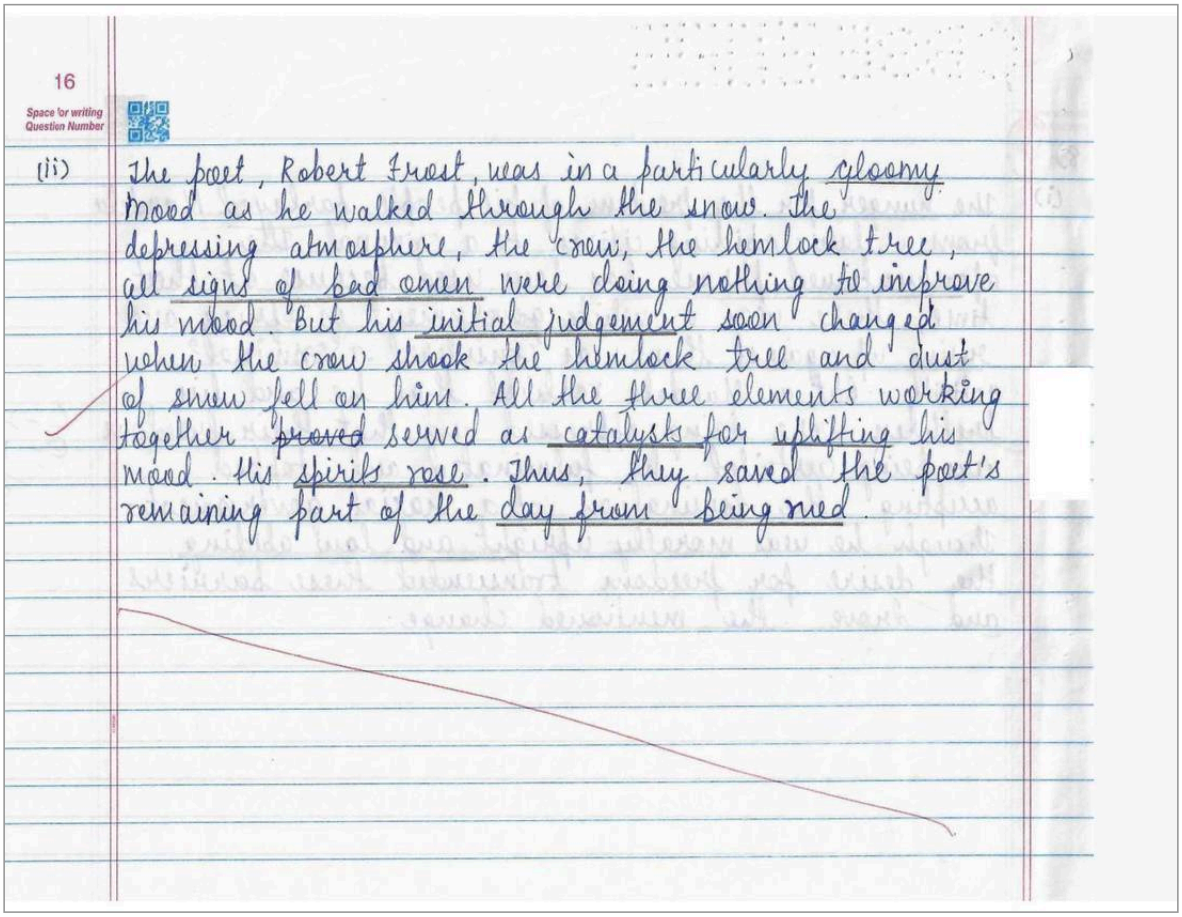
Space for writing Question

8)

(i) The hunger for the freedom of his people parlayed Mandela from a law-abiding citizen to a criminal. The aforementioned phrase has been used because at that time, there was a white government in Africa and rising up against them was considered a 'criminal' activity. But as Mandela realised that he and his brethren were being oppressed and that their freedom was being curtailed, he fulminated and stopped accepting the domination of a racial government. Though he was morally upright and law abiding, the desire for freedom transcended these barriers and drove the mentioned change.

Q8 (ii) · Dust of Snow

answer book p.16



16

Space for writing Question Number

(ii) The poet, Robert Frost, was in a particularly gloomy mood as he walked through the snow. The depressing atmosphere, the crow, the hemlock tree, all signs of bad omen were doing nothing to improve his mood. But his initial judgement soon changed when the crow shook the hemlock tree and dust of snow fell on him. All the three elements working together ~~proved~~ served as catalysts for uplifting his mood. His spirits rose. Thus, they saved the poet's remaining part of the day from being ruined.

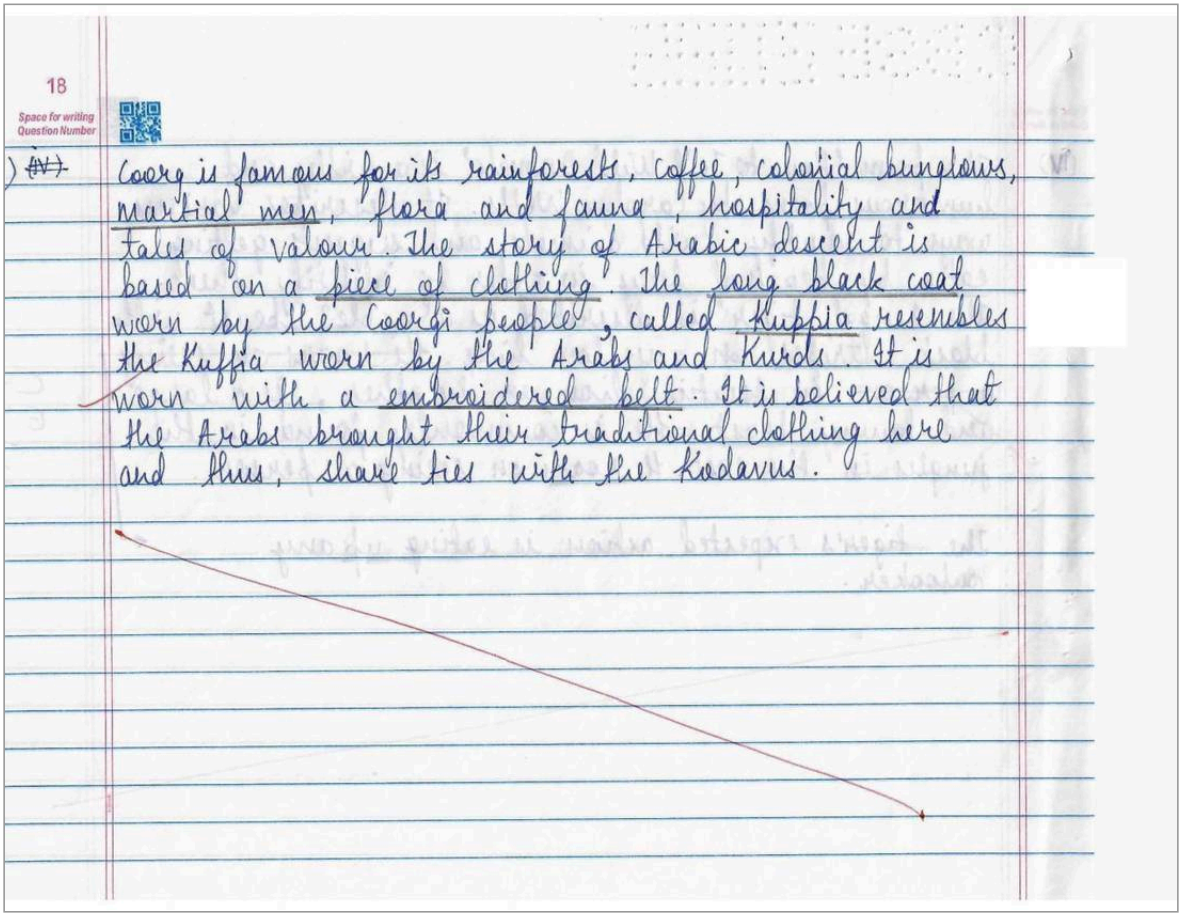
Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q8 (iii), (iv) Short Answers

Q8 (iii) · Glimpses of India (Coorg)

answer book p.18



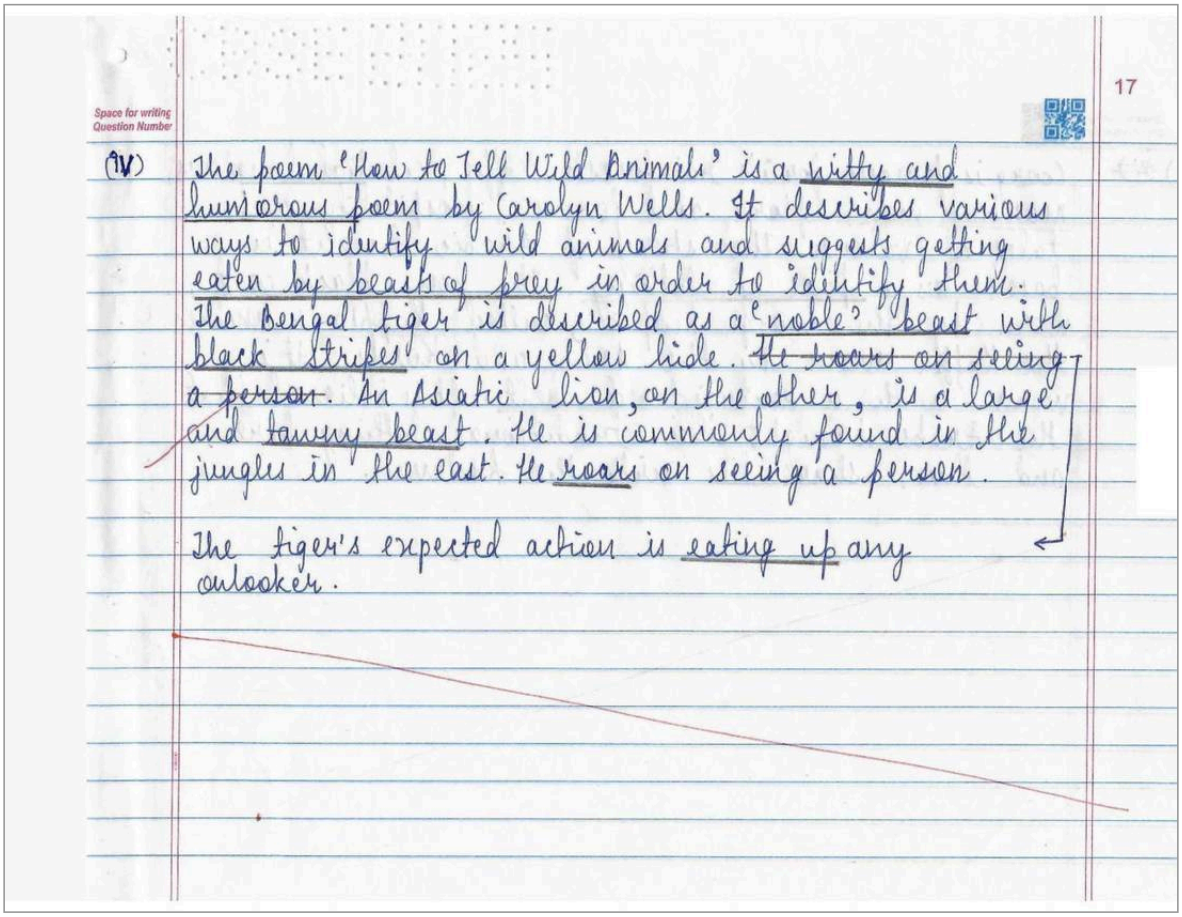
18

Space for writing Question Number

) ~~(iv)~~ Coorg is famous for its rainforests, coffee, colonial bungalows, martial men, flora and fauna, hospitality and tales of valour. The story of Arabic descent is based on a piece of clothing. The long black coat worn by the Coorgi people, called Kuppia resembles the Kuffia worn by the Arabs and Kurds. It is worn with a embroidered belt. It is believed that the Arabs brought their traditional clothing here and thus, share ties with the Kodavus.

Q8 (iv) · How to Tell Wild Animals

answer book p.17



17

Space for writing Question Number

(iv) The poem 'How to Tell Wild Animals' is a witty and humorous poem by Carolyn Wells. It describes various ways to identify wild animals and suggests getting eaten by beasts of prey in order to identify them. The Bengal tiger is described as a 'noble' beast with black stripes on a yellow hide. ~~He roars on seeing a person.~~ An Asiatic lion, on the other, is a large and tawny beast. He is commonly found in the jungles in the east. He roars on seeing a person.

The tiger's expected action is eating up any onlooker.

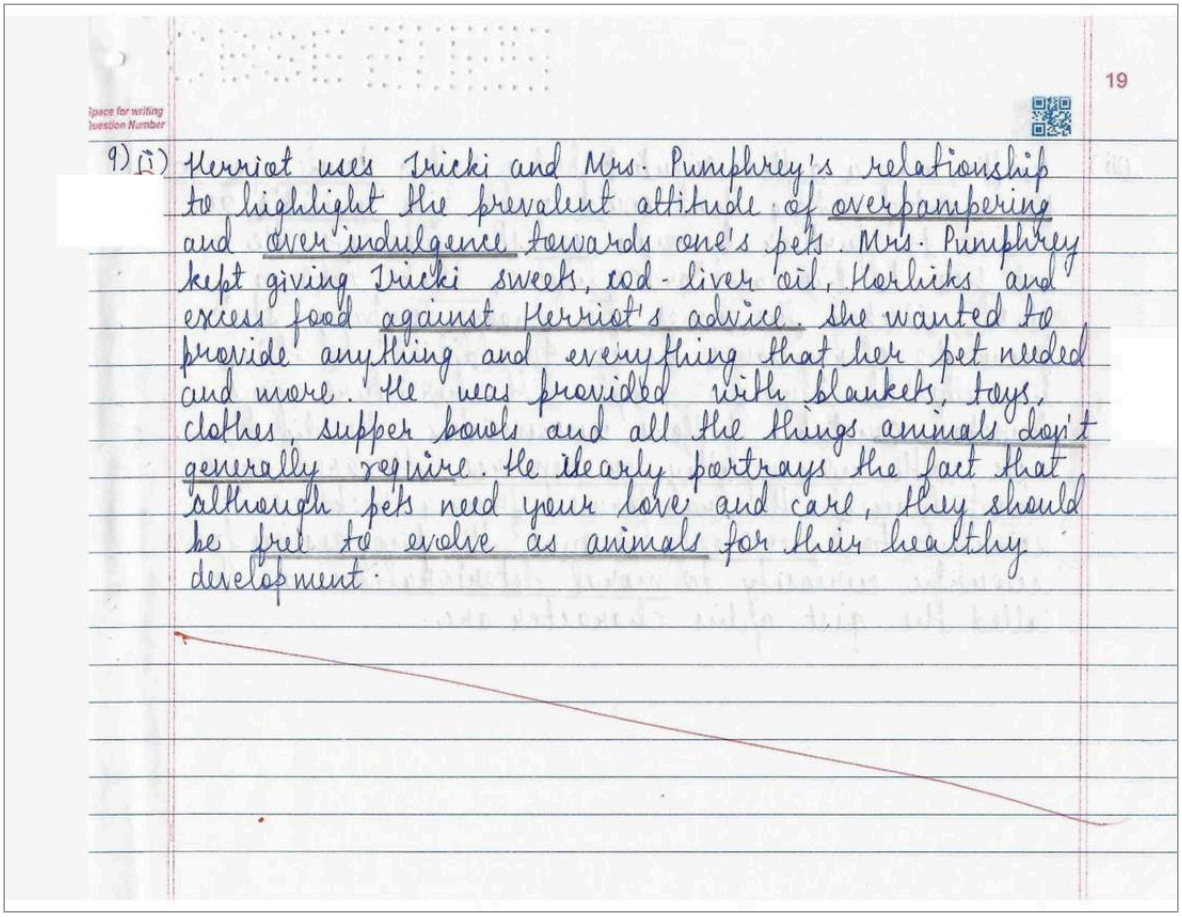
Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q9 (i), (iii) Short Answers

Q9 (i) · A Triumph of Surgery

answer book p.19



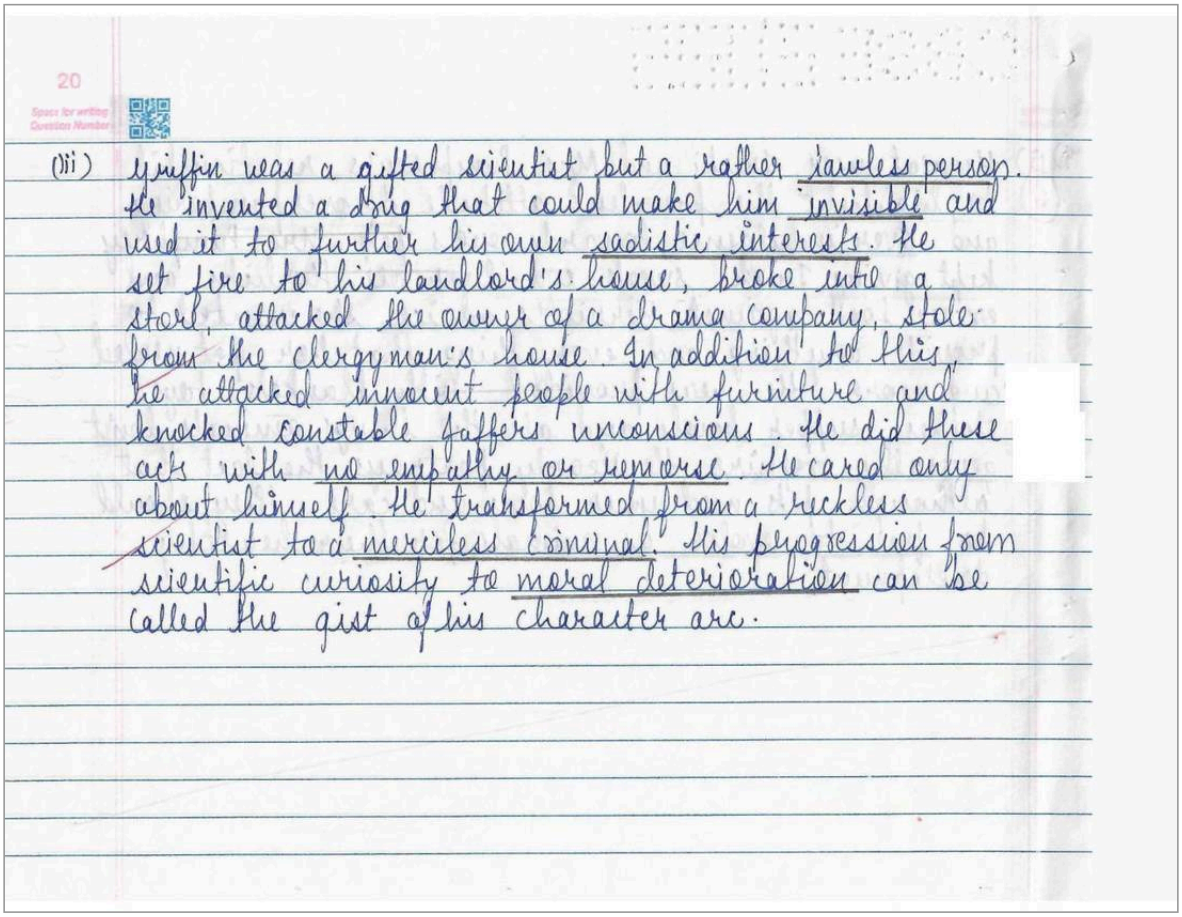
19

Space for writing Question Number

9) (i) Herriot uses Tricki and Mrs. Pumphrey's relationship to highlight the prevalent attitude of overpampering and over indulgence towards one's pets. Mrs. Pumphrey kept giving Tricki sweets, cod-liver oil, Horlicks and excess food against Herriot's advice. She wanted to provide anything and everything that her pet needed and more. He was provided with blankets, toys, clothes, supper bowls and all the things animals don't generally require. He clearly portrays the fact that although pets need your love and care, they should be free to evolve as animals for their healthy development.

Q9 (iii) · Footprints without Feet

answer book p.20



20

Space for writing Question Number

(iii) Griffin was a gifted scientist but a rather lawless person. He invented a drug that could make him invisible and used it to further his own sadistic interests. He set fire to his landlord's house, broke into a store, attacked the owner of a drama company, stole from the clergyman's house. In addition to this, he attacked innocent people with furniture and knocked constable Jaffers unconscious. He did these acts with no empathy or remorse. He cared only about himself. He transformed from a reckless scientist to a merciless criminal. His progression from scientific curiosity to moral deterioration can be called the gist of his character arc.

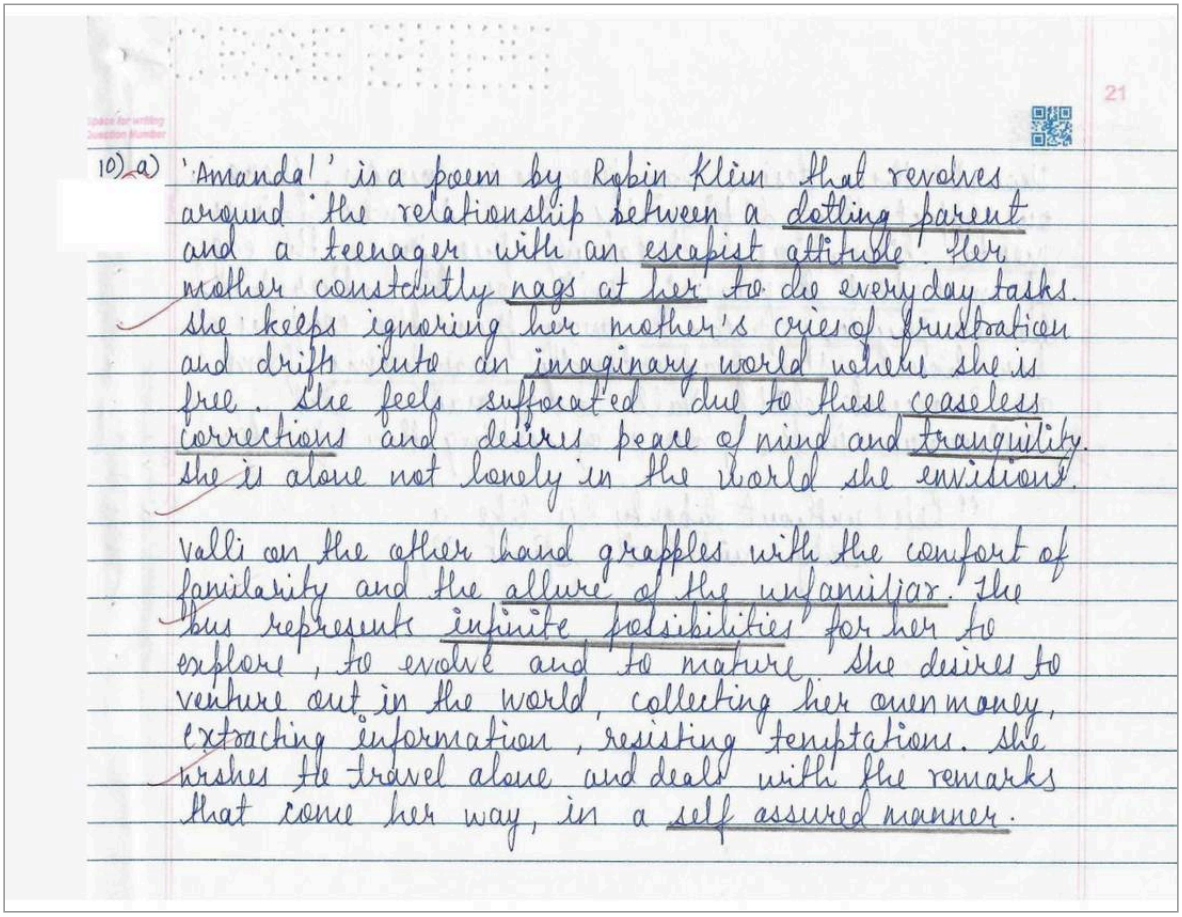
Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q10 (A) Long Answer

Q10 (A) · Amanda & Valli (long answer)

answer book p.21

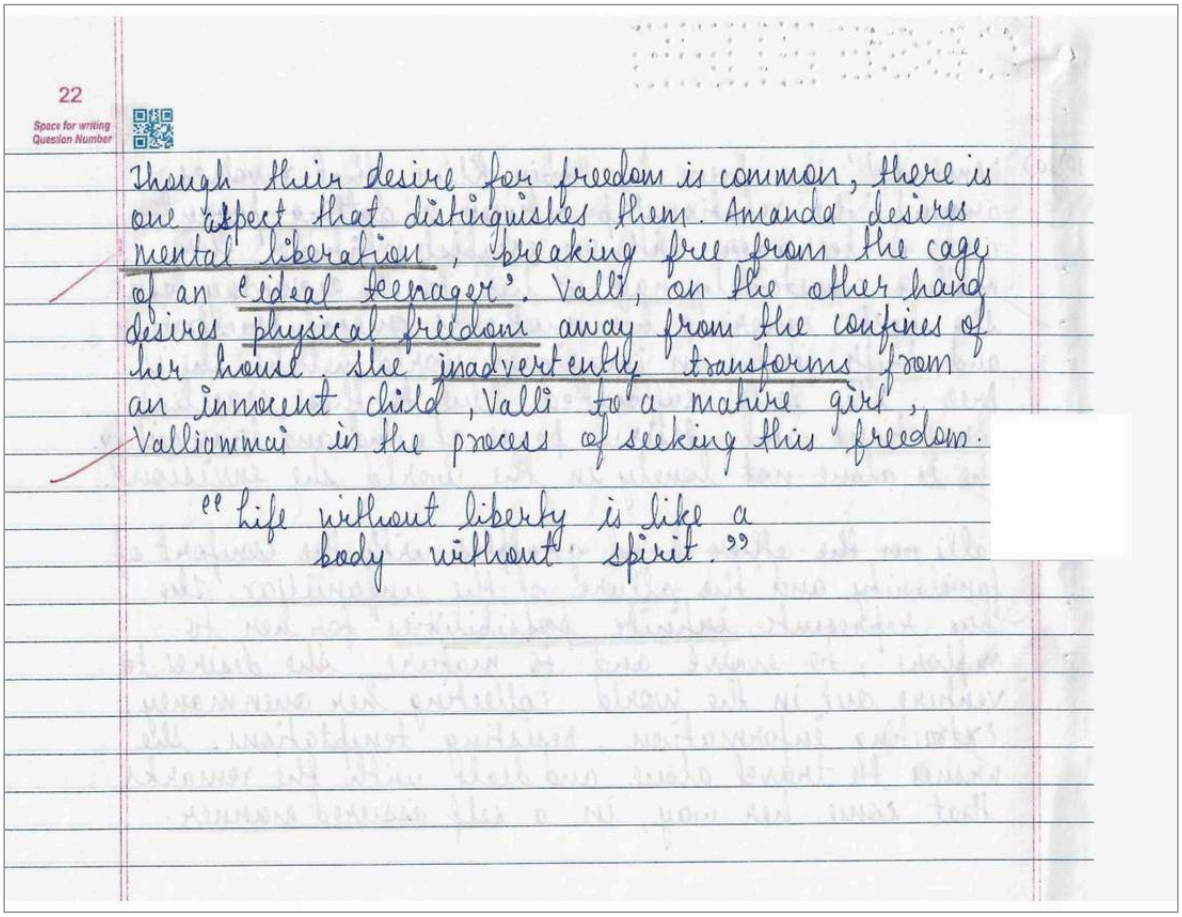


10) a) 'Amanda!' is a poem by Robin Klein that revolves around the relationship between a doting parent and a teenager with an escapist attitude. Her mother constantly nags at her to do everyday tasks. She keeps ignoring her mother's cries of frustration and drifts into an imaginary world where she is free. She feels suffocated due to these ceaseless corrections and desires peace of mind and tranquility. She is alone not lonely in the world she envisions.

Valli on the other hand grapples with the comfort of familarity and the allure of the unfamiliar. The bus represents infinite possibilities for her to explore, to evolve and to mature. She desires to venture out in the world, collecting her own money, extracting information, resisting temptations. She wishes to travel alone and deal with the remarks that come her way, in a self assured manner.

Q10 (A) · long answer (contd.)

answer book p.22



Though their desire for freedom is common, there is one aspect that distinguishes them. Amanda desires mental liberation, 'breaking free from the cage of an 'ideal teenager'. Valli, on the other hand desires physical freedom away from the confines of her home. She inadvertently transforms from an innocent child, Valli to a mature girl, Vallianmai in the process of seeking this freedom.

"Life without liberty is like a body without spirit."

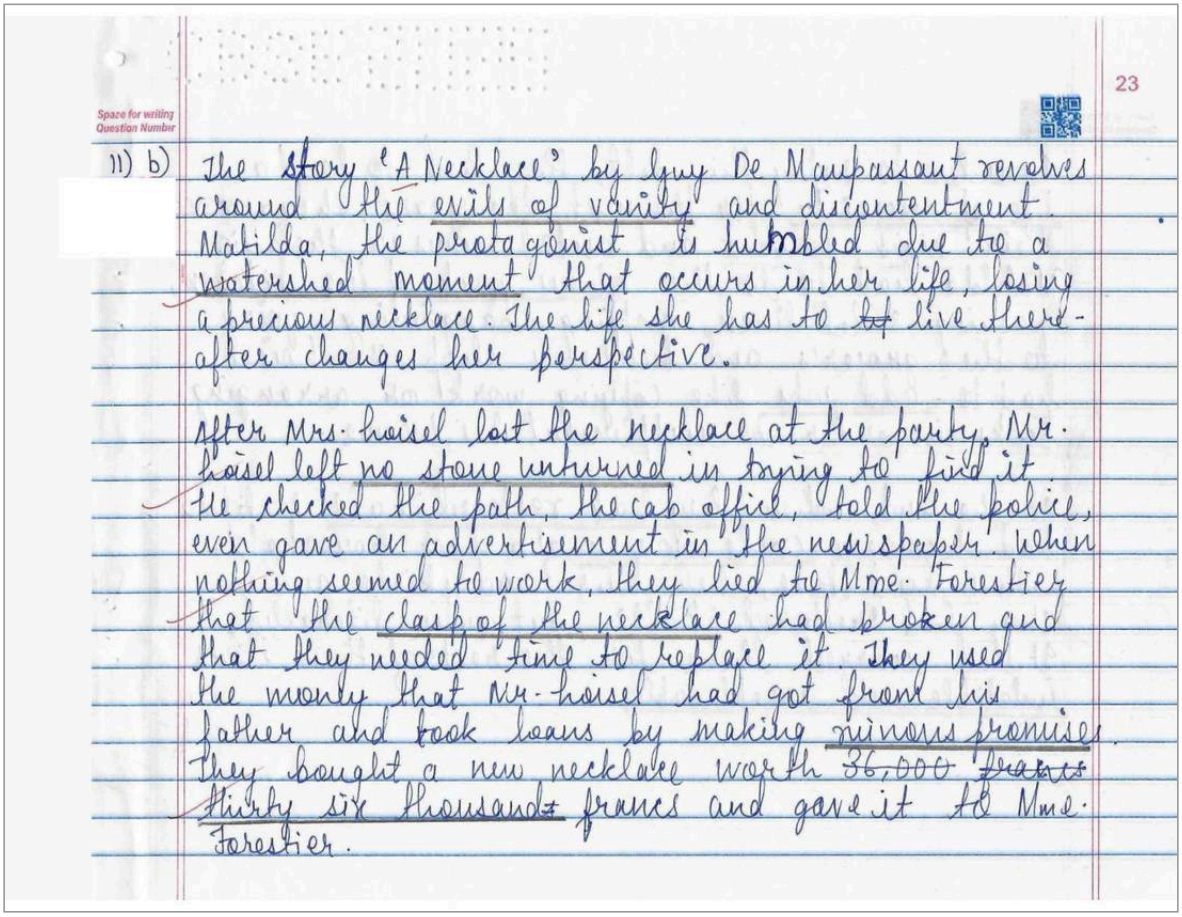
Topper's Answer Sheet

Real CBSE topper answer book · Board Exam 2025 · Set 2/1/2

Q11 (B) Long Answer

Q11 (B) · The Necklace (long answer)

answer book p.23



23

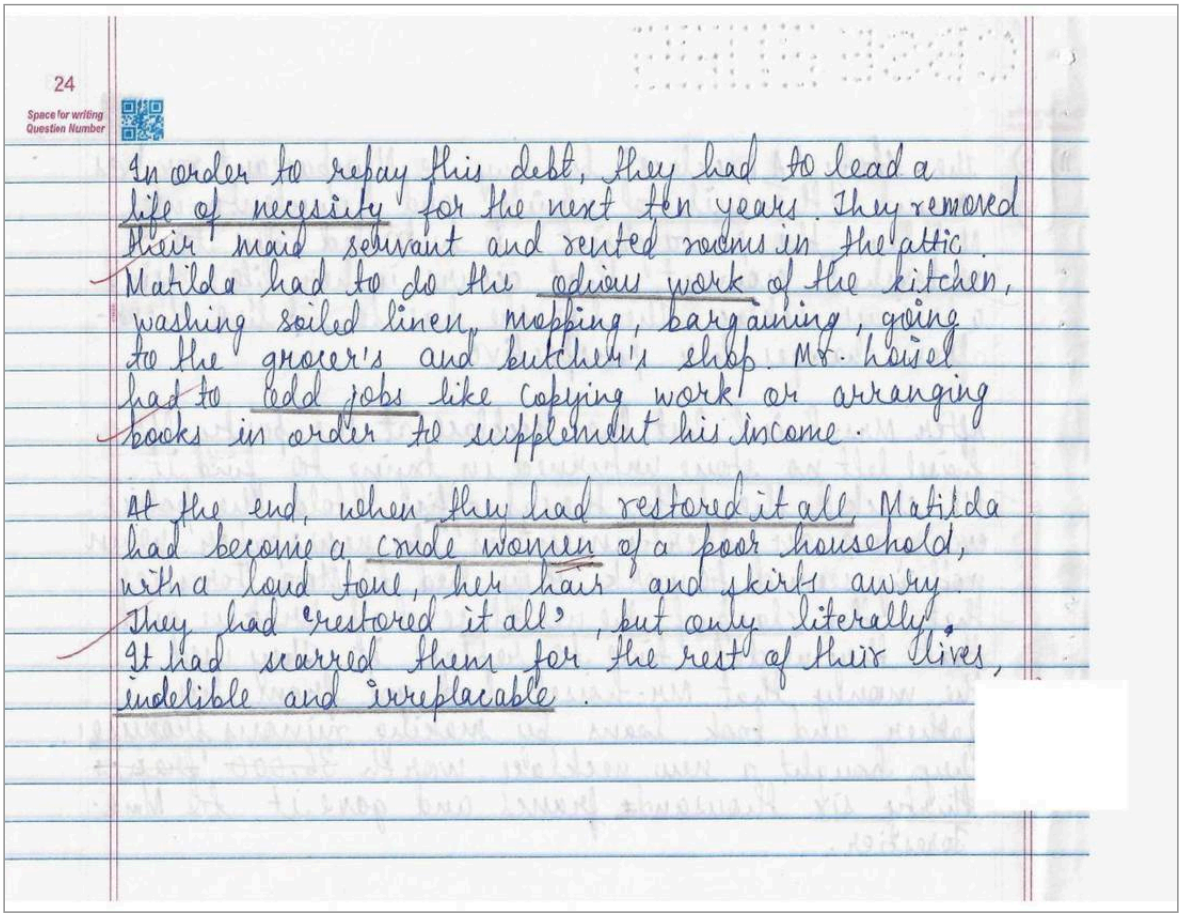
Space for writing Question Number

11) b) The story 'A Necklace' by Guy De Maupassant revolves around the evils of vanity and discontentment. Matilda, the protagonist is humbled due to a watershed moment that occurs in her life, losing a precious necklace. The life she has to ~~to~~ live thereafter changes her perspective.

After Mrs. Loisel lost the necklace at the party, Mr. Loisel left no stone unturned in trying to find it. He checked the path, the cab office, told the police, even gave an advertisement in the newspaper. When nothing seemed to work, they lied to Mme. Forestier that the clasp of the necklace had broken and that they needed time to replace it. They used the money that Mr. Loisel had got from his father and took loans by making ruinous promises. They bought a new necklace worth ~~36,000 francs~~ thirty six thousand francs and gave it to Mme. Forestier.

Q11 (B) · long answer (contd.)

answer book p.24



24

Space for writing Question Number

In order to repay this debt, they had to lead a life of necessity for the next ten years. They removed their maid servant and rented rooms in the attic. Matilda had to do the odious work of the kitchen, washing soiled linen, mopping, bargaining, going to the grocer's and butcher's shop. Mr. Loisel had to odd jobs like copying work or arranging books in order to supplement his income.

At the end, when they had restored it all, Matilda had become a crude woman of a poor household, with a loud tone, her hair and skirts awry. They had 'restored it all', but only literally. It had scarred them for the rest of their lives, indelible and irreplacable.

SAMPLE PAPER 4

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 4 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) When did you last sit with absolutely nothing to do — no phone, no screen, no plan? For most teenagers, the honest answer is 'I can't remember.' The moment a queue moves slowly or a class ends early, the itch to reach for a phone takes over. Boredom has come to be treated like a minor illness, something to be cured instantly. Yet a growing number of psychologists believe that this uncomfortable feeling may be one of the most underrated sources of creativity.

(2) Consider what happens when every empty minute is filled. A teenager scrolling through short videos receives a fresh burst of novelty every few seconds. The brain never has to generate its own entertainment, because entertainment is always delivered. Over time, the mind grows used to being fed rather than to feeding itself. As a result, the quiet space in which original ideas take shape is rarely allowed to exist.

(3) Researchers have tested this idea in simple ways. In one well-known experiment, participants first spent fifteen minutes on a deliberately dull task: copying numbers from a telephone directory. They were then asked to think of as many uses as possible for a pair of plastic cups. Those who had been bored came up with more ideas, and more unusual ones, than those who had gone straight to the creative task. A wandering mind, it seems, quietly links distant thoughts.

(4) Boredom works almost like an alarm. It tells us that what we are doing no longer satisfies us and nudges us to look for something more meaningful. Many people discover a lifelong passion during an empty summer: a girl who picks up her grandfather's old harmonium, a boy who begins sketching the street outside his window. Such interests rarely arrive on a crowded schedule. They grow in the gaps.

(5) This does not mean that all boredom is useful. Chronic boredom, the kind that comes from feeling trapped or purposeless for long periods, is linked to restlessness and low mood. The helpful kind is short-lived and voluntary — an afternoon without plans rather than a life without direction. What matters is what we do with the feeling: escape it at once, or stay with it long enough to see where it leads.

(6) Perhaps, then, the most creative thing a teenager can do is occasionally do nothing. Parents who fill every hour with tuitions and classes may wish to leave a little room on the timetable. Schools could treat quiet reflection as a skill rather than a waste of time. And young people themselves might try something radical: leave the phone in another room, look out of the window, and let the mind wander. The next great idea may be waiting on the other side of boredom.

Created for academic usage / 456 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'the itch to reach for a phone' suggest about teenagers' habits? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says, 'the mind grows used to being fed rather than to feeding itself', he refers to _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) the way constant ready-made entertainment weakens the mind's habit of producing its own ideas.

(b) the way teenagers depend on their parents for food and other daily needs.

III In paragraph 6, the writer recommends 'quiet reflection'. **1**
Which of the following is an example of the kind of unstructured time the writer recommends?

A. Attending an extra mathematics tuition on Sunday

B. Watching a series of short videos on a phone

C. Sitting on the balcony with no plan and letting thoughts wander

D. Completing a colouring worksheet set by the teacher

IV In paragraphs 3 and 4, the writer presents an experiment and examples from everyday life. What does this combination reveal about the writer's view of boredom? **2**

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 5) **1**
According to the writer, long periods of boredom caused by feeling trapped are as useful for creativity as a short afternoon without plans.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
constant notifications : scattered attention :: _____ : _____

(a) idle moments : original ideas

(b) original ideas : idle moments

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) In the experiment, participants copied numbers from a telephone directory for fifteen minutes.
(ii) Boredom may be one of the most underrated sources of creativity.
(iii) Participants who had been bored produced more uses for the plastic cups.
(iv) Schools should treat quiet reflection as a skill.
(v) The most creative thing a teenager can do is occasionally do nothing.

A. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

B. (i) O (ii) F (iii) F (iv) O (v) F

C. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) O

D. (i) F (ii) O (iii) O (iv) F (v) O

VIII What might be the author's purpose in ending the passage with the line, 'The next great idea may be waiting on the other side of boredom'? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) A recent national survey of about 12,000 students of Classes VI to XII across 20 Indian cities asked a simple question: how do children get to school? The answer reveals a quiet shift in the way young

Indians begin their day, and raises questions about their health, their safety and the air in their neighbourhoods.

(2) The survey found that 42% of students reach school through active modes — walking or cycling. The remaining 58% depend on motorised transport, the largest share being school buses and vans. The table below summarises the findings.

Mode of travel to school	Students (%)
Walking	28
Bicycle	14
School bus / van	22
Public transport (city bus / metro)	12
Car or two-wheeler driven by parents	18
Auto-rickshaw / e-rickshaw	6

(3) Distance explains part of the pattern. Nearly half the students surveyed live within two kilometres of their school, a distance most children can comfortably walk or cycle in under fifteen minutes. Yet 41% of these students are still dropped by car, two-wheeler or rickshaw. When asked why, parents most often mentioned unsafe traffic, the absence of footpaths and cycle lanes, and heavy school bags.

(4) The consequences go beyond convenience. Students who walked or cycled reported feeling more alert in the first period and spent, on average, 25 minutes more each day in physical activity than those who travelled by vehicle. Long queues of private vehicles at school gates were found to add to traffic congestion and pollution at the very hours when children are on the road. Experts believe that safe routes to school, organised ‘walking buses’ supervised by adults, and well-marked cycle lanes could encourage many more students to travel on their own two feet.

Created for academic usage / 247 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. The phrase ‘a quiet shift’ as used in paragraph 1 suggests a change that has been _____. (gradual and largely unnoticed / sudden and widely debated) **1**

II What does the fact that 41% of students living within two kilometres are still driven to school suggest about parents’ concerns? (Paragraph 3) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Motorised transport is used by a majority of the students surveyed.
Reason: Students who live close to their school are never driven there by their parents.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.

B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.

C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.

D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following are mentioned in paragraph 2 EXCEPT—

A. Twice as many students walk to school as cycle to school.

B. School buses and vans carry a larger share of students than any other motorised mode.

C. One in every three students travels by public transport.

D. More than half the students depend on motorised transport.

V Compare students who walk or cycle with those who travel by vehicle, on the basis of paragraph 4. What might this suggest for schools planning students’ well-being? **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 3) **1**
A distance of two kilometres is considered suitable for walking or cycling because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 4 that refers to groups of children walking to school together under adult supervision. **1**

VIII A school located on a busy road wants more of its students to cycle to school. Based on paragraph 4, suggest one measure it could ask the local authorities to take. **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'On Their Own Two Feet: How India Goes to School' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the line from an email sent by a school: **1**
Dear Parents,
We regret to inform you that the robotics workshop, which _____ for Saturday, has been postponed due to unavoidable reasons.

A. was scheduled B. has scheduled
C. is scheduling D. had been scheduling

II Report the coach's instruction to the players. **1**
Coach: "Drink plenty of water before the match."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the library notice: **1**
NOTICE
Students are requested to return _____ library books borrowed in July on or before 15 August.

A. all B. much C. every D. each

IV Read Rohan's statement to the Principal: **1**
"I have completed the project report and will submit it tomorrow."
Report Rohan's statement by completing the following sentence:
Rohan told the Principal that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a news report: **1**
The number of tourists visiting the hill station have doubled this year.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from a hospital's parking policy: **1**
Visitors _____ not park their vehicles in front of the emergency gate.

A. might B. must C. would D. ought

VII The given sentence has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

One of my friend has won the inter-school quiz.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	One	Ones
B.	friend	friends
C.	has	have
D.	won	win

VIII Meera asked the librarian the following question: **1**

"When will the new magazines arrive?"

Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.

Meera asked the librarian _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank. **1**

There are _____ apples left in the basket, so we must buy more before the guests arrive.

A. few B. little C. much D. less

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the line from a travel blog. **1**

Neither of the two mountain routes are safe for trekking during the monsoon.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the class teacher's reminder by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**

You _____ submit the consent form by Friday, or you will not be able to join the excursion. (should / might)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a local newsletter. **1**

The municipal workers _____ (repair) the old bridge for the last three months.

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Ishita Menon, a resident of Lake View Enclave, Bhopal. Every year, the main road of your locality gets badly waterlogged even after a short spell of rain, because the drains are blocked and have not been cleaned. Write a letter in 120 words to the Editor of a local daily, highlighting the problem, its effect on residents and schoolchildren, and suggesting measures the civic authorities should take. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Arjun Sethi, Librarian, Sunrise Public School, Jaipur. Write a letter in 120 words to Gyan Deep Book Distributors, M.I. Road, Jaipur, placing an order for books for the school library. Mention the titles, number of copies, mode of delivery and payment, and the discount expected. **5**

5 A. Read the product details of a solar-powered study lamp listed on an e-commerce website. **5**

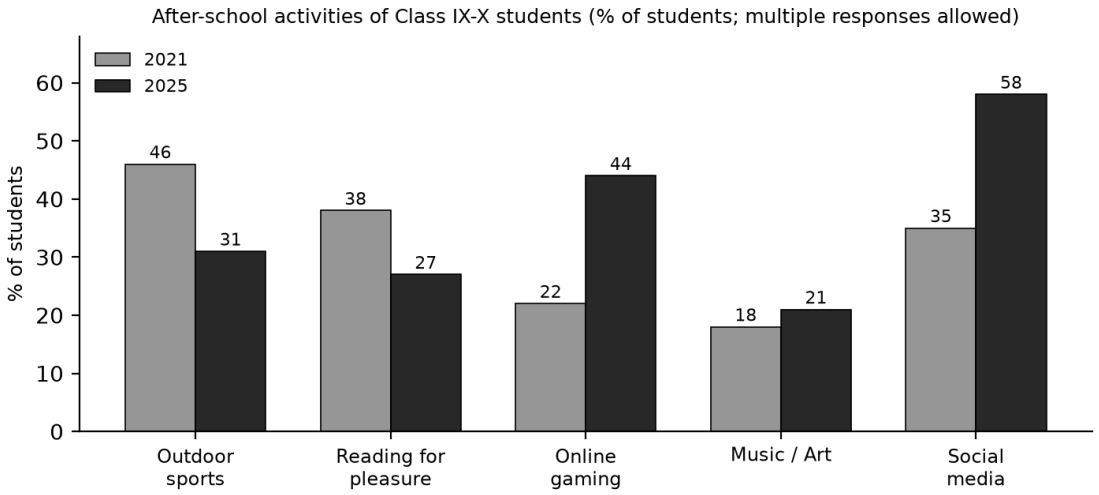
SunGlow Solar Study Lamp

– Charges by solar panel or USB; up to 10 hours of light on a full charge
– Three brightness levels and a flicker-free warm-white LED that reduces eye strain
– Foldable, lightweight body (420 g) that fits easily into a school bag
– Built-in battery indicator and auto-off timer to save power
– Shock-resistant body made of recycled plastic
– Available in sky blue and pale green
– 1-year replacement warranty

Now, analyse why this lamp would be a good purchase for students. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as its usefulness during power cuts, care for health, portability, energy efficiency and value for money.

OR

5 B. The bar graph below shows the after-school activities of Class IX–X students of a city in 2021 and 2025. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, analysing the changes shown in the graph. **5**



SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A

Lomov: I'm thinking of having a go at the blackcock, honoured Natalya Stepanovna, after the harvest. Oh, have you heard? Just think, what a misfortune I've had! My dog Guess, who you know, has gone lame.
Natalya: What a pity! Why?
Lomov: I don't know. Must have got his leg twisted or bitten by some other dog. [*sighs*] My very best dog, to say nothing of the expense. I gave Mironov 125 roubles for him.
Natalya: It was too much, Ivan Vassilevitch.
Lomov: I think it was very cheap. He's a first-rate dog.
Natalya: Papa gave 85 roubles for his Squeezer, and Squeezer is heaps better than Guess!
Lomov: Squeezer better than Guess? What an idea! [*laughs*] Squeezer better than Guess!

(The Proposal)

I Which of the following statements best explains Natalya's remark, 'It was too much, Ivan Vassilevitch'? 1

(a) She contradicts Lomov out of a habit of asserting the superiority of her own family.

(b) She is sincerely worried that Lomov has wasted his money on a lame dog.

II What does Lomov's remark, 'My very best dog, to say nothing of the expense' reveal about him? 1

A. He values Guess only for the money he paid.

B. He is proud of his dog and conscious of its price.

C. He regrets having bought Guess from Mironov.

D. He wants Natalya to pity him for his poverty.

III Complete the following suitably. 1

Just before this extract, Natalya asks Lomov whether he is going to start shooting soon, because she _____.

IV How does this exchange about the two dogs mirror the earlier quarrel over Oxen Meadows? What does it reveal about the characters? 2

OR

B

One of the employees, who was a postman and also helped at the post office, went to his boss laughing heartily and showed him the letter to God. Never in his career as a postman had he known that address. The postmaster — a fat, amiable fellow — also broke out laughing, but almost immediately he turned serious and, tapping the letter on his desk, commented, "What faith! I wish I had the faith of the man who wrote this letter. Starting up a correspondence with God!"

So, in order not to shake the writer's faith in God, the postmaster came up with an idea: answer the letter. But when he opened it, it was evident that to answer it he needed something more than goodwill, ink and paper. But he stuck to his resolution: he asked for money from his employees, he himself gave part of his salary, and several friends of his were obliged to give something 'for an act of charity'.

(A Letter to God)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1

The postmaster first laughs but almost immediately turns serious. This change shows that he _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1

The postmaster decided to answer the letter mainly _____.

A. to make fun of Lencho's simplicity

B. so that the writer's faith in God would not be shaken

C. to win the praise of his employees

D. to test the honesty of the post office staff

III Fill in the blank with the correct option from the bracket. 1

The word 'obliged' in 'several friends of his were obliged to give something' suggests that the friends contributed out of _____. (a sense of duty towards the postmaster / a deep personal faith in God)

IV '...to answer it he needed something more than goodwill, ink and paper.' What does this line reveal about the postmaster's problem and his character? 2

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A.

Belinda paled, and she cried Help! Help!
But Mustard fled with a terrified yelp,
Ink trickled down to the bottom of the household,

And little mouse Blink strategically mouseholed.

But up jumped Custard, snorting like an engine,
Clashed his tail like irons in a dungeon,
With a clatter and a clank and a jangling squirm,
He went at the pirate like a robin at a worm.

(The Tale of Custard the Dragon)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The line 'little mouse Blink strategically mouseholed' humorously suggests that Blink _____.

II The simile 'like a robin at a worm' suggests that Custard attacked the pirate _____. **1**

A. hesitantly and fearfully
B. eagerly and with ease
C. secretly and silently
D. cruelly and without reason

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
By coining the verb 'mouseholed', the poet shows his _____ use of language, which adds to the humour of the ballad.

IV Contrast the behaviour of Mustard and Custard in the extract. How does this reversal develop the central idea of the poem? **2**

OR

B.

"But I can get a hair-dye
And set such colour there,
Brown, or black, or carrot,
That young men in despair
May love me for myself alone
And not my yellow hair."

"I heard an old religious man
But yesternight declare
That he had found a text to prove
That only God, my dear,
Could love you for yourself alone
And not your yellow hair."

(For Anne Gregory)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The young woman's offer to dye her hair 'Brown, or black, or carrot' shows that she believes _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
The speaker refers to 'an old religious man' in order to _____.

A. mock the beliefs of religious people
B. give authority to his claim that only God loves unconditionally
C. show that he himself has lost faith in love
D. persuade the young woman to dye her hair

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
The poem is written in the form of a _____ between a young man and a young woman.

IV Why can the young woman not answer the speaker's final argument? What does it suggest about human love? 2

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3=12**

I Mandela says that every man has 'twin obligations'. How did fulfilling his obligation to his people affect his obligation to his family? 3

(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

II How does the poet use the contrasting settings of the cage and the jungle to convey the poem's message? 3

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

III The narrator never discovers who the pilot of the black aeroplane was. How does this unsolved mystery add to the impact of the story? 3

(Two Stories about Flying – The Black Aeroplane)

IV How does the poet link 'fire' and 'ice' to human emotions, and what warning does the poem give? 3

(Fire and Ice)

V How did Anne turn Mr Keesing's punishment into an opportunity? What does this reveal about her? 3

(From the Diary of Anne Frank)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3=6**

I Tricki recovers without any operation, yet Mrs Pumphrey calls it 'a triumph of surgery'. Explain the irony in the title. 3

(A Triumph of Surgery)

II Anil knew that Hari Singh had stolen his money, yet he neither scolded him nor reported him. What does this reveal about Anil, and how does it change Hari? 3

(The Thief's Story)

III Ausable 'did not fit any description of a secret agent'. How does he prove, through his presence of mind, that he is a very capable one? 3

(The Midnight Visitor)

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Kisa Gotami's search for a handful of mustard seed becomes a journey from personal grief to a universal truth. Trace this journey and explain the lesson the Buddha teaches through it. (The Sermon at Benares)

OR

B. 'In Goa, the baker is more than a seller of bread; he is a keeper of tradition.' Discuss with reference to 'A Baker from Goa'. (Glimpses of India)

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Horace Danby planned every robbery with great care, yet he was easily outwitted. Discuss how his own weaknesses and his misplaced trust led to his downfall, and comment on the irony in the title. (A Question of Trust)

OR

B. 'Brilliant scientist though he was, Griffin was rather a lawless person.' Write a character sketch of Griffin and comment on what his story teaches us about the misuse of scientific knowledge. (Footprints without Feet)

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SAMPLE PAPER 4

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

MARKING SCHEME · SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 4 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. MARKING SCHEME **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. The Marking Scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers / sample answers. The value points are in the nature of guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. The students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, then due marks should be awarded accordingly.
2. If a student has attempted an extra question, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note "Extra Question".
3. If more than one option is mentioned in the answer of multiple choice questions, then no marks to be awarded.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

Discursive Passage

1. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I It suggests that reaching for the phone has become an almost uncontrollable, reflex-like urge — teenagers feel restless the moment they have nothing to do and turn to their phones at once. **1**

II (a) the way constant ready-made entertainment weakens the mind's habit of producing its own ideas. **1**

III C. Sitting on the balcony with no plan and letting thoughts wander **1**

IV The experiment gives scientific support, while the everyday examples (the harmonium, the sketching) make the idea relatable. (½ + ½) **2**
Together they reveal that the writer sees boredom not as a waste of time but as a useful, even valuable state that sparks creativity and leads people to discover meaningful interests; his view is balanced, evidence-based and positive. (1)

V False **1**

VI (a) is correct. **1**
[Just as constant notifications *lead to* scattered attention (cause : effect), idle moments *lead to* original ideas. Option (b) reverses the order of cause and effect.]

VII A. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O **1**

VIII The writer ends on a hopeful, thought-provoking note to leave readers, especially teenagers, with a lasting impression. (½ + ½) **2**
It sums up the central argument that boredom can lead to creativity and encourages readers to accept boredom instead of escaping it, motivating them to try the change suggested. (1)

Case-Based Passage

2. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I	gradual and largely unnoticed	1
II	It suggests that parents are worried mainly about their children's safety and comfort (unsafe traffic, no footpaths or cycle lanes, heavy bags) rather than about distance.	1
III	C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false. [58% use motorised transport; but 41% of students living within two kilometres are still driven to school.]	1
IV	C. One in every three students travels by public transport. [Only 12% do.]	1
V	Students who walk or cycle feel more alert in the first period and get about 25 minutes more physical activity daily than those who travel by vehicle. (1) This suggests that schools can improve students' fitness and concentration by encouraging active travel, e.g. safe routes and walking groups. (1)	2
VI	most children can comfortably walk or cycle it in under fifteen minutes.	1
VII	'walking buses' (supervised by adults)	1
VIII	Any one – Ask for well-marked cycle lanes on the road leading to the school. – Request safe routes to school, e.g. footpaths and traffic control near the gate.	1
IX	Any one – The phrase 'on their own two feet' echoes the passage's central idea of encouraging active travel (walking and cycling). – It covers both the survey findings on how students commute and the call for change made at the end.	1

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR (10 marks)

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

Answer

1 mark for each correct answer (10 x 1 = 10).

I	A. was scheduled	1
II	The coach instructed / advised / told the players to drink plenty of water before the match.	1
III	A. all	1
IV	he had completed the project report and would submit it the next day / the following day.	1
V	Error: have Correction: has	1
VI	B. must	1
VII	B. friend – friends	1
VIII	when the new magazines would arrive.	1
IX	A. few	1
X	Error: are Correction: is	1
XI	should	1
XII	have been repairing	1

WRITING SKILLS (10 marks)

4. Format – 1 Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 1 Accuracy – 1 **1x5=5**

Answer

Criterion	Marks
Format: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, complimentary close, name/designation	1
Content: relevant points, adequately developed, within the word limit	2
Organisation of ideas: logical sequence, paragraphing, coherence	1
Accuracy: grammar, spelling, punctuation	1

A. **5**

Answer

(The response may be created from the following content points)

– **Issue and context:** main road of Lake View Enclave waterlogged after every short spell of rain; blocked, uncleaned drains **(½)**
– **Effects:** schoolchildren wade through dirty water or miss school; vehicles break down, traffic jams; open manholes and potholes hidden under water cause accidents; mosquito breeding, dengue/malaria risk; foul smell, damage to homes and shops **(½)**
– **Measures:** desilting and cleaning of drains before the monsoon; repair and widening of drains; covering manholes; regular inspection; a helpline for complaints; residents not to throw garbage into drains **(½)**
– **Appeal:** request the Editor to publish the letter so that the civic authorities act quickly **(½)**

Marks: Format 1 + Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 1 + Accuracy 1 = 5

Model Answer (4 A)

Lake View Enclave
Bhopal
30 October 2026

The Editor
The Bhopal Herald
Bhopal

Subject: Waterlogging on the main road of Lake View Enclave

Sir
Through the columns of your esteemed daily, I wish to draw the attention of the civic authorities to the severe waterlogging on the main road of our locality.
Even a short spell of rain floods the road because the drains are blocked and have not been cleaned for months. Schoolchildren wade through dirty water, two-wheelers break down and open manholes hidden under water have already caused accidents. The stagnant water breeds mosquitoes, putting residents at risk of dengue and malaria.
I request the Municipal Corporation to desilt and repair the drains before the next rains, cover all manholes and set up a helpline for complaints. Residents too must stop throwing garbage into drains.
I hope prompt action will be taken.

Yours faithfully
Ishita Menon

OR

B. **5**

Answer

(The response may be created from the following content points)

– Purpose: placing an order for books for the school library **(½)**
– List of titles with author/publisher and number of copies (a neat list or table) **(½)**

– Delivery: within a stated time (e.g. 10 days), to the school address, books in good condition; damaged books to be replaced **(½)**
– Payment: by cheque / bank transfer on delivery against bill **(½)**
– Discount expected (e.g. 15% as offered to educational institutions); request for confirmation of order **(½)**
Award ½ mark each for any 4 value points (Content: maximum 2).

Marks: Format 1 + Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 1 + Accuracy 1 = 5

5. Answer

Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 2 Accuracy – 1 **1x5=5**

Criterion	Marks
Content: analysis of the given cues, not a mere description; inference / conclusion	2
Organisation of ideas: logical flow, linkers, coherence, no title	2
Accuracy: grammar, spelling, punctuation	1

Analytical paragraph writing should NOT be confused with writing a description of given elements or writing a summary. It requires examining the given elements closely and sharing inputs based on the given stimulus. It carries no title or heading.

A. Answer

Suggested Response: **5**

The SunGlow Solar Study Lamp is a smart purchase for students who need reliable light for their studies. Firstly, it can be charged by the sun or through USB and gives up to ten hours of light, so power cuts no longer interrupt revision before examinations. Secondly, its flicker-free warm-white LED and three brightness levels reduce eye strain during long hours of reading. Moreover, the foldable 420-gram body fits easily into a school bag, making it ideal for hostels and travel. The battery indicator and auto-off timer save energy, while the shock-resistant body made of recycled plastic shows care for the environment. Finally, the one-year replacement warranty ensures value for money, making this lamp a practical and sensible investment.

Marks: Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 2 + Accuracy 1 = 5

OR

B. Answer

Suggested Response: **5**

The bar graph compares the after-school activities of Class IX–X students in 2021 and 2025, and reveals a clear shift from physical and reflective pursuits towards screen-based ones. Participation in outdoor sports fell sharply from 46% to 31%, and reading for pleasure declined from 38% to 27%. In contrast, online gaming doubled from 22% to 44%, while social media use rose most steeply, from 35% to 58%, making it the most popular activity in 2025. Music and art remained almost steady, rising slightly from 18% to 21%. Overall, the data suggests that screens are replacing playgrounds and books in students' free time. Schools and parents should therefore promote sports and reading to ensure a healthy balance.

Marks: Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 2 + Accuracy 1 = 5

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK 40 marks

6. Answer

Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A. Answer

Prose (The Proposal)

I (a) is correct **1**
[Natalya contradicts Lomov at every point to assert her family's superiority; she immediately compares Guess with her father's Squeezer. It is not sincere concern.]

II B. He is proud of his dog and conscious of its price. **1**

III Any one **1**
– wants to steer the conversation back to the proposal / get him started on the proposal
– wishes to make peace after the quarrel over Oxen Meadows and talk of something pleasant

IV – Like the Oxen Meadows dispute, a trivial matter turns into a heated argument as each insists that his/her own possession is better. (1) **2**
– It reveals that both characters are quarrelsome, stubborn and proud, unable to let the other win even moments before the proposal; Chekhov uses it to mock their pettiness and add humour. (1)

OR

B. Prose (A Letter to God)
Answer

I is touched by / respects Lencho's deep, simple faith in God (and is a kind, sensitive man) **1**

II B. so that the writer's faith in God would not be shaken **1**

III a sense of duty towards the postmaster **1**

IV – The problem: Lencho had asked for a hundred pesos, so a reply needed money, not merely kind words. (1) **2**
– His character: he is generous and determined — he sticks to his resolution, gives part of his own salary and collects money from employees and friends to preserve a stranger's faith. (1)

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**
Answer

A. Poetry (The Tale of Custard the Dragon)
Answer

I ran and hid in a mousehole out of fear, though the word 'strategically' mockingly presents his escape as a clever plan **1**

II B. eagerly and with ease **1**

III playful / inventive / humorous **1**

IV – Mustard, earlier described as 'brave as a tiger in a rage', flees with a terrified yelp, while Custard, mocked as a coward, jumps up and attacks the pirate fearlessly. (1) **2**
– This reversal develops the poem's message that true courage is shown in action at the moment of danger, not in boasts or appearances. (1)

OR

B. Poetry (For Anne Gregory)
Answer

I outer beauty is superficial and can be changed, and she wants to be loved for her inner self, not her looks **1**

II B. give authority to his claim that only God loves unconditionally **1**

III dialogue / conversation / debate **1**

IV – The speaker ends the argument by appealing to a higher authority — only God can love someone 'for yourself alone' — which leaves no room for reply. (1) **2**
– It suggests that human love is rarely unconditional; people are naturally attracted by outward qualities such as beauty, and pure, selfless love belongs to God alone. (1)

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3=12**

Answer

Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall

I **Value points:** **3**

– Every man has twin obligations: to his family and to his people / country **(1)**
– In apartheid South Africa, a man of colour who tried to fulfil his duty to his people was isolated and punished **(½)**
– Serving his people therefore tore Mandela away from his family; he could not be the son, husband and father he wished to be **(½)**

Model answer: Mandela believed every man owes duties to his family and to his people. In apartheid South Africa, a man of colour who served his people was isolated and imprisoned. His commitment to freedom thus forced him away from his family, and he could not be the son, husband and father he wished.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

II **Value points:** **3**

– Cage: paces the few steps of his concrete cell in quiet rage, ignores the visitors **(1)**
– Jungle: lurks in shadow, slides through long grass near the water hole, terrorises the villages **(½)**
– Message: captivity is cruel; wild animals belong to their natural habitat **(½)**

Model answer: Leslie Norris contrasts the tiger pacing the few steps of his concrete cell in quiet rage with the free tiger lurking in shadow, sliding through long grass near the water hole. The contrast exposes the cruelty of captivity and shows that wild animals belong in their natural habitat, not in zoos.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

III **Value points:** **3**

– No other aeroplane on the radar and the pilot had almost no fuel left **(1)**
– The black aeroplane vanishes without trace; its identity is left a mystery **(½)**
– Effect: suspense and wonder; readers may see it as a guardian angel, a ghost or the pilot's own instinct **(½)**

Model answer: The control tower saw no other aircraft on its radar, and the black aeroplane vanished without trace. Leaving the pilot unidentified keeps the suspense alive and lets readers interpret it as a guardian angel, a ghost or the pilot's own instinct. The open ending makes the story memorable and haunting.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

IV **Value points:** **3**

– Fire stands for desire and greed, which spread fast and consume everything **(1)**
– Ice stands for hatred and indifference, which harden hearts **(½)**
– Both are equally destructive; the poem warns that unchecked emotions can end the world **(½)**

Model answer: Frost uses 'fire' for desire and greed, which spread quickly and consume everything, and 'ice' for hatred and coldness, which harden hearts. Both, he says, are equally capable of destroying the world. The poem warns that if humans do not control these emotions, they will bring about their own end.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

V **Value points:** **3**

– Punished with essays: ‘A Chatterbox’ and ‘An Incorrigible Chatterbox’; argued talking is a student’s trait inherited from her mother **(1)**
– Witty poem ‘Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox’; Mr Keesing took the joke well and stopped punishing her **(½)**
– Reveals Anne’s wit, confidence and creativity **(½)**

Model answer: Mr Keesing punished Anne with essays on being a chatterbox. Anne argued that talking was a student’s trait inherited from her mother, and finally wrote a witty poem, ‘Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox’. He took the joke well and stopped punishing her. It reveals Anne’s wit, confidence and creativity.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

9. **2x3=6**

Answer

Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words.
Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall

I **Value points:** **3**

– Tricki was ill from overfeeding and no exercise **(1)**
– Herriot kept him at the surgery for two weeks without medicine: little food at first, then play and exercise with other dogs **(½)**
– Recovery came from diet and exercise; Mrs Pumphrey’s word ‘surgery’ shows her ignorance – ironic and humorous **(½)**

Model answer: No surgery was performed. Herriot only kept the overfed Tricki at the surgery, gave him no food at first and let him play with other dogs. Diet and exercise cured him. Mrs Pumphrey, unaware that her pampering was the cause, calls it ‘a triumph of surgery’, which makes the title ironic and humorous.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

II **Value points:** **3**

– Hari stole Anil’s money, missed the Lucknow Express and returned the notes at night **(1)**
– Next morning the fifty-rupee note Anil gave him was still wet from the rain, so Anil knew; he only said ‘Today we’ll start writing sentences’ **(½)**
– Anil is kind, forgiving and trusting; his silent trust makes Hari choose education and honesty **(½)**

Model answer: The fifty-rupee note was still wet from the night’s rain, so Anil knew of the theft. Yet neither his lips nor his eyes showed anything; he simply said, ‘Today we’ll start writing sentences.’ This reveals his kindness and forgiveness. His silent trust made Hari choose learning over stealing.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

III **Value points:** **3**

– Fat, ordinary-looking, not a romantic spy; calm when Max threatens him with a pistol for the missile report **(1)**
– Invents a detailed story of a balcony under his window and says the police will check on him **(½)**
– At the waiter’s knock Max jumps onto the non-existent balcony and falls: presence of mind and wit make Ausable a true secret agent **(½)**

Model answer: Though fat and ordinary-looking, Ausable stayed calm at gunpoint. He invented a detailed story about a balcony under his window and said the police would check on him. When the waiter knocked, Max jumped onto the imaginary balcony and fell. Ausable’s presence of mind proves him a true secret agent.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A. **6**

Answer

– Kisa Gotami's only son died; mad with grief she carried the dead body from house to house asking for medicine **(1)**
– Sent to the Buddha, who asked for a handful of mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend **(1)**
– She found no such house; realised that death is common to all **(½)**
– Lesson: life is short and full of suffering; grief brings more pain; the wise do not grieve; one who overcomes sorrow attains peace (selfishness of grief) **(½)**

Model answer:

Kisa Gotami's only son died, and, mad with grief, she carried his body from house to house asking for medicine. Finally she reached the Buddha, who asked her to bring a handful of mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend. People pitied her and offered the seed, but every household had lost someone dear. Sitting by the wayside as the city lights flickered out, she realised how selfish her grief had been, for death is common to all. Through this journey the Buddha taught that life is brief and full of suffering, that mourning only increases pain, and that the wise who overcome sorrow attain peace.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B. **6**

Answer

– Bakers (paders) survive from Portuguese days; the age-old furnaces still exist; sons continue the family profession **(1)**
– 'Jhang, jhang' of his bamboo staff announced his arrival; children ran to meet him; loaves and bread-bangles **(1)**
– Bread essential at every occasion: sweet bread 'bol' for marriages, cakes and bolinhas for Christmas, sandwiches for a daughter's engagement **(½)**
– Distinct dress (the 'kabai', later shirt and trousers); monthly accounts recorded in pencil on the wall; plump physique – a prosperous profession **(½)**

Model answer:

In 'A Baker from Goa', Lucio Rodrigues shows that the baker, or pader, is a living link with Goa's Portuguese past. Though the Portuguese have left, the age-old furnaces still burn and sons carry on their fathers' trade. The 'jhang, jhang' of his bamboo staff once woke the village, and children ran to him for bread-bangles. Bread is part of every celebration: sweet bread called 'bol' at marriages, cakes and bolinhas at Christmas, and sandwiches for a daughter's engagement. Even his dress, the knee-length frock called the 'kabai', and his monthly accounts pencilled on the wall belong to an old way of life. Thus the baker preserves the customs and identity of Goan village life.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A. **6**

Answer

– Horace Danby, about fifty, locksmith, respectable; robbed one safe a year to buy rare books **(1)**
– Careful planner: studied Shotover Grange for two weeks, wore gloves, calmed the dog Sherry by name **(½)**
– Weaknesses: hay fever (sneezing at the flowers), fear of prison, eagerness to please the young lady in red who posed as the owner's wife and 'forgot' the numbers **(½)**
– Took off his gloves, opened the safe; fingerprints – arrested; the real wife, sixty, called his story nonsense; now assistant librarian in prison **(½)**
– Irony: the trusting thief is tricked by a fellow thief – no 'honour among thieves' **(½)**

Model answer:

Horace Danby, a fifty-year-old locksmith, seemed a respectable citizen, but he robbed one safe every year to buy rare books. He studied Shotover Grange for two weeks, wore gloves and calmed the dog by calling it Sherry. Yet his hay fever made him sneeze at the flowers, and his fear of prison made him desperate to please. A charming young lady in red, posing as the owner's

wife, said she had forgotten the numbers of the safe. Trusting her, Horace took off his gloves and opened it. She escaped with the jewels, while his fingerprints sent him to prison. The title is ironic: Horace trusted a fellow thief and learnt that there is no honour among thieves.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B. Answer — **6**

– Brilliant scientist: discovered a rare drug that made his body transparent as a sheet of glass **(1)**
– Lawless and selfish: set fire to his landlord's house in revenge; attacked a shopkeeper from behind and robbed him; stole the clergyman's housekeeping money at Iping **(1)**
– Rude, irritable and secretive with Mrs Hall; violent when cornered – knocked constable Jaffers unconscious and escaped **(½)**
– Message: knowledge without morality is dangerous; science must serve humanity, not crime or revenge **(½)**

Model answer:
Griffin was a brilliant scientist who discovered a rare drug that made his body as transparent as a sheet of glass. However, he used his genius only for selfish ends. When his landlord tried to eject him, he set fire to the house in revenge. In London, he attacked a shopkeeper from behind and robbed him, and at Iping he stole money from the clergyman's desk. He was rude and irritable with Mrs Hall, and when cornered, he knocked the constable Jaffers unconscious and escaped. Griffin shows that knowledge without morality is dangerous. Science should serve humanity; misused for crime and revenge, it becomes a threat to society.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

Marks Summary

Section	Marks
Section A: Reading Skills	20
Section B: Writing Skills & Grammar	20
Section C: Literature Textbook	40
Total	**80**

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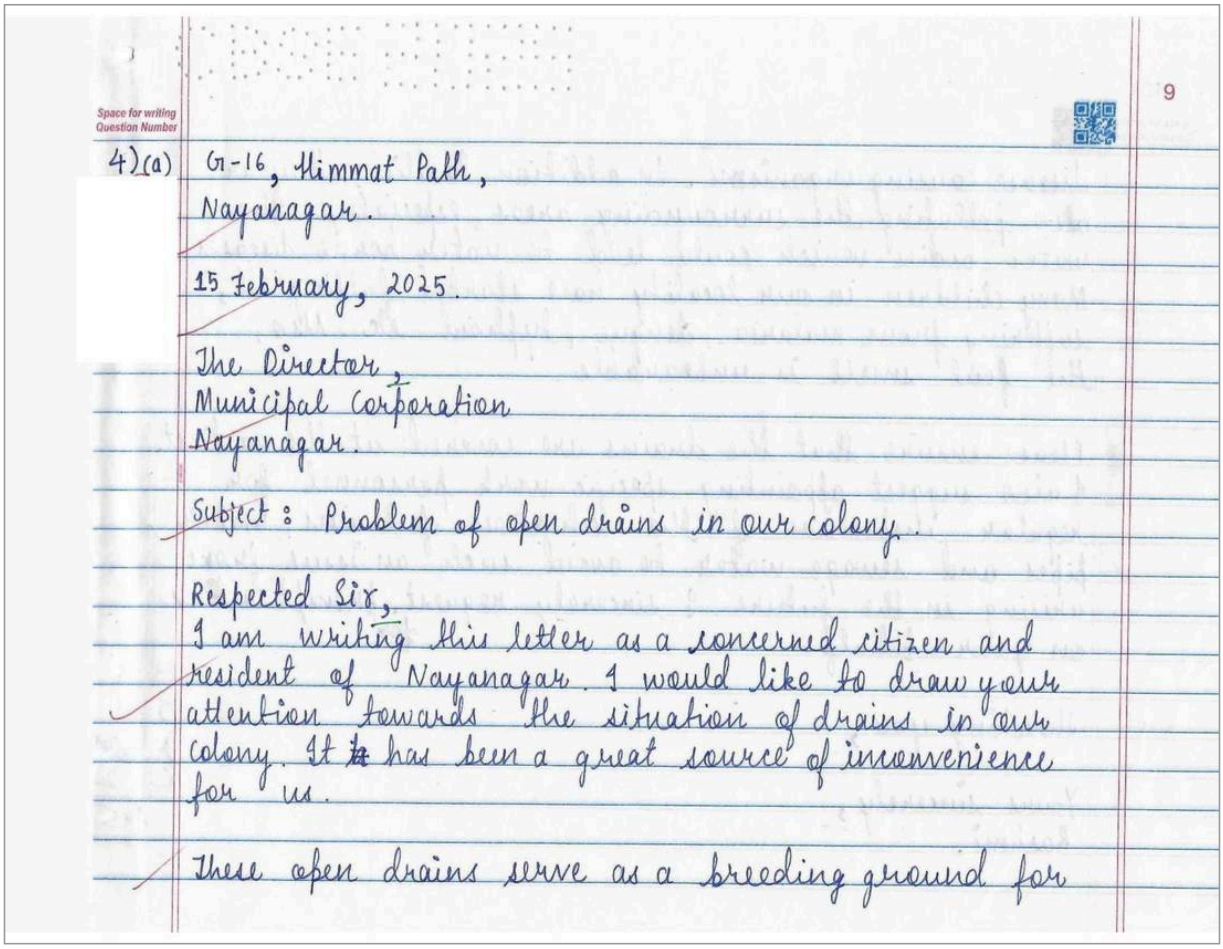
Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q4 (A) (formal letter on blocked drains) answer book p.9



Space for writing Question Number

9

4)(a) G-16, Himmat Path,
Nayanagar.

15 February, 2025.

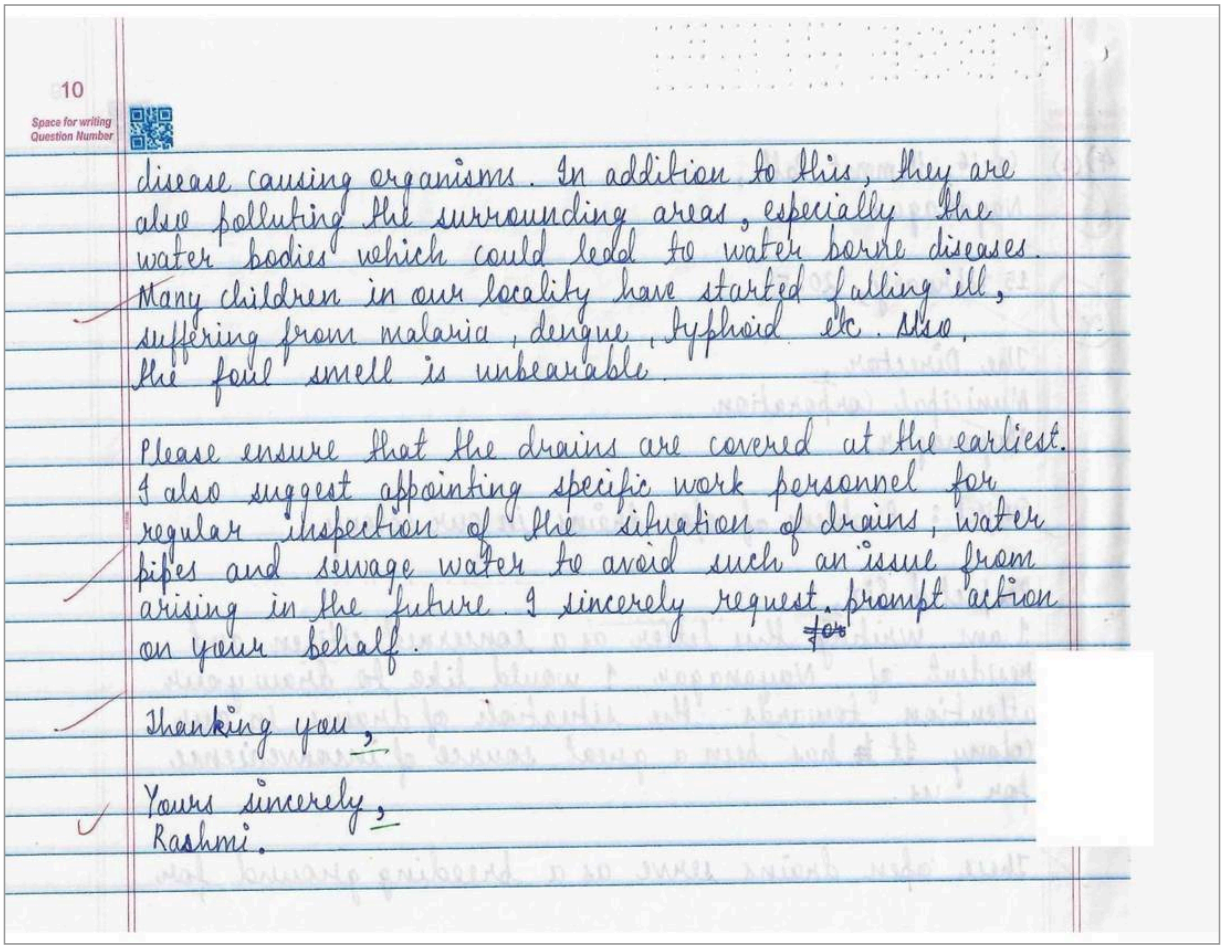
The Director,
Municipal Corporation
Nayanagar.

Subject : Problem of open drains in our colony.

Respected Sir,
I am writing this letter as a concerned citizen and resident of Nayanagar. I would like to draw your attention towards the situation of drains in our colony. It has been a great source of inconvenience for us.

These open drains serve as a breeding ground for

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · formal letter (contd.) answer book p.10



10

Space for writing Question Number

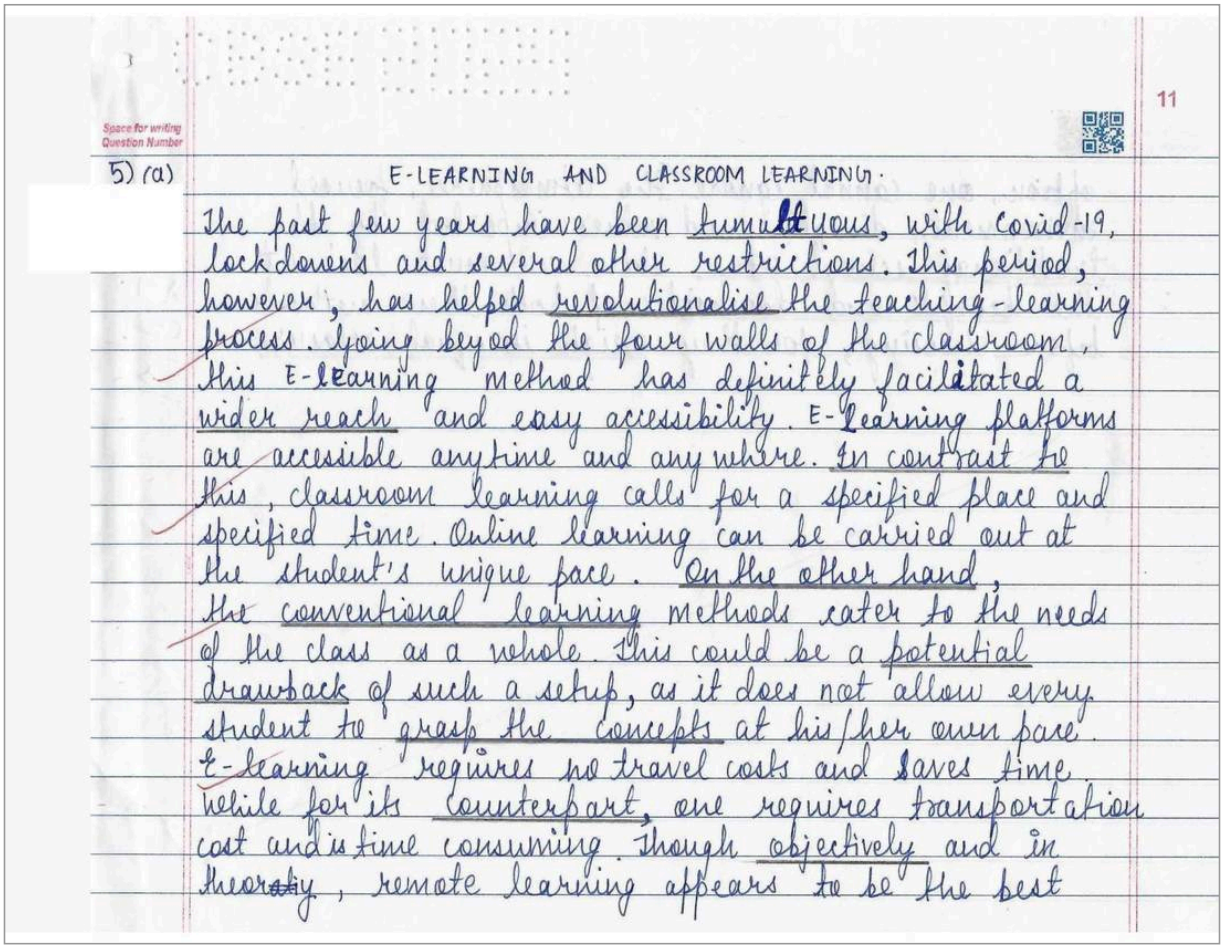
disease causing organisms. In addition to this, they are also polluting the surrounding areas, especially the water bodies which could lead to water borne diseases. Many children in our locality have started falling ill, suffering from malaria, dengue, typhoid etc. Also, the foul smell is unbearable.

Please ensure that the drains are covered at the earliest. I also suggest appointing specific work personnel for regular inspection of the situation of drains, water pipes and sewage water to avoid such an issue from arising in the future. I sincerely request prompt action on your behalf.

Thanking you,

Yours sincerely,
Rashmi.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q5 (B) (analytical paragraph on a chart) answer book p.11



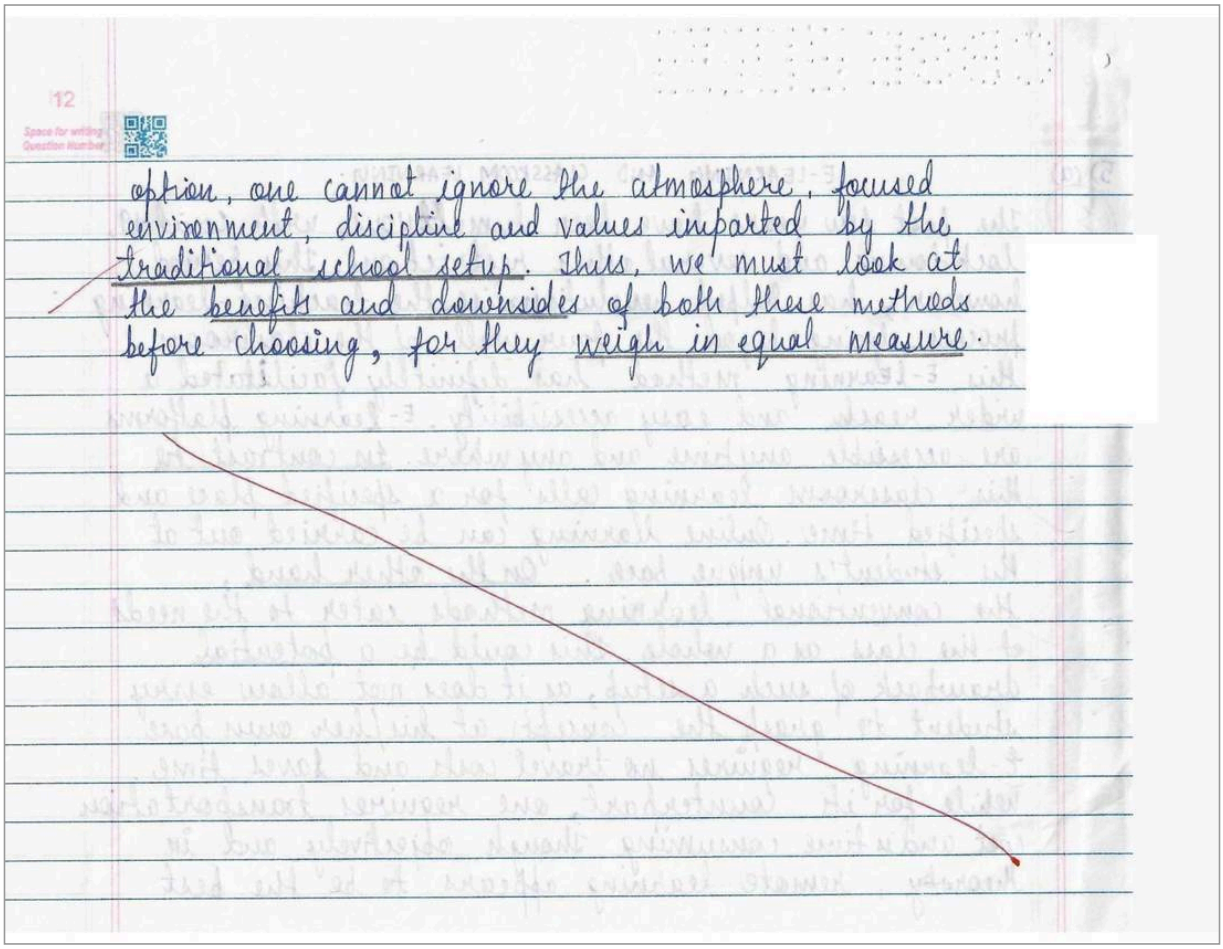
11

Space for writing Question Number

5) (a) E-LEARNING AND CLASSROOM LEARNING.

The past few years have been tumultuous, with Covid-19, lockdowns and several other restrictions. This period, however, has helped revolutionalise the teaching-learning process. Going beyond the four walls of the classroom, this E-learning method has definitely facilitated a wider reach and easy accessibility. E-learning platforms are accessible anytime and anywhere. In contrast to this, classroom learning calls for a specified place and specified time. Online learning can be carried out at the student's unique pace. On the other hand, the conventional learning methods cater to the needs of the class as a whole. This could be a potential drawback of such a setup, as it does not allow every student to grasp the concepts at his/her own pace. E-learning requires no travel costs and saves time, while for its counterpart, one requires transportation cost and is time consuming. Though objectively and in theory, remote learning appears to be the best

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · analytical paragraph (contd.) answer book p.12

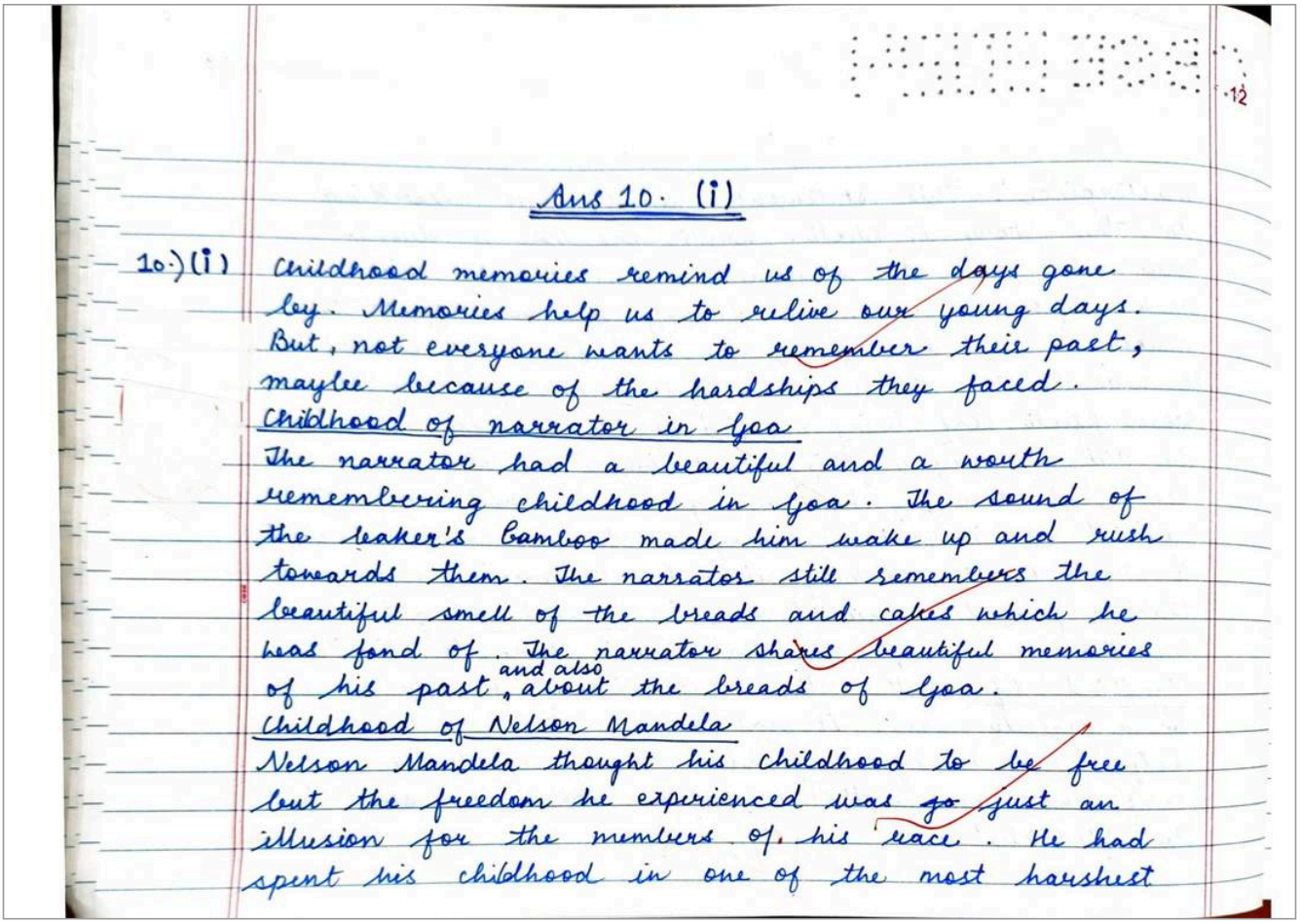


12

Space for writing Question Number

option, one cannot ignore the atmosphere, focused environment, discipline and values imparted by the traditional school setup. Thus, we must look at the benefits and downsides of both these methods before choosing, for they weigh in equal measure.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · similar to Q10 (B) (long answer, Glimpses of India) answer book p.12



Ans 10. (i)

10.)(i) Childhood memories remind us of the days gone by. Memories help us to relive our young days. But, not everyone wants to remember their past, maybe because of the hardships they faced.

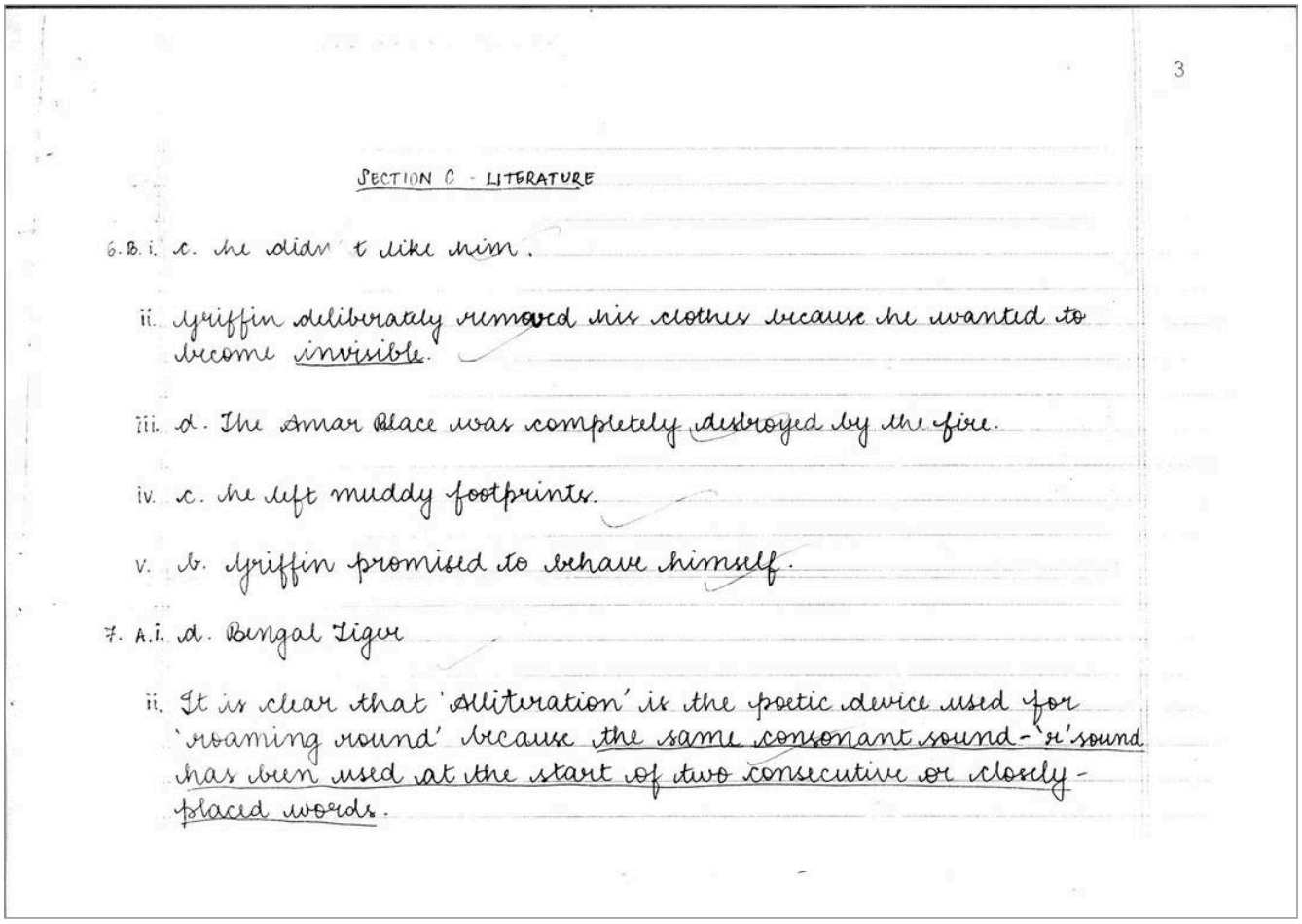
Childhood of narrator in Goa

The narrator had a beautiful and a worth remembering childhood in Goa. The sound of the leaker's bamboo made him wake up and rush towards them. The narrator still remembers the beautiful smell of the breads and cakes which he was fond of. The narrator shares beautiful memories of his past, and also about the breads of Goa.

Childhood of Nelson Mandela

Nelson Mandela thought his childhood to be free but the freedom he experienced was so just an illusion for the members of his race. He had spent his childhood in one of the most harshest

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · similar to Q11 (B), Q8 (II) (Footprints without Feet; A Tiger in the Zoo) answer book p.3



3

SECTION C - LITERATURE

6.B.i. c. he didn't like him.

ii. Griffin deliberately removed his clothes because he wanted to become invisible.

iii. d. The Amar Place was completely destroyed by the fire.

iv. c. he left muddy footprints.

v. b. Griffin promised to behave himself.

7. A.i. d. Bengal Tiger

ii. It is clear that 'alliteration' is the poetic device used for 'roaming round' because the same consonant sound - 'r' sound has been used at the start of two consecutive or closely-placed words.

SAMPLE PAPER 5

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 5 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) When did you last write a letter by hand – not a text, not an email, but ink on paper? Keyboards and touchscreens have quietly taken over our schoolwork, our office notes and even our birthday greetings. Typing is quick, neat and easy to correct, so it is tempting to ask whether handwriting has become a relic, as outdated as the inkpot. Yet the question deserves a second look, because the pen may be doing far more for us than we realise.

(2) Consider what happens in the brain when we write by hand. Forming each letter requires the fingers, the eyes and the memory to work together. Studies with school and college students have reported that those who took notes by hand remembered and understood lectures better than those who typed them. The reason is simple: a typist can copy words almost as fast as they are spoken, while a writer has to listen, select and summarise. That slower pace, which seems like a weakness, is actually a strength. It forces the mind to think before the hand moves.

(3) Handwriting matters for young learners too. Teachers often notice that children who practise writing letters by hand learn to recognise and read them faster. The careful shaping of an ‘a’ or a ‘g’ trains fine motor skills* and patience – qualities that serve a child well beyond the copybook.

(4) There is a personal side to the argument as well. A handwritten note carries something no font can copy. The slant of the letters, a word crossed out, a smudge of ink – all of these reveal the person behind the page. A grandmother’s recipe written in her own hand is a treasure; the same recipe printed from a website is merely information. Is it any wonder that people preserve old letters for decades but delete thousands of emails without a second thought?

(5) None of this means that we should abandon our devices. Digital tools let us share, search and store our work in ways paper never could. The real danger lies not in using keyboards but in letting the skill

of writing by hand quietly disappear from our lives, especially when board examinations are still written with a pen.

(6) Perhaps the answer is balance. We can type when speed matters and write when thinking, remembering or feeling matters. Keeping a journal, drafting an essay by hand or sending a handwritten card on a friend's birthday are small choices, but they keep alive a skill that connects the hand, the head and the heart. In an age of screens, the humble pen may be one of the most powerful tools we still own.

*fine motor skills: the ability to make small, precise movements using the muscles of the hands and fingers

Created for academic usage / 440 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'as outdated as the inkpot' suggest about the way many people view handwriting today? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says, 'That slower pace, which seems like a weakness, is actually a strength', he means that _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) writing by hand makes the learner listen, select and summarise information instead of copying it mechanically.

(b) writing by hand takes longer, so students get extra time to relax and rest their minds during lectures.

III The writer mentions 'fine motor skills' in paragraph 3. **1**
Which of the following is an example of a fine motor skill?

A. Running a hundred-metre race on a track

B. Threading a needle to stitch a button

C. Lifting a heavy box onto a shelf

D. Swimming across a pool without stopping

IV In paragraph 4, the writer compares a grandmother's handwritten recipe with the same recipe printed from a website. **2**
What does this comparison reveal about the writer's view of handwriting?

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 5) **1**
The writer believes that digital devices should be given up in favour of handwriting.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
thousands of emails : deleted :: _____ : _____

(a) old letters : preserved

(b) printed recipes : information

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) A typist can copy words almost as fast as they are spoken.
(ii) A handwritten note carries something no font can copy.
(iii) Board examinations are still written with a pen.
(iv) The humble pen may be one of the most powerful tools we still own.
(v) Digital tools let us search and store our work easily.

A. (i) O (ii) O (iii) F (iv) F (v) F

B. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) F

C. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F

D. (i) O (ii) F (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

VIII What is the writer's purpose in acknowledging the advantages of digital tools in paragraph 5? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Every evening, in kitchens across India's cities, perfectly edible food is scraped into the dustbin. A 2025 survey of 4,000 households found that an average urban household throws away about 1.2 kilograms of food every week. Multiplied across millions of homes, this quiet habit adds up to a staggering loss of food, money and resources.

(2) Cooked leftovers make up the largest share of household food waste at 38%, followed by fruits and vegetables that spoil before use (31%). Bread and bakery items account for 14%, dairy products for 10%, and other items for the remaining 7%. Nearly six out of ten respondents admitted that they regularly cook more than their family needs, mainly to avoid 'running short' if guests arrive.

(3) Awareness, however, does not always lead to action. While 72% of the households said that wasting food is wrong, only 29% planned their weekly meals or made a shopping list before buying groceries. Households that planned their purchases wasted 40% less food than others. Moreover, 45% of the respondents could not explain the difference between 'best before' and 'use by' dates.

(4) Food waste is not merely a moral concern. Rotting food in landfills releases methane, a greenhouse gas far more powerful than carbon dioxide. Experts suggest simple steps – buying only what is needed, storing produce correctly, reusing leftovers and composting peels – that can cut waste sharply. Small changes in millions of kitchens can make a measurable difference to the country's food security and environment.

Composition of household food waste in urban India (survey of 4,000 households, 2025)

Type of food wasted	Cooked leftovers	Fruits & vegetables	Bread & bakery	Dairy products	Others
Share of household food waste	38%	31%	14%	10%	7%

Created for academic usage / 246 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The word 'staggering' as used in paragraph 1 suggests that the loss is _____.
(shockingly large / slowly increasing)

II What does the fact that most families cook extra food to avoid 'running short' suggest about their priorities? (Paragraph 2) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Most of the urban households surveyed planned their weekly meals before buying groceries.
Reason: 72% of the households surveyed said that wasting food is wrong.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.

B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.

C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.

D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following are mentioned in paragraphs 2 and 3 EXCEPT—

A. Fruits and vegetables form nearly one-third of household food waste.

B. Fewer than one-third of the households made a shopping list before buying groceries.

C. Dairy products form a larger share of household food waste than bread and bakery items.

D. Nearly half the respondents were unsure of the difference between 'best before' and 'use by' dates.

V Compare the percentage of households that think wasting food is wrong with the percentage that plan their meals. What does this gap reveal? (Paragraph 3) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 4) **1**
Food rotting in landfills harms the environment because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 1 which indicates that food is wasted routinely and without much notice. **1**

VIII Mrs Rao often throws away bread and milk because she is not sure whether they are still safe to consume. Which finding of the survey applies to her situation, and how can she reduce such waste? (Paragraph 3) **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Waste on Our Plates: The Hidden Cost of Urban Kitchens' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening lines of a formal email: **1**
Dear Mr. Khanna,
We are pleased to inform you that the new library wing _____ to students from Monday, 9 November.

A. will be opened B. has been opened C. was opened D. had been opened

II Report the coach's instruction to the players. **1**
Coach: "Do not leave the ground until the practice session is over."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the notice issued by a Resident Welfare Association: **1**
Residents are requested to ensure that _____ vehicle parked in the visitors' area is moved by 8 p.m.

A. every B. all C. few D. many

IV Read Arjun's statement to the school librarian: **1**
"I have returned the book that I borrowed last week."
Report Arjun's statement by completing the following sentence:
Arjun told the librarian that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a survey report: **1**
Mathematics are the subject that most students find challenging, according to the survey.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from a weather update in a school newsletter: **1**
The sky has been cloudy since morning; it _____ rain in the evening, so carry an umbrella.

A. must B. may C. shall D. would

VII The given question has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

Did she finished the assignment before the deadline?

No.	Error	Correction
A.	Did	Does
B.	finished	finish
C.	before	after
D.	the	a

VIII The class teacher asked Riya the following question: **1**
"Why did you not attend the rehearsal yesterday?"
Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.
The class teacher asked Riya _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank in a ticket-booking alert. **1**
There are only _____ seats left for the concert, so book your tickets quickly.
A. a few B. little C. much D. a little

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the given line from a travel blog. **1**
I have visited Jaipur last December and loved its colourful markets.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the notice at a museum by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**
Visitors _____ take photographs in the gallery; it is strictly prohibited. (must not / need not)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the bracket from a news report. **1**
By the time the fire brigade arrived, the residents _____ (evacuate) the building.

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Arnav Bhatia, a resident of 27, Gandhi Vihar, Lucknow. For three weeks, your locality has faced frequent, unannounced power cuts lasting three to four hours, just before the board examinations. Write a letter in 120 words to the Assistant Engineer, City Electricity Board, Hazratganj, Lucknow, complaining about the problem and the difficulties it causes, and requesting prompt action. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Sneha Kulkarni, a Class 10 student of Green Valley School, Panampilly Nagar, Kochi. You have seen an advertisement for a four-week Summer Robotics Camp by RoboMinds Academy, Koramangala, Bengaluru. Write a letter in 120 words to the Camp Coordinator, enquiring about the dates, fee, eligibility and accommodation for outstation students. **5**

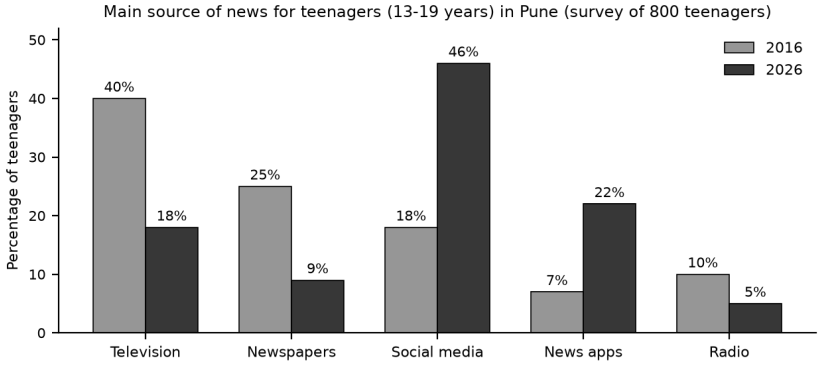
5 A. Read the product details of a smart water bottle mentioned on an e-commerce website. **5**

– Built-in sensor tracks every sip and records daily water intake
– LED cap glows gently to remind you when it is time to drink
– Syncs with a free mobile app that sets a daily goal based on age, weight and activity
– Double-walled stainless steel; keeps water cold for 24 hours and hot for 12 hours
– 750 ml capacity; leak-proof, BPA-free and dishwasher-safe body
– One USB-C charge lasts up to 15 days
– Price: ₹1,499 with a 1-year warranty

Now, analyse why this water bottle would be a good purchase for students. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as health benefits, smart features, convenience, durability and value for money.

OR

5 B. The bar graph below shows the results of a survey of 800 teenagers in Pune about their main source of news in 2016 and in 2026. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, analysing the changes and suggesting possible reasons for them. **5**



SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A.

It is from these comrades in the struggle that I learned the meaning of courage. Time and again, I have seen men and women risk and give their lives for an idea. I have seen men stand up to attacks and torture without breaking, showing a strength and resilience that defies the imagination. I learned that courage was not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it. The brave man is not he who does not feel afraid, but he who conquers that fear. No one is born hating another person because of the colour of his skin, or his background, or his religion. People must learn to hate, and if they can learn to hate, they can be taught to love, for love comes more naturally to the human heart than its opposite. Even in the grimmest times in prison, when my comrades and I were pushed to our limits, I would see a glimmer of humanity in one of the guards, perhaps just for a second, but it was enough to reassure me and keep me going. Man's goodness is a flame that can be hidden but never extinguished.

(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

I Which of the following statements best explains Mandela's idea of courage in the extract? **1**

(a) A brave person feels fear but refuses to let it control his actions.

(b) A brave person never experiences fear, even when facing torture.

II The line 'Man's goodness is a flame that can be hidden but never extinguished' suggests that human goodness is _____. 1

A. weak and easily destroyed by cruelty
B. enduring, even when it is suppressed
C. visible only during times of happiness
D. found only among freedom fighters

III Complete the following suitably. 1
Mandela believes that love can be taught because _____.

IV How does Mandela's experience with the prison guards support his belief that love comes more naturally to the human heart than hate? 2

OR

B.

Paris was about 150 kilometres behind me when I saw the clouds. Storm clouds. They were huge. They looked like black mountains standing in front of me across the sky. I knew I could not fly up and over them, and I did not have enough fuel to fly around them to the north or south.
"I ought to go back to Paris," I thought, but I wanted to get home. I wanted that breakfast.
'I'll take the risk,' I thought, and flew that old Dakota straight into the storm.
Inside the clouds, everything was suddenly black. It was impossible to see anything outside the aeroplane. The old aeroplane jumped and twisted in the air. I looked at the compass. I couldn't believe my eyes: the compass was turning round and round and round. It was dead. It would not work!

(Two Stories about Flying: The Black Aeroplane)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1
The comparison of the storm clouds to 'black mountains' emphasises their _____.

II The narrator's decision, 'I'll take the risk', shows that he _____. 1

A. was an expert pilot who never feared bad weather
B. allowed his longing to reach home to outweigh caution
C. had been instructed by Paris Control to enter the storm
D. had enough fuel to turn back whenever he wished

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
The repeated mention of 'that breakfast' reveals the narrator's _____ to reach home.

IV How does the writer build suspense in the extract? 2

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A.

The way a crow
Shook down on me
The dust of snow
From a hemlock tree

Has given my heart
A change of mood
And saved some part
Of a day I had rued.

(Dust of Snow)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1
The crow and the hemlock tree, usually associated with gloom, become in the poem a source of _____.

II The word 'rued' in the last line suggests that, before this incident, the poet _____. 1

A. had enjoyed the day thoroughly
B. had regretted the way the day was going
C. had forgotten what happened that day
D. had planned the day very carefully

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
The poem conveys that even a _____ moment in nature can lift a heavy heart.

IV How does the poet's choice of the crow and the hemlock tree add depth to the poem's message? 2

OR

B.

Some say the world will end in fire
Some say in ice.
From what I've tasted of desire
I hold with those who favour fire.
But if it had to perish twice,
I think I know enough of hate
To say that for destruction ice
Is also great
And would suffice.

(Fire and Ice)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1
In the poem, 'ice' symbolises _____.

II Which of the following best captures the poet's view in the poem? 1

A. Fire alone is capable of destroying the world.
B. Ice is far weaker than fire as a force of destruction.
C. Both desire and hatred are powerful enough to destroy the world.
D. The world can never be destroyed by human emotions.

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
The understatement in 'would suffice' makes the poet's warning more _____.

IV Why does the poet say that he 'holds with those who favour fire'? What does this reveal about human nature? 2

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3=12**

I Mr Keesing's punishments ended up giving Anne a chance to show her wit. How did Anne's essays change his attitude towards her? 3

(From the Diary of Anne Frank)

II How does the poet use contrasting images of the cage and the jungle to bring out the plight of the tiger? 3

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

III How did the search for a mustard seed help Kisa Gotami understand the truth about life and death? 3

(The Sermon at Benares)

IV How does the poet use humour and wordplay while giving 'advice' on identifying wild animals? **3**

(How to Tell Wild Animals)

V Which details in the account of Coorg highlight the martial traditions and the bravery of the Kodavu people? **3**

(Glimpses of India – Coorg)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3=6**

I Ausable did not fit Fowler's idea of a secret agent, yet he outwitted Max without firing a shot. How did his presence of mind save the report? **3**

(The Midnight Visitor)

II Horace Danby, who was always careful not to leave fingerprints, was finally caught because of his own fingerprints. How did the lady in red trick him into this? **3**

(A Question of Trust)

III Why did Mrs Hall and the people of Iping begin to suspect that there was something strange about their new guest, Griffin? **3**

(Footprints without Feet)

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Gavin Maxwell's account of Mijbil shows that keeping a wild creature as a pet brings both joy and responsibility. Discuss with reference to Maxwell's experiences with Mijbil in Basra, on the journey to London and in London.

(Mijbil the Otter)

OR

B. In 'The Proposal', Lomov comes to propose marriage but ends up quarrelling over Oxen Meadows and the dogs. Evaluate how Chekhov uses these quarrels to satirise the priorities of the landowning class.

(The Proposal)

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. 'Start with a first-rate mind, add curiosity, and mix in the will to win for the right reasons.' Show how Richard Ebright's journey from butterfly collector to scientist illustrates this formula, and how even his failures helped him.

(The Making of a Scientist)

OR

B. Instead of telling Mme Forestier the truth, the Loisels hid the loss of the necklace and spent ten years repaying the debt. Was their decision wise? Discuss how false pride and lack of honesty led to their suffering, and the lesson the story teaches.

(The Necklace)

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SAMPLE PAPER 5

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

MARKING SCHEME · SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 5 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. MARKING SCHEME **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. The Marking Scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers / sample answers. The value points are in the nature of guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. The students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, then due marks should be awarded accordingly.
2. If a student has attempted an extra question, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note "Extra Question".
3. If more than one option is mentioned in the answer of multiple choice questions, then no marks are to be awarded.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

Discursive Passage

1. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I It suggests that many people have begun to see handwriting as old-fashioned and no longer useful, a relic of the past that has been replaced by keyboards and touchscreens. **1**

II (a) writing by hand makes the learner listen, select and summarise information instead of copying it mechanically. **1**

III B. Threading a needle to stitch a button
[It needs small, precise movements of the fingers.] **1**

IV The comparison reveals that the writer values handwriting for its personal and emotional worth, not merely for the information it carries. A handwritten recipe carries the writer's identity (the slant of letters, crossings-out, smudges) and becomes a treasured keepsake, whereas a printed copy is impersonal and merely functional. Handwriting thus connects people and preserves memories. (1+1) **2**

V False **1**

VI (a) is correct.
[Just as thousands of emails are deleted without a thought, old (handwritten) letters are preserved for decades; the relationship is 'item : what people do with it'.] **1**

VII B. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) F **1**

VIII By admitting the real benefits of digital tools (sharing, searching, storing), the writer presents a balanced and fair argument. This makes the case for handwriting more credible and persuasive, since the writer is not against technology but against losing a valuable skill. It also prepares readers for the conclusion that the answer lies in balance. (any two points, 1+1) **2**

Case-Based Passage

2. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I shockingly large **1**

II It suggests that families value hospitality and avoiding embarrassment before guests more than preventing food waste. / Social image matters more to them than the cost of wasted food. **1**

III D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.
[Only 29% planned their meals; 72% did say that wasting food is wrong.] **1**

IV C. Dairy products form a larger share of household food waste than bread and bakery items.
[Dairy is 10%, bread and bakery 14%.] **1**

V 72% of households believe that wasting food is wrong, but only 29% plan their meals or make a shopping list – a gap of 43 percentage points. (1)
This reveals that awareness alone does not change behaviour; good intentions are not translated into simple practical habits that actually reduce waste. (1) **2**

VI it releases methane, a greenhouse gas far more powerful than carbon dioxide. **1**

VII this quiet habit **1**

VIII Any one **1**
- She is among the 45% who are confused about 'best before' and 'use by' dates; understanding the difference would stop her from throwing away food that is still safe.
- Label confusion applies to her; she should check the labels correctly, buy smaller quantities and store bread and milk properly.

IX Any one **1**
- The title captures the central idea that food waste happens on our own plates and in our kitchens, and points to its 'hidden' costs – money, resources and harm to the environment – discussed in the passage.
- It covers all four paragraphs: the scale of waste, its causes, the awareness–action gap and its environmental cost.

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR (10 marks)

3. Answer
Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**
1 mark for each correct answer (10 x 1 = 10).

I A. will be opened **1**

II The coach ordered / instructed / told the players not to leave the ground until the practice session was over. **1**

III A. every **1**

IV he had returned the book that he had borrowed the previous week / the week before. **1**

V Error: are Correction: is **1**

VI B. may **1**

VII B. finished – finish **1**

VIII why she had not attended the rehearsal the previous day / the day before. **1**

IX A. a few **1**

X Error: have visited Correction: visited **1**

XI must not **1**

XII had evacuated **1**

WRITING SKILLS (10 marks)

4. Answer **1x5=5**

Criterion	Marks
Format (sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, complimentary close, signature/name)	1
Content (relevance, coverage of the given points)	2
Organisation of ideas (logical sequence, coherence)	1
Accuracy (grammar, spelling, punctuation)	1

A. Answer **5**

Value points:
- Format of a formal letter of complaint; subject: frequent power cuts in Gandhi Vihar during the examination season **(Format 1)**
- Problem: unannounced power cuts for three weeks, two or three times a day, three to four hours each, mostly in the evening; helpline complaints unanswered **(1)**

– Effects: students cannot study before the board examinations; online classes disrupted; elderly and sick suffer without fans and water pumps; shops lose business **(½)**
– Request: inspect and repair the faulty transformer/lines; uninterrupted supply during examinations; advance notice of planned cuts; prompt action **(½)**

Model answer:

27, Gandhi Vihar
Lucknow
16 February 2027

The Assistant Engineer
City Electricity Board
Hazratganj, Lucknow

Subject: Frequent power cuts in Gandhi Vihar during the examination season

Sir
I wish to bring to your notice the frequent and unannounced power cuts in Gandhi Vihar for the past three weeks. Repeated complaints on your helpline have brought no relief.
Every day, the electricity goes off two or three times, often for three to four hours, mostly in the evening. With the board examinations about to begin, students are unable to study, and online classes are disrupted. Elderly and sick residents suffer without fans and water pumps, and shopkeepers are losing business.
I request you to look into the matter urgently, repair the faulty transformer, if any, and ensure an uninterrupted supply at least during the examinations. Planned cuts, if unavoidable, may be announced in advance.

Yours faithfully
Arnav Bhatia

Marks: Format 1 + Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 1 + Accuracy 1 = 5

OR

B. Answer

Value points: **5**

– Format of a letter of enquiry; subject: enquiry about the Summer Robotics Camp **(Format 1)**
– Reference to the advertisement; interest in joining the four-week camp **(½)**
– Queries: exact dates and daily timings; total fee, what it covers, mode of payment and any concession **(½)**
– Eligibility: age/class, prior knowledge of coding or robotics needed, selection process, number of seats **(½)**
– Accommodation for outstation students: hostel facility, meals, safety and supervision, extra charges **(½)**
– Request for a brochure/registration form and an early reply; polite close **(½)**
Award ½ mark each for any 4 value points (Content: maximum 2).

Marks: Format 1 + Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 1 + Accuracy 1 = 5

5. Answer **1x5=5**

Criterion	Marks
Content (analysis of the given cues, relevance)	2
Organisation of ideas (introduction, logical flow, conclusion)	2
Accuracy (grammar, spelling, punctuation)	1

Analytical paragraph writing should NOT be confused with writing a description of given elements or writing a summary. It requires examining the given elements closely and sharing inputs based on the given stimulus. It carries no title or heading.

A. Answer

Value points: **5**

– Health: tracks every sip and records daily intake; LED cap reminds at intervals – keeps students hydrated and alert **(½)**
– Smart features: app sets a personal daily goal (age, weight, activity) **(½)**
– Convenience: 750 ml, leak-proof, fits in a school bag; keeps water cold 24 hours/hot 12 hours; one charge lasts 15 days **(½)**
– Durability and safety: double-walled stainless steel, BPA-free, dishwasher-safe **(½)**
– Value: ₹1,499 with a 1-year warranty; logical conclusion **(½)**
Award ½ mark each for any 4 value points (Content: maximum 2).

Suggested response:

The smart water bottle is a sensible purchase for students who often forget to drink enough water. To begin with, its built-in sensor records every sip, while the glowing LED cap reminds the user to drink at regular intervals, helping students stay hydrated, alert and healthy. Moreover, the free mobile app sets a personal daily goal based on age, weight and activity, which makes good habits easy to track. In terms of convenience, the 750 ml leak-proof body fits easily into a school bag and keeps water cold for 24 hours. Its stainless steel, BPA-free design ensures safety and durability, and one charge lasts up to fifteen days. Priced at ₹1,499 with a one-year warranty, it offers good value for money.

Marks: Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 2 + Accuracy 1 = 5

OR

B. Answer

Value points: 5

– Introduction: survey of 800 teenagers in Pune; main source of news, 2016 vs 2026 **(½)**
– Social media rose from 18% to 46% – the leading source in 2026; news apps rose from 7% to 22% **(½)**
– Television fell from 40% to 18%; newspapers from 25% to 9%; radio halved from 10% to 5% **(½)**
– Possible reasons: cheaper smartphones and data, instant short updates; concern: fake news, need to verify sources; conclusion **(½)**

Suggested response:

The bar graph compares the main sources of news for 800 teenagers in Pune in 2016 and 2026. The most striking change is the rise of social media, whose share jumped from 18% to 46%, making it the leading source in 2026. News apps also grew sharply, from 7% to 22%. In contrast, traditional sources lost ground: television fell from 40% to 18%, newspapers dropped from 25% to 9%, and radio halved from 10% to 5%. These shifts are probably due to cheaper smartphones, affordable internet and the appeal of instant, short updates. However, the growing dependence on social media also raises concerns about fake news, which suggests that teenagers need to verify what they read and use trusted sources.

Marks: Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 2 + Accuracy 1 = 5

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK 40 marks

6. Answer

Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A. Answer

Prose (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

I (a) is correct. 1
[Mandela says courage is 'not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it'; the brave man is the one who conquers fear.]

II B. enduring, even when it is suppressed 1

III no one is born hating; hatred is learnt, and if people can learn to hate, they can also be taught to love, which comes more naturally to the human heart. 1

IV Even in the grimmest times in prison, when Mandela and his comrades were pushed to their limits, he saw a glimmer of humanity in a guard, though only for a second. (1) 2
If goodness survived even in those who served a cruel, oppressive system, it proves that love is natural and goodness can be hidden but never extinguished; this reassured him and kept him going. (1)

OR

B. Answer

Prose (Two Stories about Flying – The Black Aeroplane)

I huge size and threatening / menacing nature (they formed a barrier he could not cross) 1

II B. allowed his longing to reach home to outweigh caution 1

III eagerness / longing / impatience / desire 1

IV Any two 2
– Short, abrupt sentences ('Storm clouds. They were huge.') create tension.
– The pilot's dilemma – he cannot fly over or around the clouds and lacks fuel – heightens the danger.
– The risky decision is followed by sudden blackness, the plane jumping and twisting, and the dead compass, leaving readers anxious about what will happen next. (1+1)

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

Answer

A. **Poetry (Dust of Snow)**

Answer

I joy / a change of mood / hope / comfort **1**

II B. had regretted the way the day was going **1**

III small / simple / trivial / ordinary **1**

IV The crow is usually seen as a bad omen and the hemlock is a poisonous tree; both suggest gloom and sorrow. (1)
By making these unlikely objects the cause of his change of mood, Frost shows that joy can come from the most unexpected sources and that even ordinary or unpleasant things in nature can heal a sad heart, which deepens the poem's message. (1) **2**

OR

B. **Poetry (Fire and Ice)**

Answer

I hatred / coldness / indifference / rigidity **1**

II C. Both desire and hatred are powerful enough to destroy the world. **1**

III chilling / powerful / effective / forceful **1**

IV From his own experience ('from what I've tasted of desire'), the poet knows how consuming and destructive desire – greed, lust, ambition – can be, like fire. (1)
This reveals that uncontrolled desire is a universal human weakness that can lead to destruction, and that the poet himself is not free of it. (1) **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3=12**

Answer

Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall

I **Value points:** **3**

– Punished for talking: essays 'A Chatterbox' and 'An Incorrigible Chatterbox' **(1)**
– Argued that talking is a student's trait, inherited from her mother **(½)**
– Witty poem 'Quack, Quack, Quack, said Mistress Chatterbox'; Mr Keesing took the joke well, let her talk **(½)**

Model answer: When Mr Keesing punished Anne for talking with essays like 'A Chatterbox', she argued convincingly that talking was a student's trait inherited from her mother. Her witty poem, 'Quack, Quack, Quack, said Mistress Chatterbox', won him over. He took the joke the right way, read it to the class, let her talk and stopped punishing her.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

II **Value points:** **3**

– Cage: stalks 'the few steps of his cage', 'quiet rage', 'locked in a concrete cell', ignores visitors **(1)**
– Jungle: lurking in shadow, near the water hole, terrorising the village **(½)**
– Contrast brings out loss of freedom, power and natural dignity; stares helplessly at the stars **(½)**

Model answer: In the zoo, the tiger stalks 'the few steps of his cage' in 'quiet rage', locked in a concrete cell and ignoring visitors. In the jungle, he should be lurking in shadow near the water hole or terrorising the village. This contrast shows how captivity has robbed him of freedom, power and dignity.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

III **Value points:** **3**

– Kisa Gotami, mad with grief, sought medicine for her dead son **(1)**
– The Buddha asked for mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend **(½)**
– No such house; realised death is universal – 'the living are few, but the dead are many'; selfish grief is futile **(½)**

Model answer: The Buddha asked the grieving Kisa Gotami to bring mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a loved one. Going from house to house, she found none. She realised that death is common to all and 'the living are few, but the dead are many'. She understood that selfish grief is futile.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

IV **Value points:** **3**

– Mock-serious tone; ‘advice’ arrives only when it is too late **(1)**
– Lion identified as “you’re dyin’”, tiger ‘if he eats you’, bear by its hug, hyena by its smile, crocodile by its tears **(½)**
– Wordplay and deliberate spellings for rhyme: “dyin’”/‘Lion’, ‘peppered’/‘Leopard’, ‘lept’ **(½)**

Model answer: Carolyn Wells gives absurd, mock-serious advice: you know the Asian Lion when he roars “as you’re dyin’”, the Bengal Tiger if he eats you, and the bear by its hug. Playful rhymes and spellings like “dyin’”–‘Lion’ and ‘peppered’–‘Leopard’ heighten the humour, since the identification always comes too late.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

V **Value points:** **3**

– Possibly descended from a part of Alexander’s army; martial traditions in their culture **(1)**
– Kuppia; Coorgi homes recount tales of valour of sons and fathers **(½)**
– Coorg Regiment one of the most decorated; General Cariappa, first Chief of the Indian Army, a Coorgi; Kodavus allowed to carry firearms without a licence **(½)**

Model answer: The Kodavus are possibly descended from a part of Alexander’s army, and their culture shows martial traditions. Coorgi homes proudly recount tales of valour of their sons and fathers. The Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated, General Cariappa was a Coorgi, and Kodavus alone may carry firearms without a licence.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3=6**

Answer

Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall

I **Value points:** **3**

– Max waiting in Ausable’s sixth-floor room with a pistol, demanding the report on new missiles **(½)**
– Ausable calmly invented a story about a balcony below his window, used by an intruder before **(½)**
– When there was a knock, he claimed it was the police; Max, fearing capture, jumped onto the ‘balcony’, which did not exist **(½)**
– The knock was only the waiter, Henry, with drinks Ausable had ordered – wit, not a weapon **(½)**

Model answer: Faced with Max’s pistol, Ausable calmly invented a balcony below his window. When someone knocked, he claimed it was the police. Terrified, Max climbed out to hide on the ‘balcony’, which did not exist, and fell. The visitor was only the waiter, Henry, with drinks.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

II **Value points:** **3**

– Horace was sneezing with hay fever when a young, pretty woman in red appeared and posed as the lady of the house **(½)**
– She claimed she had forgotten the combination of the safe and wanted her jewels; promised not to call the police **(½)**
– Eager to please her, Horace took off his gloves to light her cigarette and then opened the safe with bare hands **(½)**
– His fingerprints were all over the room; the real owner’s wife was a grey-haired woman of sixty – the lady was a thief too **(½)**

Model answer: Posing as the lady of the house, the woman in red promised not to call the police if Horace opened the safe for her jewels. Eager to please her, he removed his gloves to light her cigarette, then opened the safe barehanded. His fingerprints betrayed him.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

III **Value points:** 3

– Arrived at the Iping inn in winter, wrapped in bandages, with dark glasses and a large hat; avoided company **(½)**
– Told Mrs Hall he wanted solitude and that an accident had affected his face; irritable temper, strange habits **(½)**
– Ran short of money and pretended to be expecting a cheque; the clergyman's house was robbed early one morning **(½)**
– His room was found empty with his clothes and bandages lying about; furniture attacked Mrs Hall – witchcraft suspected **(½)**

Model answer: Griffin arrived at the inn in winter, wrapped in bandages, with dark glasses and a hat, and shunned company. When the clergyman's money was stolen, his room was found empty, his clothes and bandages lying about, and the furniture attacked Mrs Hall. Suspicion fell on him.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score)

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**
Answer
Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A. **Mijbil the Otter** **6**
Answer
Value points:

– Joy: Mij's playfulness – wild delight in the bathtub, turning on the tap, dribbling a rubber ball; in London, games with ping-pong balls and marbles; strong bond; Mij followed Maxwell without a lead **(1)**
– Responsibility: airline rules, special box, journey via Paris; Mij tore the box lining and bled, escaped in the aircraft – chaos **(1)**
– Maxwell's care and patience; London: walks on a lead, curious public; a pet is a serious, demanding commitment **(1)**

Model answer:

Mijbil filled Gavin Maxwell's life with joy. In Basra, the otter grew so attached that he followed Maxwell without a lead and went wild with delight in the bathtub, even learning to turn on the tap. In London he played for hours with ping-pong balls and marbles.
Yet Mij also brought heavy responsibility. Because the airline would not carry animals, Maxwell had to fly via Paris with Mij packed in a box. Mij tore its lining and bled, and once let out on the plane, he dashed down the aircraft, causing chaos among the passengers. His experiences show that a wild pet brings deep companionship, but only to those willing to accept patience and constant care.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B. **The Proposal** **6**
Answer
Value points:

– Lomov comes to propose but quarrels over Oxen Meadows and then the dogs Guess and Squeezer **(1)**
– Pride, possessiveness and greed overpower love; insults, Lomov's palpitations, Chubukov's abuse **(1)**
– Marriage seen as an economic arrangement – land, property; reconciliation hurried, quarrels continue even after engagement **(½)**
– Satire on the materialism and pettiness of the Russian landowning class **(½)**

Model answer:

Chekhov uses the quarrels to expose the materialism of the landowning class. Lomov, a hypochondriac, comes to propose to Natalya, but the moment he mentions 'my Oxen Meadows', both forget the proposal and fight over a worthless strip of land. Chubukov joins in with insults, and the 'respected' neighbours call each other names. Later, after the hurried engagement, they quarrel again over whether Guess or Squeezer is the better dog.
These petty disputes show that pride and possession matter more to them than love. Marriage itself is viewed as a business deal: Lomov wants a good housekeeper, and Chubukov wants to settle his daughter well. Through farce and exaggeration, Chekhov mocks a class that values property above human relationships.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**
Answer
Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A. **Making of a Scientist** **6**
Answer
Value points:

– First-rate mind: a straight-A student who learned easily; later a new theory on how a cell 'reads' the blueprint of its DNA **(1)**

– Curiosity: collected all twenty-five species of butterflies around Reading by the second grade; *The Travels of Monarch X* (from his mother) opened science; tagging monarchs for Dr Urquhart; raising monarchs in his basement **(1)**
– Will to win for the right reasons: lost the county science fair in the seventh grade with slides of frog tissue – learnt that winners do real experiments; viceroy–monarch project placed first in zoology; gold-spots hormone project won first place for zoology at the International Fair **(½)**
– Failure as a teacher; Mr Weiherer: competitive but not in a bad sense **(½)**

Model answer:

Richard Ebright's life shows all three ingredients. His curiosity began early: by the second grade he had collected all twenty-five species of butterflies around his hometown, and *The Travels of Monarch X*, a gift from his mother, opened the world of science to him.
Failure taught him an important lesson. In the seventh grade he lost at a county science fair with slides of frog tissue, and realised that winners do real experiments. Thereafter, his projects on viceroys and the gold spots of the monarch pupa won top prizes.
With his first-rate mind, he later explained how a cell reads its DNA. He competed not for prizes but to do his best.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B. Answer

The Necklace **6**

Value points:

– Matilda borrowed a diamond necklace from Mme Forestier for the Minister's ball and lost it **(½)**
– False pride: unwilling to admit the loss; Loisel had her write that the clasp was broken, to gain time **(½)**
– Bought a replacement for thirty-six thousand francs (asked forty thousand); used his eighteen thousand francs inheritance and borrowed the rest from usurers **(½)**
– Ten years of hardship: dismissed the servant, moved to an attic, heavy housework; Matilda grew old and coarse **(½)**
– Irony: the original was false, worth not over five hundred francs; honesty would have saved them **(½)**
– Lesson: honesty, contentment, avoiding vanity and pretence **(½)**

Model answer:

Their decision was not wise. When Matilda lost Mme Forestier's necklace after the Minister's ball, false pride stopped the Loisels from admitting the truth. Instead, Matilda wrote that she was getting the clasp mended, and they bought a replacement for thirty-six thousand francs, borrowing heavily.
For ten years they paid a terrible price. They dismissed their servant, moved into an attic, and Matilda did heavy housework until she looked old and worn.
The cruel irony is that the original necklace was false, worth not more than five hundred francs. One honest confession would have spared them a decade of misery. The story teaches that vanity and dishonesty bring suffering, while honesty and contentment bring peace.

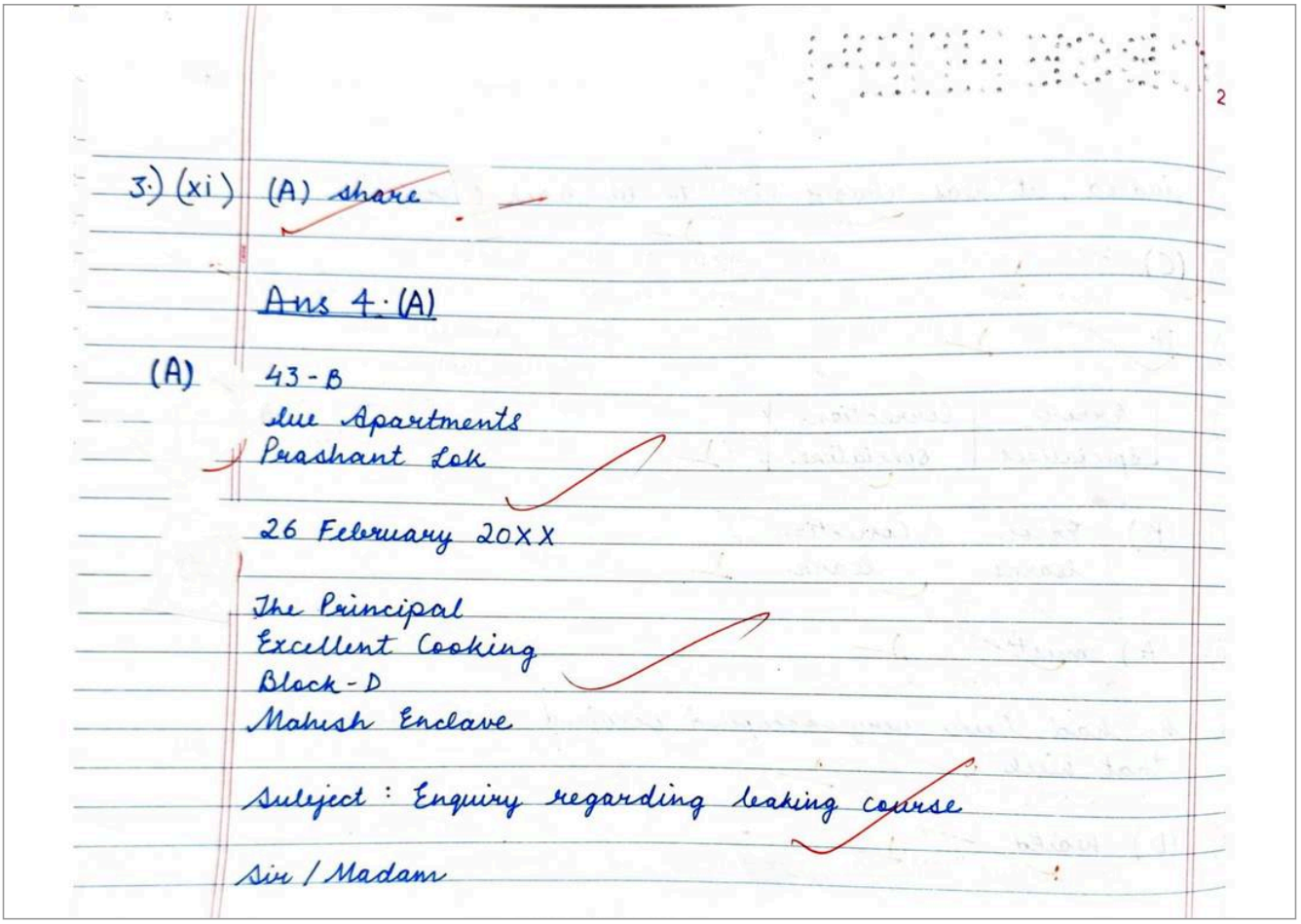
Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

Marks Summary

Section	Marks
Section A: Reading Skills	20
Section B: Writing Skills & Grammar	20
Section C: Literature Textbook	40
Total	**80**

***

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · similar to Q4 (B) (letter of enquiry about a course) answer book p.22



2

3.) (xi) (A) share

Ans 4. (A)

(A) 43-B
Ilse Apartments
Prashant Lok

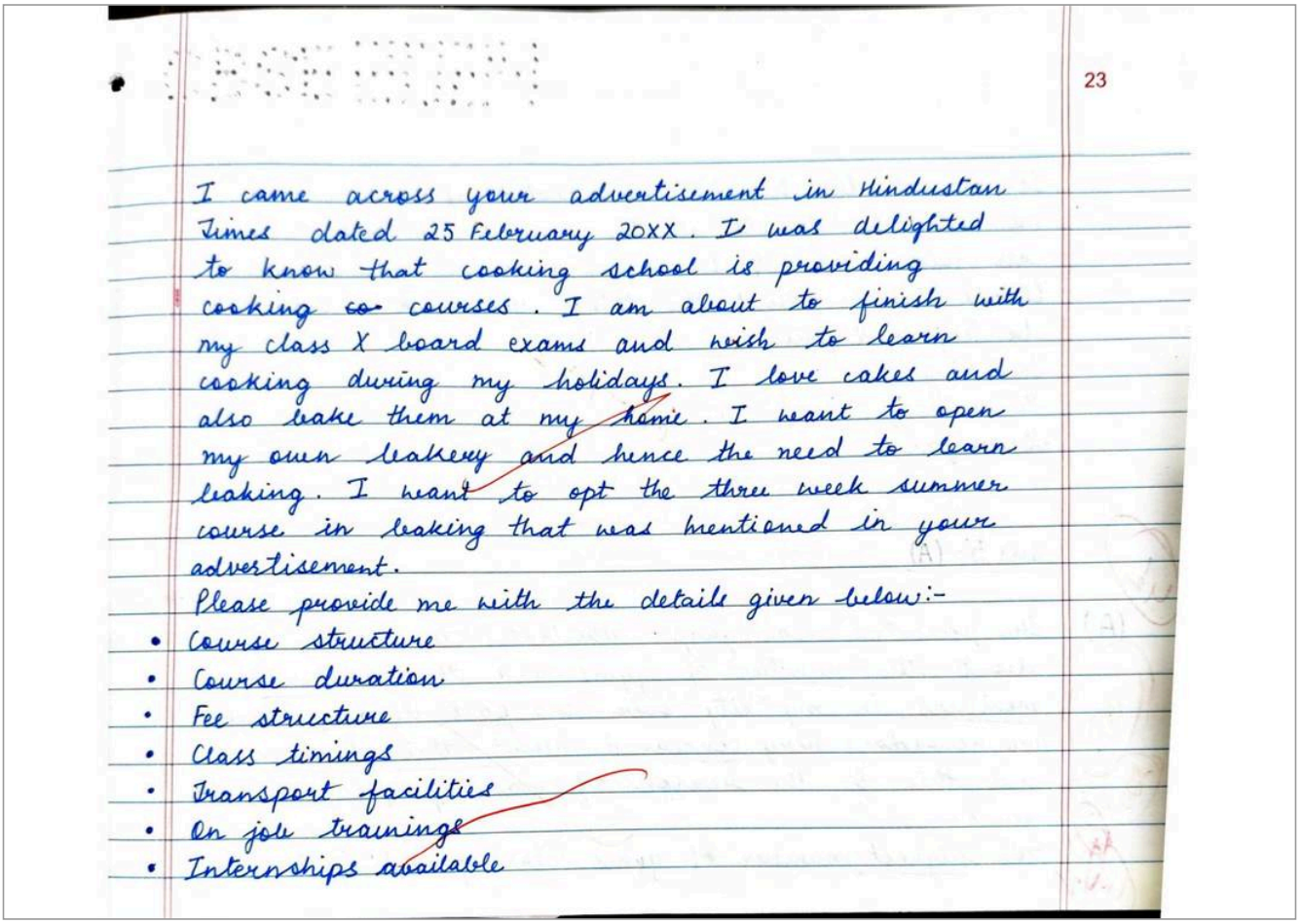
26 February 20XX

The Principal
Excellent Cooking
Block-D
Mahish Enclave

Subject : Enquiry regarding baking course

Sir / Madam

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · letter of enquiry (contd.) answer book p.23



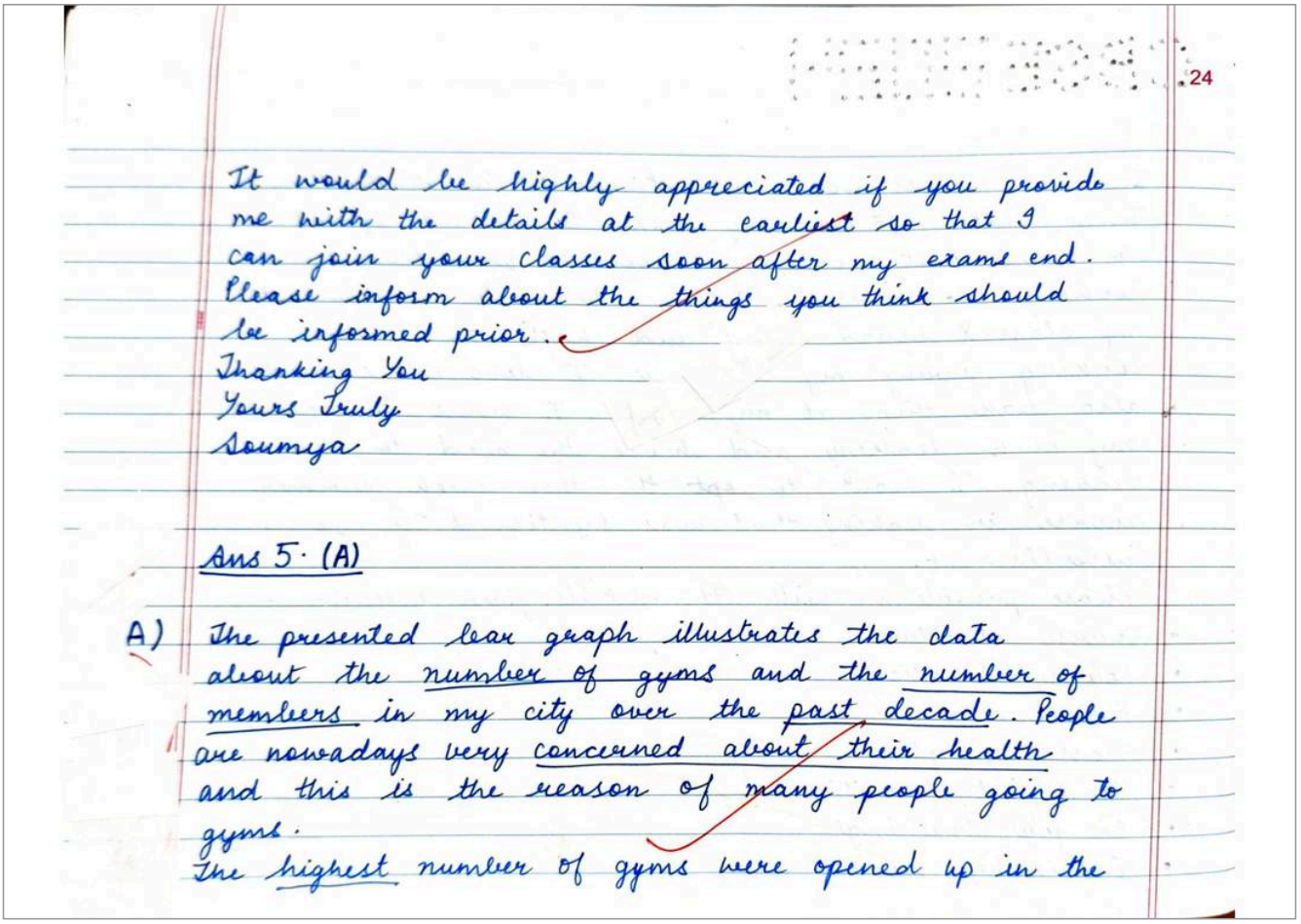
23

I came across your advertisement in Hindustan Times dated 25 February 20XX. I was delighted to know that cooking school is providing cooking ~~co~~ courses. I am about to finish with my class X board exams and wish to learn cooking during my holidays. I love cakes and also bake them at my home. I want to open my own bakery and hence the need to learn baking. I want to opt the three week summer course in baking that was mentioned in your advertisement.

Please provide me with the details given below:-

- Course structure
- Course duration
- Fee structure
- Class timings
- Transport facilities
- On job trainings
- Internships available

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · similar to Q5 (B) (letter ends; analytical paragraph on a line graph begins) answer book p.24



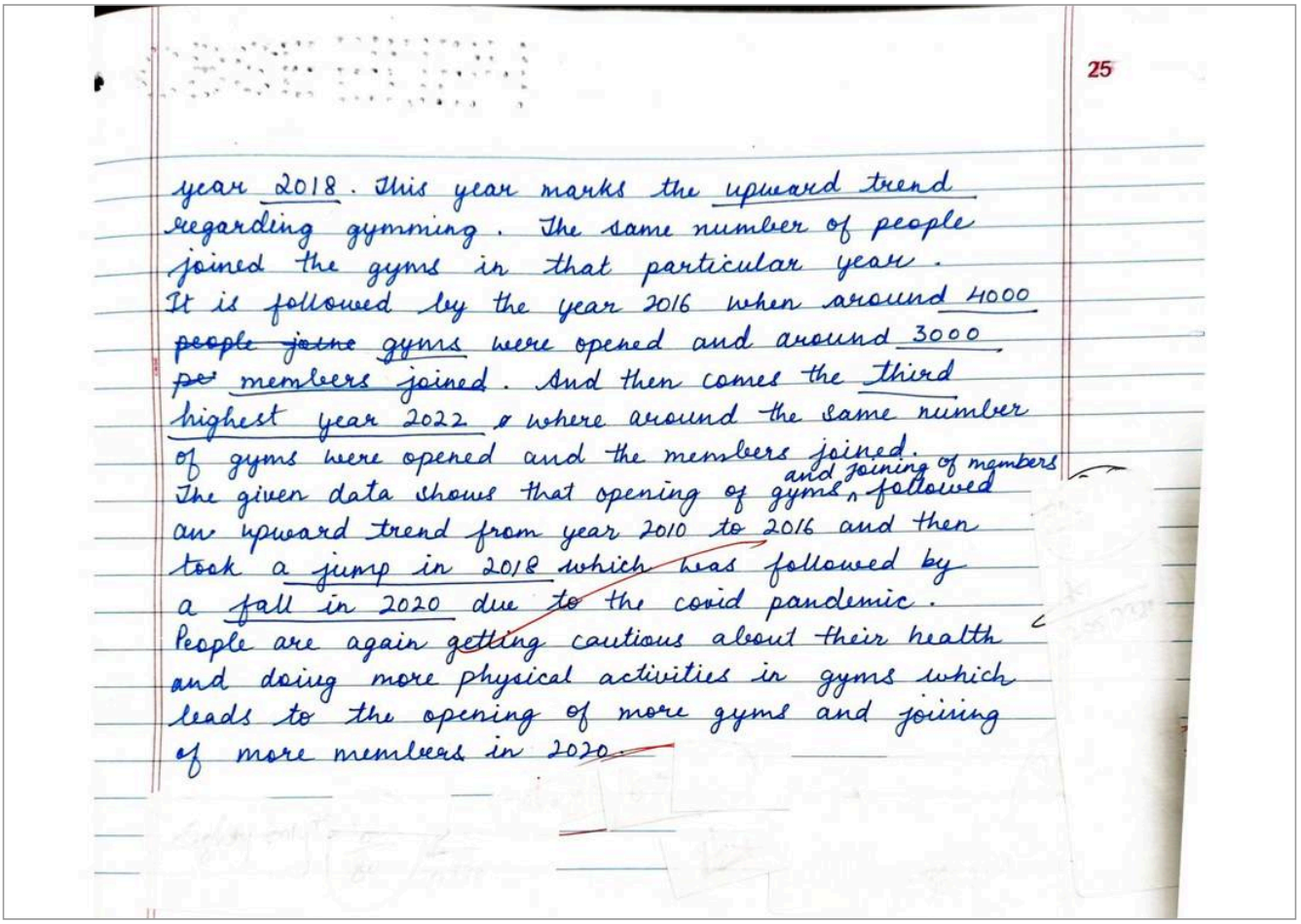
24

It would be highly appreciated if you provide me with the details at the earliest so that I can join your classes soon after my exams end. Please inform about the things you think should be informed prior.
Thanking You
Yours Truly
Soumya

Ans 5. (A)

A) The presented bar graph illustrates the data about the number of gyms and the number of members in my city over the past decade. People are nowadays very concerned about their health and this is the reason of many people going to gyms.
The highest number of gyms were opened up in the

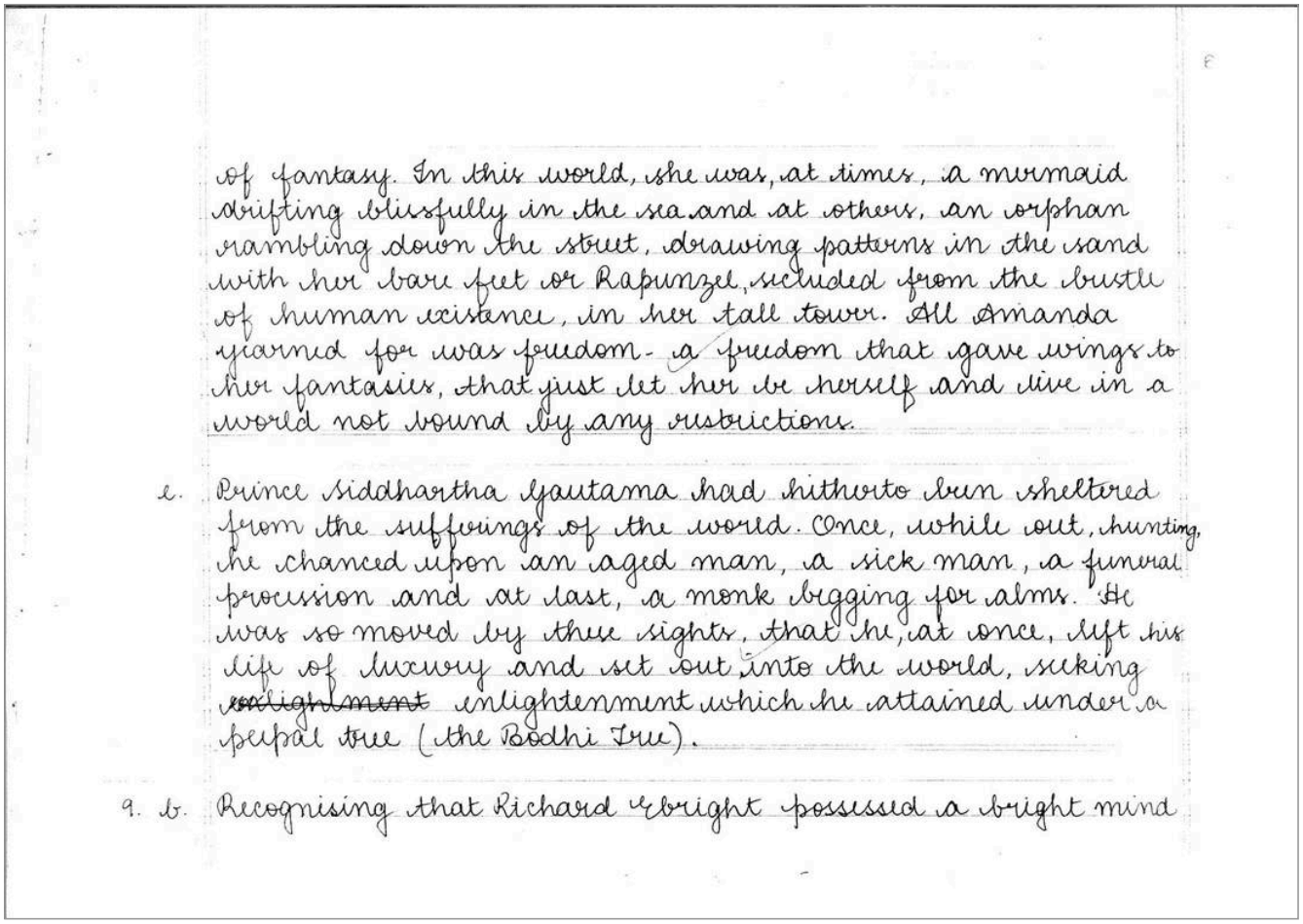
Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · analytical paragraph (contd.) answer book p.25



25

year 2018. This year marks the upward trend regarding gymming. The same number of people joined the gyms in that particular year.
It is followed by the year 2016 when around 4000 ~~people joine~~ gyms were opened and around 3000 ~~pe~~ members joined. And then comes the third highest year 2022, where around the same number of gyms were opened and the members joined.
The given data shows that opening of gyms and joining of members followed an upward trend from year 2010 to 2016 and then took a jump in 2018 which was followed by a fall in 2020 due to the covid pandemic.
People are again getting cautious about their health and doing more physical activities in gyms which leads to the opening of more gyms and joining of more members in 2020.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · similar to Q8 (III), Q11 (A) (Sermon at Benares; The Making of a Scientist) answer book p.6

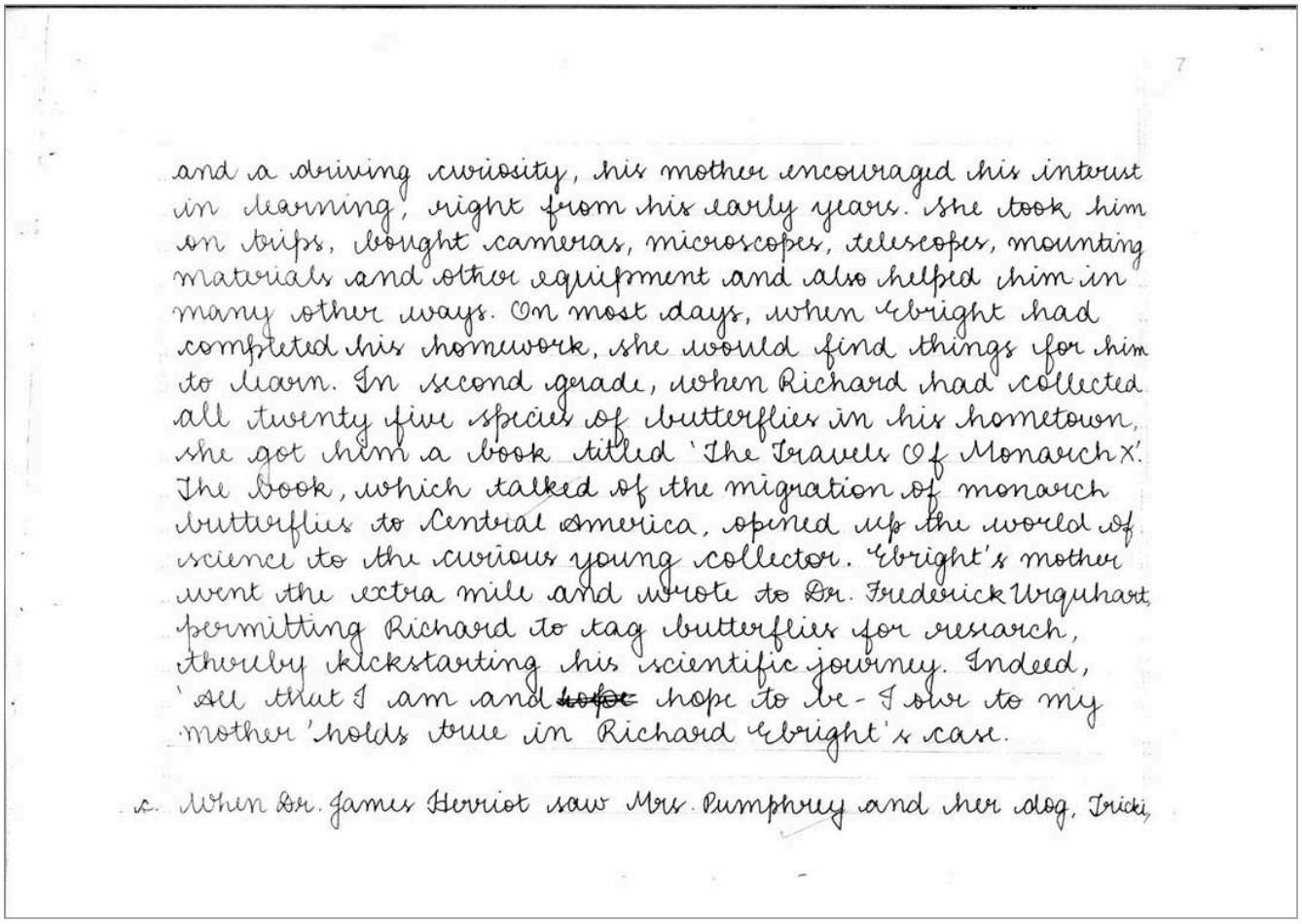


of fantasy. In this world, she was, at times, a mermaid drifting blissfully in the sea and at others, an orphan rambling down the street, drawing patterns in the sand with her bare feet or Rapunzel, secluded from the bustle of human existence, in her tall tower. All Amanda yearned for was freedom - a freedom that gave wings to her fantasies, that just let her be herself and live in a world not bound by any restrictions.

c. Prince Siddhartha Gautama had hitherto been sheltered from the sufferings of the world. Once, while out, hunting, he chanced upon an aged man, a sick man, a funeral procession and at last, a monk begging for alms. He was so moved by these sights, that he, at once, left his life of luxury and set out into the world, seeking ~~enlightenment~~ enlightenment which he attained under a peepal tree (the Bodhi Tree).

9. b. Recognising that Richard Wright possessed a bright mind

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · The Making of a Scientist (contd.) answer book p.7



and a driving curiosity, his mother encouraged his interest in learning, right from his early years. She took him on trips, bought cameras, microscopes, telescopes, mounting materials and other equipment and also helped him in many other ways. On most days, when Wright had completed his homework, she would find things for him to learn. In second grade, when Richard had collected all twenty five species of butterflies in his hometown, she got him a book titled 'The Travels Of Monarch X'. The book, which talked of the migration of monarch butterflies to Central America, opened up the world of science to the curious young collector. Wright's mother went the extra mile and wrote to Dr. Frederick Urquhart, permitting Richard to tag butterflies for research, thereby kickstarting his scientific journey. Indeed, 'All that I am and ~~hope~~ hope to be - I owe to my mother' holds true in Richard Wright's case.

c. When Dr. James Herriot saw Mrs. Pumphrey and her dog, Tricki,

SAMPLE PAPER 6

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 6 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Scroll through any social media feed for five minutes and you will meet a parade of perfect lives: sun-kissed holidays, flawless faces, glittering birthday parties and report cards full of top grades. It feels harmless, even entertaining. Yet somewhere between one swipe and the next, a quiet question begins to form in the viewer's mind: why doesn't my life look like that? This question, repeated hundreds of times a day, lies at the heart of what psychologists call the culture of comparison.

(2) Human beings have always measured themselves against others. In a village or a small school, however, the comparison was limited to a handful of familiar people whose ordinary days we could also see. Social media has changed the scale entirely. Today a fifteen-year-old can compare her morning face with the carefully lit, filtered and edited photograph of a stranger on the other side of the world. What she sees is not a life but a highlight reel, and she is comparing her behind-the-scenes with someone else's best scene.

(3) The effects are not imaginary. Several studies have linked heavy use of image-based platforms with lower self-esteem, poorer body image and higher anxiety among teenagers. The 'like' button turns approval into a number, and a post that gathers fewer likes than a friend's can feel like a public verdict on one's worth. Many young users admit to deleting photographs that do not get enough likes, as if their value had been put to a vote.

(4) It would be unfair, though, to blame the screen alone. Social media also connects isolated young people with communities that share their interests, gives a stage to talent that would otherwise go unnoticed and spreads awareness about causes that matter. The problem is not the tool but the way we use it, and the stories we tell ourselves about what we see.

(5) So what can be done? A good beginning is to curate* one's feed deliberately: unfollow accounts that leave you feeling inadequate and follow those that inform, inspire or make you laugh. Setting time

limits, turning off notifications and keeping phones out of the bedroom can loosen the grip of the endless scroll. Most importantly, young people need to be reminded, by parents, teachers and one another, that a filtered photograph is a performance, not a report.

(6) Self-esteem that depends on the approval of strangers is like a house built on sand; every new post can wash it away. Real confidence grows from within, from effort, friendship, learning and the small victories of everyday life. Perhaps the most powerful thing a teenager can do online is to stop comparing and start creating, and to measure today's self only against yesterday's.

*curate: to select, organise and look after items carefully

Created for academic usage / 446 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'a parade of perfect lives' suggest about the content people see on social media? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says, 'she is comparing her behind-the-scenes with someone else's best scene', he means that she _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) compares her ordinary, unedited everyday life with the carefully selected best moments of others.

(b) compares her achievements fairly with the equally genuine achievements of others.

III The writer says that the 'like' button 'turns approval into a number' (paragraph 3). **1**
Which of the following situations best illustrates this?

A. A student thanks a friend in person for helping with homework.

B. A teenager deletes a photograph because it received only a few likes.

C. A girl joins an online art group to learn sketching.

D. A boy switches off notifications before going to bed.

IV In paragraph 4, the writer presents the positive side of social media. **2**
Why do you think the writer includes this paragraph in a passage that mainly discusses its harmful effects?

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 2) **1**
In earlier times, people compared themselves with a small number of familiar people whose everyday lives they could also see.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
approval of strangers : fragile self-esteem :: _____ : _____

(a) effort and small victories : real confidence

(b) endless scroll : time limits

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) Studies have linked heavy use of image-based platforms with higher anxiety among teenagers.
(ii) A filtered photograph is a performance, not a report.
(iii) Many young users admit to deleting photographs that do not get enough likes.
(iv) The most powerful thing a teenager can do online is to stop comparing and start creating.
(v) Self-esteem that depends on the approval of strangers is like a house built on sand.

A. (i) O (ii) F (iii) O (iv) F (v) F

B. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F

C. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

D. (i) O (ii) O (iii) F (iv) F (v) O

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in ending the passage with the advice to 'measure today's self only against yesterday's'? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) When the United Nations declared 2023 the International Year of Millets on India's proposal, few expected these humble grains to stage a comeback so quickly. Jowar, bajra, ragi and other 'Shree Anna' grains, once dismissed as food for the poor, have found their way back into kitchens, school meals and even restaurant menus. India is the world's largest producer of millets, accounting for nearly 40 per cent of global output.

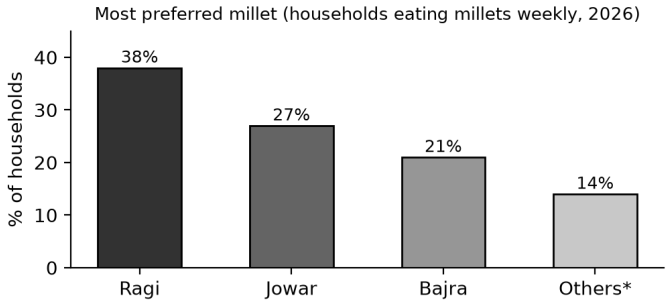
(2) A survey of 5,000 urban households conducted in 2026 found that 46% now eat millets at least once a week, compared with only 18% in 2022. Among these households, ragi was the most preferred grain (38%), followed by jowar (27%) and bajra (21%). Health was the main reason cited: 61% chose millets because they are rich in fibre and help manage blood sugar, while 23% were influenced by the crop's low water needs and 16% by taste and variety.

(3) The market has responded swiftly. The number of packaged millet products on supermarket shelves, from noodles and cookies to breakfast flakes, has nearly tripled since 2022. Several states have also added millet dishes to school mid-day meals.

(4) Challenges remain. Millet products are often 20–30% costlier than their wheat or rice equivalents, and many families say they do not know how to cook them. Farmers, too, need assured prices before they switch from water-hungry crops such as paddy. Experts believe that with better awareness and stable procurement, millets could become a lasting part of the Indian plate rather than a passing trend.

*Others: foxtail, little millet, kodo and similar varieties

Created for academic usage / 250 words



Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The phrase 'stage a comeback' as used in paragraph 1 suggests that millets have _____.
(returned to popularity after a period of neglect / been presented as a show for the public)

II What does the description of millets as 'once dismissed as food for the poor' suggest about earlier attitudes towards them? (Paragraph 1) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Health is the most common reason why the surveyed urban households have taken to millets.
Reason: Millets are rich in fibre and help manage blood sugar.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.

B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.

C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.

D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following are true according to paragraph 2 and the chart EXCEPT—

A. Weekly millet consumption in the surveyed households more than doubled between 2022 and 2026.

B. Jowar was the second most preferred millet.

C. Nearly a quarter of the millet-eating households were influenced by the crop's low water needs.

D. Bajra was preferred by more households than ragi.

V Compare the share of households eating millets every week in 2022 and in 2026. What does this change suggest about the impact of the International Year of Millets? (Paragraph 2) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 4) **1**
Farmers may hesitate to grow millets because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 3 that indicates that sellers reacted quickly to the new demand for millets. **1**

VIII A working mother wants to include millets in her family's meals but has never cooked them. Based on paragraph 4, suggest one step that could help her. **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Millets: From Forgotten Grain to Everyday Food' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the line from a bank's email to its customers: **1**
Dear Customer,
We wish to inform you that our online banking services _____ unavailable from 11 p.m. to 2 a.m. this Sunday due to scheduled maintenance.

A. were B. will be C. have been D. had been

II Report the coach's instruction to the players. **1**
Coach: "Do not leave the ground until the practice session is over."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the notice issued by a housing society: **1**
NOTICE
Water supply will remain suspended on Tuesday for cleaning of the overhead tanks.
_____ resident is requested to store sufficient water on Monday evening.

A. All B. Every C. Many D. Several

IV Read Rohan's statement to his mother about his science project: **1**
"I have finished my model and I will submit it tomorrow."
Report Rohan's statement by completing the following sentence:
Rohan told his mother that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a hospital's annual report: **1**
One of the main reasons for the delays in treatment were the shortage of trained nursing staff.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given line from a museum notice: **1**
Visitors _____ not touch the exhibits as they are extremely fragile.
A. need B. must C. would D. could

VII The given line from a book blog has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**
The author has been working on her new novel since three years.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	has	have
B.	been	being
C.	since	for
D.	novel	novels

VIII The librarian asked Meera the following question: **1**
"Have you returned the book you borrowed last week?"
Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.
The librarian asked Meera _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank in the announcement made at a cinema hall. **1**
There are only _____ seats left for the evening show, so please book your tickets quickly.
A. little B. a few C. much D. any

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the line from a school newsletter. **1**
The number of students opting for vocational subjects have increased this year.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the doctor's advice by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**
You _____ take these tablets after meals, otherwise they may upset your stomach. (should / might)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, to complete the line from a news report. **1**
By the time the fire brigade arrived, the residents _____ (evacuate) the building.

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Saket / Sanya Kulkarni, a resident of 14, Green Park Colony, Nagpur. Garbage has not been collected from your colony for three weeks, and heaps of rotting waste lie on the roadsides. Write a letter in 120 words to the Municipal Commissioner, Nagpur Municipal Corporation, complaining about the problem, pointing out the risk of dengue and other diseases, and requesting immediate action. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Ishaan / Ira Thakur, a resident of 27, Lake View Road, Dehradun. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily expressing concern over online gaming addiction among children. Mention its effects on their health, studies and behaviour, and suggest what parents, schools and the government can do. **5**

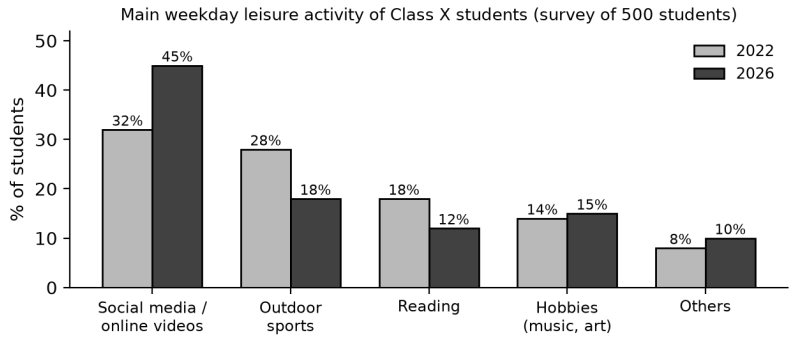
5 A. Read the product details of an e-reader designed for students, displayed on an e-commerce website. **5**

- 6-inch glare-free E Ink screen that looks like printed paper; warm light for night reading
- Stores 6,000 books; NCERT textbooks and a dictionary pre-loaded; one charge lasts up to 6 weeks
- Tap a word for its meaning; highlights and notes with a free stylus; text-to-speech
- No games, apps or social media – distraction-free study
- Weighs 180 g; water-resistant; 1-year warranty; ₹ 8,499 (10% off with a student ID)

Now, analyse why this e-reader would be a good purchase for students. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as eye comfort, convenience, learning features, focus and value for money.

OR

5 B. The bar graph below shows the results of a survey of 500 Class X students about the activity on which they spend most of their leisure time on weekdays, in 2022 and in 2026. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, analysing the changes shown and what they suggest. **5**



SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A

Let me put it more clearly, since no one will believe that a thirteen-year-old girl is completely alone in the world. And I'm not. I have loving parents and a sixteen-year-old sister, and there are about thirty people I can call friends. I have a family, loving aunts and a good home. No, on the surface I seem to have everything, except my one true friend. All I think about when I'm with friends is having a good time. I can't bring myself to talk about anything but ordinary everyday things. We don't seem to be able to get any closer, and that's the problem. Maybe it's my fault that we don't confide in each other. In any case, that's just how things are, and unfortunately they're not liable to change. This is why I've started the diary.

(From the Diary of Anne Frank)

I Which of the following statements best explains Anne's words, 'on the surface I seem to have everything'? **1**

(a) She acknowledges her outwardly comfortable life while hinting at an inner emptiness.

(b) She boasts about her family and many friends to impress the reader.

II Anne's remark, 'We don't seem to be able to get any closer', highlights _____. **1**

A. her frequent quarrels with her friends.

B. the lack of emotional closeness in her friendships.

C. her dislike of parties and social gatherings.

D. the strictness of her parents.

III Complete the following suitably. **1**

Anne says that her friendships are limited to 'ordinary everyday things', which shows that she longs for _____.

IV How does Anne's admission, 'Maybe it's my fault that we don't confide in each other', reflect her maturity? **2**

OR

B

Coorgi homes have a tradition of hospitality, and they are more than willing to recount numerous tales of valour related to their sons and fathers. The Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated in the Indian Army, and the first Chief of the Indian Army, General Cariappa, was a Coorgi. Even now, Kodavus are the only people in India permitted to carry firearms without a licence.

The river, Kaveri, obtains its water from the hills and forests of Coorg. Mahaseer — a large freshwater fish — abound in these waters. Kingfishers dive for their catch, while squirrels and langurs drop partially eaten fruit for the mischief of enjoying the splash and the ripple effect in the clear water. Elephants enjoy being bathed and scrubbed in the river by their mahouts.

(Glimpses of India – Coorg)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**

The fact that Kodavus are permitted to carry firearms without a licence shows that _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**

The statement, 'The Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated in the Indian Army', means that the regiment _____.

A. has the most beautifully decorated barracks

B. has received a very large number of awards for bravery

C. is the oldest regiment in the Indian Army

D. has the largest number of soldiers

III Fill in the blank with the correct word from the bracket. **1**

The image of squirrels and langurs dropping fruit 'for the mischief of enjoying the splash' adds a _____ tone to the description. (playful / sombre)

IV How does the writer blend the human heritage of Coorg with its natural life in this extract to present it as a unique place? **2**

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A.

He should be snarling around houses
At the jungle's edge,
Baring his white fangs, his claws,
Terrorising the village!

But he's locked in a concrete cell,
His strength behind bars,
Stalking the length of his cage,
Ignoring visitors.

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The words 'snarling', 'baring' and 'terrorising' bring out the tiger's _____ in its natural habitat.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
The phrase 'His strength behind bars' suggests that _____.

A. the tiger has grown weak and old in the zoo
B. the tiger's natural power is confined and wasted
C. the bars of the cage have been made stronger
D. the visitors are safe from the tiger's anger

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The tiger's act of 'ignoring visitors' reflects his _____ towards the people who come to watch him.

IV How does the poet use the contrast between the two stanzas to convey his view on keeping wild animals in zoos? **2**

OR

B.

If strolling forth, a beast you view,
Whose hide with spots is peppered,
As soon as he has lept on you,
You'll know it is the Leopard.
'Twill do no good to roar with pain,
He'll only lep and lep again.

If when you're walking round your yard
You meet a creature there,
Who hugs you very, very hard,
Be sure it is a Bear.
If you have any doubts, I guess
He'll give you just one more caress.

(How to Tell Wild Animals)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The phrase 'whose hide with spots is peppered' helps the reader identify the leopard by its _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
The spellings ‘lept’ and ‘lep’ in the extract are an example of _____.

A. printing errors in the poem

B. poetic licence used for rhythm and humour

C. the old British spelling of the word

D. the leopard’s clumsy movements

III Fill in the blank with the correct word from the bracket. 1
The word ‘caress’ for the bear’s deadly hug is used _____. (ironically / literally)

IV How does the poet create humour by suggesting that one can identify these animals only when it is too late? 2

8. Answer any FOUR of the following five questions in about 40-50 words each. **4x3 =12**

I Lencho calls the post office employees ‘a bunch of crooks’. How does this remark bring out the irony of the story? (A Letter to God) 3

II ‘The oppressor must be liberated just as surely as the oppressed is.’ Why does Mandela believe that the oppressor, too, is not free? (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom) 3

III How does the pilot’s encounter with the black aeroplane create an air of mystery in the story? (Two Stories about Flying – The Black Aeroplane) 3

IV How does Robert Frost link ‘fire’ and ‘ice’ with human emotions to warn us about the end of the world? (Fire and Ice) 3

V How did the Buddha make Kisa Gotami understand the truth about death without directly telling her? (The Sermon at Benares) 3

9. Answer any TWO of the following three questions in about 40-50 words each. **2x3 =6**

I How did a children’s book given to him by his mother change the course of Richard Ebright’s life? (The Making of a Scientist) 3

II ‘Brilliant scientist though he was, Griffin was rather a lawless person.’ Justify the statement with two incidents from the story. (Footprints without Feet) 3

III Had Matilda told Madame Forestier the truth about losing the necklace, how might the Loisels’ lives have been different? What lesson does this teach? (The Necklace) 3

10. Answer any ONE of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. In ‘The Proposal’, Chekhov uses petty quarrels over the Oxen Meadows and the dogs to satirise the attitude of the landowning class towards marriage. Discuss.

OR

B. Gavin Maxwell’s journey with Mijbil from Basra to London shows both the joys and the challenges of keeping a wild animal as a pet. Discuss with reference to ‘Mijbil the Otter’.

11. Answer any ONE of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. How did Bholi’s teacher change the course of her life? Trace Bholi’s journey from a neglected ‘simpleton’ to a confident young woman. (Bholi)

OR

B. ‘Think-Tank’s own arrogance and ignorance, not the Earthlings, defeated the Martian invasion.’ Justify with reference to ‘The Book That Saved the Earth’.

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SAMPLE PAPER 6

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

MARKING SCHEME · SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 6 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. MARKING SCHEME **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. The Marking Scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers / sample answers. The value points are in the nature of guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. Students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, due marks should be awarded accordingly.
2. If a student has attempted an extra question, the answer deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note "Extra Question".
3. If more than one option is mentioned in the answer of multiple choice questions, no marks are to be awarded.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

Discursive Passage

1. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I It suggests a continuous, seemingly endless display of idealised, flawless moments that make other people's lives look perfect, although it is only a selective showcase and not the full reality. **1**

II (a) compares her ordinary, unedited everyday life with the carefully selected best moments of others. **1**

III B. A teenager deletes a photograph because it received only a few likes. **1**

IV The writer includes this paragraph to present a balanced and fair view. By admitting that social media connects isolated young people, gives a stage to talent and spreads awareness, the writer shows that the tool itself is not the villain. This makes the argument more credible and shifts the focus to how we use it, preparing the ground for the solutions offered in paragraph 5. **2**
(Any two relevant points, 1 + 1)

V True **1**

VI (a) effort and small victories : real confidence **1**
[maintains the cause–result relationship of the original pair: just as the approval of strangers produces fragile self-esteem, effort and small victories produce real confidence.]

VII C. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O **1**

VIII The writer wants to end on a positive, empowering note. The advice urges readers to stop measuring their worth against others' filtered lives and instead focus on their own growth and improvement. It reinforces the central message that real confidence comes from within and motivates young readers to build healthy self-esteem. **2**
(Any two relevant points, 1 + 1)

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 + V 1 + VI 1 + VII 1 + VIII 2 = **10**

Case-Based Passage

2. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I returned to popularity after a period of neglect **1**

II It suggests that millets were earlier looked down upon as inferior, low-status food and were not valued for their nutritional worth. **1**

III A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation. **1**

IV D. Bajra was preferred by more households than ragi. **1**

V	The share of households eating millets weekly rose from 18% in 2022 to 46% in 2026, an increase of 28 percentage points, i.e. more than two and a half times. **(1)** This suggests that the International Year of Millets succeeded in raising awareness about their health and environmental benefits and brought about a real change in food habits. **(1)**	**2**
VI	they need assured prices before switching from water-hungry crops such as paddy.	**1**
VII	'responded swiftly'	**1**
VIII	Any one – She could learn simple millet recipes through awareness programmes, cooking demonstrations or online videos. – She could begin with easy-to-cook packaged millet products before trying traditional dishes.	**1**
IX	Any one – The title captures the change from a grain 'once dismissed as food for the poor' to one eaten weekly by 46% of urban households. – It covers the main ideas of the passage: the comeback of millets, the market response and the hope that they become a lasting part of the Indian plate.	**1**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 1 + V 2 + VI 1 + VII 1 + VIII 1 + IX 1 = **10**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR (10 marks)

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

Answer

I	B. will be	**1**
II	The coach instructed / ordered / told the players not to leave the ground until the practice session was over.	**1**
III	B. Every	**1**
IV	he had finished his model and (that) he would submit it the next day / the following day.	**1**
V	Error: were Correction: was	**1**
VI	B. must	**1**
VII	C. since – for	**1**
VIII	whether / if she had returned the book (that) she had borrowed the previous week / the week before.	**1**
IX	B. a few	**1**
X	Error: have Correction: has	**1**
XI	should	**1**
XII	had evacuated	**1**

Marks: 1 mark for each correct answer; any ten of the twelve items = 10 × 1 = **10**

WRITING SKILLS (10 marks)

4. **Format – 1 Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 1 Accuracy – 1** **1x5 =5**

Answer

Criterion	Marks
Format: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, complimentary close, name of the sender	1
Content: relevance of ideas, coverage of all cues given in the question	2
Organisation of ideas: logical sequencing, coherence, paragraphing	1
Accuracy: grammar, spelling, punctuation	1

Marks: Format 1 + Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 1 + Accuracy 1 = **5**

A. **Content points:** garbage not collected for three weeks; rotting heaps on roadsides; foul smell, stray animals, flies; stagnant water in waste breeds mosquitoes – risk of dengue, malaria and other diseases; children and elderly most at risk; requests – immediate clearing, regular door-to-door collection, fogging and anti-larval spraying, more dustbins, regular inspection.

Content (2): any four relevant points from the above, ½ mark each. Format (1): all the format elements listed in the rubric.

Model answer:

14, Green Park Colony
Nagpur
30 October 20XX

The Municipal Commissioner
Nagpur Municipal Corporation
Nagpur

Subject: Garbage not collected for three weeks in Green Park Colony – risk of dengue

Sir
I wish to draw your attention to the unhygienic conditions in Green Park Colony, where garbage has not been collected for the past three weeks. Heaps of rotting waste now lie on the roadsides and in empty plots, giving off a foul smell and attracting stray animals. The situation has become a serious health hazard. Rainwater has collected in discarded containers and plastic bags lying in the garbage, and these have become breeding grounds for mosquitoes. Three cases of dengue have already been reported in our colony, and children and the elderly are at the greatest risk.
I request you to get the garbage cleared at once, restore daily door-to-door collection and arrange fogging in the area.
I hope for prompt action.

Yours faithfully
Saket Kulkarni

B. **Content points (Letter to the Editor):**
– Issue: children spending long hours, often late into the night, on online games; growing addiction
– Effects on health: eye strain, headaches, poor sleep, lack of physical activity, obesity
– Effects on studies and behaviour: falling concentration and marks, irritability, aggression, isolation from family and friends; in-game purchases and money spent without permission
– Suggestions: parents to fix screen-time limits and use parental controls; schools to hold counselling and awareness sessions and promote sports; government to regulate age ratings, playing hours and in-game spending
– Appeal to parents, schools and authorities to act together
Content (2): any four relevant points from the above, ½ mark each.

5. **Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 2 Accuracy – 1** **1x5 =5**

Answer

Analytical paragraph writing should NOT be confused with writing a description of the given elements or writing a summary. It requires examining the given elements closely and sharing inputs based on the given stimulus. It carries no title or heading.

Criterion	Marks
Content: analysis of all cues with relevant inference, not mere listing	2
Organisation of ideas: introduction, logical flow with linkers, conclusion	2
Accuracy: grammar, spelling, punctuation	1

Marks: Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 2 + Accuracy 1 = **5**

A. **Value points:** eye comfort – glare-free paper-like E Ink screen, warm light – convenience – 180 g, 6,000 books, NCERT books pre-loaded, lighter school bag, 6-week battery – learning features – dictionary, highlights, notes with stylus, text-to-speech, font size – focus – no games, apps or social media – value – ₹ 8,499, 10% student discount, 1-year warranty, water-resistant
Content (2): analysis of any four of the five features above with a relevant inference, ½ mark each. Organisation (2): introduction, logical flow with linkers, conclusion.
Suggested response:
The student e-reader is a thoughtful and practical purchase for learners. Firstly, its glare-free E Ink screen looks like printed paper and, with an adjustable warm light, protects the eyes during long or late-night study. Secondly, it is extremely convenient: weighing only 180 g, it stores up to 6,000 books, including pre-loaded NCERT textbooks, and a single charge lasts up to six weeks. Moreover, features such as tap-to-define, highlighting and notes with a free stylus make learning and revision easier, while text-to-speech supports different learners. Since it has no games or social media, it also keeps students focused. Finally, at ₹ 8,499 with a student discount and a one-year warranty, it offers fair value. Overall, it is a wise investment.

B. **Value points:**
– Introduction: survey of 500 Class X students, main weekday leisure activity, 2022 vs 2026
– Sharpest rise: social media / online videos from 32% to 45% (up 13 points), now the leading activity
– Sharpest falls: outdoor sports from 28% to 18%; reading from 18% to 12%
– Little change: hobbies 14% to 15%; others 8% to 10%
– Inference: screen time is replacing physical activity and reading; possible effects on fitness, attention span and well-being
– Conclusion: need for balance – screen-time limits, encouraging sports and reading clubs
Content (2): any four of the points above with data and inference, ½ mark each.

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

Answer

A. Prose (From the Diary of Anne Frank)

Answer

I (a) is correct. **1**
[Anne admits that she has loving parents, a sister, about thirty friends and a good home, yet the words 'on the surface' and 'except my one true friend' show that she feels lonely within.]

II B. the lack of emotional closeness in her friendships. **1**

III Any one **1**
– a true friend with whom she can share her deepest thoughts and feelings
– meaningful, heart-to-heart conversations

IV Anne does not simply blame her friends; she looks within and admits that she, too, may be responsible for the distance. **(1)** **2**
This honest self-examination and acceptance of responsibility show a thoughtfulness and insight unusual for a thirteen-year-old. **(1)**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 = **5**

B. Prose (Glimpses of India – Coorg)

Answer

I Any one **1**
– their martial tradition and valour are respected and honoured by the nation
– they enjoy a special privilege because of their warrior heritage

II B. has received a very large number of awards for bravery **1**

III playful **1**

IV The writer moves from the proud human heritage of Coorg – its hospitality, tales of valour, the decorated Coorg Regiment and General Cariappa – to its rich natural life – the Kaveri, the mahaseer, kingfishers, langurs and elephants bathed by mahouts. **(1)** **2**
Placing the two side by side shows people and nature living in harmony, presenting Coorg as a place rich in both culture and natural beauty. **(1)**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 = **5**

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

Answer

A. Poetry (A Tiger in the Zoo)

Answer

I natural ferocity / power and freedom (any similar answer) **1**

II B. the tiger's natural power is confined and wasted **1**

III indifference (accept: contempt / resentment / disdain) **1**

IV The first stanza shows what the tiger 'should be' doing – snarling, baring his fangs and terrorising the village in freedom; the second shows the reality – locked in a concrete cell with his strength behind bars. **(1)**
The shift marked by 'But' highlights the tiger's loss of freedom and dignity, conveying the poet's view that zoos are unnatural and cruel and that wild animals belong in the wild. **(1)** **2**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 = **5**

B. Poetry (How to Tell Wild Animals)

Answer

I spotted skin / spots on its hide **1**

II B. poetic licence used for rhythm and humour **1**

III ironically **1**

IV The poet says one will know the leopard only 'as soon as he has lept on you' and the bear only when it 'hugs you very, very hard' – by then the knowledge is useless. **(1)**
This absurd, mock-serious advice, together with ironic words like 'caress' and 'one more caress', turns a deadly situation into light-hearted fun. **(1)** **2**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 = **5**

8. Answer any FOUR of the following five questions in about 40-50 words each. **4x3**
Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall **=12**

Answer

Content (2): value points as marked against each answer. Expression (1): fluency, coherence, relevance and word limit. Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score for grammatical and spelling errors.

I **Value points:** Postmaster and employees collected money out of charity **(½)**; Lencho received seventy pesos, not a hundred **(½)**; blind faith: God cannot err, so the post office staff must have stolen the rest **(½)**; helpers branded thieves – kindness repaid with suspicion **(½)** **3**

Model answer: The postmaster and his employees collected seventy pesos out of pity for Lencho. Yet Lencho, sure that God could never make a mistake, believed God had sent a hundred and accused his helpers of stealing the rest, calling them 'a bunch of crooks'. Their kindness earns suspicion, which is deeply ironic.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

II **Value points:** Oppressor is 'a prisoner of hatred' **(½)**; locked 'behind the bars of prejudice and narrow-mindedness' **(½)**; both oppressor and oppressed are robbed of humanity **(½)**; true freedom requires liberation of both **(½)** **3**

Model answer: Mandela believes that a man who takes away another man's freedom is 'a prisoner of hatred', locked 'behind the bars of prejudice and narrow-mindedness'. Hatred robs the oppressor of his humanity just as injustice robs the oppressed of freedom. Hence, for true freedom, both must be liberated.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

III **Value points:** Pilot lost in storm; compass and radio dead; fuel low **(½)**; black aeroplane with no lights guides him to the runway; it disappears **(½)**; control centre: no other aeroplane flying that night **(½)**; identity of rescuer unexplained **(½)** **3**

Model answer: Lost in a storm with dead instruments and little fuel, the pilot follows a black aeroplane with no lights, which guides him safely to the runway and then vanishes. The woman in the control centre says no other aeroplane was flying that night. The rescuer's identity is never explained, leaving the story mysterious.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

IV **Value points:** Fire = desire / greed – spreads fast, consumes **(½)**; ice = hatred – cold, rigid, destroys slowly **(½)**; either would 'suffice' **(½)**; warning: unchecked human passions can destroy the world **(½)** **3**

Model answer: Frost links 'fire' with desire and greed, which spread fast and consume everything, and 'ice' with hatred, which is cold and rigid and destroys slowly. He says either would 'suffice' to end the world. Thus he warns that unchecked human passions, not merely natural forces, can bring destruction.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

V **Value points:** Asked for mustard-seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend **(½)**; she went from house to house **(½)**; found none **(½)**; realised death is common to all; selfish grief is futile **(½)** **3**

Model answer: When Kisa Gotami begged for medicine, the Buddha asked for mustard-seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend. Going from house to house, she found no such home. She herself realised that death is common to all and that selfish grief is futile.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

9. Answer any TWO of the following three questions in about 40-50 words each. **2x3**

Answer **Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall** **=6**

Content (2): value points as marked against each answer. Expression (1): fluency, coherence, relevance and word limit. Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score for grammatical and spelling errors.

I **Value points:** By the second grade Ebright had collected all twenty-five species of butterflies around his hometown and might have stopped **(½)**; mother got him 'The Travels of Monarch X' (migration of monarchs to Central America); readers invited to tag butterflies for Dr Frederick A. Urquhart, University of Toronto **(½)**; mother wrote to Dr Urquhart; Ebright tagged and later raised monarchs **(½)**; the book opened the world of science to him **(½)** **3**

Model answer: Having collected all twenty-five butterfly species around his hometown, Ebright might have stopped. Then his mother got him 'The Travels of Monarch X', about monarchs migrating to Central America. It invited readers to tag butterflies for Dr Frederick A. Urquhart. Tagging and raising monarchs opened the world of science to him.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

II **Value points:** Set fire to his landlord's house in revenge **(1)**; broke into a London store and theatrical shop and took clothes and disguises **(1)**; stole money from the clergyman's desk at Iping **(1)**; struggled violently to escape arrest by constable Jaffers **(1)** **3**

Any two incidents, 1 mark each (1 + 1 = 2).

Model answer: When his landlord tried to eject him, Griffin set fire to the house in revenge. Later, at Iping, he stole money from a clergyman's desk, and when the constable Jaffers came to arrest him, he struggled violently to escape. He misused his brilliance for selfish, criminal ends.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

III **Value points:** Madame Forestier would have told her the necklace was false, worth not more than five hundred francs **(½)**; no need to buy a replacement for thirty-six thousand francs; no borrowing from usurers, no attic, no ten years of hard labour and poverty **(½)**; Matilda would not have lost her youth and beauty **(½)**; lesson: honesty is better than false pride and pretence; appearances deceive **(½)** **3**

Model answer: Madame Forestier would have told her that the necklace was false, worth not more than five hundred francs. The Loisels would not have bought a replacement for thirty-six thousand francs, borrowed from usurers or spent ten years in poverty. The story teaches that honesty is wiser than false pride and pretence.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

10. Answer any ONE of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer **Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1**

Content (3): value points as marked against each answer. Expression (2): organisation of ideas, coherence, fluency and word limit. Accuracy (1): grammar, spelling and punctuation.

A. **Value points:** marriage seen as convenience – Lomov's age, health, need for a regulated life; Chubukov eager to marry off his daughter **(½)**; quarrel over Oxen Meadows (worthless land) **(½)**; quarrel over Guess vs Squeezer **(½)**; insults, palpitations, near-collapse **(½)**; quarrelling continues after engagement **(½)**; satire on greed, pride, materialism of landowners **(½)**

Model answer: In 'The Proposal', Lomov comes to propose to Natalya, but marriage is treated as a matter of convenience and property. Lomov wants to marry only because he is thirty-five, suffers from palpitations and needs a quiet, well-regulated life, while Chubukov is delighted to get rid of his daughter. Before Lomov can propose, he and Natalya quarrel bitterly over the Oxen Meadows, a worthless strip of land that each claims. Later, after Chubukov brings him back, they fight again over whether Guess or Squeezer is the better dog. Insults fly and Lomov nearly collapses. Even after the hurried engagement, the quarrel resumes. Through these absurd quarrels, Chekhov satirises the greed, pride and materialism of rich landowners who treat marriage as a property deal.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = **6**

OR

B. **Value points:** joys – affection, playfulness (tap, rubber ball), companionship **(½)**; challenges – British airline refused animals; flight via Paris; small box; Mij tore lining, got hurt, escaped in aircraft; chaos among passengers **(1)**; air hostess's help **(½)**; Londoners could not identify him **(½)**; pets need patience and responsibility **(½)**

Model answer: Mijbil brought Maxwell great joy. The otter soon followed him without a lead and amused him by turning on the bathroom tap and dribbling a rubber ball round the room like a four-footed soccer player. However, taking a wild animal to England was a real challenge. As the British airline would not fly animals, Maxwell booked a flight to Paris and then to London, with Mij packed in a box eighteen inches square. Mij tore the lining of the box, hurt himself and later escaped inside the aircraft, causing chaos among the passengers, until a kind air hostess let him sit on Maxwell's knee. The journey shows that a wild pet needs patience, care and responsibility.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = **6**

11. Answer any ONE of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

Content (3): value points as marked against each answer. Expression (2): organisation of ideas, coherence, fluency and word limit. Accuracy (1): grammar, spelling and punctuation.

A. **Value points:** Bholi neglected – fall at ten months, small-pox marks, stammer, mocked; sent to school only because no one would marry her **(½)**; teacher's kindness – soft voice, encouragement to say her name, 'put the fear out of your heart', picture book, promise of respect through learning **(½)**; years of education build confidence **(½)**; refuses greedy, lame Bishamber who demands five thousand rupees; speaks without a stammer **(½)**; decides to serve parents and teach in the same school **(½)**; teacher's deep satisfaction – her masterpiece **(½)**

Model answer: Sulekha, called Bholi, was neglected from childhood. A fall at ten months had left her slow, small-pox had scarred her face, and her stammer made her a figure of fun. Sent to school only because no one would marry her, she found a teacher who changed her life. She spoke softly, praised each stammered attempt at her name and told her to put the fear out of her heart. She gave her a picture book and promised that learning would earn her respect. When the lame, greedy Bishamber later demanded five thousand rupees as dowry, Bholi flung the garland into the fire and refused him without a stammer. She chose to serve her parents and teach in the same school, the teacher's true masterpiece.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = **6**

OR

B. **Value points:** invasion of 2040 planned by Think-Tank **(½)**; arrogance – mirror, 'balloon brain', contempt for Earthlings, 'Think-Tank is never wrong' **(½)**; ignorance – books called sandwiches; takes credit for Noodle's suggestions **(½)**; misreads Mother Goose – Mistress Mary (silver, explosives), Hey Diddle Diddle (cows in space) **(½)**; Humpty Dumpty looks like him; fears capture; cancels invasion, orders Mars evacuated, flees towards Alpha Centauri **(½)**; Earth saved by his folly, not by force **(½)**

Model answer: The Martians planned to invade Earth in 2040, yet no Earthling fired a shot. Think-Tank, proud of his 'balloon brain', thought himself the most intelligent being in the universe and scorned the 'tiny-headed' Earthlings. When his crew found books in the Centerville Public Library, he declared them sandwiches, and when Noodle tactfully suggested they were used for communication, he pretended it was his own idea. He then misread innocent Mother Goose rhymes: 'Mistress Mary' meant Earthlings could grow silver and explosives, and 'Hey Diddle Diddle' meant cows could attack from space. Finally, seeing Humpty Dumpty's egg-shaped head, he believed Earth was after him, cancelled the invasion and ordered Mars evacuated. His vanity and ignorance saved the Earth.

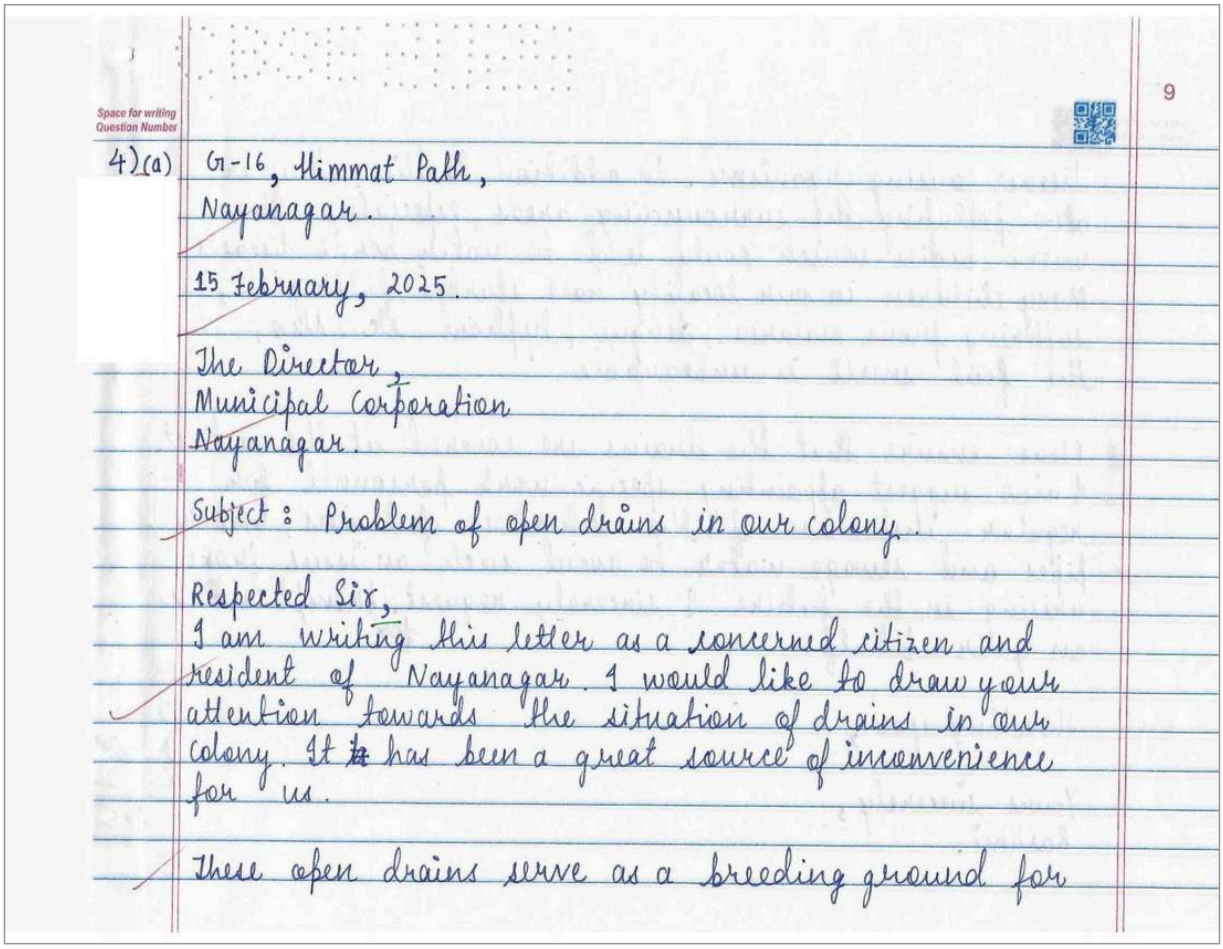
Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = **6**

MARKS SUMMARY

Section	Skill area	Questions	Marks
A	Reading Skills	Q1 (10) + Q2 (10)	20
B	Grammar (Q3: 10) and Writing Skills (Q4: 5, Q5: 5)	Q3 (10) + Q4 (5) + Q5 (5)	20
C	Literature Textbook	Q6 (5) + Q7 (5) + Q8 (12) + Q9 (6) + Q10 (6) + Q11 (6)	40
	Total		**80**

***

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q4 (A) (complaint letter on a civic problem) answer book p.9



Space for writing Question Number 9

4)(a) G-16, Himmat Path,
Nayanagar.

15 February, 2025.

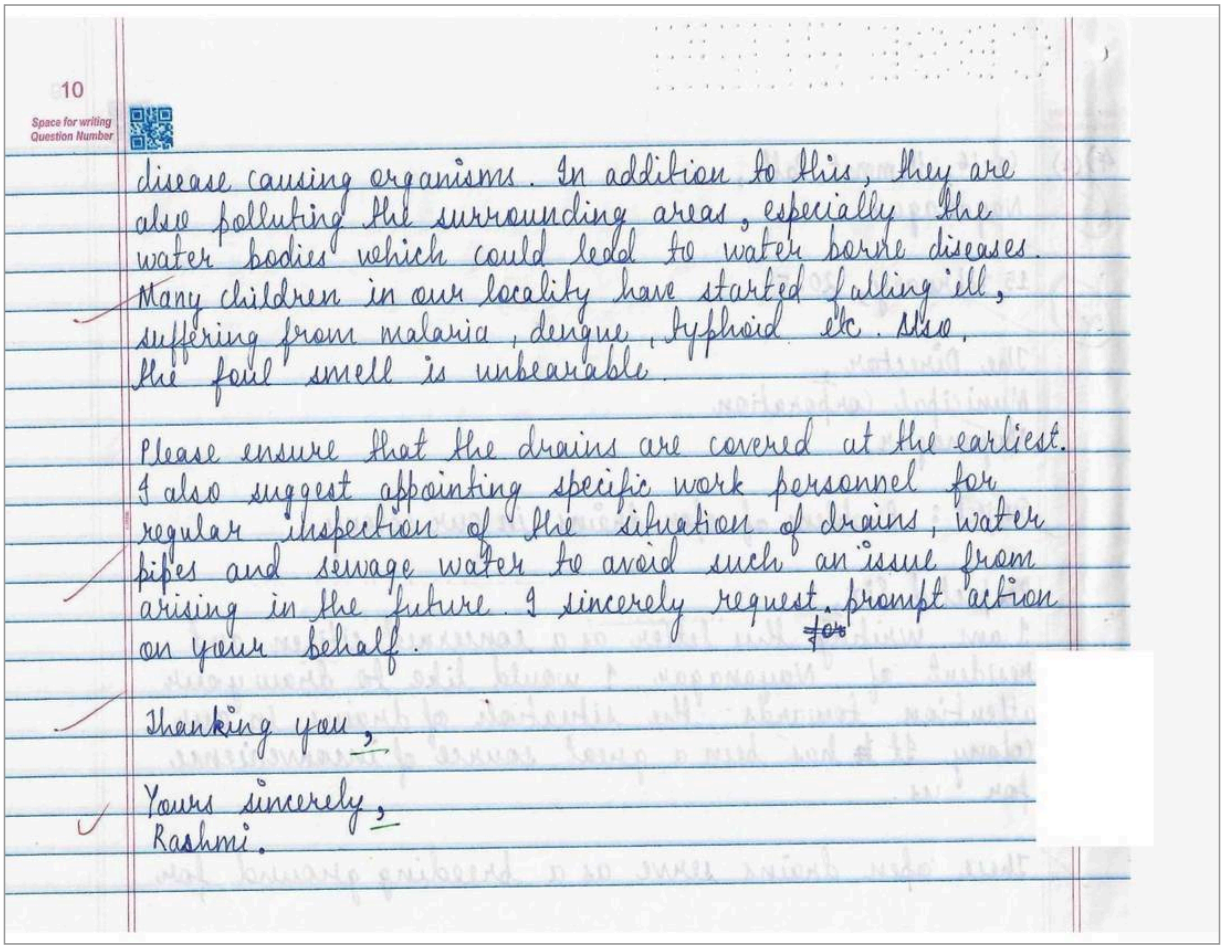
The Director,
Municipal Corporation
Nayanagar.

Subject : Problem of open drains in our colony.

Respected Sir,
I am writing this letter as a concerned citizen and resident of Nayanagar. I would like to draw your attention towards the situation of drains in our colony. It has been a great source of inconvenience for us.

These open drains serve as a breeding ground for

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · formal letter (contd.) answer book p.10



Space for writing Question Number 10

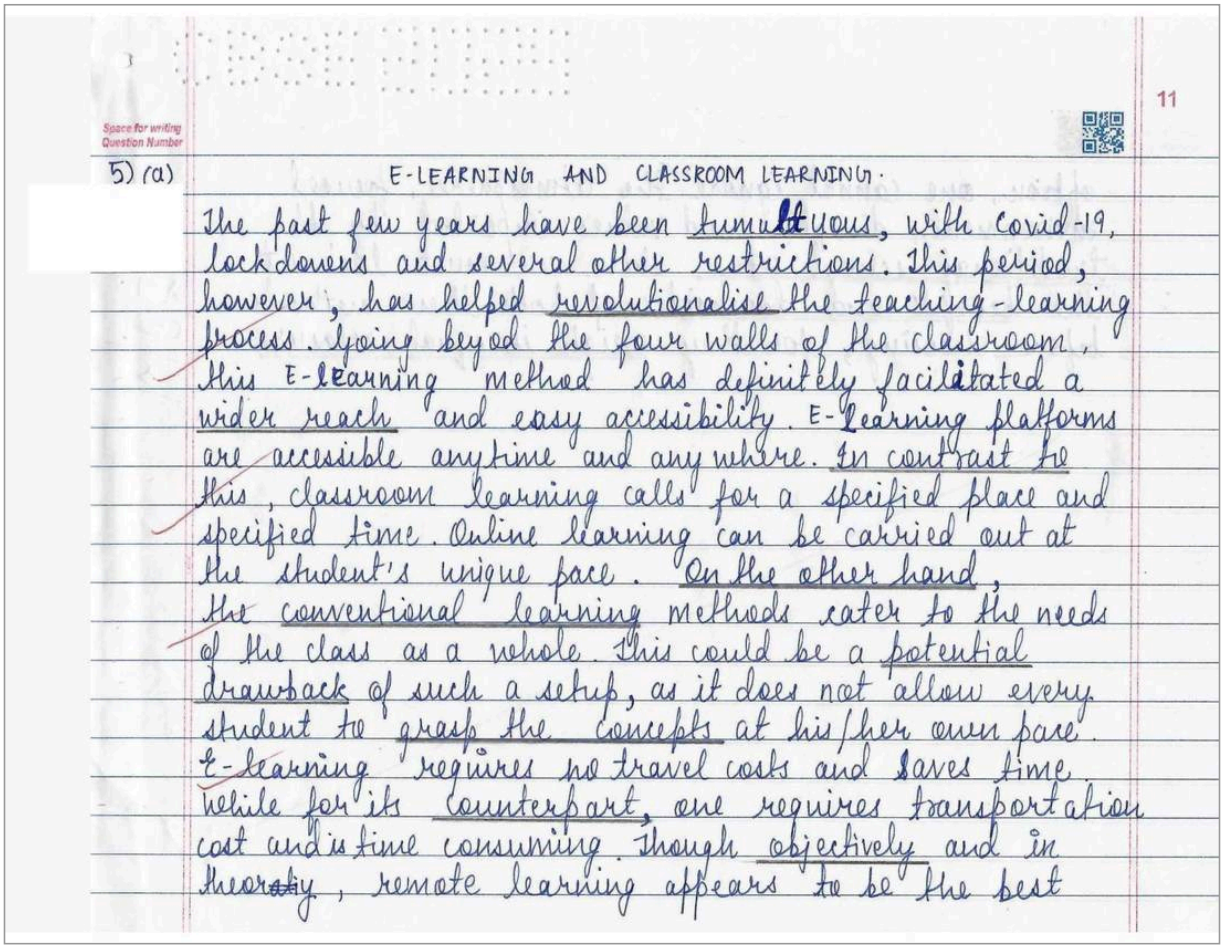
disease causing organisms. In addition to this, they are also polluting the surrounding areas, especially the water bodies which could lead to water borne diseases. Many children in our locality have started falling ill, suffering from malaria, dengue, typhoid etc. Also, the foul smell is unbearable.

Please ensure that the drains are covered at the earliest. I also suggest appointing specific work personnel for regular inspection of the situation of drains, water pipes and sewage water to avoid such an issue from arising in the future. I sincerely request prompt action on your behalf.

Thanking you,

Yours sincerely,
Rashmi.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q5 (B) (analytical paragraph on a chart) answer book p.11



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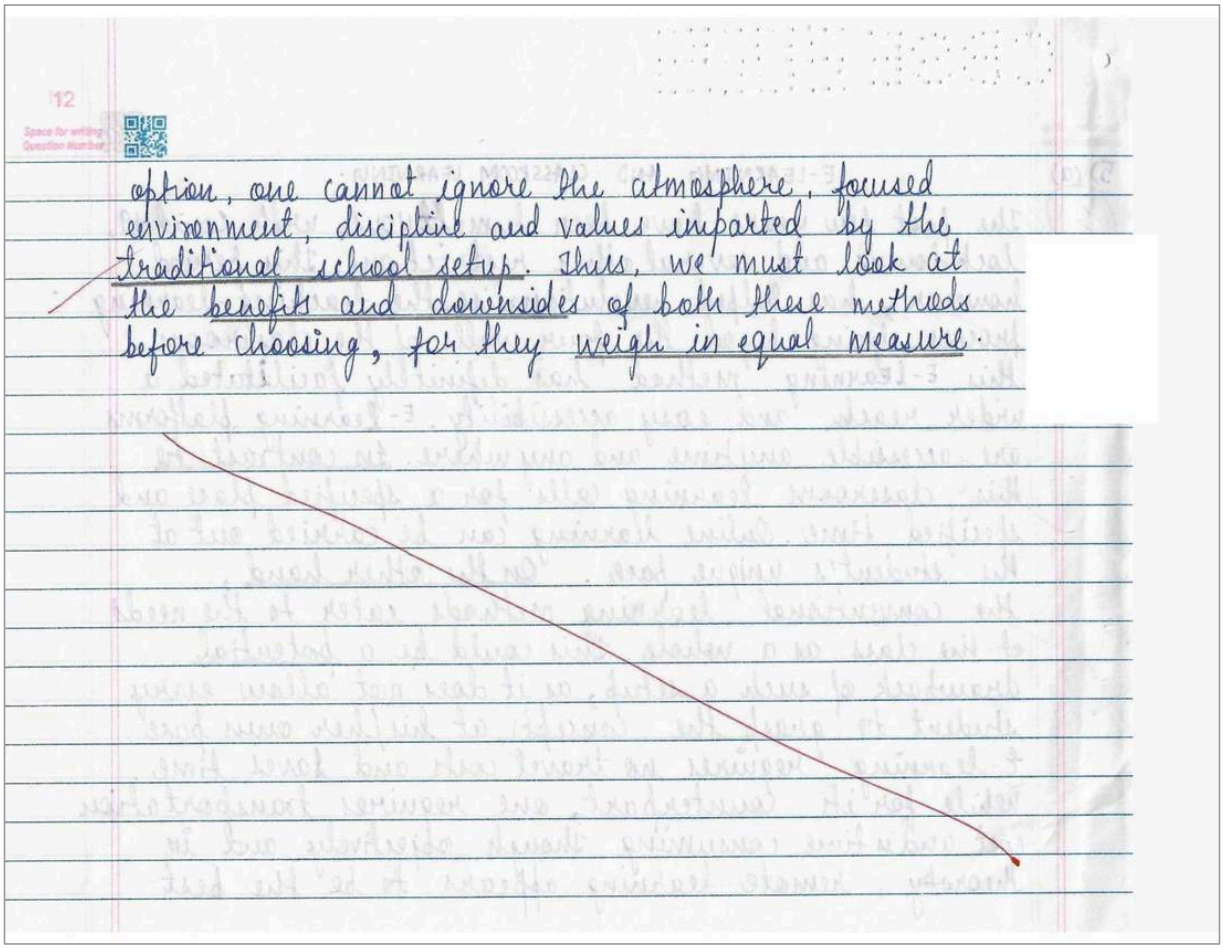
5) (a) E-LEARNING AND CLASSROOM LEARNING.

The past few years have been tumultuous, with Covid-19, lockdowns and several other restrictions. This period, however, has helped revolutionalise the teaching-learning process. Going beyond the four walls of the classroom, this E-learning method has definitely facilitated a wider reach and easy accessibility. E-learning platforms are accessible anytime and anywhere. In contrast to this, classroom learning calls for a specified place and specified time. Online learning can be carried out at the student's unique pace. On the other hand, the conventional learning methods cater to the needs of the class as a whole. This could be a potential drawback of such a setup, as it does not allow every student to grasp the concepts at his/her own pace. E-learning requires no travel costs and saves time, while for its counterpart, one requires transportation cost and is time consuming. Though objectively and in theory, remote learning appears to be the best

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · analytical paragraph (contd.) answer book p.12

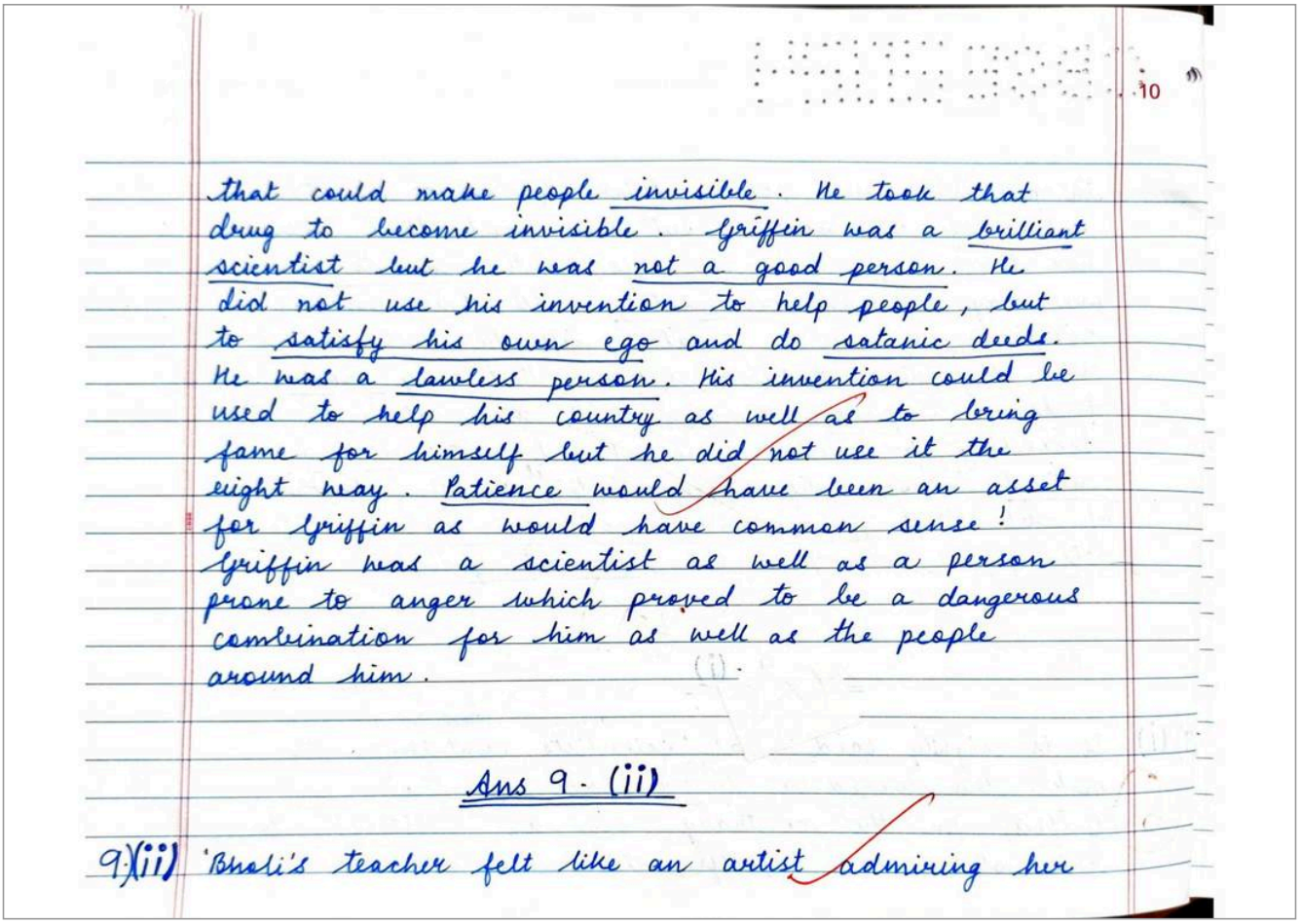


12

Space for writing Question Number

option, one cannot ignore the atmosphere, focused environment, discipline and values imparted by the traditional school setup. Thus, we must look at the benefits and downsides of both these methods before choosing, for they weigh in equal measure.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · similar to Q9 (II), Q11 (A) (Footprints without Feet; Bholi) answer book p.10



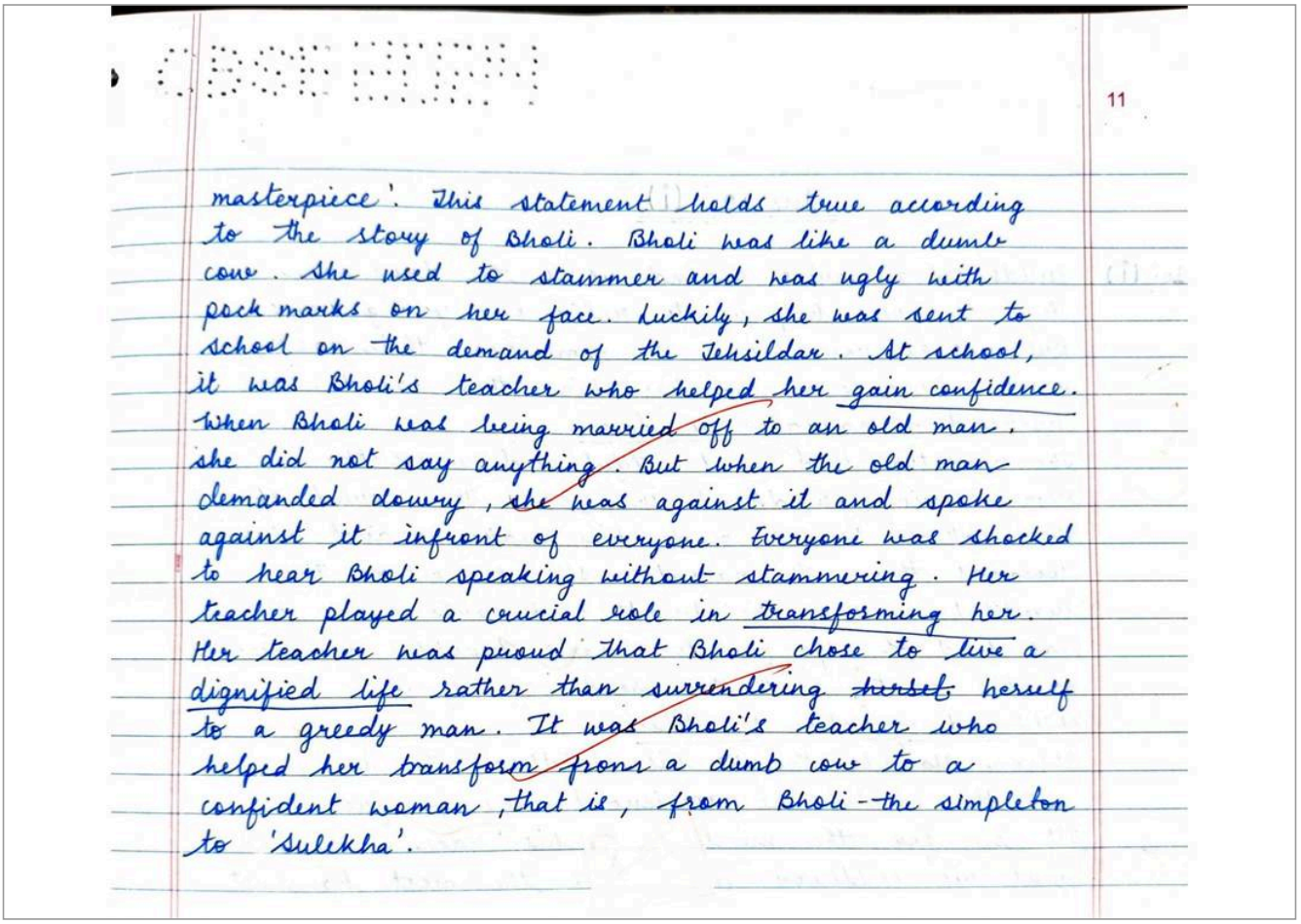
10

that could make people invisible. He took that drug to become invisible. Griffin was a brilliant scientist but he was not a good person. He did not use his invention to help people, but to satisfy his own ego and do satanic deeds. He was a lawless person. His invention could be used to help his country as well as to bring fame for himself but he did not use it the right way. Patience would have been an asset for Griffin as would have common sense! Griffin was a scientist as well as a person prone to anger which proved to be a dangerous combination for him as well as the people around him.

Ans 9. (ii)

9.(ii) 'Bholi's teacher felt like an artist admiring her

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · Bholi (contd.) answer book p.11



11

masterpiece'. This statement holds true according to the story of Bholi. Bholi was like a dumb cow. She used to stammer and was ugly with pock marks on her face. Luckily, she was sent to school on the demand of the Tehsildar. At school, it was Bholi's teacher who helped her gain confidence. When Bholi was being married off to an old man, she did not say anything. But when the old man demanded dowry, she was against it and spoke against it infront of everyone. Everyone was shocked to hear Bholi speaking without stammering. Her teacher played a crucial role in transforming her. Her teacher was proud that Bholi chose to live a dignified life rather than surrendering herself to a greedy man. It was Bholi's teacher who helped her transform from a dumb cow to a confident woman, that is, from Bholi - the simpleton to 'Sulekha'.

SAMPLE PAPER 7

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 7 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Think back to the first time you tried to ride a bicycle. You probably wobbled, lost your balance and scraped a knee more than once. Yet you climbed back on, adjusted the way you held the handlebar and tried again. Nobody called those falls ‘failures’; they were simply part of learning. Somewhere between that bicycle and the board examination, however, many of us begin to treat mistakes as something shameful, something to hide rather than examine.

(2) Schools, homes and even social media often celebrate only the final result – the trophy, the rank, the perfect score. The messy journey behind it is rarely shown. As a result, young people learn to fear red ink more than they value the lesson it carries. A student who is afraid of being wrong stops raising her hand, avoids the difficult sum and picks the safest topic for her project. Fear of failure, ironically, becomes the surest path to it.

(3) Research on how we learn tells a different story. When we make an error and then work out why it happened, the brain pays closer attention than when we get something right without effort, and the corrected idea tends to stay with us longer. Psychologist Carol Dweck describes the belief that abilities can be developed through effort as a ‘growth mindset’*. Students with this mindset treat a low score as information, not as a final verdict on their intelligence.

(4) History is crowded with such examples. Thomas Edison and his team tested thousands of materials before they found a filament that made the electric bulb practical. In 2019, Indian scientists watched the Chandrayaan-2 lander crash on the surface of the Moon. Four years later, after studying what had gone wrong, they landed Chandrayaan-3 safely near the Moon’s south pole. Their success was built on the lessons of an earlier setback.

(5) Of course, learning from failure is not automatic. A mistake teaches only when we pause to ask what went wrong and what we would do differently next time. Simply repeating the same error is not

resilience; it is carelessness. Keeping an 'error log', in which a student notes every mistake made in tests along with the reason behind it, is one simple habit that turns setbacks into stepping stones.

(6) Perhaps the real question is not whether we will fail, but what we will do when we do. The child on the bicycle already knows the answer: get up, adjust and pedal again. All we need to do is remember it.

*growth mindset: the belief that one's abilities and intelligence can be developed through effort, good strategies and help from others

Created for academic usage / 415 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'something to hide rather than examine' suggest about the way many students view their mistakes? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says, 'Fear of failure, ironically, becomes the surest path to it', he means that _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) students who avoid challenges for fear of being wrong lose chances to learn, and therefore end up doing poorly.

(b) students who are afraid of failing work harder than everyone else, and therefore rarely fail.

III Which of the following statements best reflects a 'growth mindset' as described in paragraph 3? **1**

A. "I am just not good at mathematics, so I will drop it next year."

B. "I scored low in this test; let me find out which concepts I misunderstood."

C. "Some people are born intelligent and others are not."

D. "If I skip the difficult sums, I can never get them wrong."

IV In paragraph 4, the writer refers to Thomas Edison and the Chandrayaan missions. What do these examples reveal about the writer's view of the relationship between failure and success? **2**

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 5) **1**
Repeating the same mistake again and again is a sign of resilience.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
setbacks : stepping stones :: _____ : _____

(a) mistakes : lessons

(b) trophies : ranks

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) The Chandrayaan-2 lander crashed on the surface of the Moon in 2019.
(ii) Fear of failure is the surest path to failure.
(iii) Edison's team tested thousands of materials before finding a practical filament.
(iv) Keeping an error log is the best habit a student can develop.
(v) A child on a bicycle understands success better than most adults.

A. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F

B. (i) O (ii) O (iii) F (iv) F (v) O

C. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

D. (i) F (ii) O (iii) O (iv) F (v) O

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in beginning and ending the passage with the image of a child learning to ride a bicycle? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Sleep specialists widely agree that teenagers need between eight and ten hours of sleep every night. A recent survey conducted by a city's school health network, however, suggests that most senior students are falling well short of this. The survey covered 1,200 students of Classes 9 to 12 from eight schools, who kept a record of their sleep for two weeks.

(2) The findings show a steady decline in sleep as students move to higher classes. While Class 9 students slept an average of 7.6 hours on school nights, Class 12 students managed only 6.3 hours. Overall, just 11% of the students surveyed slept eight hours or more on school nights. On weekends, they slept 1.8 hours longer on average, which researchers describe as 'catch-up sleep'.

Class	Average sleep on school nights (hours)	Students sleeping less than 7 hours	Screen time after 9 p.m. (minutes per day)
9	7.6	28%	45
10	7.0	41%	58
11	6.7	52%	66
12	6.3	63%	74

(3) When asked what kept them awake, 46% of the students blamed the use of phones and other screens late at night, 31% cited homework and coaching classes, and 14% pointed to early school timings and long commutes.

(4) The effects were visible in the classroom. Students who slept less than seven hours were nearly three times as likely to feel drowsy during the first two periods, and teachers noticed more frequent lapses in attention among them. The researchers recommend a fixed bedtime, a 'screen curfew' an hour before sleep, and better planning of homework schedules. As one school counsellor put it, "Sleep is not time taken away from studies; it is the time when learning settles in."

Created for academic usage / 241 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The word 'steady' as used in paragraph 2 suggests that the decline in sleep is _____.
(gradual and continuous / sudden and unexpected)

II What does the practice of 'catch-up sleep' on weekends suggest about the students' sleep on school nights? (Paragraph 2) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Class 12 students get the least sleep on school nights among the four classes surveyed.
Reason: Class 12 students spend the least time on screens after 9 p.m.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.
B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.
C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following are mentioned in paragraph 3 EXCEPT—

A. Nearly half of the students blamed late-night screen use for their lack of sleep.
B. Homework and coaching classes kept almost a third of the students awake.
C. Early school timings and long commutes affected 14% of the students.
D. Most students preferred studying late at night to studying early in the morning.

V Compare the sleep pattern of Class 9 and Class 12 students, as shown in the table. What might explain the difference? (Paragraphs 2 and 3) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 4) **1**
Students who slept less than seven hours found it harder to learn in class because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 4 that refers to a fixed time before sleep after which screens should not be used. **1**

VIII Aarav, a Class 11 student, studies till midnight with his phone beside him and wakes up at 6 a.m. for school. Based on the researchers' recommendations, suggest one change he should make. (Paragraph 4) **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Short on Sleep: The Hidden Cost of Senior Classes' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the line from an email sent by a school librarian: **1**
Dear Ritu,
We regret to inform you that the book you requested _____ to another member before your request reached us.

A. had been issued B. has issued C. was issuing D. is issued

II Report the coach's instruction to the players. **1**
Coach: "Do not skip your warm-up exercises before the match."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the notice put up by a museum: **1**
Notice
The museum will remain closed on Monday, 16 November, for maintenance work. _____ visitor holding a ticket for that day will receive a full refund.

A. All B. Every C. Few D. Many

IV Read Rohan's statement to his principal: **1**
"I have completed my project on water conservation and will submit it tomorrow."
Report Rohan's statement by completing the following sentence:
Rohan told the principal that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a newspaper report: **1**
The quality of the roads in the new sectors have improved considerably this year.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given line from a hospital notice: **1**
Visitors _____ not use mobile phones inside the Intensive Care Unit.

A. need B. must C. would D. might

VII The given sentence has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

Neither of the two candidates were selected for the final round.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	Neither	None
B.	of	from
C.	were	was
D.	the	a

VIII Meera asked the librarian the following question: **1**

"When will the new reference books arrive?"

Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.

Meera asked the librarian _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank. **1**

There were _____ seats left in the auditorium, so many late visitors had to stand.

A. few B. a little C. much D. little

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the given line from a travel blog. **1**

One of my favourite places in the city are the old botanical garden near the river.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the teacher's advice by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**

You _____ revise the chapter once more before the test; it will help you remember the dates. (should / would)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a school's annual report. **1**

The school _____ (plant) over five hundred saplings since the green drive began in July.

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Ritika / Rohit Saxena, a resident of 23, Arera Colony, Bhopal. The use of loudspeakers till late at night and construction work carried out after dark in your locality have made it difficult for students preparing for their board examinations to study and sleep. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily in 120 words, highlighting the problem, its effects on students and other residents, and suggesting measures to control it. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Ishaan / Isha Kapoor, residing at 45, Model Town, Ludhiana. You ordered a smartwatch from an online store, ShopWise India (Order No. SW-482193). It stopped charging two days after delivery. Write a letter to the Customer Care Manager of the store in 120 words, complaining about the defective product and requesting a replacement or a full refund. **5**

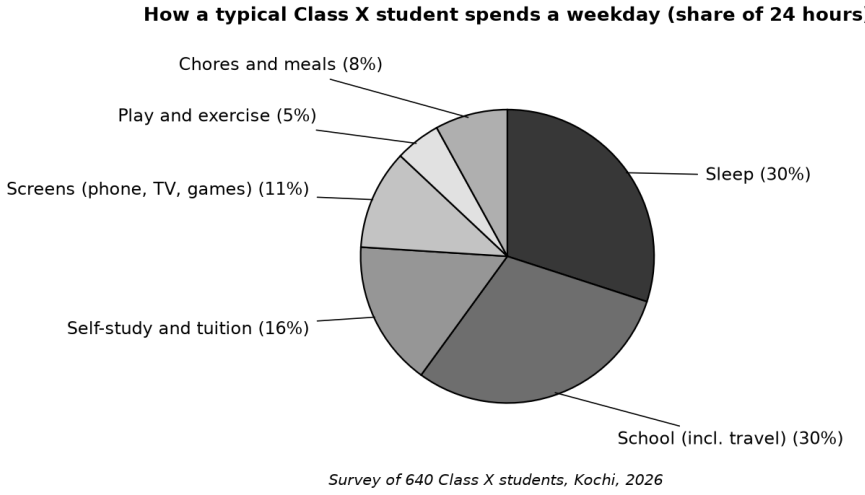
5 A. Read the product details mentioned on an e-commerce website for an ergonomic school backpack, the *SpineSafe Junior*. **5**

- Padded S-shaped shoulder straps with an adjustable chest strap that spreads the load evenly
- Breathable mesh back panel with built-in lumbar (lower-back) support
- Weighs only 650 g when empty; 30-litre capacity
- Separate compartments for books, a tablet or laptop (up to 15.6″), a water bottle and a lunch box
- Water-resistant fabric with reflective strips for visibility after dark
- Load guide on the tag: carry no more than 10% of your body weight
- Price: ₹1,499 | 3-year warranty on zips and seams

Now, analyse why this backpack would be a good purchase for school students. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as comfort and posture, organisation, safety, durability and value for money.

OR

5 B. The pie chart below shows the findings of a survey on how a typical Class X student in Kochi spends a weekday. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, analysing how the student's day is divided and what the pattern suggests. **5**



SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A.

Two days later, Mijbil escaped from my bedroom as I entered it, and I turned to see his tail disappearing round the bend of the corridor that led to the bathroom. By the time I got there he was up on the end of the bathtub and fumbling at the chromium taps with his paws. I watched, amazed; in less than a minute he had turned the tap far enough to produce a trickle of water, and after a moment or two achieved the full flow. (He had been lucky to turn the tap the right way; on later occasions he would sometimes screw it up still tighter, chittering with irritation and disappointment at the tap's failure to cooperate.)

(Mijbil the Otter)

I Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. 1
The narrator's reaction, 'I watched, amazed', shows that he _____.
(a) was surprised by the otter's intelligence and its skill in working the tap.
(b) was annoyed that the otter had escaped from the bedroom without his permission.

II Which of the following best describes Mijbil's behaviour in the extract? 1
A. clumsy but curious and determined
B. lazy and indifferent
C. aggressive and destructive
D. timid and fearful

III Complete the following suitably. 1
Mijbil headed straight for the bathroom because _____.

IV What does the narrator's comment in brackets about the tap's 'failure to cooperate' reveal about his attitude towards Mijbil? 2

OR

B.

Sitting down, she looked to see who had spoken. It was an elderly man who had honestly been concerned for her, but she was annoyed by his attention.
"There's nobody here who's a child," she said haughtily. "I've paid my thirty paise like everyone else."
The conductor chimed in. "Oh, sir, but this is a very grown-up madam. Do you think a mere girl could pay her own fare and travel to the city all alone?"
Valli shot an angry glance at the conductor and said, "I am not a madam. Please remember that. And you've not yet given me my ticket."
"I'll remember," the conductor said, mimicking her tone. Everyone laughed, and gradually Valli too joined in the laughter.

(Madam Rides the Bus)

I Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. 1
Valli's reply, 'I've paid my thirty paise like everyone else', shows that she _____.
(a) wants to be treated as an independent, grown-up passenger.
(b) is worried that she has been charged too much for her ticket.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
The conductor's words, 'this is a very grown-up madam', are spoken in a tone that is _____.
A. harsh and insulting
B. playful and teasing
C. fearful and nervous
D. dull and indifferent

III Why was Valli annoyed by the elderly man's attention, even though he was honestly concerned for her? 2

IV Fill in the blank with the correct word from the bracket. 1
Valli joining in the laughter at the end shows that she is basically _____.
(good-natured / arrogant)

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A.

I would not intrude on him;
A dime, another ball, is worthless. Now
He senses first responsibility
In a world of possessions. People will take
Balls, balls will be lost always, little boy.
And no one buys a ball back. Money is external.

He is learning, well behind his desperate eyes,
The epistemology of loss, how to stand up
Knowing what every man must one day know
And most know many days, how to stand up.

(The Ball Poem)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The poet chooses not to intrude on the boy because _____.

II The phrase 'Money is external' suggests that _____. **1**

A. money cannot buy back the memories and feelings attached to the lost ball
B. money is easily available to everyone
C. the boy has no money of his own
D. buying things is the only way to deal with loss

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The repetition of 'how to stand up' stresses that one must face loss and move on with _____.

IV 'He senses first responsibility / In a world of possessions.' Explain what the boy begins to understand about possessions and responsibility. **2**

OR

B.

Did you finish your homework, Amanda?
Did you tidy your room, Amanda?
I thought I told you to clean your shoes,
Amanda!
(I am an orphan, roaming the street.
I pattern soft dust with my hushed, bare feet.
The silence is golden, the freedom is sweet.)

(Amanda!)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The questions in the first stanza of the extract show that the speaker is mainly concerned about Amanda's _____.

II Why does Amanda imagine herself to be an orphan? **1**

A. She has actually lost her parents.
B. She longs for freedom from constant instructions and nagging.
C. She wants to live on the street and earn her own money.
D. She does not want to clean her shoes only.

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The line 'The silence is golden' suggests that Amanda values _____ over the constant nagging she hears.

IV Analyse how the use of brackets and the change in rhythm in the second stanza of the extract bring out the contrast between the two voices in the poem. **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3 =12**

I Lencho called the post office employees 'a bunch of crooks'. Why is this accusation ironic? **3**

(A Letter to God)

II According to Mandela, every man has 'twin obligations'. What are they, and why was it almost impossible for a black man in South Africa to fulfil both? **3**

(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

III How does the poet use 'fire' and 'ice' to comment on human emotions and their power to destroy? **3**

(Fire and Ice)

IV How did the Buddha help Kisa Gotami overcome her grief without preaching to her directly? **3**

(The Sermon at Benares)

V How does the poet contrast the tiger's life in the cage with the life it should be living in the jungle? **3**

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3 =6**

I How did Matilda react when her husband brought home the invitation to the Minister's ball? What does her reaction reveal about her? **3**

(The Necklace)

II For what unusual reason was Bholi sent to school? What does this reveal about her family's attitude towards her? **3**

(Bholi)

III How did Think-Tank's misreading of the nursery rhymes in 'Mother Goose' save the Earth from a Martian invasion? **3**

(The Book That Saved the Earth)

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Mr Keesing's punishments were meant to silence Anne, but she turned them into an opportunity. How does this episode reveal Anne's wit, confidence and creativity?

(From the Diary of Anne Frank)

OR

B. Through the constant quarrels of its characters, 'The Proposal' satirises the materialistic attitude of the rich land-owning class towards marriage. Discuss.

(The Proposal)

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Mrs Pumphrey loved Tricki dearly, yet her love nearly killed him. Write a character sketch of Mrs Pumphrey and comment on what the story teaches us about the responsible care of pets.

(A Triumph of Surgery)

OR

B. Anil never accused Hari Singh of the theft, yet he changed him forever. How did Anil's trust and the promise of education bring about a change of heart in Hari Singh?

(The Thief's Story)

***

SAMPLE PAPER 7

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

MARKING SCHEME · SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 7 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. | **MARKING SCHEME** | **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions: The marking scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers. These are guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. Students may use their own expression; if it is correct, due marks should be awarded.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Reading Comprehension through Discursive Passage — **10**

Answer

I It suggests that many students feel ashamed of their mistakes and try to cover them up instead of studying them to understand what went wrong and learn from them. — **1**

II (a) students who avoid challenges for fear of being wrong lose chances to learn, and therefore end up doing poorly. — **1**

III B. "I scored low in this test; let me find out which concepts I misunderstood." — **1**

IV — **2**
- The writer believes that failure is not the opposite of success but a part of the path to it. **(½)**
- Edison's team succeeded only after testing thousands of materials, and Chandrayaan-3 succeeded because scientists studied why Chandrayaan-2's lander crashed. **(½ + ½)**
- Thus, setbacks, when analysed honestly, provide the lessons on which success is built. **(½)**

V False — **1**

VI (a) mistakes : lessons
[Just as setbacks can become stepping stones, mistakes can become lessons when we learn from them.] — **1**

VII C. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O — **1**

VIII — **2**
- The familiar image of a child learning to ride a bicycle connects instantly with readers, since everyone has experienced falling and trying again. **(½)**
- At the beginning it shows that we naturally accept mistakes as part of learning when we are young; **(½)**
- at the end it brings the argument full circle and reminds readers that the same attitude – get up, adjust and try again – should be carried into studies and life. **(½ + ½)**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 + V 1 + VI 1 + VII 1 + VIII 2 = **10**

2. Reading Comprehension through Case-based Factual Passage — **10**

Answer

I gradual and continuous — **1**

II It suggests that students do not get enough sleep on school nights and try to make up for the shortfall by sleeping longer on weekends. — **1**

III C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
[Class 12 students sleep the least (6.3 hours), but they spend the MOST time on screens after 9 p.m. (74 minutes), not the least.] — **1**

IV D. Most students preferred studying late at night to studying early in the morning. — **1**

V — **2**
- Class 9 students sleep 7.6 hours on average while Class 12 students sleep only 6.3 hours; the share sleeping less than seven hours rises from 28% to 63%. **(½ + ½)**
- The difference may be explained by greater academic pressure (homework, coaching classes) in senior classes **(½)**
- and by higher late-night screen time, which increases from 45 to 74 minutes a day. **(½)**

VI they felt drowsy during the first two periods and suffered frequent lapses in attention. — **1**

VII 'screen curfew' — **1**

VIII	Any one: Aarav should keep his phone away and stop using screens an hour before sleeping (screen curfew) / fix an earlier, regular bedtime / plan his homework so that he can finish studying earlier.	**1**
IX	Any one: The title is suitable because the passage shows that students sleep less and less as they move to senior classes (from 7.6 hours in Class 9 to 6.3 hours in Class 12), and this lack of sleep has a hidden cost – drowsiness and poor attention in class.	**1**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 1 + V 2 + VI 1 + VII 1 + VIII 1 + IX 1 = **10**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

Answer

I	A. had been issued	**1**
II	The coach instructed / advised / told the players not to skip their warm-up exercises before the match.	**1**
III	B. Every	**1**
IV	he had completed his project on water conservation and would submit it the next day / the following day.	**1**
V	Error: have Correction: has	**1**
VI	B. must	**1**
VII	C. were – was	**1**
VIII	when the new reference books would arrive.	**1**
IX	A. few	**1**
X	Error: are Correction: is	**1**
XI	should	**1**
XII	has planted	**1**

Marks: 1 mark for each correct answer; any ten of the twelve items = 10 × 1 = **10**

WRITING SKILLS (10 MARKS)

4. **Formal Letter** – Format 1 Content 2 Organisation of ideas 1 Accuracy 1 **1x5 =5**

Answer

Criterion	Marks
Format (sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, complimentary close, name)	1
Content (relevance of ideas, coverage of the given points)	2
Organisation of ideas (logical sequencing, paragraphing, coherence)	1
Accuracy (grammar, spelling, punctuation)	1

Marks: Format 1 + Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 1 + Accuracy 1 = **5**

A.

Answer

(The response may be created from the following content points)

- **Issue:** loudspeakers at functions till late at night; construction work after dark in the locality
- **Effects on students:** unable to concentrate during board examination preparation; disturbed sleep, fatigue, stress
- **Effects on others:** elderly people and patients suffer headaches, high blood pressure, restlessness; infants disturbed
- **Measures:** strict enforcement of the 10 p.m. loudspeaker rule; fines on builders working beyond permitted hours; complaint helpline; awareness drives by RWAs
- **Appeal:** request the authorities to act promptly

Content (2): any four relevant points from the above, ½ mark each.

Model answer (A):

23, Arera Colony
Bhopal

12 November 20XX

The Editor
The Daily Sentinel
Bhopal

Subject: Noise pollution at night troubling students during examinations

Sir

Through the columns of your esteemed daily, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities towards the rising noise pollution in Arera Colony.

Loudspeakers at functions blare till well past midnight, while construction work on two new buildings continues after dark. Students preparing for board examinations are unable to concentrate or get proper sleep. Elderly people and patients suffer from headaches and restlessness, and infants are woken up repeatedly.

I request the police to strictly enforce the ban on loudspeakers after 10 p.m. Builders should be fined for working beyond permitted hours, and helpline numbers for complaints should be displayed in every block. Residents, too, must be made aware of the harm caused by noise.

I hope prompt action will be taken.

Yours truly
Ritika Saxena

OR

B.

Answer

(The response may be created from the following value points)

– Reference to the order: smartwatch, Order No. SW-482193, date of delivery
– Nature of the defect: stopped charging two days after delivery; tried a different charger/socket, no result
– Inconvenience caused; product not as promised
– Request: replacement with a working piece or full refund within a stated time; arrange pick-up of the defective item
– Enclosures: copy of invoice / photographs; contact details for follow-up

Content (2): any four relevant points from the above, ½ mark each.

5. **1x5 =5**

Answer

Analytical Paragraph – Content 2 Organisation of ideas 2 Accuracy 1

Criterion	Marks
Content (analysis of all the given elements, relevant inferences)	2
Organisation of ideas (introduction, logical flow, conclusion; no title)	2
Accuracy (grammar, spelling, punctuation)	1

Marks: Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 2 + Accuracy 1 = **5**

Analytical paragraph writing should NOT be confused with writing a description of the given elements or a summary. It requires examining the given elements closely and drawing inferences. It carries no title or heading.

A.

Answer

(The response may be created from the following value points)

– **Comfort and posture:** padded S-shaped straps, adjustable chest strap, lumbar support spread the load and protect the spine; breathable mesh back
– **Organisation:** separate compartments for books, tablet/laptop (up to 15.6″), water bottle and lunch box
– **Light weight and healthy use:** 650 g empty, 30-litre capacity; load guide of not more than 10% of body weight
– **Safety and durability:** reflective strips for visibility after dark; water-resistant fabric; 3-year warranty on zips and seams
– **Value for money:** ₹1,499 for comfort, safety and long life; conclusion – a sensible purchase

Content (2): analysis of any four of the points above with relevant inference, ½ mark each. Organisation (2): introduction, logical flow with linkers, conclusion.

Model answer (A):

The SpineSafe Junior backpack is a wise choice for school students. Firstly, its padded S-shaped straps, adjustable chest strap and lumbar support spread the load evenly and protect the growing

spine, while the breathable mesh panel keeps the back cool. Secondly, separate compartments for books, a tablet, a water bottle and a lunch box keep things organised and stop heavy items from shifting. Moreover, at only 650 g it adds little weight, and its 10% body-weight load guide encourages healthy habits. The reflective strips improve safety after dark, and the water-resistant fabric protects books in the rain. Finally, at ₹1,499 with a 3-year warranty, it offers durability and good value for money.

OR

B. Answer

(The response may be created from the following value points)

– Introduction: pie chart of how a typical Class X student in Kochi spends a weekday (survey of 640 students)
– Largest shares: sleep 30% and school including travel 30% – together 60% of the day
– Self-study and tuition 16%: with school, nearly half the day goes to learning
– Screens 11% – more than twice play and exercise (5%); chores and meals 8%
– Inference/conclusion: study-centred routine, little physical activity, slightly short sleep (about 7 hours); reducing screen time could make room for play and rest

Content (2): analysis of any four of the points above with relevant inference, ½ mark each. Organisation (2): introduction, logical flow with linkers, conclusion.

Model answer (B):

The pie chart shows how a typical Class X student in Kochi spends a weekday. Sleep and school, including travel, take up the largest shares, 30% each, which together account for well over half of the day. Self-study and tuition claim another 16%, so nearly half the day is devoted to learning. Strikingly, screens take up 11% of the day, more than twice the time given to play and exercise, which receives only 5%. Chores and meals account for the remaining 8%. Sleep of about seven hours is slightly below what doctors recommend for teenagers. Overall, the data suggests that students lead a study-centred life with little physical activity, and that cutting screen time could create room for play, exercise and rest.

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Answer — Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A. Answer

Prose (Mijbil the Otter)

I (a) was surprised by the otter's intelligence and its skill in working the tap. **1**

II A. clumsy but curious and determined **1**

III Any one: he loved water, like all otters / he had earlier gone wild with joy playing in the water of the bathtub. **1**

IV **2**
– The remark is light-hearted and affectionate; Maxwell describes the otter's irritation as though Mijbil were a human child. **(½ + ½)**
– It shows his fondness for and amusement at Mijbil, and his keen, patient observation of the otter's behaviour. **(½ + ½)**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 = **5**

OR

B. Answer

Prose (Madam Rides the Bus)

I (a) wants to be treated as an independent, grown-up passenger. **1**

II B. playful and teasing **1**

III **2**
– Valli wanted to be treated as a grown-up who was travelling on her own, having paid her own fare. **(½ + ½)**
– Being called 'child' and told to sit down hurt her pride and sense of independence, so she resented even well-meant advice. **(½ + ½)**

IV good-natured **1**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 2 + IV 1 = **5**

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

Answer

A. **Poetry (The Ball Poem)**

Answer

I he wants the boy to experience the loss himself and learn from it / the boy must learn to deal with loss on his own. **1**

II A. money cannot buy back the memories and feelings attached to the lost ball **1**

III courage / strength / resilience (any one) **1**

IV **2**
- The boy realises for the first time that in a world full of possessions, things will be lost and cannot always be replaced. **(½ + ½)**
- He understands that he is responsible for what he owns and must learn to bear its loss and move on – a first step towards maturity. **(½ + ½)**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 = **5**

OR

B. **Poetry (Amanda!)**

Answer

I discipline / responsibilities / daily chores (any one) **1**

II B. She longs for freedom from constant instructions and nagging. **1**

III peace / quiet / solitude (any one) **1**

IV **2**
- The brackets set apart Amanda's private daydream from the adult's spoken commands, showing that she is not listening. **(½ + ½)**
- The first stanza is abrupt, with questions and an exclamation, while the second has a smooth, flowing rhyme (street/feet/sweet) and a calm, dreamy tone, contrasting nagging control with Amanda's longing for freedom. **(½ + ½)**

Marks: I 1 + II 1 + III 1 + IV 2 = **5**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3 =12**

Answer

Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – deduct up to 1 mark from overall

Content (2): value points as marked against each answer. Expression (1): fluency, coherence, relevance and word limit. Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score for grammatical and spelling errors.

I **Value points:** Post office employees collected the seventy pesos for Lencho out of charity **(½)**; the postmaster even gave a part of his salary **(½)**; Lencho calls these very people 'a bunch of crooks' **(½)**; his blind faith in God makes him suspect his real benefactors **(½)** **3**

Model answer: The irony is that the post office employees, whom Lencho calls 'a bunch of crooks', were the very people who had collected the seventy pesos for him out of charity. The postmaster even gave a part of his salary. Lencho's blind faith in God made him suspect his real benefactors.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

II **Value points:** Obligation to his family – parents, wife and children **(½)**; obligation to his people, community and country **(½)**; under apartheid a black man who served his people was punished and isolated **(½)**; he was torn away from his family and could not fulfil both duties **(½)** **3**

Model answer: Mandela says every man has an obligation to his family – parents, wife and children – and to his people, community and country. Under apartheid, a black man who tried to serve his people was punished and isolated, and so was torn away from his family. He could not fulfil both duties.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

III **Value points:** Fire symbolises desire and greed **(½)**; ice symbolises hatred, coldness and indifference **(½)**; fire destroys quickly and fiercely, ice slowly by hardening hearts **(½)**; both can end the world: uncontrolled emotions can destroy humanity **(½)** **3**
Model answer: Frost uses fire to symbolise desire and greed, and ice to symbolise hatred, coldness and indifference. Fire destroys quickly and fiercely, whereas ice destroys slowly by hardening hearts. Both, he suggests, are powerful enough to end the world, since uncontrolled human emotions can destroy relationships and humanity itself.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

IV **Value points:** Asked her to bring mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend **(½)**; she went from house to house and found none **(½)**; she realised by herself that death is common to all **(½)**; her grief was selfish; the lesson came from experience, not preaching **(½)** **3**
Model answer: Instead of preaching, the Buddha asked Kisa Gotami to bring a handful of mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend. Going from house to house, she found none. She realised by herself that death is common to all and that her grief was selfish.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

V **Value points:** In the zoo: stalks the few steps of its cage in quiet rage **(½)**; at night: hears patrolling cars, stares at the brilliant stars **(½)**; in the jungle: lurking in shadow, sliding through long grass near the water hole, terrorising villagers **(½)**; the contrast highlights the cruelty of captivity **(½)** **3**
Model answer: In the zoo, the tiger stalks the few steps of its cage, quietly raging, and at night hears patrolling cars and stares at the brilliant stars. In the jungle, it should be lurking in shadow, sliding through long grass near the water hole and terrorising villagers. The contrast highlights the cruelty of captivity.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3**
Answer Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – deduct up to 1 mark from overall **=6**
Content (2): value points as marked against each answer. Expression (1): fluency, coherence, relevance and word limit. Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark from the overall score for grammatical and spelling errors.

I **Value points:** Threw the invitation spitefully on the table instead of being delighted **(½)**; wept because she had no suitable dress **(½)**; Loisel gave her the four hundred francs saved for a gun **(½)**; reveals her discontent, vanity and selfishness **(½)** **3**
Model answer: Instead of being delighted, Matilda threw the invitation spitefully on the table, murmuring, 'What do you suppose I want with that?' She wept because she had no suitable dress, and Loisel gave her the four hundred francs he had saved for a gun. It reveals her discontent, vanity and selfishness.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

II **Value points:** A girls' school opened; the Tehsildar asked Ramlal to set an example **(½)**; his wife feared educated girls would not get married **(½)**; she suggested sending Bholi, who had little chance of marriage anyway **(½)**; 'Let the teachers at school worry about her' shows the parents' neglect **(½)** **3**
Model answer: When a girls' school opened, the Tehsildar told Ramlal to set an example by sending his daughters. His wife feared educated girls would not get married, so suggested sending Bholi, who had little chance of marriage anyway: 'Let the teachers at school worry about her.' It shows their neglect of her.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

III **Value points:** Think-Tank misread nursery rhymes as coded messages **(½)**; 'Mistress Mary': Earthlings grow metals and explosives; 'Hey Diddle Diddle': even animals know space travel **(½)**; Humpty Dumpty's picture made him fear capture **(½)**; cancelled the invasion and fled towards Alpha Centauri **(½)** **3**
Model answer: Think-Tank misread the rhymes as coded messages. 'Mistress Mary' meant Earthlings could grow metals and explosives; 'Hey Diddle Diddle' meant even animals knew space travel. When Noodle showed him Humpty Dumpty's picture, he thought Earthlings planned to capture him, so he cancelled the invasion and fled towards Alpha Centauri.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = **3**

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

Content (3): value points as marked against each answer. Expression (2): organisation of ideas, coherence, fluency and word limit. Accuracy (1): grammar, spelling and punctuation.

A.

Answer

Value points: Mr Keesing punished Anne's talking with extra homework: essays on 'A Chatterbox' and 'An Incorrigible Chatterbox' **(½)**; Anne argued that talking is a student's trait inherited from her mother – wit and logic **(1)**; Third topic answered in verse with Sanne's help: mother duck, father swan, ducklings bitten to death for chattering **(1)**; Mr Keesing took the joke the right way, read it to the class and allowed her to talk – creativity, confidence, humour **(½)**

Model answer:

Anne's maths teacher, Mr Keesing, was annoyed by her constant talking and punished her by asking her to write an essay on 'A Chatterbox'. Instead of feeling humiliated, Anne argued cleverly that talking is a student's trait inherited from her mother. She wrote the second essay, 'An Incorrigible Chatterbox', just as confidently. For the third topic, 'Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox', she replied in verse with the help of her friend Sanne. The poem, about a mother duck and a father swan who bit his ducklings to death for chattering too much, made Mr Keesing laugh. He read it to the class and finally allowed her to talk. The episode reveals Anne's wit, confidence and creativity.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = **6**

OR

B.

Answer

Value points: Marriage seen as a deal: Lomov wants a good housekeeper and a quiet, regular life; Chubukov readily agrees **(1)**; Quarrels over Oxen Meadows and the dogs Guess and Squeezer show greed and false pride in property **(1)**; Natalya's sudden change of attitude on learning of the proposal; quarrels continue even after the engagement **(½)**; Farce exposes the materialism and pettiness of the land-owning class **(½)**

Model answer:

Chekhov's one-act play shows how marriage among the rich landowners is driven by property, not love. Lomov, a hypochondriac, wants to marry Natalya only because she is a good housekeeper, not bad-looking and well-educated, and because he wants to lead a quiet and regular life. Chubukov, who has long waited for this, welcomes him at once. Before the proposal is even made, Lomov and Natalya quarrel bitterly over the ownership of the Oxen Meadows, and later over whose dog is better, Guess or Squeezer. Insults about each other's families follow. Natalya changes her attitude only when she learns that Lomov had come to propose. Even after the engagement, they continue quarrelling. Through these trivial fights, Chekhov mocks the greed, pride and materialism of the upper class.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = **6**

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

Content (3): value points as marked against each answer. Expression (2): organisation of ideas, coherence, fluency and word limit. Accuracy (1): grammar, spelling and punctuation.

A.

Answer

Value points: Rich, kind-hearted lady who loves her little dog Tricki like a child **(½)**; Blind, indulgent love: cream cakes and chocolates; malt, cod-liver oil and Horlicks when he grows listless; cannot refuse him and ignores Herriot's advice **(1)**; Generous and devoted: sends two dozen eggs at a time, wine and brandy to 'build up' Tricki in the surgery **(½)**; Naive: calls a recovery brought about by diet and exercise 'a triumph of surgery' **(½)**; Lesson: responsible pet care means a balanced diet, exercise and discipline, not pampering **(½)**

Model answer:

Mrs Pumphrey is a rich, kind-hearted lady who loves her little dog, Tricki, like a child. However, her love is blind and foolish. She overfeeds him with cream cakes and chocolates and, when he becomes listless, adds malt, cod-liver oil and Horlicks, believing he is weak. She cannot refuse his begging and ignores Herriot's advice to cut down on sweets. She is also generous, sending two dozen eggs at a time, wine and brandy to build up his strength. Yet she is naive, for she calls his

recovery, achieved only through diet and exercise, ‘a triumph of surgery’. The story teaches that true care means a balanced diet, regular exercise and discipline, not indulgence.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = **6**

OR

B.

Answer

Value points: Hari Singh, 15, a practised thief, wins over Anil, 25, a kind writer; Anil lets him cook, teaches him to write his name, promises whole sentences **(½)**; Steals 600 rupees in fifties from under Anil’s mattress; hesitates and misses the Lucknow Express **(½)**; Realises the value of education: whole sentences could bring more than a few hundred rupees; returns in the rain and puts back the damp notes **(1)**; Anil gives him a wet fifty-rupee note and says they will start writing sentences – he knew but forgave silently; trust and kindness reform Hari **(1)**

Model answer:

Hari Singh, a fifteen-year-old thief, won the confidence of Anil, a kind young writer. Anil let him cook and shop for him and taught him to write his name, promising to teach him whole sentences. One night, Hari stole six hundred rupees from under Anil’s mattress and ran to catch the Lucknow Express, but he hesitated and let the train go. Sitting in the rain, he realised that he had lost a chance to become educated: whole sentences could one day bring him more than a few hundred rupees. He returned and put back the damp notes. Next morning, Anil gave him a wet fifty-rupee note and said they would start writing sentences. Anil’s silent forgiveness reformed Hari.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = **6**

MARKS SUMMARY

Section	Skill area	Questions	Marks
A	Reading Skills	Q1 (10) + Q2 (10)	20
B	Grammar (Q3: 10) and Writing Skills (Q4: 5, Q5: 5)	Q3 (10) + Q4 (5) + Q5 (5)	20
C	Literature Textbook	Q6 (5) + Q7 (5) + Q8 (12) + Q9 (6) + Q10 (6) + Q11 (6)	40
	Total		**80**

***

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · similar to Q4 (A) (letter to the Editor) answer book p.18

4. A. C-63
Canvel
Mumbai - 400012

27 February 2023

The Editor
The Times Of India
24 Beach Road
Mumbai - 400005

Subject :- Pitiable condition of child labourers

Dear Sir / Madam

This is to bring to your notice, a pressing issue in today's society, ~~~~ about which I recently came across in a magazine article.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · letter to the Editor (contd.) answer book p.19

The article described the hazardous conditions that underage children are subjected to. Most of them belong to families living below the poverty line. Hence, school education is a distant dream for them. To supplement their family incomes, they are ~~~~ coerced to work in dimly lit factories, tea stalls and in garages. To my absolute shock, the children in factories must work with sharp tools, capable of injuring them. Accompanying the article was a photograph of a young boy employed in a tea stall. The pain in his eyes was heart-wrenching. To make matters worse, most of them are ill-treated by their employers. The youth make up a large part of our nation's population. Children are our future, and if we do not protect them, who will?

As vigilant citizens, it is our responsibility to eradicate this menace. Boycott of enterprises ~~~~ utilising child labour will force them to shut down. Providing low-

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · similar to Q5 (B) (letter ends; analytical paragraph on a data table begins) answer book p.20

cost education to these children will go a long way. Government agencies must take a more pro-active approach through surprise checks and hefty penalties. I hope fervently that this national problem is brought to the notice of the authorities concerned through the columns of your esteemed newspaper and the necessary measures are taken.

Yours truly
~~Jyoti~~
(Anjali)

5. A

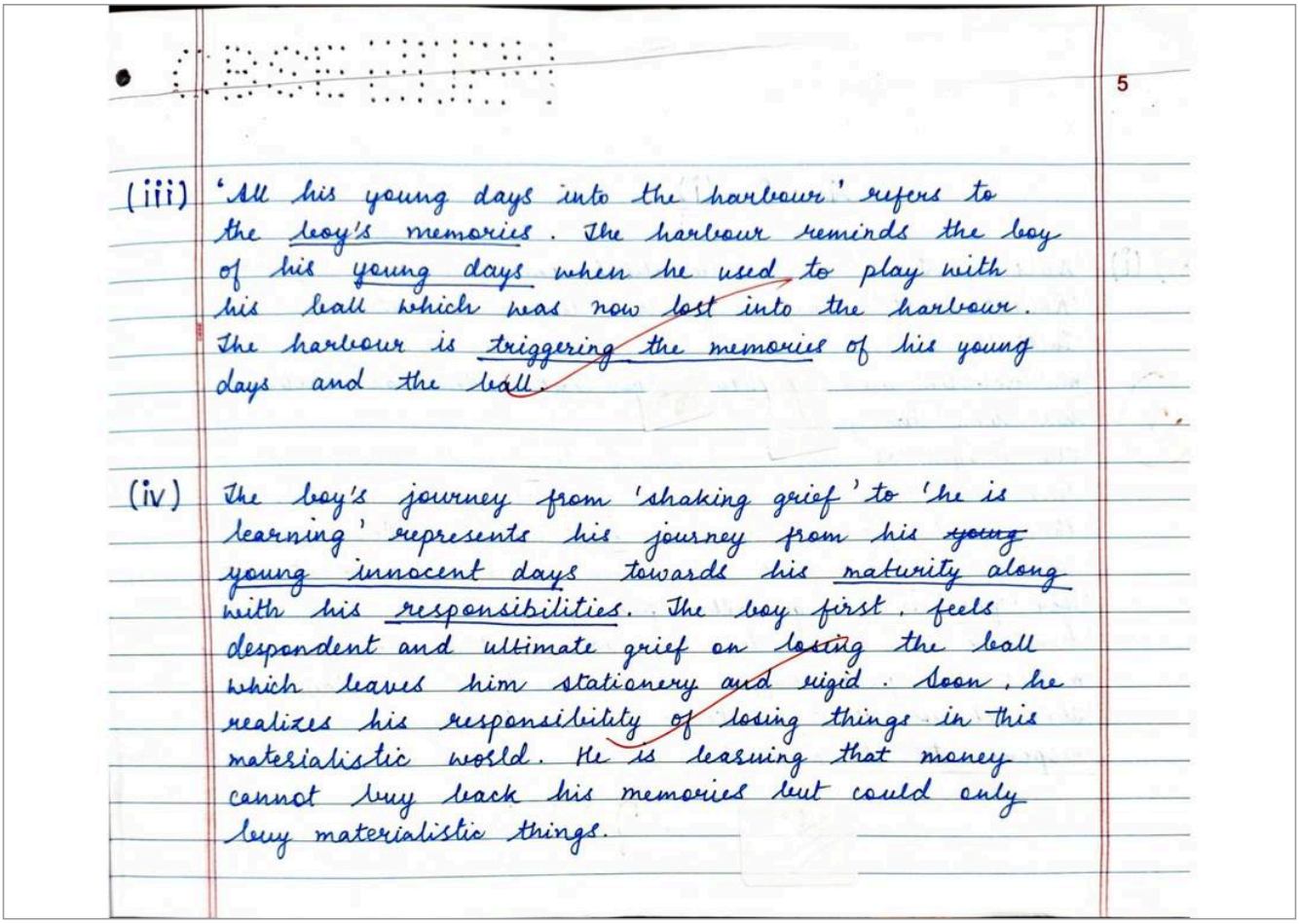
The Issue Of Air Pollution

The given table provides the pollution figures of some major Indian towns and cities. The data includes ~~the~~ three major air pollutants namely, suspended particulate matter, sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides, their

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · analytical paragraph (contd.) answer book p.21

permissible levels and their levels in Ludhiana, Delhi, Mumbai and Chennai. The levels of suspended particulate matter in all four cities (453 in Ludhiana, 680 in Delhi, 435 in Mumbai and 262 in Chennai) far exceed the permissible level of 200. The abnormal levels of particulate matter may be attributed to the smoke and dust released by vehicles in these well-developed cities, apart from burning of agricultural produce in Delhi and Ludhiana. The permissible levels of both sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide are 80. The high proportions of sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide in Delhi (124 and 137 respectively) are alarming. However, in the other cities, these are fortunately well within the limit. The sulphur dioxide levels are lowest in Ludhiana at 20, followed by Mumbai at 27 and then Chennai at 45. The levels of nitrogen oxide follow the opposite trend with Chennai at 34 and then Mumbai at 53 and Ludhiana at 64. It is evident that air pollution is a major issue affecting big towns and cities in

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · similar to Q7 (A) (extract, The Ball Poem) answer book p.5

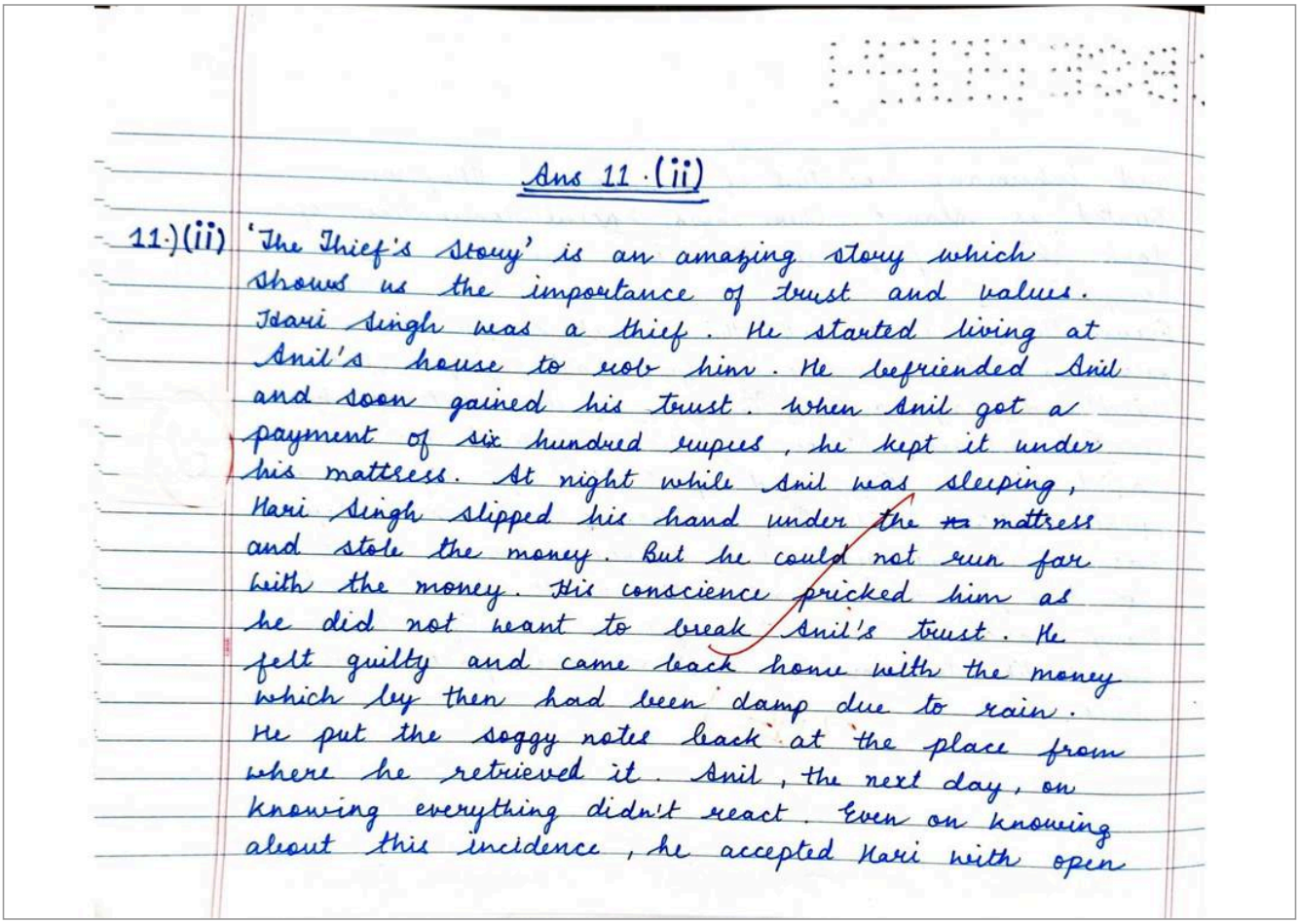


5

(iii) 'All his young days into the harbour' refers to the boy's memories. The harbour reminds the boy of his young days when he used to play with his ball which was now lost into the harbour. The harbour is triggering the memories of his young days and the ball.

(iv) The boy's journey from 'shaking grief' to 'he is learning' represents his journey from his ~~young~~ young innocent days towards his maturity along with his responsibilities. The boy first, feels despondent and ultimate grief on losing the ball which leaves him stationery and rigid. Soon, he realizes his responsibility of losing things in this materialistic world. He is learning that money cannot buy back his memories but could only buy materialistic things.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · similar to Q11 (B) (long answer, The Thief's Story) answer book p.14



Ans 11 · (ii)

11.)(ii) 'The Thief's Story' is an amazing story which shows us the importance of trust and values. Hari Singh was a thief. He started living at Anil's house to rob him. He befriended Anil and soon gained his trust. When Anil got a payment of six hundred rupees, he kept it under his mattress. At night while Anil was sleeping, Hari Singh slipped his hand under the ~~his~~ mattress and stole the money. But he could not run far with the money. His conscience pricked him as he did not want to break Anil's trust. He felt guilty and came back home with the money which by then had been damp due to rain. He put the soggy notes back at the place from where he retrieved it. Anil, the next day, on knowing everything didn't react. Even on knowing about this incidence, he accepted Hari with open

SAMPLE PAPER 8

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 8 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) There was a time when the dinner table was the busiest place in an Indian home – not because of the food, but because of the talk. Grandparents recounted stories of their village, parents discussed the day's news, and children competed to describe the funniest thing that had happened at school. Today, in many homes, the same table is strangely quiet. Heads are bowed, not in prayer, but over glowing screens. The clatter of spoons has replaced the clamour of voices.

(2) How did we get here? The answer is not simply 'smartphones', though they are the most visible culprit. Long working hours, coaching classes that end late, and the habit of eating in front of the television have all nibbled away at the shared meal. When family members eat at different times, in different rooms, the dinner table turns into a mere refuelling station. A meal that once lasted an hour now takes fifteen minutes.

(3) Why should this worry us? Conversation is not idle chatter; it is the classroom where children first learn to listen, to wait for their turn and to put their thoughts into words. Researchers who study families have found that children who regularly share meals with their parents tend to have a richer vocabulary and greater confidence in expressing themselves. A screen may answer questions, but it cannot notice that a child looks worried, or gently ask her what is wrong.

(4) Something deeper is lost too. Family stories – how a grandfather walked miles to school, how parents survived their first job – are handed down at the dinner table. These stories give young people a sense of belonging and the courage to face their own difficulties. When the table falls silent, these living histories are quietly buried, and with them a thread that ties the generations together.

(5) None of this means that technology is the enemy. A video call can bring a faraway aunt to the table, and a shared laugh over a funny clip can spark a lively discussion. The problem lies not in the device but in the habit of allowing it to take the place of the people sitting beside us.

(6) The remedy is surprisingly simple. Some families now keep a 'phone basket' near the dining area; others set aside one screen-free dinner every week. A simple question – 'What was the best part of your day?' – can open the door to conversation. After all, the most valuable thing served at a family dinner was never the food. It was each other.

Created for academic usage / 421 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'Heads are bowed, not in prayer, but over glowing screens' convey? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says that the dinner table 'turns into a mere refuelling station', he/she means that _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) meals have become quick, functional acts of eating, with little shared time or conversation.

(b) families now prefer energy-rich food that can be cooked and served quickly.

III According to paragraph 3, which of the following is a skill that children learn through conversation at the dinner table? **1**

A. Operating digital devices responsibly

B. Waiting for their turn to speak

C. Preparing simple meals on their own

D. Memorising facts for examinations

IV In paragraphs 3 and 4, the writer describes what is lost when families stop talking at meals. **2**
What does this reveal about the writer's view of the family dinner?

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 5) **1**
The writer believes that technology itself is the main enemy of family conversation.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
dinner table : refuelling station :: _____ : _____

(a) conversation : classroom

(b) family stories : generations

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) Some families keep a 'phone basket' near the dining area.
(ii) The most valuable thing served at a family dinner is the company of one another.
(iii) Researchers have found that children who regularly share meals with parents tend to have a richer vocabulary.
(iv) The problem lies not in the device but in the habit of using it.
(v) In many homes, family members eat at different times and in different rooms.

A. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F

B. (i) O (ii) O (iii) F (iv) F (v) F

C. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) F

D. (i) F (ii) O (iii) O (iv) O (v) F

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in ending the passage with practical suggestions and the line 'It was each other'? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Electric two-wheelers, once a curiosity on Indian roads, have become a common sight in metros and small towns alike. Industry figures show that annual sales of electric scooters and motorcycles rose

from about 2.5 lakh units in 2021-22 to nearly 11.5 lakh units in 2024-25 – an increase of more than four and a half times in just three years.

(2) A survey of 2,000 first-time buyers found that 58% chose an electric two-wheeler mainly because of its lower running cost. Charging an e-scooter costs about 25 paise per kilometre, compared with roughly ₹2 per kilometre for a petrol scooter. Another 21% said that concern for the environment was their main reason, 13% were drawn by government subsidies, and 8% by modern features such as app connectivity.

(3) However, the road ahead is not entirely smooth. Among people who considered buying an electric two-wheeler but did not, 47% cited the lack of charging points, 32% the high upfront price and 21% worries about battery life and range. An electric scooter typically costs ₹20,000 to ₹30,000 more than a comparable petrol model. Battery fires reported in 2022 led to stricter battery-testing standards.

(4) Experts believe that falling battery prices and a growing network of charging stations will keep the momentum going. Battery-swapping stations, where a rider can exchange a drained battery for a fully charged one in under two minutes, are proving especially popular with delivery riders, who cannot afford to wait for hours while a vehicle charges.

Created for academic usage / 244 words

Year	Electric two-wheelers sold (lakh units)	Share of all two-wheelers sold
2021-22	2.5	1.9%
2022-23	7.3	4.5%
2023-24	9.5	5.4%
2024-25	11.5	6.1%

Table: Sales of electric two-wheelers in India (figures rounded off)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The word ‘curiosity’ as used in paragraph 1 suggests that electric two-wheelers were once _____.
(a rare and unusual sight / a subject of scientific research)

II What does the rise in the share of electric two-wheelers from 1.9% to 6.1% of all two-wheelers sold suggest about Indian buyers? (Table) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Lower running cost is the most common reason why first-time buyers choose electric two-wheelers.
Reason: Charging an e-scooter costs about one-eighth of what it costs to run a petrol scooter for the same distance.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following are mentioned in paragraph 3 EXCEPT —

A. Nearly half of the hesitant buyers were worried about the lack of charging points.
B. About one-third of the hesitant buyers found the upfront price too high.
C. Battery fires reported in 2022 led to stricter battery-testing standards.
D. Most people who bought electric two-wheelers later regretted their decision.

V Compare the share of buyers motivated by concern for the environment with those motivated by lower running cost. What does this suggest about buyer priorities? (Paragraph 2) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 4) **1**
Battery-swapping stations are especially popular with delivery riders because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 1 which indicates that electric two-wheelers are now seen everywhere. **1**

VIII Kabir, a college student, travels about 40 km daily in a city that has several charging points. He is choosing between a petrol scooter and an electric scooter. Based on the passage, which one would you recommend and why? **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Charging Ahead: India's Electric Two-Wheeler Boom' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the circular sent by a school: **1**
Dear Parents,
The Annual Sports Meet, which was postponed due to heavy rain, _____ on 14 November in the school stadium.

A. will now be held B. has held
C. was holding D. is holding

II Report the coach's instruction. **1**
Coach: "Do not skip your warm-up exercises before the match."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the notice at a museum: **1**
Visitors are requested not to carry _____ eatables inside the galleries.

A. some B. any C. much D. few

IV Read Rohan's statement to his mother: **1**
"I have finished my project and I will submit it tomorrow."
Report Rohan's statement by completing the following sentence:
Rohan told his mother that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a school magazine report: **1**
The number of students opting for vocational subjects have risen sharply this year.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given line from the railway safety instructions: **1**
Passengers _____ not lean out of the doors or windows of a moving train.

A. need B. must C. would D. might

VII The given sentence from an official email has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

Neither of the two applicants were selected for the final round of interviews.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	Neither	None
B.	were	was
C.	for	to
D.	final	finally

VIII The librarian asked Meera the following question: **1**
"Have you returned the book you borrowed last week?"
Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.
The librarian asked Meera _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank. **1**
There were only _____ seats left for the evening show, so we booked our tickets at once.

A. a few B. little C. much D. a little

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the following line from a newspaper report. **1**
One of the main reasons for the traffic jams in the old city are the lack of parking space.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the notice by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**
Students who wish to join the educational trip _____ submit the signed consent form by Friday; no student will be allowed without it. (must / may)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a travel blog. **1**
By the time we reached the station, the train _____ (leave) and we had to wait for three hours.

WRITING

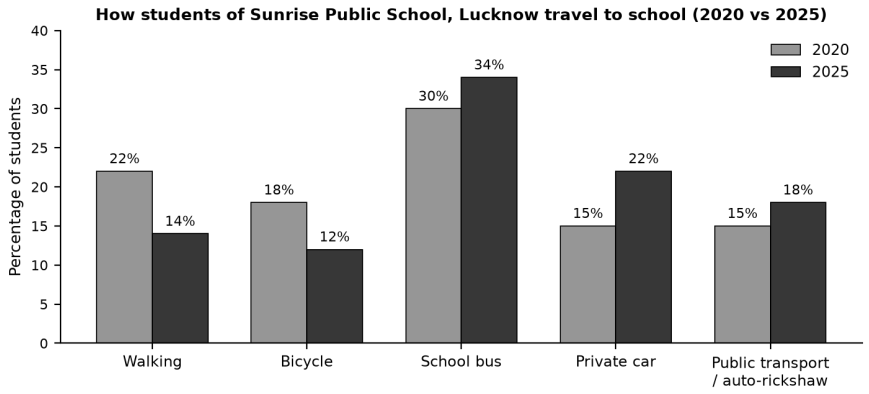
NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Tanvi Kulkarni, a resident of Civil Lines, Nagpur. Every morning and afternoon, the road outside the schools in your area is choked with private cars, vans and auto-rickshaws dropping off and picking up children. Write a letter in about 120 words to the Editor of a local daily, drawing attention to the problem of traffic congestion outside schools at opening and closing hours, its consequences and the measures that the authorities, schools and parents should take. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Arjun Verma, Librarian, Green Valley School, Shimla. You had ordered a set of 40 reference books for the school library from Bookwell Distributors, Chandigarh. On delivery, you found that eight books were damaged, five were of an old edition and the bill had been raised for 45 books. Write a letter in about 120 words to the Sales Manager of Bookwell Distributors complaining about the supply and requesting replacement and a corrected bill. **5**

5 A. The bar graph below shows how the students of Sunrise Public School, Lucknow travelled to school in 2020 and in 2025. **5**



Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, analysing the changes in the modes of transport used by the students, and drawing a suitable conclusion.

OR

5 B. Read the product details of a classroom air purifier mentioned on an e-commerce website. **5**

- Suitable for classrooms of up to 900 sq ft (about 40 students)
- Three-stage filter (pre-filter, HEPA and activated carbon) removes 99.9% of dust, pollen and fine particles (PM2.5)
- Live air-quality display with colour indicator (green / yellow / red)
- Auto mode adjusts fan speed to the level of pollution
- Whisper-quiet night/class mode: 28 decibels, quieter than a whisper
- Uses only 45 watts; one filter lasts about 12 months
- Priced at ₹14,999 with a 3-year warranty

Now, analyse why this air purifier would be a worthwhile purchase for schools, especially in cities with poor winter air quality. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as its health benefits, effectiveness, ease of use, running cost and value for money.

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A.

Poor Kisa Gotami now went from house to house, and the people pitied her and said, “Here is mustard-seed; take it!” But when she asked, “Did a son or daughter, a father or mother, die in your family?” they answered her, “Alas! the living are few, but the dead are many. Do not remind us of our deepest grief.” And there was no house but some beloved one had died in it.

Kisa Gotami became weary and hopeless, and sat down at the wayside watching the lights of the city, as they flickered up and were extinguished again. At last the darkness of the night reigned everywhere. And she considered the fate of men, that their lives flicker up and are extinguished again. And she thought to herself, “How selfish am I in my grief! Death is common to all; yet in this valley of desolation there is a path that leads him to immortality who has surrendered all selfishness.”

(The Sermon at Benares)

I The people's reply, 'Alas! the living are few, but the dead are many', suggests that _____. 1

A. an epidemic had recently struck the city
B. death is a universal experience that has touched every household
C. the people were unwilling to help Kisa Gotami
D. the dead are more important than the living

II Complete the following suitably. 1
Watching the lights of the city that 'flickered up and were extinguished again' helped Kisa Gotami realise that _____.

III How does Kisa Gotami's thought, 'How selfish am I in my grief!' mark a turning point in her understanding of sorrow? 2

IV Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
The phrase 'valley of desolation' describes the world as a place full of _____.

OR

B.

NATALYA: Yes, yes, let that pass. [*aside*] I wish I knew how to get him started. [*aloud*] Are you going to start shooting soon?
LOMOV: I'm thinking of having a go at the blackcock, honoured Natalya Stepanovna, after the harvest. Oh, have you heard? Just think, what a misfortune I've had! My dog Guess, who you know, has gone lame.
NATALYA: What a pity! Why?
LOMOV: I don't know. Must have got his leg twisted or bitten by some other dog. [*sighs*] My very best dog, to say nothing of the expense. I gave Mironov 125 roubles for him.
NATALYA: It was too much, Ivan Vassilevitch.
LOMOV: I think it was very cheap. He's a first-rate dog.
NATALYA: Papa gave 85 roubles for his Squeezer, and Squeezer is heaps better than Guess!
LOMOV: Squeezer better than Guess? What an idea! [*laughs*] Squeezer better than Guess!
(The Proposal)

I What does Natalya's aside, 'I wish I knew how to get him started' reveal? 1

A. She wants Lomov to begin his proposal of marriage.
B. She wants Lomov to leave for the hunt at once.
C. She wants to restart the quarrel about Oxen Meadows.
D. She wants Lomov to sell his dog Guess to her father.

II Complete the following suitably. 1
Lomov considers the price of 125 roubles for Guess 'very cheap' because _____.

III The Oxen Meadows dispute has just been settled, yet a fresh argument begins. What does this reveal about the characters of Lomov and Natalya? 2

IV Fill in the blank with the correct option from the bracket. 1
Lomov's repetition of 'Squeezer better than Guess!' with a laugh shows his _____. (scornful disbelief / polite agreement)

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A.

All night the roots work
to disengage themselves from the cracks
in the veranda floor.
The leaves strain toward the glass

small twigs stiff with exertion
long-cramped boughs shuffling under the roof
like newly discharged patients
half-dazed, moving
to the clinic doors.

(The Trees)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The roots that 'work to disengage themselves from the cracks in the veranda floor' show the trees' _____.

II Choose the correct option. **1**
The comparison of the boughs to 'newly discharged patients' is an example of _____.

A. metaphor B. simile C. alliteration D. hyperbole

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The expression 'long-cramped boughs' suggests that the branches had been kept in a/an _____ space for a long time.

IV How does the image of patients, 'half-dazed, moving to the clinic doors' convey the condition of the trees as they begin to move out? **2**

OR

B.

The fog comes
on little cat feet.
It sits looking
over harbour and city
on silent haunches
and then moves on.

(Fog)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The phrase 'on little cat feet' suggests that the fog arrives _____.

II Choose the correct option. **1**
In the poem, the poet compares the fog to a cat without using 'like' or 'as', throughout the poem. This device is called _____.

A. simile B. extended metaphor
C. alliteration D. onomatopoeia

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The words 'and then moves on' suggest that the fog's stay is _____.

IV How do the words 'sits looking over harbour and city on silent haunches' create the picture of a watchful cat? **2**

8. Answer any FOUR of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3 =12**

I In his second letter, Lencho asks God not to send the money through the mail because the post office employees are 'a bunch of crooks'. Comment on the irony in this request. **3**
(A Letter to God)

II 'Courage was not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it.' How does Mandela arrive at this understanding of courage? **3**
(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

III How did the young seagull's mother finally make him fly? What does this reveal about her? (Two Stories about Flying – His First Flight) **3**

IV Contrast the tiger's life in the zoo with the life the poet says it should be living in the wild. (A Tiger in the Zoo) **3**

V Why does Amanda imagine herself as a mermaid, an orphan and Rapunzel? What do these fantasies have in common? (Amanda!) **3**

9. Answer any TWO of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3 =6**

I Think-Tank insists on being hailed as the 'most powerful and intelligent creature in the whole universe'. How does his handling of the 'sandwich' prove the opposite? (The Book That Saved the Earth) **3**

II Mrs Pumphrey loves Tricki dearly, yet her love nearly kills him. Explain how this is so. (A Triumph of Surgery) **3**

III "He knew. But neither his lips nor his eyes showed anything." What did Anil know, and what does his silence tell us about him? (The Thief's Story) **3**

10. Answer any ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. In 'From the Diary of Anne Frank', Anne turns Mr Keesing's punishment into an opportunity. Discuss how her wit and creativity change the relationship between the teacher and the student.

OR

B. In 'A Baker from Goa' (Glimpses of India), the baker is much more than a seller of bread. Discuss how the writer uses the figure of the baker to celebrate Goan traditions and to express nostalgia for the past.

11. Answer any ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. 'Ausable did not fit any description of a secret agent Fowler had ever read.' Write a character sketch of Ausable, showing how his presence of mind proves a greater weapon than Max's gun. (The Midnight Visitor)

OR

B. Horace Danby, a careful planner, is caught because he trusts the wrong person. Discuss how the story illustrates the saying 'honour among thieves' and why Horace now hates hearing it. (A Question of Trust)

***

SAMPLE PAPER 8

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

MARKING SCHEME · SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 8 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. MARKING SCHEME **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. The Marking Scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers / sample answers. The value points are in the nature of guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. The students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, then due marks should be awarded accordingly.
2. If a student has attempted an extra question, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note "Extra Question".
3. If more than one option is mentioned in the answer of multiple choice questions, then no marks are to be awarded.

SECTION A: READING SKILLS — 20 marks

Discursive Passage

1. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I It conveys that family members are absorbed in their phones/devices at the dinner table instead of talking to one another; the comparison with prayer ironically suggests a silent, almost devoted attention to screens. **1**

II (a) meals have become quick, functional acts of eating, with little shared time or conversation. **1**

III B. Waiting for their turn to speak **1**

IV The writer sees the family dinner as far more than a meal. It is a place of learning, where children learn to listen and express themselves (½) and where parents notice a child's worries (½). It is also a link between generations, through which family stories pass on a sense of belonging and courage (½). Hence the writer regards it as precious and worth protecting (½). **2**

V False **1**

VI (a) conversation : classroom
[In paragraph 2 the dinner table is metaphorically called a 'refuelling station'; in paragraph 3 conversation is metaphorically called a 'classroom'. The relationship (a thing : the metaphor used for it) is maintained only in (a).] **1**

VII C. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) F **1**

VIII The writer wants to end on a positive, hopeful note by showing that the problem can be solved easily (½), offering practical, doable steps such as a phone basket or a weekly screen-free dinner (½). The final line, 'It was each other', leaves a lasting emotional impact (½) and persuades readers to value togetherness over food and gadgets, encouraging them to act (½). **2**

Case-Based Passage

2. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I a rare and unusual sight **1**

II Indian buyers are increasingly accepting electric two-wheelers as a practical choice / the preference for electric vehicles is growing steadily, though they are still a small part of the market. **1**

III A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
[25 paise against about ₹2 per km is roughly one-eighth; this saving explains why 58% chose lower running cost as the main reason.] **1**

IV D. Most people who bought electric two-wheelers later regretted their decision. **1**

V	Only 21% of buyers were motivated mainly by concern for the environment, while 58%, nearly three times as many, chose them for the lower running cost (1). This suggests that most buyers are guided by practical, economic benefits/savings rather than environmental idealism; the green benefit is a welcome bonus rather than the main reason (1).	**2**
VI	they can exchange a drained battery for a fully charged one in under two minutes and do not lose working time waiting for the vehicle to charge.	**1**
VII	a common sight	**1**
VIII	Any one, with a reason: An electric scooter, because he travels a long distance daily, so the saving in running cost (25 paise vs ₹2 per km) would be large, and the several charging points in his city remove the main worry about charging.	**1**
IX	Any one – The phrase 'Charging Ahead' suggests both the electric charging of vehicles and the rapid growth of the market, which the passage describes. – The word 'Boom' reflects the sharp rise in sales from 2.5 lakh to 11.5 lakh units shown in the passage and the table.	**1**

SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR (10 marks)

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

Answer

1 mark for each correct answer (any ten: 10 x 1 = 10)

I	A. will now be held	**1**
II	The coach instructed/told/advised the players not to skip their warm-up exercises before the match.	**1**
III	B. any	**1**
IV	he had finished his project and (that) he would submit it the next day/the following day.	**1**
V	Error: have Correction: has	**1**
VI	B. must	**1**
VII	B. were – was	**1**
VIII	if/whether she had returned the book she had borrowed the previous week/the week before.	**1**
IX	A. a few	**1**
X	Error: are Correction: is	**1**
XI	must	**1**
XII	had left	**1**

WRITING SKILLS (10 marks)

4. **Format – 1 Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 1 Accuracy – 1** **1x5 =5**

Answer

Criterion	Marks
Format: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, complimentary close, name/signature	1
Content: relevant value points covering the issue, its effects and the suggested steps	2
Organisation of ideas: logical sequence, paragraphing, coherence and formal tone	1
Accuracy: grammar, spelling and punctuation	1

Marks: Format (1) + Content (2) + Organisation of ideas (1) + Accuracy (1) = 5

A.

Answer

(The response may be created from the following content points)

– **Issue:** severe traffic congestion outside schools at opening and closing hours; private cars, vans and autos stop and park haphazardly on the road
– **Consequences:** long jams; ambulances and office-goers delayed; children put at risk while crossing; noise, fumes and frayed tempers; students reach late
– **Measures by authorities:** traffic police at school gates during peak hours; no-parking and drop-off zones; zebra crossings and speed breakers
– **Measures by schools and parents:** staggered timings for different classes; encourage school buses and car-pooling; parents to park at a distance and walk children to the gate

– **Appeal** to the editor to publish the letter so that the authorities act promptly

Answer

Model answer (4 A):

12, Civil Lines
Nagpur
30 October 20XX

The Editor
The Nagpur Times
Nagpur

Subject: Traffic congestion outside schools

Sir/Madam
Through your esteemed daily, I wish to draw attention to the daily traffic chaos outside schools in Civil Lines at opening and closing hours.
Private cars, vans and auto-rickshaws stop in the middle of the road and park haphazardly. As a result, long jams form, ambulances and office-goers are held up, and young children are put at serious risk while crossing.
Traffic police should be posted at school gates during peak hours, and proper drop-off zones and zebra crossings created. Schools could stagger their timings and promote school buses and car-pooling, while parents should park at a distance and walk their children to the gate.
I hope the authorities will act before an accident occurs.

Yours faithfully
Tanvi Kulkarni

OR

B.

Answer

The response may be created from the following value points:
– **Reference:** order for 40 reference books (order number and date) placed with Bookwell Distributors
– **Complaint:** eight books damaged (torn covers, loose pages); five books of an old edition instead of the latest; bill raised for 45 books instead of 40
– **Inconvenience:** students and teachers cannot use the books; library records cannot be completed
– **Request:** replace the damaged and old-edition books within a fixed time (e.g. a week); send a corrected bill for 40 books; arrange collection of defective books at the firm's cost
– **Close:** hope for prompt action; future orders depend on it

5. **Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 2 Accuracy – 1** **1x5 =5**

Answer

Criterion	Marks
Content: correct interpretation of the data/cues, key trends and comparisons, a suitable conclusion	2
Organisation of ideas: introduction, logical sequence, linkers, conclusion; coherence	2
Accuracy: grammar, spelling and punctuation	1

Marks: Content (2) + Organisation of ideas (2) + Accuracy (1) = 5

Analytical paragraph writing should NOT be confused with writing a description of given elements or writing a summary. It requires examining the given elements closely and sharing inputs based on the given stimulus. It carries no title or heading.

A.

Answer

Suggested response: The bar graph compares the modes of transport used by the students of Sunrise Public School, Lucknow in 2020 and 2025. The most striking change is the decline in active travel. The share of students who walked fell from 22% to 14%, while cycling dropped from 18% to 12%. In contrast, travel by private car rose sharply from 15% to 22%. The school bus remained the most popular mode, growing from 30% to 34%, and public transport or auto-rickshaws also increased from 15% to 18%. Overall, motorised transport grew from 60% to 74% of all students. It may be concluded that students are relying more on vehicles, which raises concerns about traffic congestion near the school and reduced physical activity among students.

OR

B.

Answer

Suggested response: The classroom air purifier is a worthwhile purchase for schools, especially in cities where winter air quality is poor. Its three-stage filter removes 99.9% of dust, pollen and fine PM2.5 particles, protecting students from coughs, allergies and breathing problems. Designed for rooms of up to 900 sq ft, it can serve a full class of about forty students. Moreover, the live air-quality display and auto mode make it easy to use, while the whisper-quiet 28-decibel mode ensures that lessons are not disturbed. Since it

consumes only 45 watts and one filter lasts about a year, its running cost is low. Although it is priced at ₹14,999, the three-year warranty and the gain in students' health make it excellent value for money.

SECTION C: LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

Answer

A. Prose (The Sermon at Benares)

Answer

I	B. death is a universal experience that has touched every household	**1**
II	human lives are like those lights – they begin and end/are short-lived; death is the fate of all mortals.	**1**
III	Until then Kisa Gotami thought only of her own loss and hoped that her son could be brought back to life (½). Seeing that every house had lost a loved one, she realised that death is common to all (½). She recognised that her grief had made her selfish (½), and moved from personal sorrow to acceptance, beginning the path to peace and enlightenment that the Buddha intended (½).	**2**
IV	sorrow/grief/suffering	**1**

OR

B. Drama (The Proposal)

Answer

I	A. She wants Lomov to begin his proposal of marriage.	**1**
II	he believes Guess is a first-rate dog/his very best dog.	**1**
III	Both are quarrelsome, stubborn and proud (½); neither can bear to accept the other's point of view, even on trivial matters (½). Natalya, though eager for the proposal, cannot resist boasting about her father's dog, and Lomov, though anxious to propose, cannot let the remark pass (½). Their pride and argumentative nature make the proposal itself a comic struggle (½).	**2**
IV	scornful disbelief	**1**

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

Answer

A. Poetry (The Trees)

Answer

I	struggle/great effort to free themselves from confinement (their longing for freedom)	**1**
II	B. simile	**1**
III	confined/narrow/restricted	**1**
IV	Like patients who have just been discharged after a long illness, the trees are weak, unsteady and confused after long captivity inside the house (1). Yet, like the patients, they move determinedly towards freedom and a return to their natural life, the forest (1).	**2**

OR

B. Poetry (Fog)

Answer

I	silently/quietly and stealthily, unnoticed	**1**
II	B. extended metaphor	**1**
III	temporary/brief/short	**1**
IV	A cat often sits on its haunches, quietly gazing at its surroundings before moving away (1). In the same way the fog spreads over the harbour and the city, seems to settle and observe everything silently, and then drifts away; the poet thus gives the fog the calm, watchful, independent nature of a cat (1).	**2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3**

Answer *Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall* **=12**

I – Postmaster and employees collected the money out of kindness to keep Lencho's faith alive **(½)** **3**
– Lencho, receiving seventy pesos, believed God could not err, so suspected them of stealing **(½)**
– The very people who helped him are called crooks – situational irony **(1)**

Model answer: The irony is that the post office employees, who had kindly collected seventy pesos from their own salaries to keep Lencho's faith alive, are the very people he calls 'a bunch of crooks'. His blind faith in God makes him certain that God cannot err, so he suspects his benefactors of theft.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

II – Saw the courage of comrades who suffered and sacrificed for their beliefs **(½)** **3**
– Admits he felt fear more times than he can remember but hid it behind a mask of boldness **(½)**
– Learnt that the brave man is not he who does not feel afraid but he who conquers that fear **(1)**

Model answer: Mandela saw countless comrades risk and give their lives for the struggle against apartheid. He admits that he himself felt fear more times than he could remember, but hid it behind a mask of boldness. From them he learnt that a brave man is not one who feels no fear, but one who conquers it.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

III – Mother brought a piece of fish in her beak and hovered just below the ledge, out of his reach **(½)** **3**
– Maddened by hunger, he dived at the fish, fell outwards, then spread his wings and flew **(½)**
– Shows a wise, patient and caring mother who uses 'tough love' **(1)**

Model answer: The mother seagull flew towards him with a piece of fish in her beak and halted just below the ledge, out of his reach. Maddened by hunger, he dived at the food, fell outwards and, in fear, spread his wings and flew. She is wise and loving, using hunger to overcome his fear.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

IV – Zoo: stalks the few steps of his concrete cell in quiet rage; ignores visitors; at night stares at the stars **(½)** **3**
– Wild: should be lurking in shadow, sliding through long grass near the water hole where plump deer pass **(½)**
– Should be snarling around houses at the jungle's edge, terrorising the village **(1)**

Model answer: In the zoo, the tiger stalks the few steps of his concrete cell in quiet rage, ignores visitors and, at night, helplessly stares at the brilliant stars. In the wild, he should be lurking in shadow near the water hole, hunting plump deer, and snarling around village houses, showing his fangs and claws freely.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

V – Amanda is constantly nagged and corrected by her parent **(½)** **3**
– Escapes into fantasy: a mermaid drifting blissfully in a languid emerald sea; an orphan roaming freely; Rapunzel in a tranquil tower who would never let down her hair **(½)**
– Common thread: solitude, freedom and peace away from instructions **(1)**

Model answer: Amanda is tired of being constantly nagged and corrected. So she escapes into fantasy: a mermaid drifting alone in a calm sea, an orphan roaming freely in golden silence, and Rapunzel living peacefully in a tower. All three fantasies share a longing for freedom, solitude and peace, away from adult control.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3**
Answer *Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall* **=6**

I – Insists on being hailed as the 'most powerful and intelligent creature in the whole universe'; insists 'Think-Tank is never wrong' **(½)** **3**
– Declares the books found in the library to be sandwiches, the main staple of Earth diet; Oop is made to eat one and finds it dry **(½)**
– When Noodle says Earthlings did not eat them, he twists it into 'communication sandwiches' – never admits a mistake; shows foolish arrogance **(1)**

Model answer: Think-Tank insists on being hailed as the most intelligent creature in the universe, yet he declares the library books to be sandwiches, Earth's staple food, and has Oop eat one. When Noodle says Earthlings never ate them, he calls them 'communication sandwiches', proving himself a conceited fool.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

II 3

– Mrs Pumphrey pampers Tricki: overfeeds him with cream cakes, chocolates and other rich food between meals **(½)**
– Ignores Herriot's advice; gives him no exercise; he becomes grossly fat, lethargic, refuses food and starts vomiting **(½)**
– Her blind, misguided love makes him seriously ill; he recovers only when Herriot keeps him at the surgery on a strict diet with exercise **(1)**

Model answer: Mrs Pumphrey loves Tricki so blindly that she stuffs him with cream cakes and chocolates and denies him exercise, ignoring Herriot's advice. Tricki grows grossly fat and lethargic and starts vomiting. He recovers only when Herriot keeps him at the surgery on a strict diet with plenty of exercise.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

III 3

– Anil knew that Hari had stolen his 600 rupees during the night and later put the money back **(½)**
– The fifty-rupee note he gave Hari next morning was still wet from the night's rain – the money had been out in the rain **(½)**
– His silence shows a kind, forgiving and trusting nature; instead of punishing Hari, he offers regular pay and lessons in writing whole sentences, giving him a chance to reform **(1)**

Model answer: Anil knew that Hari had stolen his money and quietly returned it, for the fifty-rupee note he gave Hari was still wet from the rain. Yet he neither accused nor punished him. Instead, he promised regular pay and lessons in writing sentences, showing kindness, forgiveness and faith in Hari.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

10. 6

Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words.

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A.

Answer

– Mr Keesing, the maths teacher, was annoyed with Anne for talking too much in class and assigned her extra homework **(½)**
– Essay 1 'A Chatterbox': argued that talking is a student's trait and inherited from her mother **(½)**
– Essay 2 'An Incorrigible Chatterbox'; essay 3 'Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox' – a poem, written with Sanne's help, about a mother duck, a father swan and three ducklings bitten to death for chattering **(½)**
– Mr Keesing took the joke the right way, read the poem aloud to the class, and allowed Anne to talk; never assigned extra homework again **(½)**
– Shows Anne's wit, creativity, confidence and maturity; turns conflict into understanding **(1)**

Model answer: Mr Keesing, the old maths teacher, was annoyed with Anne for talking in class and punished her with extra homework. Instead of sulking, Anne used her wit. In her essay 'A Chatterbox' she cleverly argued that talking was a student's trait and that she had inherited it from her mother. When he set 'An Incorrigible Chatterbox' and later 'Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox', she replied, with her friend Sanne's help, with a humorous poem about a father swan who bit his chattering ducklings to death. Mr Keesing took the joke in the right spirit, read the poem aloud and allowed her to talk. Anne's creativity thus turned punishment into mutual respect.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B.

Answer

– Elders reminisce about the Portuguese days and their famous loaves; the eternal furnaces and the bakers (paders) still exist **(½)**
– The jingling thud of the bamboo staff announced his arrival; children ran to meet him for bread-bangles **(½)**
– Bread central to Goan life: bol as marriage gift, cakes and bolinhas at Christmas, sandwiches at a daughter's engagement **(½)**
– Kabai, a single-piece long frock reaching the knees; monthly accounts recorded on a wall in pencil **(½)**
– Baking was profitable – the baker's plump physique; nostalgic, affectionate tone **(1)**

Model answer: In 'A Baker from Goa', Lucio Rodrigues uses the baker, or pader, to celebrate a living tradition. Though the Portuguese have left, the mixers, moulders and their eternal furnaces still exist in Goa. The writer fondly recalls the jingling thud of the baker's bamboo, which woke the children who ran to meet him for bread-bangles. Bread is woven into every celebration: the bol is a must as a marriage gift, cakes and bolinhas at Christmas, and sandwiches at a daughter's engagement. Even the baker's kabai and the pencil accounts on the wall belong to a cherished past. Through this affectionate, nostalgic portrait, the baker becomes a symbol of Goan culture and continuity.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A.

Answer

– Ausable: fat, sloppy, speaks with an American accent; does not look like a secret agent; disappoints Fowler, who expected romance and adventure **(½)**
– Calm and composed when Max appears with a pistol; shows no fear, only irritation **(½)**
– Presence of mind: invents a convincing story of a balcony under his window through which intruders get in, and says the knock at the door is the police he had called for protection **(½)**
– Max, panicking, climbs out of the window to hide on the 'balcony' and falls, since there is no balcony; the knock was only Henry the waiter **(½)**
– Message: quick wit, intelligence and composure can defeat brute force; appearances can be deceptive **(1)**

Model answer: Ausable, a fat, sloppy secret agent with an American accent, disappoints the young writer Fowler, who expected mystery and romance. Yet he proves far more dangerous than he looks. When Max, a rival agent, appears in his room with a pistol to steal a report on new missiles, Ausable stays perfectly calm. He grumbles that intruders keep entering through the balcony below his window. When someone knocks, he claims it is the police he had asked for protection. Panicking, Max climbs out of the window to hide on the balcony and falls, because there is no balcony. The knock was only Henry, the waiter. Ausable wins with presence of mind, not a gun, showing that a sharp brain is the best weapon.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B.

Answer

– Horace Danby: about fifty, locksmith, thought to be an honest citizen; robs one safe a year to buy rare books; plans every robbery carefully and wears gloves to avoid fingerprints **(½)**
– At Shotover Grange, a young lady in red catches him; claims to be the owner's wife and asks him to open the safe for her jewels **(½)**
– Afraid of prison and eager to please, he takes off his gloves to light her cigarette and opens the safe with bare hands **(½)**
– She was actually a thief herself; she takes the jewels; Horace is arrested because his fingerprints are all over the room; no one believes his story **(½)**
– Irony: a thief was tricked by another thief – there was no 'honour among thieves'; so he gets angry whenever anyone talks about it; now assistant librarian in the prison **(1)**

Model answer: Horace Danby, a respectable locksmith of about fifty, secretly robbed one safe a year to buy rare books. He planned every job carefully and always wore gloves. At Shotover Grange, however, a charming young lady in red caught him and claimed to be the owner's wife. Afraid of prison, Horace agreed to open the safe for her jewels and even took off his gloves to light her cigarette. She vanished with the jewels, and Horace was arrested because his fingerprints were everywhere. The real lady of the house, a grey-haired woman of sixty, called his story nonsense. Horace had trusted a fellow thief, but she betrayed him. That is why he, now the prison's assistant librarian, hates hearing about 'honour among thieves'.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

Marks Summary

Section	Questions	Marks
Section A: Reading Skills	Q1 – Q2	20
Section B: Writing Skills & Grammar	Q3 – Q5	20
Section C: Literature Textbook	Q6 – Q11	40
Total		**80**

***

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · similar to Q4 (A) (letter to the Editor) answer book p.18

4. A. C-63
Canvel
Mumbai - 400012

27 February 2023

The Editor
The Times Of India
24 Beach Road
Mumbai - 400005

Subject :- Pitiable condition of child labourers

Dear Sir / Madam

This is to bring to your notice, a pressing issue in today's society, ~~~~ about which I recently came across in a magazine article.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · letter to the Editor (contd.) answer book p.19

The article described the hazardous conditions that underage children are subjected to. Most of them belong to families living below the poverty line. Hence, school education is a distant dream for them. To supplement their family incomes, they are ~~~~ coerced to work in dimly lit factories, tea stalls and in garages. To my absolute shock, the children in factories must work with sharp tools, capable of injuring them. Accompanying the article was a photograph of a young boy employed in a tea stall. The pain in his eyes was heart-wrenching. To make matters worse, most of them are ill-treated by their employers. The youth make up a large part of our nation's population. Children are our future, and if we do not protect them, who will?

As vigilant citizens, it is our responsibility to eradicate this menace. Boycott of enterprises ~~~~ utilising child labour will force them to shut down. Providing low-

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · similar to Q5 (A) (letter ends; analytical paragraph on a data table begins) answer book p.20

cost education to these children will go a long way. Government agencies must take a more pro-active approach through surprise checks and hefty penalties. I hope fervently that this national problem is brought to the notice of the authorities concerned through the columns of your esteemed newspaper and the necessary measures are taken.

Yours truly
~~Jyoti~~
(Anjali)

5. A

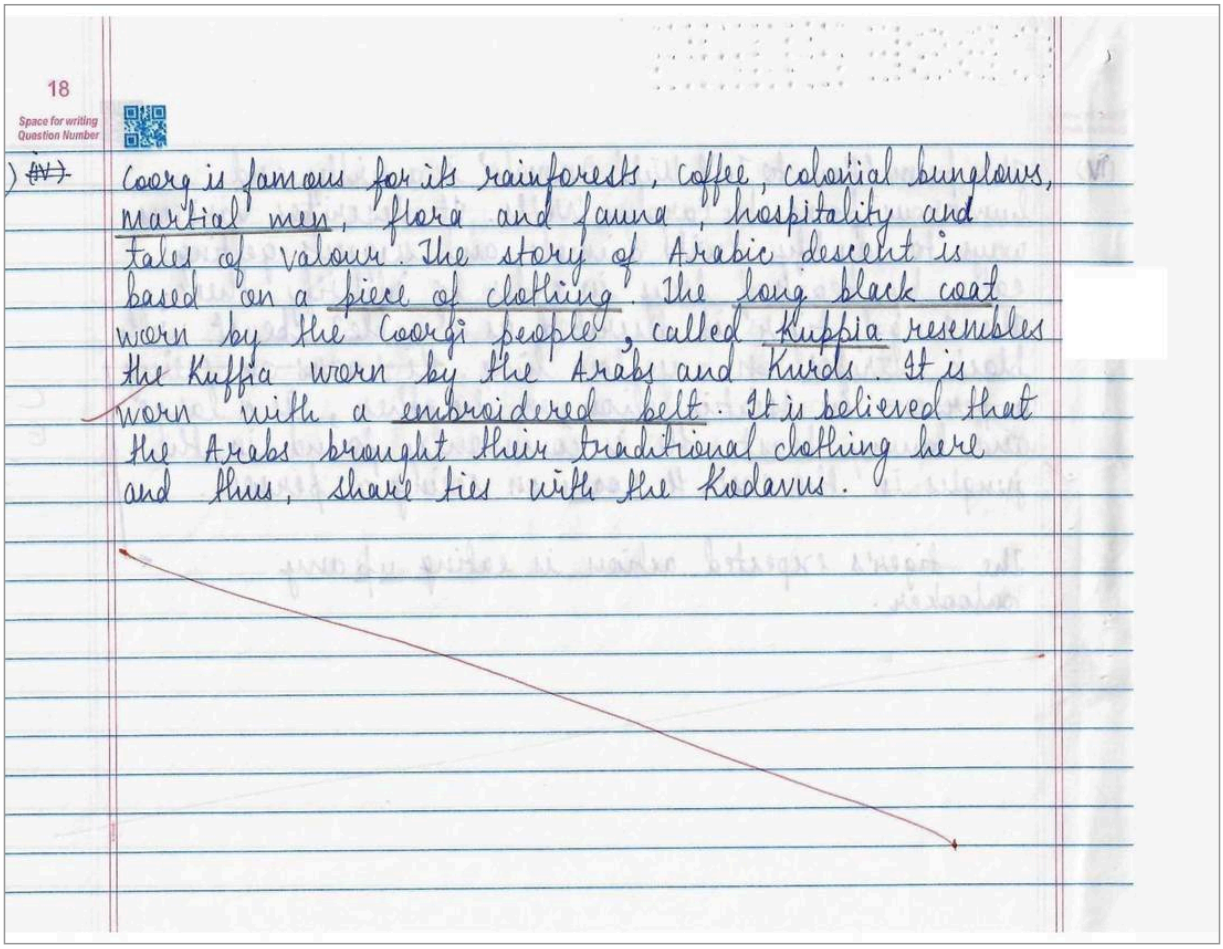
The Issue Of Air Pollution

The given table provides the pollution figures of some major Indian towns and cities. The data includes ~~the~~ three major air pollutants namely, suspended particulate matter, sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides, their

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · analytical paragraph (contd.) answer book p.21

permissible levels and their levels in Ludhiana, Delhi, Mumbai and Chennai. The levels of suspended particulate matter in all four cities (453 in Ludhiana, 680 in Delhi, 435 in Mumbai and 262 in Chennai) far exceed the permissible level of 200. The abnormal levels of particulate matter may be attributed to the smoke and dust released by vehicles in these well-developed cities, apart from burning of agricultural produce in Delhi and Ludhiana. The permissible levels of both sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide are 80. The high proportions of sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide in Delhi (124 and 137 respectively) are alarming. However, in the other cities, these are fortunately well within the limit. The sulphur dioxide levels are lowest in Ludhiana at 20, followed by Mumbai at 27 and then Chennai at 45. The levels of nitrogen oxide follow the opposite trend with Chennai at 34 and then Mumbai at 53 and Ludhiana at 64. It is evident that air pollution is a major issue affecting big towns and cities in

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q10 (B) (Glimpses of India) answer book p.18

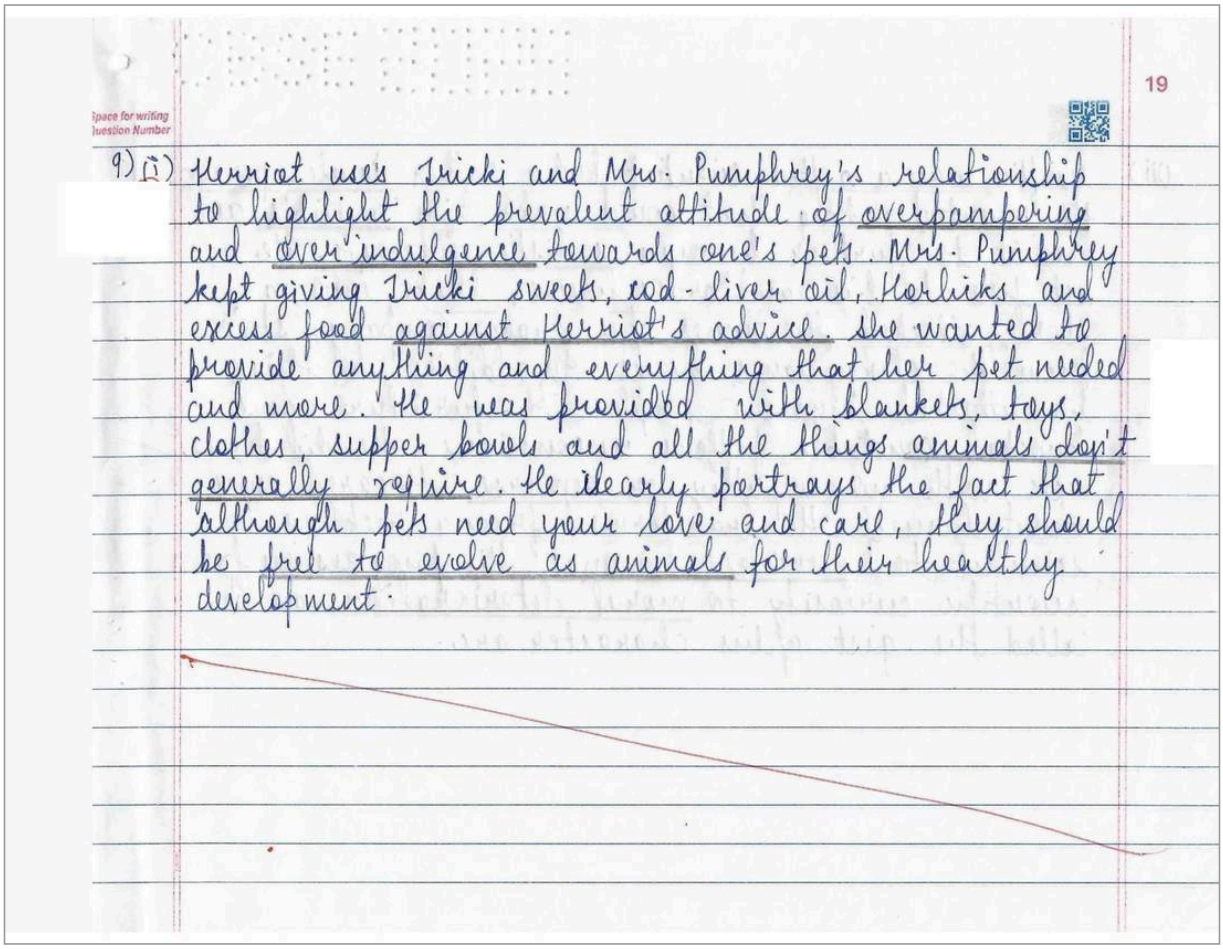


18

Space for writing Question Number

) ~~(iv)~~ Coorg is famous for its rainforests, coffee, colonial bunglows, martial men, flora and fauna, hospitality and tales of valour. The story of Arabic descent is based on a piece of clothing. The long black coat worn by the Coorgi people, called Kuppia resembles the Kuffia worn by the Arabs and Kurds. It is worn with a embroidered belt. It is believed that the Arabs brought their traditional clothing here and thus, share ties with the Kodavus.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q9 (II) (A Triumph of Surgery) answer book p.19



19

Space for writing Question Number

9) (ii) Herriot uses Tricki and Mrs. Pumphrey's relationship to highlight the prevalent attitude of overpampering and over indulgence towards one's pets. Mrs. Pumphrey kept giving Tricki sweets, cod-liver oil, Horlicks and excess food against Herriot's advice. She wanted to provide anything and everything that her pet needed and more. He was provided with blankets, toys, clothes, supper bowls and all the things animals don't generally require. He clearly portrays the fact that although pets need your love and care, they should be free to evolve as animals for their healthy development.

SAMPLE PAPER 9

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 9 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Ask a group of students what education is for, and most will mention marks, entrance tests and careers. Few will mention the elderly neighbour who cannot read her electricity bill, or the park at the end of the street that has quietly become a dumping ground. Yet these, too, are classrooms of a kind. A growing number of schools now believe that learning which never leaves the four walls of a building is, at best, half-finished.

(2) Volunteering, when it is built into the school day rather than squeezed into a holiday, changes what students notice. A Class 9 student who spends two afternoons a month teaching younger children at a community centre soon discovers that explaining fractions is harder than solving them. She learns patience, she learns to listen, and she learns that knowledge grows when it is shared. No textbook chapter can teach these lessons as convincingly as a restless eight-year-old can.

(3) Critics argue that students are already overburdened, and that community service steals precious time from preparation for board examinations. The concern is understandable, but it rests on a narrow view of preparation. Studies of service-learning* programmes in several countries suggest that students who volunteer regularly tend to show better attendance, stronger communication skills and greater confidence in group work. These are not distractions from academic success; they are often its foundation.

(4) There is also the question of empathy. It is one thing to read about water scarcity in a geography lesson; it is quite another to stand in a queue with families who wait an hour each morning for a water tanker. Such experiences turn abstract facts into human stories. Students who have seen a problem up close are far less likely to dismiss it as someone else's business.

(5) However, volunteering works only when it is genuine. A certificate collected for a single afternoon of taking photographs at an old-age home teaches little except how to look busy. Schools that succeed treat service as a sustained commitment, with clear goals, guidance from teachers and time for students to reflect on what they did and why it mattered.

(6) Perhaps the strongest case for community service is that it answers a question that marks cannot: what kind of person is this student becoming? A society needs skilled engineers, doctors and accountants, but it also needs citizens who notice when something is wrong and feel responsible for putting it right. Education that nurtures both is not a luxury. It is the only kind worth having.

*service-learning: a method of teaching that combines classroom learning with meaningful service to the community

Created for academic usage / 416 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the writer mean by calling the elderly neighbour and the neglected park 'classrooms of a kind'? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**

When the writer says, 'No textbook chapter can teach these lessons as convincingly as a restless eight-year-old can', he suggests that _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) real experience of teaching and dealing with young learners teaches patience and listening more effectively than reading about them.

(b) young children know more than textbooks do, and should therefore help in designing school lessons.

III The writer says that volunteering should be 'built into the school day rather than squeezed into a holiday'. (paragraph 2) **1**

Which of the following is an example of this?

A. A student collects old clothes for a donation drive once during the summer vacation.

B. A school sets aside one period every week for students to run a reading club in a nearby settlement.

C. A student helps at a city marathon on a Sunday to earn a participation certificate.

D. A family donates money to a charitable trust on a child's birthday.

IV In paragraph 3, how does the writer respond to the critics who feel that community service takes time away from board examination preparation? What does this reveal about the writer's idea of 'preparation'? **2**

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 5) **1**

According to the writer, any act of volunteering, even a single afternoon of taking photographs at an old-age home, helps to build a student's character.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**

a single afternoon of photographs : looking busy :: _____ : _____

(a) sustained commitment : genuine learning

(b) teachers' guidance : extra certificates

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**

(i) A growing number of schools now include community service in their programmes.
(ii) Learning that never leaves the school building is, at best, half-finished.
(iii) Studies suggest that students who volunteer regularly tend to show better attendance.
(iv) Education that nurtures character is the only kind worth having.
(v) Some families wait an hour each morning for a water tanker.

A. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) F
B. (i) O (ii) O (iii) F (iv) F (v) O
C. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F
D. (i) F (ii) O (iii) O (iv) O (v) F

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in presenting the critics' point of view in paragraph 3 before giving his own? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) In July 2026, a city-based environmental group surveyed the canteens of 60 schools, 36 private and 24 government, to find out how much single-use plastic reaches students along with their snacks. Over four weeks, volunteers recorded the packaging of every item sold and interviewed 1,800 students and 120 canteen staff. The aim was not to blame canteen owners but to identify practical alternatives that schools could adopt.

(2) The findings were sobering. On an average school day, the 60 canteens together handed out about 21,000 plastic items, roughly 350 per canteen. Only 9 canteens offered drinking water from a dispenser; the rest sold it in plastic bottles. Most of these items were used for less than ten minutes before being thrown away.

Single-use plastic items handed out per canteen on an average school day

Item	Average number	Share of total
Snack wrappers	140	40%
Straws	70	20%
Carry bags	52	15%
Water bottles	49	14%
Cups and cutlery	39	11%
Total	**350**	**100%**

(3) Students' attitudes offered some hope. As many as 72% said they would carry their own steel bottle if refilling stations were installed, and 64% were willing to pay two or three rupees more for snacks in paper or leaf packaging. However, only 18% said they always put wrappers into dry-waste bins, and canteen staff pointed out that such bins were often missing or overflowing.

(4) The schools that had already acted showed what is possible. In the 9 canteens with water dispensers and steel tumblers, daily plastic use was nearly a third lower than the average. The report recommends a phased ban on straws and carry bags, refilling stations in every school, and student 'green monitors' to check that waste is segregated.

Created for academic usage / 242 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**

The word 'sobering' as used in paragraph 2 suggests that the findings were _____.
(serious and worrying / pleasant and encouraging)

II Why do you think the volunteers interviewed the canteen staff as well as the students? (Paragraph 1) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**

Assertion: Snack wrappers make up the largest share of single-use plastic handed out in school canteens.
Reason: Only 9 of the 60 canteens offered drinking water from a dispenser.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.
B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.
C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**

All of the following are stated in the passage EXCEPT—

A. The survey covered more private schools than government schools.
B. Straws account for one-fifth of the plastic items handed out.
C. Most students always put their wrappers into dry-waste bins.
D. Canteens with water dispensers used less plastic than the average.

V Compare the students' willingness to change their habits with their actual waste-disposal behaviour. What does this suggest? (Paragraph 3) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 3) **1**

The canteen staff's remark suggests that students do not segregate waste partly because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 4 which indicates that the ban would be introduced gradually rather than all at once. **1**

VIII The principal of a school whose canteen sells water only in plastic bottles wants to reduce plastic use quickly. Based on the survey, suggest one step she could take. **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Wrapped in Plastic: What School Canteens Serve' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of a formal email: **1**

Dear Parents,
We regret to inform you that the Annual Sports Meet, which was scheduled for 14 November, _____ because of the heavy rain forecast for that week.

A. has been postponed B. had postponed C. is postponing D. was postponing

II Report the coach's instruction to the players. **1**

Coach: "Do not leave the ground without informing me."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the circular: **1**

Circular for Classes IX and X
_____ student must submit the consent form, duly signed by a parent, by Monday.

A. All B. Each C. Many D. Several

IV Read Arjun's statement to the school librarian: **1**

"I have returned the book that I borrowed last week."

Report Arjun's statement by completing the following sentence:
Arjun told the librarian that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a hostel inspection report: **1**

The quality of the mangoes supplied to the hostel mess have declined this season.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from a notice displayed at a metro station: **1**

Passengers _____ not carry inflammable material inside the metro coaches.

A. need B. must C. would D. might

VII The given sentence from a student's diary has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

Meera has visited the science exhibition with her cousins yesterday.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	has visited	visited
B.	the	a
C.	with	by
D.	yesterday	today

VIII Mrs Rao asked the delivery agent the following question: **1**

"When will the parcel reach my office?"

Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.
Mrs Rao asked the delivery agent _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank from a workshop announcement. **1**

There are only _____ seats left for the robotics workshop, so register at the earliest.

A. a few B. a little C. much D. less

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the given line from a travel blog. **1**

Every morning, my grandfather walk to the lake and feeds the ducks before breakfast.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the notice displayed outside a hospital ward by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**

Visitors _____ keep their mobile phones on silent mode inside the ICU. (must / may)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a newspaper report. **1**

By the time the fire brigade arrived, the residents _____ (evacuate) the building.

WRITING

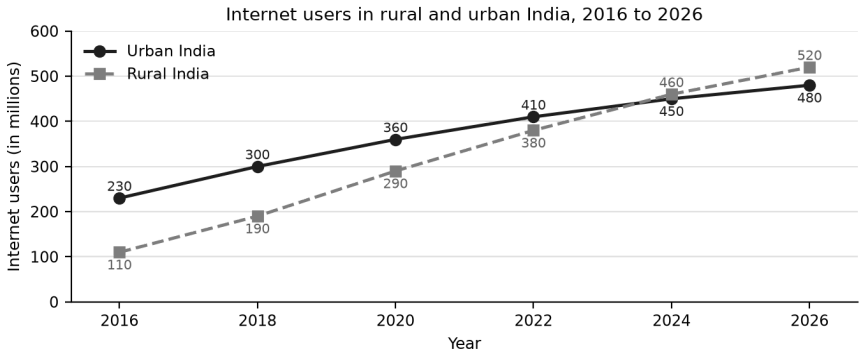
NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Ritika / Rohan Malhotra, a resident of Model Town, Jalandhar. Many students in your town cycle to school, but the main roads have no cycle lanes and heavy traffic makes the ride dangerous. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily in 120 words, highlighting the need for safe cycle lanes for school students and suggesting measures that the authorities could take. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Anjali / Arjun Menon, Sports Secretary of Sunrise Public School, Kakkanad, Kochi. Your school is hosting an inter-school football and basketball tournament next month. Write a letter in 120 words to the Sales Manager, Champion Sports Pvt. Ltd., MG Road, Kochi, placing an order for the required sports equipment. Mention the items and quantities, and the terms of delivery and payment. **5**

5 A. The line graph below shows the number of internet users (in millions) in rural and urban India from 2016 to 2026, according to an imaginary survey by a digital research agency. **5**



Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, analysing the trends shown in the graph and the possible reasons behind them.

OR

5 B. Read the product details mentioned on an e-commerce website for **ScribeLink**, a smart pen that digitises handwritten notes. **5**

- Writes with real ink on ordinary notebook paper
- Built-in sensor captures every stroke and syncs the notes to a mobile app through Bluetooth
- Converts handwriting into editable, searchable text in 12 languages, including Hindi
- Records audio while you write; tap any word to replay what the teacher was saying at that moment
- Stores up to 1,000 pages offline; 12 hours of use on a 90-minute USB-C charge
- Weighs only 22 grams
- Price: ₹4,999 with a 1-year warranty

Now, analyse whether this pen would be a useful purchase for a Class 10 student. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as organisation of notes, time saving, support for revision, cost and possible drawbacks.

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A.

One of the employees, who was a postman and also helped at the post office, went to his boss laughing heartily and showed him the letter to God. Never in his career as a postman had he known that address. The postmaster — a fat, amiable fellow — also broke out laughing, but almost immediately he turned serious and, tapping the letter on his desk, commented, "What faith! I wish I had the faith of the man who wrote this letter. Starting up a correspondence with God!"

So, in order not to shake the writer's faith in God, the postmaster came up with an idea: answer the letter. But when he opened it, it was evident that to answer it he needed something more than goodwill, ink and paper. But he stuck to his resolution: he asked for money from his employees, he himself gave part of his salary, and several friends of his were obliged to give something 'for an act of charity'. (A Letter to God)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**

The postmaster first broke out laughing but almost immediately turned serious. This shows that he _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1

The postmaster decided to answer the letter mainly _____.

A. to make fun of the writer's ignorance
B. so that the writer's faith in God would not be shaken
C. to collect money for his poor employees
D. to win the praise of the people of the town

III Select the option that correctly explains the phrase 'were obliged to give something 'for an act of charity''. 1

(a) The friends gave money eagerly because they too had complete faith in God.
(b) The friends gave money because they felt duty-bound, though perhaps not very willingly.

IV '…to answer it he needed something more than goodwill, ink and paper.' What does this line reveal about the postmaster's challenge and his character? 2

OR

B.

I was not born with a hunger to be free. I was born free — free in every way that I could know. Free to run in the fields near my mother's hut, free to swim in the clear stream that ran through my village, free to roast mealies under the stars and ride the broad backs of slow-moving bulls. As long as I obeyed my father and abided by the customs of my tribe, I was not troubled by the laws of man or God.

It was only when I began to learn that my boyhood freedom was an illusion, when I discovered as a young man that my freedom had already been taken from me, that I began to hunger for it. At first, as a student, I wanted freedom only for myself, the transitory freedoms of being able to stay out at night, read what I pleased and go where I chose.

(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1

Mandela calls his boyhood freedom an 'illusion' because _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1

The 'transitory freedoms' that Mandela wanted as a student were _____.

A. freedoms for all the people of his country
B. short-lived personal freedoms such as staying out at night
C. the freedoms of earning his keep and having a family
D. freedom from the customs of his tribe

III Fill in the blank with the correct option from the bracket. 1

The images of roasting mealies under the stars and riding the backs of slow-moving bulls create a mood of _____. (carefree innocence / bitter resentment)

IV How does the repetition of the word 'free' in the first paragraph contrast with the phrase 'hunger for it' in the second? What does this contrast reveal? 2

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A.

But up jumped Custard, snorting like an engine,
Clashed his tail like irons in a dungeon,
With a clatter and a clank and a jangling squirm,
He went at the pirate like a robin at a worm.

The pirate gaped at Belinda's dragon,
And gulped some grog from his pocket flagon,

He fired two bullets, but they didn't hit,
And Custard gobbled him, every bit.

(The Tale of Custard the Dragon)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**

The simile 'snorting like an engine' suggests that Custard _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**

The line 'He went at the pirate like a robin at a worm' suggests that Custard attacked the pirate _____.

A. hesitantly and fearfully
B. swiftly and with complete ease
C. clumsily and noisily
D. cruelly and without reason

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**

The pirate gaped and gulped some grog, which shows that the sight of the dragon made him _____.

IV How does the poet use sound words in these stanzas to create both excitement and humour? **2**

OR

B.

"But I can get a hair-dye
And set such colour there,
Brown, or black, or carrot,
That young men in despair
May love me for myself alone
And not my yellow hair."

"I heard an old religious man
But yesternight declare
That he had found a text to prove
That only God, my dear,
Could love you for yourself alone
And not your yellow hair."

(For Anne Gregory)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**

The young woman's offer to dye her hair 'brown, or black, or carrot' shows that she _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**

The speaker refers to 'an old religious man' in the second stanza in order to _____.

A. show his deep respect for religious texts
B. support his argument that only God can love a person for her inner self
C. make fun of the young woman's beliefs
D. change the topic of the conversation

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**

In the poem, 'yellow hair' stands for a person's outward _____.

IV What do these stanzas suggest about the difference between human love and divine love? **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3 =12**

I How does the poet use the images of fire and ice to comment on human emotions and their power to destroy? (Fire and Ice) **3**

II Anne writes that 'paper has more patience than people'. What does this reveal about her state of mind and her reasons for keeping a diary? (From the Diary of Anne Frank) **3**

III How does the writer show that the baker was an inseparable part of the social and cultural life of a Goan village? (Glimpses of India – A Baker from Goa) **3**

IV How does the poet contrast the tiger's life in the cage with the life it should have been living in the wild? (A Tiger in the Zoo) **3**

V How does Kisa Gotami's search for a handful of mustard seed change her understanding of death? (The Sermon at Benares) **3**

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3 =6**

I Hari Singh reached the station with the stolen money but did not leave for Lucknow. What made him go back to Anil instead? (The Thief's Story) **3**

II How did Ausable get rid of Max without using a gun or any violence? What does this show about him? (The Midnight Visitor) **3**

III Horace Danby, who robbed safes himself, was tricked by a cleverer thief. Bring out the irony in his situation. (A Question of Trust) **3**

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Chekhov uses the trivial quarrels between Lomov and Natalya over the Oxen Meadows and their dogs to expose the materialistic attitude towards marriage in the society of his time. Discuss. (The Proposal)

OR

B. Gavin Maxwell's journey from Basra to London with Mijbil shows both the responsibilities and the rewards of keeping an unusual pet. Discuss. (Mijbil the Otter)

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Griffin was a brilliant scientist but a lawless man. Draw a character sketch of Griffin, showing how he misused his remarkable discovery. (Footprints without Feet)

OR

B. 'A curious mind, a will to win for the right reasons, and the right encouragement make a scientist.' Discuss with reference to Richard Ebright's journey from a young butterfly collector to a research scientist. (The Making of a Scientist)

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SAMPLE PAPER 9

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

MARKING SCHEME · SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 9 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. MARKING SCHEME **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. The Marking Scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers / sample answers. The value points are in the nature of guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. The students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, then due marks should be awarded accordingly.
2. If a student has attempted an extra question, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note "Extra Question".
3. If more than one option is mentioned in the answer of multiple choice questions, then no marks to be awarded.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

Discursive Passage

1. **Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.** **10**

Answer

I The neighbour and the park are real-life problems in the community from which students can learn valuable lessons; they are opportunities for learning that exist outside the school building. **1**

II (a) real experience of teaching and dealing with young learners teaches patience and listening more effectively than reading about them. **1**

III B. A school sets aside one period every week for students to run a reading club in a nearby settlement. **1**

IV The writer first admits that the critics' concern is understandable, but calls it a 'narrow view of preparation'. He supports his view with studies showing that students who volunteer regularly have better attendance, stronger communication skills and greater confidence in group work. (1) This reveals that, for the writer, preparation means the all-round development of skills and character that forms the foundation of academic success, not merely studying for examinations. (1) **2**

V False **1**

VI (a) is correct. **1**
[A token act like a single afternoon of photographs results only in 'looking busy'; in the same way, a sustained commitment results in genuine learning. Both pairs show an action and its result.]

VII A. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) F **1**

VIII The writer uses the counter-argument technique. By presenting the critics' view fairly, he shows that he is balanced and has considered the concerns of parents and students. (1) He then answers the objection with evidence, which makes his own argument more credible and persuasive and guides readers to accept community service as part of education. (1) **2**

Case-Based Passage

2. **Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.** **10**

Answer

I serious and worrying **1**

II Canteen staff handle the sale of items and the disposal of waste every day, so their views give a practical, complete picture of why plastic is used and what problems exist (e.g. missing bins). *(Any relevant answer)* **1**

III B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation. **1**

IV C. Most students always put their wrappers into dry-waste bins. **1**

V Most students are willing to change: 72% would carry their own steel bottle if refilling stations were installed and 64% would pay more for paper or leaf packaging. However, only 18% always put wrappers into dry-waste bins. (1) **2**

This suggests a gap between intention and action; willingness alone is not enough, and students need proper facilities, reminders and habit-building to turn good intentions into practice. (1)

VI dry-waste bins are often missing or overflowing / proper facilities for segregation are not available **1**

VII a phased ban **1**

VIII *Any one:* **1**
– Install a water dispenser / refilling station with steel tumblers in the canteen.
– Encourage students to carry their own steel bottles.

IX *Any one:* **1**
– The title captures the central finding that most snacks and drinks in school canteens reach students wrapped in plastic (about 350 items per canteen a day).
– It is catchy and covers all parts of the passage – the problem, students' attitudes and the solutions suggested.

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20 marks

GRAMMAR (10 marks)

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

Answer

1 mark for each correct answer (any ten: 10 x 1 = 10)

I A. has been postponed **1**

II The coach ordered / told / instructed the players not to leave the ground without informing him / her. **1**

III B. Each **1**

IV he had returned the book that he had borrowed the previous week / the week before. **1**

V Error: have Correction: has **1**

VI B. must **1**

VII A. has visited – visited **1**

VIII when the parcel would reach her office. **1**

IX A. a few **1**

X Error: walk Correction: walks **1**

XI must **1**

XII had evacuated **1**

WRITING SKILLS (10 marks)

4. **Format – 1 Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 1 Accuracy – 1** **1x5 =5**

Answer

Criterion	Marks
Format: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, complimentary close, name (and designation where relevant)	1
Content: relevant ideas covering the issue, its effects and the suggestions / details asked for	2
Organisation of ideas: logical sequencing of paragraphs, coherence and cohesion	1
Accuracy: grammatical accuracy, spelling and punctuation	1

Marks: Format (1) + Content (2) + Organisation of ideas (1) + Accuracy (1) = 5

A. (The response may be created from the following content points)
- **Issue and context:** many students cycle to school; main roads have no cycle lanes; heavy, speeding traffic of buses, trucks and two-wheelers
- **Effects:** frequent accidents and injuries; fear among parents; students shift to motor vehicles, adding to congestion and pollution
- **Suggestions:** separate cycle lanes with barriers on main roads; speed breakers, zebra crossings and signboards near schools; traffic wardens during school hours; fines for vehicles parked on cycle lanes; cycle stands in schools
- **Appeal:** request the newspaper to highlight the issue and the authorities to act at the earliest

Model answer (4 A):

Model Town
Jalandhar
30 October 2026

The Editor
The Daily Chronicle
New Delhi

Subject: Need for safe cycle lanes for school students

Sir/Madam
Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to the dangers faced by students who cycle to school in Model Town, Jalandhar.
Every morning, hundreds of students ride along busy main roads where speeding buses, trucks and two-wheelers leave them hardly any space. Last month alone, three students were injured in accidents. Many worried parents have stopped their children from cycling, which only adds to traffic and pollution.
The Municipal Corporation should build separate cycle lanes with barriers on major roads, install speed breakers and zebra crossings near schools and post traffic wardens during school hours. Vehicles parked on cycle lanes must be fined.
Safe roads will encourage a healthy and eco-friendly habit. I hope the authorities will act at the earliest.

Yours faithfully
Ritika Malhotra

OR

B. The response may be created from the following value points:

- **Format:** sender's address (school), date, receiver (Sales Manager, Champion Sports Pvt. Ltd., MG Road, Kochi), subject: Order for sports equipment
- **Introduction:** purpose – school hosting inter-school football and basketball tournament next month; wish to place an order
- **Order details** (preferably in a table): footballs (size 5) – e.g. 10; basketballs (size 7) – e.g. 10; goalkeeping gloves – 4 pairs; football nets – 2; basketball nets – 4; jerseys / bibs in two colours – 30; first-aid kit – 2 *(any reasonable items and quantities)*
- **Terms:** quality / brand specifications; delivery at school before a specific date; replacement of damaged goods; usual discount for schools; mode of payment (cheque / online transfer on delivery)
- **Closing:** request for prompt delivery and bill; Yours faithfully, name and designation (Sports Secretary)

5. **Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 2 Accuracy – 1** **1x5 =5**

Answer

Criterion	Marks
Content: correct interpretation of the data / cues, key trends and comparisons, inference or conclusion	2
Organisation of ideas: introduction, logical development, conclusion; coherence and cohesion	2
Accuracy: grammatical accuracy, spelling and punctuation	1

Marks: Content (2) + Organisation of ideas (2) + Accuracy (1) = 5

Analytical paragraph writing should NOT be confused with writing a description of given elements or writing a summary. It requires examining the given elements closely and sharing inputs based on the given stimulant. It carries no title or heading.

A. Value points: **overview** – users rose in both rural and urban India from 2016 to 2026; **urban** – roughly doubled (230 → 480 million), growth slowed after 2020; **rural** – grew almost fivefold (110 → 520 million), fastest growth between 2018 and 2022; **crossover** – rural users overtook urban users by 2024 (460 vs 450 million); total about 1,000 million in 2026; **possible reasons** – cheaper smartphones and data, mobile towers in villages, digital payments, online classes and government services; conclusion.

Suggested response (5 A):

The line graph traces the growth of internet users in rural and urban India between 2016 and 2026. In both regions the number of users rose steadily, but at very different speeds. Urban users roughly doubled, from 230 million to 480 million, and their growth slowed after 2020, as

most city dwellers were already online. Rural India, however, grew almost fivefold, from 110 million to 520 million. The gap narrowed rapidly after 2018, and by 2024 rural users (460 million) had overtaken urban users (450 million). This surge can be linked to cheaper smartphones and data, the spread of mobile towers and the growth of services such as digital payments and online classes. Overall, the internet, once largely an urban privilege, has become a truly national resource.

OR

B. Value points: **organisation** – real ink on ordinary paper, every page synced to a phone app, notes never lost; **time saving** – handwriting converted into editable, searchable text (12 languages incl. Hindi); **support for revision** – audio recording, tap a word to replay the teacher's explanation; **reliability** – 1,000 pages offline, 12 hours on a 90-minute charge, light (22 g), 1-year warranty; **cost and drawbacks** – ₹4,999 is expensive; dependence on a phone may distract; still needs paper; conclusion – useful for a disciplined student who can afford it.

Suggested response (5 B):

The ScribeLink smart pen could be a valuable study companion for a Class 10 student. Since it writes with real ink on ordinary paper, the student keeps the familiar habit of handwriting while every page is saved on a phone, so notes stay organised and are never lost. Converting handwriting into searchable text saves time when looking for a topic before a test, and the audio recording lets a student replay a teacher's explanation at the exact word, which strongly supports revision. A 12-hour battery and offline storage of 1,000 pages make it reliable. However, at ₹4,999 it is costly, and depending on a phone app may tempt students towards distractions. On balance, it is a worthwhile purchase for a disciplined learner who can afford it.

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

Answer

A. **Prose (A Letter to God)**

Answer

I was a kind and sensitive man who quickly recognised and respected the depth of the writer's faith *(any similar answer)* **1**

II B. so that the writer's faith in God would not be shaken **1**

III (b) The friends gave money because they felt duty-bound, though perhaps not very willingly. **1**

IV – **Challenge:** Lencho had asked God for a hundred pesos, so a reply with kind words alone would not do; the postmaster had to arrange money. (1)
– **Character:** he is compassionate, generous and determined – he 'stuck to his resolution', gave part of his own salary and collected money from his employees and friends to protect a stranger's faith. (1) **2**

OR

B. **Prose (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)**

Answer

I he discovered as a young man that his freedom had already been taken from him; it lasted only as long as he obeyed his father and the customs of his tribe *(any one)* **1**

II B. short-lived personal freedoms such as staying out at night **1**

III carefree innocence **1**

IV – The repeated word 'free' stresses how complete, natural and joyful his boyhood freedom seemed – something he took for granted. (½)
– 'Hunger for it' suggests an intense, painful craving that arises only after a loss. (½)
– The contrast reveals his journey from innocence to awareness: one values freedom most when one realises it has been taken away, and this marks the beginning of his longing for freedom. (1) **2**

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

Answer

A. **Poetry (The Tale of Custard the Dragon)**

Answer

I charged forward with great power, energy and determination *(any similar answer)* **1**

II B. swiftly and with complete ease **1**

III frightened / nervous / terrified **1**

IV – Sound words such as 'snorting', 'clashed', 'clatter', 'clank' and 'jangling' (onomatopoeia and alliteration) recreate the noise of a fierce battle and build excitement. (1)
– Humour comes from the contrast between this sudden heroism and Custard's reputation as a coward, and from comic images like the pirate gulping grog and Custard gobbling him 'every bit', giving the ballad its mock-heroic tone. (1) **2**

OR

B. Answer

Poetry (For Anne Gregory)

I wants to be loved for her true self and inner qualities, not for her beautiful hair, and is even willing to give up her beauty for it **1**

II B. support his argument that only God can love a person for her inner self **1**

III beauty / appearance **1**

IV – Human love is usually drawn to outward beauty; the young man insists that men will always be attracted by her 'yellow hair', whatever its colour. (1)
– Divine love alone is pure and unconditional and sees the inner self; the poem suggests that it is almost impossible for a human being to love someone 'for yourself alone'. (1) **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3**

Answer **Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall** **=12**

I **(Fire and Ice)** Value points: **3**

– Fire = desire, greed, passion; spreads quickly and consumes **(½)**
– Ice = hatred, coldness, indifference; slow but rigid **(½)**
– either is enough to destroy the world **(½)**
– warns that human emotions, not nature, are the real threat **(½)**

Model answer:

> Frost uses fire as a symbol of desire, greed and passion, which spread rapidly and consume everything, and ice as a symbol of hatred, which is cold, rigid and insensitive. By saying that either 'would suffice', he warns that unchecked human emotions, rather than natural disasters, can destroy the world.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

II **(From the Diary of Anne Frank)** Value points: **3**

– Anne felt lonely, bored and depressed **(½)**
– had family and many acquaintances but no true friend to confide in **(½)**
– paper listens patiently without judging or interrupting **(½)**
– diary (Kitty) becomes her friend to express her innermost thoughts **(½)**

Model answer:

> Anne recalled the saying on a day when she was feeling depressed, bored and listless. Though she had a loving family and many acquaintances, she had no true friend to share her innermost feelings with. Paper, unlike people, would listen patiently without judging, so she made her diary, Kitty, her friend.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

III **(Glimpses of India – A Baker from Goa)** Value points: **3**

– Baker's jingling bamboo announced the morning **(½)**
– marriage gifts meaningless without the sweet bread bol **(½)**
– cakes and bolinhas essential at Christmas and festivals **(½)**
– sandwiches for a daughter's engagement **(½)**
– baker's furnace essential in the village; accounts on the wall **(½)**

Any 4 relevant points, ½ mark each = 2

Model answer:

> The baker's jingling bamboo woke the village each morning and the children ran to meet him. No marriage gift was complete without the sweet bread called bol, no Christmas or festival without cakes and bolinhas, and a daughter's engagement needed sandwiches. Thus the baker's furnace was essential to Goan village life.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

IV **(A Tiger in the Zoo)** Value points: **3**

– Cage: stalks a few steps, quiet rage, locked in a concrete cell, ignores visitors, stares at the stars **(½)**

– Wild: lurks in long grass near the water hole for plump deer, snarls around houses at the jungle's edge, bares white fangs **(½)**
– contrast condemns captivity **(1)**

Model answer:

> In the cage, the tiger stalks a few steps in quiet rage, locked in a concrete cell, ignoring visitors and staring at the stars at night. In the wild, it would lurk in long grass near the water hole for plump deer and terrorise villages at the jungle's edge. The contrast condemns captivity.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

V **(The Sermon at Benares)** Value points: **3**

– Kisa Gotami's only son died; she sought medicine from all **(½)**
– the Buddha asked for mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend **(½)**
– no such house found **(½)**
– realised death is common to all and her grief selfish **(½)**
– accepted death calmly **(½)**

Any 4 relevant points, ½ mark each = 2

Model answer:

> Grieving for her only son, Kisa Gotami was asked by the Buddha to bring mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend. Finding no such house, she realised that death is common to all and that her grief was selfish, and accepted it calmly.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3**

Answer **Content – 2 Expression – 1 Accuracy – Deduct up to 1 mark from overall** **=6**

I **(The Thief's Story)** Value points: **3**

– The Lucknow Express was just moving out, but Hari hesitated, for a reason he could not explain, and missed it **(½)**
– sitting in the cold drizzle, he imagined that Anil's face would show a touch of sadness, not for the money but for the loss of trust **(½)**
– realised that education could make him 'a really big man, a clever and respected man', worth more than a few hundred rupees **(½)**
– went back to Anil, if only to learn to read and write **(½)**

Model answer:

> Hari hesitated and missed the moving Lucknow Express. Sitting in the drizzle, he imagined Anil's sadness at the loss of trust, not money. He realised that learning to read and write could make him a really big, respected man, which stealing never could. So he went back to Anil.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

II **(The Midnight Visitor)** Value points: **3**

– Max, a rival agent, was in Ausable's room with a pistol to take the report on new missiles **(½)**
– Ausable stayed calm and invented a story of a balcony below his window **(½)**
– claimed he had asked for police protection **(½)**
– when the waiter knocked with the drink Ausable had ordered, Max thought it was the police and jumped out to the balcony that did not exist **(½)**
– shows presence of mind, sharp intelligence, coolness under pressure **(½)**

Any 4 relevant points, ½ mark each = 2

Model answer:

> Max held a pistol, but Ausable stayed calm. He invented a balcony below his window and said he had asked for police protection. When the waiter knocked with Ausable's drink, Max took it for the police and jumped to the non-existent balcony. This shows Ausable's presence of mind.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

III **(A Question of Trust)** Value points: **3**

– Horace, a respectable lock-maker, robbed one safe a year to buy rare books **(½)**
– planned the robbery at Shotover Grange carefully **(½)**
– a charming young lady in red posed as the lady of the house and tricked him into opening the safe **(½)**
– she took the jewels; he had opened the safe without gloves, so his fingerprints were all over the room and he was jailed **(½)**

– irony: a careful thief trusted another thief and was punished for her crime; nobody believed his story **(½)**

Any 4 relevant points, ½ mark each = 2

Model answer:

Horace planned the robbery at Shotover Grange carefully, yet trusted a charming lady in red who posed as the lady of the house. He opened the safe for her without gloves, and she took the jewels. His fingerprints sent him to jail. Ironically, the thief was outwitted and punished for another thief's crime.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 *(Accuracy: up to 1 mark deducted overall for errors)*

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A. (The Proposal)

– Marriage seen as a practical arrangement: Lomov, thirty-five and in poor health, wants a 'quiet, well-regulated life'; Natalya is 'an excellent housekeeper, not bad-looking, well-educated' **(½)**
– Chubukov welcomes the match readily, eager to marry off his daughter **(½)**
– Quarrel over the Oxen Meadows – a worthless strip of land – shows pride in property outweighs feelings **(½)**
– Quarrel over the dogs, Guess and Squeezer, again reflects pride in possessions **(½)**
– Even the union takes place amid quarrels; farce exposes the materialism and pettiness of the landowning class **(1)**

Model answer:

In 'The Proposal', Chekhov turns a marriage proposal into a farce to expose how marriage among Russian landowners rested on property rather than love. Lomov proposes not out of affection but because he is thirty-five, in poor health and needs a 'quiet, well-regulated life'; to him, Natalya is simply 'an excellent housekeeper, not bad-looking, well-educated'. Chubukov welcomes him eagerly, keen to marry off his daughter. Yet before the proposal is even made, the two quarrel bitterly over the Oxen Meadows, a worthless strip of land, and later over whose dog, Guess or Squeezer, is better. Their pride in possessions clearly outweighs any feeling. Thus the comedy satirises a society that treats marriage as a property deal.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B. (Mijbil the Otter)

– Responsibilities: airline would not fly animals, so Maxwell booked a flight to Paris on another airline; Mij had to be packed in a box not more than eighteen inches square **(½)**
– Mij tore the lining of the box and was found exhausted and blood-spattered; rush to the airport; Maxwell had to keep the lid down with his hand **(½)**
– Chaos on the plane: Mij escaped, a woman screamed 'A rat!', Maxwell found his face covered in curry; the air hostess helped **(½)**
– Rewards: Mij bounded on to his knee and nuzzled his face; in Basra he soon followed Maxwell without a lead; in London he played for hours with ping-pong balls and marbles **(½)**
– Conclusion: an unusual pet demands patience, planning and care, but repays it with deep companionship **(1)**

Model answer:

Maxwell's journey with Mijbil shows that an unusual pet brings both heavy responsibilities and rich rewards. Since the airline he first chose would not fly animals, he booked a flight to Paris on another airline and had Mij packed in a box not more than eighteen inches square. Mij tore the box's lining and was found blood-spattered. On the plane, Mij escaped, a woman screamed 'A rat!' and Maxwell ended up with curry on his face. Yet the rewards were touching: Mij soon bounded on to his knee and nuzzled his face, and in London he played for hours with his toys. Such a pet demands patience but repays it with true companionship.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

Answer

Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A. (Footprints without Feet)

– **Brilliant scientist:** discovered how to make the human body invisible by swallowing certain rare drugs **(½)**

– **Lawless and bad-tempered:** set fire to his landlord's house in revenge when the landlord tried to eject him **(½)**
– **Misuse in London:** hid in a big London store; knocked down and robbed a shopkeeper in Drury Lane for bandages, dark glasses, false nose, whiskers and a hat **(½)**
– **Misuse at Iping:** aroused suspicion at the inn; stole money from the clergyman's house; threw off his clothes and knocked the constable Jaffers unconscious when cornered **(½)**
– **Conclusion:** genius without moral sense – a menace to society instead of a benefactor **(1)**

Model answer:

> Griffin was a brilliant but lawless scientist. He discovered how to make the human body invisible by swallowing certain rare drugs, a remarkable achievement. Yet he used it only for selfish and harmful ends. When his landlord tried to throw him out, he set fire to the house in revenge. In London, he hid in a big store and later knocked down and robbed a shopkeeper in Drury Lane to get bandages, dark glasses, a false nose and whiskers. At Iping, his strange ways aroused suspicion; he stole money from the clergyman's house and, when cornered, threw off his clothes and knocked the constable, Jaffers, unconscious. Griffin's genius, without a moral sense, made him a menace rather than a benefactor.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B. **(The Making of a Scientist)**

– **Curious mind:** as a child collected butterflies, rocks, fossils, coins; all twenty-five species of butterflies around his hometown by the second grade **(½)**
– **Encouragement:** his mother bought him telescopes, microscopes, cameras and 'The Travels of Monarch X', which opened the world of science; Dr Urquhart's suggestions guided his projects **(½)**
– **Will to win:** after losing at the seventh-grade science fair, resolved to do real experiments **(½)**
– **Achievements:** projects on a viral disease of monarchs, on viceroys copying monarchs, and on the gold spots of the monarch pupa (a hormone) won top prizes **(½)**
– **Right reasons:** competed to do his best, not to beat others (Mr Weiherer); led to important research on how cells read the DNA blueprint **(1)**

Model answer:

> Richard Ebright's journey shows how curiosity, a healthy will to win and encouragement together make a scientist. As a child near Reading, Pennsylvania, he collected butterflies, rocks and coins, and by the second grade he had collected all twenty-five species of butterflies around his hometown. His mother encouraged every interest; she gave him telescopes, microscopes and cameras, and the book 'The Travels of Monarch X', which opened the world of science to him. When his seventh-grade entry won nothing, he resolved to do real experiments. His projects on the viceroy butterfly and on the gold spots of the monarch pupa won top prizes. As his teacher noted, Ebright competed not to beat others but to do his best.

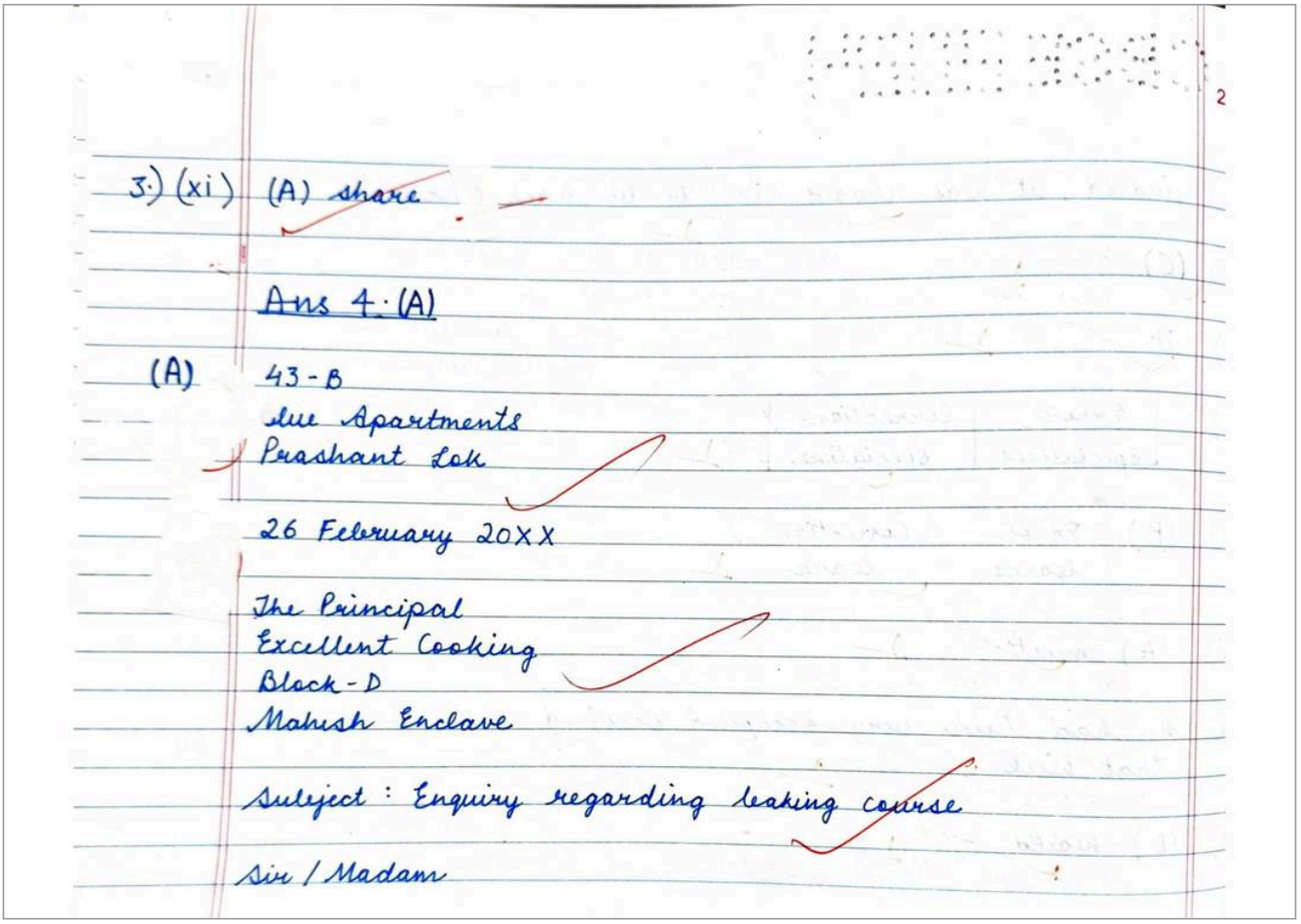
Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

Marks Summary

Section	Questions	Marks
Section A: Reading Skills	Q1 – Q2	20
Section B: Writing Skills & Grammar	Q3 – Q5	20
Section C: Literature Textbook	Q6 – Q11	40
Total		**80**

***

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · similar to Q4 (B) (formal business letter) answer book p.22



2

3.) (xi) (A) share

Ans 4. (A)

(A) 43-B
Ilue Apartments
Prashant Lok

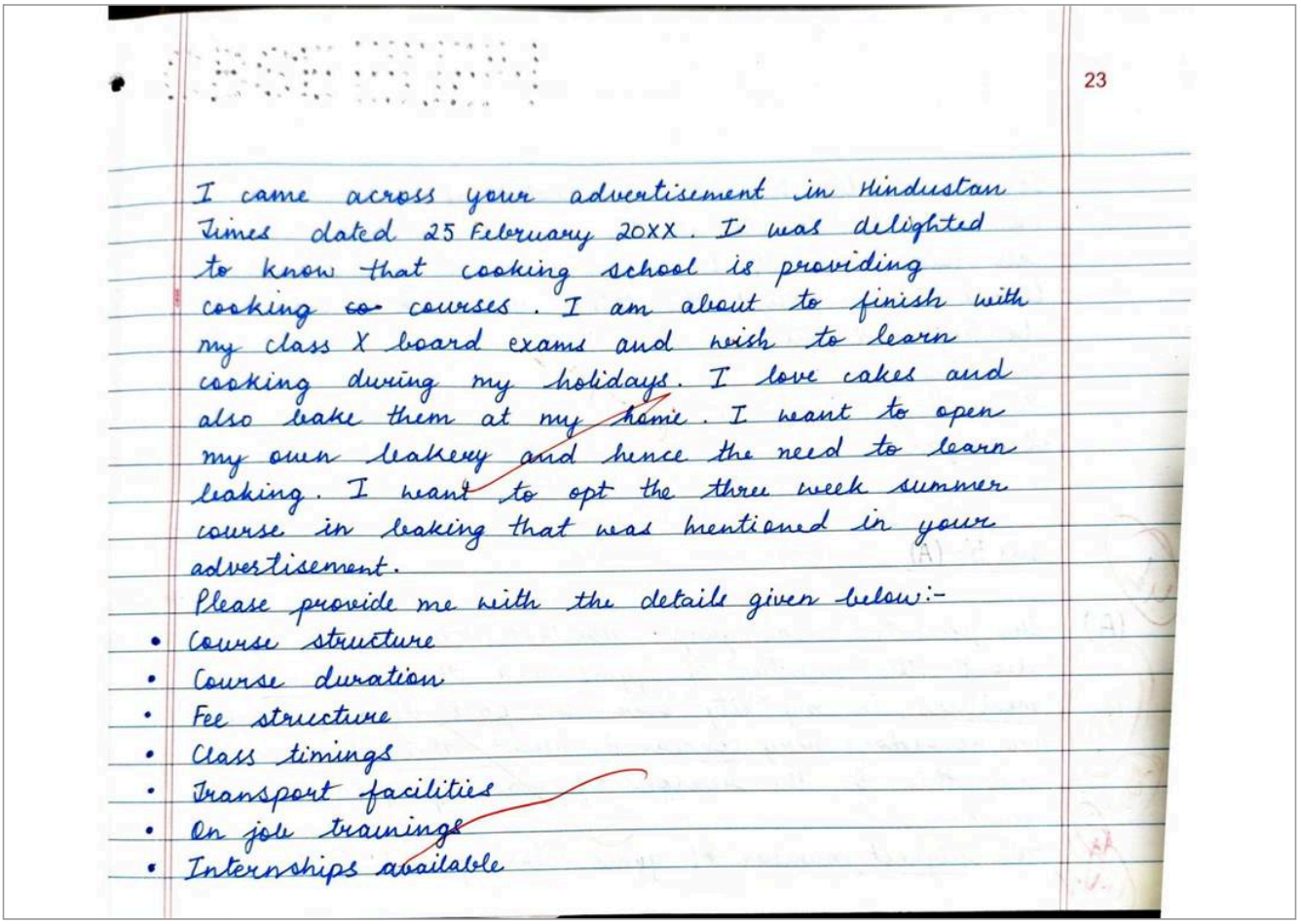
26 February 20XX

The Principal
Excellent Cooking
Block-D
Mahish Enclave

Subject : Enquiry regarding baking course

Sir / Madam

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · letter of enquiry (contd.) answer book p.23

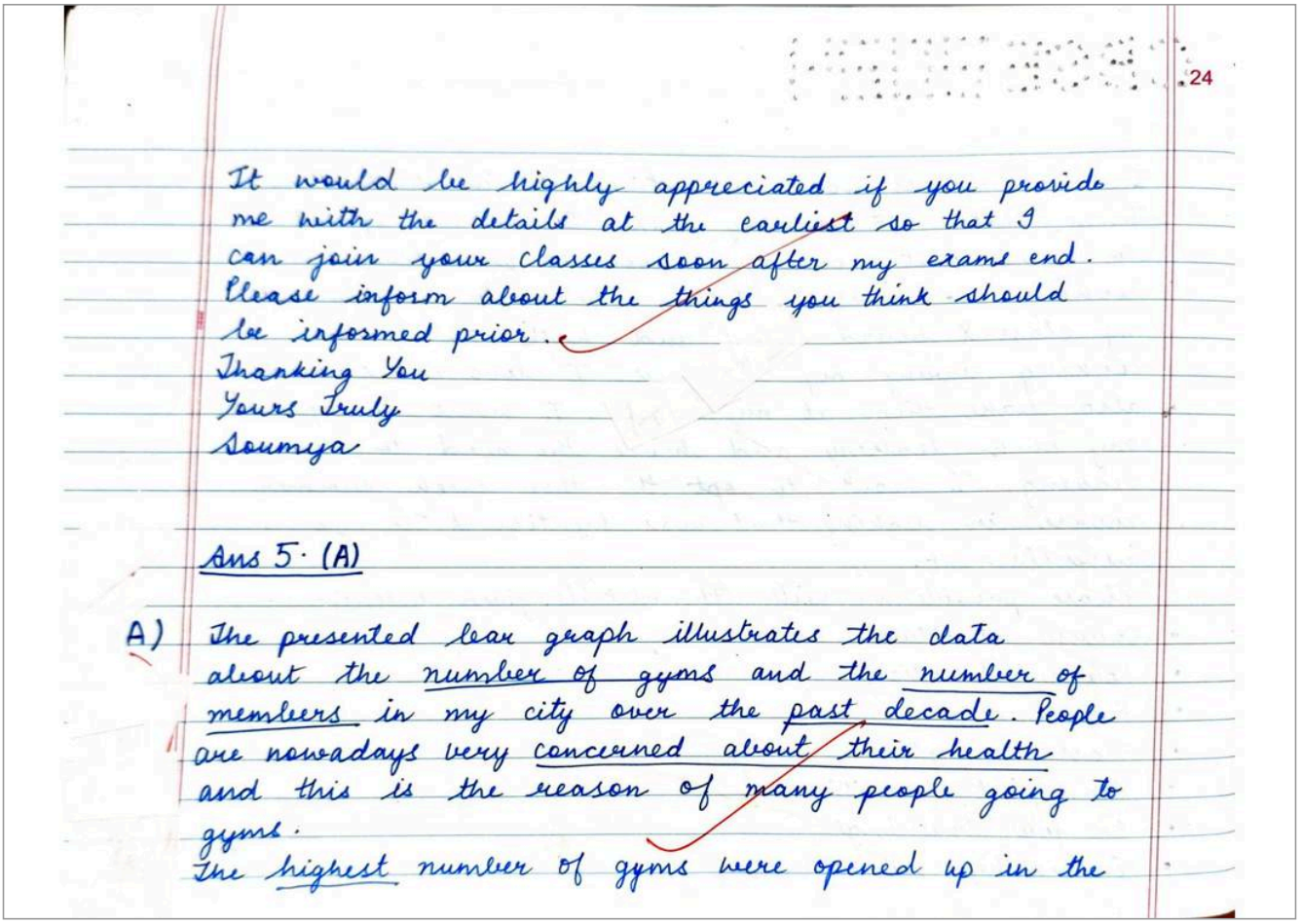


23

I came across your advertisement in Hindustan Times dated 25 February 20XX. I was delighted to know that cooking school is providing cooking ~~co~~ courses. I am about to finish with my class X board exams and wish to learn cooking during my holidays. I love cakes and also bake them at my home. I want to open my own bakery and hence the need to learn baking. I want to opt the three week summer course in baking that was mentioned in your advertisement.
Please provide me with the details given below:-

- Course structure
- Course duration
- Fee structure
- Class timings
- Transport facilities
- On job trainings
- Internships available

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · similar to Q5 (A) (letter ends; analytical paragraph on a line graph begins) answer book p.24



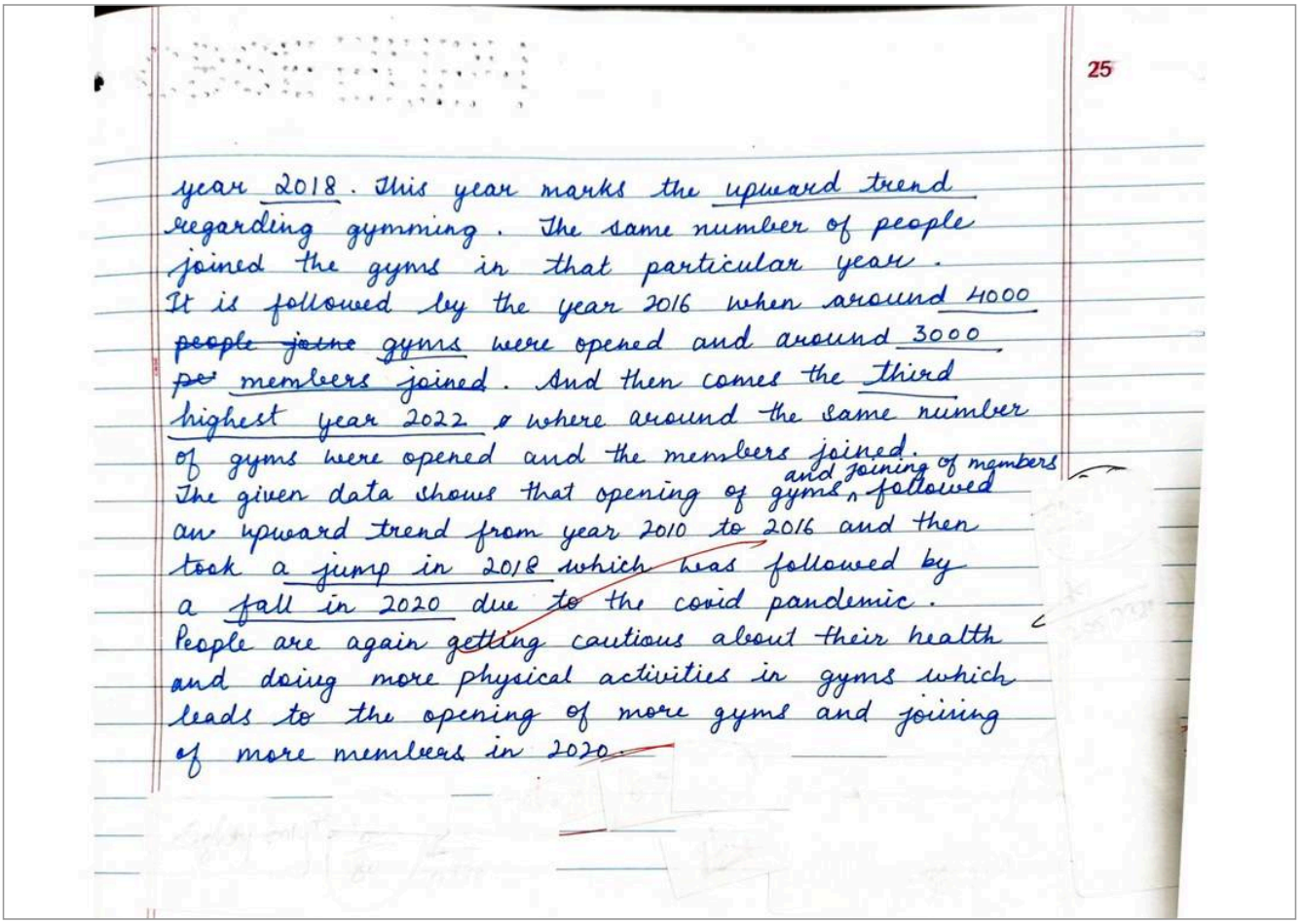
24

It would be highly appreciated if you provide me with the details at the earliest so that I can join your classes soon after my exams end. Please inform about the things you think should be informed prior.
Thanking You
Yours Truly
Soumya

Ans 5. (A)

A) The presented bar graph illustrates the data about the number of gyms and the number of members in my city over the past decade. People are nowadays very concerned about their health and this is the reason of many people going to gyms.
The highest number of gyms were opened up in the

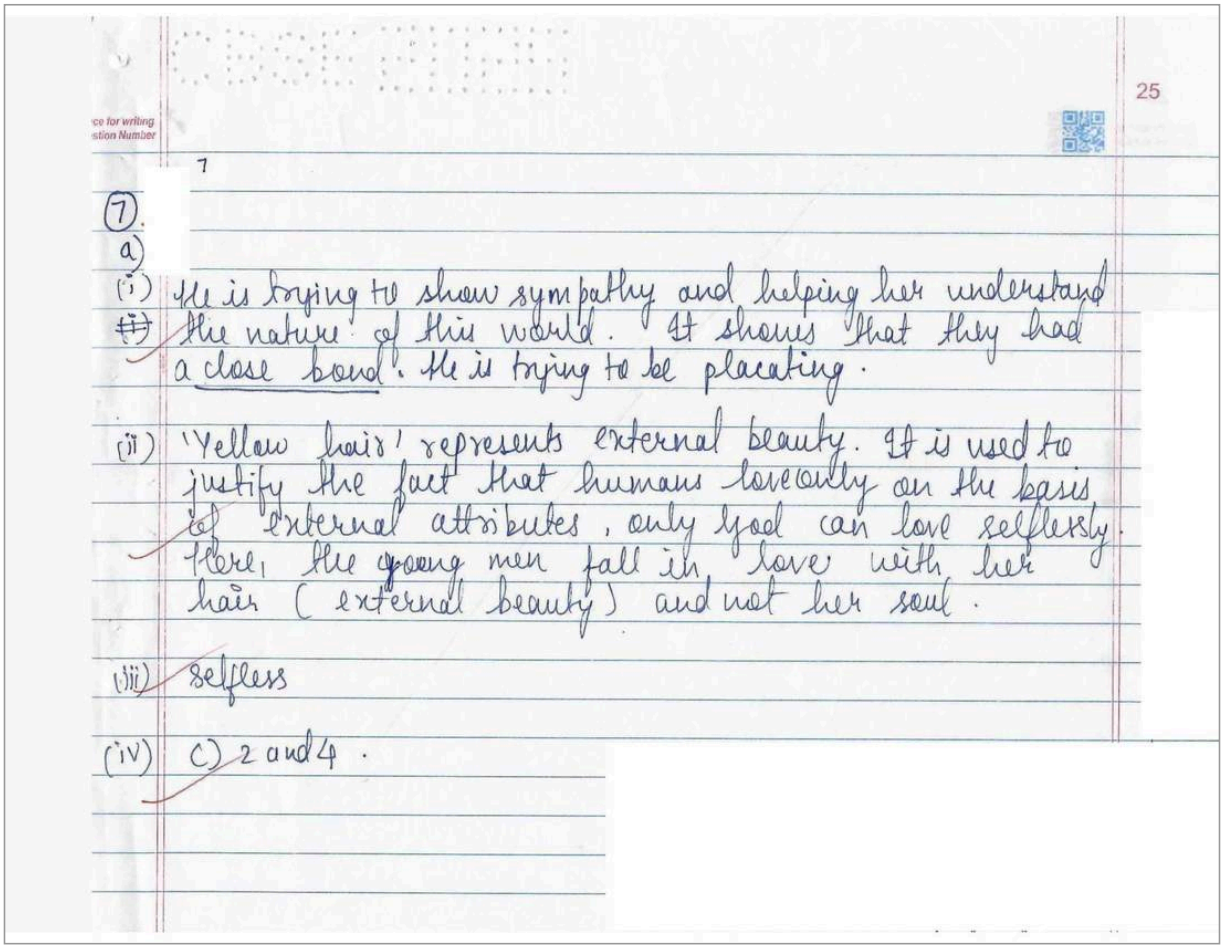
Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2024 · analytical paragraph (contd.) answer book p.25



25

year 2018. This year marks the upward trend regarding gymming. The same number of people joined the gyms in that particular year.
It is followed by the year 2016 when around 4000 ~~people joine~~ gyms were opened and around 3000 ~~pe~~ members joined. And then comes the third highest year 2022, where around the same number of gyms were opened and the members joined.
The given data shows that opening of gyms and joining of members followed an upward trend from year 2010 to 2016 and then took a jump in 2018 which was followed by a fall in 2020 due to the covid pandemic.
People are again getting cautious about their health and doing more physical activities in gyms which leads to the opening of more gyms and joining of more members in 2020.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q7 (B) (extract, For Anne Gregory) answer book p.25



25

7

(7)

a)

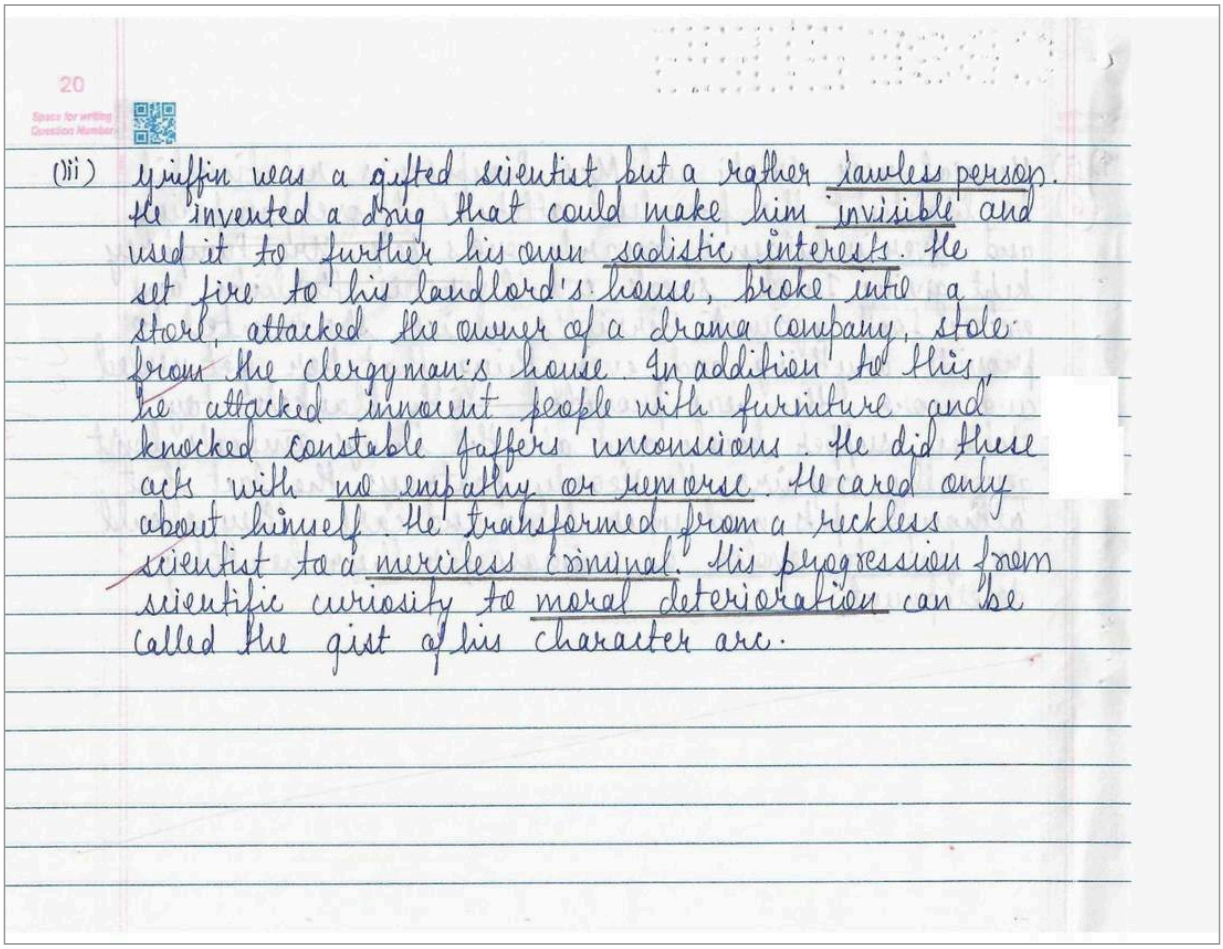
(i) He is trying to show sympathy and helping her understand the nature of this world. It shows that they had a close bond. He is trying to be placating.

(ii) 'Yellow hair' represents external beauty. It is used to justify the fact that humans love only on the basis of external attributes, only God can love selflessly. Here, the young men fall in love with her hair (external beauty) and not her soul.

(iii) selfless

(iv) c) 2 and 4.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q11 (A) (Footprints without Feet) answer book p.20



20

(iii) Griffin was a gifted scientist but a rather lawless person. He invented a drug that could make him invisible and used it to further his own sadistic interests. He set fire to his landlord's house, broke into a store, attacked the owner of a drama company, stole from the clergyman's house. In addition to this, he attacked innocent people with furniture and knocked constable Jaffers unconscious. He did these acts with no empathy or remorse. He cared only about himself. He transformed from a reckless scientist to a merciless criminal. His progression from scientific curiosity to moral deterioration can be called the gist of his character arc.

SAMPLE PAPER 10

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 10 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Somewhere in almost every home there is a forgotten instrument—a keyboard under a dust cover, a guitar with a missing string, a harmonium that once came out for every festival. We buy them with great enthusiasm and abandon them just as quickly. Yet those who persist with an instrument often describe the experience as one of the most rewarding of their lives. Learning to play music, it turns out, is far more than a pleasant hobby; it quietly reshapes the way we think, feel and connect with others.

(2) Consider first what happens inside the brain. Playing even a simple tune asks the eyes to read notation, the ears to judge pitch, the fingers to move with precision and the memory to hold the melody together, all at once. Researchers who study the brain have observed that regular practice strengthens the connections between its different regions. Several studies have linked music training in childhood with better attention, memory and language skills. No other everyday activity seems to give the mind quite so complete a workout.

(3) Then there is the matter of patience. In a world of instant downloads and ten-second videos, an instrument refuses to be hurried. A difficult passage on the sitar or the violin may take weeks to master, and no shortcut exists. Students learn, often for the first time, that small efforts repeated daily add up to visible progress. This lesson in discipline travels well beyond the music room, into examinations, sport and, later, the workplace.

(4) Music also offers a refuge. After a tiring day, ten minutes at the piano can calm the mind in a way that scrolling through a phone rarely does. Many learners say that playing helps them express feelings they cannot put into words. For teenagers under academic pressure, this emotional outlet can be invaluable.

(5) Perhaps the greatest joy, however, is shared. Playing in a school band, accompanying a friend's song or joining a family singing session builds a sense of belonging. Musicians must listen to one another, adjust their pace and support a weaker player. In short, they learn teamwork without being told to.

(6) It is never too late to begin. Adults who pick up the flute at forty, and grandparents who return to the tabla after retirement, report the same delight as young beginners. The instrument in the corner of your home is not asking for talent; it is asking for time. Perhaps it is time to take off the dust cover.

Created for academic usage / 411 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'a keyboard under a dust cover' suggest about the instruments found in many homes? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says that 'an instrument refuses to be hurried' (paragraph 3), he means that _____.

(a) learning an instrument demands steady, regular practice over a long period and cannot be rushed.

(b) musical instruments are delicate and must always be played at a slow pace.

III Paragraph 2 describes how the eyes, ears, fingers and memory work 'all at once' while playing a tune. **1**
Which of the following situations shows a similar combined effort?

A. Listening to a favourite song on headphones while resting

B. Reading a novel silently in the school library

C. A drummer reading a score while keeping time with both hands and feet

D. Memorising the lyrics of a song for a recitation

IV In paragraphs 3 and 4, the writer contrasts learning an instrument with quick digital entertainment. **2**
What does this contrast reveal about the writer's view of modern leisure habits?

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 5) **1**
According to the writer, musicians who play together learn teamwork mainly because their teachers instruct them to cooperate.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
daily practice : visible progress :: _____ : _____

(a) regular music training : better attention and memory

(b) instant downloads : patience and discipline

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) Playing a tune requires reading notation, judging pitch and moving the fingers precisely.
(ii) No other everyday activity gives the mind so complete a workout.
(iii) Several studies have linked music training in childhood with better attention and memory.
(iv) Ten minutes at the piano calms the mind better than scrolling through a phone.
(v) Some adults begin learning the flute at the age of forty.

A. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F
B. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) F
C. (i) O (ii) O (iii) F (iv) F (v) F
D. (i) F (ii) O (iii) O (iv) O (v) O

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in ending the passage with the image of the 'dust cover' that was introduced in paragraph 1? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Public libraries were once written off as dusty buildings that young people would abandon for the internet. The latest figures suggest otherwise. A 2025 survey of 2,400 readers aged 13 to 19, conducted across the public library network of six Indian cities, shows that libraries are quietly reinventing themselves—and teenagers are returning.

(2) Footfall among young members fell by nearly 60% between 2019 and 2021, when reading rooms were closed or opened only for limited hours. Since then, the recovery has been steady. By 2025, the number of visits by readers in this age group was 18% higher than in 2019.

(3) What brings them back? As the table below shows, nearly half of young visitors come mainly for a quiet place to study, while fewer than a third come to borrow books. Many respondents said that their homes were too crowded or noisy for serious study before examinations.

(4) Reading habits are changing too. E-book loans to young members rose from about 12,000 in 2019 to 75,000 in 2025, while loans of printed books fell by only 8% in the same period. Fiction made up 58% of the printed books borrowed by teenagers, with graphic novels the fastest-growing category.

(5) Challenges remain. Four in ten respondents said that library timings clashed with their school and coaching hours. In response, several libraries have begun to stay open until 9 p.m. and to run weekend reading circles, a step that librarians hope will turn occasional visitors into lifelong readers.

Created for academic usage / 248 words

Main reason for visiting the library (2025)	Share of young visitors
A quiet place to study	46%
Borrowing books	31%
Events such as reading clubs and writing workshops	14%
Free computers and Wi-Fi	9%

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The word ‘footfall’ as used in paragraph 2 refers to _____.
(the number of people visiting a place / the sound of footsteps in a building)

II What does the fact that young readers’ visits in 2025 were 18% higher than in 2019 suggest about their attitude towards public libraries? (Paragraph 2) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Borrowing books is the main reason why young readers visit public libraries today.
Reason: Many young readers find their homes too crowded or noisy for serious study.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.

B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.

C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.

D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following are mentioned in paragraph 4 EXCEPT—

A. E-book loans to young members rose more than six times between 2019 and 2025.

B. Loans of printed books fell by less than one-tenth over the same period.

C. Fiction accounted for more than half of the printed books borrowed by teenagers.

D. Graphic novels formed the largest share of printed books borrowed by teenagers.

V Compare the share of young visitors who come for a quiet place to study with those who come to borrow books. What does this suggest about the changing role of public libraries? (Paragraph 3 and the table) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 5) **1**
Several libraries have started staying open until 9 p.m. because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 1 which shows that public libraries were once considered to be of no further use. **1**

VIII Rohan, a Class X student, lives in a small and noisy flat and loves reading comics. Give one way in which his local public library can help him. (Paragraphs 3 and 4) **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Turning a New Page: Teenagers Return to Public Libraries' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed.

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of a formal email: **1**
Dear Mr Verma,
We are pleased to inform you that the annual inter-school music festival _____ on 14 December at the City Auditorium.

A. will be held B. has held C. is holding D. was being held

II Report the coach's instruction to the players. **1**
Coach: "Do not leave the field before the final whistle."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the library notice: **1**
Library Notice
_____ student who borrows a reference book must return it before the library closes on the same day.

A. All B. Every C. Few D. Many

IV Read Arjun's statement to his mother: **1**
"I have finished my science project and I will submit it tomorrow."
Report Arjun's statement by completing the following sentence:
Arjun told his mother that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a school's annual report: **1**
The number of students opting for vocational subjects have risen sharply this year.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from an airline's safety instructions: **1**
Passengers _____ keep their seat belts fastened while the seat-belt sign is on.

A. might B. would C. must D. could

VII The given sentence has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

Neither of the two drafts were approved by the editor yesterday.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	Neither	Either
B.	were	was
C.	approved	approve
D.	yesterday	tomorrow

VIII The receptionist asked the visitor the following question: **1**

"Where did you park your car?"

Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.

The receptionist asked the visitor _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank from a concert advertisement. **1**

Hurry! Only _____ seats are left for Saturday's concert.

A. little B. a few C. much D. a little

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the following line from a student's blog. **1**

My younger sister has been learning the violin since five years.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the music teacher's announcement by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**

You _____ not bring your own instruments to the workshop; the school will provide them. (need / must)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in brackets, from a news report. **1**

By the time the firefighters arrived, the flames _____ (spread) to the second floor of the building.

WRITING

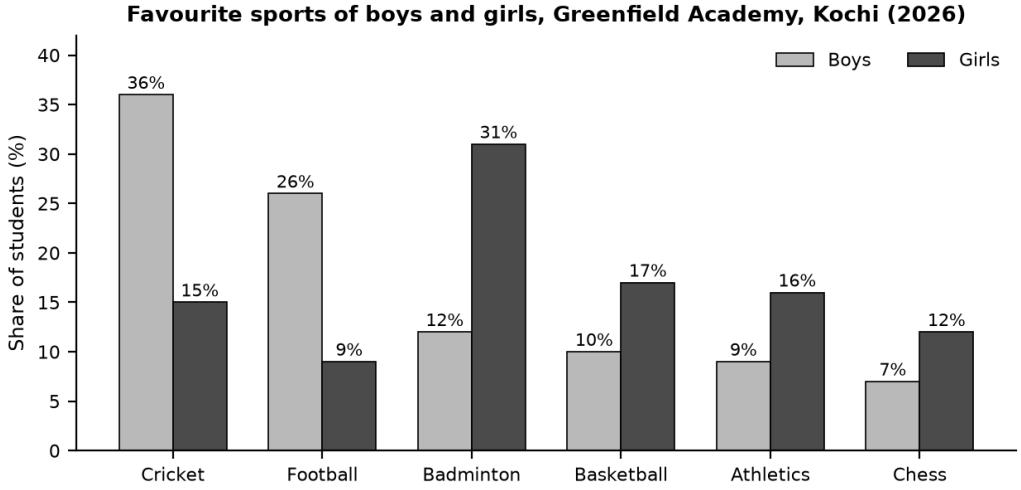
NOTE: All details presented in the questions in the writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Aditya/Aditi Rao, a resident of 42, Lake View Colony, Bhopal. Recent news reports show a sharp rise in road accidents in your city involving students below eighteen years of age driving motorbikes, scooters and cars, often without a licence or a helmet. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily in 120 words, expressing your concern over the rising road accidents caused by underage driving and suggesting measures to check it. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Rohan/Ritu Deshpande, Activity In-charge, Sunrise Public School, Nagpur. Your school is setting up a new music room. Write a letter in 120 words to M/s Swaranjali Music House, Civil Lines, Nagpur, placing an order for musical instruments. Mention the items, their quantities and specifications, the mode of payment and the expected date of delivery. **5**

5 A. The bar graph below shows the favourite sports of 480 students (240 boys and 240 girls) of Classes VI to X at Greenfield Academy, Kochi, as found in a survey conducted in 2026. **5**



Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, comparing the preferences of boys and girls shown in the graph and suggesting possible reasons for them.

OR

5 B. Read the product details of a language-learning app subscription listed on an app store. **5**

BhashaSetu Premium – Annual Subscription

- Courses in 12 languages, including French, German, Spanish, Japanese and six Indian languages
- Ten-minute daily lessons designed by experienced language teachers; levels from beginner to advanced
- Speech-recognition tool that checks and corrects pronunciation
- Offline mode: download lessons and learn without the internet
- Weekly live conversation sessions with native speakers
- Progress reports, and a certificate on completing each level
- ₹1,499 a year (about ₹125 a month); 7-day free trial; family plan for up to 4 users at ₹2,499 a year

Now, analyse why this subscription would be a useful choice for school students who wish to learn a new language. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as content, flexibility, features and value for money.

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A

He stepped slowly out to the brink of the ledge, and standing on one leg with the other leg hidden under his wing, he closed one eye, then the other, and pretended to be falling asleep. Still they took no notice of him. He saw his two brothers and his sister lying on the plateau dozing with their heads sunk into their necks. His father was preening the feathers on his white back. Only his mother was looking at him. She was standing on a little high hump on the plateau, her white breast thrust forward. Now and again, she tore at a piece of fish that lay at her feet and then scrapped each side of her beak on the rock. The sight of the food maddened him. (Two Stories about Flying – His First Flight)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The young seagull pretends to be falling asleep in order to _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
The line 'Only his mother was looking at him' suggests that the mother _____.

A. had completely given up hope of her son ever flying
B. was angry with him for disturbing the family's rest
C. was keeping a watchful eye on him in spite of her apparent indifference
D. was enjoying the fish and wanted to tease him

III How does the mother's act of tearing at the fish in full view of the young seagull serve as a deliberate strategy? Explain. **2**

IV Fill in the blank with the correct option from the bracket. **1**
The word 'preening' suggests that the father was _____. (grooming his feathers / searching for food)

OR

B

That evening, after I'd finished the rest of my homework, the note about the essay caught my eye. I began thinking about the subject while chewing the tip of my fountain pen. Anyone could ramble on and leave big spaces between the words, but the trick was to come up with convincing arguments to prove the necessity of talking. I thought and thought, and suddenly I had an idea. I wrote the three pages Mr Keesing had assigned me and was satisfied. I argued that talking is a student's trait and that I would do my best to keep it under control, but that I would never be able to cure myself of the habit since my mother talked as much as I did if not more, and that there's not much you can do about inherited traits. (From the Diary of Anne Frank)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
Anne's remark that 'anyone could ramble on and leave big spaces between the words' shows that she _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
Anne's argument about 'inherited traits' can best be described as _____.

A. a witty and clever justification of her habit
B. an angry protest against her teacher
C. a sincere confession of guilt
D. a serious complaint against her mother

III What does the extract reveal about Anne's attitude towards the punishment given to her by Mr Keesing? Explain. **2**

IV Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The detail 'chewing the tip of my fountain pen' shows that Anne was deep in _____.

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A

The way a crow
Shook down on me
The dust of snow
From a hemlock tree

Has given my heart
A change of mood

And saved some part
Of a day I had rued.

(Dust of Snow)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The poet's choice of a crow and a hemlock tree, which are usually associated with gloom, shows that _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
The word 'rued' in the last line means _____.

A. celebrated B. planned C. forgotten D. regretted

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
In the course of the poem, the poet's mood changes from regret to _____.

IV How does the poem show that a small, ordinary moment in nature can have a lasting effect on human emotions? **2**

OR

B

But if it had to perish twice,
I think I know enough of hate
To say that for destruction ice
Is also great
And would suffice.

(Fire and Ice)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
In the extract, 'ice' stands for _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
The phrase 'if it had to perish twice' suggests that the poet _____.

A. firmly believes that the world will actually end twice
B. imagines a second end of the world in order to weigh two destructive forces
C. is terrified of the coming end of the world
D. wishes that the world would end soon

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The word 'suffice' suggests that hate would be _____ to destroy the world.

IV What does the speaker's claim, 'I think I know enough of hate' reveal, and how does it strengthen his argument? **2**

8. Answer any FOUR of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words each. **4x3 =12**

I The story ends with Lencho calling the post office employees 'a bunch of crooks'. How does this ending bring out the irony of the story? **3**

(A Letter to God)

II "The brave man is not he who does not feel afraid, but he who conquers that fear." How did Mandela arrive at this understanding of courage? **3**

(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

III How does the poet contrast the tiger's life in the zoo with the life it ought to be living in the wild? **3**

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

IV What does the 'old religious man' suggest about true love, and why is this significant for the young girl in the poem? **3**

(For Anne Gregory)

V How does the writer establish that the people of Coorg are a brave, martial race with a distinct identity? **3**

(Glimpses of India – Coorg)

9. Answer any TWO of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words each. **2x3 =6**

I Horace Danby was a careful planner, yet a young woman tricked him easily. How did she deceive him, and what mistake of his led to his arrest? **3**

(A Question of Trust)

II Why did Griffin find it difficult to survive in London after he became invisible? How did he try to overcome this difficulty? **3**

(Footprints without Feet)

III "Richard Ebright's mother played an important role in making him a scientist." Justify the statement with reference to the story. **3**

(The Making of a Scientist)

10. Answer any ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A Kisa Gotami moves from personal grief to an understanding of a universal truth. How does the Buddha's method of teaching through experience, rather than through explanation, help her find peace?

(The Sermon at Benares)

OR

B Lomov comes to propose marriage to Natalya but ends up quarrelling over Oxen Meadows and the dogs. How does Chekhov use these quarrels to satirise the attitude of rich landowners towards marriage?

(The Proposal)

11. Answer any ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A M. Loisel's quiet sacrifices stand in sharp contrast to his wife's vanity. Write a character sketch of M. Loisel, showing why he may be called the real hero of the story.

(The Necklace)

OR

B 'Bholi' exposes the neglect of the girl child and the evil of dowry in our society. How does Bholi's refusal at her wedding challenge these evils? What message does the story give to society?

(Bholi)

***

SAMPLE PAPER 10

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

MARKING SCHEME · SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 10 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. MARKING SCHEME **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. The Marking Scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers / sample answers. The value points are in the nature of guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. The students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, then due marks should be awarded accordingly.
2. If a student has attempted an extra question, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note "Extra Question".
3. If more than one option is mentioned in the answer of multiple choice questions, then no marks are to be awarded.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

Discursive Passage

1. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I	It suggests that many instruments are bought with great enthusiasm but are soon abandoned and left unused/neglected in homes.	1
II	(a) learning an instrument demands steady, regular practice over a long period and cannot be rushed.	1
III	**C.** A drummer reading a score while keeping time with both hands and feet	1
IV	The contrast reveals that the writer finds modern leisure habits hurried and shallow. Instant downloads, ten-second videos and endless scrolling give quick pleasure but build neither patience nor calm (1). An instrument, by contrast, rewards slow, steady effort, teaches discipline and offers a deeper emotional outlet; the writer clearly values such meaningful leisure over passive entertainment (1).	2
V	False	1
VI	(a) regular music training : better attention and memory [Just as daily practice leads to visible progress, regular music training leads to better attention and memory: an effort and the benefit it produces. Option (b) breaks the relationship, as instant downloads do not lead to patience and discipline.]	1
VII	**B.** (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) F	1
VIII	By returning to the dust cover, the writer brings the passage full circle and links the forgotten instrument of the opening to a direct call to action (1). It leaves the reader with a gentle, personal invitation to begin, or resume, playing the neglected instrument at home, which makes the argument persuasive and memorable (1).	2

Case-Based Passage

2. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. **10**

Answer

I	the number of people visiting a place	1
II	It suggests that young readers value public libraries; they came back by choice and in greater numbers than before, so the decline was temporary and not a loss of interest.	1
III	**D.** The assertion is false, but the reason is true.	1
IV	**D.** Graphic novels formed the largest share of printed books borrowed by teenagers. [They were the fastest-growing category, not the largest; fiction made up 58%.]	1
V	46% of young visitors come mainly for a quiet place to study, compared with 31% who come to borrow books, i.e. 15 percentage points more (1). This suggests that libraries are changing from places that mainly lend books into community spaces for study, learning and activities, especially for students who lack a quiet place at home (1).	2
VI	four in ten young readers said that library timings clashed with their school and coaching hours (so longer hours make the library accessible to them).	1

VII ‘written off’ (as dusty buildings) **1**

VIII Any one: **1**
– He can use the library’s quiet reading room to study for his board examinations.
– He can borrow graphic novels/comics or e-books, or join the weekend reading circles.

IX Any one: **1**
– ‘Turning a New Page’ suggests a fresh start, and the passage shows libraries reinventing themselves while teenagers return, with visits 18% above the 2019 level.
– The title covers all key ideas: the recovery in footfall, new reasons for visiting, changing reading habits and the steps libraries are taking.

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR (10 marks)

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **1x10**
Answer *Award 1 mark for each correct answer (any ten). In the error-correction items, ½ mark for identifying the error + ½ mark for the correct word.* **=10**

I **A.** will be held **1**

II The coach ordered/instructed/told the players not to leave the field before the final whistle. **1**

III **B.** Every **1**

IV he had finished his science project and (that he) would submit it the next day/the following day. **1**

V Error: have **(½)** Correction: has **(½)** **1**

VI **C.** must **1**

VII **B.** were – was **1**

VIII where he/she had parked his/her car. **1**

IX **B.** a few **1**

X Error: since **(½)** Correction: for **(½)** **1**

XI need **1**

XII had spread **1**

WRITING SKILLS (10 marks)

4. Format – 1 Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 1 Accuracy – 1 **1x5**
Answer **=5**

Criterion	Marks
Format: sender’s address, date, receiver’s address, subject, salutation, complimentary close, name/designation	1
Content: relevant, adequate ideas as given in the value points	2
Organisation of ideas: coherence, logical sequencing and paragraphing	1
Accuracy: grammar, spelling and punctuation	1

Marks: Format (1) + Content (2) + Organisation of ideas (1) + Accuracy (1) = 5

A The response may be created from the following content points. **Content (2): ½ mark for each value point.** **4**
– **Issue and context:** sharp rise in road accidents caused by students below eighteen driving motorbikes, scooters and cars, often without a licence or helmet **(½)**
– **Causes and effects:** overspeeding, rash driving and lack of training; parents handing over vehicles; injuries and loss of young lives; danger to pedestrians and other road users **(½)**
– **Measures:** checking of vehicles near schools and coaching centres; fines on parents/vehicle owners as per law; road-safety workshops in schools; awareness campaigns; parents refusing to let minors drive **(½)**
– **Appeal:** request to the newspaper to highlight the issue and to the authorities to act firmly and promptly **(½)**

Model Answer (137 words)
42, Lake View Colony
Bhopal
12 March 20XX

The Editor
The Daily Chronicle
Bhopal

Subject: Rising road accidents caused by underage driving

Sir/Madam
Through the columns of your esteemed daily, I wish to express my concern over the alarming rise in road accidents caused by underage drivers in our city.
Every day, students below eighteen speed through crowded streets on motorbikes and in cars, often without helmets or licences. Many parents hand over the keys proudly, unaware of the danger. Last month alone, three teenagers were seriously injured near our colony.
The traffic police must check vehicles near schools and coaching centres and fine the parents of offenders. Schools should hold road-safety workshops, and parents must refuse to let minors drive.
I hope the authorities act before more young lives are lost.

Yours faithfully
Aditi Rao

OR

B The response may be created from the following content points. **Content (2): ½ mark for each value point.** **4**

- **Purpose:** placing an order for musical instruments for the school's new music room; reference to the catalogue/price list **(½)**
- **Order details** (in a clear list or table with quantity and specifications), e.g. harmonium (3-octave, scale-changer) – 2; tabla set with cushions – 2; acoustic guitars (full size) – 4; electronic keyboard (61 keys) with stand – 2; flutes – 6 **(½)**
- **Terms:** mode of payment (cheque/online transfer on delivery), expected discount for an educational institution, delivery by a specific date, free installation/tuning, replacement of damaged items **(½)**
- **Closing:** request for an early confirmation and the bill/invoice **(½)**

Marks: Format (1) + Content (2) + Organisation of ideas (1) + Accuracy (1) = 5

5. Content – 2 Organisation of ideas – 2 Accuracy – 1 **1x5 =5**

Answer

Analytical paragraph writing should NOT be confused with writing a description of given elements or writing a summary. It requires examining the given elements closely and sharing inputs based on the given stimulus. It carries no title or heading.

Criterion	Marks
Content: correct reading and interpretation of the data/cues; comparison; reasons; conclusion	2
Organisation of ideas: introduction, logical sequencing of points, conclusion	2
Accuracy: grammar, spelling and punctuation	1

Marks: Content (2) + Organisation of ideas (2) + Accuracy (1) = 5

A The response may be created from the following points. **Content (2): any four value points, ½ mark each.**

- **Introduction:** the graph compares the favourite sports of 240 boys and 240 girls of Greenfield Academy, Kochi (2026) **(½)**
- **Boys:** cricket most popular (36%), followed by football (26%); badminton 12%, basketball 10%, athletics 9%, chess 7% **(½)**
- **Girls:** badminton most popular (31%), followed by basketball (17%) and athletics (16%); cricket 15%, chess 12%, football 9% **(½)**
- **Comparison:** cricket and football preferred far more by boys; badminton, basketball, athletics and chess more by girls; chess least popular overall **(½)**
- **Possible reasons:** media coverage of cricket and football; availability of indoor courts; role models; school facilities **(½)**
- **Conclusion:** the school should offer a wide range of sports to suit every student **(½)**

Model Answer (126 words)
The bar graph compares the favourite sports of boys and girls at Greenfield Academy, Kochi. Cricket is the boys' first choice (36%), followed by football (26%), while only 15% and 9% of girls prefer these games. Girls, on the other hand, favour badminton most (31%), against just 12% of boys. Basketball and athletics are also more popular among girls (17% and 16%) than boys (10% and 9%). Chess attracts the smallest share of both groups, though slightly more girls (12%) than boys (7%) choose it. These differences may reflect the greater media coverage of cricket and football and the easy availability of indoor courts for badminton. Overall, the school should offer a wide range of sports so that every student finds a game to enjoy.

Marks: Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 2 (introduction, logical sequence, conclusion) + Accuracy 1 = 5

OR

B The response may be created from the following points. **Content (2): any four value points, ½ mark each.**

- **Content:** 12 languages, including foreign and Indian languages; lessons designed by experienced teachers; levels from beginner to advanced **(½)**
- **Flexibility:** ten-minute daily lessons fit around school and homework; offline mode allows learning without the internet **(½)**
- **Features:** speech-recognition tool corrects pronunciation; weekly live conversation sessions with native speakers build speaking confidence; progress reports and certificates motivate learners **(½)**
- **Value for money:** ₹1,499 a year (about ₹125 a month); 7-day free trial to test before paying; family plan for up to 4 users at ₹2,499 **(½)**
- **Conclusion:** an affordable, flexible and effective way for students to learn a new language **(½)**

Model Answer (122 words)
BhashaSetu Premium offers school students a practical way to learn a new language. Its courses cover 12 languages, from French and Japanese to six Indian languages, and are designed by experienced teachers for every level. Ten-minute daily lessons fit easily around school and homework, while the offline mode allows learning even without the internet. The speech-recognition tool corrects pronunciation, and weekly live sessions with native speakers build real speaking confidence. Progress reports and certificates keep learners motivated. At ₹1,499 a year, about ₹125 a month, it is affordable, and the 7-day free trial lets students test it before paying. A family plan for four users adds further value. Overall, the app is a flexible, effective and economical choice for young learners.

Marks: Content 2 + Organisation of ideas 2 (introduction, logical sequence, conclusion) + Accuracy 1 = 5

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Extract-based questions (any one of A and B) **5**

Answer

A **Two Stories about Flying – His First Flight**

I attract the attention of his family/make them notice him and bring him food (accept: to seek sympathy). **1**

II **C.** was keeping a watchful eye on him in spite of her apparent indifference **1**

III The mother deliberately eats the fish where the hungry young seagull can see it, so that the sight of food will madden him (1). She then flies towards him with a piece of fish and stops just out of reach; driven by hunger, he dives at it, falls off the ledge and discovers that he can fly. Her apparent cruelty is a planned lesson in tough love (1). **2**

IV grooming his feathers **1**

B **From the Diary of Anne Frank**

I wanted to write a meaningful essay with convincing arguments rather than simply fill three pages (she took the task seriously). **1**

II **A.** a witty and clever justification of her habit **1**

III Anne does not resent the punishment or treat it as a disgrace (½); she accepts it as a challenge and takes it sportingly (½). She thinks hard, writes the required three pages and uses wit and clever reasoning (talking as a student's trait, inherited from her mother) to defend her habit, which shows her confidence and good humour (1). **2**

IV thought (accept: thinking/concentration/reflection) **1**

7. Extract-based questions (any one of A and B) **5**

Answer

A **Dust of Snow**

I joy and comfort can come from the most ordinary or unexpected sources/even things associated with gloom can lift one's spirits. **1**

II **D.** regretted **1**

III happiness (accept: joy/cheerfulness/hope/relief) **1**

IV A crow shaking down a little snow from a hemlock tree is a tiny, everyday event, yet it changes the poet's mood (1). It saves the rest of a day that he had regretted, showing that nature has the power to heal and that a small moment can turn sorrow into hope (1). **2**

B **Fire and Ice**

I hate (accept: coldness, indifference, rigidity and lack of feeling). **1**

II **B.** imagines a second end of the world in order to weigh two destructive forces **1**

III enough (accept: sufficient/adequate) **1**

IV The claim shows that the speaker has personally experienced or observed hatred and its cold, hardening effect on people (1). Because he speaks from experience rather than theory, his conclusion that ice (hate) is as destructive as fire (desire) sounds credible and convincing (1). **2**

8. Answer any FOUR of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words each. **4x3 =12**

Answer

I **A Letter to God** **Content (2):** any two of these value points, 1 mark each: **3**

– Lencho had complete faith that God would send the hundred pesos **(1)**
– The postmaster and his employees collected money out of charity; they could send only seventy pesos **(1)**
– Lencho blamed the very people who had helped him, calling them 'a bunch of crooks'; the benefactors were treated as thieves, which is the irony **(1)**

Model Answer (51 words)
The ending is deeply ironic. Moved by Lencho's faith, the postmaster and his employees gave part of their salaries and sent him seventy pesos. Lencho, who never doubted God, assumed that the missing money had been stolen and called his kind helpers 'a bunch of crooks'. Charity was repaid with suspicion.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark overall)

II **Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom** **Content (2):** any two of these value points, 1 mark each: **3**

– Mandela saw comrades risk their lives, stand up to attacks and torture without breaking **(1)**
– He realised that courage is not the absence of fear but the triumph over it **(1)**
– He felt fear many times himself but hid it behind a mask of boldness **(1)**

Model Answer (52 words)
Mandela learned this from the men and women who fought apartheid. He saw them risk everything and stand up to attacks and torture without breaking. He felt fear more times than he could remember, but hid it behind boldness. He realised that true courage is the triumph over fear, not its absence.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark overall)

III **A Tiger in the Zoo** **Content (2):** any two of these value points, 1 mark each: **3**

– In the zoo: stalks the length of his small cage with quiet rage, locked in a concrete cell, strolling, ignoring visitors, listening to patrolling cars at night **(1)**
– In the wild: lurking in shadow and long grass near the water hole to hunt deer; snarling around houses at the jungle's edge, baring his white fangs **(1)**
– Contrast shows the cruelty of captivity: strength, freedom and dignity are lost **(1)**

Model Answer (51 words)
In the zoo, the tiger stalks the length of his cage in quiet rage, locked in a concrete cell, ignoring visitors. In the wild, he would lurk in long grass near the water hole for plump deer and terrorise villages, baring his white fangs. The contrast exposes the cruelty of captivity.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark overall)

IV **For Anne Gregory** **Content (2):** any two of these value points, 1 mark each: **3**

– Young men admire Anne for her 'great honey-coloured ramparts', her yellow hair **(1)**
– The old religious man found a text proving that only God could love her for herself alone and not her yellow hair **(1)**

– True love looks beyond appearance to inner worth; human love is often shaped by physical beauty, so Anne must not expect to be loved for herself alone **(1)**

Model Answer (51 words)
Anne wants to be loved for herself, not for her hair. The speaker quotes an old religious man who found a text proving that only God could love her for herself alone and not her yellow hair. True love sees inner worth, while human love is often drawn by outward beauty.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark overall)

V **Glimpses of India – Coorg** **Content (2):** any two of these value points, 1 mark each: **3**

– Coorg is inhabited by 'a proud race of martial men'; possibly descended from a part of Alexander's army, or of Arab origin **(1)**
– Kodavus wear the kuppia, which resembles the Arab kuffia; distinct martial traditions, marriage and religious rites **(1)**
– The Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated in the Indian Army; General Cariappa, the first Chief of the Indian Army, was a Coorgi; Kodavus are the only people in India permitted to carry firearms without a licence **(1)**

Model Answer (51 words)
The writer calls the Kodavus 'a proud race of martial men', possibly descended from Alexander's soldiers or Arabs. Their dress, the kuppia, and their rites are distinct from the mainstream. The Coorg Regiment is among the most decorated, General Cariappa was a Coorgi, and Kodavus may carry firearms without a licence.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark overall)

9. Answer any TWO of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words each. **2x3 =6**

Answer

I **A Question of Trust** **Content (2):** any two of these value points, 1 mark each: **3**

– The young lady in red acted like the lady of the house: the dog Sherry rubbed against her, she straightened the ornaments and spoke kindly but firmly **(1)**
– She said she had come from London for her jewels to wear to a party and had forgotten the numbers to open the safe; Horace, desperate to avoid prison, agreed to help **(1)**
– Eager to please her, he took off his gloves to light her cigarette and opened the safe without them; his fingerprints led to his arrest, and the real owner, a gray-haired woman of sixty, called his story nonsense **(1)**

Model Answer (48 words)
The lady in red behaved like the owner: Sherry greeted her and she spoke kindly but firmly. Claiming she had forgotten the safe's combination, she won his help. Eager to please her, Horace took off his gloves and opened the safe, leaving fingerprints that led to his arrest.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark overall)

II **Footprints without Feet** **Content (2):** any two of these value points, 1 mark each: **3**

– It was mid-winter in London; the air was bitterly cold and he could not do without clothes, but clothes would make him visible **(1)**
– He slipped into a big London store, dressed himself, ate cold meat and coffee and slept on a pile of quilts; he overslept, was chased by the assistants and had to throw off the clothes to escape **(1)**
– In a theatrical shop in Drury Lane he got bandages, dark glasses, a false nose, big bushy side-whiskers and a large hat to hide his invisibility **(1)**

Model Answer (50 words)
It was bitterly cold mid-winter, and Griffin could not survive without clothes, yet clothes made him visible. He hid in a big London store, dressed and slept on quilts, but overslept and had to flee. At a Drury Lane shop he took bandages, dark glasses, a false nose and whiskers.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark overall)

III **The Making of a Scientist** **Content (2):** any two of these value points, 1 mark each: **3**

– She encouraged his interest in learning: took him on trips, bought him telescopes, microscopes, cameras and mounting materials **(1)**
– After his father died (when Richard was in third grade) she was his companion and found learning work for him every evening at the dining table **(1)**
– She got him the book 'The Travels of Monarch X', which opened the world of science to him, and wrote to Dr Urquhart, which led to his tagging monarch butterflies **(1)**

Model Answer (48 words)
Ebright's mother encouraged his curiosity, taking him on trips and buying him telescopes, microscopes and cameras. After his father's death she found learning work for him every evening. She gave him 'The Travels of Monarch X' and wrote to Dr Urquhart, opening the world of science to him.

Marks: Content 2 + Expression 1 = 3 (Accuracy: deduct up to 1 mark overall)

10. Answer any ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**
Answer
Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A **The Sermon at Benares Content (3):** any three of these value points, 1 mark each:
- Kisa Gotami's only son died; in grief she went from house to house seeking medicine **(1)**
- The Buddha asked her for a handful of mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend **(1)**
- She found no such house: 'the living are few, but the dead are many' **(1)**
- Watching the city lights flicker and go out, she realised that death is common to all and that she had been selfish in her grief **(1)**
- Learning through her own experience made the truth convincing; she accepted it and found peace **(1)**

Model Answer (120 words)
When her only son died, Kisa Gotami went from house to house begging for medicine to bring him back. Instead of explaining that death cannot be undone, the Buddha asked her to bring a handful of mustard seed from a house where no one had lost a child, husband, parent or friend. Eager to save her son, she set out at once, but every house had lost someone; 'the living are few, but the dead are many'. Sitting by the wayside, she watched the lights of the city flicker and go out and understood that death is common to all. By discovering this truth herself, she accepted it fully, realised she had been selfish in her grief and found peace.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B **The Proposal Content (3):** any three of these value points, 1 mark each:
- Lomov wants to marry for convenience: age, health, Natalya is a good housekeeper; Chubukov is eager to marry off his daughter to a rich neighbour **(1)**
- Quarrel over Oxen Meadows (five dessiatins, worth perhaps 300 roubles) and over the dogs Guess and Squeezer; insults to each other's families **(1)**
- Lomov's hypochondria (palpitations, numb leg) adds to the farce **(1)**
- Even after agreeing to marry, they quarrel again; Chubukov calls for champagne **(1)**
- Satire: marriage among rich landowners is a deal for property and status; pride and possessions outweigh love **(1)**

Model Answer (115 words)
Lomov proposes not out of love but because he is 35, 'a critical age', and Natalya is 'an excellent housekeeper, not bad-looking, well-educated'. Chubukov is only too eager to marry off his daughter to a wealthy neighbour. Yet before the proposal is made, Lomov and Natalya quarrel bitterly over Oxen Meadows, worth perhaps 300 roubles, and later over whether Guess or Squeezer is the better dog. Both sides insult each other's families, and Lomov, a hypochondriac, almost faints. When Chubukov finally joins their hands, they agree to marry but resume quarrelling at once. Through this farce Chekhov shows that, for rich landowners, marriage is a property deal, and pride and possessions matter more than love.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

11. Answer any ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**
Answer
Content – 3 Expression – 2 Accuracy – 1

A **The Necklace Content (3):** any three of these value points, 1 mark each:
- A petty clerk in the Board of Education; loving husband who brought home the invitation to the Minister's ball to please Matilda **(1)**
- Self-sacrificing: gave her the four hundred francs he had saved for a gun for lark-shooting; patiently waited, half asleep in a little salon at the ball, from midnight till four **(1)**
- Responsible and resourceful when the necklace was lost: searched the route on foot, went to the police and cab offices, advertised a reward **(1)**
- Bore the burden: spent the eighteen thousand francs left by his father, borrowed the rest from usurers, worked evenings on merchants' accounts and copied at night at five sous a page for ten years **(1)**
- Never blamed his wife; quiet, dutiful and uncomplaining – the real hero, in contrast to Matilda's vanity **(1)**

Model Answer (122 words)
M. Loisel, a petty clerk in the Board of Education, is a loving and self-sacrificing husband. He brought home the invitation to the Minister's ball to please Matilda and gave her the four hundred francs he had saved to buy a gun for lark-shooting. At the ball he waited, half asleep in a small salon, till four in the morning. When the necklace was lost, he searched the route on foot, went to the police and cab offices and advertised a reward. He spent the eighteen thousand francs left by his father and borrowed the rest from usurers. For ten years he kept books for merchants and copied documents at night. Uncomplaining and dutiful, he is the real hero of the story.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

OR

B **Bholi Content (3):** any three of these value points, 1 mark each:

- Neglect of the girl child: pock-marked and stammering, Bholi was called a simpleton and sent to school only because her parents felt no one would marry her **(1)**
- Parents accepted Bishamber – a lame man almost Ramlal's age with grown-up children – mainly because he asked for no dowry **(1)**
- At the wedding he demanded five thousand rupees after seeing her pock-marks; Ramlal placed his turban at his feet and paid **(1)**
- Bholi flung the garland into the fire and, without a stammer, refused to marry a mean, greedy and contemptible coward; she would serve her parents and teach in her school **(1)**
- Message: education gives girls confidence and a voice; girls deserve equal respect; dowry must be rejected **(1)**

Model Answer (118 words)
'Bholi' shows how girls are neglected and how dowry humiliates families. Pock-marked and stammering, Bholi was called a simpleton and sent to school only because her parents felt no one would marry her. They accepted Bishamber, a lame man almost Ramlal's age, because he asked for no dowry. At the wedding, seeing her pock-marks, he demanded five thousand rupees, and Ramlal placed his turban at his feet and paid. Bholi flung the garland into the fire and declared, without a stammer, that she would not marry such a mean, greedy coward. She chose to serve her parents and teach in her school. The story teaches that education gives girls a voice and that dowry must be firmly rejected.

Marks: Content 3 + Expression 2 + Accuracy 1 = 6

Marks Summary

Section A: Reading Skills	Section B: Writing Skills and Grammar	Section C: Literature Textbook	Total
20	20	40	**80**

***

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · similar to Q4 (A) (letter to the Editor) answer book p.18

4. A. C-63
Canvel
Mumbai - 400012

27 February 2023

The Editor
The Times Of India
24 Beach Road
Mumbai - 400005

Subject :- Pitiable condition of child labourers

Dear Sir / Madam

This is to bring to your notice, a pressing issue in today's society, ~~~~ about which I recently came across in a magazine article.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · letter to the Editor (contd.) answer book p.19

The article described the hazardous conditions that underage children are subjected to. Most of them belong to families living below the poverty line. Hence, school education is a distant dream for them. To supplement their family incomes, they are ~~~~ coerced to work in dimly lit factories, tea stalls and in garages. To my absolute shock, the children in factories must work with sharp tools, capable of injuring them. Accompanying the article was a photograph of a young boy employed in a tea stall. The pain in his eyes was heart-wrenching. To make matters worse, most of them are ill-treated by their employers. The youth make up a large part of our nation's population. Children are our future, and if we do not protect them, who will?

As vigilant citizens, it is our responsibility to eradicate this menace. Boycott of enterprises ~~~~ utilising child labour will force them to shut down. Providing low-

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · similar to Q5 (A) (letter ends; analytical paragraph on a data table begins) answer book p.20

cost education to these children will go a long way. Government agencies must take a more pro-active approach through surprise checks and hefty penalties. I hope fervently that this national problem is brought to the notice of the authorities concerned through the columns of your esteemed newspaper and the necessary measures are taken.

Yours truly

~~Jyoti~~

(Anjali)

5. A

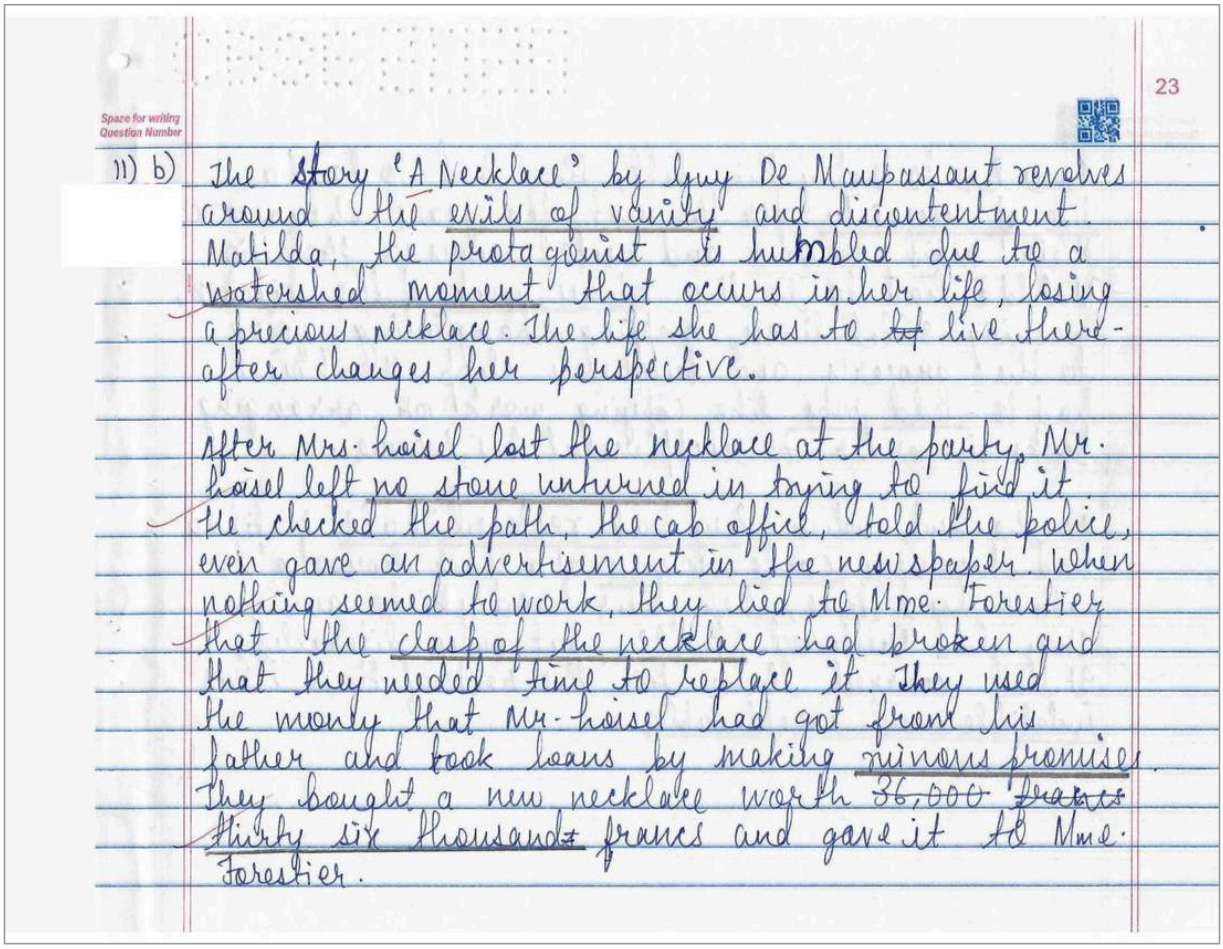
The Issue Of Air Pollution

The given table provides the pollution figures of some major Indian towns and cities. The data includes ~~the~~ three major air pollutants namely, suspended particulate matter, sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides, their

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2023 · analytical paragraph (contd.) answer book p.21

permissible levels and their levels in Ludhiana, Delhi, Mumbai and Chennai. The levels of suspended particulate matter in all four cities (453 in Ludhiana, 680 in Delhi, 435 in Mumbai and 262 in Chennai) far exceed the permissible level of 200. The abnormal levels of particulate matter may be attributed to the smoke and dust released by vehicles in these well-developed cities, apart from burning of agricultural produce in Delhi and Ludhiana. The permissible levels of both sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide are 80. The high proportions of sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide in Delhi (124 and 137 respectively) are alarming. However, in the other cities, these are fortunately well within the limit. The sulphur dioxide levels are lowest in Ludhiana at 20, followed by Mumbai at 27 and then Chennai at 45. The levels of nitrogen oxide follow the opposite trend with Chennai at 34 and then Mumbai at 53 and Ludhiana at 64. It is evident that air pollution is a major issue affecting big towns and cities in

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · similar to Q11 (A) (long answer, The Necklace) answer book p.23



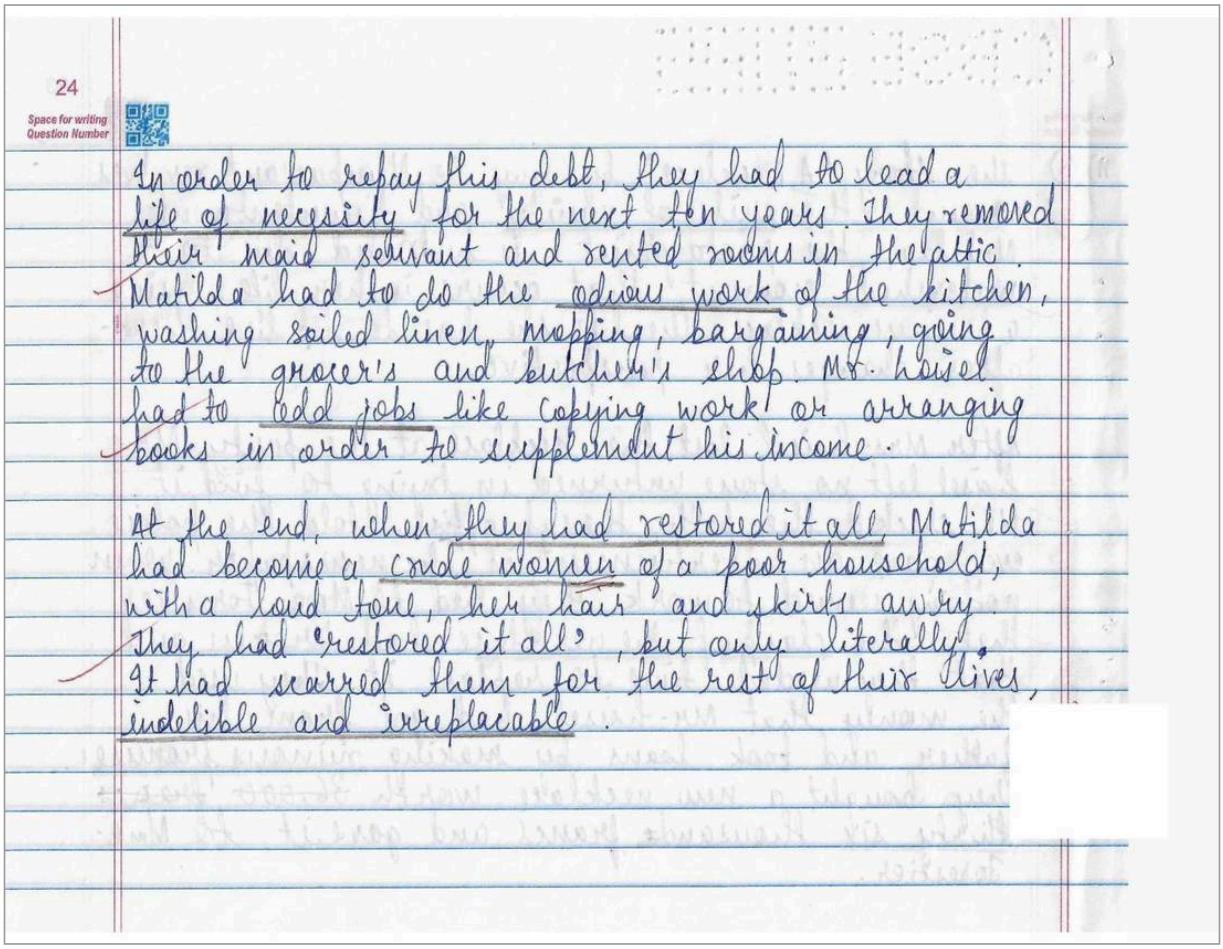
23

Space for writing Question Number

11) b) The story 'A Necklace' by Guy De Maupassant revolves around the evils of vanity and discontentment. Matilda, the protagonist is humbled due to a watershed moment that occurs in her life, losing a precious necklace. The life she has to ~~to~~ live thereafter changes her perspective.

After Mrs. Loisel lost the necklace at the party, Mr. Loisel left no stone unturned in trying to find it. He checked the path, the cab office, told the police, even gave an advertisement in the newspaper. When nothing seemed to work, they lied to Mme. Forestier that the clasp of the necklace had broken and that they needed time to replace it. They used the money that Mr. Loisel had got from his father and took loans by making ruinous promises. They bought a new necklace worth ~~36,000 francs~~ thirty six thousand francs and gave it to Mme. Forestier.

Real CBSE topper's answer · Board Exam 2025 · long answer, The Necklace (contd.) answer book p.24



24

Space for writing Question Number

In order to repay this debt, they had to lead a life of necessity for the next ten years. They removed their maid servant and rented rooms in the attic. Matilda had to do the odious work of the kitchen, washing soiled linen, mopping, bargaining, going to the grocer's and butcher's shop. Mr. Loisel had to odd jobs like copying work or arranging books in order to supplement his income.

At the end, when they had restored it all, Matilda had become a crude women of a poor household, with a loud tone, her hair and skirts awry. They had 'restored it all', but only literally. It had scarred them for the rest of their lives, indelible and irreplacable.

SAMPLE PAPER 11

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 11 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Step out of a crowded metro station in any large Indian city and the first thing you notice is concrete: flyovers, glass towers and parking lots stretching in every direction. Somewhere between them, if you are lucky, there is a small park with a few benches, a jogging track and a cluster of neem trees. It is easy to dismiss such patches as mere decoration. Yet researchers increasingly argue that these modest green islands may be among the most valuable public health tools a city possesses.

(2) Consider what urban life does to the mind. Noise, traffic, long commutes and the constant glow of screens keep the nervous system on alert. Psychologists describe a condition called ‘directed attention fatigue’*, the mental exhaustion that follows hours of forced concentration. Studies conducted in several countries have found that even a twenty-minute walk among trees can lower the level of cortisol, the body’s stress hormone, and improve the ability to concentrate afterwards. Nature, it seems, gives the overworked brain a chance to rest without falling asleep.

(3) The benefits are not only individual. A well-kept neighbourhood park is one of the few places where strangers meet as equals. Grandparents watch children on the swings, college students play cricket and vendors sell roasted corn at the gate. These small, repeated encounters build a sense of belonging, and loneliness, which doctors now treat as a serious risk to health, quietly loosens its grip.

(4) Unfortunately, green space is rarely shared fairly. Wealthier localities often enjoy landscaped gardens, while crowded settlements may have none within walking distance. When land prices rise, a vacant plot is far more likely to become a mall than a meadow. The people who would gain the most from a place to breathe are frequently the ones left without it.

(5) The good news is that greening a city need not be expensive. Rooftop gardens, tree-lined footpaths, pocket parks on unused corners and restored lakes can all make a difference. Some municipal bodies have begun involving residents’ welfare associations in maintaining parks, which keeps costs low and gives citizens a sense of ownership.

(6) Perhaps the real question is not whether we can afford green spaces, but whether we can afford to lose them. A city is more than a machine for working and travelling; it is a place where people must live. If we want calmer, kinder and healthier communities, we may need to measure progress not only in kilometres of road, but also in the number of trees a child can see from her window.

*directed attention fatigue: a state of mental tiredness caused by long periods of concentrating on demanding tasks

Created for academic usage / 421 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In Paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'modest green islands' suggest about city parks? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says, 'Nature, it seems, gives the overworked brain a chance to rest without falling asleep', he means that _____. (Paragraph 2)

(a) time spent in natural surroundings refreshes the mind even while one remains awake and active.

(b) people who walk in parks usually feel sleepy and need to lie down afterwards.

III The writer mentions 'small, repeated encounters' in Paragraph 3. **1**
Which of the following is an example of such an encounter?

A. A resident greeting the same group of morning walkers in the park every day

B. A tourist visiting a famous botanical garden once during a holiday

C. An employee attending an online meeting from home

D. A shopper ordering groceries through a mobile application

IV In Paragraph 4, the writer contrasts wealthier localities with crowded settlements. **2**
What does this comparison reveal about the writer's view of the way cities are planned?

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 5) **1**
Creating green spaces in a city always requires a large budget and new land.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
loneliness : belonging :: _____ : _____

(a) exhaustion : refreshment

(b) traffic : commute

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) Cortisol is a hormone that the body releases in response to stress.
(ii) Studies have linked a short walk among trees with lower levels of cortisol.
(iii) A neighbourhood park is the best place for strangers to meet as equals.
(iv) Some municipal bodies involve residents' welfare associations in maintaining parks.
(v) Progress should be measured by the number of trees a child can see from her window.

A. (i) F (ii) O (iii) O (iv) F (v) F

B. (i) O (ii) F (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

C. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) F (v) O

D. (i) F (ii) F (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in ending the passage with the image of 'the number of trees a child can see from her window'? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) A survey conducted in 2025 across 40 schools in five Indian cities asked 2,000 students of Classes 9 to 12 how they use artificial intelligence (AI) tools for their homework. The findings show that these tools are no longer a novelty; they have quietly become a part of the study routine of a large number of teenagers.

(2) Of the students surveyed, 68% said that they had used an AI tool for schoolwork at least once in the previous month. Among these users, the most common purpose was understanding difficult concepts (61%), followed by checking answers (47%) and generating ideas for projects (38%). Only 22% admitted to using AI to write complete answers or essays. Mathematics and science were the subjects in which AI help was sought most often.

(3) Students described the tools as patient tutors that are available at midnight, when teachers and parents are not. However, the survey also raised concerns. Nearly 45% of the users said that they sometimes copied an AI response without checking it, and about one in three teachers reported noticing assignments that 'sounded the same'.

(4) Educators believe that the solution lies in guidance rather than bans. Several schools in the survey have begun teaching 'AI literacy': how to frame questions, verify facts and acknowledge the use of a tool. As one principal put it, the calculator did not end the learning of arithmetic; it changed what we chose to teach.

Created for academic usage / 236 words

Table: Key findings of the survey (purposes: more than one response allowed)

Survey finding (2,000 students, Classes 9–12)	Percentage
Used an AI tool for schoolwork in the previous month (all students)	68%
Purpose: understanding difficult concepts (users)	61%
Purpose: checking answers (users)	47%
Purpose: generating ideas for projects (users)	38%
Purpose: writing complete answers or essays (users)	22%
Sometimes copied an AI response without checking it (users)	45%

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The word 'novelty' as used in Paragraph 1 refers to something that is _____.
(new and unfamiliar / old and dependable)

II What does the fact that AI help was sought most often in mathematics and science suggest about students' academic needs? (Paragraph 2) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Most students who use AI tools use them to write complete answers or essays.
Reason: Some students copy AI responses without checking them.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.

B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.

C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.

D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following are mentioned in Paragraph 2 EXCEPT—

A. More than two-thirds of the surveyed students had used an AI tool in the previous month.

B. Checking answers was a more common purpose than generating ideas for projects.

C. Fewer than a quarter of the users relied on AI to write complete answers.

D. Students of Class 12 used AI tools more frequently than students of Class 9.

V Compare the percentage of users who use AI to understand difficult concepts (61%) with those who use it to write complete answers (22%). What might this suggest about how most students view AI tools? (Paragraph 2) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 3) **1**
Some teachers noticed assignments that 'sounded the same' because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from Paragraph 4 which indicates that educators prefer to direct students rather than stop them from using AI tools. **1**

VIII Riya submitted a history answer generated by an AI tool, and it contained a wrong date. Based on Paragraph 4, which skill of 'AI literacy' would have helped her avoid this mistake? **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'AI in the Homework Hour: Help or Shortcut?' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of a formal email: **1**
Dear Mr. Khanna,
We are pleased to inform you that the library membership card you applied for _____ and can be collected from the front desk.

A. has been issued B. had issued
C. is issuing D. will issue

II Report the coach's statement to the players. **1**
Coach: "You must warm up properly before every match."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the notice put up by a housing society: **1**
Notice to All Residents
Visitor passes can be collected from the society office. _____ resident is allowed a maximum of two passes per day.

A. All B. Each C. Many D. Several

IV Read what Arjun said to his sister about his school work: **1**
"I have finished my science project and will submit it tomorrow."
Report Arjun's statement by completing the following sentence:
Arjun told his sister that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a newspaper report: **1**
The number of visitors to the heritage museum have doubled since the new gallery opened.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from the rules displayed in a school library: **1**
Books borrowed from the reference section _____ not be taken out of the library under any circumstances.

A. need B. must C. would D. might

VII The given sentence from an employee's profile has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**
She has been working in this company since five years.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	has been	had been
B.	working	worked
C.	since	for
D.	this	that

VIII At an interview, Mr. Rao asked the candidate the following question: **1**
"Why did you choose engineering as your career?"
Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.
Mr. Rao asked the candidate _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank. **1**
"Hurry up! We have _____ time left before the train departs," said Father.
A. few B. little C. many D. a few

X Identify the error in the given line from a school circular and suggest the correction. **1**
If it will rain tomorrow, the school picnic will be postponed to next Saturday.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the line from a weather bulletin by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**
According to the forecast, it _____ snow in the hills this weekend, so tourists should carry warm clothes. (may / must)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a food blog. **1**
By the time we reached the restaurant, the chef _____ (prepare) the special dish of the day.

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Ishita Raghavan, a resident of Lakeview Enclave, Bhopal. For the past three weeks, most of the streetlights on the main road of your locality have not been working, making it unsafe for residents, especially women, children and senior citizens, to move about after dark. Write a letter to the Executive Engineer, Bhopal Municipal Corporation, in 120 words, complaining about the problem and requesting prompt action. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Arjun Bhatia, the Tour Coordinator of Green Valley Public School, Dehradun. Your school is planning a five-day educational trip to Rajasthan in December for 40 students of Class 10 and four teachers. Write a letter to the Manager, Rajasthan Tourism Development Corporation, Jaipur, in 120 words, enquiring about the tour packages available for students, the safety arrangements for travel and stay, and the total cost per student. **5**

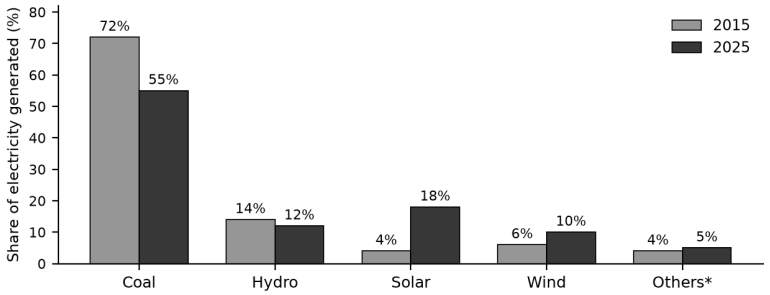
5 A. Read the product details given on a school-supplies website for a portable mini projector meant for classrooms. **5**

– Projects a clear Full HD (1080p) picture from 40 to 120 inches on any plain wall
– Wireless screen mirroring from phones, tablets and laptops; HDMI and USB ports
– Built-in rechargeable battery: up to 3 hours of projection on one charge
– In-built 5 W speaker, so no extra sound system is needed
– Compact and light (850 g) with a padded carry case; sets up in under a minute
– Long-life LED lamp (30,000 hours); 2-year warranty; price ₹14,999

Now, analyse how useful this projector would be for teaching and learning in a school. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as picture quality, ease of use, portability, benefits for students and value for money.

OR

5 B. The bar graph given below shows the share of electricity generated from different sources in a state in 2015 and 2025. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, describing the data and analysing the major trends. **5**



Share of electricity generated from different sources (%), 2015 and 2025
**Others: nuclear and biomass*

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A

Coorgi homes have a tradition of hospitality, and they are more than willing to recount numerous tales of valour related to their sons and fathers. The Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated in the Indian Army, and the first Chief of the Indian Army, General Cariappa, was a Coorgi. Even now, Kodavus are the only people in India permitted to carry firearms without a licence.

The river, Kaveri, obtains its water from the hills and forests of Coorg. Mahaseer — a large freshwater fish — abound in these waters. Kingfishers dive for their catch, while squirrels and langurs drop partially eaten fruit for the mischief of enjoying the splash and the ripple effect in the clear water. Elephants enjoy being bathed and scrubbed in the river by their mahouts.

(Glimpses of India – Coorg)

I Which of the following statements best describes the people of Coorg as presented in the extract? **1**

(a) They are warm and welcoming, and take great pride in their tradition of courage.

(b) They are reserved with outsiders and prefer to keep their history to themselves.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
The word 'decorated' in 'one of the most decorated in the Indian Army' means that the Coorg Regiment has _____.

A. the most colourful uniforms

B. received many awards for bravery

C. the largest number of soldiers

D. the best weapons and equipment

III Complete the following suitably. 1
The writer mentions that Kodavus may carry firearms without a licence to highlight _____.

IV How does the description of squirrels and langurs dropping fruit 'for the mischief of enjoying the splash' bring the natural world of Coorg alive for the reader? 2

OR

B

> Two days later, Mijbil escaped from my bedroom as I entered it, and I turned to see his tail disappearing round the bend of the corridor that led to the bathroom. By the time I got there he was up on the end of the bathtub and fumbling at the chromium taps with his paws. I watched, amazed; in less than a minute he had turned the tap far enough to produce a trickle of water, and after a moment or two achieved the full flow. (He had been lucky to turn the tap the right way; on later occasions he would sometimes screw it up still tighter, chittering with irritation and disappointment at the tap's failure to cooperate.)
> Very soon Mij would follow me without a lead and come to me when I called his name.
>
> (Mijbil the Otter)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1
Mijbil's success in turning on the tap by himself shows that he was _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
The word 'chittering' suggests that Mij _____.

A. made quick, high-pitched sounds of annoyance

B. fell silent out of fear

C. splashed water all around him

D. called out to the writer for help

III Fill in the blank with the correct word from the bracket. 1
The writer 'watched, amazed' because Mij's action was _____ for an animal.
(unexpected / ordinary)

IV What does the last line of the extract reveal about the relationship developing between the writer and Mij? Explain briefly. 2

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A.

> But he's locked in a concrete cell,
> His strength behind bars,
> Stalking the length of his cage,
> Ignoring visitors.
> He hears the last voice at night,
> The patrolling cars,
> And stares with his brilliant eyes
> At the brilliant stars.

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The phrase 'His strength behind bars' suggests that the tiger's power is _____.

II Why does the tiger ignore the visitors? **1**

A. He is too tired to notice anyone around him.
B. He feels indifferent and resentful towards those who keep him captive.
C. He is waiting patiently for his keeper to bring food.
D. He is frightened of the large crowds near his cage.

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The repetition of 'brilliant' links the tiger's eyes with the stars and suggests his deep longing for _____.

IV How does the contrast between the 'concrete cell' and the 'brilliant stars' convey the poet's message about keeping wild animals in zoos? **2**

OR

B.

If when you're walking round your yard
You meet a creature there,
Who hugs you very, very hard,
Be sure it is a Bear.
If you have any doubts, I guess
He'll give you just one more caress.

Though to distinguish beasts of prey
A novice might nonplus,
The Crocodile you always may
Tell from the Hyena thus:
Hyenas come with merry smiles;
But if they weep they're Crocodiles.

(How to Tell Wild Animals)

I Fill in the blank with the correct option from the bracket. **1**
The bear's 'caress' mentioned in the first stanza is actually a _____. (deadly attack / gentle sign of affection)

II The lines 'Hyenas come with merry smiles; / But if they weep they're Crocodiles' refer to _____. **1**

A. the popular belief that hyenas laugh and crocodiles shed false tears
B. the fact that hyenas and crocodiles are friendly animals
C. the way hyenas and crocodiles hunt together
D. the sounds that both animals make before sleeping

III Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
In the line 'A novice might nonplus', the word 'novice' refers to _____.

IV How does the poet create humour in these two stanzas? Explain with reference to the extract. **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3 =12**

I Lencho calls the post office employees 'a bunch of crooks'. What does this reveal about Lencho and about the irony of the situation? **3**

(A Letter to God)

II What 'twin obligations' does Mandela speak of, and why was it impossible for a man of colour in South Africa to fulfil both? **3**

(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

III How does the poet use 'fire' and 'ice' to express his view about how the world may end? **3**

(Fire and Ice)

IV How did Anne turn Mr Keesing's punishment into an opportunity to show her wit and confidence? **3**

(From the Diary of Anne Frank)

V How did the Buddha help Kisa Gotami understand the truth about life and death without directly telling her? **3**

(The Sermon at Benares)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3 =6**

I How did Richard Ebright's mother help him grow into a scientist? **3**

(The Making of a Scientist)

II What does Matilda's reaction to the invitation to the ball reveal about her character? How did her husband try to please her? **3**

(The Necklace)

III Why was Ramlal worried about Bholi's marriage, and why did he accept Bishamber's proposal? **3**

(Bholi)

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. In 'The Proposal', Lomov, Natalya and Chubukov quarrel over trivial matters even during a marriage proposal. Discuss how Chekhov uses these quarrels to satirise the materialistic attitude of the wealthy landowning class.

OR

B. The poem 'Amanda!' contrasts the constant instructions of an adult with the imaginary world of a child. Analyse how this contrast conveys the poet's message about the needs of growing children.

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. 'A little knowledge is a dangerous thing.' Think-Tank's pride in his own wisdom and his misreading of a book of nursery rhymes save the Earth from a Martian invasion. Write a character sketch of Think-Tank with reference to 'The Book That Saved the Earth'.

OR

B. Mrs Pumphrey loved Tricki dearly, yet her love nearly killed him. How did Mr Herriot cure Tricki, and what does the story 'A Triumph of Surgery' teach us about the right way to care for those we love?

***

SAMPLE PAPER 12

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 12 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Think back to the first song you learnt or the first story you heard at bedtime. Chances are, all of them reached you in the language spoken at home. Before children ever enter a classroom, they have built an entire world of meaning in their mother tongue. The real question is whether schools build on that world or quietly ask children to leave it at the gate.

(2) Imagine a six-year-old in a classroom where every instruction is in an unfamiliar language. She must decode the words before she can even begin to grasp the idea behind them. Simple tasks such as counting objects or describing a picture become a double burden. Many such children fall silent, not because they lack ability, but because they lack the words to show it. Teachers may then mistake confusion for slowness, and an early label can follow a child for years.

(3) Research from many countries points in one direction: children who learn to read and reason first in a familiar language tend to understand concepts faster and take part in class more confidently. India's National Education Policy 2020 recognises this, recommending that, wherever possible, the medium of instruction* until at least Grade 5 be the home language or mother tongue. The logic is simple: a child who understands what 'more' and 'less' mean in her own language can carry that understanding into any other language later.

(4) Some parents worry that this approach will weaken their children's English, the language they link with good jobs. Learning is not a race in which one language must lose for another to win. Skills such as summarising, predicting and questioning, once mastered in one language, transfer readily to the next. A strong foundation in the mother tongue often makes a second language easier, not harder, to learn.

(5) Something deeper is also at stake. Language carries lullabies, proverbs, recipes and the wisdom of grandparents. When a child is made to feel that her home language has no place in school, she may begin to feel that her family and culture have no place there either. A classroom that welcomes her language tells her that who she is matters.

(6) Of course, this is not easy to put into practice. A single classroom in a city may have children speaking five or six languages, and trained teachers and books in many languages are scarce. Yet these are problems to be solved, not reasons to give up. Bilingual textbooks, picture dictionaries and storytelling by community members are already helping in many schools. If we want children who think boldly in every language, we must first let them think comfortably in their own.

*medium of instruction: the language in which subjects are taught in school

Created for academic usage / 440 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'leave it at the gate' suggest about what some schools expect of young children? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says that simple tasks 'become a double burden', he refers to _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) the effort of understanding an unfamiliar language as well as the idea being taught.

(b) the pressure of finishing classwork in school as well as homework at home every day.

III The writer says that skills mastered in one language 'transfer readily to the next' (paragraph 4). **1**
Which of the following is an example of this?

A. A child memorises an English poem without understanding its meaning.

B. A child who learnt to predict story endings in Marathi uses the same skill while reading an English story.

C. A child moves from a Hindi-medium school to an English-medium school and repeats Grade 2.

D. A child learns new English words by copying each of them ten times.

IV In paragraph 2, the writer says that teachers may 'mistake confusion for slowness'. **2**
What does this reveal about the writer's view of how early classroom experiences shape a child's future?

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 4) **1**
The writer believes that learning in the mother tongue in the early years reduces a child's chances of learning English well.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
unfamiliar language : silence :: _____ : _____

(a) welcoming classroom : confidence

(b) bilingual textbooks : shortage

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) The National Education Policy 2020 recommends the home language as the medium of instruction until at least Grade 5, wherever possible.
(ii) A single classroom in a city may have children who speak several different languages.
(iii) Learning is not a race in which one language must lose for another to win.
(iv) A classroom that welcomes a child's language tells her that who she is matters.
(v) Bilingual textbooks and picture dictionaries are being used in some schools.

A. (i) F (ii) O (iii) O (iv) F (v) F

B. (i) O (ii) F (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

C. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F

D. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) F (v) O

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in discussing the worries of parents (paragraph 4) and the practical difficulties of the idea (paragraph 6) in a passage that supports learning in the mother tongue? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) A survey conducted in 2025 by the municipal water board of a large Indian city recorded the average daily water use of 600 households, each with four members, across three seasons. The findings, shown in the table below, reveal that the amount of water a family uses is shaped as much by the weather as by its habits.

(2) Summer was the thirstiest season, with average use rising to 640 litres a day. Bathing alone accounted for 200 litres, as families bathed more often to beat the heat. Washing clothes and cleaning or gardening took 110 litres each, as sweaty clothes were washed daily and plants and floors needed frequent watering.

Average daily water use per household of four (in litres), 2025

Purpose	Summer	Monsoon	Winter
Bathing	200	150	140
Toilet flushing	130	120	120
Washing clothes	110	80	80
Kitchen (cooking, drinking, utensils)	90	70	70
Cleaning and gardening	110	30	50
Total	**640**	**450**	**460**

(3) During the monsoon, household use dropped to 450 litres. Rain took over the job of watering plants, and cleaning and gardening fell to just 30 litres. Interestingly, use rose slightly again in winter, to 460 litres, mainly because gardens needed watering once the rains stopped. Toilet flushing remained the most stable category, varying by only 10 litres across the year.

(4) The board's benchmark for urban homes is 135 litres per person per day, or 540 litres for a family of four. While families stayed within this limit for most of the year, summer use exceeded it by nearly a fifth. Officials believe that simple steps such as bucket baths, full-load washing and reusing kitchen water for plants could bring summer use within the benchmark.

Created for academic usage / 234 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. The word 'thirstiest' as used in paragraph 2 suggests that summer was the season in which _____. **1**
(households needed the most water / people drank the most water)

II Why did the water used for cleaning and gardening fall so sharply during the monsoon? (Paragraph 3) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Toilet flushing was the most stable category of household water use across the year.
Reason: Families bathed more often in summer to beat the heat.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.

B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.

C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.

D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
According to the table, all of the following are true EXCEPT—

A. Bathing used more water than any other purpose in every season.

B. Kitchen use was the same in the monsoon and in winter.

C. In summer, washing clothes took more water than toilet flushing.

D. Cleaning and gardening used the least water during the monsoon.

V Compare the water used for bathing in summer and in winter. What might explain the difference? (Paragraph 2 and table) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 4) **1**
A family of four using 640 litres of water a day is above the board's benchmark because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 4 which indicates that the changes suggested by officials are easy to adopt. **1**

VIII The Iyer family wants to cut its summer water use without compromising on cleanliness. Which step from paragraph 4 would you suggest to them, and how would it help? **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Every Drop, Every Season' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of an email from the city library: **1**
Dear Members,
We are pleased to inform you that the renovated reading room _____ to the public from Monday, 4 January.

A. will be opened B. has been opened

C. was opening D. had opened

II Report the coach's instruction. **1**
Coach: "Do not skip your warm-up exercises before the match."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the notice put up by a housing society: **1**
Notice to All Residents
The society office has received _____ complaints about the broken lift in Block C. It will be repaired by Friday.

A. much B. several C. a little D. any

IV Read Rohan's statement to the school librarian: **1**
"I returned the book yesterday, but my library card still shows it as pending."
Report Rohan's statement by completing the following sentence:
Rohan told the librarian that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a newspaper report: **1**
The number of visitors to the city science museum have increased sharply this year.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from a hospital notice: **1**
Visitors _____ not use mobile phones inside the Intensive Care Unit.

A. need B. must C. would D. might

VII The given question has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**
Does the members of the organising committee know about the change in venue?

No.	Error	Correction
A.	Does	Do
B.	members	member
C.	know	knows
D.	about	of

VIII Meera asked the shopkeeper the following question: **1**
"Do you have this kurta in a smaller size?"
Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.
Meera asked the shopkeeper _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank. **1**
We had _____ time left before the train departed, so we rushed to the platform.

A. few B. a few C. little D. many

X Identify the error and suggest the correction. **1**
Neither the principal nor the teachers was informed about the change in the examination timetable.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the father's advice by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**
You _____ carry an umbrella today; the weather report says there is no chance of rain. (need not / must not)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a travel blog. **1**
By the time we reached the fort, the guide _____ (leave) with the earlier group.

WRITING

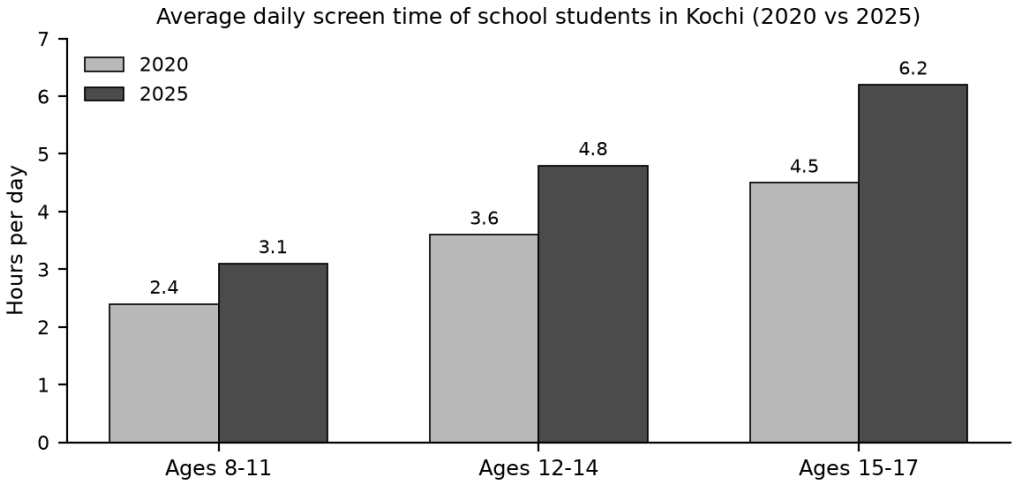
NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Ritika Saxena, a resident of Shanti Nagar, Bhopal. Stray cattle are often seen sitting or wandering on the main roads of your city, causing traffic jams and accidents, especially at night. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily in 120 words, drawing attention to the problem, its dangers for commuters and the animals, and suggesting measures the civic authorities could take. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Arjun Rao, B-14, Sector 9, Dwarka, New Delhi. Three weeks ago you bought a water purifier from the online store of Neerja Home Appliances Ltd. It stopped working within ten days and your two service requests have received no response. Write a letter in 120 words to the Customer Care Manager of the company, complaining about the defective product and the poor service, and requesting a replacement or a full refund. **5**

5 A. The bar graph below shows the average daily screen time (in hours) of school students in three age groups in Kochi, as recorded by a survey of 1,500 students conducted by the Kochi Parents' Forum in 2020 and in 2025. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, describing the main trends and comparing the data. **5**



OR

5 B. Your city has launched a public bicycle-sharing scheme called 'Clean Commute'. Read its details given below. **5**

- 500 bicycles at 40 docking stations across the city, including near schools and metro stations
- Unlock with a mobile app or a smart card; first 30 minutes free, ₹5 for every 30 minutes after that
- Monthly pass for students at ₹99
- Helmets available on request at major stations
- Stations open from 6 a.m. to 9 p.m.; no dedicated cycle lanes yet on most main roads
- Bicycles to be serviced every week; damage to be reported through the app

Now, write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, evaluating how useful the scheme would be for school students, considering factors such as cost, convenience, safety, health and the environment.

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A.

Valli wasn't bored in the slightest and greeted everything with the same excitement she'd felt the first time. But suddenly she saw a young cow lying dead by the roadside, just where it had been struck by some fast-moving vehicle.

"Isn't that the same cow that ran in front of the bus on our trip to town?" she asked the conductor.

The conductor nodded, and she was overcome with sadness. What had been a lovable, beautiful creature just a little while ago had now suddenly lost its charm and its life and looked so horrible, so frightening as it lay there, legs spreadeagled, a fixed stare in its lifeless eyes, blood all over...

The bus moved on. The memory of the dead cow haunted her, dampening her enthusiasm. She no longer wanted to look out the window. (Madam Rides the Bus)

I Which of the following statements best explains Valli's reaction on seeing the cow? 1

(a) She realises, perhaps for the first time, how suddenly life can end and beauty can turn into something frightening.

(b) She feels guilty because she had laughed at the same cow on her way to town.

II What does the phrase 'dampening her enthusiasm' suggest about the change in Valli? 1

A. She has become tired after a long day of travelling.

B. Her joy in the journey has been replaced by sadness and silence.

C. She is worried that her mother will discover her secret trip.

D. She has lost interest because the sights on the way back are the same.

III Complete the following suitably. 1

Valli asks the conductor whether it is the same cow because _____.

IV How does the contrast between 'a lovable, beautiful creature' and 'so horrible, so frightening' help to convey the central idea of the story? 2

OR

B.

Poor Kisa Gotami now went from house to house, and the people pitied her and said, "Here is mustard-seed; take it!" But when she asked, "Did a son or daughter, a father or mother, die in your family?" they answered her, "Alas! the living are few, but the dead are many. Do not remind us of our deepest grief." And there was no house but some beloved one had died in it. Kisa Gotami became weary and hopeless, and sat down at the wayside watching the lights of the city, as they flickered up and were extinguished again. At last the darkness of the night reigned everywhere. And she considered the fate of men, that their lives flicker up and are extinguished again. (The Sermon at Benares)

I Which of the following statements best explains the meaning of 'the living are few, but the dead are many'? 1

(a) Death is a universal experience that has touched every family.

(b) The city had recently suffered a terrible epidemic.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1

The image of the city lights that 'flickered up and were extinguished again' is used to symbolise _____.

A. the wealth and splendour of the city

B. the brief and uncertain nature of human life

C. the coming of a violent storm

D. the weakening of Kisa Gotami's eyesight

III Fill in the blank with the correct word from the bracket. 1

Watching the lights in the darkness, Kisa Gotami moves from personal grief towards _____ of the fate of all human beings.

(understanding / ignorance)

IV Why does the Buddha send Kisa Gotami to look for mustard-seed from a house where no one has died, instead of simply telling her that death is common to all? 2

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A.

An ultimate shaking grief fixes the boy
As he stands rigid, trembling, staring down
All his young days into the harbour where
His ball went. I would not intrude on him;
A dime, another ball, is worthless. Now

He senses first responsibility
In a world of possessions. (The Ball Poem)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1
The words 'rigid, trembling, staring' show that the boy is _____.

II Why does the poet say, 'I would not intrude on him'? 1

A. He is afraid that the boy will be angry with him.

B. He wants the boy to learn to face the loss on his own.

C. He does not have enough money to buy another ball.

D. He feels that the loss of a ball is too small to matter.

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
The phrase 'staring down / All his young days' suggests that, for the boy, the ball stands for his _____.

IV How does the loss of the ball make the boy sense his 'first responsibility / In a world of possessions'? 2

OR

B.

Did you finish your homework, Amanda?
Did you tidy your room, Amanda?
I thought I told you to clean your shoes,
Amanda!
(I am an orphan, roaming the street.
I pattern soft dust with my hushed, bare feet.
The silence is golden, the freedom is sweet.) (Amanda!)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1
The series of questions in the first stanza of the extract shows that the speaker is _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
Amanda imagines herself as an orphan because she _____.

A. does not love her parents

B. longs to be free from constant instructions

C. wants to experience a life of poverty

D. has lost her way back home

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
By saying 'The silence is golden', Amanda contrasts her imagined world with the constant _____ of the speaker.

IV How do the brackets and the change in tone between the two stanzas of the extract show the contrast between Amanda's real and imagined worlds? 2

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. 4x3=12

I Mandela says that he learned that 'courage was not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it'. How does this idea reflect the experience of the freedom fighters he admired? 3
(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

II Why does the narrator's rescue by the mysterious black aeroplane leave the story open to more than one interpretation? (Two Stories about Flying: The Black Aeroplane) 3

III How does the poet use the contrast between the cage and the jungle to make readers question the practice of keeping wild animals in zoos? (A Tiger in the Zoo) 3

IV How do the quarrels over Oxen Meadows and the dogs expose the real motives behind the proposal? (The Proposal) **3**

V What does the old religious man's 'text' suggest about the possibility of being loved 'for yourself alone'? (For Anne Gregory) **3**

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3=6**

I Mrs Pumphrey's love for Tricki nearly harmed him. How does Mr Herriot's handling of the situation show both professional skill and tact? (A Triumph of Surgery) **3**

II How was Bholi's first day at school different from the way she was treated at home? (Bholi) **3**

III It was Think-Tank's vanity, and not the might of Earth, that saved the planet. Do you agree? Give reasons. (The Book That Saved the Earth) **3**

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Anne writes that 'paper has more patience than people'. Discuss how writing helps Anne cope with her loneliness and also helps her win over Mr Keesing. (From the Diary of Anne Frank)

OR

B. In 'A Baker from Goa', the baker is much more than a seller of bread. Discuss how the writer uses the figure of the baker to present the traditions of Goa and his own nostalgia for his childhood. (Glimpses of India)

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Anil never accused Hari Singh of the theft, yet the boy chose to return. Discuss how Anil's trust, kindness and the promise of education brought about a change in Hari Singh. (The Thief's Story)

OR

B. Ausable did not fit any description of a secret agent, yet he outwitted an armed rival. Draw a character sketch of Ausable, showing how his presence of mind and imagination helped him defeat Max. (The Midnight Visitor)

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SAMPLE PAPER 13

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 13 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Watch any group of children playing an informal game of football in a park, and you will notice something remarkable. Within minutes, strangers become teammates, roles are divided without a word, and a shared goal takes shape. Long before they learn the word ‘cooperation’ in a classroom, children discover it on the playing field. Sport, it seems, is one of the oldest and most effective teachers we have.

(2) The first lesson sport teaches is that no individual, however gifted, wins alone. A striker may score the goal, but only because a defender won the ball, a midfielder passed it forward and a teammate drew the opponents away. Players learn to trust one another, to communicate quickly and to celebrate a teammate’s success as their own. These are precisely the qualities employers today list as most desirable: the ability to work in teams, to listen and to put the group’s goal above personal glory.

(3) Equally valuable is the lesson of resilience. Every athlete, from a school relay runner to an Olympic champion, faces defeat far more often than the headlines suggest. A missed penalty, a dropped catch or a loss in the final can feel crushing at that moment. Yet the very next morning, the player is back at practice, analysing mistakes and trying again. Sport turns failure into feedback. It teaches young people that a setback is not the end of the story but a part of it, and that the courage to return after a loss matters more than the loss itself.

(4) Regular participation in sport also supports physical and mental health. Physical activity releases endorphins*, which reduce stress and improve mood. Students who play regularly often sleep better, concentrate longer and manage their time more carefully, since they must balance training with studies. Many also report feeling more confident in class, perhaps because the field has already taught them to speak up and take responsibility. In my view, these benefits make sport not an extra-curricular activity but an essential part of education.

(5) Unfortunately, many schools still treat the games period as the first thing to be sacrificed when examinations approach. Playgrounds are shrinking in crowded cities, and children spend more hours in front of screens than on fields. Should we be surprised, then, when young people struggle to cope with pressure or to work with others? If we want a generation that is confident, cooperative and able to bounce back from disappointment, we must give sport the place it deserves. After all, the scoreboard records only goals and runs; the real victories of sport are the lessons it leaves behind.

*endorphins: chemicals produced in the brain that reduce pain and create a feeling of well-being

Created for academic usage / 432 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'strangers become teammates' emphasise? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says, 'Sport turns failure into feedback', he means that _____. (paragraph 3)

(a) athletes use their defeats as information to learn from and improve their game.

(b) athletes are hardly affected by defeats because they face them so often.

III The writer says that the qualities learnt on the field are 'precisely the qualities employers today list as most desirable'. (paragraph 2) **1**
Which of the following situations best reflects these qualities at a workplace?

A. An employee completes every task alone so that she gets full credit.

B. A team member shares his data with colleagues so that the group meets its deadline.

C. A manager avoids team meetings in order to save time.

D. A worker competes against his colleagues to win a personal award.

IV In paragraph 2, the writer describes how a goal is scored in football. What point does this example help the writer make about individual talent? **2**

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 4) **1**
Students who play sports regularly find it harder to manage their time because training takes up their hours.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
practice : improvement :: _____ : _____

(a) endorphins : better mood

(b) screens : playgrounds

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) Physical activity releases endorphins.
(ii) Sport is one of the oldest and most effective teachers we have.
(iii) Playgrounds are shrinking in crowded cities.
(iv) Sport should be treated as an essential part of education.
(v) The real victories of sport are the lessons it leaves behind.

A. (i) O (ii) F (iii) O (iv) F (v) F

B. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) F

C. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O

D. (i) O (ii) O (iii) F (iv) F (v) O

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in ending the passage with a contrast between 'the scoreboard' and 'the real victories of sport'? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Indian cities are home to a surprising variety of birds, from the familiar house sparrow to the colourful Indian roller. A citizen-science report released in 2026, based on nearly 2.4 lakh checklists submitted

by more than 15,000 volunteer birdwatchers across 12 cities, offers a mixed picture of how these birds have been faring over the past decade.

(2) Of the 140 species assessed, 58 have declined, 34 are stable and 21 have increased; data for the remaining 27 was insufficient. The birds that are thriving are largely 'generalists' such as the rock pigeon and the house crow, which eat almost anything and nest comfortably on buildings. In contrast, 'specialists' that depend on insects, old trees or wetlands are losing ground.

Change in sightings of selected urban bird species (2016–2026)

Species	Type	Change in sightings (2016–2026)
Rock pigeon	Generalist	+48%
House crow	Generalist	+15%
Black kite	Generalist	+22%
House sparrow	Specialist (insects for chicks, nesting gaps)	−30%
Indian roller	Specialist (open land, old trees)	−41%
Common kingfisher	Specialist (wetlands)	−25%

(3) The report links these declines to shrinking tree cover, modern glass-and-concrete buildings that offer no gaps or ledges for nesting, and the heavy use of pesticides in parks and gardens, which reduces the insects that many birds feed their chicks.

(4) There is, however, reason for hope. Neighbourhoods that have restored lakes, planted native trees or put up nest boxes have recorded a rise in sightings of sparrows and other small birds. The report concludes that small, local actions by residents, schools and municipal bodies can make our cities welcoming to birds once again.

Created for academic usage / 212 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The word 'faring' as used in paragraph 1 refers to how the birds have been _____.
(travelling from one city to another / managing or getting on)

II What does the large number of volunteers and checklists suggest about the findings of the report? (paragraph 1) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Sightings of the house sparrow fell by 30% over the decade.
Reason: The use of pesticides in parks and gardens increases the number of insects available to birds.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.
B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.
C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
According to paragraph 2 and the table, all of the following are true EXCEPT —

A. More species declined than increased over the decade.
B. Among the selected species, the Indian roller showed the steepest fall.
C. Nearly one-fifth of the species assessed could not be judged for lack of data.
D. Among the selected species, the black kite recorded the highest rise.

V Compare the trend shown by generalist birds with that of specialist birds. What does this difference suggest about the urban environment? (paragraph 2 and table) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (paragraph 3) **1**
Modern glass-and-concrete buildings are a problem for birds because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 4 that indicates that the problem can be tackled at the level of neighbourhoods and schools. **1**

VIII The eco-club of a school wants to attract more birds to its campus. Based on paragraph 4, suggest one step it could take. **1**

IX Suggest one reason why 'Winged Neighbours: Losses and Hope' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR — 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the formal email: **1**
Dear Mr Rao,
We regret to inform you that the robotics workshop, which _____ for 14 November, has been postponed due to unforeseen circumstances.
A. was scheduled B. is scheduling C. had been scheduling D. schedules

II Report the coach's instruction to the players. **1**
Coach: "Drink plenty of water before the match."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the school circular: **1**
Two buses have been arranged for the excursion. _____ of the two buses will leave the school gate at 7:30 a.m.; the other will leave at 8:00 a.m.
A. Each B. One C. Both D. All

IV Read Arjun's statement to his principal: **1**
"I have completed the project report and will submit it tomorrow."
Report Arjun's statement by completing the following sentence:
Arjun informed the principal that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a newspaper report: **1**
The number of visitors to the city museum have doubled this year.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given line from a hospital notice: **1**
Visitors _____ not use mobile phones inside the intensive care unit.
A. need B. must C. would D. could

VII The given sentence from a school magazine profile has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**
Our new librarian has been living in Pune since five years.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	has	have
B.	been living	lived
C.	since	for
D.	in	at

VIII Meera's mother asked her the following question: **1**
"Have you packed your bag for the trip?"
Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.
Meera's mother asked her _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank in the announcement. **1**
There are _____ seats left for the evening show, so book your tickets quickly.

A. a few B. little C. much D. a little

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the given line from a student's blog. **1**
One of my cousins live in Jaipur and visits us every winter.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the mother's advice by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**
You _____ carry an umbrella; the forecast says it will be sunny all day.
(needn't / mustn't)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a company newsletter. **1**
Our design team _____ (work) on the new mobile app for the last six months.

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Tanvi Malhotra, 27, Green Park, Lucknow. You are worried that playgrounds and open spaces for children in your city are disappearing fast, being replaced by parking lots and buildings. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily in about 120 words, expressing your concern, its effect on the health of children and suggesting measures to protect such spaces. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Rohit Bansal, Laboratory In-charge, Sunrise Valley School, Dehradun. Your school needs some equipment for its science laboratory. Write a letter in about 120 words to the Sales Manager, Prakash Scientific Instruments, Ambala Cantt, placing an order for the items listed below. Mention the mode of payment, the date by which the goods must be delivered and the need for careful packing of glassware. **5**

Item	Quantity
Compound microscopes	6
Beakers (250 ml, borosilicate glass)	40
Test-tube stands with test tubes	20 sets
Digital weighing balance	2
Convex lenses and lens stands	15 each

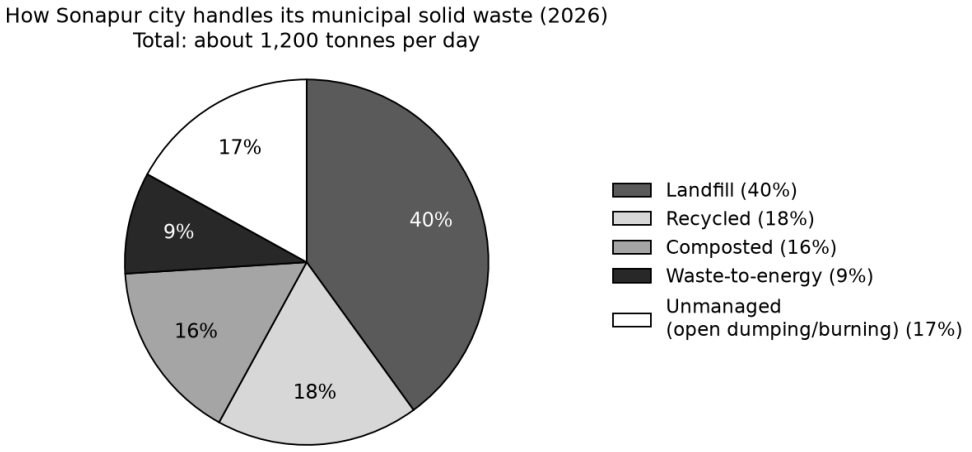
5 A. Read the product details of an insulated tiffin set mentioned on an e-commerce website. **5**

– Three food-grade stainless-steel containers (300 ml, 450 ml and 600 ml)
– Double-wall insulation keeps food warm for up to 6 hours
– Leak-proof lids with silicone seals; suitable for dal and curries
– Comes in a padded, washable carry bag with a bottle holder
– Rust-free, dishwasher-safe and free of harmful plastics (BPA-free)
– Total weight 780 g
– Price ₹1,199; 3-year warranty against rust

Now, analyse why this tiffin set would be a good purchase for school students and office-goers. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as health and hygiene, convenience, durability, environmental friendliness and value for money.

OR

5 B. The pie chart below shows how the municipal solid waste of Sonapur city was handled in 2026. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words describing the information given and suggesting how the share of waste that is recycled or composted could be increased. **5**



SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A

NATALYA: Excuse my interrupting you. You say, “my Oxen Meadows”. But are they yours?
LOMOV: Yes, mine.
NATALYA: What are you talking about? Oxen Meadows are ours, not yours!
LOMOV: No, mine, honoured Natalya Stepanovna.
NATALYA: Well, I never knew that before. How do you make that out?
LOMOV: How? I’m speaking of those Oxen Meadows which are wedged in between your birchwoods and the Burnt Marsh.
NATALYA: Yes, yes... they’re ours.
LOMOV: No, you’re mistaken, honoured Natalya Stepanovna, they’re mine.
NATALYA: Just think, Ivan Vassilevitch! How long have they been yours?
LOMOV: How long? As long as I can remember.
NATALYA: Really, you won’t get me to believe that!

(The Proposal)

I Select the option that best describes Natalya as revealed by her interruption in the opening line. 1

(a) She is polite on the surface but quick to take offence where her property is concerned.

(b) She is shy and unwilling to contradict a guest in her house.

II Lomov keeps addressing Natalya as 'honoured Natalya Stepanovna' even while disagreeing with her. This shows his _____. 1

A. sarcasm towards her

B. attempt to remain formal and polite

C. fear of her father

D. indifference to the dispute

III Complete the following suitably. 1

The quarrel over the Oxen Meadows is ironic because Lomov had actually come to the Chubukovs' house to _____.

IV How do the short, rapid exchanges between Natalya and Lomov build up the comic conflict in this extract? 2

OR

B

> The postmaster — a fat, amiable fellow — also broke out laughing, but almost immediately he turned serious and, tapping the letter on his desk, commented, "What faith! I wish I had the faith of the man who wrote this letter. Starting up a correspondence with God!"
> So, in order not to shake the writer's faith in God, the postmaster came up with an idea: answer the letter. But when he opened it, it was evident that to answer it he needed something more than goodwill, ink and paper. But he stuck to his resolution: he asked for money from his employees, he himself gave part of his salary, and several friends of his were obliged to give something 'for an act of charity'.
>
> *(A Letter to God)*

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1

The postmaster stopped laughing and turned serious almost immediately because he _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1

'He stuck to his resolution' means that the postmaster _____.

A. gave up the idea when it proved costly

B. remained firm in his decision to answer the letter

C. asked the writer of the letter to wait for a reply

D. reported the letter to his seniors

III The postmaster needed 'something more than goodwill, ink and paper' to answer the letter. What did he need, and what does his effort to arrange it reveal about him? 2

IV Fill in the blank with the correct option from the bracket. 1

The word 'obliged' suggests that the postmaster's friends gave money out of _____. (a sense of duty / an expectation of reward)

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A

> All night the roots work
> to disengage themselves from the cracks
> in the veranda floor.
> The leaves strain toward the glass
> small twigs stiff with exertion
> long-cramped boughs shuffling under the roof

like newly discharged patients
half-dazed, moving
to the clinic doors.

(The Trees)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The phrase ‘stiff with exertion’ suggests that the small twigs are _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
The simile ‘like newly discharged patients’ compares the boughs to people who are _____.

A. weak and dazed but eager to leave their confinement
B. angry and ready to fight
C. happy to remain indoors
D. fully healed and full of energy

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The roots working ‘all night’ to free themselves from the cracks in the floor show the trees’ strong _____ for freedom.

IV How does the poet use images of effort and struggle in these lines to convey the idea that the trees have been imprisoned? **2**

OR

B

The fog comes
on little cat feet.
It sits looking
over harbour and city
on silent haunches
and then moves on.

(Fog)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The poet compares the arrival of the fog to a cat mainly because both _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
The lines ‘It sits looking / over harbour and city’ suggest that the fog _____.

A. destroys the harbour and the city
B. spreads calmly over and covers the whole area
C. is afraid of the busy harbour
D. moves fast and noisily through the streets

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The poem has no regular rhyme or rhythm; it is written in _____ verse.

IV What does the phrase ‘and then moves on’ suggest about the nature of fog, and how does it complete the image of the cat? **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. **4x3=12**

I Mandela says that he learned that courage was not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it. How does his own struggle illustrate this idea? **3**

(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

II The narrator never finds out who the pilot of the black aeroplane was. How does this unanswered question add to the effect of the story? **3**

(Two Stories about Flying – The Black Aeroplane)

III How does the poet contrast the tiger's life in the cage with the life he should be living in the wild? **3**

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

IV How did the Buddha help Kisa Gotami understand the truth about life and death without directly telling her? **3**

(The Sermon at Benares)

V What does the old religious man's 'text' suggest about the difference between human love and divine love? **3**

(For Anne Gregory)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3 =6**

I Who, in your opinion, was really responsible for Tricki's illness — Tricki or Mrs Pumphrey? Justify your answer. **3**

(A Triumph of Surgery)

II Anil knew that Hari Singh had stolen his money, yet he said nothing and offered to teach him whole sentences. What does this reveal about Anil? **3**

(The Thief's Story)

III How did Ausable's presence of mind, rather than his strength, help him get rid of Max? **3**

(The Midnight Visitor)

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Anne turned Mr Keesing's punishment into a personal triumph. How does the 'chatterbox' episode reveal her wit, confidence and maturity, and what does it show about Mr Keesing?

(From the Diary of Anne Frank)

OR

B. Valli's bus ride is a journey from childish excitement to a first glimpse of the seriousness of life. Discuss with reference to the dead cow she sees on her way back.

(Madam Rides the Bus)

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Horace Danby thought of himself as a clever and respectable man, yet he was completely outwitted. How does the story show that there is 'no honour among thieves'?

(A Question of Trust)

OR

B. Griffin's invisibility, which he thought would give him great power, brought him nothing but trouble. Discuss with reference to his adventures in London and Iping.

(Footprints without Feet)

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SAMPLE PAPER 14

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 14 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) Walk into any shopping mall or scroll through a shopping app, and you will find racks of trendy clothes priced lower than a family dinner. New designs seem to appear every week, and a T-shirt can cost less than a sandwich. This is 'fast fashion' — clothing designed, produced and sold at lightning speed to keep up with the latest trends. It looks like a bargain. But is it really as cheap as the price tag suggests?

(2) The true cost of fast fashion is paid elsewhere. Producing a single cotton T-shirt can require about 2,700 litres of water — roughly what one person drinks in two and a half years. Much of today's clothing is made from polyester, a fabric derived from petroleum, which sheds tiny plastic threads called microfibres* every time it is washed. These fibres travel through drains into rivers and oceans, where they are swallowed by fish and eventually find their way back to our plates. The fashion industry is also estimated to be responsible for nearly a tenth of the world's carbon emissions.

(3) There is a human cost too. To keep prices low, many brands rely on factories where workers, often young women, stitch garments for long hours at very low wages. In 2013, the collapse of the Rana Plaza factory building in Bangladesh killed more than 1,100 garment workers. Tragedies like this remind us that someone, somewhere, pays for our cheap clothes.

(4) Perhaps the most troubling part is how quickly we throw clothes away. Many garments are worn only a handful of times before being discarded. Clever advertising and 'limited-time' sales persuade us that what we bought last month is already out of style. As a result, mountains of textile waste pile up in landfills, where synthetic fabrics can take up to two hundred years to decompose.

(5) Does this mean we must stop buying clothes altogether? Not at all. Small changes can make a real difference. We can buy fewer but better-quality clothes, repair torn garments

instead of replacing them, swap outfits with friends, or shop at thrift stores. Our grandparents turned old saris into quilts and worn-out shirts into dusters; perhaps we have something to learn from them.

(6) Ultimately, every purchase is a vote for the kind of world we want. Fashion should be about expressing who we are, not about chasing every passing trend at the expense of the planet and the people who make our clothes. The next time a 'super sale' tempts you, pause and ask yourself: do I really need this?

*microfibres: tiny plastic threads, less than 5 mm long, released from synthetic fabrics

Created for academic usage / 421 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'at lightning speed' suggest about the way fast fashion is produced? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says, 'The true cost of fast fashion is paid elsewhere', he refers to _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) the harm caused to the environment, such as heavy water use and pollution, which is not reflected in the low price.

(b) the extra amount that shoppers pay when they buy clothes from foreign brands in other countries.

III The writer says that microfibres 'find their way back to our plates' (paragraph 2). Which of the following best explains this? **1**

A. Fish are packed and sold in polyester bags.
B. People eat fish that have swallowed plastic fibres from the water.
C. Washing machines release fibres directly into kitchen sinks.
D. Polyester is widely used to make plates and cutlery.

IV In paragraph 3, the writer refers to the Rana Plaza tragedy. What does this reference reveal about the writer's view of the link between shoppers and garment workers? **2**

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (paragraph 4) **1**
According to the writer, most fast fashion garments are thrown away because they wear out quickly.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
discarded garments : landfills :: _____ : _____

(a) old saris : quilts

(b) polyester : petroleum

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) The Rana Plaza factory building collapsed in Bangladesh in 2013.
(ii) Polyester is a fabric derived from petroleum.
(iii) Fashion should be about expressing who we are.
(iv) We have something to learn from the way our grandparents reused clothes.
(v) Every purchase is a vote for the kind of world we want.

A. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O
B. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) O
C. (i) O (ii) F (iii) O (iv) F (v) F
D. (i) F (ii) F (iii) F (iv) O (v) F

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in ending the passage with the question, 'do I really need this?' **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) A recent survey of 1,200 students aged 13 to 17 across six Indian cities set out to understand how teenagers manage their pocket money. It found that 78% of the

respondents receive a regular allowance from their parents, the average amount being Rs 1,150 a month.

(2) Food and snacks remain the biggest expense, accounting for 32% of an average teenager's monthly spending. Mobile recharges and online subscriptions come next at 21%, followed by clothes and accessories at 15%. Stationery and books claim 12%, while outings and entertainment take up 11%. Only 9% of the money is saved.

(3) The survey also revealed a gap between intention and practice. While 64% of the teenagers said that saving money was 'very important', fewer than one in four (23%) actually kept a written or digital record of what they spent. Students who tracked their expenses were found to save nearly twice as much as those who did not.

(4) Experts believe that pocket money can be a powerful tool for financial learning. When young people are allowed to make small choices — and occasional mistakes — with their own money, they develop budgeting skills that last a lifetime. Some schools have now started short 'money management' workshops to help students plan their spending wisely.

How an average teenager uses monthly pocket money	Share (%)
Food and snacks	32
Mobile recharges and online subscriptions	21
Clothes and accessories	15
Stationery and books	12
Outings and entertainment	11
Savings	9

Created for academic usage / 209 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The word 'allowance' as used in paragraph 1 refers to _____.
(a fixed sum of money given regularly / permission to do something)

II What does the fact that 78% of the respondents receive a regular allowance suggest about the attitude of their parents? (paragraph 1) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Food and snacks form the largest share of teenagers' monthly spending.
Reason: Teenagers who keep a record of their expenses save nearly twice as much as those who do not.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.

B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.

C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.

D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following are true according to the passage and the table EXCEPT—

A. Teenagers spend a larger share on mobile recharges and subscriptions than on clothes and accessories.

B. Outings and entertainment take up a smaller share than stationery and books.

C. Savings make up nearly one-third of an average teenager's monthly pocket money.

D. Fewer than a quarter of the respondents keep a record of their spending.

V Compare the percentage of teenagers who consider saving 'very important' (64%) with the share of pocket money actually saved (9%). What might this suggest about teenagers' money habits? (paragraphs 2 and 3) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (paragraph 3) **1**
Students who kept a record of their expenses probably saved more because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 4 which indicates that the money skills learnt as a teenager remain useful throughout one's life. **1**

VIII Riya, a student of Class IX, spends most of her pocket money in the first week of every month and has nothing left by the middle of the month. Which suggestion from the passage would help her the most, and why? (paragraphs 3 and 4) **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Small Change, Big Lessons' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of a formal email from an online store: **1**
Dear Mr. Rao,
We regret to inform you that the parcel you ordered on our website _____ due to heavy rain in your region.
A. has been delayed B. had delayed C. has delaying D. delays

II Report the coach's command. **1**
Coach: "Do not leave the ground before the practice session ends."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the school notice: **1**
NOTICE
_____ student of Class X must submit the signed consent form for the educational trip by Monday.
A. All B. Every C. Few D. Many

IV Read Arjun's statement to the school librarian: **1**
"I returned the book last Tuesday, but my library card still shows it as pending."
Report Arjun's statement by completing the following sentence:
Arjun told the librarian that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a newspaper report: **1**
The number of visitors to the city museum have increased sharply this year.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from a hospital notice: **1**
Visitors _____ not use mobile phones inside the Intensive Care Unit.
A. need B. must C. would D. might

VII The given sentence from a school magazine has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

She is one of the most talented singer in our school choir.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	is	are
B.	most	more
C.	singer	singers
D.	in	at

VIII Kabir's mother asked him the following question: **1**

"Where have you kept your school bag?"

Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.

Kabir's mother asked him _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank. **1**

Please add _____ sugar to my tea; I like it only slightly sweet.

A. a little B. little C. a few D. many

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the following line from a school blog: **1**

Our school annual function has been held last Saturday in the new auditorium.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the announcement on a flight by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**

Passengers _____ fasten their seat belts when the seat-belt sign is switched on. (may / must)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a travel diary. **1**

By the time we reached the railway station, the train _____ (leave).

WRITING

NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Tanvi Saxena, a resident of Rose Garden Enclave, Jaipur. The road leading from your colony to the nearby school is full of potholes and most of its streetlights have not worked for weeks, which has led to a few minor accidents. Write a letter to the Executive Engineer, Municipal Corporation, Jaipur in 120 words, complaining about the condition of the road and requesting urgent repairs. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Aditya Kulkarni, a resident of Shanti Kunj Housing Society, Nashik. Every monsoon a large amount of rainwater from the rooftops of your society drains away, while in summer the residents depend on expensive water tankers. Write a letter in 120 words to the Secretary of the Resident Welfare Association, proposing that a rainwater-harvesting system be installed in the society. Explain its benefits and suggest how the cost could be shared. **5**

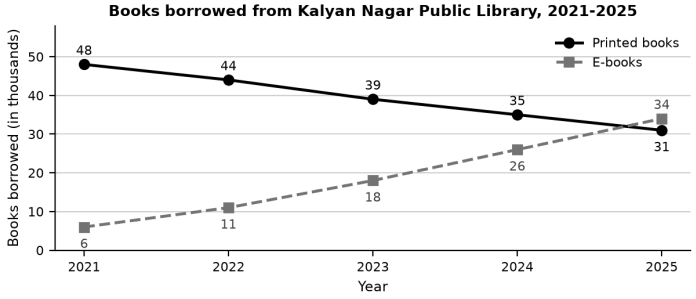
5 A. Read the product details mentioned on an e-commerce website for a fitness band designed for teenagers. **5**

- Tracks daily steps, distance walked and calories burnt
- Heart-rate monitor with an alert if the rate stays unusually high
- Sleep tracker that shows hours of deep and light sleep
- 'Screen-break' reminder after every 45 minutes of sitting
- Water-resistant and sweat-proof; can be worn while swimming
- Battery lasts up to 7 days on a single charge
- Lightweight (22 g) with a soft, skin-friendly strap
- Price: ₹2,499 with a 1-year warranty

Now, analyse why this fitness band would be a good purchase for teenagers. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, considering factors such as health monitoring, healthy study habits, durability, convenience and value for money.

OR

5 B. The line graph below shows the number of printed books and e-books borrowed from Kalyan Nagar Public Library from 2021 to 2025. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, describing the changes in reading habits shown in the graph. **5**



SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A

It is from these comrades in the struggle that I learned the meaning of courage. Time and again, I have seen men and women risk and give their lives for an idea. I have seen men stand up to attacks and torture without breaking, showing a strength and resilience that defies the imagination. I learned that courage was not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it. The brave man is not he who does not feel afraid, but he who conquers that fear.

No one is born hating another person because of the colour of his skin, or his background, or his religion. People must learn to hate, and if they can learn to hate, they can be taught to love, for love comes more naturally to the human heart than its opposite. Even in the grimmest times in prison, when my comrades and I were pushed to our limits, I would see a glimmer of humanity in one of the guards, perhaps just for a second, but it was enough to reassure me and keep me going. Man's goodness is a flame that can be hidden but never extinguished.

(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

I Which of the following best explains what Mandela means by 'a strength and resilience that defies the imagination'? **1**

(a) an ability to bear suffering without losing courage, so great that it is almost impossible to imagine

(b) a physical strength that helped the freedom fighters defeat their attackers in open combat

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
According to Mandela, a brave man is one who _____.

A. never feels afraid
B. conquers his fear
C. avoids dangerous situations
D. hides his fear from others

III Complete the following suitably. 1
Mandela is hopeful that people can be taught to love because _____.

IV 'Man's goodness is a flame that can be hidden but never extinguished.' Explain this metaphor and what it reveals about Mandela's outlook on life. 2

OR

B

Paris was about 150 kilometres behind me when I saw the clouds. Storm clouds. They were huge. They looked like black mountains standing in front of me across the sky. I knew I could not fly up and over them, and I did not have enough fuel to fly around them to the north or south.
"I ought to go back to Paris," I thought, but I wanted to get home. I wanted that breakfast.
'I'll take the risk,' I thought, and flew that old Dakota straight into the storm.
Inside the clouds, everything was suddenly black. It was impossible to see anything outside the aeroplane. The old aeroplane jumped and twisted in the air.
(Two Stories about Flying – The Black Aeroplane)

I Which of the following statements best describes the narrator's decision in the extract? 1

(a) He takes a hasty risk, driven mainly by his strong wish to reach home and have breakfast.
(b) He takes a carefully planned risk after checking the weather report with Paris Control.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1
The storm clouds are compared to 'black mountains' to show that they were _____.

A. beautiful and inviting
B. huge and impossible to fly over
C. far away and harmless
D. moving quickly towards Paris

III Complete the following suitably. 1
The narrator could not fly around the storm clouds to the north or south because _____.

IV How do the lines 'I ought to go back to Paris' and 'I'll take the risk' reveal the narrator's inner conflict and build suspense in the extract? 2

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A.

But up jumped Custard, snorting like an engine,
Clashed his tail like irons in a dungeon,
With a clatter and a clank and a jangling squirm,
He went at the pirate like a robin at a worm.

The pirate gaped at Belinda's dragon,
And gulped some grog from his pocket flagon,
He fired two bullets, but they didn't hit,
And Custard gobbled him, every bit.

(The Tale of Custard the Dragon)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1
The simile 'like a robin at a worm' suggests that Custard attacked the pirate _____.

II Choose the correct option to identify the poetic device used in the line, 'With a clatter and a clank and a jangling squirm'. 1

A. Personification B. Onomatopoeia C. Metaphor D. Oxymoron

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1

Custard's bold action in these lines is ironic, because the others had always mocked him as a _____.

IV How does the poet create humour in describing the pirate's defeat in these lines? 2

OR

B.

"But I can get a hair-dye
And set such colour there,
Brown, or black, or carrot,
That young men in despair
May love me for myself alone
And not my yellow hair."

"I heard an old religious man
But yesternight declare
That he had found a text to prove
That only God, my dear,
Could love you for yourself alone
And not your yellow hair."

(For Anne Gregory)

I Complete the sentence suitably. 1

The young woman wants to change the colour of her hair because she wishes to _____.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. 1

The reference to the 'old religious man' in the second stanza of the extract is meant to _____.

A. prove that the young woman's plan to dye her hair will succeed
B. suggest that only God can love a person for their inner self alone
C. show that the speaker has lost faith in religion
D. advise the young woman to cut off her yellow hair

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1

By listing 'Brown, or black, or carrot', the young woman shows that she regards hair colour as a/an _____ feature that can easily be changed.

IV How does the refrain '… for myself alone / And not my yellow hair', repeated with slight changes at the end of each stanza, strengthen the central idea of the poem? 2

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. 4x3=12

I Lencho has unshakeable faith in God but calls the post office employees 'a bunch of crooks'. What does this contrast reveal about his character? 3

(A Letter to God)

II Anne Frank writes that 'paper has more patience than people'. What does this reveal about her feelings and her reason for keeping a diary? 3

(From the Diary of Anne Frank)

III How does the poet use the contrast between the tiger's life in the cage and its life in the wild to convey his message? **3**

(A Tiger in the Zoo)

IV How did the Buddha help Kisa Gotami understand that death is common to all? Why was his method more effective than simply telling her so? **3**

(The Sermon at Benares)

V How does the poet link human emotions to the possible end of the world in the poem? **3**

(Fire and Ice)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. **2x3 =6**

I Ausable did not look like the secret agent Fowler had imagined, yet he proved far smarter than Max. How did he use his presence of mind to get rid of Max without any violence? **3**

(The Midnight Visitor)

II Griffin was a brilliant scientist but a lawless man. How does the story show that a great discovery can be misused? **3**

(Footprints without Feet)

III Horace Danby, a clever and experienced thief, was himself tricked by a lady. How did she make him open the safe for her? **3**

(A Question of Trust)

10. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. 'The Proposal' is a humorous satire on marriage among the wealthy landowners of Russia. Discuss how the quarrels between Lomov and Natalya over the Oxen Meadows and their dogs show that property and pride matter more to them than love.

OR

B. Through the figure of the baker, the writer of 'A Baker from Goa' celebrates the place of tradition in Goan village life. Explain how the baker, or pader, continues to be an important part of the social life of the village.

(Glimpses of India)

11. Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Richard Ebright's success shows that a scientist is made not only by a brilliant mind but also by curiosity, hard work and the right encouragement. Draw a character sketch of Richard Ebright, bringing out the qualities that helped him become a scientist.

(The Making of a Scientist)

OR

B. Matilda Loisel lost ten years of her life to pay for a single evening of borrowed glory. Discuss how her pride and her dissatisfaction with her life led to her suffering, and what the story teaches us about honesty.

(The Necklace)

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SAMPLE PAPER 15

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 15 · CLASS-X (2026-27)

Time allowed: 3 Hrs. **Maximum Marks: 80**

Marks Distribution (CBSE 2026-27)

Section	Questions	Marks
A: Reading Skills	Q1 Discursive passage (10) + Q2 Case-based passage (10)	20
B: Grammar and Creative Writing	Q3 Grammar (any 10 of 12 × 1 = 10) + Q4 Letter (5) + Q5 Analytical Paragraph (5)	20
C: Literature Textbook	Q6 Prose extract (5) + Q7 Poetry extract (5) + Q8 Short answers (4×3 = 12) + Q9 Footprints short answers (2×3 = 6) + Q10 Long answer (6) + Q11 Long answer (6)	40
Total	**11 questions**	**80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
   Section – A: Reading Skills
   Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) There is a quiet ritual that many successful people swear by, and it requires nothing more than a notebook, a pen and ten minutes of honesty. Journaling, the simple habit of writing down one's thoughts, feelings and experiences, has been practised for centuries by explorers, scientists, writers and ordinary people alike. Yet in an age of instant messages and endless scrolling, the idea of sitting alone with a blank page can seem old-fashioned, even a little odd. Why, then, are so many young people rediscovering it?

(2) Part of the answer lies in the noise of modern life. Our days are crowded with notifications, deadlines and opinions, most of which belong to other people. A journal is one of the few places where we hear our own voice clearly. When we write about a difficult day, we are forced to slow down, choose our words and arrange events in order. This act of organising turns a tangled knot of worry into something we can examine and, very often, something we can solve.

(3) Psychologists have studied this effect for decades. Their research suggests that expressive writing*, done for fifteen to twenty minutes on a few consecutive days, can reduce stress and improve mood. Students who write about their anxieties before an examination often perform better, perhaps because the fears that were occupying their minds have been 'parked' on paper. The page, it seems, can hold what the mind struggles to carry.

(4) Reflective writing does something more than calm us down; it helps us learn. A student who notes not only what went wrong in a test but why it went wrong begins to see patterns—a habit of rushing, a topic avoided, a night of poor sleep. Over weeks, the journal becomes a mirror that shows us who we are becoming, not just who we were on a single bad afternoon.

(5) Of course, journaling is not a magic cure. Some people find it difficult to begin, and others give up because they believe they must write beautifully or every single day. Neither is true. A journal is not a

performance for an audience; spelling mistakes and half-finished sentences are perfectly welcome. Even three lines written before bed—one thing that happened, one thing felt, one thing learnt—can build the habit.

(6) Ultimately, a journal is a conversation with oneself that no one else needs to overhear. In a world that constantly asks us to share, post and respond, choosing to write privately is a small act of independence. It reminds us that our thoughts are worth recording, and that the most important audience for our story may be ourselves.

*expressive writing: writing freely about one's thoughts and feelings, without worrying about style or correctness

Created for academic usage / 438 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'swear by' suggest about the attitude of successful people towards journaling? **1**

II Complete the following with the correct option from the two given. **1**
When the writer says, 'A journal is one of the few places where we hear our own voice clearly', he means that _____. (paragraph 2)

(a) a journal offers a space, free from the opinions of others, where one's own thoughts become clear.

(b) people should read their journals aloud in order to understand themselves better.

III The writer says that fears can be 'parked' on paper (paragraph 3). **1**
Which of the following best illustrates this idea?

A. A student who rewrites her class notes neatly the night before a test

B. A student who lists her worries about the examination on a page before entering the hall

C. A student who posts about her examination stress on social media

D. A student who memorises formulae on the way to school

IV In paragraph 4, the writer calls the journal 'a mirror that shows us who we are becoming'. **2**
What does this comparison reveal about the writer's view of reflective writing as a tool for self-improvement?

V Identify whether the following statement is True or False. (Paragraph 5) **1**
According to the writer, a journal must be written neatly and every day to be of any real benefit.

VI Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two correct options (a) or (b). **1**
expressive writing : reduced stress :: _____ : _____

(a) reflective writing : learning from patterns

(b) blank page : old-fashioned habit

VII Read the statements (i–v) given below and select the option that correctly classifies them as Facts (F) or Opinions (O). **1**
(i) Journaling has been practised for centuries by many kinds of people.
(ii) Research suggests that expressive writing for fifteen to twenty minutes on a few consecutive days can reduce stress.
(iii) Choosing to write privately is a small act of independence.
(iv) Sitting alone with a blank page is an old-fashioned and odd activity.
(v) The most important audience for our story may be ourselves.

A. (i) F (ii) O (iii) O (iv) F (v) O
B. (i) O (ii) F (iii) F (iv) O (v) O
C. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) O (v) O
D. (i) F (ii) F (iii) O (iv) F (v) F

VIII What might be the writer's purpose in addressing common misconceptions about journaling in paragraph 5? **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

(1) India's heritage sites are drawing crowds again. After the sharp fall of the pandemic years, footfall at protected monuments has climbed steadily, and domestic travellers now account for nearly nine out of every ten visitors. For many families, a weekend trip to a fort or a temple has become as common as a visit to a shopping mall.

(2) The table below shows visitor numbers at five well-known sites. The Taj Mahal remains the most visited monument by a wide margin, but its growth has been modest. In contrast, smaller sites such as Hampi have grown much faster, suggesting that travellers are increasingly willing to look beyond the familiar tourist circuit.

Visitors at five heritage sites

Heritage site	2022-23 (in lakh)	2023-24 (in lakh)	Change
Taj Mahal, Agra	62.4	68.1	+9%
Red Fort, Delhi	25.6	28.2	+10%
Qutub Minar, Delhi	24.8	30.0	+21%
Sun Temple, Konark	22.5	25.9	+15%
Group of Monuments, Hampi	7.9	10.3	+30%

(Figures are indicative and created for academic usage.)

(3) Several factors explain the trend. Better highways and new regional airports have shortened travel times, while photographs and short videos shared on social media have turned lesser-known monuments into must-see destinations. Online ticketing has also made visits easier: the share of tickets booked online rose from about 40 per cent to 58 per cent in a single year, sparing visitors long queues at the gate.

(4) This popularity brings pressures. Crowding, littering and the constant touch of thousands of hands cause wear on ancient stone and painted surfaces. To protect these treasures, site managers are experimenting with timed entry slots, daily visitor caps and trained local guides who explain why fragile walls must not be touched. Heritage, after all, can be enjoyed by future generations only if it is respected today.

Created for academic usage / 241 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I Complete the sentence by selecting the correct option from those given in the bracket. **1**
The word 'footfall' as used in paragraph 1 refers to the _____.
(number of people visiting a place / damage caused to a place by walking)

II What does the fact that domestic travellers make up nearly nine out of every ten visitors suggest about Indians' interest in their own heritage? (Paragraph 1) **1**

III Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. **1**
Assertion: Hampi recorded the highest percentage growth in visitors among the five sites.
Reason: Hampi received the largest number of visitors in 2023-24.

A. Both assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation.
B. Both are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation.
C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

IV Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
All of the following can be concluded from the table EXCEPT—

A. Every one of the five sites recorded an increase in visitors.

B. Qutub Minar received more visitors than the Red Fort in 2023-24.

C. The number of visitors at the Sun Temple rose by more than three lakh.

D. The Taj Mahal received more visitors in 2023-24 than the other four sites put together.

V Compare the growth in visitors at the Taj Mahal with that at Hampi. What might this suggest about the changing choices of travellers? (Paragraph 2 and table) **2**

VI Complete the sentence suitably. (Paragraph 3) **1**
Online ticketing has made visits to heritage sites easier because _____.

VII Identify the phrase from paragraph 4 that indicates that monuments are slowly being damaged by heavy use. **1**

VIII The manager of a popular fort finds that it becomes dangerously overcrowded every Sunday. Suggest one step from paragraph 4 that she could take, and say how it would help. **1**

IX Suggest one reason why the title, 'Heritage on the Move: Monuments Draw New Crowds' is a suitable title for the passage. **1**

SECTION B WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR 20 marks

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of the twelve following tasks, as directed. **10**

I Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of a formal email: **1**
Dear Mr Rao,
We are pleased to inform you that your request for a duplicate library card _____, and the card will be ready for collection on Monday.

A. has been approved B. had approved C. is approving D. approves

II Report the coach's instruction to the players. **1**
Coach: "Warm up properly before every match."

III Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the notice displayed at a museum: **1**
Notice for Visitors
_____ visitor must carry a valid photo identity card and show it at the entry gate.

A. All B. Every C. Many D. Few

IV Read Arjun's statement to his mother: **1**
"I have finished my science project and will submit it tomorrow."
Report Arjun's statement by completing the following sentence:
Arjun told his mother that _____.

V Identify and correct the error in the given line from a school newsletter: **1**
The number of students opting for skill-based subjects have increased this year.

Error	Correction

VI Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from the examination guidelines: **1**

Candidates _____ not carry mobile phones or smart watches into the examination hall.

A. need B. must C. would D. might

VII The given sentence from a student's blog has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

I have been living in this city since five years.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	have	has
B.	living	lived
C.	since	for
D.	this	that

VIII The class teacher asked Riya the following question: **1**

"Why did you not submit your assignment on time?"

Report it correctly to complete the following sentence.

The class teacher asked Riya _____.

IX Choose the correct option to fill in the blank in this message from a cinema's booking app. **1**

Hurry! There are only _____ seats left for the evening show.

A. little B. a few C. much D. a little

X Identify the error and suggest the correction in the following line from a travel diary. **1**

When we reached the railway station, the train already left the platform.

Error	Correction

XI Fill in the blank to complete the weather update by choosing the correct option from those given in brackets. **1**

The sky is cloudy, and it _____ rain later today, so carry an umbrella. (may / must)

XII Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets, from a newspaper report. **1**

The new metro line _____ (inaugurate) by the Chief Minister last Sunday.

WRITING

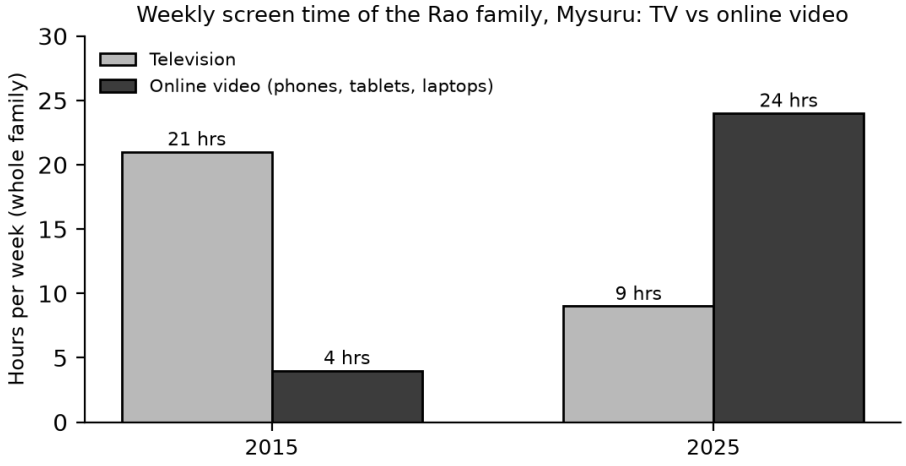
NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A. You are Arnav Sethi, a resident of 22, Shanti Nagar, Nagpur. The school buses that run on Route 7 between Wardha Road and Sitabuldi are often overcrowded, with students standing in the aisles and on the footboard, and they rarely keep to their timings. Write a letter in about 120 words to the Regional Transport Officer, Nagpur, complaining about the problem, its risks for students' safety and punctuality, and suggesting measures that the department could take. **5**

OR

4 B. You are Ishita Bose, a student of Class X, living at 9, Park Lane, Kolkata. You saw an advertisement for a four-week summer course in creative writing offered by Northfield University, Shimla. Write a letter in about 120 words to the Director, Summer School Programmes, Northfield University, enquiring about the eligibility, course content, dates, fees, accommodation and the procedure for applying. **5**

5 A. The bar graph given below shows the number of hours per week that the Rao family of Mysuru spent watching television and watching online video in 2015 and in 2025. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, analysing the changes shown, the possible reasons for them and their likely effects on family life. **5**



OR

5 B. Your school magazine has invited articles on the theme 'Online Classes: Advantages and Challenges'. Using the cues given below, write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words, weighing the benefits of online classes against their difficulties, and conclude with your view on how they can best be used. **5**

Advantages

– Learning from home; no travel time
– Recorded lectures can be replayed for revision
– Access to expert teachers from anywhere
– Builds digital and self-study skills

Challenges

– Weak internet and lack of devices in many homes
– Screen fatigue and eye strain
– Less interaction with teachers and classmates
– Distractions at home; needs self-discipline

SECTION C LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A.

However, during the third lesson he'd finally had enough. "Anne Frank, as punishment for talking in class, write an essay entitled — 'Quack, Quack, Quack, Said Mistress Chatterbox'." The class roared. I had to laugh too, though I'd nearly exhausted my ingenuity on the topic of chatterboxes. It was time to come up with something else, something original. My friend, Sanne, who's good at poetry, offered to help me write the essay from beginning to end in verse and I jumped for joy. Mr Keesing was trying to play a joke on me with this ridiculous subject, but I'd make sure the joke was on him.

I finished my poem, and it was beautiful! It was about a mother duck and a father swan with three baby ducklings who were bitten to death by the father because they quacked too much. Luckily, Mr Keesing took the joke the right way. He read the poem to the class, adding his own comments, and to several other classes as well. (From the Diary of Anne Frank)

I Which of the following statements best explains why 'the class roared'? **1**

(a) The students found the title of the essay that Mr Keesing assigned amusing and absurd.

(b) The students were angry with Mr Keesing for punishing Anne unfairly once again.

II Anne's resolve that she would 'make sure the joke was on him' reveals her _____. **1**

A. resentment towards her teacher B. wit and self-confidence

C. fear of further punishment D. complete dependence on her friend

III Complete the following suitably. **1**

Mr Keesing's reading the poem aloud to several other classes shows that he _____.

IV How does Anne's poem about the mother duck, the father swan and the ducklings turn Mr Keesing's punishment into a victory for her? **2**

OR

B.

Coorgi homes have a tradition of hospitality, and they are more than willing to recount numerous tales of valour related to their sons and fathers. The Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated in the Indian Army, and the first Chief of the Indian Army, General Cariappa, was a Coorgi. Even now, Kodavus are the only people in India permitted to carry firearms without a licence.

The river, Kaveri, obtains its water from the hills and forests of Coorg. Mahaseer — a large freshwater fish — abound in these waters. Kingfishers dive for their catch, while squirrels and langurs drop partially eaten fruit for the mischief of enjoying the splash and the ripple effect in the clear water. Elephants enjoy being bathed and scrubbed in the river by their mahouts.

(Glimpses of India – Coorg)

I Fill in the blank with the correct option from the bracket. **1**

The 'tales of valour' that Coorgi families recount reflect their _____.

(pride in their martial tradition / distrust of visitors)

II Which detail from the extract best shows that the Kodavus enjoy a special status in India? **1**

A. Mahaseer abound in the waters of the Kaveri.

B. They are permitted to carry firearms without a licence.

C. The Kaveri obtains its water from the hills of Coorg.

D. Elephants are bathed by their mahouts in the river.

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**

By saying that squirrels and langurs drop fruit 'for the mischief of enjoying the splash', the writer gives the animals a _____, almost human quality.

IV How does the extract present Coorg as a place where people, animals and nature live in harmony? **2**

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **5**

A.

The way a crow
Shook down on me

The dust of snow
From a hemlock tree

Has given my heart
A change of mood
And saved some part
Of a day I had rued.

(Dust of Snow)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
The dust of snow shaken down by the crow acts as a _____ that changes the poet's state of mind.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
The word 'rued' suggests that the poet's day had been one of _____.

A. regret and sorrow | B. excitement and joy | C. calm and rest | D. anger towards the crow

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The crow and the hemlock tree, usually associated with gloom, ironically become a source of _____ for the poet.

IV How does the poem suggest that a small, unexpected moment in nature can heal a troubled mind? **2**

OR

B.

From what I've tasted of desire
I hold with those who favour fire.
But if it had to perish twice,
I think I know enough of hate
To say that for destruction ice
Is also great
And would suffice.

(Fire and Ice)

I Complete the sentence suitably. **1**
In the extract, 'fire' is linked with _____, while 'ice' is linked with hate.

II Choose the correct option to complete the sentence. **1**
When the poet says, 'I hold with those who favour fire', he means that he _____.

A. agrees with those who believe the world will end in fire
B. prefers warm weather to cold weather
C. rejects every prediction about the end of the world
D. wishes the world would end soon

III Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. **1**
The short, quiet final line 'And would suffice' gives the poem an _____ tone, making a terrible idea sound calm and matter-of-fact.

IV How does the poet's use of personal experience, in phrases such as 'From what I've tasted' and 'I know enough of hate', make his view about the end of the world convincing? **2**

8. Answer any FOUR of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words each. **4x3 =12**

I Mandela says that in South Africa, a man of colour who tried to fulfil his 'twin obligations' was punished and isolated. What were these obligations, and why could he not fulfil both? (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom) **3**

II Why does the pilot decide to fly into the storm clouds instead of returning to Paris? What does the outcome of this decision suggest about the dangers of choices made in haste? (Two Stories about Flying – The Black Aeroplane) **3**

III How does the poet use the contrast between the cage and the jungle to make readers feel the tiger's suffering? (A Tiger in the Zoo) **3**

IV How does the Buddha lead Kisa Gotami to understand the truth about death without directly telling her? (The Sermon at Benares) **3**

V Amanda imagines herself as a mermaid, an orphan and Rapunzel. What does each of these fantasies reveal about her inner longing? (Amanda!) **3**

9. Answer any TWO of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words each. **2x3 =6**

I Griffin's invisibility brought him more trouble than power. Do you agree? Support your answer with two details from the story. (Footprints without Feet) **3**

II How did Richard Ebright's mother help to shape him into a scientist? (The Making of a Scientist) **3**

III Had Matilda told Mme Forestier the truth about the lost necklace, her life would have been very different. Explain. (The Necklace) **3**

10. Answer any ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Lomov comes to Chubukov's house to propose marriage to Natalya, yet the visit turns into two bitter quarrels. Discuss how Chekhov uses these quarrels to make fun of a society in which marriage is treated as a matter of property and convenience rather than love. (The Proposal)

OR

B. Lencho's faith in God is unshakeable, yet he distrusts the very people who help him. Examine the irony at the end of the story and what it reveals about faith and human kindness. (A Letter to God)

11. Answer any ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. **6**

A. Ramlal loves his daughter, yet his decisions about Bholi reflect the attitudes of his society towards girls. Discuss his role in Bholi's life and explain how Bholi's final decision exposes the evils he had accepted. (Bholi)

OR

B. Think-Tank's arrogance, and not the strength of the Earthlings, defeats the Martian invasion. Discuss how his misreading of a book of nursery rhymes saves the Earth, and what the play suggests about the danger of believing oneself to be all-knowing. (The Book That Saved the Earth)

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ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

ANSWER KEY

Sample Paper 11: Answer Key (objective items)

SECTION A: READING

Q1 I	City parks are small, humble patches of nature surrounded by concrete
Q1 II	(a)
Q1 III	A
Q1 IV	Hint: unequal access; planning favours profit/the rich
Q1 V	False
Q1 VI	(a) exhaustion : refreshment
Q1 VII	C
Q1 VIII	Hint: memorable, human image; new measure of progress
Q2 I	new and unfamiliar
Q2 II	Hint: these subjects feel difficult; need extra help
Q2 III	D
Q2 IV	D
Q2 V	Hint: mostly a learning aid, not a shortcut
Q2 VI	Hint: students copied unchecked AI responses
Q2 VII	‘guidance rather than bans’
Q2 VIII	verifying facts
Q2 IX	Hint: shows both benefits and misuse

SECTION B: GRAMMAR (Q3)

Q3 I	A. has been issued
Q3 II	The coach told the players that they had to (must) warm up properly before every match.
Q3 III	B. Each
Q3 IV	he had finished his science project and would submit it the next day.
Q3 V	have → has
Q3 VI	B. must
Q3 VII	C. since → for
Q3 VIII	why he/she had chosen engineering as his/her career.
Q3 IX	B. little
Q3 X	will rain → rains
Q3 XI	may
Q3 XII	had prepared

SECTION C: LITERATURE

Q6 A I	(a)
Q6 A II	B
Q6 A III	Hint: their martial tradition / special status
Q6 A IV	Hint: playful, personified animals; lively scene
Q6 B I	Hint: intelligent and curious
Q6 B II	A
Q6 B III	unexpected
Q6 B IV	Hint: trust and affection; Mij obeys his call
Q7 A I	Hint: wasted / held captive
Q7 A II	B
Q7 A III	freedom
Q7 A IV	Hint: captivity vs freedom of nature
Q7 B I	deadly attack
Q7 B II	A
Q7 B III	Hint: a beginner at identifying animals
Q7 B IV	Hint: irony, wordplay, exaggeration

Q8 I	Hint: unshaken faith; helpers called thieves
Q8 II	Hint: family and nation; apartheid laws
Q8 III	Hint: desire = fire, hatred = ice
Q8 IV	Hint: witty essays; ‘Quack, Quack, Quack’ poem
Q8 V	Hint: mustard seed; death is universal
Q9 I	Hint: books, telescope, microscope; encouraged learning
Q9 II	Hint: threw it down, wept: no dress; discontented, vain. Gave his 400 francs saved for a gun
Q9 III	Hint: pock-marked, slow, no suitor; Bishamber well-off, asked no dowry
Q10	Hint A: land, dogs; marriage as gain. B: nagging vs freedom
Q11	Hint A: proud, insults Noodle; Humpty Dumpty seen as threat to his egg-shaped head; flees. B: overfed; two weeks at surgery, little food, play; sensible love

Writing hints. Q4 A: complaint format; dark roads unsafe, request repair. B: enquiry format; packages, safety, cost per student, early reply. Q5 A: 1080p, wireless, 3 h battery, 850 g, value for schools. B: coal 72→55%, solar 4→18%, wind 6→10%; shift to renewables. Self-assess Q4, Q5 and the 2-mark and long answers against the CBSE marking criteria given with the solved papers.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

ANSWER KEY

Sample Paper 12: Answer Key

CLASS-X (2026-27)

SECTION A: Reading Skills

Q1	Answer / Hint	Q2	Answer / Hint
I	Hint: give up / set aside the home language on entering school	I	households needed the most water
II	(a)	II	Hint: rain watered the plants
III	B	III	B
IV	Hint: confusion read as lack of ability; an early label can follow a child for years	IV	C
V	False	V	Hint: 200 vs 140 litres (60 more); heat, more frequent baths
VI	(a)	VI	Hint: benchmark is 540 litres (135 x 4); 100 litres over
VII	C	VII	simple steps
VIII	Hint: answers objections; balanced, convincing, realistic	VIII	Hint: bucket baths / full-load washing / reuse kitchen water
		IX	Hint: use varies with seasons; saving every drop

SECTION B: Grammar (Q3)

Item	Answer	Item	Answer
I	A. will be opened	VII	A. Does → Do
II	The coach advised/instructed the players not to skip their warm-up exercises before the match.	VIII	whether (if) she had that kurta in a smaller size.
III	B. several	IX	C. little
IV	he had returned the book the previous day, but his library card still showed it as pending.	X	was → were
V	have → has	XI	need not
VI	B. must	XII	had left

SECTION C: Literature (objective items)

Q6 A	Q6 B	Q7 A	Q7 B
I. (a)	I. (a)	I. Hint: frozen with shock / grief	I. Hint: a nagging, controlling parent
II. B	II. B	II. B	II. B
III. Hint: she had seen it run in front of the bus on the way to town	III. understanding	III. childhood	III. Hint: nagging / noise / instructions
IV. Hint: suddenness of death; knowing vs understanding	IV. Hint: learn by her own experience	IV. Hint: money cannot buy back loss; learns to bear it	IV. Hint: real world nags, imagined world free

Value points: Q4, Q5, Q9, Q11 (Q8 and Q10 are marked on content, organisation and accuracy as per CBSE scheme)

Q	Value points / Hint
4 A	Letter to the Editor, correct format. Stray cattle on Bhopal roads; jams, night accidents, harm to animals; suggest shelters, fines on owners, reflective collars, patrols.
4 B	Complaint: order details; purifier failed in ten days; two requests unanswered; ask for replacement or full refund.
5 A	Rise in all groups: 8-11: 2.4 to 3.1 h; 12-14: 3.6 to 4.8 h; 15-17: 4.5 to 6.2 h (highest, steepest rise of 1.7 h). Screen time grows with age; overall upward trend.
5 B	Use all cues: features, costs, student pass, timings, limitation; conclude on usefulness.
9 I	Firm diagnosis (overfeeding, no exercise); keeps Tricki at his surgery, no rich food, exercise; returns him fit; Mrs Pumphrey calls it a triumph of surgery, her feelings spared.
9 II	Home: neglected, mocked, called a simpleton. School: teacher kind, patted her, gave her a book, promised she would speak without stammering; hope and confidence.
9 III	Vain Think-Tank misread Mother Goose (Hey Diddle Diddle, Humpty Dumpty), panicked and called off the invasion; Earth did nothing.
11 A	Hari Singh stole Anil's 600 rupees, let the Lucknow Express go, valued learning and trust, returned; Anil gave him a still-wet fifty-rupee note, said nothing; trust reformed him.
11 B	Ausable: fat, unimpressive but calm, quick-witted, imaginative; balcony story, Henry's knock as 'police'; Max jumps to a non-existent balcony; brains over looks.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

ANSWER KEY

Sample Paper 13: Answer Key (objective items)

CLASS-X (2026-27)

Section A: Reading

Q1 I	Players who do not know each other quickly unite for a common goal (sport builds instant cooperation)
II	(a)
III	B
IV	No one wins alone; success depends on the contribution of every player / teamwork (hint)
V	False
VI	(a) endorphins : better mood
VII	C. (i) F (ii) O (iii) F (iv) O (v) O
VIII	Hint: to leave a lasting message that life lessons matter more than results
Q2 I	managing or getting on
II	The findings are broad-based and reliable / wide public interest
III	C
IV	D (the rock pigeon, +48%, rose most)
V	Hint: generalists rising, specialists declining; cities suit adaptable birds, lack trees, insects, wetlands
VI	they offer no gaps or ledges for nesting
VII	“small, local actions”
VIII	Plant native trees / put up nest boxes / restore a water body
IX	It covers both the decline of species (losses) and the recovery through local action (hope)

Section C: Short-answer hints (Q8–Q11)

Q8 I	fear in prison/underground; acted despite it
Q8 II	mystery, supernatural, reader left wondering
Q8 III	cage: few steps, ignores visitors; wild: hiding in grass, terrorising villages
Q8 IV	mustard seed from a house where none died
Q8 V	only God loves for self, not yellow hair
Q9 I	Mrs Pumphrey’s overfeeding, no exercise
Q9 II	Anil kind, forgiving, trusting; reforms Hari by trust, not punishment
Q9 III	invents balcony; Henry’s knock taken for police; Max jumps out: no balcony
Q10 A	essays & poem; Keesing’s sportsmanship
Q10 B	pity, silence, maturity
Q11 A	tricked by lady in red; fingerprints; jailed
Q11 B	fire, naked in cold, theft, chased, flees Iping

Section B: Grammar (any ten)

Q3 I	A. was scheduled
II	The coach advised/instructed the players to drink plenty of water before the match.
III	B. One
IV	he had completed the project report and would submit it the next day/the following day.
V	have → has
VI	B. must
VII	C. since → for
VIII	if/whether she had packed her bag for the trip.
IX	A. a few
X	live → lives
XI	needn’t
XII	has been working

Section C: Extracts (Q6, Q7)

Q6 A I	(a)
II	B
III	propose marriage to Natalya
IV	Hint: quick contradictions, repetition of ‘ours/mine’, rising tempers over trivial land
Q6 B I	was moved by the writer’s deep faith in God
II	B
III	Hint: money (a hundred pesos); kind, generous, sensitive
IV	a sense of duty
Q7 A I	straining hard to break free
II	A
III	desire / longing / urge
IV	Hint: roots work all night, leaves strain, long-cramped boughs = long confinement
Q7 B I	move silently / quietly
II	B
III	free
IV	Hint: fog is temporary; a cat sits briefly and leaves on its own

Writing hints (Q4, Q5)

Q4 A	Editor; parks lost to parking/buildings; obesity, screen time; protect open spaces
Q4 B	order letter; item table; payment, delivery date, pack glassware
Q5 A	tiffin: insulated, leak-proof, BPA-free, durable, ₹1,199 value
Q5 B	landfill 40% largest; recycled+composted 34%; unmanaged 17%; segregation at source

Writing (Q4, Q5) and long answers (Q10, Q11) are marked for content, organisation and accuracy as per the CBSE marking scheme pattern.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE - Code No. 184

ANSWER KEY

Sample Paper 14: Answer Key (objective items)

CLASS-X (2026-27)

Section A – Q1

Q.	Answer
I	very fast / in a hurry, to keep pace with every new trend
II	(a)
III	B. People eat fish that have swallowed plastic fibres
IV	hint: shoppers share responsibility; cheap prices cost workers' safety and lives
V	False (thrown away because they seem out of style)
VI	(a) old saris : quilts
VII	B
VIII	hint: make readers pause and reflect; mindful buying

Section A – Q2

Q.	Answer
I	a fixed sum of money given regularly
II	hint: parents trust teenagers; encourage independence
III	B
IV	C
V	hint: intention not matched by practice; poor planning
VI	they could see where money went and plan / cut waste
VII	'last a lifetime'
VIII	hint: keep a record of expenses; budgeting
IX	hint: small amounts teach lasting money skills

Section B – Q3 Grammar

Q.	Answer
I	A. has been delayed
II	The coach ordered/told the players not to leave the ground before the practice session ended.
III	B. Every
IV	… he had returned the book the previous Tuesday, but his library card still showed it as pending.
V	have → has
VI	B. must
VII	C. singer → singers
VIII	… where he had kept his school bag.
IX	A. a little
X	has been held → was held
XI	must
XII	had left

Section C – Q6 and Q7

Q.	Answer
6A	I (a); II B; III love comes more naturally to the human heart than hate; IV hint: goodness survives oppression; hope, faith in humanity
6B	I (a); II B; III he did not have enough fuel; IV hint: reason vs desire; reader fears the outcome
7A	I swiftly and easily, as if the pirate were harmless prey; II B; III coward; IV hint: mock-heroic; pirate 'gobbled'
7B	I be loved for herself alone, not for her yellow hair; II B; III superficial / external; IV hint: refrain; inner self vs outward beauty

Hints for Q4 A: formal complaint, potholes, faulty streetlights, accidents, repair request; 4 B: proposal to RWA Secretary, water scarcity, tanker costs, recharge of groundwater, cost-sharing. Q5 A: health tracking, screen-breaks, sleep, 7-day battery, water-resistant, value at ₹2,499; 5 B: printed 48k→31k fall, e-books 6k→34k rise, overtook in 2025. Hints for Q8–Q11 (descriptive): 8 I faith vs distrust, irony; II loneliness, no true friend, 'Kitty'; III cage "stalks" vs jungle freedom; IV mustard seed, every house had lost someone; V fire = desire, ice = hatred. 9 I invented balcony, knock (Henry/police), Max jumps out to a balcony that does not exist; II invisibility used for theft, arson, assault; III posed as owner, forgot combination, jewels for party, gloves/fingerprints. 10 A greed, Chubukov, Guess vs Squeezer; B bread, bol, sweet bread, kabai, jingling bamboo. 11 A curiosity, mother's support, *The Travels of Monarch X*, will to win, viceroy/monarch, science fairs, cell theory; B discontent, borrowed necklace, lost, 36,000 francs, ten years of hardship, false pride vs honesty.

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ANSWER KEY

Sample Paper 15: Answer Key (objective items)

Class X (2026-27) **Hints for short answers in italics**

Item	Answer
1 I	*strong faith/trust in its value; they rely on it*
1 II	(a)
1 III	B
1 IV	*writing helps one notice patterns, grow and improve over time*
1 V	False
1 VI	(a)
1 VII	C
1 VIII	*remove doubts; encourage readers to begin*
2 I	number of people visiting a place
2 II	*strong/renewed interest in own heritage*
2 III	C
2 IV	D
2 V	*Taj +9% (large base) vs Hampi +30%; travellers explore lesser-known sites*
2 VI	*it spares visitors long queues at the gate*
2 VII	wear on ancient stone
2 VIII	*timed entry slots / daily visitor caps; spread or limit crowds*
2 IX	*covers rising footfall and changing choices*

Item	Answer
3 I	A. has been approved
3 II	The coach told/instructed the players to warm up properly before every match.
3 III	B. Every
3 IV	he had finished his science project and would submit it the next day.
3 V	have → has
3 VI	B. must
3 VII	C (since → for)
3 VIII	why she had not submitted her assignment on time.
3 IX	B. a few
3 X	already left → had already left
3 XI	may
3 XII	was inaugurated
6 A	I (a); II B; III *appreciated her wit / took the joke sportingly*; IV *turned the title into clever verse; teacher won over*
6 B	I pride in their martial tradition; II B; III playful; IV *animals at ease, elephants cared for by mahouts*
7 A	I trigger / catalyst; II A; III joy / hope; IV *a trivial act lifts a gloomy mood*
7 B	I desire; II A; III understated / ironic; IV *first-hand knowledge of human emotions*

Hints for Q4–Q5: 4 A: *formal complaint format; overcrowding, footboard travel, late/irregular buses; safety and punctuality; more buses, fixed timetable, checks by inspectors* · 4 B: *formal enquiry format; eligibility, content, dates, fees, hostel, how to apply* · 5 A: *TV 21→9 hrs, online video 4→24 hrs; total 25→33 hrs; smartphones, cheap data, on-demand content; more solitary viewing, less family time* · 5 B: *use all cues; balanced analysis; conclusion: online classes best as a support to classroom learning*

Hints for Q8–Q11: 8 I: *to family and to people; serving people meant leaving family* · 8 II: *wanted home and breakfast; lost in storm, saved by mysterious plane* · 8 III: *stalking in cage vs. lurking in long grass; helpless rage* · 8 IV: *mustard seed from a house where no one died; death common to all* · 8 V: *freedom, solitude, escape from nagging* · 9 I: *naked in the chill January air; followed by boys through his muddy footprints; had to disguise himself with bandages, dark glasses and false nose; suspected of the clergyman's burglary; finally exposed at the Iping inn* · 9 II: *took him on trips; bought telescopes, microscopes, cameras; gave him The Travels of Monarch X; found him learning work every evening* · 9 III: *Mme Forestier's necklace was false (worth at most 500 francs); no 36,000-franc replacement, no ten years of poverty* · 10 A: *Oxen Meadows, Guess and Squeezer; land and dowry over love* · 10 B: *post office employees helped; Lencho calls them crooks* · 11 A: *numberdar sent her to school only to set an example; chose old, lame Bishamber to avoid dowry; placed turban at his feet, paid 5000; Bholi refuses, will teach and care for parents* · 11 B: *Think-Tank's vanity; takes Mother Goose as code (cat and fiddle, cow jumped over the moon); Humpty Dumpty looks like him; orders Mars evacuated to Alpha Centauri*